French, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they are written.

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Preface

This book teaches French one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart — traced back to its root (usually Latin), then forward to the English cousins you already own, so nothing here is a fresh thing to memorize. It is written for someone starting from zero, whose only shared language is English. *jour* ("day") arrives next to *journal* and *journey*; *salut* ("hi") turns out to wish you *health*, like *salute* and *salubrious*.

French has a close sibling in Spanish — both are worn-down Latin — so where a French word and its Spanish cousin descend from one Latin root, the book shows both and dwells on the *difference* between them (why the same *dies* became French *jour* but Spanish *día*; why French keeps *bonjour* singular where Spanish pluralizes *buenos días*). Every such comparison is supplied in full by the text — no prior Spanish is assumed; it is offered as enrichment, and a reader who happens to know Spanish simply nods along.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the French out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind pronunciation. Each lesson names the one or two sounds its own word needs, exactly where they are needed. The whole system is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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134 Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address **951**
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137 To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe **969**
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137.2 visiter . . . 970
137.3 répondre . . . 971
137.4 mettre . . . 971
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138 To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed **975**
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138.2 préférer . . . 976

138.3 espérer 977
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139 Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All 983
139.1 rien 983
139.2 aucun / aucune 984
139.3 non plus 985
139.4 lequel / laquelle 986
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140 Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen 989
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141 The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise 995
141.1 l'avenir 995
141.2 ce soir 996
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142 Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill 1001
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142.3 le loyer 1003
142.4 l'annonce 1004
142.5 la facture 1005
142.6 (dialogue) 1005
142.7 (dialogue) 1006

143 To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout 1007
143.1 allumer 1007
143.2 éteindre 1008
143.3 sauter 1009
143.4 sourire 1009
143.5 crier 1010

144 To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue 1013
144.1 expliquer 1013
144.2 traduire 1014
144.3 décider 1015
144.4 essayer 1015
144.5 continuer 1016

145 To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel 1019
145.1 signer 1019
145.2 remplir un formulaire 1020
145.3 téléphoner 1021
145.4 discuter 1021
145.5 se disputer 1022

146 To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke 1025
146.1 s'ennuyer 1025
146.2 s'amuser 1026
146.3 se fâcher 1027
146.4 s'inquiéter 1027
146.5 fumer 1028

147 To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove 1031
147.1 comparer 1031
147.2 conseiller 1032
147.3 convaincre 1033
147.4 critiquer 1033
147.5 démontrer 1034

148 To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own 1037
148.1 observer . . . 1037
148.2 participer . . . 1038
148.3 se promener . . . 1039
148.4 plier . . . 1039
148.5 posséder . . . 1040

149 To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream 1043
149.1 découvrir . . . 1043
149.2 sembler . . . 1044
149.3 servir . . . 1045
149.4 souffrir . . . 1045
149.5 rêver . . . 1046

150 To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver 1049
150.1 s'éloigner . . . 1049
150.2 s'approcher . . . 1050
150.3 bavarder . . . 1051
150.4 brancher . . . 1051
150.5 livrer . . . 1052

151 To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe 1055
151.1 héberger . . . 1055
151.2 prier . . . 1056
151.3 recommander . . . 1057
151.4 ralentir . . . 1058
151.5 respirer . . . 1058
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151.7 (dialogue) . . . 1060

152 To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower 1063
152.1 admirer . . . 1063
152.2 agir . . . 1064
152.3 avancer . . . 1065
152.4 reculer . . . 1065
152.5 baisser . . . 1066

153 To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed 1069
153.1 remarquer . . . 1069
153.2 remplacer . . . 1070
153.3 rencontrer . . . 1071
153.4 rougir . . . 1071
153.5 saigner . . . 1072

154 Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney 1075
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154.2 le cerveau . . . 1076
154.3 le poumon . . . 1077
154.4 le foie . . . 1077
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155 Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love 1081
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155.2 le sommeil . . . 1082
155.3 le rêve . . . 1083
155.4 l'angoisse . . . 1083
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156 Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still 1087
156.1 rarement . . . 1087
156.2 ensuite . . . 1088
156.3 enfin . . . 1089
156.4 désormais . . . 1089
156.5 encore . . . 1090

157 Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside 1093
157.1 au-dessus . . . 1093
157.2 au-dessous . . . 1094
157.3 devant . . . 1095
157.4 derrière . . . 1095
157.5 à côté . . . 1096

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158.1 donc . . . 1099
158.2 pourtant . . . 1100
158.3 de toute façon . . . 1101
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159.2 inconfortable 1106
159.3 poli / polie 1107
159.4 impoli / impolie 1108
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161.1 moderne 1117
161.2 ancien / ancienne 1118
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162.1 inquiet / inquiète 1123
162.2 enrhumé / enrhumée 1124
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162.4 marié / mariée 1125
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163.2 la salle à manger 1130
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164.1 le passeport 1135
164.2 la douane 1136
164.3 la réservation 1137
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165.2 la paix 1142
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171 Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble 1177
171.1 le volcan 1177
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173 Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory 1189
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174 Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract 1195
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174.2 le collègue 1196
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175 To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park 1201
175.1 embrasser 1201
175.2 saluer 1202
175.3 remercier 1203
175.4 inviter 1203
175.5 garer 1204

176 To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold 1207
176.1 arrêter 1207
176.2 changer 1208
176.3 déplacer 1209
176.4 enlever 1209
176.5 tenir 1210

177 To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue 1213
177.1 promettre 1213
177.2 permettre 1214
177.3 interdire 1215
177.4 protéger 1215
177.5 sauver 1216

178 To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear 1219
178.1 neiger 1219
178.2 accompagner 1220
178.3 ajouter 1221
178.4 annoncer 1221
178.5 apparaître 1222

179 To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn 1225
179.1 dépendre 1225
179.2 partager 1226
179.3 éviter 1227
179.4 lancer 1227
179.5 tourner 1228

180 To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up 1231
180.1 préparer . . . 1231
180.2 présenter . . . 1232
180.3 prêter . . . 1233
180.4 proposer . . . 1233
180.5 ramasser . . . 1234

181 To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake 1237
181.1 ressembler . . . 1237
181.2 pousser . . . 1238
181.3 tirer . . . 1239
181.4 gaspiller . . . 1239
181.5 dépasser . . . 1240

182 To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate 1243
182.1 corriger . . . 1243
182.2 diriger . . . 1244
182.3 détruire . . . 1245
182.4 exagérer . . . 1245
182.5 fêter . . . 1246

183 To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip 1249
183.1 renoncer . . . 1249
183.2 échanger . . . 1250
183.3 télécharger . . . 1251
183.4 skier . . . 1251
183.5 glisser . . . 1252
183.6 (dialogue) . . . 1253
183.7 (dialogue) . . . 1254

184 To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow 1255
184.1 bouger . . . 1255
184.2 cueillir . . . 1256
184.3 défendre . . . 1257
184.4 disparaître . . . 1257
184.5 emprunter . . . 1258

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185.1 le muscle . . . 1261
185.2 le pouce . . . 1262
185.3 la blessure . . . 1263
185.4 la cicatrice . . . 1263
185.5 le rhume . . . 1264

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186.1 l'amitié . . . 1267
186.2 l'espoir . . . 1268
186.3 la confiance . . . 1269
186.4 le courage . . . 1269
186.5 la honte . . . 1270

187 In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since 1273
187.1 alors . . . 1273
187.2 tard . . . 1274
187.3 soudain . . . 1275
187.4 jusqu'à . . . 1275
187.5 depuis . . . 1276

188 Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left 1279
188.1 près de . . . 1279
188.2 loin de . . . 1280
188.3 au fond . . . 1281
188.4 à droite . . . 1281
188.5 à gauche . . . 1282

189 Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really 1285
189.1 malgré . . . 1285
189.2 malheureusement . . . 1286
189.3 heureusement . . . 1287
189.4 certainement . . . 1287
189.5 vraiment . . . 1288

190 Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful 1291
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190.2 sérieux / sérieuse . . . 1292
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190.4 courageux / courageuse 1293
190.5 peureux / peureuse 1294

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191.1 simple 1297
191.2 compliqué / compliquée 1298
191.3 nécessaire 1299
191.4 utile 1299
191.5 inutile 1300

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192.1 cuit / cuite 1303
192.2 mûr / mûre 1304
192.3 sombre 1305
192.4 clair / claire 1305
192.5 lointain / lointaine 1306
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192.7 (dialogue) 1308

193 Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan 1309
193.1 le drap 1309
193.2 le tiroir 1310
193.3 le fauteuil 1311
193.4 la casserole 1311
193.5 la poêle 1312

194 Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito 1315
194.1 la vallée 1315
194.2 la température 1316
194.3 le papillon 1317
194.4 la mouche 1318
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195 Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard 1321
195.1 le dialecte 1321
195.2 la nouvelle 1322
195.3 la publicité 1323
195.4 l'écran 1323
195.5 le clavier 1324

196 Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker 1327
196.1 le boucher . . . 1327
196.2 le mécanicien . . . 1328
196.3 l'électricien . . . 1329
196.4 le plombier . . . 1329
196.5 l'ouvrier . . . 1330

197 Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure 1333
197.1 le marié . . . 1333
197.2 la mariée . . . 1334
197.3 le veuf . . . 1335
197.4 le succès . . . 1335
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198.2 la réduction . . . 1340
198.3 les soldes . . . 1341
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199.1 l'entrée . . . 1345
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199.3 les bagages . . . 1347
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200 Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden 1351
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201 Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame 1357
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203 Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection 1369
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204 Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper 1375
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204.3 l'imprimante 1377
204.4 le téléphone portable 1377
204.5 la feuille de papier 1378
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Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: **voice** (9) **pen** (6) **Hands-free start:** the first of 15 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone in French, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.
>
> *The French greetings, built from their pieces — a word for "good," words for "day," "evening" and "night," and the gender machine that decides their endings. French and Spanish are both daughters of Latin; where a French word and its Spanish cousin split from one Latin root, both appear here, because the difference between them is often the lesson — and the text supplies the Spanish word whether or not you have met it before.*

1.1 salut — "hi," and a wish for your health

Your first French word, and a warmer one than it looks. *Salut* is the casual "hi" — but taken apart, it literally wishes you good health.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the final **t is silent**: *salut* is *sa-LU*, not *sa-LUT*. Most French final consonants go silent. → reference
- `vowel-u` — the **u** is the French front-rounded *ee* (say *ee* with pursed lips), not *oo*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salut — informal "hi" (and "bye"). Root: Latin **salus, salutem** ("health, safety, well-being"). So *salut* is, at root, a wish of *health* — the same instinct as English "cheers" or old "hail" (be healthy). The family you already own in English:

- **salut**e, **salut**ation — a greeting (a wishing-of-health).
- **salut**ary, **salu**brious — health-giving.
- and, from the close cousin *salvus* ("safe"), *save*, *salvation*, *safe*.

Spanish note: its casual "hi" is *hola* — an uncertain, rootless interjection. French *salut* is the opposite: a transparent Latin word meaning "health." Two Romance languages, two totally different casual "hi"s.

Why it's said this way

Salut is strictly **informal** — friends, family, peers — and it doubles as "bye." For anyone you'd show respect to, or a first meeting, you reach past it for the formal greeting (a few lessons on), exactly as Spanish reaches past *hola* for *buenos días*.

Writing — trace the silent t

Keep **salut** visible. Trace only its final **t**, once, then say *sa-LU*: you stop on the **u**, but the page keeps the **t**.

Do not copy the word yet; the next lesson traces all of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "salut" — *sa-LU*, silent *t*
- "salut" then English "salute", "salutary" — the health root

Before you move on

What does *salut* literally wish someone? (Health — from Latin *salus*.) What happens to its final *t*? (Silent.)

1.2 *salut* — let your eye and hand meet one known word

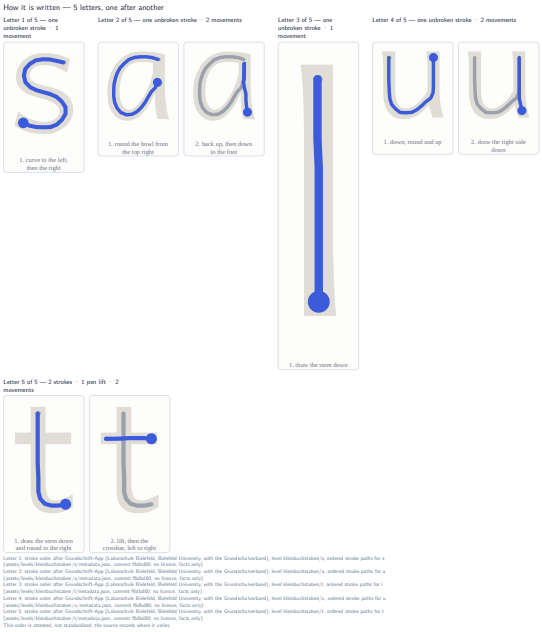
Say the casual greeting you just learned: *salut*, *sa-LU*. Today adds no new French. You will only notice how that familiar word sits on a page.

What you've built — one spelling

s a l u t → salut

The word has five written letters. Your voice finishes on **u**; the final **t** stays visible and silent. Point to each letter from left to right once.

Writing — trace with the model visible



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

Keep **salut** visible. Slowly finger-trace the five letters once, left to right. Then trace the word once in the air. Say *sa-LU* only after your finger reaches the silent **t**.

This is noticing, not a handwriting test. Use the letter forms you normally write; there is no new alphabet and no demand for perfect penmanship.

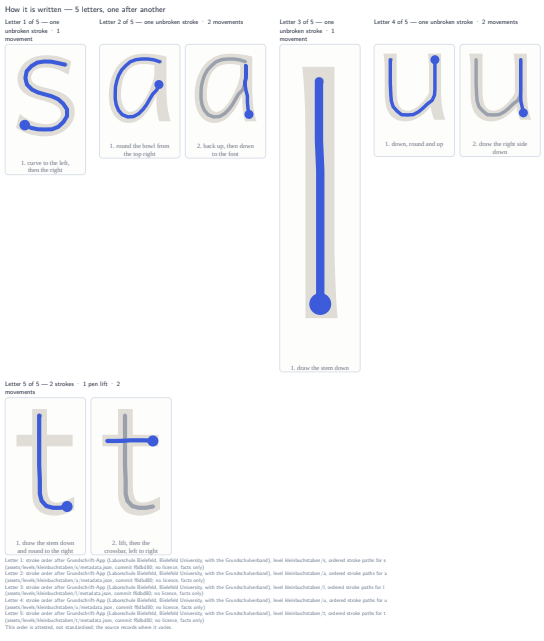
Before you move on

Point to the silent letter. Stop here; copying comes in the next tiny lesson.

1.3 *salut* — one supported copy

Point to the last letter in **salut**. It is written **t** and said as silence. Keep the model on the page for the whole lesson.

Writing — guided copy



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

Copy **salut** once. You may look back after every letter.

When you finish, touch **s-a-l-u-t** in your copy and say *sa-LU*. The eye checks five letters; the voice does not add a final *t* sound.

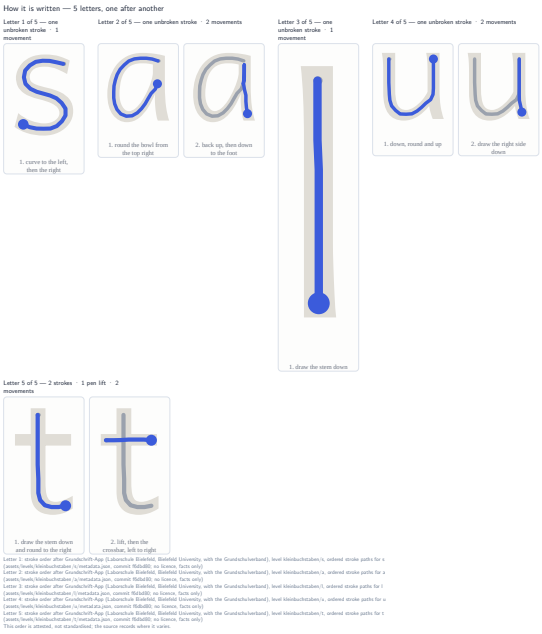
Before you move on

Compare only the order and presence of the five letters. Repair one letter if needed, then stop. The model stays visible today.

1.4 *salut* — look, hide, write, compare

Look at **salut** for five seconds. Touch the final silent **t**. Do not copy it yet.

Writing — delayed copy



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

1. cover the model;
2. wait five seconds;
3. write the word once from memory;
4. uncover **salut**, compare, and repair only the place that differs.

If one letter differs, circle that place and repair only that letter. A repair is part of the exercise, not a failure.

Before you move on

Read your repaired word as *sa-LU*. Stop after one memory attempt.

1.5 One heard greeting — write what you know

Cover the answer line lower on this page. You will hear one familiar casual greeting. No new vocabulary is hiding in this lesson.

Writing — short dictation

Hear: sa-LU

Write the French greeting from the sound alone. Remember that your pen records one final letter that your voice does not pronounce.

Now uncover and compare: **salut**. Check only the five letters and the silent final **t**. Repair one place if needed.

Before you move on

Writing from sound is the endpoint of this four-step runway. It is not yet a DILF mock; later lessons will grow from one known word to contact details, numbers, forms, and short practical messages.

1.6 bien — "well," a whole answer

A tiny, essential word: **bien**, "well." It carries a good chunk of everyday conversation, and its root reaches straight into English.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **ien** is a **nasal** *byan*: air through the nose, and the *n* itself is silent. Not "bee-en." → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bien — "well." Root: Latin **bene** ("well"). The English *bene-* family is yours already:

- **bene**fit ("do well"), **bene**volent ("wish well"), **bene**diction ("speak well"), be**nign**.

  A cross-language aside: Spanish, another daughter of Latin, has the very same word — *bien*, also from *bene*, also "well." French and Spanish each inherited the Latin adverb independently and it barely changed in either; when two Romance languages agree this exactly, you're looking straight at the shared Latin parent.

Using it alone: asked "how's it going?", you can answer with one word: "**Bien.**" ("Well / good.")

Grammar Lens: the "good" it pairs with

bien is the **adverb** ("well" — *how* something is done). The **adjective** "good" (describing a thing) is a different word — the next lesson. This is the same *well* vs. *good* split as English, and the same *bien* vs. *bueno* split as Spanish; French's adjective comes from Latin *bonus*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bien" — nasal *byan*
- "bien" then English "benefit", "benevolent"

Before you move on

French *bien* and Spanish *bien* come from the same Latin word — which one? (*bene*, "well.") Adverb or adjective? (Adverb — "good" the adjective is a different word, next.)

1.7 bon / bonne — "good," the block you build greetings from

This is the word that starts French's "good day" and "good evening." Learn it alone first — including the trick that its two forms *sound* completely different even though they look nearly the same.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-on` — **bon** is a **nasal** *bõ*: the *n* is silent, the vowel goes through the nose. → reference
- `silent-final` — but **bonne** (feminine) is *bun* — the doubled *nn* **cancels the nasal** and you actually pronounce an *n*. So *bon* (*bõ*) and *bonne* (*bun*) sound different despite looking alike.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bon — "good" (adjective, masculine). **bonne** — "good" (feminine). Root: Latin **bonus / bona** ("good"). Your English cousins:

- **bon**us (borrowed straight from Latin *bonus*), **bon**anza, and — via Old French *bonté* — **boun**ty. Even *bonbon* ("good-good," a candy).

  Spanish cousin: from the same *bonus / bona*, Spanish made *bueno / buena*. Notice French kept it shorter (*bon*) while Spanish broke the *o* into a diphthong (*bue-*). Same Latin word, two accents of wear.

Grammar Lens: adjectives agree with their noun

Like every Romance adjective, *bon* **agrees** with its noun's gender and number — *bon* (masc.), *bonne* (fem.), *bons* (masc. pl.), *bonnes* (fem. pl.). This is Latin's legacy: adjectives change their ending to match the noun (Spanish runs the same machine on *bueno / buena*). You'll watch it in the next few lessons: the day greeting takes *bon*, the night one *bonne*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bon" (nasal *bõ*) then "bonne" (*bun*) — hear the difference
- the four shapes — bon, bonne, bons, bonnes

Before you move on

Why do *bon* and *bonne* sound different? (The double *nn* in *bonne* cancels the nasal — *bõ* vs *bun*.) Which Spanish adjective shares *bon*'s Latin root? (*bueno*, from the same *bonus*.)

1.8 le, la, les — "the," and the gender it carries

Before your first noun: the words for "the." French splits "the" by gender — masculine *le*, feminine *la* — a habit it inherited from Latin (its sibling Spanish did the same, from the same source).

Sounds you'll need

- **le** = *luh*, **la** = *lah*, **les** = *lay* (the *s* is silent — `silent-final`). → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le — "the" (masculine). **la** — "the" (feminine). **les** — "the" (plural, both genders). Roots: Latin demonstratives **ille / illa / illos** ("that one / those"):

- **le** ← *ille*, **la** ← *illa*, **les** ← *illos* — the pointing force ("that") faded into a plain "the," and the initial *il-* wore off.

  Spanish cousin, exactly: from the *same ille / illa / illos*, Spanish made *el / la / los*. French kept *le* where Spanish kept *el* — same parent. And those same Latin demonstratives also gave French **il** ("he") and **elle** ("she") (Spanish *él / ella*): article and pronoun, one Latin root. (English "the" is Germanic — unrelated.)

Grammar Lens: French gender, also from Latin

Every French noun is **masculine or feminine** — a grammatical gender baked into the noun, inherited from Latin: its three genders (masculine, feminine, neuter) collapsed to two, the neuters folding into the masculine. (Spanish, the other Latin daughter, did the very same.) You learn each noun **with its article** (*le* or *la*), because the gender can't be guessed. French has one convenience here: in the plural, both genders share a single article, *les*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le", "la", "les"
- "le" (masc.), "la" (fem.), "les" (plural) — the nouns that wear them are coming

Before you move on

le and *la* come from which Latin words? (*ille* / *illa*, "that one" — same as Spanish *el/la*.) What's the single plural "the"? (*les*.)

1.9 jour — "day," and a detour through Latin that explains English *journey*

Your first French noun. In Spanish "day" is *día*; in French it's *jour* — they look nothing alike, yet they're cousins. The gap between them is the whole lesson, and it cracks open a shelf of English words.

What to know first

- le / la / les — gender and the articles; *jour* is masculine, *le jour*.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — **j** is the soft *zh* of *measure*: *jour* starts *zh-*.
- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** say *oo*. So *jour* = *zhoor*. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le jour — "the day" (masculine). Root: Latin **diurnum** ("daytime, daily") — itself from **dies** ("day"). That extra step through *diurnum* is why *jour* looks so unlike Spanish *día*:

- Spanish took *dies* → *día* (short path).
- French took the derivative *diurnum* → *jorn* → *jour* (the *di-* crushed down to *j-*).

Same ultimate root, two different Latin words, two very different results. And *diurnum* is a goldmine of English cousins — most of them arrived through French:

- **jour**nal (a *daily* record), **jour**ney (originally a *day's* travel or work — French *journée*, "a day's worth"), **jour**nalist.
- so**journ** ("to stay [for days]"), ad**journ** (*à jour*, "to [another] day").
- and straight from *dies*: **di**urnal, **di**ary — cousins of *jour* through the grandparent root.

So English *journey* and Spanish *día* are cousins, meeting back at Latin *dies* — one through French *jour*, one direct. That's the kind of hidden family this whole book is built to show.

Grammar Lens

jour is **masculine** — *le jour* — a gender it inherited from its Latin source. As always, learn it with the article. Plural: French adds a (silent) **-s** — *les jours* — sounds identical to the singular; only *les* tells your ear it's plural.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le jour" — *luh zhoor*
- "jour" then "journal", "journey" — the daily root

- "les jours" — plural, heard only in the *les*

Before you move on

jour and Spanish *día* share which grandparent root? (Latin *dies*.) What English travel-word is literally "a day's worth"? (*Journey*, from *journée*.)

1.10 bonjour — assembled, and *not* plural (unlike Spanish)

Snap two words together — *bon* + *jour* — and you have the single most important word in French politeness. And there's a sharp contrast with Spanish hiding in it.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · jour

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonjour = **bon** ("good") + **jour** ("day") = "good day." One written word, said *bõ- zhoor*. *bon* is masculine because *jour* is masculine — the agreement from the *bon* lesson, quietly at work.

Why it's said this way

Here's the contrast worth banking. Spanish says *buenos días* — **plural**, "good days," the fossil of a blessing ("may God give you good days"). French says *bonjour* — **singular**, just "good day." French didn't fossilize the plural; it kept the plain, single wish. Same two building blocks (*good* + *day*), same Latin roots, but Spanish pluralized the blessing and French didn't. Two neighbours, two instincts. Culturally, *bonjour* carries weight far beyond "hello": in France, opening almost any interaction — a shop, a bus, a desk — *without* a *bonjour* reads as rude. It's the formal, all-purpose daytime greeting (the evening has its own, two lessons on), and the polite default where *salut* would be too casual.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- build it — "bon" … "jour" … "bonjour"
- "salut" (casual) then "bonjour" (polite) — feel the register gap
- bonjour vs Spanish buenos días — one singular, one plural

Before you move on

bonjour is singular; the Spanish equivalent is plural — what is it, and why plural? (*Buenos días*, fossil of "may God give you good days.")

1.11 soir — "evening," and the same "late" idea Spanish used

The evening counterpart of *jour*. And there's a lovely parallel with Spanish waiting: both languages built their "later in the day" word out of the Latin word for *late*.

What to know first

- jour — the day word; *soir* is its evening partner.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — **oi** = *wa*: *soir* is *swahr*. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le soir — "the evening" (masculine). Root: Latin **sērum** (*tempus*), "the **late** [hour]," from **sērus** ("late"). English cousins are few but real: *soirée* (an evening party — borrowed straight from French *soir*), and the rare *serotine* (a bat that flies in the *late* evening).

Spanish parallel — this is the good part. Spanish *tarde* ("afternoon") comes from Latin *tardus*, "**late**." French *soir* ("evening") comes from *sērus*, "**late**." Two different Latin "late" words, two languages, the same idea: name the later

part of the day after its *lateness*.

Grammar Lens

soir is **masculine** — *le soir* — so, like *jour*, it will take *bon* (not *bonne*) in the greeting. Plural *les soirs*, the *s* silent.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le soir" — *luh swahr*
- "soir" then English "soirée"
- Spanish *tarde* ← "late", French *soir* ← "late" — same idea

Before you move on

What did *soir*'s Latin root *sērus* mean? ("Late.") What Spanish time-word did the exact same thing from a different "late" word? (*Tarde*, ← *tardus*.)

1.12 bonsoir — good evening

Same assembly as *bonjour*, one word swapped. If you have that one, this is nearly free.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · soir · bonjour

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonsoir = **bon** ("good") + **soir** ("evening") = "good evening." *bon* stays masculine because *soir* is masculine — same as *bonjour*, no new agreement to learn. Said *bõ- swahr*.

Why it's said this way

bonsoir is the evening swap for *bonjour*: as the day turns to evening (roughly late afternoon on), French speakers switch from *bonjour* to *bonsoir*. Both are the polite, all-purpose greeting for their time of day. And like Spanish *buenas noches*, *bonsoir* works both **arriving** and **leaving** in the evening — "good evening" on the way in, "goodnight-ish" on the way out. (For actually sending someone to bed, French has a separate phrase — the next two lessons.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bonsoir" — *bõ- swahr*
- "bonjour" (daytime) then "bonsoir" (evening) — the pair

Before you move on

What two words build *bonsoir*, and why does *bon* stay masculine? (*bon* + *soir*; *soir* is masculine.)

1.13 nuit — "night," and a sound-change that mirrors Spanish

"Night." In Spanish it's *noche*; in French, *nuit*. They came from the *same* Latin word and drifted apart by two different rules — and once you know the rules, you can predict a dozen more words.

What to know first

- le / la / les — *nuit* is feminine, *la nuit*.

Sounds you'll need

- **nuit** = *nwee* — the **u** is the front-rounded French *u* gliding into *ee*; the final **t** is silent (`silent-final`). → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la nuit — "the night" (feminine). Root: Latin **noctem** (*nox*, stem *noct-*). English cousins through the *noct-* root: **noct**urnal, **noct**urne, equi**nox** ("equal night").

The sound-change, side by side with Spanish. Latin *noctem* went two ways:

- Spanish softened *-ct-* → **-ch-**: *noctem* → *noche*.
- French turned *-ct-* → **-it-**: *noctem* → *nuit*.

And it's a *rule*, not a one-off — watch it repeat:

Latin	Spanish / French	English
noctem	noche / nuit	night
lactem	leche / lait	(lact-, "milk")
factum	hecho / fait	fact

So a Spanish *-ch-* word and a French *-it-* word are often the *same* Latin word — and the English cousin usually kept the *-ct-*.

Grammar Lens

nuit is **feminine** — *la nuit* — inherited from Latin, where *nox* was feminine (exactly as Spanish *la noche* is). Its gender matters next lesson: it's why "good night" is *bon**ne** nuit*, not *bon nuit*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la nuit" — *lah nwee*
- "nuit" then Spanish "noche" — same Latin *noctem*, two rules
- the row — "noche, nuit, night"

Before you move on

Latin *noctem* → Spanish *noche* by *-ct-→-ch-*; → French *nuit* by which change? (*-ct-→-it-*.) Is *nuit* masculine or feminine? (Feminine — *la nuit*.)

1.14 bonne nuit — good night, and the feminine side of *bon*

The last greeting of the day — and the one that finally shows *bon* in its feminine coat.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · nuit

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonne nuit = **bonne** ("good," feminine) + **nuit** ("night," feminine) = "good night." Here it is at last: because *nuit* is **feminine**, *bon* becomes **bonne** — and, from the *bon* lesson, remember they even *sound* different: *bon* is nasal *bõ*, but *bonne nuit* is *bun nwee*, with a real *n*.
So the three evening-ish greetings line up and show the whole agreement rule in one breath:

- *bon**jour*** — *jour* masculine → *bon*
- *bon**soir*** — *soir* masculine → *bon*
- *bon**ne** nuit* — *nuit* feminine → *bonne*

Why it's said this way

Unlike *bonsoir* (an evening *greeting*), *bonne nuit* is a **farewell for bed** — "goodnight," said when parting for sleep. It maps onto the Spanish split you may feel forming: Spanish overloads *buenas noches* for both, while French keeps *bonsoir* (evening hello/bye) separate from *bonne nuit* (off-to-sleep).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bonne nuit" — *bun nwee*
- the trio — bonjour, bonsoir, bonne nuit — and for each, is *bon* masculine or feminine, and why?

Before you move on

Why is it *bonne* nuit but *bon* jour? (*nuit* is feminine, *jour* masculine — agreement.) *bonsoir* vs *bonne nuit* — which is "off to bed"? (*Bonne nuit.*)

1.15 Practice — the French greetings

No new words — just the ones you built, until the register and the agreement are automatic.

What you've built

- **salut** — casual "hi/bye" (← *salus*, "health").
- **bien** — "well," a one-word answer (← *bene*; Spanish kept the same word).
- **bon / bonne** — "good," the adjective (← *bonus*), and its agreement.
- **le / la / les** — "the," carrying gender (← *ille/illa/illos*).
- **bonjour** = bon + jour (masc.) — polite daytime "hello," *singular* where Spanish is plural.
- **bonsoir** = bon + soir (masc.) — evening greeting.
- **bonne nuit** = bonne + nuit (fem.) — off-to-bed "goodnight."

Two threads run through it all: **register** (*salut* vs *bonjour*) and **agreement** (*bon jour / bon soir / bonne nuit*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- greet a friend casually, then a shopkeeper politely — *salut / bonjour*
- pick the right greeting for right now (day → *bonjour*, evening → *bonsoir*)
- bonjour, bonsoir, bonne nuit — and say why each takes *bon* or *bonne*

- answer "how are you" in one word — *bien*

Twice through: Run bonjour → bonsoir → bonne nuit without hesitating on *bon/bonne*.

Writing — close the first runway

Cover the word **salut** elsewhere in this chapter. Write the casual greeting once from memory, then uncover it and check the silent final **t**. This is a chapter-level retrieval of the tiny trace-to-dictation runway, not a new word.

Before you move on

French *bonjour* is singular; the Spanish morning greeting is plural — name it. (*Buenos días.*) Next chapter: introducing yourself — "my name is…" — and French's own two words for "you," one familiar and one formal.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce myself in French, give my name, and understand the other person's name.
>
> *Now a first real exchange — "Je m'appelle Mira." / "Comment vous appelez-vous?" / "Je m'appelle Arun." / "Enchanté." — giving your name, asking for someone else's, and saying you are glad to meet them. We build it the same way as the greetings: each piece taken apart first, then assembled.*

2.1 je — "I," the smallest word you own

To introduce yourself you need "I." French's is tiny — but it comes from a word you already own whole in English.

Sounds you'll need

- **je** = *zhuh* — a soft *j* (as in *measure*) plus a light *uh*.
- Before a vowel it **elides**: the *e* drops and an apostrophe takes its place, **j'**. You'll meet the same squeeze in *je m'appelle*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

je — "I." Root: Latin **ego**. That Latin form survives *raw* in English:

- **ego**, **ego**ist, **ego**tism, **ego**centric — the "I" at the center of the self.

So the word for "I" and the psychologist's *ego* are the **same** ancient word — one worn down to a whisper (*je*), one kept whole (*ego*). (Spanish wore *ego* down to *yo*; French wore it further, to *je*.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je" (*zhuh*)
- "je", then the bare *zh* of **j'** — all that is left when the *e* drops
- the English cousin that kept the Latin whole — *ego*

Before you move on

What Latin word is **je** worn down from, and what English word kept it whole? (*ego* — English *ego*.) What happens to *je* before a vowel? (It elides to *j'*.)

2.2 me — "myself," the same word as English *me*

The middle piece of *je m'appelle*. It's a real word with a real history — not just a bit of glue — and you've owned it in English all your life.

Sounds you'll need

- **me** = *muh* — a light *uh*, like *je*.
- Before a vowel it **elides**: *me appelle* → **m'appelle** (the *e* drops, the words fuse).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

me — "me / myself." Root: Latin **mē** (the accusative "me") — literally the **same** word as English **me**. The whole family grows from one Proto-Indo-European root ***me-**:

- English **me**, **my**, **mine**;
- Latin **mē** and **meus** ("my"), which became French *mon / ma /*

mes.

So the tiny *m'* in *je m'appelle* is a first-person marker you've carried in English since childhood — *me*, *my*, *mine* are its cousins.

Grammar Lens: the reflexive set (me / te / se)

me is one of three little pronouns that **bounce a verb back onto its doer** — *me* ("myself"), *te* ("yourself"), *se* ("himself, herself"). Their roots run in parallel with the one you just met, and two of them you already own in English:

- *te* ← Latin **tē**, the cousin of archaic English **thee**.
- *se* ← Latin **sē**, the "self" root behind **se**parate and, at a distance, **su**icide (*suī*, "of oneself").

Only **me** does any work here: it is what gives your own name, *je m'appelle*. *te* turns up once, in the informal "what's your name?" at the end of this chapter, and *se* waits for a lesson that needs it. The set is named so its shape is familiar, not laid out as a grid to memorize — you meet each one where it earns its place.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "me" (*muh*), then its elision — "m'appelle"
- the English cousins from the same root — *me*, *my*, *mine*
- the set — *me* (myself), *te* (yourself), *se* (oneself)

Before you move on

What Latin word is **me** from, and what three English words share its root? (*mē* — *me*, *my*, *mine*.) What are its two siblings, and what does *me* do to a verb? (*te*, *se*; it bounces the action back onto the doer — reflexive.)

2.3 (s')appeler — "to call," and "to call *oneself*"

French says "my name is" by saying "I call myself." Here's the verb that does it — and a fat English family riding on it.

Sounds you'll need

- **appeler** = *a-play* — the *-er* infinitive ending is a plain "ay."
- In **m'appelle** the doubled *ll* keeps a crisp "l": *ma-PELL*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

appeler — "to call." Root: Latin **appellāre** ("to address, call by name"). The English cousins are everywhere in formal language:

- **appeal** — to *call* to a higher authority.
- **appell**ation — a name or title (an *appellation* of wine is its official name).
- **appell**ate, **appell**ant — the court that hears appeals, and the one who brings it.

To **name** someone is, at root, to **call** them.

Grammar Lens: reflexive verbs — doing something to yourself

French builds "to be called" from "to call" plus a little word that bounces the action back onto the doer: **s'appeler**, "to call *oneself*." That bounce-back word changes for each person:

- **me** = myself · **te** = yourself · **se** = himself/herself.

So "I call myself" needs **me**: *je* ***me*** *appelle* → (elided) *je m'appelle*. English hides the same move in "I call **myself**" — French just uses it as the normal way to give a name.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "appeler" (*a-play*)

- the English cousins — *appeal*, *appellation*
- "call oneself" with *me* — *je me appelle*

Before you move on

What Latin verb is **appeler** from, and two English cousins? (*appellāre* — *appeal*, *appellation*.) What does a *reflexive* verb do, and which little word means "myself"? (Bounces the action back on the doer; *me*.)

2.4 je m'appelle... — "my name is...," literally "I call myself"

Assemble the two pieces you just met — *je* and *(s')appeler* — into the single most useful sentence for meeting anyone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Three atoms, each already taken apart on its own — je (I, ← *ego*), me (myself, ← *mē*), appelle (call, ← *appellāre*):

- **je** (I) + **me** (myself) + **appelle** (call).
- *me* elides before the vowel of *appelle* → **m'**.

  je m'appelle... = word for word "I call myself..." = **"my name is..."**

Je m'appelle Arun. → "My name is Arun." *Je m'appelle Mira.* → "My name is Mira."

Why it's said this way

French *prefers* this verb-based "I call myself" to a literal "my name is." The literal form does exist:

- **mon nom est...** ("my name is..."), with **nom** ("name") ← Latin **nōmen** → English **noun**, **nom**inate, **nom**inal, **nom**enclature.

But *mon nom est* sounds stiff and official — a passport-desk phrase. For a real introduction, reach for **je m'appelle**. (You now also see

why “noun” is literally “a naming word.”)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “je m’appelle…” then your own name
- what it *literally* says (“I call myself”)
- the stiff literal alternative — “mon nom est…”

Before you move on

What does **je m’appelle** literally mean, and why does *me* become *m’*? (“I call myself”; elision before the vowel of *appelle*.) What’s the more literal but stiffer “my name is,” and what English word is *nom* cousin to? (*mon nom est*; *noun*.)

2.5 tu / vous — “you,” familiar and formal

To *ask* someone their name, you need “you.” French has two, and choosing between them is a small act of social judgment.

Sounds you’ll need

- **tu** = *too*, but with the front-rounded French *u* (lips rounded, tongue forward). **vous** = *voo* (silent *s*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **tu** (familiar “you”) ← Latin **tū**.
- **vous** (formal / plural “you”) ← Latin **vōs**, “you all.”

English once had the same split — old **thou** was the *tu* — but *thou* died out, leaving one flat **you** for everyone.

Grammar Lens: two "you"s, chosen by register

- **tu** — for friends, family, children, peers. Intimate, equal.
- **vous** — for strangers, elders, anyone you'd show respect — **and** it's the plural "you all."

The trick: French makes politeness by using the **plural** on a single person. Addressing one respected person as "you all" is the polite move (French even has a verb for it, *vouvoyer*). This is the same politeness Spanish builds with *usted*, but by a different route: Spanish coined a whole new pronoun (from "your grace"); French just borrows its plural. Using *tu* too early can feel over-familiar — **when in doubt, *vous***.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu" (front-rounded *u*), "vous" (*voo*)
- who gets *tu* (friends), who gets *vous* (strangers, elders)
- the rule of thumb — "when in doubt, *vous*"

Before you move on

What decides *tu* vs *vous* — and what does French do to be polite to one person? (Register — familiar vs respect; it uses the *plural* (*vous*) on one person.) What old English word was the lost *tu*? (*thou*.)

2.6 comment — "how," from the same *quomodo* as Spanish *cómo*

French asks "what's your name?" as "**how** are you called?" — so first, the word for "how."

Sounds you'll need

- **comment** = *ko-MAHN* — the final *-ent* is a **nasal** vowel; the *t* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comment — "how." Root: Latin **quo modo**, "in what manner" — two words fused and worn into one.

- That same **quomodo** also became Spanish **cómo** — two Romance languages, one Latin "in-what-way," reshaped differently.
- The piece **modo** ("manner, measure") is alive in English **mode**, **mod**el, **mod**erate, **mod**ify — all about the *way* a thing is done.

Grammar Lens: French counts names as a matter of "how"

Where English asks "**what** is your name?", French asks "**how** are you called?" — *comment* (how), not *what*. The question is about the *manner* of your calling, not a thing to be named. Don't translate word for word; learn the French logic: the name-question runs on **comment**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comment" (*ko-MAHN*, nasal ending)
- the Latin *quo modo* → French *comment*, Spanish *cómo*
- English *mode/model* share the *modo* piece

Before you move on

What two Latin words fused into **comment**, and what Spanish word shares them? (*quo modo* — Spanish *cómo*.) English asks "what is your name?" — what does French literally ask? ("*How* are you called?")

2.7 comment vous appelez-vous? — "what's your name?"

Assemble it: "how" + "do you call yourself" = the polite question that gets the introduction going.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **comment** (how) + **vous appelez-vous** ("do you call yourself").

  comment vous appelez-vous? = literally "**how do you call yourself?**" = the polite **"what's your name?"**

Grammar Lens: asking by inversion

A statement — *vous vous appelez* ("you call yourself") — becomes a **question** by flipping the verb and the pronoun, joined with a hyphen:

> *vous appelez-**vous**?*

That flip is French's formal way to ask anything. The **informal** version simply swaps in *tu*:

> *comment **tu t'appelles**?* — note *te* elides to **t'**, exactly as *me* became *m'* in *je m'appelle*.

So the same verb, *s'appeler*, runs the whole exchange: *je m'appelle* to give your name, *comment vous appelez-vous?* to ask for theirs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comment vous appelez-vous?" (formal)
- the informal — "comment tu t'appelles?"
- the pair — ask, then answer: "…vous appelez-vous?" / "je m'appelle…"

Before you move on

What does **comment vous appelez-vous?** literally say? ("How do you call yourself?") How do you turn the statement into a question, and what's the *tu* version? (Invert verb + pronoun with a hyphen; *comment tu t'appelles?*)

2.8 enchanté(e) — "delighted," i.e. "pleased to meet you"

The graceful close to an introduction — and it literally says you've been put under a spell.

Sounds you'll need

- **enchanté** = *ahn-shahn-TAY* — two **nasal** vowels (*en*, *an*), then a clean "tay." **ch** = English *sh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enchanté — "delighted." Root: Latin **in-** ("upon") + **cantāre** ("to sing, chant"). To *enchant* was literally to **sing a spell upon** someone. The magic survives in the English family:

- **enchant**, **incant**ation, and the plain **chant**.

So saying *enchanté* on meeting someone means, gallantly, "I'm **enchanted** [to meet you]."

Grammar Lens: it agrees with *you*

enchanté follows the gender-agreement rule you met in *bon/bonne*: it reports the **speaker's own gender**.

- A man says **enchanté**.
- A woman says **enchantée** — an extra *-e* (same sound, silent).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "enchanté" (*ahn-shahn-TAY*)
- the English cousins — *enchant*, *incantation*, *chant*
- both forms — *enchanté* (m.) / *enchantée* (f.)

Before you move on

What does **enchanté** literally mean, and from what Latin pieces? ("Enchanted" — *in-* + *cantāre*, "to sing upon.") How does a woman say it, and why? (*enchantée* — it agrees with the speaker's gender.)

2.9 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

Every piece is built. Here's the exchange it was all for.

The exchange

French	English
Je m'appelle Mira.	My name is Mira.
Comment vous appelez-vous?	What's your name?
Je m'appelle Arun.	My name is Arun.
Enchanté.	Pleased to meet you.

Every piece traced to a root:

- **je** ← *ego* (English *ego*)
- **me** ← *mē* (English *me*, *my*, *mine*)
- **(s')appeler** ← *appellāre* (English *appeal*, *appellation*)
- **comment** ← *quo modo* (Spanish *cómo*, English *mode*)
- **enchanté** ← *in-cantāre* (English *enchant*, *incantation*, *chant*)

And two habits of French to keep: it gives a name with a **reflexive verb** ("I call *myself*") and asks for one with **"how"** ("*how* are you called?"), and it makes politeness by using the **plural** *vous* on one person.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- your own introduction — "je m'appelle …, enchanté(e)"
- ask it back — "comment vous appelez-vous?"

Before you move on

Give your name in French, ask someone else's, and say you're pleased to meet them. (*Je m'appelle… / Comment vous appelez-vous? / Enchanté(e).*) Which two French habits does this exchange show? (Naming with a reflexive verb; asking with "how," not "what.")
Next chapter: *Comment ça va?* ("how's it going?") and answering with *bien* again — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone is in French, answer naturally, and return the question.
>
> *Now the small talk that follows a name: thanking, answering a thank-you, and asking how someone is doing. French asks that last question with a verb of motion — not "how are you?" but "how does it go?"*

3.1 merci — "thank you," and it means *mercy*

You can introduce yourself in French. Next you'll ask *how are you?* — and every polite answer needs **merci** first. It hides a word you already know: *mercy*.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular` — **merci** = *mehr-SEE*, with the soft guttural French *r* at the back of the throat (never the Spanish tap). Stress the end: *mehr-**SEE***.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

merci — "thank you." Root: Latin **mercēs**, *"wages, reward, price, that which is earned."* Saying *merci* originally invoked a **reward** owed for a kindness — and, in old religious use, a plea for divine **mercy** (a reward you haven't earned).
That one root **merc-** ("pay, trade, reward") pays out a huge English

family:

- **mercy**, **merciful** — the reward/pity sense.
- **mercenary** — a soldier who fights for *wages*.
- **merchant**, **commerce**, **market**, **mercantile** — buying and selling, the *price* sense (Latin *mercārī*, "to trade").
- Even **Mercury** — the Roman god of merchants.

Why it's said this way

Here's a lovely contrast to lock in:

language	"thank you"	literal root
French	*merci*	*mercēs* — **reward / mercy**
Spanish	*gracias*	*grātia* — **grace / favour**
Portuguese	*obrigado*	*obligātus* — "I am **obliged**"

Three Romance sisters, three different pictures of gratitude: French hands you a **reward**, Spanish hands you **grace**, Portuguese declares itself **obliged**. Same feeling, three metaphors — this is exactly the kind of thing worth *noticing*, not just memorizing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "merci" — *mehr-SEE*, guttural *r*
- "merci" then English "mercy, merchant, commerce" — one family
- French *merci* (reward) vs Spanish *gracias* (grace) — feel the difference

Before you move on

What everyday English word is *merci* a cousin of? (*Mercy.*) And its "trade" cousins? (Merchant, commerce, market, mercenary.) How

does its metaphor differ from Spanish *gracias*? (*merci* = reward/ mercy; *gracias* = grace.) Next: the reply to a thank-you.

3.2 de rien — "you're welcome," or "it was nothing"

Someone says **merci**. The easy reply: **de rien** — literally *"of nothing."* You wave the favour off as no trouble — and Spanish pulls *this exact trick* too.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **rien** is a nasal ending: the air goes out through the nose and there is no hard *n* to stop it. *duh RYAN*, with that final vowel humming rather than closing.
- `r-uvular` — that guttural French *r* again, at the back of the throat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **de** = "of / from" (Latin **dē**).
- **rien** = "nothing." And here is the beautiful part.

rien comes from Latin **rem** — the accusative of **rēs**, *"a thing."* In Latin *rem* meant a **thing**, something real. But French kept using it inside negations — *ne … rien*, "not … a thing" — until the *thing* word absorbed the "nothing" and **rien came to mean 'nothing' all by itself.**
Latin *rēs* also gives English **real**, **re**public (*rēs pūblica*, "the public thing"), and **rebus**. So *rien* is, at the root, a **real thing** that learned to mean nothing at all.

Why it's said this way

If that sounds familiar, it should: **Spanish did the identical thing with nada** (← Latin *nāta*, "a born thing" → "nothing"). Two sister languages, the same move — the word for **thing** collapses into the word for **nothing**:

language	"you're welcome"	the "nothing" word, from Latin
French	*de rien*	*rien* ← *rem*, "a thing"
Spanish	*de nada*	*nada* ← *nāta*, "a born thing"

Two sister languages, one instinct: wave the favour off as no *thing* at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "merci" … "de rien" — the full exchange, both voices
- French *de rien* and Spanish *de nada* back to back — same idea, two "thing → nothing" words

Before you move on

What did *rien* ("nothing") originally mean in Latin? (*rem* — a *thing*.) What Spanish word pulled the same trick, and from what? (*nada* ← *nāta*, "a born thing.") Next: the verb French uses for "how are you?" — and it's not "to stand" like Spanish, but **to go**.

3.3 aller — "to go," the verb behind "how are you?"

Spanish asks *how are you* with **estar**, "to *stand*." French asks it with **aller**, "to **go**" — *how does it go?* Same question, a different picture of a life: one language stands, the other walks. Meet **aller**.

Sounds you'll need

- `er-ending` — the infinitive **-er** is a clean *ay*: **aller** = *ah-LAY* (the double *l* is just one *l* sound; the *r* is silent here).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aller means "to go." Its origin is one of the great messes of French — it is **suppletive**, meaning it was stitched together from **three** different Latin verbs, and you can still see the seams in its everyday forms:

- **je vais** ("I go") ← Latin **vādere**, "to go, to rush" → English **invade**, **evade**, **wade** (all "going" words).
- **nous allons** ("we go"), and the infinitive **aller** ← Latin **ambulāre**, "to walk" → English **amble**, **ambulance** (a walking hospital), **preamble**, **perambulate**.
- **j'irai** ("I will go") ← Latin **īre**, "to go" → English **exit** (*ex-it*, "he goes out"), **transit**, **initial**.

So a single French verb carries **three** Latin roots for motion. You don't need to conjugate it yet — just recognize one form for the next lesson:

- **ça va** = "it goes" (the *va* is from *vādere*) — the beating heart of French small talk.

Grammar Lens: "going" as "being"

Lots of languages borrow a motion verb to talk about *state*: English says "how are you **getting on**? / how's it **going**?" French made that the standard: *Comment ça va?* = "How does it **go**?" Hold the metaphor — it makes the next lesson obvious.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "aller" — *ah-LAY*
- "ça va" — *sa VA*, "it goes"
- English "amble, ambulance" (walk) and "invade, evade" (go) — aller's two big families

Before you move on

What does *aller* literally mean, and how many Latin verbs is it stitched from? (To *go*; three — *ambulāre, vādere, īre.*) Which everyday form means "it goes"? (*ça va.*) So *Comment ça va?* literally asks — what? ("How does it *go*?") Next: ask it for real.

3.4 Comment ça va ? — "how are you?"

You know **comment**, "how," and **ça va**, "it goes." Assemble the most useful neutral check-in in spoken French.

> **Comment ça va ?** — "How are you?" literally: "How does this go?"

The even shorter **Ça va ?** is extremely common. Answer with the same words:

> **Ça va ? — Ça va.** "How's it going? — It's going / I'm fine."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **comment** comes from Latin *quōmodo*, "in what manner";
- **ça** comes from *ecce hoc*, "behold this";
- **va** is the third-person form of **aller**, "to go."

French pictures wellbeing as **going**. Spanish uses a "standing" verb instead; the comparison is a memory hook, not a prerequisite. Pronounce *comment* roughly *ko-mahn*: the ending is nasal and the written *t* is silent in this neutral phrase.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Comment ça va ?"
- the shorter question — "Ça va ?"

- the pair — "Ça va ? — Ça va."

Twice through: "Ça va ? — Ça va."

Before you move on

What does *Comment ça va ?* literally ask? ("How does it go?") Which verb owns **va**? (**Aller**.) What is the shortest version? (**Ça va ?**) How can you answer it? (**Ça va.**) Next: choose *tu* or *vous* explicitly.

3.5 Comment vas-tu ? / Comment allez-vous ?

Comment ça va ? avoids naming the listener. Now use the *tu* / *vous* choice you learned when you gave your name.

Grammar Lens: a ladder of three registers

French offers a neat climb from casual to formal. *tu* is the familiar "you" (a friend, a peer); *vous* is the formal or plural "you" (a stranger, an elder, a group).

register	question	literally
casual, universal	**Comment ça va ?** (or **Ça va ?**)	"How does *it* go?"
informal, one friend	**Comment vas-tu ?**	"How go *you*?"
formal or plural	**Comment allez-vous ?**	"How go *you* (vous)?"

Vas and **allez** are simply the *tu* and *vous* forms of *aller*, "to go." Formal writing and careful speech invert verb and pronoun: **allez-vous**, literally "go-you." For a stranger or a boss, reach for **Comment allez-vous ?**

Sounds you'll need

The final *t* of **comment** is normally silent. Before vowel-initial **allez**, liaison can carry it across:

Comment allez-vous ? — roughly *ko-mahn-ta-lay-voo*

That linking sound is not an extra word; it is a normally silent consonant surfacing between two words.

Use **Ça va ?** as the easy neutral default, **vas-tu** for a friend when you want explicit informality, and **allez-vous** for formal or plural address.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to a friend — "Comment vas-tu ?"
- to a stranger — "Comment allez-vous ?"
- the neutral default — "Ça va ?"

Twice through: "Vas-tu — friend. Allez-vous — formal or plural."

Before you move on

Which form addresses one friend? (**Comment vas-tu ?**) Which is formal or plural? (**Comment allez-vous ?**) What sound appears in the liaison? (The normally silent ***t*** of *comment.*) Next: the "so-so" answer.

3.6 comme ci, comme ça — the classic French shrug

Someone asks *Ça va?* You're not great, not bad. The perfect, gloriously French answer — a phrase English borrowed whole — is **comme ci, comme ça**: "like this, like that." A verbal shrug of the shoulders.

First, twenty seconds of review. From your first greetings: **bien** — "well" (← Latin *bene*). So *Ça va bien* = "It's going well." Now the answer for when it's only *going.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comme ci, comme ça — literally **"like this, like that."** Every piece is an old friend:

- **comme** = "like, as" — from Latin **quōmodo**, "in what manner." That's the **same root as *comment*** ("how") from last lesson! *comment* = "in what manner (as a question)"; *comme* =

"in the manner of, like." One Latin word, two French children.

- **ci** = "here / this" ← Latin **ecce hic**, "behold here."
- **ça** = "there / that" ← Latin **ecce hoc**, "behold this" — the same *ça* from *Ça va?*.

So you're literally waving a hand: *a bit like this way, a bit like that way* — neither up nor down.

Grammar Lens: your answer set for *Ça va?*

answer	sense
Bien, merci	well, thank you
Ça va	fine / okay ("it goes")
Comme ci, comme ça	so-so
Pas mal	not bad

Why it's said this way

Every language has its shrug, and each paints it differently: Spanish says **más o menos** ("more or less") or **regular**, Italian says **così così** ("so so"), French says **comme ci, comme ça** ("like this, like that"). Same gesture, three pictures.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comme ci, comme ça" — with a little hand-wobble in the voice
- answer "Ça va?" three ways — "Bien" / "Ça va" / "Comme ci, comme ça"
- notice *comme* and *comment* share a root — *quōmodo*

Before you move on

What does *comme ci, comme ça* literally mean? ("Like this, like that.") What "how"-word shares *comme*'s root? (*comment* — both from *quōmodo*.) What's the Spanish equivalent shrug? (*más o*

menos / regular.) Next: put the whole exchange together.

3.7 Practice — "comment ça va ?", start to finish

No new words. This chapter's atoms — *merci, de rien, aller, ça va, comme ci comme ça* — assemble into a real exchange, run formally and informally. It picks up right where the introduction exchange left off.

The exchange

Formal (a stranger, an elder):

— Bonjour. **Comment allez-vous ?** — **Bien, merci.** Et vous ? — **Comme ci, comme ça.** — [later, after a small favour] — Merci ! — **De rien.**

Informal (a friend):

— Salut ! **Ça va ?** — **Ça va, et toi ?** — Comme ci, comme ça.

The glue word is **et vous ? / et toi ?** — "and you?" (*et* = "and," Latin *et*; *toi* is the stressed "you"). It bounces the question back — exactly like Spanish *¿y usted? / ¿y tú?*

What you've built this chapter

- **merci** — thank you (← *mercēs*, "reward / mercy").
- **de rien** — you're welcome (← *rem*, "a thing" → "nothing"; twin of Spanish *de nada*).
- **aller / ça va** — "to go," the verb French uses for *how are you* (vs Spanish *estar*, "to stand").
- **Comment ça va ? / allez-vous ? / vas-tu ?** — the casual, formal, and informal question.
- **bien / ça va / comme ci comme ça / pas mal** — the answer ladder.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full *formal* exchange, both voices
- the same *informally* — *allez-vous* → *ça va*, *vous* → *toi*
- chain the introduction onto this one — "Je m'appelle … Comment allez-vous ?"

Twice through: "Ça va ? — Ça va, et toi ?" until it's reflex.

Before you move on

Which verb carries French "how are you?", and how does its metaphor differ from Spanish's? (*aller*, "to go" — *how does it go?* — vs *estar*, "to stand.") What does *de rien* literally say, and its Spanish twin? ("Of nothing"; *de nada*.) Next chapter: **farewells**.

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can end a French conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.

You can open a French conversation; now close it. French has one plain goodbye and a small family of soft ones, all built the same way — the preposition à ("to") followed by a time word — and this chapter also teaches the accents, the cedilla and the trema you have been reading all along.

4.1 au revoir — "goodbye," i.e. "until we see each other again"

You can open a French conversation; now close it. The standard goodbye is **au revoir** — and where Spanish *adiós* commends you *to God*, French makes a promise to **see you again**.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular` — two guttural French *r*'s: *oh ruh-VWAHR*.
- `vowel-oi` — **-voir** = *vwahr* (the *oi* = *wa*, as in *soir*, the evening).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au revoir is **au** + **revoir** = "at the **re-seeing**":

- **au** = "at/to the" (a fusion of *à* + *le*).
- **revoir** = "to see again" = **re-** ("again") + **voir** ("to see").

So *au revoir* literally means **"until the seeing-again"** — a small promise that this isn't the end. It's built on **voir**, from Latin **vidēre**, "to see" — one of the richest roots in English:

- **vis**ion, **vis**ible, **vis**it, **vis**a, **view**, **video** ("I see").
- **re-vise** ("look again"), **e-vid**ent ("seen out"), **pro-vide**, **super-vise**, **sur-vey**.

Why it's said this way

Here's a satisfying cross-language pair: **German says the exact same thing.** *Auf Wiedersehen* = *auf* ("on") + *wieder* ("again") + *sehen* ("to see") = "on the seeing-again." French and German, side by side, both promise a **re-seeing**; Spanish *adiós* instead commends you *to God*. Same moment, two different pictures.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "au revoir" — *oh ruh-VWAHR*
- "au revoir" then English "vision, revise, video" — the *vidēre* family
- French *au revoir* and German *auf Wiedersehen* — both "see you again"

Before you move on

What does *au revoir* literally mean? ("Until the seeing-again.") What Latin verb is *voir* from, and two English cousins? (*vidēre* — vision, video, revise.) Which other language builds its goodbye the same "see again" way? (German *auf Wiedersehen*.) Next: "see you later."

4.2 à plus tard — the casual "see you later"

The everyday, friendly "see you later" is **à plus tard** — and among friends it shrinks to just **à plus** (*ah PLUSS*, and here you *do* sound the final *s*). It's the French twin of Spanish *hasta luego*.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — in the full phrase, *plus* is *ploo* (silent *s*): *ah ploo TAR*. But in the clipped **à plus**, the *s* is pronounced: *ah PLUSS*.
- **tard** = *tar* (silent *d*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à plus tard = literally "to more late" → "see you later."

- **à** = "to / at" (Latin *ad*) — French's all-purpose farewell preposition, the way Spanish leans on *hasta*: *à* + a time = a soft goodbye.
- **plus** = "more," from Latin **plūs** — the *plus* you already write in English (and the *plu-* of *plural*, *surplus*).
- **tard** = "late," from Latin **tarde**, "slowly, late." English keeps it in **tardy** and **retard** ("hold back, make late").

So *à plus tard* is "until more-late" — see you at some later point.

Why it's said this way

Spanish inherited that identical Latin *tarde* — the word you met giving your name — but the two languages grew it in different directions. French kept it meaning **late** (*tard*); Spanish grew it into **afternoon** (*tarde*). One Latin word, two everyday meanings. And where French leans on **à** for its soft goodbyes, Spanish leans on **hasta** ("until"): *hasta luego* is the twin of *à plus tard*.

Grammar Lens: the "à ..." farewells

French's soft goodbyes are all **à** + a time word — mirror this against Spanish *hasta*:

French	Spanish	"until / to …"
à plus tard / à plus	hasta luego	later
à + "soon" (next lesson)	hasta pronto	soon
à + "tomorrow" (the lesson after)	hasta mañana	tomorrow

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à plus tard" (*ah ploo TAR*), then clipped "à plus" (*ah PLUSS*)
- "tard" then Spanish "tarde" — the same Latin *tarde*, "late"
- English "tardy, retard" — held back, late

Before you move on

What does *à plus tard* literally mean? ("To more late.") What Spanish word is *tard* identical to at the root, and what does each mean now? (*tarde* — French "late", Spanish "afternoon".) What preposition carries French's soft goodbyes, like Spanish *hasta*? (*à*.) Next: "see you soon."

4.3 à bientôt — "see you soon"

For when you'll genuinely meet again shortly: **à bientôt**, "see you soon" — the French twin of Spanish *hasta pronto*. It hides a word you already know from your first greetings: **bien**.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **bien** = *byan*, nasal (the sound you met in your first greetings).
- **bientôt** = *byan-TOH*; the circumflex on *ô* just marks a long *o*, and the final *t* is silent. Whole phrase: *ah byan-TOH*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à bientôt = "to soon" → "see you soon."

- **à** = "to" (the farewell preposition again).
- **bientôt** = "soon," and it's a compound you can pull apart: - **bien** = "well" (from Latin *bene*, the *bene* of *benefit*). - **tôt** = "early / soon." - Together, *bien + tôt* = "**well-soon**" → *quite soon*. (French loves gluing *bien* onto words for emphasis — *bientôt* "soon", *bienvenue* "welcome" = "well-come".)

The circumflex **ô** is itself a little history lesson: a circumflex usually marks an **s that dropped out** (*hôtel* was *hostel*, *forêt* was *forest*). *tôt* came from an older *tost* — so the hat on *ô* is the ghost of a lost *s*.

Grammar Lens: bien, the intensifier

You met *bien* as "well" (an answer to *ça va?*). Here it's doing a second job: **gluing onto another word to strengthen it** — *bien + tôt* = "soon indeed." Same word, new trick.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à bientôt" — *ah byan-TOH*
- pull it apart — "bien" (well) + "tôt" (early) = bientôt (soon)
- "à bientôt" = Spanish "hasta pronto" — see you soon

Before you move on

What two words hide inside *bientôt*? (*bien* "well" + *tôt* "early" → soon.) What does the circumflex on *ô* usually mark? (A dropped *s* — *tost* → *tôt*.) What's the Spanish equivalent of *à bientôt*? (*hasta pronto*.) Next: "until tomorrow."

4.4 à demain — "see you tomorrow"

Parting for the day: **à demain**, "until tomorrow" — the twin of Spanish *hasta mañana*. And *demain* shares a hidden root with *mañana* that's worth seeing.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **demain** = *duh-MAN*: the *-ain* is the nasal you heard in *bien*; the final consonant is silent. *ah duh-MAN*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à demain = "to tomorrow" → "see you tomorrow."

- **à** = "to" (the farewell preposition, one last time).
- **demain** = "tomorrow," from Latin **dē māne**, "**from the morning**": - **dē** = "from" · **māne** = "in the morning." - The next "morning" is *tomorrow* → *de mane* fused into **demain**.

English keeps *māne* too, in the poetic **matins** (morning prayers) and **matinée** (a *morning*/daytime show).

Why it's said this way

Spanish *mañana* ("tomorrow / morning") comes from Latin *(hōra) maneana* — built on the **same** *māne*, "morning." So French **demain** and Spanish **mañana** are cousins through one Latin word: both turn "morning" into "tomorrow," just assembled differently — French says *from-morning*, Spanish says *morning-ish hour*.

Grammar Lens: the "à ..." farewells, complete

Your French soft-goodbye set, mapped to Spanish:

French	Spanish	when
à plus tard / à plus	hasta luego	later (default)
à bientôt	hasta pronto	soon
à demain	hasta mañana	tomorrow

…and **au revoir** for the plain goodbye.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à demain" — *ah duh-MAN*
- "demain" ← *dē māne* "from morning"; Spanish "mañana" ← *maneana* — same *māne*
- the three "à …" goodbyes — à plus tard / à bientôt / à demain

Before you move on

What does *demain* literally come from? (*dē māne* — "from the morning.") What Spanish word shares that *māne* root? (*mañana.*) Which French goodbye for parting until tomorrow? (*à demain.*) Next: put the farewells together.

4.5 Practice — saying goodbye in French

No new words. The farewells — *au revoir* and the three *à …* goodbyes — now close a real conversation and fold back into everything since *salut.*

Your turn: choosing the right goodbye

you're...	**say**
parting plainly / politely	**au revoir**
expecting to meet again shortly	**à bientôt**
casual "see you"	**à plus (tard)**
leaving for the day	**à demain**

The exchange, start to finish

Everything from the French Chapters 1–4:

— Salut ! Je m'appelle Chloé. Comment tu t'appelles ? — Je m'appelle Marc. Enchanté. — Ça va ? — Ça va bien, merci, et toi ? — Bien. Bon… **à demain**, Marc. — Oui, **à demain**, Chloé. **Au revoir !**

What you've built this chapter

- **au revoir** — the plain goodbye ("until the seeing-again"; the *voir* / *vidēre* family; twin of German *auf Wiedersehen*).
- **à plus tard / à bientôt / à demain** — later / soon / tomorrow, all **à** + a time, mirroring Spanish's **hasta**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full conversation, both voices — *salut* to *au revoir*
- pick the goodbye — a friend you'll see tomorrow? (à demain); a polite plain goodbye? (au revoir)

Twice through: Run the exchange, greeting to goodbye, without stopping.

Before you move on

What does *au revoir* literally promise? (A *re-seeing* — "until we see again.") Which preposition carries French's soft goodbyes? (*à* — like Spanish *hasta*.) You can now hold a whole short French exchange, hello to goodbye. Next chapter: your first verbs — to speak, to live somewhere, to work.

4.6 é è ê — the three hats on *e*, and the one that hides an *s*

French sprinkles little marks over its vowels, and they are **not** decoration — each does a specific job. You've read one since *enchanté*, and another on the *à* of your goodbyes. Three of them ride on *e*, and one of the three hides a word you already know in English.

You'll want to know: the three accents, and what they do

- **é** — *accent aigu* (rising stroke, like Spanish's). It fixes the sound: **é = a crisp "ay"** (no glide). *enchanté*, *été* ("summer").

- **è** — *accent grave* (falling stroke). **è = an open "eh"** as in *bed*. *première* ("first" — English borrowed it as *premiere*), *Genève* ("Geneva"). The grave also just **separates look-alikes**: *a* ("has") vs **à** ("to") — same job as Spanish *tu/tú*.
- **ê** — *accent circonflexe* (a little hat). This one is a **fossil**.

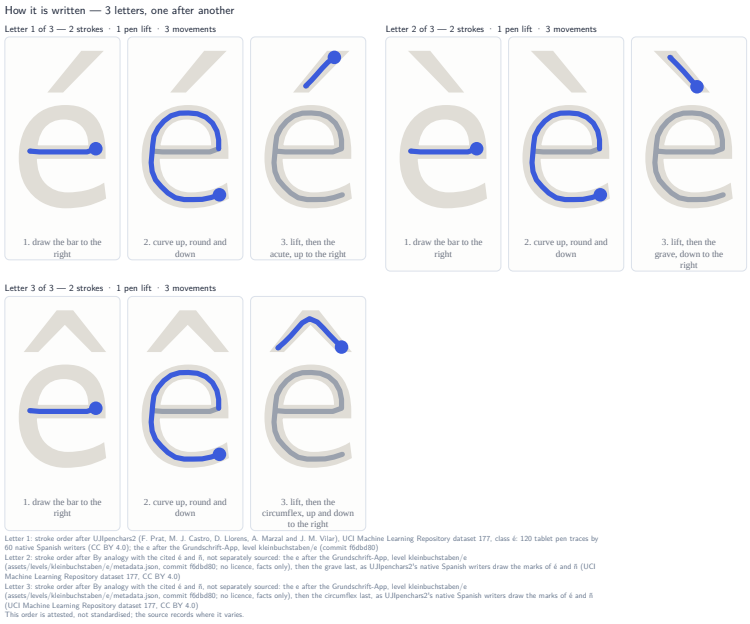
Why it's said this way

Centuries ago French dropped an *s* before certain consonants, and left a **hat** where it used to stand. English, having borrowed the older form, usually **still has that s** — so the circumflex is a decoder ring between the two languages:

French (hat)	**the lost *s***	**English kept it**
forêt	forest	**forest**
hôpital	hospital	**hospital**
île	isle	**isle / island**
bête	beste	**beast**
fête	feste	**feast**
pâte	paste	**paste / pasta**
goût	gust	(Latin *gustus*, cf. *gusto*)

So when you meet a circumflex, **mentally slot an *s* back in** and an English cousin often appears. *Hôpital* → *hospital*. It's the single most useful reading trick in French spelling.

Writing: the three accents



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: é, è, ê

All three are small strokes **above** the vowel: **é** leans right (up-stroke), **è** leans left (down-stroke), **ê** is a little peak (^). Get the *lean* right — *é* and *è* are different sounds, so the direction matters.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "é" = *ay* (*enchanté*), "è" = *eh* (*première*) — hear the two sounds
- forêt → forest, hôpital → hospital, île → isle — put the *s* back
- "à" vs "a" — the grave that only separates

Before you move on

Which accent makes *e* say "ay," and which "eh"? (*é* aigu = ay; *è* grave = eh.) What does the circumflex **ê** usually mark, and how do you use it? (A lost *s* — slot it back to find the English cousin: *forêt*

→ forest.) Next writing lesson: the little hook under *c* — the **cédille**.

4.7 ç — the little tail that softens *c*

You've seen it in **français** and **garçon**. The **cédille** is the tiny hook under a *c* — **ç** — and it exists to solve one specific spelling problem.

You'll want to know: the problem the cedilla solves

In French (as in Latin, Italian, Spanish), **c is soft (an *s* sound) before *e* and *i***, but **hard (a *k*) before *a*, *o*, *u***:

- *ce*, *ci* → soft: *ceci* = *suh-SEE*.
- *ca*, *co*, *cu* → hard: *car*, *comme*, *cure* = *k*.

So "franc-ais" would read *frank-ay* — wrong. To force the **soft** *s* before *a/o/u*, French adds the hook: **ç**.

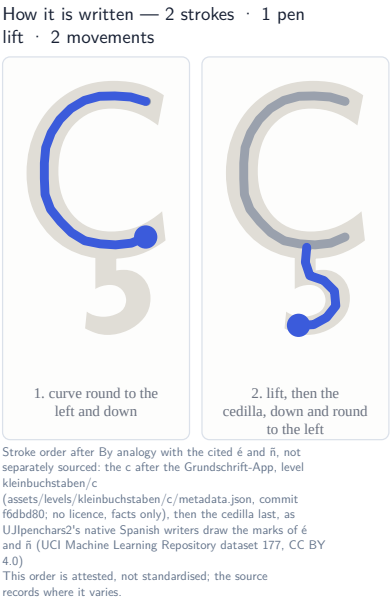
- **français** = *frahn-**SEH*** (not "frank-").
- **garçon** = *gar-**SOHN*** ("boy").
- **ça** = *sa* ("that" — the *ça* of *ça va?*).
- **reçu** = *ruh-**SU*** ("received").

The rule is tidy: **ç only ever appears before a, o, u** — never before *e/i*, where *c* is already soft and the hook would be pointless.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The *cédille* is literally **"a little *z*."** Its name is Spanish **zedilla** ("little zeta") — medieval scribes wrote a small subscript **z** under the *c* to say "pronounce this like *z/s*, not *k*." Over time the little *z* shrank into the hook you write today. So **ç = c + a ghost z.** (Spanish later dropped it; French and Portuguese kept it — *ç* is alive in *português* itself.)

Writing: the cedilla



How ç is written, stroke by stroke

Write a normal **c**, then add a small **hook curling left off the bottom**, like a tiny *5*'s tail. Only ever under *c*, only before *a/o/u*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "français", "garçon", "ça" — the ç forcing a soft *s*
- imagine no cédille — "franc-ais" as *frank-ay* — that's what it prevents

Before you move on

What does the cédille do, and before which letters does it appear? (Keeps *c* soft (*s*) — only before *a, o, u*.) What is the hook, historically? (A shrunken subscript *z* — Spanish *zedilla*, "little z".) Next writing lesson: the two dots — the **tréma**.

4.8 ï ë ü — the two dots that say "say me on my own"

The last French mark: two little dots over a vowel — the **tréma** (English calls it a *diaeresis*). It answers one question the reader would otherwise get wrong: **do these two vowels blend, or not?**

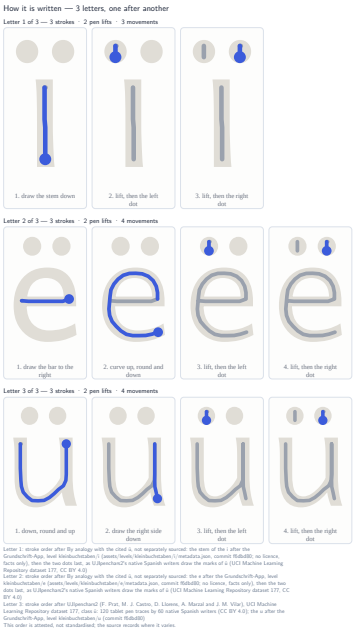
You'll want to know: the problem the trema solves

French loves to fuse vowel pairs into one sound: *a-i* says *eh*, *a-u oh*, *o-u oo*, *o-i wa*. Usually that's what you want. But sometimes two vowels really should be sounded **separately** — and the tréma is how the spelling says so: **"break these apart; pronounce the marked vowel on its own."**

- **naïve** = *na-**EEV*** (na-i, two syllables) — not "nave." (English kept the dots: *naïve*.)
- **Noël** = *no-**EL*** ("Christmas") — *o* and *e* separately, not "nurl."
- **maïs** = *ma-**EES*** ("corn"). Without the dots the same letters blend to *meh*, a different word: the dots flip the meaning.
- **Citroën**, **Israël**, **égoïste** — same rule: split the vowels.

So the tréma is the **opposite** of a blend instruction: where *a-i* says "merge," *aï* says "don't."

Writing: the trema



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ï, ë, ü

Two dots, side by side, **above** the vowel that starts its **own** sound — the *second* vowel of the pair (na-**ï**-ve). (It looks like a German umlaut, but the job is different: German ä/ö/ü *change* the vowel; the French tréma *separates* it. Same two dots, opposite purpose — that's the next lesson.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "naïve" = na-EEV, "Noël" = no-EL — two syllables each
- "maïs" (ma-EES, corn), then the blended *meh* the dots forbid

Before you move on

What does the tréma tell you to do? (Pronounce the two vowels **separately**, not blended.) How is it different from a German umlaut? (Tréma *separates* vowels; umlaut *changes* a vowel's sound.) That's the French writing kit: **é è ê**, **ç**, and **ï ë**.

4.9 à — one word, three goodbyes

Three soft goodbyes, from memory. Say all three, then say the one word every one of them begins with.

You'll want to know: the soft goodbyes are all à plus a time

à plus tard	to more late — later, the default
à bientôt	to well-soon — soon
à demain	to tomorrow

One preposition and a word for *when*. Choosing between them is choosing a distance in time, and nothing else about the sentence moves.

bonne nuit is not in that family and is worth keeping apart: it is for someone going to **bed**, not for someone leaving a room. Said on the way out of an afternoon meeting it lands oddly.

Grammar Lens: tu and vous, and where the choice actually shows

tu is the familiar you, for a friend or a peer; *vous* is the formal or plural one, for a stranger, an elder, a group. The climb is visible in the question: **Comment vas-tu ?** against **Comment allez-vous ?** The verb changes with the pronoun, so the choice is not a single word you can swap late — it is decided before the sentence starts.

What you've built — thanks, and the shrug

merci and its reply **de rien**, "of nothing" — the same modesty Spanish reaches for with *de nada*.
And the shrug: **comme ci, comme ça**, "like this, like that". Every language paints that gesture differently — Spanish weighs it (*más o menos*, more or less), Italian doubles a word (*così così*), French points twice. One gesture, three pictures.

Before you move on

What do the three soft goodbyes share? (**à**, plus a word for when.) Who is **bonne nuit** for? (**Someone going to bed.**) Where does the tu-vous choice show itself? (**In the verb** — *vas-tu* against

allez-vous.) And what does **de rien** say literally? (**Of nothing.**)

4.10 ê ç ï — three marks, three different jobs

forêt, **hôpital**, **île**. One letter is missing from each, and English still has it. Say which letter, before reading on.

Script: what each mark is actually for

The three arrived a page apart and do three unrelated jobs. Sorted by what they change, they stop looking like a single topic called *accents*:

mark	what it changes
ê the circumflex	**nothing you say** — it records an *s* that fell out
ç the cédille	**the sound** — it keeps **c** soft before a, o, u
ï the tréma	**the grouping** — read this vowel on its own

The circumflex is the odd one and the useful one. French dropped an *s* before certain consonants and left a hat where it stood; English borrowed the older spelling and kept the *s*. So **forêt** is forest, **hôpital** is hospital, **île** is isle. **A hat is a decoder ring**, not a pronunciation instruction.

The other two are instructions. **ç** exists because **c** would otherwise go hard before those three vowels; **ï** exists because two vowels side by side would otherwise be read as one sound.

Your turn

- *Look:* at a word with a hat and say the English word that kept the *s*
- *Say it:* a **c** before **a** with the hook and without it
- *Say it:* two vowels with the tréma and without, and hear them split
- *Trace it:* each of the three marks once

Before you move on

Which of the three changes nothing you say? (**The circumflex**.)
What does it record? (**A lost *s***, which English usually still has.)
What does the cédille stop happening? (**A hard c** before a, o, u.)
And what does the tréma ask you to do? (**Read the vowel separately**.)

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build short present-tense French sentences with the chapter's first verbs.
>
> *Until now you have assembled fixed phrases. This chapter hands you a pattern instead: the regular -er verbs, the largest verb family in French by a wide margin. Learn the one template and thousands of verbs come with it — and with it you build your first sentence that nobody handed you pre-made.*

5.1 parler — "to speak," and the great regular French verb

Until now you've assembled fixed phrases. **parler** ("to speak") is your first real **verb** — and it's the model for the **biggest** French verb family by far: the **-er** verbs. Learn this one pattern and you can drive thousands.

Sounds you'll need

- `er-ending` — the infinitive **-er** is a clean *ay*: **parler** = *par-LAY* (the *r* is silent in the ending). The stem is *parl-*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parler comes from Late Latin **parabolāre**, *"to tell parables, to discourse"* — from **parabola**, "a comparison, a speech" (itself from

Greek *parabolē*, "a throwing-beside"). So to *speak*, in French, is at root to *tell parables*. That root fans into English:

- **parable** — the story-comparison itself.
- **parole** — a spoken word of honour (a prisoner's *parole*).
- **palaver** — a long talk; **parley** — to talk terms; even **parliament** — a *talking*-place.

Grammar Lens: the -er present tense (and its silent trap)

Drop **-er**, add the ending for the person:

person	**ending, on *parler***	**sounds like**
je	**-e**: **je parle**	*parl*
tu	**-es**: **tu parles**	*parl*
il / elle	**-e**: **il parle**	*parl*
nous	-ons: **nous parlons**	par-LON
vous	-ez: **vous parlez**	par-LAY
ils / elles	**-ent**: **ils parlent**	*parl*

Here is the great French surprise: **-e, -es, and -ent are all SILENT** — *je parle*, *tu parles*, *ils parlent* **all sound identical**, just *parl*. Only *nous* (*-ons*) and *vous* (*-ez*) are audible.

Grammar Lens: why French keeps its pronouns

That silence has a consequence which shapes the whole language. In Spanish the ending alone tells you who is speaking — *hablo* ("I speak") against *hablas* ("you speak") — so the pronoun can be dropped. In French your ear cannot hear any difference between *parle*, *parles* and *parlent*, so the **pronoun must stay** to carry the person. *Je* and *tu* are not optional decoration in French; they are the only thing telling you who is doing the speaking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "parler" — *par-LAY*
- "je parle, tu parles, il parle" — all *parl*, identical

- "parler" then English "parable, parole, palaver" — the *parabola* root

Before you move on

What Latin word is *parler* from, and its English cousins? (*parabolāre* ← *parabola* — parable, parole.) Which three present-tense endings are silent? (*-e, -es, -ent* — je/tu/ils all sound *parl.*) Why does French keep *je/tu* when Spanish drops *yo/tú*? (The endings are silent, so the pronoun carries the person.) Next: the verb "to live."

5.2 habiter — "to live," and it's about *having a place*

A second **-er** verb — snap it into the exact template you just learned. **habiter** ("to live, to dwell") lets you say *where* you live, the answer to a "where?" question.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the **h is silent** (French *h* never sounds): **habiter** = *a-bee-TAY*. Same *-er* = *ay* ending as *parler*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

habiter comes from Latin **habitāre**, *"to dwell, to keep on having [a place]"* — the **frequentative** of **habēre**, "to have." To *dwell* somewhere is to *keep having* it as your place. That root is thoroughly English:

- **habitat** — the place a creature dwells.
- **inhabit**, **inhabitant**, **habitation** — to dwell in / one who dwells.
- and (via *habēre*, "have") **habit** — what you "keep having," and **able**, **ability** (what you "have" it in you to do).

Grammar Lens: same -er template

Drop **-er**, add the endings — identical to *parler*, silent trap and all: | j'habite · tu habites · il habite | (all *a-BEET*) |

| nous habitons · vous habitez | (a-bee-TON · a-bee-TAY) |
Note **j'habite** — *je* elides to **j'** before the vowel of *habite* (the *h* is silent, so it counts as a vowel). Now you can say where you live:

J'habite à Paris. — "I live in Paris."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "habiter" — *a-bee-TAY*, silent *h*
- "j'habite, tu habites, il habite" — all *a-BEET*
- "habiter" then English "habitat, inhabit" — the *habitāre* root

Before you move on

What Latin verb is *habiter* from, and what does it literally involve? (*habitāre*, "keep having a place" — from *habēre*, "to have.") English cousins? (Habitat, inhabit, habitation.) Say "I live in Paris." (*J'habite à Paris.*) Next: the verb "to work."

5.3 travailler — "to work," and the torture behind "travel"

A third **-er** verb, and it shares its dark, delightful origin with a Spanish word you may already know: **travailler** ("to work") began as a word for **torture**, and it's the secret ancestor of English **travel**.

Sounds you'll need

- `ai-y` — the **-ill-** is a *y* glide: **travailler** = *tra-va-YAY*. Same *-er* = *ay* ending.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

travailler comes from Vulgar Latin **tripaliāre**, *"to torture"* — from **tripalium**, a Roman instrument of torture made of **three stakes** (*tri-* "three" + *pālus* "stake" → English *pale*, *impale*).

The slide of meaning is grim and logical: *torture* → *painful toil* → **work**. And two English words came down the same road:

- **travail** — painful, laborious effort.
- **travel** — journeying was once such an **ordeal** that *travail* (toil) became *travel* (to make a journey). You are, etymologically, *tortured* every time you travel.

Why it's said this way

Spanish **trabajar** ("to work") comes from the very same *tripaliāre* — a perfect cross-language twin, torture and all. The middle of the word went one way in each language: the *-al-* stayed in French (*travail*, *travailler*) and softened to *-aj-* in Spanish (*trabajo*, *trabajar*).

Grammar Lens: same -er template

| je travaille · tu travailles · il travaille | (all *tra-VYE*) |
| nous travaillons · vous travaillez | |

Je travaille à Paris. — "I work in Paris."

Nothing new to learn — that's the point. **One template, every -er verb.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "travailler" — *tra-va-YAY*
- "je travaille" — *je tra-VYE*, "I work"
- travailler → travail → travel — torture became a journey; twin of Spanish *trabajar*

Before you move on

What did *travailler* originally mean, and from what device? ("To torture," ← *tripalium*, three stakes.) What two English words share the root? (*Travail* and *travel*.) Its Spanish twin? (*Trabajar* — same

tripaliāre.) Next: build your first full sentence — "I speak French."

5.4 Je parle français — your first real sentence

The moment it all pays off: you take a **verb** you conjugated and a **noun**, and build a sentence **no one handed you pre-made** — *Je parle français*, "I speak French."

Sounds you'll need

- `soft-c-s` — **français** = *frahn-SEH*. The cedilla under the **ç** forces a soft *s* where a plain *c* would have been hard.
- The opening *fran-* is nasal, and the final *-ais* is a plain *eh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

français = "French" — both the language and a French person — from **Francia**, "land of the **Franks**": the Germanic people who settled Roman Gaul and gave France its name. And here is the twist: the Franks' own name meant **"free."** That is why English **frank** and **frankly** mean open and unguarded, and why the old French coin was called a *franc*.

Grammar Lens: two rules hiding in four words

Snap together two things you own:

> **Je** (I, ← *ego*) + **parle** (speak, from *parler*) = **Je parle français.**

A complete, grammatical French sentence. Two rules are hiding in it:

- **You keep the *je*.** Spanish drops its pronoun — *hablo español* says "I speak Spanish" with no word for "I," because the ending *-o* carries the person. French cannot do that: *parle*, *parles* and *parlent* all sound alike, so **the pronoun must stay**. This is the single biggest structural difference between French and its Iberian cousins.
- **No article on the language** here: *je parle français*, not *je parle le français*.

Swap the pieces and it generates:

- **J'habite à Paris.** — "I live in Paris."
- **Tu parles français ?** — "Do you speak French?" (just raise the tone).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Je parle français" — *zhuh parl frahn-SEH*
- keep the *je* — French can't drop it (unlike Spanish *hablo*)
- swap — "Tu parles français ?", "J'habite à Paris"

Before you move on

Where does *français* come from, and what did the Franks' name mean? (*Francia*, "land of the Franks"; the name meant "free" — English *frank*.) Why must French keep *je* where Spanish drops *yo*? (French endings are silent, so the pronoun carries the person.) Next: practice.

5.5 Practice — making sentences with -er verbs

For the first time you're not reciting phrases — you're **building** sentences from a pattern. Drill the three verbs, and burn in the French rule the whole language turns on: **keep the pronoun** (the endings are silent).

Your turn: conjugate on command

Run each through *je / tu / il*:

- **parler**: je parle · tu parles · il parle — all **parl**
- **habiter**: j'habite · tu habites · il habite — all **a-beet**
- **travailler**: je travaille · tu travailles · il travaille — all **tra-vye**

Every singular form (and the *ils* form) **sounds the same** — the *-e/-es/ -ent* are silent. That's why *je, tu, il* stay put: they carry the person your ear can't hear.

Your turn: say something real

— **Tu parles** français ? — Oui, je **parle** français. (Do you speak French? — Yes, I speak French.) — **Tu habites** à Lyon ? — Oui, **j'habite** à Lyon. Je **travaille** à Paris. — Merci ! — De rien.

What you've built this chapter

- **the regular -er present tense** — drop *-er*, add *-e/-es/-e/-ons/ -ez/-ent*; the singular + *ils* endings are **silent**, so the pronoun is mandatory (the big contrast with Spanish/Italian pro-drop).
- **parler** (← *parabolāre* → parable/parole), **habiter** (← *habitāre* → habitat/inhabit), **travailler** (← *tripalium* → travail/travel; twin of Spanish *trabajar*).
- **Je parle français** — your first self-assembled sentence (*français* ← *Francia*, the Franks = "free").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- conjugate all three verbs, je/tu/il — hear that they don't change
- answer about yourself — where you live, where you work, what you speak
- chain it — "Bonjour ! Je parle français. Tu parles français ? … Au revoir !"

Twice through: "Tu parles français ? — Oui, je parle français."

Before you move on

Which -er endings are silent, and what follows from that? (*-e, -es, -ent* — so French keeps its subject pronouns.) Give "I" forms of the three verbs. (*Je parle, j'habite, je travaille.*) Say "I live in Paris. I

work in Lyon." (*J'habite à Paris. Je travaille à Lyon.*) French now moves in real sentences.

Chapter 6

Numbers One to Ten

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (12) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from one to ten in French and use the numbers in a short exchange.
>
> *The ten most-reused words in the language, taken one at a time. Each is a Latin numeral that barely moved on its way into French, so English has already handed you half of them — and four of them left a copy of themselves in the calendar, still counting two months out of place.*

6.1 un — one

Numbers are the most-reused words in any language, and French inherited them from Latin almost unchanged. You already half-know them through English. We take them **one at a time**, starting with the first.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-un` — **un** is a **nasal vowel**, close to "uh" hummed through the nose. No *n* is ever pronounced. The letters *u*-*n* are a single sound, not two.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

un (1) comes from Latin **ūnus**, and that root is everywhere in English:

- **unit** — one thing counted

- **union** — many made one
- **unique** — one of its kind
- **universe** — everything turned into one

English **one** and **a/an** descend from the same ancient word, worn down at home rather than borrowed. Spanish keeps the Latin shape more plainly: *uno*.

Grammar Lens: one word for "one" and "a"

French draws no line between "one" and "a/an." **un** does both jobs, and it takes the gender of the noun it stands in front of:

- **un** before a masculine noun — *un jour*, "a day" **or** "one day"
- **une** before a feminine noun — *une nuit*, "a night" **or** "one night"

You met that same masculine/feminine split in *le* and *la*. It is the same split, on a different word. Spanish does exactly this too (*un* / *una*). The counting words that follow never change shape; this first one is the only one that does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un" — hum it through the nose, no *n* at the end
- "un jour" then "une nuit" — same word, two genders
- "un" then English "unit, union, unique" — hear the ūnus

Before you move on

How do you say one in French? (**un**, nasal, with no *n* sounded.) What two things does it mean? (**One**, and **a/an**.) What is its feminine form, and when do you use it? (**une**, before a feminine noun — *une nuit*.) Next: the number two.

6.2 deux — two

One down. The second number brings a vowel your mouth has to be taught, and a final letter you must **not** say.

Travailler and Spanish *trabajar* are twins from one Latin word: French kept the *-al-*, Spanish softened it to *-aj-*.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-eu` — say "eh," then round your lips as if for "oo" without moving your tongue. That rounded *eu* is the whole word: **deux** = *deuh*.
- `silent-final` — the **x** is silent. French writes letters at the end of a word that it has stopped pronouncing, and this is your first one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

deux (2) comes from Latin **duo**, which English borrowed several times over:

- **duo** — two performers
- **dual**, **duel** — of two
- **duet** — a piece for two
- **double** — Latin *duplus*, "two-fold"

Spanish went the other way with the same word and wore it down to *dos*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "deux" — round the lips, stop before the *x*
- "un, deux" — count what you have so far
- "deux jours" — two days

Before you move on

How do you say two? (**deux**, *deuh.*) What happens to the **x**? (Nothing — it is silent.) Which English words carry the same Latin *duo*? (*Duo, dual, duet, double.*) Count what you have. (*Un, deux.*) Next: the number three.

6.3 trois — three

The third number shows you the most French vowel spelling there is: **oi**, which sounds nothing like either letter in it.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — the pair **oi** is always *wa*. So **trois** = *trwa*.
- `silent-final` — the **s** is silent here, exactly as the *x* was in *deux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trois (3) comes from Latin **trēs**. Look at what happened next: French turned it into *trois* and Spanish into *tres*. **Same Roman word, worn two different ways** — the clearest picture yet of how one language becomes two.
English took the Latin form whole, over and over:

- **trio** — three players
- **triple** — three-fold
- **trident** — three teeth
- **triangle** — three corners

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "trois" — *trwa*, one syllable
- "un, deux, trois" — the count so far
- "trois" then Spanish "tres" — one Latin word, two shapes

Before you move on

How do you say three? (**trois**, *trwa.*) What sound does **oi** always make? (*Wa.*) Which Latin word gave both *trois* and Spanish *tres*? (**trēs.**) Count to three. (*Un, deux, trois.*) Next: the number four.

6.4 quatre — four

The fourth number is the first that runs to two syllables, and it ends in a letter French writes but barely breathes.

Sounds you'll need

- **quatre** = *KA-truh.* The **qu-** is a plain *k*; no *w* sound survives.
- `silent-final-e` — the closing **-e** is a whisper, not a vowel you lean on.
- `r-uvular` — the French **r** is made at the back of the throat, near where you would gargle, and never rolled at the tip of the tongue.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatre (4) comes from Latin **quattuor**. English borrowed the Latin stem and kept the *qua-* visible in every one:

- **quart** — a fourth of a gallon
- **quarter** — a fourth of anything
- **quatrain** — a four-line verse
- **quadrant** — a quarter of a circle

Spanish stayed nearer the Latin with *cuatro*; French compressed the middle of the word away.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quatre" — *KA-truh*, the *r* at the back of the throat

- "un, deux, trois, quatre"
- "quatre" then English "quarter, quadrant" — the same *quattuor*

Before you move on

How do you say four? (**quatre**, *KA-truh.*) Where in your mouth is the French **r** made? (At the **back of the throat**.) Which English words come from *quattuor*? (*Quart, quarter, quatrain, quadrant.*) Next: the number five, which closes the first hand.

6.5 cinq — five

Five closes the first hand — and this one came into English so completely that you have handled it on a pair of dice.

Sounds you'll need

- `soft-c-s` — a **c** before *i* or *e* is an *s*. So **cinq** opens with *s*, not *k*.
- `nasal-in` — the **in** is nasal, like the *un* you met in **un**, but with the tongue further forward. The **q** at the end **is** sounded: *sank*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinq (5) comes from Latin **quīnque**. English took the Latin stem for counting words:

- **quintet** — five players
- **quintessence** — the *fifth* essence, the one the ancients set above earth, water, air and fire

And English took the **French** word whole for one job: **cinque**, the five on a die or a playing card. Spanish, again, kept the Latin *q*: *cinco*.

Grammar Lens: what the first five have in common

Set the five beside their Latin parents and one fact stands out: **the numbers barely moved.** *ūnus, duo, trēs, quattuor, quīnque* went into French as the five words you have learned, and into Spanish as *uno, dos, tres, cuatro, cinco*. Words used every day by every speaker

are the words a language changes least.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "cinq" — *sank*, the *q* sounded
- "un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq" — count the whole hand
- "cinq jours" — five days

Twice through: "un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq"

Before you move on

How do you say five? (**cinq**, *sank.*) Why does the **c** sound like *s*? (It stands before **i**.) Which English word for the 5 on a die is French? (**cinque**.) Count to five. (*Un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq.*) Next: the number six, and a rule about final letters that turn on and off.

6.6 six — six

Six is spelled like the English word and means the same thing. The new thing here is not the word. It is that its last sound **switches on and off** depending on what follows.

Sounds you'll need

- Counting on its own, **six** ends in an *s* sound: *sees.*
- The **i** is the short, tight vowel of English *machine*, not of *sit.*

Grammar Lens: a final letter that comes and goes

French final consonants are not a fixed yes or no. **six** has three settings, and which one you hear is decided by the next word:

- **counting, or standing alone** — the *s* is sounded: *sees*
- **before a consonant** — the *s* falls silent: *six livres* = *see livres*
- **before a vowel** — it comes back voiced, as a *z*: *six ans* =

*see-**z**-ans*

That third case is called **liaison**: a silent ending waking up to bridge into a vowel. French does this constantly, and you will meet it in every chapter from here on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

six (6) comes from Latin **sex**, which is where English got:

- **sextet** — six players
- **sextant** — an instrument marking a sixth of a circle
- **semester** — Latin *sex mensis*, "six months"

Spanish made *seis* from the same *sex*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "six" alone — *sees*, the *s* sounded
- "six livres" — *see livres*, the *s* gone
- the count so far, one through six
- "six ans" — *see-z-ans*, the *s* back as a *z*

Before you move on

How do you say six when counting? (*Sees*, with the *s*.) What happens to that *s* before a consonant? (It **goes silent** — *six livres*.) And before a vowel? (It returns as a **z** — *six ans*. That is **liaison**.) Next: the number seven, and a secret hidden in the calendar.

6.7 sept — seven

Seven is the first of four numbers that left a copy of themselves in the calendar. Learn the number and you have been handed a month.

Sounds you'll need

- **sept** = *set*. The **p** is written and never spoken.
- The final **t**, unusually, **is** spoken. French keeps a handful of final consonants alive, and this is one of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sept (7) comes from Latin **septem**. The same *septem* stands, undisguised, at the front of a month you already know:

- **septembre** — French for September
- **septet** — seven players

The month is worth staring at. *Septembre* announces itself as the **seventh**, and everybody uses it as the ninth. That gap has an explanation, and it is waiting at the end of this chapter. Spanish made *siete* from the same *septem*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sept" — *set*, no *p*
- the count so far, one through seven
- "sept" then English "September" — the seven inside the month

Before you move on

How do you say seven? (**sept**, *set*.) Which written letter is silent? (The **p**.) Which month carries the same Latin *septem*? (**September**, in French as in English — the ninth month, for a reason we come to.) Next: the number eight.

6.8 huit — eight

Every number so far has looked like its Latin parent. This one looks like nothing at all — and that is the lesson.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — French never pronounces a written **h**. Not here, not anywhere.
- **huit** = *weet*, with the final **t** sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

huit (8) comes from Latin **octō**, and the road it travelled is worth following step by step:

octō → *oit* → **huit**

The *c* dropped out, the vowels softened, and a written *h* grew on the front as a prop. The number came out unrecognisable. English, which borrowed the Latin form directly, kept it whole in **octave**, **octagon** and **octopus** — the eight-armed one.
Here is the consolation: French kept the old shape in the **month**. **Octobre** still carries *oct-* in plain sight. The eight vanished from the number and survived in the calendar. Spanish made *ocho*, which sits about halfway along the same road.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "huit" — *weet*, no *h*, with the *t*
- the count so far, one through eight
- the road — "octō, oit, huit" — then the month, where the *oct-* held (English "October" kept it too)

Before you move on

How do you say eight? (**huit**, *weet*.) What does French do with a written **h**? (Never pronounces it.) Which Latin word is *huit* worn down from, and where can you still see it? (**octō** — kept intact in the month: French's, and English **October**.) Next: the number nine.

6.9 neuf — nine

You met a final letter that goes silent before a consonant. Nine shows you the other move: a final letter that **changes shape** to reach a vowel.

Sounds you'll need

- **neuf** = *nuhf*. The vowel is the rounded *eu* you learned in **deux**, and the **f** is sounded.

Grammar Lens: the f that turns into a v

Standing before a vowel, the **f** of *neuf* softens into a **v**:

- **neuf ans** ("nine years") = *neu-**v**-ans*
- **neuf heures** ("nine o'clock") = *neu-**v**-eures*

This is the same instinct you saw in *six ans*: French will not let a consonant sit awkwardly against a following vowel, so it bends the sound to bridge them. With *six* the ending woke up as a *z*; with *neuf* it softens to a *v*. Both are liaison, doing the one job of keeping the line smooth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neuf (9) comes from Latin **novem**. Once again the month kept the number visible: **novembre** wears its *nov-* on the outside, and English has **novena**, a devotion of nine days. Spanish made *nueve*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "neuf" — *nuhf*, with the *f*
- "neuf ans" — *neu-v-ans*, the *f* softened
- "six ans, neuf ans" — a *z* and a *v*, the same bridging move

Before you move on

How do you say nine? (**neuf**, *nuhf.*) What happens to the **f** before a vowel? (It becomes a **v** — *neuf ans.*) Which month keeps the same Latin *novem*? (**November**, in French as in English.) Next: the number ten, and the count is complete.

6.10 dix — ten

The last number of the count, and the one you have been carrying in your pocket in English without knowing it.

Sounds you'll need

- Counting on its own, **dix** ends in an *s* sound: *dees.*
- It behaves exactly like **six**: silent before a consonant (*dix livres* = *dee livres*), and back as a *z* before a vowel (*dix ans* = *dee-**z**-ans*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix (10) comes from Latin **decem**, and it has left tracks in three places you already walk:

- **décembre** — the month that says "ten"
- **decimal** — counting by tens
- **dime** — a tenth of a dollar. That one came through Old French **disme**, from Latin *decima*, "a tenth." The coin in an American pocket is a French word for a tenth part.

Spanish made *diez* from the same *decem.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix" alone — *dees*
- "dix livres", then "dix ans" — silent, then *z*
- "dix" then English "decimal, dime" — the *decem* in both

Before you move on

How do you say ten on its own? (**dix**, *dees.*) Which other number shares its on-and-off ending? (**six**.) Which American coin is a worn-down French word for a tenth? (The **dime**, from *disme* ← *decima.*) Next: why those four months are counting wrong.

6.11 The months that are off by two

Four times in this chapter a number turned up at the front of a month, and four times the arithmetic was wrong by two. Here is why.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Line up what the four months **say** against where they **sit**:

month	**says**	**sits at**
septembre	seven (*septem*)	9th
octobre	eight (*octō*)	10th
novembre	nine (*novem*)	11th
décembre	ten (*decem*)	12th

Every one is two places late, and all four are late by the **same** two places. A single event moved them.

The old Roman year began in **March**, not January. Counting from March, *September* genuinely was the seventh month and *December* the tenth — the names were accurate. Later, two months named for **Julius Caesar** and the emperor **Augustus** were fixed into the middle of the year, and the start of the year was moved back to January. The counting months were shoved two places along. Their Latin names never caught up.

So every December, in French and in English alike, you are saying the Roman word for **ten**. Spanish carries the identical fault: *diciembre* is *decem* too.

Before you move on

What does *septembre* mean, and which month is it? (**Seven** — and it is the ninth.) In which month did the old Roman year begin? (**March**.) Which two months were pushed in, and for whom? (The

two named for **Julius Caesar** and **Augustus**.) What number are you saying when you say *décembre*? (**Ten**, Latin *decem*.)

6.12 Practice — counting to ten, out loud and in use

Ten words, taken one at a time. Now run them together until the chain is one motion, then put it to work.

Your turn: the whole count

Up, then down:

un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq, six, sept, huit, neuf, dix

Twice through: the count from one to ten

Then backwards, which is where a memorised chant stops helping and the words have to be individually yours: *dix, neuf, huit, sept, six, cinq, quatre, trois, deux, un.*

Your turn: the endings that move

Three numbers change sound depending on what comes next. Say each pair and listen for the difference:

- *six livres* / *six ans* — silent, then **z**
- *dix livres* / *dix ans* — silent, then **z**
- *neuf livres* / *neuf ans* — **f**, then **v**

Your turn: say something real

— Bonjour ! **Un** jour ? — Non, **deux** jours.

— **Trois** ? — Non, **deux**. Merci !

— De rien. Bonne nuit — **une** nuit, **deux** nuits.

Say how many, then correct yourself. The exchange is short on purpose: every word in it is already yours, from this chapter or from the first.

What you've built this chapter

- **un** to **dix** — the ten most-reused words in the language, each of them a Latin numeral that barely moved on the way in.
- **un / une** — the number one doubling as "a/an," and taking gender.
- **liaison** — *six*, *dix* and *neuf* changing their final sound to reach a following vowel.
- **the four months at the end of the year** — still counting seven to ten, two places out of place ever since the Roman year stopped starting in March.

Before you move on

Count from one to ten without stopping. Now backwards. Which three numbers change their ending before a vowel, and how? (*Six* and *dix* to a **z**, *neuf* to a **v**.) What is the difference between *un jour* and *une nuit*? (Gender — the same word for "one" and "a," agreeing with the noun.) Why does the twelfth month say **ten**? (The Roman year began in **March**, and two months were later inserted.)

Chapter 7

The Days of the Week

Modes: **voice** (7) **eyes** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 7 of 9 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the days of the week in French and use them in simple plans.

Seven day-names that are a map of the sky. Five carry a Roman planet-god and all of them carry Latin dies, "day" – so half of every weekday comes free, and English names the same gods on the same days under Germanic names. Then two days where a later faith wrote over the planets entirely.

7.1 la lune — the Moon

The seven-day week is one of the oldest things any language carries, and the French day-names are a **map of the sky**. Before we read the map, one of the objects on it.

Sounds you'll need

- `front-rounded-u` — the French **u** has no English equivalent. Say "ee," and then, without moving your tongue, round your lips as though for "oo." That is **u**. So **lune** is *lün*, never *loon*.
- `silent-final-e` — the closing **-e** is a whisper, not a syllable of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la lune is feminine, so it takes **la**, the article you already know. It comes from Latin **lūna**, which English kept in a small family:

- **lunar** — of the Moon
- **lunation** — one full cycle of it
- **lunatic** — someone the Moon was believed to have unsettled, back when moonlight was thought to disturb the mind

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lune" — *lün*, lips rounded and tongue forward
- "la lune" — feminine, so *la*
- "lune" then English "lunar, lunatic" — the same *lūna*

Before you move on

How do you say the Moon? (**la lune**, *la lün.*) Which article does it take, and why? (**la** — the word is feminine.) How do you make the French **u**? (Say "ee," then round the lips without moving the tongue.) Next: the day named after it.

7.2 lundi — Monday

You have the Moon. Add one ending and you have the first day of the week — and, with it, the second half of five more words.

Sounds you'll need

- **lundi** = *luh(n)-DEE*, opening with the nasal *un* you met in the number **un**.
- The weight falls on the **second** syllable. French leans on the end of a word where English leans near the front: *MON-day* against *lun-DI.*

Grammar Lens: every weekday ends in "day"

Every French weekday ends in **-di**, always said *DEE*. That **-di** is Latin **diēs**, "day" — the same word English puts at the *end* of *Monday*, and French puts at the end too.
So a French weekday reads as **"[god]'s day,"** the god in front and the day behind:

> **lundi** = *lūnae* ("of the Moon") + *diēs* ("day") = **the Moon's day**

The Romans named each day for a planet-god, and the planets were the gods. Learn to hear that **-di** and half of five more words is already yours.

Why it's said this way

English *Monday* says the identical thing — *Moon* plus *day* — but out of Germanic parts rather than Latin ones. The two languages did not copy each other. They inherited the **same Roman week** and each translated it into its own words. That is why the days will keep lining up as we go, and why they will line up through their *meanings* rather than their sounds.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lundi" — *luh(n)-DEE*, weight on the end
- it split — "lune" plus "-di": the Moon's day
- "lundi, Monday" — the same sentence in two languages

Before you move on

How do you say Monday? (**lundi**, *luh(n)-DEE*.) What does the **-di** mean, and from which Latin word? ("Day," from **diēs**.) What does *lundi* mean once you take it apart, and what does *Monday* mean? (Both: **the Moon's day**.) Next: the day of the war-god.

7.3 mardi — Tuesday

The second day carries the best story in the week: *mardi* and *Tuesday* look nothing alike and are, underneath, exactly the same word.

Sounds you'll need

- **mardi** = *mar-DEE*, with the **r** made at the back of the throat, as in **quatre**.
- The familiar **-di** closes it, so only the first syllable is new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mardi is **Martis diēs**, "the day of **Mars**" — the god of war, and the red planet named for him.

Why it's said this way

English *Tuesday* is named for **Tiw**, the Germanic war-god. French *mardi* is named for **Mars**, the Roman one. Different gods, different sounds — and the **same day**, because it is the same slot in the same week.

Here is how that happened. The Romans mapped their gods onto the planets and named the days for them. When the week reached the Germanic-speaking peoples, they did not borrow the Roman names; they **swapped in their own gods**, matching them role for role. Scholars call that *interpretatio germanica*: translating a pantheon rather than a word.

So the two languages will keep agreeing about **which** god each day belongs to while disagreeing about that god's name. Once you know that, every remaining weekday has an English key.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mardi" — *mar-DEE*, the *r* at the back of the throat
- "lundi, mardi" — the first two, both ending *DEE*
- the bridge — "mardi is Mars, Tuesday is Tiw, both the war-god"

Before you move on

How do you say Tuesday? (**mardi**, *mar-DEE.*) Which god is it named for? (**Mars**, the war-god.) Why do *mardi* and *Tuesday* line up despite sharing no sound? (Same day, same role — Latin used *Mars*, the Germanic peoples put in their own war-god **Tiw**.) Next: the messenger's day.

7.4 mercredi — Wednesday

The longest day-name of the week, and the first place to try the key you were handed: find the god, and English will tell you the day.

Sounds you'll need

- **mercredi** = *mair-kruh-DEE*, three syllables with the weight at the end.
- Two throat-**r** sounds in one word, one in each of the first two syllables. Take it slowly; this word is worth drilling on its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mercredi is **Mercuriī diēs**, "the day of **Mercury**" — the messenger of the gods, and the swiftest planet. English kept the god's name in **mercurial**, "quick-changing," and gave it to the metal that runs like water.

Why it's said this way

Apply the key from *mardi*. English *Wednesday* is **Woden's day** — and Woden is the god the Romans matched to Mercury, both of them travellers, guides and carriers of the dead. Same day, same role, two names. English still spells the *d* it stopped pronouncing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mercredi" — *mair-kruh-DEE*, slowly, both *r* sounds at the back

- "lundi, mardi, mercredi" — three down
- the key again — "Mercury for the Romans, Woden for the Germanic peoples, one day"

Before you move on

How do you say Wednesday? (**mercredi**, *mair-kruh-DEE.*) Which god is it named for? (**Mercury**, the messenger.) Which god does English name the same day for? (**Woden** — the god Rome matched to Mercury.) Next: the day of the king of the gods.

7.5 jeudi — Thursday

The fourth day belongs to the king of the gods, and it introduces the sound most people get wrong on their first attempt at French.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the French **j** is the soft buzz in the middle of English *mea**s**ure* or *vi**si**on*. It is never the hard *j* of *jam*.
- `vowel-eu` — the rounded *eu* you learned in **deux**.
- Together: **jeudi** = *zheu-DEE*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeudi is **Jovis diēs**, "the day of **Jove**" — Jove being the other name of **Jupiter**, king of the gods and the largest planet. English keeps *Jove* in the phrase *by Jove*, and keeps the god's temperament in **jovial**: cheerful, the way people born under Jupiter were said to be.

Why it's said this way

The key once more. English *Thursday* is **Thor's day** — Thor, the thunder-god, matched to Jupiter, who also threw the lightning. Two pantheons, one sky-king, one day. Every weekday so far has agreed on the god's *job* and disagreed on the god's *name*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "jeudi" — *zheu-DEE*, the soft *j* of "measure"
- "mercredi, jeudi" — the pair
- the bridge — "Jupiter and Thor, both the thunder-king, one day"

Before you move on

How do you say Thursday? (**jeudi**, *zheu-DEE*.) What English sound is the French **j**? (The buzz in *measure*, never the *j* of *jam*.) Which god is *jeudi* named for, and which god does *Thursday* name? (**Jupiter**, or Jove — and **Thor**.) Next: the day of the morning star.

7.6 vendredi — Friday

The fifth day closes the planet-week, and it is the only one named for a goddess.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-en` — the opening **en** is nasal, sent through the nose like the *un* of **lundi** but with the mouth more open. So **vendredi** = *van-druh-DEE*.
- The **r** is the throat-**r** again, and the ending is the familiar *DEE*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vendredi is **Veneris diēs**, "the day of **Venus**" — goddess of love and the brightest thing in the sky after the Sun and Moon. Her name is still in English **venerate**, "to hold in reverence."

Why it's said this way

The last application of the key, and the cleanest. English *Friday* is **Frigg's day** — Frigg, the Germanic goddess of love and marriage, matched to Venus. Five days, five gods, and every single pairing made by role.
That is the whole planet-week: **lundi** the Moon, **mardi** Mars,

mercredi Mercury, **jeudi** Jupiter, **vendredi** Venus. Two days are left, and neither of them is a planet — which is the next surprise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vendredi" — *van-druh-DEE*, the *en* through the nose
- the work week — "lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi"
- each as a god — "Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus"

Twice through: the five weekdays, in order

Before you move on

How do you say Friday? (**vendredi**, *van-druh-DEE.*) Which goddess is it named for, and who does English name it for? (**Venus** — and **Frigg**.) Give the five planet-days in order. (*Lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi.*) Next: the two days where the planets stop.

7.7 samedi — Saturday

Five days named for planets — and then two that are not. The weekend is where **religion overwrote astronomy**, and French shows both layers.

Sounds you'll need

- **samedi** = *sam-DEE*. The **a** is open, and the middle **e** is so light it nearly disappears: two syllables in practice, not three.
- `nasal-none` — the **am** here is **not** nasal, because the *m* is followed by a vowel that pulls it into the next syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

samedi still carries the **-di** of *diēs*, so the shape of the week holds. What changed is the first half. It is **sambatī diēs**, from Latin **Sabbatum**, which is Hebrew **shabbāt** — "to cease, to rest."

Not a god. An instruction.

Why it's said this way

By the Roman pattern this should have been **Saturn's day** — and in English it still is. *Saturday* is the one weekday English kept a Roman god for, while replacing the other four with Germanic ones.
French did the reverse. It kept the Roman gods on the weekdays and let this one go: Latin-speaking Christians took the Jewish **Sabbath** and put it here, so the planet was written over by the rest-day.
So *Saturday* and *samedi* are the same day under two ideas — **the planet against the Sabbath** — and the two languages swapped exactly which half of the week they preserved.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "samedi" — *sam-DEE*, the middle *e* almost gone
- "vendredi, samedi" — the pair
- the contrast — "samedi is the Sabbath, Saturday is Saturn"

Before you move on

How do you say Saturday? (**samedi**, *sam-DEE*.) Where does the first half come from? (The **Sabbath** — Latin *Sabbatum*, Hebrew *shabbāt*, "to rest.") Which planet-god does English keep on this day that French dropped? (**Saturn**.) Next: the last day, where even the **-di** moves.

7.8 dimanche — Sunday

Six days have ended in **-di**. The seventh breaks the pattern in public — and once you see how, it is not a break at all.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-sh` — the French **ch** is *sh*, as in English *machine*. Never *ch* as in *church*.

- `nasal-an` — the **an** is nasal, the same open nasal as the **en** of **vendredi**: French spells that one sound two ways.
- Together: **dimanche** = *dee-MAHNSH*.

Grammar Lens: the ending that moved to the front

Look at the first two letters. **Di**manche. That is the **same *diēs*** every other day of the week ends with, sitting at the front instead.

diēs Dominica → *di-manche* → **dimanche**

Latin let the two words come in either order, and for this one day the order that survived is "day of the Lord" rather than "the Lord's day." So the pattern did not break; it flipped. All seven days still carry *diēs*, and *dimanche* is the only one that wears it where you can see it first.

Why it's said this way

Dominica comes from **Dominus**, "lord, master" — which English holds in **dominion**, **dominate**, and, worn much smoother, **dame**. English kept **Sun**day, the star. French dropped it entirely for "the Lord's day." Put beside *samedi*, that makes the weekend two different rewrites of the same Roman week:

- **samedi** — the planet replaced by the **Sabbath**, a day of rest
- **dimanche** — the Sun replaced by the **Lord**, a day of worship

Five days of Roman sky, then two days where a later faith wrote over it. The French week is a record of both.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dimanche ← Old French *diemenche* ← Latin *dies Dominica*, "the Lord's day" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dimanche" — *dee-MAHNSH*, the *ch* as *sh*

- "samedi, dimanche" — the weekend
- the whole week — "lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi, samedi, dimanche"

Before you move on

How do you say Sunday? (**dimanche**, *dee-MAHNSH.*) Where did its *diēs* go? (**To the front** — *diēs Dominica.*) What does it mean literally? ("The **Lord's** day.") What does English keep on this day that French dropped? (The **Sun**.) Next: the whole week, run together.

7.9 Practice — the whole week

Seven days, taken one at a time. Now put them in a row and make the row automatic — a week you have to assemble is a week you cannot use.

Your turn: the seven, in order

Read down the column, then cover the right-hand side and read down the left:

French	English
lundi	Monday
mardi	Tuesday
mercredi	Wednesday
jeudi	Thursday
vendredi	Friday
samedi	Saturday
dimanche	Sunday

Twice through: the seven days, in order

Then start from **jeudi** and go round to *mercredi*. A list you can only say from the top is a list you have memorised rather than learned.

Your turn: name the god

Five of the seven still name a planet. Say each day, then what is inside it:

- **lundi** — *la lune*, the Moon

- **mardi** — Mars
- **mercredi** — Mercury
- **jeudi** — Jupiter
- **vendredi** — Venus

Every one of those ends in **-di**, Latin *diēs*, "day."

What you've built this chapter

- **the -di rule** — every weekday ends in Latin *diēs*, "day," so half of five words came free.
- **the planet week** — Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, named by Rome.
- **the key to English** — *Tuesday*, *Wednesday*, *Thursday* and *Friday* name the **same** gods by their Germanic names, matched role for role. The days agree about the god's job and disagree about the god's name.
- **the weekend rewrite** — *samedi* is the **Sabbath** where English keeps Saturn; *dimanche* is the **Lord's day** where English keeps the Sun. And in *dimanche* the *diēs* moved to the front.

Before you move on

Give the seven days without stopping. Now start from **jeudi**. What does the **-di** mean? ("Day," Latin *diēs*.) Which two days are not named for a planet, and what replaced them? (**samedi**, the Sabbath; **dimanche**, the Lord's day.) Why do *mardi* and *Tuesday* mean the same thing? (Same day, same role — the war-god, called **Mars** in Latin and **Tiw** in Germanic.)

Chapter 8

Telling the Time

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for and tell the time in French.
>
> *One noun, one frame and three small additions. heure is the same word as English hour, both from Latin hora and both keeping an h neither language ever said; il est … heures counts the hours where English says o'clock; and midi and minuit are one idea used twice, the middle of the day and the middle of the night.*

8.1 heure — the hour

With your numbers in hand you are one word away from telling the time. This is that word — and it turns out you have been saying it in English your whole life.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — the **h** of **heure** is silent, exactly as in English *hour*. Say *eur*.
- `liaison-z` — because the word **begins with a vowel sound**, the number in front links straight onto it. That is the liaison you met counting: **deux heures** = *deu-**z**-eur*, **trois heures** = *troi-**z**-eur*.

The silent *h* is why the liaison happens at all. A written *h* that is never pronounced is not a consonant in the way; the number hears a vowel

and reaches for it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heure comes from Latin **hōra**, which came from Greek **hōrā**. The Greek word did not mean "hour." It meant *a period, a season, the right time* — the goddesses of the seasons were the **Horae**. Latin narrowed it to a fixed slice of the day, and French wore *hōra* down to **heure**. English took the **same** Latin *hōra* and made **hour**. So *heure* and *hour* are one word spelt two ways — and the silent *h* in both is a fossil of the Latin spelling that neither language ever said aloud.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "heure" — *eur*, no *h* at all
- "deux heures" — *deu-z-eur*, the number linking on
- "trois heures, six heures, dix heures" — hear the *z* each time

Before you move on

How do you say hour? (**heure**, *eur*.) Why does a number link onto it with a *z*? (The **h** is silent, so the word starts with a vowel sound.) What did the Greek *hōrā* originally mean? (**A season, the right time** — the *Horae* were the season-goddesses.) Next: the frame that puts a number in front of it.

8.2 il est ... heures — telling the clock

One word for the hour, one small frame to hang it in, and the clock is yours. Take the frame whole for now — it never changes.

Grammar Lens: French counts the hours

To say the time, French uses a fixed opening — **il est** — then the number, then **heures**:

il est + *number* + **heures**

Il est deux heures. Read it literally and it says *"it is two **hours**."* French **counts the hours**. English does something stranger and then hides it: *two o'clock* is a worn-down *two of the clock*, which counted the hours too before it shrank.
Learn **il est** as one unbreakable piece for now. It is the same *it is* that English uses for weather and time — a subject that stands for nothing in particular — and you will meet the verb inside it properly later.

Sounds you'll need

- **il est** = *eel-**eh***. The final **t** of *est* is silent on its own.
- But before **heures**, with its silent *h*, that **t** wakes up and links: **il est une heure** = *eel eh-**t**-ün-eur*. Another liaison, the same instinct as *deux heures*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il est ... heures — *il* ← Latin *ille*, "that"; *est* is Latin *est*, "is"; *heure* ← Latin *hora*, "hour". All three are inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il est" — *eel-eh*, no *t* sounded
- "Il est deux heures." — *eel eh deu-z-eur*
- "Il est six heures. Il est dix heures."

Twice through: "Il est deux heures."

Before you move on

What frame tells the time in French? (**il est** + number + **heures**.)
What does *Il est deux heures* say literally? ("It is two **hours**.")
What is English *o'clock* worn down from? (*Of the clock* — which counted hours too.) Next: the one hour that takes a different ending.

8.3 une heure — one o'clock

Eleven of the twelve hours behave identically. One does not, and the reason is a rule you already met on a different word.

Grammar Lens: one hour, two hours

heure is a **feminine** noun, so "one" in front of it is **une**, not *un* — the same gendered "one" you learned counting. And because the noun counts, it takes a plural **-s** from two upwards:

- **Il est une heure.** — one o'clock. One hour, so no *-s*.
- **Il est deux heures.** — two o'clock. Two hours, so *-s*.

Now listen rather than read. That **-s** is **silent**, like every plural *-s* in French. *Une heure* and *deux heures* end in the identical sound. The plural is visible on the page and inaudible in the air — what your ear actually uses to tell them apart is the **number in front**, which is why French never drops it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Il est une heure." — *eel eh-t-ün-eur*
- "Il est deux heures." — *eel eh deu-z-eur*
- both again and notice the ending never changes — only the number does

Before you move on

How do you say one o'clock? (**Il est une heure** — *une*, because *heure* is feminine.) When does *heure* take an **-s**? (From **two** upwards.) Can you hear that *-s*? (**No** — it is silent, so the number carries the count.) Next: the two hours that refuse a number altogether.

8.4 midi — noon

Two hours in the day do not get a number. They get a name, because they are the pivots the rest of the day turns on. Here is the first.

Sounds you'll need

- **midi** = *mee-DEE*, two clean syllables with the weight at the end.
- Both vowels are the tight French **i** of *machine*, never the *i* of *sit*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

midi is Latin **medius diēs**, "the middle day," and both halves are still visible:

> **mi-** ("middle," from *medius*) + **-di** (*diēs*, "day") = **the day's middle**

You already own the second half. That **-di** is the same *diēs* that ends *lundi* and *mardi* — here it has come round to the front of a different word. And *medius* is the English **medium**, **median**, **mid** and **middle**, all one family.

Grammar Lens: a name instead of a number

Because **midi** *is* the hour, it does not take **heures**. Drop the number and drop the noun:

> **Il est midi.** — "It is noon."

Not "it is twelve hours" with a number in the slot. The frame stays; what goes into it is a name.

Why it's said this way

English **noon** is Latin **nōna hōra**, "the **ninth** hour" — which in Roman reckoning was the middle of the afternoon. Over centuries the meal it named crept earlier, and the word came with it until it landed on midday and stopped. So English says *noon* and means "the ninth hour"; French says *midi* and means what it says.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "midi" — *mee-DEE*
- "Il est midi." — no number, no *heures*
- it split — "mi- plus -di: the day's middle"

Before you move on

How do you say noon? (**midi**, *mee-DEE*.) What are its two halves? (**mi-**, "middle," and **-di**, *diēs*, "day.") Where have you met that *-di* before? (Ending **lundi** and **mardi**.) Why is there no *heures* after it? (*Midi* **is** the hour.) Next: its opposite number.

8.5 minuit — midnight

The second pivot, and it is built from a word you have had since the very first chapter.

Sounds you'll need

- **minuit** = *mee-NWEE*. The **ui** is a single gliding sound, *wee*, not two vowels taken in turn.
- The final **t** is silent, as it is in **nuit** itself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

minuit is Latin **media nox**, "the middle night," and the two halves are as plain as they were in *midi*:

> **mi-** ("middle," *medius* again) + **-nuit** (*nox*, "night") = **the night's middle**

The second half is the **nuit** you learned in your first week. Latin *nox* has the stem *noct-*, which English carries in **nocturnal** and, straight through its Germanic side, in **night** itself.
So the two pivots of the French day are one idea applied twice: the **middle** of the day, and the **middle** of the night. English builds *midday* and *midnight* out of exactly the same two pieces.

Grammar Lens: the same rule as midi

minuit is the hour, so no number and no **heures**:

Il est minuit. — "It is midnight."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "minuit" — *mee-NWEE*, the *ui* as one glide
- "Il est midi. Il est minuit." — the two pivots
- both split — "the day's middle, the night's middle"

Before you move on

How do you say midnight? (**minuit**, *mee-NWEE.*) What are its two halves? (**mi-**, "middle," and **nuit**, "night," from Latin *nox.*) Which English word carries the *noct-* stem? (**Nocturnal**.) Say both pivots. (*Il est midi. Il est minuit.*) Next: the quarter hour.

8.6 et quart — quarter past

Whole hours are not enough to make an appointment. Three small additions finish the clock, and the first is already half-known to you from counting.

Sounds you'll need

- **quart** = *kar.* The **qu-** is a plain *k*, and the final **t** is silent.
- The **r** is the throat-**r**, as in **quatre**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quart is "a fourth part," and it comes from the same Latin **quattuor** that gave you **quatre**. English took the identical word and made **quarter** — a fourth of an hour, a fourth of a gallon, a fourth of a town. Once you see *quatre* inside *quart*, it stops being a new word and becomes a number you already have, doing a different job.

Grammar Lens: adding to the hour

French adds the quarter with **et** ("and"), after the hour:

> **Il est deux heures et quart.** — "It is a quarter past two."

Read literally: *"it is two hours **and a quarter**."* French does not say "past"; it adds.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quart" — *kar*, no *t*
- "Il est deux heures et quart."
- "quatre, quart" — the number and the fourth part, one root

Before you move on

How do you say a quarter? (**quart**, *kar.*) Which number is it built on? (**quatre** — Latin *quattuor.*) How do you say quarter past two? (*Il est deux heures **et quart**.*) Next: the half hour.

8.7 et demie — half past

Same move as the quarter, a different fraction — and a spelling that tells you something about the word it leans on.

Sounds you'll need

- **demie** = *duh-MEE*. The first **e** is the light, almost-swallowed vowel you met in the middle of *samedi*.
- The final **-e** is silent, so *demie* and *demi* sound identical.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

demie comes from Latin **dimidius**, "halved" — literally *di-* ("apart") plus *medius*, the "middle" you have now met twice, in **midi** and

minuit. To halve a thing is to cut it at its middle.
English borrowed the French form as the prefix **demi-**: a **demigod** is half a god, a **demitasse** is half a cup.

Grammar Lens: why it is demie and not demi

The **-e** on the end is agreement. It follows **heure**, which is feminine, so the half agrees with it and takes a feminine **-e**:

> **Il est deux heures et demie.** — "It is half past two."

After **midi** and **minuit**, which are masculine, it drops the *-e*:

> **Il est midi et demi.** — "It is half past twelve."

Your ear cannot tell them apart; the page can. That is the same silent-agreement pattern as the plural *-s* on *heures*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "demie" — *duh-MEE*
- "Il est deux heures et demie."
- "Il est midi et demi." — masculine, so no *-e* on the page

Before you move on

How do you say half past two? (*Il est deux heures* ***et demie***.) Why does *demie* carry an **-e**? (It agrees with **heure**, which is feminine.) What is inside Latin *dimidius*? (*Medius* — the same "middle" as in *midi*.) Next: the one that subtracts.

8.8 moins le quart — quarter to

Twice now you have **added** to the hour. The last piece of the clock does the opposite, and it does it with a word you can read on a calculator.

Sounds you'll need

- **moins** = *mwa(n)*. The **oi** is *wa*, as in **trois**, and the **in** is nasal, as in **cinq**.
- The final **s** is silent. Two familiar sounds and one silent letter — nothing in this word is new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moins is Latin **minus**, and it means exactly what *minus* means: **less**, taken away. English uses the Latin form untouched for subtraction, and keeps the same root in **minor**, **minimum** and **diminish**.

Grammar Lens: French subtracts from the next hour

To say "quarter to," French does not look back at the hour that has passed. It names the hour **coming**, and takes the quarter off it:

> **Il est trois heures moins le quart.** — "It is a quarter to three."

Literally: *"it is three hours **minus** the quarter."* English does the same arithmetic and hides it behind the word *to*; French shows its working. So the three additions to the hour are one small system:

- **et quart** — the hour, plus a quarter
- **et demie** — the hour, plus a half
- **moins le quart** — the *next* hour, minus a quarter

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "moins" — *mwa(n)*, no *s*
- "Il est trois heures moins le quart."
- the three in a row — "deux heures et quart, deux heures et demie, trois heures moins le quart"

Before you move on

How do you say quarter to three? (*Il est trois heures* ***moins le quart***.) Which hour does French name in that sentence, the one gone or the one coming? (**The one coming** — it subtracts from it.) What Latin word is *moins*? (**Minus**.) Next: the whole clock, put to use.

8.9 Practice — reading the clock

One frame, one noun and three small additions. Put them together and you can say any time on a clock face.

Your turn: whole hours

Put each of these into the frame — *Il est …* — then cover the right column and read back from the left:

French	English
une heure	one o'clock
deux heures	two o'clock
six heures	six o'clock
dix heures	ten o'clock

Twice through: the four whole hours, each inside *Il est …*

Listen for the liaison each time: *ün-eur*, *deu-z-eur*, *see-z-eur*, *dee-z-eur*.

Your turn: the two that take a name

- **Il est midi.** — noon, "the day's middle"
- **Il est minuit.** — midnight, "the night's middle"

No number and no *heures*: each of them **is** the hour.

Your turn: the parts of the hour

French	English
deux heures et quart	quarter past two
deux heures et demie	half past two
trois heures moins le quart	quarter to three
midi et demi	half past twelve

Say all four inside the frame and hear the clock move. The third names the hour **ahead** and subtracts from it.

What you've built this chapter

- **heure** — the same word as English *hour*, both Latin *hōra*, both keeping a silent *h* neither language ever pronounced.
- **il est ... heures** — French counts the hours; English says *o'clock*.
- **agreement you cannot hear** — *une heure* against *deux heures*, *et demie* against *et demi*. The page shows it; the ear uses the number in front.
- **midi** and **minuit** — one idea twice: the *middle* of the day and of the night, with the *-di* of *lundi* and the *nuit* of your first chapter.
- **adding and subtracting** — *et quart*, *et demie*, *moins le quart*.

Before you move on

Say one o'clock, then two. (*Il est une heure. Il est deux heures.*) Say noon and midnight, and what each means literally. (*Midi*, the day's middle; *minuit*, the night's middle.) Say quarter past two, half past two, quarter to three. Which of those names an hour that has not arrived? (**Quarter to** — *moins le quart* subtracts.) Why do *heure* and *hour* both carry a silent *h*? (Both are Latin *hōra*, where it was already silent.)

Chapter 9

The Months: Gods and Beginnings

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the first six months in French and say which Roman figure each one carries.
>
> *Six months, and not one of them is a number. The calendar is a procession of Roman gods and festivals carried almost unchanged out of Latin – Janus in the doorway of the year, the Februa that cleaned the city before it turned, and the war-god who already owns a weekday.*

9.1 janvier — January

The week was a map of the sky. The calendar is a **procession of Roman gods and emperors**, carried almost unchanged out of Latin — and it opens with the one god who faces both ways at once.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the soft **j** of *measure*, the one you met in **jeudi**.
- `nasal-an` — the **an** is nasal.
- Together: **janvier** = *zhan-vee-AY*, three syllables, weight at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

janvier is Latin **Januarius**, "the month of **Janus**."
Janus is the god of **doorways** — of gates, of thresholds, of any moment where one thing stops and another starts. He is carved with **two faces**, one looking back and one looking forward, because that is what a doorway is.
Put the first month of the year in his care and the name explains itself: the month that stands in the door, looking back at the year that closed and forward into the one opening. English **January** is the identical word; a **janitor** was once a doorkeeper, from the same *janua*, "door."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "janvier" — *zhan-vee-AY*, the soft *j* of **jeudi**
- the god — "Janus, two faces, the doorway of the year"
- "janvier" then English "January, janitor" — one door-god in all three

Before you move on

How do you say January? (**janvier**, *zhan-vee-AY*.) Which god is it named for, and what is he god of? (**Janus** — **doorways**, beginnings.) Why does he have two faces? (One looks **back**, one looks **forward** — the year's threshold.) Next: the month named for a washing.

9.2 février — February

Eleven of the twelve months are named for a god, an emperor or a number. This one is named for a **festival** — and specifically for a cleaning.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-e-acute` — the **é** is a tight, bright *ay*, said with the mouth narrow. It is the accent that tells you the vowel is that one and no other.

- **février** = *fay-vree-AY*. The **r** is the throat-**r**, and the ending is the same *-AY* as **janvier**.

Why it's said this way

février is Latin **Februarius**, from the **Februa** — a Roman festival of **purification** held in this month.
That placement is the interesting part. The old Roman year began in **March**, so February was the **last** month, and the city cleaned itself before the year turned. The month is named for the scrubbing that came before the fresh start.
English **February** is the same word, and English speakers have been quietly dropping its first **r** for centuries.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "février" — *fay-vree-AY*, the *é* bright and narrow
- "janvier, février" — the first two, both ending *-AY*
- the reason — "the Februa, the cleaning before the year turned"

Before you move on

How do you say February? (**février**, *fay-vree-AY*.) What is it named after? (The **Februa**, a festival of **purification**.) Why did a cleaning-festival fall at the end of the year? (The Roman year began in **March**, so February closed it.) Next: a month you already know as a day.

9.3 mars — March

This one you have already half-learned, in a different part of the calendar. The war-god who owns Tuesday also owns a month.

Sounds you'll need

- **mars** = *marss*. The final **s** **is** sounded here — one of the small set of French words that keeps it.

- Do not read it as English *Mars*, which has a different vowel; the French **a** is open and flat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mars is Latin **Martius**, the month of **Mars**, the war-god.
Now put it beside the weekday:

- **mars** — *Martius*, **his month**
- **mardi** — *Martis diēs*, **his day**

The same god, twice in the calendar. Spot one and you already know the other, which is the first time a French word has paid you back in two different systems at once. English keeps the god's name in **martial**, "of war," and in the planet **Mars**.

Why it's said this way

March was the **first month** of the old Roman year. That single fact has now explained three separate things you have met: why *février*'s cleaning festival came at the end, why the counting months land two places late, and why the war-god gets the opening of the year — campaigning season began when the weather turned.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mars" — *marss*, the *s* sounded
- the pair — "mars, mardi": his month and his day
- "janvier, février, mars" — the first three

Before you move on

How do you say March? (**mars**, *marss*, with the *s*.) Which god is it named for? (**Mars**, the war-god.) Which weekday is named for the same god, and what is the difference between the two words? (**mardi** — *Martis diēs*, his **day**; *mars* is *Martius*, his **month**.) Which month opened the old Roman year? (**March**.) Next: the

month the buds open.

9.4 avril — April

Every month so far has had a firm answer behind it. This one has a guess — and the guess is old enough that the Romans were already making it.

Sounds you'll need

- **avril** = *a-VREEL*. Two syllables; the **r** sits at the back of the throat, and the **i** is the tight vowel of *machine*.
- The final **l** is sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avril is Latin **Aprilis**, and where *Aprilis* came from is genuinely uncertain. The oldest guess, and still the best one, is Latin **aperīre**, "to **open**" — the month the buds open.
It is worth noticing that this is a **guess**, and saying so. A book that hands you a confident story for every word is inventing some of them. English **aperture**, an opening, comes from that same *aperīre*, so if the guess is right, an aperture and April are the same idea: something unclosing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "avril" — *a-VREEL*, the *l* sounded
- "mars, avril" — the pair
- the guess — "aperīre, to open; the buds open"

Before you move on

How do you say April? (**avril**, *a-VREEL*.) What is the best guess at its root, and what does it mean? (**aperīre**, "to **open**.") How certain is that? (Not very — it is a **guess**, and an ancient one.) Next: the

goddess of growing.

9.5 mai — May

The shortest month-name in French, and one of the shortest words you have met: three letters, one syllable.

Sounds you'll need

- `ai-y` — the pair **ai** is a single sound, close to the *e* of English *bed*. So **mai** = *may*, in one beat. Neither letter is heard on its own.
- This is the same **ai** you will meet again and again; it is one of the most common vowel pairs in French, and it never splits.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mai is Latin **Maius**, the month of **Maia** — an old Italic goddess of **growth** and increase, worshipped long before the Romans wrote much down about her.
Her name is thought to sit on the same root as Latin **maior**, "greater," which English carries in **major**, **majority** and **mayor**. If that is right, then *mai* is the **growing** month in the plainest sense: the one where things get bigger.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mai" — *may*, one beat, the *ai* never split
- "avril, mai" — the pair
- the goddess — "Maia, growth; and maior, greater"

Before you move on

How do you say May? (**mai**, *may*.) What sound does the pair **ai** make? (One sound, close to the *e* of *bed* — never two.) Which goddess is the month named for, and what is she goddess of? (**Maia** — **growth**.) Next: the queen of the gods.

9.6 juin — June

The sixth month closes the half-year, and it belongs to the one figure in the calendar who outranks everybody else in it.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the soft **j** again, as in **jeudi** and **janvier**.
- `nasal-in` — the **in** is nasal, as in **cinq**.
- Together: **juin** = *zhwa(n)*, one syllable. It is shorter than it looks.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juin is Latin **Junius**, the month of **Juno** — queen of the gods, wife of Jupiter, and the goddess of marriage.
That last detail still shows. June is the traditional wedding month across Europe because it was **her** month, and couples wanted her on their side.
You have already met her husband: **jeudi**, *Jovis diēs*, is Jupiter's day. So the calendar now holds both halves of the divine marriage — his **day** and her **month**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "juin" — *zhwa(n)*, one syllable
- "mai, juin" — the pair
- the couple — "juin is Juno's month, jeudi is Jupiter's day"

Before you move on

How do you say June? (**juin**, *zhwa(n)*, one syllable.) Which goddess is it named for? (**Juno**, queen of the gods.) Why are weddings held in June? (She is the goddess of **marriage**, and it is her month.) Which day belongs to her husband? (**jeudi** — Jupiter's.) Next: the first six, run together.

9.7 Practice — the first half of the year

Six months, taken one at a time. Run them together now, then say what is inside each one.

Your turn: the six, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
janvier	January
février	February
mars	March
avril	April
mai	May
juin	June

Twice through: the six months, in order

Four of them end in that same unstressed *-AY*; **mars** and **mai** are the two short ones, and they are the two easiest to lose.

Your turn: name what is inside

Say each month, then the figure or thing behind it:

- **janvier** — **Janus**, the two-faced god of doorways
- **février** — the **Februa**, a festival of purification
- **mars** — **Mars**, the war-god (and *mardi* is his day)
- **avril** — perhaps *aperīre*, "to open," though nobody is certain
- **mai** — **Maia**, goddess of growth
- **juin** — **Juno**, queen of the gods

What you've built this chapter

- **six month names**, each of which is a Roman figure rather than a number.
- **one word paying twice** — *mars* and *mardi* are the same god's month and day, which is the first time a French word has cashed out in two systems.

- **the old Roman year began in March**, which has now explained three separate oddities: why a cleaning-festival names February, why the war-god opens the year, and why four months you have seen are counting two places out.

Before you move on

Give the six months without stopping. Now start from **avril**. Which month shares its god with a weekday, and which weekday? (**mars** — with **mardi**, both Mars.) Which month is named for a festival rather than a person? (**février**, the Februa.) Which one is a guess? (**avril** — perhaps *aperīre*, "to open.")

Chapter 10

The Months: Caesars and Counting

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the last six months in French and explain why four of them are counting wrong.

Two men put their names on a calendar of gods, and the four months after them have been miscounting since long before either was born. juillet is Julius Caesar and août is the emperor Augustus — but neither added a month: Quintilis and Sextilis were renamed. What pushed septembre to décembre two places out was janvier and février, added at the front of a year that used to begin in March.

10.1 juillet — July

Six months named for gods and a festival. The next two are named for **men** — the only two months in the year that carry a person who actually lived.

Sounds you'll need

- `ill-mouille` — the **ill** in the middle is not an *l* sound at all. It is a *y*, as in English *yes*. This spelling is everywhere in French and it catches every beginner once.
- With the soft **j** of **juin**: **juillet** = *zhwee-YAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juillet is Latin **Julius**, and the Julius in question is **Julius Caesar**. He **reformed the entire calendar** — the Julian calendar is his, and it ran Europe for sixteen centuries. He did not add a month while doing it. The month was already there, and it was called **Quintilis**, "the 5th." After his death it was **renamed** in his honour, and *Quintilis* has not been heard since.
English **July** is the same name, worn down a different way from the same *Julius*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "juillet" — *zhwee-YAY*; the *ill* is a **y**, never an *l*
- "juin, juillet" — both open with the soft *j*, and they are easy to confuse; say them back to back until they separate
- the man — "Julius Caesar: Quintilis, the 5th, renamed for him"

Before you move on

How do you say July? (**juillet**, *zhwee-YAY*.) What sound does the **ill** make? (A **y**, as in *yes* — never an *l*.) Who is it named for, and what did he do to the calendar? (**Julius Caesar** — he **reformed** it.) Did he add this month to the year? (**No** — it already existed as **Quintilis**, "the 5th," and was **renamed** for him.) Next: the emperor who copied him.

10.2 août — August

The most violently worn-down word in the French calendar. Four letters on the page, and barely two sounds in the mouth.

Sounds you'll need

- **août** = *oot*, and in much of France simply *oo*. The **a** is not sounded, and the final **t** is optional.
- `circumflex` — the little hat on the **û** is a **gravestone**. It marks

a letter that used to be there and is gone: older French wrote *aoust*, and when the **s** fell silent the hat took its place.

You have met that hat before, on **hôpital** and **forêt** in English's *hospital* and *forest*. Wherever you see a circumflex, try putting an **s** after the vowel and see whether an English word appears.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

août is Latin **Augustus**, the first Roman emperor.
Julius Caesar had a month renamed for him. His heir Augustus, not to be outdone, had **the next one** renamed for himself: **Sextilis**, "the 6th," became *Augustus*.
Note what neither man did. **Neither one added a month.** *Quintilis* and *Sextilis* were already sitting in the year; the two most powerful men in Rome simply took the two of them and wrote their own names over the top. The calendar did not get longer. Two of its months just stopped being numbers and started being people.

Why it's said this way

Ten of the twelve months are a god, a festival or a number. **Two are people.**
Julius and Augustus put themselves among the gods, in the most public place available — the calendar everybody has to say out loud. They did not need to build anything to do it; they only had to rename what was there. Two thousand years later, France still says both their names every summer, and nobody thinks of either man while doing it. That is what winning looks like at scale.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "août" — *oot*, and hear how little of the spelling survives
- "juillet, août" — the two men, back to back
- the hat — "aoust lost its *s*, and the circumflex marks the grave"

Before you move on

How do you say August? (**août** — *oot*, or simply *oo*.) What does the circumflex mark? (A **lost letter** — here an *s*, from older *aoust*.) Who are the two months named for people? (**Julius Caesar** and the emperor **Augustus**.) Did either of them add a month to the year? (**No** — they **renamed** two that already existed, *Quintilis* and *Sextilis*, "the 5th" and "the 6th.") Next: the four that are still counting.

10.3 septembre — September

You met this word while counting, as the proof that *sept* means seven. Now take it as a month in its own right.

Sounds you'll need

- **septembre** = *sep-TAHM-bruh*. The **em** in the middle is **nasal**, and the closing **-re** is barely a syllable.
- All four of the counting months end this same way, so learning it once buys you four.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

septembre is Latin **september**, "the **seventh**" — from **septem**, the seven you can already count with.

You know why it sits ninth: the old Roman year began in **March**, so counting from there, *september* really was the seventh. Then **janvier and février were added at the front** of the year — centuries before either Caesar was born — and every month behind them slid two places without being renamed. The name never caught up.

That is worth being exact about, because the story is usually told wrong. It was not Julius and Augustus. They renamed two months in the middle and added nothing; the damage was done long before them, at the **front** of the year.

What is new here is the **word**: *septembre* is now yours as a month, not only as evidence about a number.

English **September** is the identical Latin word, carrying the identical mistake.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "septembre" — *sep-TAHM-bruh*, the *em* through the nose
- "sept, septembre" — the number and the month it hides in
- "août, septembre" — the emperor, then the month that miscounts for an older reason

Before you move on

How do you say September? (**septembre**, *sep-TAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**sept**, seven — Latin *septem.*) Which month is it actually? (The **ninth**.) What put it two places out — the emperors, or something older? (**Older**: *janvier* and *février* were added at the **front** of a year that used to begin in March.) Next: the eighth month, which is the tenth.

10.4 octobre — October

Of the four counting months, this is the one that rescues a number you could no longer see.

Sounds you'll need

- **octobre** = *ok-TOH-bruh.* The **o** sounds are both closer to English *taught* than to *toe.*
- Same *-bruh* ending as **septembre**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

octobre is Latin **october**, "the **eighth**," from **octō**.
Here is why this word matters more than the other three. When you learned to count, *octō* had been battered past recognition on its way to **huit** — the *c* gone, the vowels softened, a written *h* propped on the front. The number kept none of its ancestry.
The month kept all of it. *Oct-* stands there in plain sight, exactly as Latin left it, and English **octave**, **octagon** and **octopus** stand beside it. The eight vanished from the number and survived in the calendar.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "octobre" — *ok-TOH-bruh*
- the contrast — "huit, octobre": the same eight, unrecognisable and intact
- "septembre, octobre" — the pair

Before you move on

How do you say October? (**octobre**, *ok-TOH-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**octō**, eight.) Why is the eight easier to see here than in the number **huit**? (*Huit* wore its Latin away; the **month kept it**.) Next: the ninth, which is the eleventh.

10.5 novembre — November

The third of the four, and by now you can predict both the shape and the arithmetic.

Sounds you'll need

- **novembre** = *no-VAHM-bruh*, the **em** nasal and the ending the same *-bruh* as the last two.
- Three months in a row have now ended identically. That is the pattern paying out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

novembre is Latin **november**, "the **ninth**," from **novem** — the nine you count with as **neuf**.
Unlike *huit*, **neuf** still shows its Latin: *novem* to *neuf* is a short walk, and the *nov-* is right there in both. English keeps the same root in **novena**, a devotion of nine days.
Be careful of one false friend: Latin **novus** means "new," and English **novel** and **novelty** come from *that*, not from *novem*. Two similar roots, two different ideas. **November is a count, not a newness.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "novembre" — *no-VAHM-bruh*
- "neuf, novembre" — the nine in both
- "septembre, octobre, novembre" — three in a row, one ending

Before you move on

How do you say November? (**novembre**, *no-VAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**novem**, nine — the *neuf* you count with.) Does it have anything to do with "new"? (**No** — that is Latin *novus*, a different root.) Next: the last of them, and the biggest number.

10.6 décembre — December

The twelfth month, and it says **ten**. This is the last and largest of the four miscounts, and after it the year closes.

Sounds you'll need

- **décembre** = *day-SAHM-bruh.* The **é** is the bright *ay* of **février**, the **c** before *e* is an *s*, and the **em** is nasal.
- The familiar *-bruh* closes it for the fourth and final time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décembre is Latin **december**, "the **tenth**," from **decem**.
That root is one of the most productive you have met. It gave you the number **dix**; it gives English **decimal**, **decade** and **decimate**; and it reached an American pocket as the **dime**, through Old French *disme* from Latin *decima*, "a tenth part."
So every December, in French and English alike, you say the Roman word for ten and mean the twelfth month. Spanish carries the identical fault: *diciembre* is *decem* too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "décembre" — *day-SAHM-bruh*
- "dix, décembre, dime" — one Latin *decem* in three places
- all four — "septembre, octobre, novembre, décembre"

Before you move on

How do you say December? (**décembre**, *day-SAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**decem**, ten — the *dix* you count with.) Name two English words from the same root. (*Decimal*, *decade*, *decimate* — or the **dime**.) Next: all twelve, together.

10.7 Practice — the whole year

Twelve months, six at a time. Run the whole year now, and hear where it breaks.

Your turn: the twelve, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
janvier	January
février	February
mars	March
avril	April
mai	May
juin	June
juillet	July
août	August
septembre	September
octobre	October
novembre	November
décembre	December

Twice through: the twelve months, in order
Then start from **juillet** and go round to *juin*.

Your turn: the two hard pairs

Two pairs cause almost all the trouble. Drill them alone:

- **juin** / **juillet** — *zhwa(n)* against *zhwee-YAY*. Both open with the soft *j* and neither is long.
- **mars** / **mai** — *marss* against *may*. The two short ones, and the two most easily swallowed.

What you've built this chapter

- **twelve month names**, and the year runs end to end.
- **two men in a calendar of gods** — *juillet* for Julius Caesar, *août* for the emperor Augustus. Neither added a month: *Quintilis* and *Sextilis*, "the 5th" and "the 6th," were already there and were **renamed**.
- **why the last four miscount** — the Roman year began in **March**, and *janvier* and *février* were later added at the **front**, sliding *septembre* through *décembre* two places along. Their Latin names never caught up. The emperors get blamed for this and had nothing to do with it.
- **a number rescued** — *octō* is unrecognisable inside **huit** and perfectly legible inside **octobre**. When a word wears down, look for a longer relative that did not.

Before you move on

Give the twelve months without stopping. Now start from **septembre**. Which two are named for people, and who? (**juillet**, Julius Caesar; **août**, the emperor Augustus.) Did either add a month? (**No** — both were **renamings**.) So what pushed the counting months two places out? (**janvier** and **février**, added at the **front** of a year that began in March.) Which month shows a number that its own French numeral has lost? (**octobre** — the *octō* that vanished from *huit*.)

Chapter 11

The Four Seasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the four seasons in French and say that something happens in one of them.
>
> *Four small Latin poems about heat, sleep and first things. printemps is prīmum tempus, "the first time"; été is aestās, "heat"; hiver is hībernum, the wintry season that gave English hibernate. And three seasons take en while spring takes au, for a reason that is not about seasons at all.*

11.1 le printemps — spring

Twelve months name gods, emperors and numbers. The four seasons are something else entirely: four small Latin poems about **heat, sleep and first things**. Here is the first thing.

Sounds you'll need

- **le printemps** = *luh pran-TAHN*. **Two nasal vowels in one word**: the **in** of *prin-* and the **em** of *-temps*.
- Everything after that second nasal is silent. The **-ps** on the end is not said at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

printemps is two words fused: **prīmum tempus**, "the **first time**."

prin- = *prīmum*, "first" — English **prime**, **primary**,

> **premier -temps** = *tempus*, "time, season" — English **temporal**, **tempo**
>
> So spring is the year's **prime time**, and the French say so every time they name it. Older French used **primevère**, from the same *prima vera*, "first spring" — which Italian keeps to this day as **primavera**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le printemps" — *luh pran-TAHN*, both vowels through the nose
- it split — "prīmum tempus: the first time"
- "décembre, printemps" — the year ending, then the year beginning
- "printemps" then Italian "primavera" — two names for one idea

Before you move on

How do you say spring? (**le printemps**, *luh pran-TAHN.*) What are its two halves? (*prīmum*, "**first**," and *tempus*, "**time**.") How many nasal vowels does it hold? (**Two**.) What does Italian call the same season? (**Primavera** — the same "first spring.") Next: the hot one.

11.2 l'été — summer

> Spring was named for its **place** in the year. Summer is named for what it **feels like**.

Sounds you'll need

- **été** = *ay-TAY*. Both **é** are the bright, narrow *ay* you met in **février**.
- `elision` — the article does not stay *le*. Before a vowel sound it drops its own vowel and clamps on: *le été* is impossible, so it becomes **l'été**, said as one word, *lay-TAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

été is Latin **aestās**, and *aestās* means "**heat**."
Not "the third season" or "the warm months" — just *heat*. Summer, in Latin and so in French, is named for the thing itself. English keeps the same root in **estival**, "of summer," and in **aestivate**, which is what an animal does when it sleeps through the hot season rather than the cold one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'été" — *lay-TAY*, one word, the article clamped on
- "le printemps, l'été" — hear the article change shape
- the meaning — "aestās: heat"

Before you move on

How do you say summer? (**l'été**, *lay-TAY*.) Why is it *l'* and not *le*? (The word starts with a **vowel**, so the article elides.) What does the Latin *aestās* mean? (**Heat**.) Next: the one English borrowed whole.

11.3 l'automne — autumn

Three of the four seasons are a Latin idea reshaped by French. This one is a Latin word that French barely touched, and then handed to English intact.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-au` — the letter pair **a-u** is a single *o* sound, closer to English *taught* than to *cow*. It never sounds like *ow*.
- **automne** = *o-TON*. Here is the oddity worth knowing: the **m** is written and the **n** is not sounded — the spelling keeps a letter the mouth dropped.
- With elision: **l'automne** = *lo-TON*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

automne is Latin **autumnus**, and unlike the other three seasons nobody is sure what *autumnus* originally meant. It may not even be Latin in origin.
What is certain is where it went. English took **autumn** from French, spelling and silent letter and all — which is why English writes an *n* it does not say in exactly the same place. Two languages carrying the identical silent letter, because one copied the other's spelling.
American English mostly prefers **fall**, a Germanic word for the leaves coming down; **autumn** is the French one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'automne" — *lo-TON*, the *a-u* a single *o*
- "l'été, l'automne" — both elide
- French "automne" then English "autumn" — the same silent letter twice

Before you move on

How do you say autumn? (**l'automne**, *lo-TON*.) What sound does **a-u** make? (A single **o**.) Which written letter is not pronounced, and does English do the same? (The **n** — and **yes**, English *autumn* copied the spelling from French.) Next: the cold one, and a bear.

11.4 l'hiver — winter

The last season, and it shares a root with the deepest sleep in the animal world.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — the **h** is silent, exactly as in **heure**. And because a silent *h* is no obstacle, the article elides straight through it: **l'hiver**, *lee-VAIR*.
- The **r** at the end is the throat-**r**, and it **is** sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hiver is Latin **hībernum**, short for *hībernum tempus* — "the **wintry** season." Like *printemps*, it is a *tempus* phrase with the *tempus* worn off.
Now follow that root sideways. English **hibernate** is *hībernāre*, and it means, with no metaphor at all, "**to spend the winter**." A bear hibernating is a bear *wintering*.
So the same Latin word gave French a season and English a kind of sleep — one naming the time, the other naming what you do in it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'hiver" — *lee-VAIR*, the *h* silent and the article through it
- "heure, hiver" — two silent *h*, two elisions
- the pair — "hiver and hibernate: the season and the sleeping"

Before you move on

How do you say winter? (**l'hiver**, *lee-VAIR*.) Why does the article elide in front of an **h**? (The **h** is silent, so the word begins with a vowel sound.) What does English **hibernate** literally mean? ("**To spend the winter**.") Next: how to say you are *in* a season.

11.5 au printemps, en été — saying you are *in* a season

You have the four seasons. Now put something *in* one — and meet a rule with exactly one exception, which turns out not to be an exception at all.

Grammar Lens: three take en, one takes au

Three of the four use **en**:

en été · **en automne** · **en hiver**

And spring does not:

au printemps

Learn it as a list and it is an oddity to memorise. Look at the words and it stops being odd. **Été**, **automne** and **hiver** all begin with a **vowel sound** — that is why each of them elides its article to *l'*. **Printemps** begins with a consonant, and it is the only one that does. So the split is not about seasons at all. It is the **same vowel-or-consonant question** that decided *le* against *l'*, asked one more time about a different little word. French keeps asking it, and once you hear it you stop needing the list.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "en été, en automne, en hiver"
- the one — "au printemps"
- the reason aloud — "three start with a vowel, one starts with a consonant"

Twice through: "au printemps, en été, en automne, en hiver"

Before you move on

How do you say "in summer"? (**en été**.) In winter? (**en hiver**.) In spring? (**au printemps** — not *en*.) And **why** is spring different? (It is the only season starting with a **consonant**; the other three begin with a vowel sound, which is also why they elide to *l'*.)

11.6 Practice — the turning year

Four seasons, four small Latin poems. Run them, then put a month inside each one.

Your turn: the four, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
le printemps	spring
l'été	summer
l'automne	autumn
l'hiver	winter

Twice through: the four seasons, in order

Notice which article each one carries. **Three elide to *l'*** and one does not, and that single fact is about to do a second job.

Your turn: in a season

- **au printemps** — the consonant one
- **en été** · **en automne** · **en hiver** — the three vowel ones

Now join what you learned last chapter to what you learned this one. Say each month inside its season:

> **en hiver** — *janvier, février* · **au printemps** — *mars, avril, mai* **en été** — *juin, juillet, août* · **en automne** — *septembre, octobre*

What you've built this chapter

- **four season names**, each one a Latin sentence worn down to a word: *printemps* is "the **first time**," *été* is "**heat**," *hiver* is "the **wintry** season," and *automne* is a word so old nobody is sure of it.
- **two of them still pay out in English** — *estival* from *aestās*, and **hibernate**, which means, with no metaphor, "to spend the winter."
- **au against en**, and the reason behind it: **printemps** is the only season beginning with a consonant. It is the same vowel-or-consonant question that decided *le* against *l'*, asked about a different word.

Before you move on

Give the four seasons. Which three take **en**, and which takes **au**? (*En été, en automne, en hiver*; **au printemps**.) Why? (Spring is the only one starting with a **consonant**.) What does *printemps* literally mean? ("The **first time**.") Which English word means "to spend the winter"? (**Hibernate** — from the same *hībernum* as *hiver*.)

Chapter 12

Family, and the Oldest Words We Have

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four closest family members in French, each with its article, and use one sound-law to recognise their English cousins.

Four words — père, mère, frère, sœur — and every one of them is older than Latin. Each also hands you an English word you already knew: paternal, maternal, fraternal, sorority. One sound-law, Grimm's p→f and t→th, turns père into father and frāter into brother in a single move, and the fused letter œ arrives here, in sœur and cœur.

12.1 le père — father

The calendar took you back two thousand years, to Rome. This word goes back further than Rome — further than Latin, further than any written language at all.

Sounds you'll need

- `e-grave` — the **è** is open, the mouth wider than for **é**. Think of the *e* in English *bed*, held a moment longer.
- `r-uvular` — the **r** is the French one, made at the back of the throat.

- Together: **le père** = *luh PEHR*, one syllable after the article.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

père is Latin **pater**, worn down by French mouths for fifteen centuries until only four letters were left.
pater itself is inherited, not invented. Behind it stands Proto-Indo-European ***ph₂tḗr** — a word nobody ever wrote down, reconstructed from the shapes its descendants kept. Sanskrit *pitṛ́*, Greek *patḗr*, Latin *pater*: the same word, spoken across a continent, for longer than anyone can document.
English never borrowed *père*, but it borrowed *pater* itself, over and over, and left it visible every time:

- **pat**ernal, **pat**ernity — "of a father"
- **pat**ron — a man who stands to you as a father would
- **pat**riarch, ex**pat**riate, **pat**rimony

So the French word is short and the English cousins are long, and they are the same word. When *père* looks like nothing you know, say *paternal* and the *p* and the *t* are still there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le père" — *luh PEHR*, the **è** open and the **r** in the throat
- the ladder — "*ph$_2$tḗr, pater, père"
- "père → paternal, patron" — the *p* and *t* still standing

Before you move on

How do you say "the father"? (**le père**, *luh PEHR*.) Which article does it take, and what does that tell you? (**le** — it is masculine.) What Latin word is it? (**pater**.) Name two English words with that *pater* still inside them. (**paternal**, **patron** — also *paternity*, *patriarch*.) Next: the other half of the pair.

12.2 la mère — mother

The same word, one letter different, one article different — and a much stranger set of English cousins waiting at the end of it.

Sounds you'll need

- **la mère** = *lah MEHR*. The vowel is the identical open **è** you just met in **père**; only the first consonant changes.
- Say them back to back — *père, mère* — and hear that the rhyme is exact. That rhyme is not a coincidence; it is two inherited words worn down by the same mouths in the same way.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mère is Latin **māter**, from Proto-Indo-European ***méh₂tēr**.
The obvious English cousins are the ones you would guess:

- **mat**ernal, **mat**ernity — "of a mother"
- **mat**ron, **mat**riarch, alma **mat**er

And then there is one nobody guesses. Latin took *māter* and built **materia** from it — originally the **usable wood of a tree**, the growing part, the stuff a mother-trunk yields. Roman writers then stretched *materia* to mean the stuff anything is made of, and English inherited it twice over:

- **material** — what a thing is made of
- **matter** — stuff itself, the physical world

So when a physicist says *matter*, the word underneath is *mother*. That is the kind of thing etymology is for: not a party trick, but a reminder that abstract vocabulary is almost always a concrete word that travelled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la mère" — *lah MEHR*

- the pair — "le père, la mère"; the rhyme is exact, the articles are not
- the surprising one — "māter → materia → matter"

Before you move on

How do you say "the mother"? (**la mère**, *lah MEHR.*) Which article, and why is it not the same as *père*'s? (**la** — *mère* is feminine.) Give both parents together. (**le père, la mère**.) Which everyday English word for physical stuff comes from *māter*? (**matter** — through *materia*, the wood a tree yields.) Next: why English says *father* where French says *père*.

12.3 père / father — one sound-law

You have met two words that mean what English *father* and *mother* mean, and look almost nothing like them. That is about to stop being true.

Grammar Lens: the same word went down two roads

French took *pater* and *māter* straight from Latin. English did **not** borrow them from anybody. It inherited the very same Proto-Indo-European words down a different branch of the family — and on that branch, one systematic change hit every word at once. It is called **Grimm's law**, and the part that matters here is short: **p became f, and t became th.**

Apply it and watch the disguise fall off. Each row is one inherited word, shown first as it is reconstructed, then down each of the two roads:

Proto-Indo-European	**Latin → French**	**English**
*ph$_2$tḗr	*pater* → **père**	**f**a**th**er
*méh$_2$tēr	*māter* → **mère**	**m**o**th**er

père keeps the **p**; *father* shifts it to **f**. The *t* of *pater* is still a *t* in French and has become *th* in English. Nothing else moved.

This is why the resemblance between *maternal* and *mother* feels different from the resemblance between *paternal* and *father*: **maternal** came into English late, borrowed whole from Latin with its *t* intact, while **mother** came down the long way and took the sound-change

with it. Two arrivals of one word, centuries apart.
The point is not the pair. It is that sound-change is **regular** — it applies to a language wholesale, not word by word — which is exactly what makes a word you have never seen guessable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the law — "p becomes f, t becomes th"
- "père, father" — then "mère, mother"; hear the same word twice
- the two arrivals — "maternal came by boat, mother came on foot"

Before you move on

Which two sounds does Grimm's law change, in the version you need here? (**p** → **f** and **t** → **th**.) Are *père* and *father* borrowed from each other? (**No** — they are the **same inherited word**, arriving by two different roads.) Why does *maternal* keep its *t* while *mother* does not? (*maternal* was **borrowed late from Latin**; *mother* came down the Germanic road and took the sound-change.) Next: the brother.

12.4 le frère — brother

Parents done. The next word rhymes with both of them, and it lets you use the sound-law you just learned instead of only hearing about it.

Sounds you'll need

- **le frère** = *luh FREHR*. The same open **è**, the same throat **r** — and now an **r** on each side of the vowel, which is the only hard part.
- Say **père**, then **frère**. One consonant has been added at the front; everything else is identical.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frère is Latin **frāter**, from Proto-Indo-European ***b^{h}réh$_2$tēr**.
Now use what you have. English **brother** is that same PIE word down the Germanic road: the *t* became *th*, exactly as it did in *father* and *mother*. The law you just met explains a third pair without being told to.
By the Latin road, English got the formal set:

- **frat**ernal, **frat**ernity, **frat**ernize
- and, softened through Old French *frere*, **friar** — a monk who is literally a *brother* of his order

Fraternity and *friar* are the same word twice, once in a lecture hall and once in a monastery, and the difference between them is only how long each spent in a French mouth on the way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le frère" — *luh FREHR*, an *r* on both sides of the vowel
- the three so far — "le père, la mère, le frère"
- the law again — "frāter, brother: the *t* went to *th*"
- "frère → fraternal, friar"

Before you move on

How do you say "the brother"? (**le frère**, *luh FREHR*.) What Latin word is behind it? (**frāter**.) Which sound-change turns *frāter* into English *brother*? (The same one: **t** → **th**.) What is a **friar**, underneath the word? (A **brother** — the same *frère*, worn down through Old French.) Next: the sister, and a letter you have not met.

12.5 la sœur — sister

Three words that rhyme, and then this one. *Père, mère, frère* — and **sœur**, which refuses the pattern and brings a letter with

it.

Sounds you'll need

- **la sœur** = *lah SUR*, but not the *sur* of English *sure*. Round your lips as if to say *oo*, then say *eh* without moving them. That rounded front vowel is what **œu** spells.
- The **r** is the throat **r**, as in the other three.
- The strange letter is **œ**, an *o* and an *e* fused into one. It gets a lesson of its own next; for now, read it as the single vowel you just made.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sœur is Latin **soror** — and you can watch it collapse:
soror → *seror* → *suer* → **sœur**
Two syllables ground down into one, which is why it stopped rhyming with its three relatives. They were worn evenly; this one was worn out of shape.
English kept *soror* whole in the borrowed words:

- **soror**ity, **soror**al
- and a nun is still addressed as **Sister** in English and **ma sœur** in French, the same word in both mouths

English **sister** is not from *soror* by borrowing — it comes down the Germanic road from the same PIE ***swésōr**. So *soror* and *sister* are cousins who have not spoken since before either language existed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la sœur" — lips rounded, then *eh* without moving them
- the pair — "le frère, la sœur"
- the collapse — "soror, seror, sœur"
- all four — "le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur"

Before you move on

How do you say "the sister"? (**la sœur**, *lah SUR* with rounded lips.) What Latin word is behind it? (**soror**.) Why does it not rhyme with the other three? (It was worn down from **two syllables to one** — *soror* → *sœur*.) An English word that kept *soror* whole? (**sorority**.) Next: that fused letter, on its own.

12.6 œ — one letter, not two

You have just read a word containing a character English does not own. It is worth two minutes on its own, because it is not decoration and it is not rare.

Script: œ, one letter and not two

œ is an *o* and an *e* pushed together into a **single letter**. French calls it *e dans l'o* — "e in the o" — which is exactly what it looks like.

Three things follow, and they are the whole lesson:

- It counts as **one** letter when you spell aloud. **sœur** is spelled *s-œ-u-r*: four letters, not five.
- Writing it as two separate letters — *soeur* — is a **substitution**, the way writing *ae* for *æ* is. French readers accept it and French typography does not; a printed book, a newspaper and a road sign all use **œ**.
- It is not a separate sound of its own. In **sœur** the vowel is spelled **œu**, the rounded vowel you made in the last lesson.

Its capital exists too, and looks like what you would expect: **Œ**.

Writing: œ, and the everyday words that need it

The list of everyday **œ** words is short enough to hold in your head, and you already have one of them:

- **la sœur** — the sister, which you have
- **le cœur** — the heart

The words for "egg" and "eye" need it too, and both come later in this book as words in their own right, so learning the letter now means that when they arrive, only the meaning is new. **le cœur** is here because you will meet it everywhere else — it is one of the most common nouns in the language.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the name of the letter — "e dans l'o"
- *Say it:* spell it — "s-œ-u-r", four letters
- *Say it:* the two words — "sœur, cœur"
- *Write it:* **œ** three times: draw the *o*, then start the *e* inside its right edge

Before you move on

How many letters is **œ**? (**One.**) What does French call it? (*e dans l'o* — "e in the o".) How many letters in **sœur**? (**Four** — *s-œ-u-r.*) Name another word that uses it. (**cœur**, the heart.) Next: putting the family together.

12.7 Practice — four words, one law

Four words, learned one at a time. Run them as a set now, and then cash in what each one buys you in English.

Your turn: the set, with articles

The article is half the word, and a family word said bare is a word half learned.

Say these aloud:

- "le père, la mère" — the parents, masculine then feminine
- "le frère, la sœur" — the siblings, same order
- all four straight through, then in reverse

Twice through: "le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur"

Your turn: the three that rhyme, and the one that does not

Say these aloud:

- "père, mère, frère" — one vowel, three times: the open **è**
- "sœur" after them, and hear the break
- why it broke — "soror ground down two syllables into one"

Your turn: cash in the English

Each French word hands you an English one you already knew and never thought about, and the French is the key rather than the lock.

Say these aloud:

- "père → paternal, patron"
- "mère → maternal, matter"
- "frère → fraternal, friar"
- "sœur → sorority"

What you've built this chapter

- **four family words**, each with its article.
- **one sound-law** — Grimm's law, $p \to f$ and $t \to th$. It is why *père* is *father*, *mère* is *mother* and *frāter* is *brother*, and it turned three separate memorisations into one fact.
- **a letter** — **œ**, one character, waiting in *cœur*.
- **a habit worth more than any of them**: when a French word looks like nothing, reach for the long formal English word rather than the short common one. *Père* is opaque next to *father* and obvious next to *paternal*.

Before you move on

Give all four family words with their articles. (**le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur**.) Which two are feminine? (**la mère, la sœur**.) State Grimm's law in the form you need. (**p → f**, **t → th**.) Use it:

what English word is *frāter*? (**brother**.) How many letters is **œ**, and name a word besides *sœur* that has it. (**One**; *cœur*.) Which English word for physical stuff traces back to *mère*? (**matter**.)

Chapter 13

Bread, Water, Wine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name bread, water and wine in French, and ask for some of any of them.
>
> *Three things on a table, and two opposite fates for one kind of word: aqua dissolved into eau, a single vowel spelled with three letters, while vīnum stayed legible in wine, vine and vinegar. pānis gave French its bread and English its companions. Then one rule that English simply leaves out — de plus the article, contracting to du — turns each noun from the thing into some of it.*

13.1 le pain — bread

Food at last. This one word sits at the centre of the French table, and it hides what may be the loveliest word-story English has.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the **-ain** is a **nasal vowel**: the air goes through the nose and the **n** is never said as a consonant of its own.
- `silent-final` — nothing after that vowel is pronounced.
- Together: **le pain** = *luh PA(N)*, where the *(n)* is the nose and not a letter you hear. It is masculine: **le** pain.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pain is Latin **pānis**, "bread." That much is unremarkable. What the root did in English is not.
Take *com-*, "with," and put *pānis* after it. **com + pānis** — "one you break bread with." That is a **companion**, and the word means nothing else:

- **companion**, **company** — a *company* was first a group who ate together, and only later a body of soldiers or a business
- **pantry** — the room the bread is kept in
- **pannier** — a bread-basket, now the bag slung over a bicycle or a donkey

So *le pain* and *companion* are the same root wearing two different jobs. French kept the bread; English kept the friendship built on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le pain" — *luh PA(N)*, the vowel through the nose
- the sum — "com + pānis: one you break bread with"
- "pain → companion, company, pantry"

Before you move on

How do you say "the bread"? (**le pain**, *luh PA(N).*) Is the **n** a consonant here? (**No** — it marks the vowel as **nasal**.) What Latin word is it? (**pānis**.) What does *companion* literally mean? ("One you **break bread with**" — *com-* + *pānis*.) Next: the drink that wore away to a single vowel.

13.2 l'eau — water

Every word so far has been worn down a little. This one was worn down almost completely — and you can still hear what it used to be, in English.

Sounds you'll need

- `o-eau` — **eau** is pronounced **"oh."** That is the entire word. Three written letters, *e-a-u*, spelling **one** vowel sound and nothing else.
- `elision` — it begins with a vowel sound, so the article elides: **l'eau**, not *le eau*. The same elision you met on **l'été**.
- Together: **l'eau** = *loh*. Two letters heard, four written.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eau is Latin **aqua**. Say those two aloud, one after the other, and the distance is almost comic.
Watch the erosion happen, though, and each step is small:
aqua → *ewe* → *eaue* → **eau**
The **q** goes, then the **w**-sound goes, then the final vowel goes, and what is left is a held "oh" with a spelling that remembers the rest.
French, quite literally, **drank the consonants out of** *aqua*.
Meanwhile the loud original survived — in **English**, which borrowed the Latin word whole and never wore it at all: **aqua**tic, **aqua**rium, **aque**duct, **aqua**lung. Italian barely touched it either: *acqua*.
So **l'eau** and **aquarium** are the two far ends of one word, and English is holding the end that still looks like Latin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'eau" — *loh*, one vowel and no more
- the erosion — "aqua, ewe, eaue, eau"
- the two ends — "l'eau, aquarium"
- "le pain, l'eau" — and notice why one elides and the other does not

Before you move on

How do you say "the water"? (**l'eau**, *loh*.) How many sounds are in **eau**? (**One.**) Why is the article **l'** and not *le*? (**eau** begins with a **vowel sound**.) What Latin word is underneath it? (**aqua**.) Where

can you still hear *aqua* loud and whole? (**English** — *aquatic*, *aquarium*, *aqueduct*; and Italian *acqua*.) Next: the drink that refused to wear down.

13.3 le vin — wine

Eau dissolved down to one vowel. This word, sitting on the same table, did the opposite — and the reason is not linguistic.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the same nasal you met in **pain**, spelled **-in** this time rather than **-ain**. Two spellings, one vowel.
- `silent-final` — again, the **n** is the nose and not a consonant.
- Together: **le vin** = *luh VA(N)*. Say **pain** and **vin** back to back and hear that only the first consonant differs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vin is Latin **vīnum** — and unlike *aqua*, it is still recognisable everywhere it went.
English has it several times over, by several routes:

- **wine** — *vīnum* borrowed into early Germanic, long before French existed
- **vine**, **vine**yard — the plant it comes from
- **vin**egar — French *vin* + *aigre*, "**sour wine**," which is exactly what vinegar is
- **vint**age, **vin**yl — the harvest year, and a plastic named from wine spirit

Why did *aqua* dissolve while *vīnum* held? Because words wear down with use and hold their shape when they are **traded**. Water is what you have; wine is what you buy, ship, tax and write down. A word that keeps appearing on a bill of lading in three countries stays legible in all three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le vin" — *luh VA(N)*, the nose again
- the near-pair — "le pain, le vin"; one consonant apart
- "vin → wine, vine, vinegar"
- the contrast — "l'eau wore away, le vin did not"

Before you move on

How do you say "the wine"? (**le vin**, *luh VA(N).*) Which other word this chapter has the same vowel? (**le pain**.) What Latin word is behind it? (**vīnum**.) What does *vinegar* literally say? (**Sour wine** — *vin* + *aigre*.) Next: how to ask for **some** of any of them.

13.4 du pain, de l'eau — asking for *some*

You have three things on the table and no way to ask for any of them yet. **le pain** is *the* bread — a particular loaf. What you actually want at a table is **some** bread, and French makes you say so.

Grammar Lens: French says "of the", where English says nothing

English can drop the word entirely. *"I'd like bread"* is perfectly good English. French cannot: it marks **an unmeasured amount of a thing** with **de** plus the article the noun already takes.

de + le pain → du pain — *some bread*

de + le vin → du vin — *some wine*

de + l'eau → de l'eau — *some water*

That is one rule, not three. **de + le** always contracts to **du**; **de + l'** has nothing to contract, so it simply stays apart. You are not learning a new list here — you are putting *de* in front of the article you already know, and letting the vowel rule you already met decide the shape.

And the contrast is worth hearing directly:

- **le pain** — *the* bread, that loaf, the one on the table
- **un pain** — *a* loaf, one whole item you could pick up
- **du pain** — *some* bread, an amount with no edges

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "du pain, du vin, de l'eau"
- the reason — "de plus the article; du where it contracts"
- the ladder on one noun — "le pain, un pain, du pain"

Twice through: "du pain, du vin, de l'eau"

Before you move on

How do you say "some bread"? (**du pain**.) Some wine? (**du vin**.) Some water? (**de l'eau** — *eau* takes **l'**, so there is nothing to contract.) What are the two words hiding inside **du**? (**de** + **le**.) What is the difference between *un pain* and *du pain*? (**un pain** is **a loaf**, one whole item; **du pain** is **some bread**, an amount with no edges.) Next: all three together.

13.5 Practice — the table, and asking for some of it

Three nouns and one rule. Run the nouns first, then put the rule on each of them in turn.

Your turn: the three, with their articles

Say these aloud:

- "le pain, l'eau, le vin"
- the odd one — "l'eau elides, because it opens with a vowel"

- the near-pair — “le pain, le vin”; the same nasal, one consonant apart

Twice through: “le pain, l’eau, le vin”

Your turn: now ask for some

Say these aloud:

- “du pain, du vin, de l’eau”
- each noun three ways — “le pain, un pain, du pain”
- the same three ways for wine — “le vin, un vin, du vin”

Your turn: two words that wore differently

Say these aloud:

- the erosion — “aqua, ewe, eaue, eau”
- the survival — “vīnum: wine, vine, vinegar”
- the sum — “com plus pānis: companion”

What you’ve built this chapter

- **three nouns** you can put on a table, each with the right article.
- **one rule for “some”** — *de* plus the article, contracting to **du** where it can. It is the first time French has asked you to say something English simply leaves out.
- **two opposite fates for one kind of word.** *aqua* dissolved into *eau*; *vīnum* is still legible in four English words. Everyday things wear down, traded things stay legible — which is a rule you can use on words you have not met yet.
- **a root that paid twice** — *pānis* gave French its bread and English its **companions**.

Before you move on

Give all three with their articles. (**le pain, l’eau, le vin**.) Why does only one of them elide? (**eau** begins with a **vowel sound**.) Ask

for some of each. (**du pain, du vin, de l'eau**.) What two words are inside **du**? (**de** + **le**.) Which Latin word wore down to a single vowel, and which one barely moved? (**aqua** → *eau*; **vīnum** → *vin*.)

Chapter 14

The Welded Teens

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from eleven to sixteen in French, and say which half of each word is the digit and which is the ten.
>
> *Six numbers French did not build. It inherited them from Latin already welded shut — ūndecim, duodecim, trēdecim — and wore them down to one syllable each. The -ze they all share is decem, the same ten already hiding in dix and in décembre, and the front of every one of them is its own digit: deux in douze, six in seize. The digit comes first and the ten comes second, which is a choice, and French is about to make the other one.*

14.1 onze — eleven

You can count to ten. The eleventh number is where you find out that French did not build its teens at all — it inherited them, already welded shut.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-on` — the **on** is a **nasal vowel**, the same one you have in **bonjour**.
- `z-voiced` — the **z** is buzzed, not hissed: your throat should vibrate.
- Together: **onze** = *ONZ*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

onze is Latin **ūndecim** — *ūnus* ("one") plus *decem* ("ten"), fused into one word before French existed.
Notice what French did **not** do. English says *eleven*, which is its own strange word; German says *elf*. French could have said **dix-un**, "ten-one," and it does not. It took the Latin compound whole and wore it down: *ūndecim* → *onze*, four syllables into one.
That is worth flagging now, because it will not last. French keeps this inherited style for exactly six numbers, and then abandons it in front of you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "onze" — *ONZ*, the vowel through the nose, the *z* buzzed
- the count so far — "huit, neuf, dix, onze"
- what is inside it — "ūnus plus decem: one-ten"

Before you move on

How do you say eleven? (**onze**, *ONZ*.) What two Latin words are fused inside it? (***ūnus*** and ***decem*** — "one" and "ten".) Did French build this word out of *dix* and *un*? (**No** — it inherited *ūndecim* already joined.) Next: twelve, the same way.

14.2 douze — twelve

One welded number could be an accident. Two of them is a pattern, and this one lets you hear the join.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** make a single pure **oo**, as in English *food*. Never two sounds.
- `z-voiced` — the same buzzed **z** as **onze**.
- Together: **douze** = *DOOZ*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douze is Latin **duodecim** — *duo* ("two") plus *decem* ("ten"). And this time you can see both halves survive into the French. Say **deux**, then say **douze**, and listen to the front of each: *deu-*, *dou-*. That is the same digit, and it did not disappear — it was only worn down. The back half is doing the same thing. **onze** and **douze** both end in **-ze**, and both come from a Latin word ending in *-decim*. Two words, one shared ending, and a strong hint about where that ending came from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "douze" — *DOOZ*, the *o-u* a single pure vowel
- the digit surfacing — "deux, douze"
- the pair — "onze, douze"; hear the shared ending

Before you move on

How do you say twelve? (**douze**, *DOOZ*.) Which small number can you hear at the front of it? (***deux***.) What Latin word is it from? (***duodecim***.) What ending do *onze* and *douze* share? (**-ze**.) Next: what that **-ze** actually is.

14.3 -ze — the ten you keep meeting

Onze and *douze* share an ending. Before you learn four more words that also share it, it is worth two minutes to find out what it **is** — because you have already met it twice, wearing other clothes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The **-ze** on the end of *onze* and *douze* is Latin **decem**, "ten." That is all it is. *ūn-decim* → *on-ze*. *duo-decim* → *dou-ze*. The Latin *-decim* has been ground down to a single buzzed consonant and a silent vowel, but it is still the word **ten**, still sitting in the back half of the

number, still telling you what the number is built on.
Now put it beside the other two places you have already met that same *decem*:

- **dix** — ten itself, worn down from *decem* at the front instead of the back
- **décembre** — the old **tenth** month, which kept *decem* almost intact
- **-ze** — the same ten, welded onto a digit and nearly erased

One Latin root, three disguises, and you now hold all three. This is the single most useful habit this book can give you: when a scrap of a word looks familiar, it usually is, and the long word is the one that tells you what the short one was.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three disguises — "dix, décembre, onze"
- the claim — "the -ze is decem; it means ten"
- the two you have — "onze, douze"; and hear the ten on the end of both

Before you move on

What is the **-ze** of *onze* and *douze*? (Latin **decem**, "ten".) Name two other French words where you have already met that same *decem*. (**dix** and **décembre**.) Which of the three kept it most intact? (**décembre**.) Next: thirteen, with the ten now visible on the end.

14.4 treize — thirteen

With the **-ze** identified, the rest of the welded teens stop being words to memorise and start being sums you can read.

Sounds you'll need

- The **ei** is the open **è** you met in *père* and *frère* — *treh*, not *tray*.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** again.
- Together: **treize** = *TREHZ*, one syllable, with the throat **r** at the front.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

treize is Latin **trēdecim** — *trēs* ("three") plus *decem* ("ten").
Read it as a sum now rather than a word:
trei- is *trois*, worn down · **-ze** is *decem*, worn down
Say **trois**, then **treize**, and the front half answers for itself. You are not learning a thirteenth arbitrary noise; you are reading *three* and *ten* stuck together and then rubbed smooth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "treize" — *TREHZ*, the open *è*
- the digit surfacing — "trois, treize"
- the three you have — "onze, douze, treize"

Before you move on

How do you say thirteen? (**treize**, *TREHZ*.) What are its two halves? (***trois*** and the **-ze** that is **decem**.) Count from eleven. (*Onze, douze, treize.*) Next: fourteen, the longest of them.

14.5 quatorze — fourteen

Every teen so far has been one syllable. This one is two, and the reason is that it started out longer than any of them.

Sounds you'll need

- **quatorze** = *ka-TORZ*. Two syllables, weight on the second.
- The **qu** is a plain **k**, exactly as in **quatre** — never a *kw*.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** closes it, like all the others.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatorze is Latin **quattuordecim** — *quattuor* ("four") plus *decem*. *Quattuordecim* is five syllables. *Quatorze* is two. French has thrown away more than half the word and still kept both ideas: **quator-** is the four, **-ze** is the ten.
Set it beside its own digit — **quatre**, *KATR* — and the family resemblance is obvious once you stop expecting the spelling to match. Both begin *quat-*; the number simply grew a syllable to carry the ten.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quatorze" — *ka-TORZ*, the *qu* a plain *k*
- the digit surfacing — "quatre, quatorze"
- the four you have — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze"

Before you move on

How do you say fourteen? (**quatorze**, *ka-TORZ*.) How is the **qu** pronounced? (A plain **k**.) What Latin word is behind it? (***quattuordecim***.) Count from eleven. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze*.) Next: fifteen.

14.6 quinze — fifteen

Back to one syllable — and this is the teen whose Latin half you are most likely to already know from English.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the **in** is the nasal vowel you have in **pain** and **vin**.
- The **qu** is a plain **k** again.
- Together: **quinze** = *KANZ*, one syllable, the vowel through the nose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quinze is Latin **quīndecim** — *quīnque* ("five") plus *decem*.
The French digit **cinq** has travelled a long way from *quīnque*, so *quinze* does not obviously look like *cinq*. But the Latin **quīn-** is loud in English, and that is the way in:

- **quin**tet — a group of five
- **quin**tuplet — one of five
- **quin**tessence — the *fifth* essence, the one the ancients added to earth, water, air and fire

So when *cinq* and *quinze* refuse to look related, go through English: *quintet* is the bridge between them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quinze" — *KANZ*, the vowel through the nose
- the bridge — "cinq, quintet, quinze"
- the five you have — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze"

Before you move on

How do you say fifteen? (**quinze**, *KANZ*.) Which English words carry the same *quīn-*? (**quintet**, **quintuplet**, **quintessence**.) Why is that useful here? (*cinq* and *quinze* **do not look alike**; the English word is the **bridge** between them.) Next: sixteen, the last of the welded ones.

14.7 seize — sixteen

The sixth and last of them. After this word the pattern you have spent five lessons learning simply stops — which is the next chapter's whole subject.

Sounds you'll need

- The **ei** is the open **è**, the same vowel as **treize**.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** one last time.
- Together: **seize** = *SEHZ*. Say **treize** and **seize** back to back: one consonant apart, and they rhyme exactly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seize is Latin **sēdecim** — *sex* ("six") plus *decem*.
That is the sixth and final inherited compound. Latin had them beyond this point too, but French did not keep them, and you are about to see what it did instead.
Note also what **seize** is not. It is **not** *dix-six*. Nothing in the first six teens is built out of *dix* plus a digit — every one of them arrived from Latin already joined, and French merely wore them down. That distinction is the thing to hold on to going into the next chapter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "seize" — *SEHZ*
- the rhyme — "treize, seize"
- all six — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Before you move on

How do you say sixteen? (**seize**, *SEHZ*.) Which other teen rhymes with it? (**treize**.) Is it built from *dix* and *six*? (**No** — it came from Latin *sēdecim* already **fused**.) Count all six. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize*.) Next: which end of each word is the digit.

14.8 trei-ze — which half is which

You have six words and you know their ending is *ten*. One question is left, and it is the one that makes the next chapter make sense: **which end of the word is the digit?**

Grammar Lens: digit in front, ten behind

In all six, the **digit comes first** and the **ten comes second**.
Trēdecim is "three-ten," **not** "ten-three."
Each word is its own small number worn down, with the ten stuck on the back:

number	the digit in front	the ten behind
onze	**on-** ← *un*	**-ze**
douze	**dou-** ← *deux*	**-ze**
treize	**trei-** ← *trois*	**-ze**
quatorze	**quator-** ← *quatre*	**-ze**
quinze	**quin-** ← *cinq*	**-ze**
seize	**sei-** ← *six*	**-ze**

Say each pair slowly — *deux, douze*; *six, seize* — and the small number surfaces every time.
Hold on to the **order**, not just the halves. Digit-first is a choice, and a language can make the other one. French is about to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the rule — "digit first, ten second"
- the six pairs — "un/onze, deux/douze, trois/treize, quatre/quatorze, cinq/quinze, six/seize"
- the shape of one — "trei- is three, -ze is ten"

Twice through: "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Before you move on

In *treize*, which half is the three and which is the ten? (**trei-** is the three; **-ze** is the ten.) So is 13 built as "three-ten" or "ten-three"?

(**Three-ten** — the **digit comes first**.) Which digit is hiding in *quatorze*? (***quatre***.) Next chapter: the number where French reverses that order and stops fusing altogether.

14.9 Practice — eleven to sixteen

Six words, learned one at a time. Run them as a block, then take each one apart again from memory.

Your turn: the run

Say these aloud:

- "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"
- from ten — "dix, onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"
- backwards — "seize, quinze, quatorze, treize, douze, onze"

Twice through: "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Your turn: surface the digit

Say these aloud:

- each pair — "un/onze, deux/douze, trois/treize"
- the harder three — "quatre/quatorze, cinq/quinze, six/seize"
- the one that needs English — "cinq, quintet, quinze"

Your turn: the ten on the end

Say these aloud:

- the three disguises — "dix, décembre, -ze"
- one sum aloud — "trei- is three, -ze is ten, treize is thirteen"

What you've built this chapter

- **six numbers**, eleven to sixteen.
- **one ending explained** — the **-ze** is *decem*, the same ten you already had in **dix** and **décembre**. Three disguises, one root.
- **the order** — digit in front, ten behind. *Treize* is "three-ten."
- **a way in when a word refuses** — *cinq* and *quinze* do not look alike, and English **quintet** stands between them. Reach for the long formal English word whenever the short French one has worn past recognition.

Before you move on

Count eleven to sixteen without stopping. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize.*) What is the **-ze**? (Latin **decem**, "ten".) Which comes first in these words, the digit or the ten? (The **digit**.) Which digit is in *quatorze*? (***quatre***.) Were any of these built out of *dix* plus a digit? (**No** — all six arrived from Latin already **fused**.)

Chapter 15

Where French Changes Its Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from seventeen to twenty in French, and name the two things that change at seventeen.
>
> *At exactly seventeen, French stops inheriting numbers and starts building them — and swaps the order of the parts while doing it. seize is six-ten, fused; dix-sept is ten-seven, built out of two words you already own. Most language change is too slow to point at; this seam sits between two consecutive numbers and you can say both sides of it aloud. Then vingt arrives as a single inherited word again, and it is the number French will later count in: quatre-vingts, four twenties.*

15.1 dix-sept — seventeen

Six words in a row arrived from Latin already welded. Here is the seventh, and you can read it at sight — which is exactly the surprise.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-sept** = *dees-SET*. The **x** of *dix* becomes an **s** sound here, and the **p** of *sept* is silent as always.
- `final-consonant` — the **t** of *sept* **is** pronounced. That is unusual for a final consonant in French, and *sept* keeps it in every position.
- Two words, one hyphen, one number.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

There is no Latin ancestor to trace here, and that is the point. **dix-sept** is **dix** and **sept**, the two words you have had since the counting chapter, put side by side with a hyphen. Nothing has been worn down, nothing is hiding, nothing needs an etymology. It says **ten-seven** and it means seventeen.

Latin *did* have a fused word for this — *septendecim* — and French threw it away. After six inherited compounds the language simply stopped, and started building numbers out of parts the speaker already had.

You have just watched a language change its mind mid-count. The next lesson is about what exactly changed, because it is **two** things and not one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-sept" — *dees-SET*, and the final *t* is heard
- the seam — "seize, dix-sept"; one is welded, one is built
- the parts — "dix, sept, dix-sept"

Before you move on

How do you say seventeen? (**dix-sept**, *dees-SET*.) What two words is it made of? (***dix*** and ***sept***.) Did French inherit this one from Latin the way it inherited *seize*? (**No** — Latin had *septendecim* and French **abandoned** it, building the number out of parts instead.) Next: the two things that changed at this exact number.

15.2 seize / dix-sept — the seam

Put the two words side by side — **seize**, then **dix-sept** — and something changed between them. Two things did, and most people only notice one.

Grammar Lens: strategy and direction, both at once

The obvious change is **strategy**. Up to sixteen the numbers are **fused** — single words inherited whole and worn down. From seventeen they are **transparent** — built in the open out of words you already have. The change nobody notices is **direction**, and it is a question of which half comes first:

number	**shape**	**what comes first**
seize	*sē-decim*, fused	the **digit**: six-ten
dix-sept	*dix* + *sept*, built	the **ten**: ten-seven

Seize is **six-ten**. *Dix-sept* is **ten-seven**. The two halves have swapped places. So at exactly one number, French changed **how** it makes the word and **which way round** the parts go — and it never went back. That is worth seeing because it is a rare thing to catch. Languages usually change too slowly to point at. Here the join is visible between two consecutive numbers, and you can say both sides of it out loud.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- across the seam — "seize, dix-sept"
- the first change — "fused, then built"
- the second change — "six-ten, then ten-seven"
- the summary — "at seventeen, both the method and the order flipped"

Before you move on

Name the **two** things that change between *seize* and *dix-sept*. (The **strategy** — fused becomes built; and the **direction** — digit-first becomes ten-first.) Which half comes first in *seize*? (The **digit**: six-ten.) And in *dix-sept*? (The **ten**: ten-seven.) Next: eighteen, which now costs you nothing.

15.3 dix-huit — eighteen

This is the first number in the book that costs you nothing. You already know the rule; this is just applying it.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-huit** = *dee-ZWEET*. The **x** of *dix* buzzes into a **z** here, because *huit* begins with a vowel sound.
- `silent-h` — the **h** of *huit* is not said, which is why the *z* can carry straight across into it.
- The final **t** of *huit* **is** pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix + huit, ten and eight. Nothing more.
What is worth a moment is what Latin did here instead, because it is stranger than anything French does. For 18 and 19 Latin did not add — it **subtracted**. Eighteen was **duodēvīgintī**: "**two from twenty**." Nineteen was *ūndēvīgintī*, "one from twenty."
Every language descended from Latin dropped that. French, Spanish and Italian all count **up** to twenty rather than down from it. So the plain *ten-eight* in front of you is not a lazy simplification — it is the survivor of a competition, and the elegant subtraction trick is the thing that lost.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-huit" — *dee-ZWEET*, the *x* buzzing into the vowel
- the pair — "dix-sept, dix-huit"; hear *dees-* then *dee-z-*
- what Latin said — "two from twenty"

Before you move on

How do you say eighteen? (**dix-huit**, *dee-ZWEET*.) Why does the *x* buzz here but hiss in *dix-sept*? (***huit*** begins with a **vowel sound**; *sept* does not.) How did Latin build eighteen? (By **subtracting** —

duodē- vīgintī, "**two from twenty**".) Did French keep that? (**No.**) Next: nineteen.

15.4 dix-neuf — nineteen

The last of the built teens — and a word that quietly means two different things.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-neuf** = *dees-NUF*. The **x** hisses as an **s** here, the way it does in *dix-sept*, because *neuf* begins with a consonant.
- The **eu** is the rounded vowel you made in **sœur**: lips rounded, tongue forward.
- The final **f** is pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix + neuf, ten and nine.
The interesting part is **neuf** itself, which is two words wearing one coat:

- **neuf** = **nine**, from Latin *novem*
- **neuf** = **new**, from Latin *novus*

Those were distinct in Latin and French wore them into the same four letters. So *un livre neuf* is "a new book," and *neuf livres* is "nine books," and only the position tells you which.
They are not unrelated, either. The same *nov-* is behind English **novel**, **novice**, **innovate** and **November** — the old **ninth** month, which is the counting month you already met. *Novem* and *novus* are cousins from far enough back that nobody is quite sure which sense came first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-neuf" — *dees-NUF*, the *f* heard

- all three built teens — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf"
- the double word — "neuf is nine, and neuf is new"

Before you move on

How do you say nineteen? (**dix-neuf**, *dees-NUF*.) What are its two parts? (***dix*** and ***neuf***.) What else does **neuf** mean besides nine? (**New** — from *novus*, where the number is from *novem*.) Which month carries the same *nov*-? (**novembre**.) Next: twenty, and a different system again.

15.5 vingt — twenty

Three built numbers in a row, and then this — which is not built out of anything at all.

Sounds you'll need

- **vingt** = *VA(N)*. The **in** is the nasal vowel you have in **vin** and **pain**.
- `silent-final` — the **g** and the **t** are both silent. Four written letters after the vowel, none of them heard.
- Say **vin** and **vingt** aloud: standing alone they are **identical**. Only the spelling and the sentence tell them apart.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vingt is Latin **vīgintī**, and that is the whole story: an old, single, inherited word, like *dix* and unlike *dix-sept*.
So the count you have just walked through has **three** systems in it, not two:

- 11–16 — inherited, **fused**, digit first
- 17–19 — **built**, transparent, ten first
- 20 — inherited again, a **single word** built from nothing

Twenty is not the end of a pattern. It is the start of a different one, because *vingt* is the number French will later count **in**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vingt" — *VA(N)*, everything after the vowel silent
- the homophones — "vin, vingt"; identical on their own
- the last four — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Before you move on

How do you say twenty? (**vingt**, *VA(N)*.) How many of its letters after the vowel are pronounced? (**None.**) Which word from the table chapter sounds exactly the same? (***vin***, wine.) Is *vingt* built out of smaller numbers? (**No** — it is a single inherited word, from *vīgintī*.) Next: what that *vīgintī* went on to do.

15.6 vīgintī — the number French counts in

Vingt looks like an ending. It is a beginning, and this lesson is here so that a famous French oddity is already explained before you meet it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin **vīgintī** did not only give French *vingt*. It gave English a word for an idea:
vigesimal — counting in **twenties**, the way *decimal* is counting in tens.
Most of Europe counts in tens. But a way of counting in **twenties** survived underneath French, and it surfaces in the higher numbers. Eighty in French is not "eight-ten." It is:

quatre-vingts — literally **four twenties**

Four twenties is eighty. And ninety-nine, famously, is *quatre-vingt-dix-neuf* — "four twenties, ten, nine."
You are not learning those numbers here. You are learning **why** they will look the way they do, so that when they arrive they are a consequence rather than a shock. English keeps one fossil of the same habit: a **score** is twenty, and "four score and seven years ago" is

quatre-vingt-sept in a different language.
So *vingt* is the base of a second counting system hiding inside a decimal one — which is a much better thing to know at twenty than at eighty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the English word — "vigesimal: counting by twenties"
- the preview — "quatre-vingts, four twenties, eighty"
- the English fossil — "four score and seven"

Before you move on

What does **vigesimal** mean? (**Counting by twenties.**) What does *quatre-vingts* literally say, and what number is it? ("**Four twenties**" — **eighty**.) Which English word for twenty preserves the same habit? (A **score**.) Next: all ten numbers together.

15.7 Practice — across the seam, and up to twenty

You can now count to twenty. Run the whole thing, and listen for the place where the machine changes.

Your turn: the full count

Say these aloud:

- eleven to twenty — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize, dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"
- from one, the whole way
- the four new ones alone — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Twice through: "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Your turn: hear the seam

Say these aloud:

- the two words either side — "seize, dix-sept"
- what changed first — "fused, then built"
- what changed second — "six-ten, then ten-seven"

Your turn: the x that cannot decide

Say these aloud:

- hissing — "dix-sept, dix-neuf"; both follow a consonant
- buzzing — "dix-huit"; it follows a vowel sound
- the reason aloud — "the x buzzes into a vowel and hisses before a consonant"

What you've built this chapter

- **four numbers**, seventeen to twenty, and with them the whole count to 20.
- **a seam you can point at** — at seventeen French changed both its **strategy** and its **direction**, and never went back. Most language change is too slow to witness; this one sits between two consecutive numbers.
- **three systems in ten numbers** — inherited and fused, built and transparent, then a single inherited word again at *vingt*.
- **an oddity explained before you meet it** — *vīgintī* is why eighty will be **quatre-vingts**, four twenties.

Before you move on

Count from eleven to twenty without stopping. Which number is the seam, and what two things change there? (**Seventeen** — **fused becomes built**, and **digit-first becomes ten-first**.) Why does the *x* of *dix* buzz in *dix-huit* but hiss in *dix-neuf*? (***huit*** begins with a **vowel sound**.) What will *quatre-vingts* mean, and why? ("**Four**

twenties” — eighty; from *vīgintī*, the **vigesimal** habit.)

Chapter 16

Colours

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name four basic colours in French, put a colour after the noun it describes, and say which of them are not Latin.
>
> *Four colours with two different homelands. noir walked down from Latin niger and rouge from a root older than Latin — the same one behind English red, rust and German rot. But blanc and bleu are Frankish, Germanic words that displaced Latin ones inside a Romance language, which is the opposite of the usual traffic. albus did not die when blanc took its job; it stopped being a colour and became l'aube, the dawn. And the colour goes after its noun — le vin rouge — with bonjour as the exception the reader already says every day.*

16.1 noir — black

Four colours in this chapter, and they do not have four similar stories. Start with the one that behaves exactly as you would expect, so the surprises stand out later.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — the **oi** is *wa*, one gliding vowel. It is the same **oi** you have in **trois** and **soir**.
- `r-uvular` — the final **r** is sounded here, made in the throat.
- Together: **noir** = *NWAR*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noir is Latin **niger**, "black." Nothing was borrowed and nothing is hiding: the word walked straight down from Rome into French, and did the same into its sisters — Spanish *negro*, Italian *nero*.
English took *niger* too, but only as a metaphor. To **denigrate** someone is, literally, to **blacken** them — to darken a name rather than a thing. The colour stayed in the Romance languages; the insult is what crossed into English.
So *noir* is the plain case. Hold on to that, because the next colour is not plain at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "noir" — *NWAR*, the *oi* a single gliding vowel
- the family — "niger, noir, negro, nero"
- the English one — "denigrate: to blacken a name"

Before you move on

How do you say black? (**noir**, *NWAR*.) What Latin word is it from? (***niger***.) What does **denigrate** literally mean? (To **blacken** — to darken someone's name.) Next: white, which did not come from Latin at all.

16.2 blanc — white

Every word in this book so far has come down from Latin. This one did not, and the direction it came from is the opposite of what usually happens.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-an` — the **an** is the nasal vowel you have in **janvier**.
- `silent-final` — the **c** at the end is **not** pronounced.
- Together: **blanc** = *BLA(N)*, one syllable, nothing after the nose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin had a perfectly good word for white: **albus**. French does not use it.
blanc is **Frankish** — a **Germanic** word, from **blank*, meaning not "white" exactly but "**shining, gleaming, flashing**." The Franks are the people who gave France its name, and they gave it its word for white as well.
That direction is the surprising part. Latin words pour into Germanic languages constantly; English is more than half built of them. Traffic the other way, a Germanic word displacing a Latin one **inside** a Romance language, is much rarer.
Why did *albus* lose? Most likely because *blank* was more **vivid**. *Albus* is a flat, plain white; *blank* is a white that **shines**. Colour words are replaced by the more dramatic option surprisingly often — the exciting word wins and then calms down into the ordinary one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "blanc" — *BLA(N)*, the *c* silent
- the pair — "noir, blanc"
- the origin — "Frankish blank: shining"
- the two stories — "noir walked down from Rome, blanc walked in from the north"

Before you move on

How do you say white? (**blanc**, *BLA(N).*) Is the final **c** sounded? (**No.**) Which language did it come from? (**Frankish** — Germanic, not Latin.) What did **blank* actually mean? ("**Shining**, gleaming.") What was the Latin word it displaced? (***albus***.) Next: where *albus* went instead.

16.3 l'aube — the white that stopped being a colour

Blanc took the job. That does not mean *albus* was thrown away — words that lose an argument usually go and do something else.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin **albus** is still all around you. It simply stopped being the word for the colour, and survives inside words for **things that are white**:

- **l'aube** — the **dawn**: the sky going white. French, and pronounced *lohb*
- **l'aubépine** — the **hawthorn**, literally the "**white thorn**"
- **album** — English, from a *blank white tablet* you wrote on
- **albino** — English, someone white-skinned

That is a pattern worth naming, because it will keep happening. When a newer word takes over a plain everyday meaning, the older one does not vanish. It gets pushed into the **specific** — a time of day, a particular tree, a technical term — and stays there for centuries, unnoticed.
So French has two whites after all. One you say when you mean the colour, and one you say without knowing you are saying it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'aube" — *lohb*, the dawn
- the white inside it — "albus: the sky going white"
- the English survivors — "album, albino"
- the two whites — "blanc for the colour, aube for the hour"

Before you move on

What does **l'aube** mean, and what is white about it? (The **dawn** — the sky going white.) Which Latin word is inside it? (***albus***.) Name two English words that kept the same *albus*. (**album**, **albino**.) What happens to a word when a newer one takes its everyday job? (It survives in the **specific** — a time, a tree, a technical term.) Next: red, which is older than Latin.

16.4 rouge — red

Noir came from Latin and *blanc* from the Franks. This one goes back further than either — further than Latin itself.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** make the pure **oo** you have in **douze**.
- `soft-j` — the **g** here is the soft *zh* of *measure*, the same sound as the **j** in **janvier**.
- Together: **rouge** = *ROOZH*, one syllable. English borrowed the word whole for makeup and kept the French sound with it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rouge is Latin **rubeus**, "reddish." But *rubeus* is itself inherited, from a Proto-Indo-European root ***h₁rewd^{h}-** so old that its children are scattered across the whole family:

- Latin *ruber*, *rubeus* → French **rouge**, and English **ruby**, **rubric**
- English **red**, **rust**, **ruddy**
- German **rot**

So *rouge* and **red** are not lookalikes that happen to mean the same thing. They are **actual cousins**, separated for something like five thousand years and still saying the same colour.
That is not an accident of this one word. **Red** is one of the oldest colours any language names — after black and white, it is almost

always the third colour a language gets a word for, and often the only other one for a long time. A word that old survives everywhere because it was never not needed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "rouge" — *ROOZH*, the soft *g*
- the cousins in a row — "rouge, red, rot"
- the Latin ones — "ruber, ruby, rubric"
- the three you have — "noir, blanc, rouge"

Before you move on

How do you say red? (**rouge**, *ROOZH*.) How is the **g** pronounced? (Soft — the *zh* of *measure*.) Are *rouge* and English *red* borrowed from each other? (**No** — they are **cousins** from the same Proto-Indo-European root.) Name two more of that root's children. (**rust**, **ruddy**, **ruby**, **rubric**, German **rot** — any two.) Next: blue, which went abroad and came home.

16.5 bleu — blue

The fourth colour, and the second one that is not Latin. Once is a curiosity; twice is a pattern about who was actually living in France.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-eu` — the **eu** is the rounded front vowel you made in **sœur**: lips rounded, tongue forward.
- `silent-final` — there is no consonant after it to say.
- Together: **bleu** = *BLUH*, one syllable, and shorter than English speakers expect.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bleu is **Frankish *blāo** — Germanic again, borrowed exactly the way *blanc* was.
Then something neat happened. **English took *bleu* from French.** So English **blue** is a Germanic word that walked into France, spent centuries there changing its shape, and was then borrowed back into a Germanic language. It went abroad and came home wearing different clothes.
Meanwhile German never sent its copy anywhere: it still says **blau**, which is what **blāo* sounded like all along. Say **blau**, **bleu**, **blue** in a row and you are hearing one word at three stages of one journey.
*(French has a second, more poetic blue as well — **azur**, ultimately from Arabic* lāzaward*, "lapis lazuli." You have almost certainly seen it already, on the map: the **Côte d'Azur**.)*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bleu" — *BLUH*, lips rounded, and keep it short
- the round trip — "blau, bleu, blue"
- the two Frankish ones — "blanc, bleu"
- all four — "noir, blanc, rouge, bleu"

Before you move on

How do you say blue? (**bleu**, *BLUH.*) Which language did it come from? (**Frankish** — Germanic, like *blanc.*) What is odd about English **blue**? (It is a **Germanic** word that English borrowed **from French** — it went abroad and came back.) What did German keep? (**blau**.) Next: where the colour goes in the sentence.

16.6 le vin rouge — where the colour goes

You have four colours and a table full of nouns. Putting them together takes one rule, and English gets it the other way round.

Grammar Lens: the colour comes second

English puts the colour **in front** of the noun: *red wine*, *white bread*. French puts it **behind**:

> **le vin rouge** — the wine red
>
> **le pain blanc** — the bread white

The order feels backwards for about a week and then stops feeling like anything. What makes it stick faster is noticing that you **already say the exception**.
bonjour is *bon* + *jour* — a good day, with the adjective in **front**. So French does both, and the split is not random: a small handful of very common, very short adjectives go before the noun — *bon*, *bonne*, and a few others you will meet — while nearly everything else, **colours included**, goes after.
That is the useful form of the rule. Not "French adjectives follow the noun," which the word *bonjour* would immediately contradict, but: **the short common ones lead, and everything else follows.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two wines — "le vin rouge, le vin blanc"
- with bread — "le pain blanc"
- the exception you already own — "bonjour: bon comes first"
- the rule as one line — "short and common in front, everything else behind"

Twice through: "le vin rouge, le vin blanc"

Before you move on

How do you say "red wine"? (**le vin rouge** — the colour **second**.) White bread? (**le pain blanc**.) Which everyday word puts its adjective **first**? (**bonjour** — *bon* + *jour*.) State the rule in one line. (**Short, common adjectives go in front; everything else,**

colours included, goes after.) Next: the three colours on the flag.

16.7 bleu, blanc, rouge — the flag

Three of your four colours are the flag, and saying them in its order is the easiest way to keep them. There is also a joke buried in them.

Why it's said this way

The French flag is named by its colours, left to right:

bleu, blanc, rouge

Say it in that order and it comes as one unit rather than three words. French speakers say it that way constantly — *le drapeau bleu-blanc-rouge* — and it is by far the most common context in which all three appear together.
Now count where they came from:

- **bleu** — Frankish, Germanic
- **blanc** — Frankish, Germanic
- **rouge** — Latin, from a root older than Latin

So the **tricolour is two-thirds Germanic**. The flag of the most self-consciously Latin nation in Europe names itself with two borrowed Germanic words and one inherited one, and no one notices, because a word stops being foreign the moment everybody uses it.
That is the honest summary of this chapter: of four basic colours, **half** came from the north. Half of French's most everyday vocabulary is not doing what the label "Romance language" would lead you to expect.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the flag — "bleu, blanc, rouge"
- all four colours — "noir, blanc, rouge, bleu"

- the sources — “Latin, Frankish, Latin, Frankish”
- the finding — “the tricolour is two-thirds Germanic”

Twice through: “bleu, blanc, rouge”

Before you move on

Name the flag’s colours in order. (**bleu, blanc, rouge**.) Which two of them are Germanic borrowings? (***bleu*** and ***blanc***.) So what fraction of the tricolour is Germanic? (**Two-thirds.**) And of the chapter’s four colours? (**Half.**) Next: all four, put to work.

16.8 Practice — four colours and where they came from

Four words, and then the thing that makes them worth more than four words: each one has a passport.

Your turn: the four

Say these aloud:

- “noir, blanc, rouge, bleu”
- the flag order — “bleu, blanc, rouge”
- the two nasal ones — “blanc”; and the two that end in a vowel sound — “bleu”

Twice through: “noir, blanc, rouge, bleu”

Your turn: put them on nouns

Say these aloud:

- “le vin rouge, le vin blanc”
- “le pain blanc”
- the order out loud — “the noun, then the colour”
- the exception — “bonjour”

Your turn: where each one came from

Say these aloud:

- "noir — Latin niger; denigrate"
- "blanc — Frankish blank, shining"
- "rouge — Latin rubeus; red, rot, ruby"
- "bleu — Frankish blao; blau, bleu, blue"
- the one that changed jobs — "albus became l'aube, the dawn"

What you've built this chapter

- **four colours**, and the flag as a set.
- **word order** — the colour goes **after** the noun, and *bonjour* is the exception you already said before you knew it was one.
- **half of them are not Latin.** *blanc* and *bleu* are Frankish, which runs against the usual direction of traffic: Latin words flood into Germanic languages, not the reverse.
- **a word that lost and survived anyway** — *albus* gave up the colour and kept the dawn. That is what usually happens to a displaced word, and it is worth looking for.

Before you move on

Give the four colours. (**noir, blanc, rouge, bleu**.) Which two are Germanic? (***blanc*** and ***bleu***.) Say "red wine." (**le vin rouge** — the colour second.) Which Latin word for white did French drop, and where did it end up? (***albus*** — in **l'aube**, the dawn, and in English *album* and *albino*.) Are *rouge* and *red* borrowed from each other? (**No** — **cousins**, from one Proto-Indo-European root.)

Chapter 17

To Have, and How Old You Are

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (14) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 14 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use all six forms of avoir, and ask and answer how old someone is the way French does it — by having years rather than being them.
>
> *The verb French leans on hardest, taken one person at a time. Its three singular forms are written ai, as and a and sound the same, which is why French keeps the subject pronouns Spanish drops; its plural endings -ons and -ez survived and are unmistakable. Then the sentence the verb exists for: J'ai vingt ans, "I have twenty years". Never "to be", and ans cannot be dropped — and every Romance language on the continent agrees while every Germanic one does not.*

17.1 j'ai — I have

The verb French leans on hardest starts here, with the form you will say most — and it is one sound long.

Sounds you'll need

- `elision` — it is **j'ai**, never *je ai*. Before a vowel **je** drops its **e**, the same move that turns *le eau* into **l'eau**.
- The **ai** is a single vowel, close to English *eh*.
- Together: **j'ai** = *zhay*. One syllable, and the whole of "I have."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

j'ai is Latin **habeō**, "I have."
Say those two aloud: *ha-be-o*, then *zhay*. Three syllables become one, and not one consonant of the Latin survives into the vowel.
French does this harder than any of its sisters. Italian kept **ho**, Spanish kept **he** — both still a whole syllable with a consonant. French kept a vowel. It is the same appetite that ground *aqua* down to **eau**, and you will see it again every time a very common word looks like nothing.
The rule of thumb is worth having now: **the more often a word is said, the more of it wears away.** That is why the most useful words in a language are usually its least recognisable ones.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai" — *zhay*, one syllable
- the erosion — "habeō, ho, he, j'ai"
- a whole sentence — "J'ai un frère"

Before you move on

How do you say "I have"? (**j'ai**, *zhay*.) Why is it not *je ai*? (**Elision** — *je* drops its **e** before a vowel.) What Latin word is it from? (***habeō***.) What do Italian and Spanish still keep that French does not? (A whole **syllable** — *ho*, *he*.) Next: the same verb, said to one person.

17.2 tu as — you have

The second form of the verb, and the first sign that this paradigm is easier to say than it looks to read.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the **s** of **as** is **not pronounced**.
- **tu as** = *tü ah*. The **u** of *tu* is the tight front-rounded vowel; the **as** is a bare open *ah*.

- Say **j'ai** and **tu as** back to back and notice how little work the verb is doing in either.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

as is the **tu** form — the one you use with a friend, a child, or anyone you would call by their first name. It is the same *tu* you met when you learned which "you" to pick.
The written **s** is a signal to the eye and nothing to the ear. That is the normal state of affairs in French verbs: the endings are alive on the page and almost dead in the mouth. It is why the pronoun is not optional — *as* on its own would tell a listener nothing about who has something.
Keep that in mind as the paradigm fills in. You are learning six written forms and rather fewer sounds.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu as" — *tü ah*, the *s* silent
- the pair — "j'ai, tu as"
- with a noun — "Tu as un frère"

Before you move on

How do you say "you have" to a friend? (**tu as**, *tü ah*.) Is the **s** pronounced? (**No.**) Why can you not drop the pronoun? (The verb form alone **does not say who** — the pronoun carries it.) Next: he and she.

17.3 il a, elle a — he has, she has

The third form, and the shortest verb you will ever meet: one letter.

Sounds you'll need

- **a** is a bare open *ah* — the same sound as **tu as**, with nothing written after it.
- **il a** = *eel ah*. **elle a** = *el ah*.
- All three singular forms are now in your mouth, and the next lesson is about what they have in common.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

a is the form for **il** (he) and **elle** (she), and it is a single letter carrying an entire verb.
You already know the two pronouns from the articles: **le** and **la** split the world into masculine and feminine, and **il** and **elle** do the same for people. French has no separate word for *it* — a table is *elle*, a book is *il*, because the noun's gender decides.
One thing to notice for later. When French turns this into a question by putting the verb first, two vowels would collide — *a il ?* — so a **t** is pushed in between them: **a-t-il ?**, "has he?" That **t** means nothing at all. It is there purely so the mouth has something to land on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il a, elle a" — *eel ah, el ah*
- the three singulars — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the question shape — "a-t-il ?"; the *t* is only there for the mouth

Before you move on

How do you say "he has"? (**il a**.) And "she has"? (**elle a**.) How many letters is the verb? (**One.**) What is the **t** doing in *a-t-il ?* (**Nothing** — it keeps two vowels from colliding.) Next: why those three forms are harder to hear than to read.

17.4 ai · as · a — three spellings, one ear

You have the three singular forms. Say them one after another and listen to how much difference there actually is.

Grammar Lens: the endings are for the eye

Written, the three singular forms are **ai**, **as**, **a** — three different words. Spoken, **as** and **a** are the same bare *ah*, and **ai** is a single vowel too. The written endings differ; your ear has almost nothing to work with. This is not a quirk of *avoir*. It is the central fact about French verbs, and it has one large consequence: **the pronoun is compulsory.** Spanish can say *tengo* and drop the *yo*, because *-o* means "I" out loud. French cannot drop the *je*, because the ending that would have carried it went silent centuries ago. So French kept the pronoun and Spanish did not, and the two languages ended up in different places for the same reason: **what the ear can still hear decides what the sentence must carry.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three verb forms bare — "ai, as, a"; hear how close they are
- them with their pronouns — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the consequence — "the pronoun does the work the ending stopped doing"

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a"

Before you move on

Write it: the three singular forms (**ai**, **as**, **a**.) How many distinct sounds are there? (Effectively **one** — a bare vowel.) Why can French not drop its subject pronouns the way Spanish can? (Because the **endings are silent** — the pronoun is the only thing left that says **who**.) Next: the plural, where the endings come back to life.

17.5 nous avons — we have

Three forms that sound alike, and then this: an ending you can actually hear.

Sounds you'll need

- **nous avons** = *noo-za-VO(N)*. The **s** of *nous* wakes up and buzzes into the vowel — that is the liaison you already know.
- `nasal-on` — the **-ons** ending is a nasal vowel; the **n** is the nose, not a consonant.
- Weight on the last syllable, as almost always in French.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avons is Latin **habēmus**, "we have."
Here the paradigm turns around. The three singular endings wore away to nothing; **-ons** did not. It is a full syllable, it is unmistakable, and it belongs to **nous** and nothing else.
That pattern holds across French verbs: **-ons** for *nous*, **-ez** for *vous*. Once you have those two you can hear the plural coming in any verb in the language, regular or not. *avoir* is one of the most irregular verbs French has, and it still obeys this.
So the difficulty is not spread evenly. The singular is a listening problem and the plural is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nous avons" — *noo-za-VO(N)*, the *s* buzzing across
- the contrast — "il a" then "nous avons"; one is a vowel, one is a syllable
- the ending alone — "-ons is always nous"

Before you move on

How do you say "we have"? (**nous avons**, *noo-za-VO(N).*) Which ending marks *nous*? (**-ons**.) Why is this form easier to hear than *il a*? (The **plural endings survived** where the singular ones went silent.) Next: the other you.

17.6 vous avez — you have

The second plural ending, and a form you will use with strangers far more often than with crowds.

Sounds you'll need

- **vous avez** = *voo-za-VAY*. The same buzzing liaison as *nous avons*.
- `vowel-e-acute` — the **-ez** is the bright, narrow *ay* of **février**. The **z** is silent.
- Say **nous avons, vous avez** together: *-ons*, *-ez*, the two plural endings of nearly every French verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avez is Latin **habētis**, and it goes with **vous**.
vous is two things at once. It is the plural "you" — several people. And it is the polite "you" for **one** person, which is the use you will need first and most: a shopkeeper, a stranger, anyone you have not been invited to call *tu*.
So *vous avez* is what you say to one person you are being careful with. Getting this wrong is one of the few grammar mistakes in French that a listener hears as a mistake about **them** rather than about the language, which is why *tu* and *vous* is worth more attention than most endings.
The verb form does not change between the two meanings. Only who you are looking at does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vous avez" — *voo-za-VAY*
- the two plural endings — "nous avons, vous avez"
- the two jobs — "vous to a group, vous to one stranger"

Before you move on

How do you say "you have" politely? (**vous avez**, *voo-za-VAY*.) What are the two jobs *vous* does? (**Plural you**, and **polite you** to one person.) Which ending marks *vous*? (**-ez**.) Next: the last form, and the odd one.

17.7 ils ont, elles ont — they have

The sixth and last form, and the one that does not resemble the other five.

Sounds you'll need

- **ils ont** = *eel-ZO(N)*. The **s** of *ils* buzzes across into the vowel.
- `nasal-on` — **ont** is one nasal vowel; the **n** and **t** are both silent.
- **elles ont** = *el-ZO(N)*, identical but for the first vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ont is Latin **habent**, and it is the odd one out: every other form of *avoir* has an **a** in it, and this one does not.

There is a trap here worth meeting before you fall into it. **ils ont** is "they have." In two chapters you will meet "they **are**," one consonant away from it and just as common. The way to keep them apart is the liaison: *ils* ***ont*** buzzes — *eel-**z**-o(n)* — and the "are" form hisses. The buzz means *have*.

That is the whole paradigm. Six forms, and you now have all of them: **j'ai · tu as · il a · nous avons · vous avez · ils ont**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ils ont" — *eel-ZO(N)*, the buzz

- "elles ont" — *el-ZO(N)*, the same buzz; the buzz means have
- all six in order

Before you move on

How do you say "they have"? (**ils ont**, *eel-ZO(N)*.) What tells your ear that it means *have*? (The **buzz** — *ils ont* links with a **z**; the "they are" form you meet later hisses.) What is unusual about *ont* among the six forms? (It is the only one with **no a** in it.) Next: where the whole verb came from.

17.8 habēre — the root you already met

You have all six forms of *avoir*. You have also, without being told, already learned its root — in a different verb, several chapters ago.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avoir is Latin **habēre**, "to have."
Now recall **habiter**, "to live somewhere." That is Latin **habitāre** — and *habitāre* is just *habēre* run through a pattern that means "keep doing it." To *habitāre* a place is to **keep having** it.
So *avoir* and *habiter* are the same verb twice: one wore down to a vowel, the other kept the *h*, the *b* and the *t* because it was said far less often. The two French verbs sitting at opposite ends of the same root are a compact demonstration of the rule you met with *j'ai*: frequency is what erodes a word.
English borrowed the Latin whole and shows the root undisguised every time:

- **habit** — what you *have* regularly
- **inhabit** — to *have* a place; the exact twin of *habiter*
- **exhibit** — to *hold* out
- **prohibit** — to *hold* back

Four English words, one French verb you use constantly, and one French verb you met learning to say where you live — all the same handful of Latin letters.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the root — "habēre"
- the two French verbs — "avoir, habiter"
- the English four — "habit, inhabit, exhibit, prohibit"
- the twins — "habiter, inhabit"

Before you move on

What Latin verb is *avoir* from? (***habēre***.) Which other French verb you already know comes from it? (***habiter*** — from *habitāre*, "to keep having a place".) Which English word is *habiter*'s exact twin? (**inhabit**.) Why did *avoir* wear down so much further than *habiter*? (It is said **far more often** — frequency erodes a word.) Next: all six forms, together.

17.9 Practice — the whole of avoir

Six forms, learned one at a time. This is the first time they stand together — and a paradigm you have already built is a recap, not a wall.

Your turn: the six in order

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"
- the singulars alone — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the plurals alone — "nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Your turn: the two halves sound different

Say these aloud:

- the three that blur — "ai, as, a"
- the two that do not — "-ons, -ez"
- "ils ont" with its liaison — *eel-z-o(n)*; the buzz means have

Your turn: use it

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai un frère"
- "Tu as une sœur"
- "Nous avons du pain"
- the root — "avoir, habiter, inhabit"

What you've built so far

- **six forms** of the verb French leans on hardest, one lesson each.
- **a listening fact** — the singular endings are silent, so French keeps its subject pronouns where Spanish drops them.
- **a root that pays twice** — *habēre* gave French *avoir* and *habiter*, and English *habit*, *inhabit*, *exhibit*, *prohibit*.

Before you move on

Give all six forms without stopping. Which three sound effectively the same? (**ai, as, a**.) Which two endings can you always hear? (**-ons** and **-ez**.) What do you hear in *ils ont* that marks it as *have*? (The **buzz** — *ont* takes a liaison **z**.) What Latin verb is behind all of it? (***habēre***.)

17.10 un an — a year

One small word, and it unlocks the single most common question anyone will ask you in a new language.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-an` — **an** is a **nasal vowel**, the same one in **blanc** and **janvier**. The **n** is the nose, not a consonant.
- `silent-final` — the plural **ans** adds a written **s** and no sound at all.
- **un an** = *a(n)-NA(N)*: the **n** of *un* links across into the vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

an is Latin **annus**, "year," and English kept it whole in a whole shelf of words:

- **annual** — happening each year
- **anniversary** — literally the year **turning** (*annus* + *vertere*, "to turn")
- **annals** — a record kept year by year
- ***per annum*** — English never even translated this one

You have met *annus*'s neighbours already: the months came out of the same Roman calendar, and *janvier* stands at the door of exactly this word.
French also has a second word for year, **année**, and the difference is real but small: *an* counts years, *année* describes them as a stretch of time. For counting — which is what the next lesson does — you want **an**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un an" — *a(n)-NA(N)*, both vowels through the nose
- the plural — "deux ans, dix ans"; the *s* is silent
- the English family — "annual, anniversary, annals"

Before you move on

How do you say "a year"? (**un an**.) What Latin word is it? (***annus***.) Does the plural **ans** sound different from **an**? (**No** — the **s** is silent.) What does *anniversary* literally say? (The **year turning**.) Next: what French does with *avoir* and *ans* together.

17.11 j'ai vingt ans — having your years

Here is the first thing French lets you say that English cannot say the same way at all.

Grammar Lens: age is something you have

English **is** its age: you *are* twenty. French **has** it:

J'ai vingt ans. — literally, "I *have* twenty years."

Two things follow, and both are absolute.
The verb is *avoir*, never "to be." Building it with French's "to be" is not a stylistic choice; it is simply wrong, and it is the single most common thing an English speaker gets wrong in their first month.
And *ans* cannot be dropped. English says "I'm twenty" with no noun at all. French must name the years: *J'ai vingt* on its own means nothing.
One sound to get right. **vingt** normally ends in silence — you learned it as *VA(N)*, with the **g** and **t** both dead. Put **ans** after it and the **t wakes up**: *vin-**t**-a(n)*. That is liaison, doing what it always does — reviving a buried consonant when a vowel follows it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai vingt ans" — with the liaison, *vin-t-a(n)*
- the rule — "avoir, never 'to be'"
- the buried t waking — "vingt" alone, then "vingt ans"
- your own age, with the numbers you have

Twice through: "J'ai vingt ans"

Before you move on

How does French say "I'm twenty"? (**J'ai vingt ans** — "I *have* twenty years".) Which verb, and which is wrong? (***avoir***; "to be" is wrong.) Can you drop *ans* the way English drops "years"? (**No.**) What happens to the **t** of *vingt* before *ans*? (It **wakes up** — *vin-t-a(n)*, a liaison.) Next: how to ask.

17.12 Quel âge as-tu ? — asking someone's age

You can answer the question. Now you can ask it — and this is a phrase worth taking whole rather than building.

Sounds you'll need

- **Quel âge as-tu ?** = *kel AHZH ah-tü.*
- `circumflex` — the hat on **â** is the gravestone you met on **août**: it marks a lost **s**. Older French wrote *aage*, and before that Latin had *aetāticum.*
- The **g** of *âge* is the soft *zh* of **rouge**.
- The polite form is **Quel âge avez-vous ?** — *kel AHZH ah-vay-VOO.*

The exchange

Take it as one unit, the way you took *Comment vous appelez-vous ?*

— **Quel âge as-tu ?** — "What age do you *have*?"

— **J'ai vingt ans.** — "I *have* twenty years."

Notice the question uses **avoir** as well. The whole exchange is built on having, on both sides — which is what makes it a pair worth memorising together rather than two separate facts.

And **âge** is a word you already own in English. *Age* came into English from French, hat and all, having lost its *s* on the way: Latin *aetāticum* → *aage* → **âge** → English **age**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Quel âge as-tu ?" — *kel AHZH ah-tü*
- the polite one — "Quel âge avez-vous ?"
- both halves — "Quel âge as-tu ? J'ai vingt ans."
- the hat's meaning — "â marks a lost s, like août"

Twice through: "Quel âge as-tu ? J'ai vingt ans."

Before you move on

How do you ask a friend their age? (**Quel âge as-tu ?**) And a stranger? (**Quel âge avez-vous ?**) Which verb does the **question** use? (***avoir*** — the same as the answer.) What does the circumflex on **â** mark? (A **lost s**.) Next: who else in Europe does it this way.

17.13 "having" your years — who else does it

French is not being strange here. It is on one side of a line that runs straight across Europe, and the line is exactly where you would draw it.

Why it's said this way

Ask the same question in six languages and count the verbs.

language	**"I am 20"**	**verb**
French	*j'ai vingt ans*	have
Spanish	*tengo veinte años*	have
Italian	*ho venti anni*	have
Portuguese	*tenho vinte anos*	have
German	*ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt*	be
English	*I am twenty*	be

A clean split, and not a coincidental one: every **Romance** language on that list *has* its years, and every **Germanic** one *is* them.
French treats age as something you **carry**: a count of years in your

possession, which grows. English treats it as something you **are**, a property like tall or tired.
Neither is more logical. What matters is that the choice is inherited rather than reasoned: French did not decide this, it received it, along with the rest of what Latin left behind. And it means the mistake you are most likely to make — *je suis vingt ans* — is you importing your own family's habit into another one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

j'ai vingt ans — *ai* ← Latin *habeo*, "I have"; *vingt* ← Latin *viginti*; *an* ← Latin *annus*, "year". All three are inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four that have — "j'ai, tengo, ho, tenho"
- the two that are — "ich bin, I am"
- the line — "Romance has its years; Germanic is its years"
- the French one again, correctly — "J'ai vingt ans"

Before you move on

Which language family uses **have** for age? (**Romance** — French, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese.) Which uses **be**? (**Germanic** — German, English.) Is either one more logical? (**No** — the choice is **inherited**, not reasoned.) Which error does that make an English speaker likely to commit? (***Je suis vingt ans*** — importing English's *be*.) Next: all of it together.

17.14 Practice — to have, and how old you are

A verb and a sentence. Run the verb first, then use it for the thing it will earn its keep on.

Your turn: the paradigm, cold

Say these aloud:

- all six — "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"
- backwards — "ils ont, vous avez, nous avons, il a, tu as, j'ai"
- "ils ont" — the liaison buzz that means *have*

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Your turn: the exchange

Say these aloud:

- "Quel âge as-tu ?"
- "J'ai vingt ans" — with the liaison, *vin-t-a(n)*
- the polite pair — "Quel âge avez-vous ?"
- your own age

Your turn: use the verb on what you own

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai un frère, j'ai une sœur"
- "Nous avons du pain et du vin"
- the root pair — "avoir, habiter"

What you've built this chapter

- **the whole of *avoir***, six forms, one lesson each, and a paradigm you built rather than one you were handed.
- **why French keeps its pronouns** — the singular endings went silent, so *je*, *tu* and *il* carry what the verb stopped saying.
- **age is something you have** — *J'ai vingt ans*, never "I am," and *ans* is compulsory. Every Romance language on the continent agrees with French, and every Germanic one disagrees.

- **one root, two verbs, four English words** — *habēre* gave *avoir* and *habiter*, plus *habit*, *inhabit*, *exhibit*, *prohibit*.

Before you move on

Give the six forms of *avoir*. Ask a friend their age. (**Quel âge as-tu ?**) Answer with your own. Which verb must you never use for age? (The verb **"to be"**.) Can *ans* be left out? (**No.**) Which other French verb shares *avoir*'s root? (***habiter***.) What marks *ils ont* as *have*? (The **buzz** of its liaison.)

Chapter 18

The Compound Past

Modes: **voice** (12) **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build and use French's everyday past tense, and recognise the second past tense that only appears in writing.
>
> *French's everyday past is avoir plus a participle that never moves, so it costs one new form rather than six. It exists because habeō litterās scriptās once meant plain possession — 'I have letters, written ones' — and hardened into a tense, which is also why a participle still agrees when its object comes first. Then the other past: il parla, which you read in every novel and never hear. It is the same inherited tense Spanish says every day as habló, and it retreated into writing across a connected block of France, southern Germany and northern Italy while the languages at the western edge kept theirs.*

18.1 parlé — the past participle

Before French can talk about the past it needs one new form of the verb, and for the verbs you already have it is the smallest change imaginable.

Grammar Lens: -er becomes -é

Take an **-er** verb and put an accent where the **r** was:

> **parler** → **parlé** · **habiter** → **habité** · **travailler** → **travaillé**

That form is the **past participle**. On its own it is not a tense and not

even really a verb — it is closer to an adjective, and *parlé* means something like "spoken," the way *written* or *broken* work in English. That is worth holding on to, because it explains everything this chapter does next. You are not learning a past tense yet. You are learning a **part**, and the tense gets built out of it in the next lesson. All three of your **-er** verbs behave identically. There is no list to learn and no exception in this class at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the swap — "parler, parlé"
- the other two — "habiter, habité; travailler, travaillé"
- what it is — "spoken, lived, worked: adjectives, not tenses"

Before you move on

What is the past participle of *parler*? (**parlé**.) What changes? (The **-er** becomes **-é**.) Is *parlé* a past tense on its own? (**No** — it is closer to an **adjective**, "spoken.") Give the participles of *habiter* and *travailler*. (**habité**, **travaillé**.) Next: what to build with it.

18.2 j'ai parlé — the past built from "have"

You have both halves of French's everyday past tense already. This lesson only puts them next to each other.

Grammar Lens: avoir, then the participle

The recipe is two words:

avoir (conjugated) + **past participle**

So, with *parlé*:

- **j'ai parlé** — I spoke, I have spoken
- **tu as parlé** — you spoke

- **il a parlé** — he spoke
- **nous avons parlé** — we spoke
- **ils ont parlé** — they spoke

Only *avoir* changes. The participle sits there, identical in every line. So this is not six new forms — it is the verb you spent last chapter on, with one unchanging word after it.
Notice too that French makes no distinction English insists on. *J'ai parlé* is both "I spoke" and "I have spoken"; there is no separate form for the two. Where English has two past tenses to choose between, French conversation mostly has this one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the recipe — "avoir, then the participle"
- the run — "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, ils ont parlé"
- another verb — "j'ai travaillé, j'ai habité"
- the two English meanings — "I spoke, I have spoken; French has one form"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé"

Before you move on

What are the two parts of the compound past? (***avoir* conjugated**, then the **past participle**.) Which part changes with the person? (**Only *avoir*.**) Say "we worked." (**Nous avons travaillé**.) How many English tenses does *j'ai parlé* cover? (**Two** — "I spoke" and "I have spoken".) Next: a spelling trap you cannot hear.

18.3 parler · parlé · parlez — one sound, three jobs

Say the infinitive, the participle and the *vous* form out loud, one after the other. Now try to hear a difference.

Grammar Lens: your ear gets no help at all

parler, **parlé** and **parlez** are pronounced **exactly the same**: *par-LAY*.
Three different jobs, three different spellings, one sound:

- **parler** — to speak (the infinitive)
- **parlé** — spoken (the participle)
- **parlez** — you speak (the *vous* form)

This is the same phenomenon you met with *ai*, *as* and *a*, and it has the same cause: French endings survive on the page and die in the mouth. But it lands harder here, because these three are **different parts of speech**, and only the sentence around them says which one you heard. The good news is that the sentence always does. *Vous parlez* has a pronoun in front of it. *J'ai parlé* has *avoir* in front of it. **Parler** has nothing in front of it, or another verb, the way English *speak* follows *want to*. In practice you never have to decide — which is why French speakers are untroubled by a distinction that looks impossible written down.
For **writing**, though, you do have to choose, and choosing wrongly is the single most common spelling mistake native French speakers make.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "parler, parlé, parlez"; one sound
- each in its frame — "vous parlez", "j'ai parlé"
- the rule of thumb — "what comes before it tells you which"

Before you move on

How many of *parler*, *parlé* and *parlez* sound different? (**None** — all three are *par-LAY*.) What tells you which one you are hearing? (**What comes before it** — a pronoun, *avoir*, or nothing.) Which is the participle? (**parlé**.) Next: the verbs that do not end in *-er*.

18.4 fini · vendu — the other two classes

Every verb you have met so far ends in **-er**. That is by far the biggest group, and it is not the only one.

Grammar Lens: three classes, three vowels

French verbs are sorted by how the infinitive ends, and each group makes its participle with its own vowel:

infinitive ends in	participle ends in	example
-er	**-é**	*parler* → *parlé*
-ir	**-i**	*fini*, "finished"
-re	**-u**	*vendu*, "sold"

fini and *vendu* are the standard examples, and they are here as **examples of the pattern** rather than words to add to your vocabulary — neither verb has had a lesson of its own in this book yet. What you want from this lesson is the shape: when you meet a verb, its infinitive ending already tells you what its participle will look like. That is three facts, not three hundred. And **-er** is the group that matters most in practice: it holds the overwhelming majority of French verbs, and it is the only group still taking new members — every verb French invents or borrows becomes an *-er* verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three endings — "é, i, u"
- the three participles — "parlé, fini, vendu"
- the useful half — "-er is the big one, and the only one still growing"

Before you move on

What vowel ends the participle of an **-ir** verb? (**-i**.) And an **-re** verb? (**-u**.) And **-er**? (**-é**.) Which class is by far the largest? (**-er** — and it is the only one that still takes new verbs.) Next: where those three endings came from.

18.5 -ātum · -ītum · -ūtum — where the endings came from

Three participle vowels, and two of them are inherited. The third is French tidying up after itself, which is a different kind of fact.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin marked its participles with a **-t-** and a vowel in front of it:

- **parlé** ← *-ātum*
- **fini** ← *-ītum*
- **vendu** ← *-ūtum*

French wore away the **-t-** and the ending, and kept the vowel. English, which borrowed from Latin rather than inheriting it, kept the **-t-** instead — you can see it whole in **fini*te***, **acu*te***, **statu*te***. Same suffix, two salvage strategies: French saved the vowel, English saved the consonant.

Now the third one, which is the interesting one. ***-ūtus* was rare in Latin.** It turns up in a handful of words — *minūtus* (small, hence *minute*), *tribūtus* (assigned, hence *tribute*) — and nothing like a whole class.

French and Italian took that small, scrappy group and **spread it across an entire conjugation**. So *-é* and *-i* are straight inheritance, and *-u* is largely the language **tidying up by analogy**: a pattern noticed in a few words and then applied on purpose to many.

That is worth separating from ordinary etymology. Most of what this book shows you is erosion — words wearing down. This is the opposite force: speakers **regularising**, making a language tidier than they received it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three Latin endings — "-ātum, -ītum, -ūtum"
- what English kept — "finite, acute, statute"; the *t* survived
- the odd one — "-ūtus was rare, and French spread it"
- the two forces — "erosion wears words down; analogy tidies them up"

Before you move on

What did French keep from the Latin participle ending, and what did English keep? (French kept the **vowel**; English kept the **-t-**, as in *finite*, *acute*, *statute*.) Which of the three French endings is **not** straight inheritance? (**-u** — *-ūtus* was **rare** in Latin and French spread it over a whole class.) What is that process called? (**Analogy** — speakers regularising.) Next: why this tense exists at all.

18.6 habeō litterās scriptās — the buried possessive

There is an obvious question about this tense that is worth asking: why *have*? What does owning something have to do with the past?

Grammar Lens: it was never a tense to begin with

Latin could say:

habeō litterās scriptās — "I *have* letters, written ones."

Read that as Latin, not as French. It is **not** a past tense. It is *habēre* in its plain, ordinary sense — **I possess some letters** — with *scriptās* as an **adjective** describing them, agreeing with *litterās* in gender and number the way any Latin adjective would.
The sentence says nothing about who did the writing, and nothing about when. It says: I own letters, and their condition is *written*. Then centuries pass. The phrase gets said constantly, the possession fades out of it, and what is left is the doing: *I wrote*. A construction

about **owning** an object hardened into a construction about **having done** an action.
This happens to be one of the best-documented examples of the whole process, and you can watch it happen in the surviving texts. It is also why English "I have written" exists — English built the same thing, from the same starting point, independently.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the Latin — "habeō litterās scriptās"
- what it meant — "I have letters, written ones"
- what it became — "I wrote"
- the shift in one line — "possession hardened into a tense"

Before you move on

What did *habeō litterās scriptās* originally mean? ("**I have letters, written ones**" — plain possession.) What part of speech was *scriptās*? (An **adjective**, describing the letters.) What did the phrase turn into? (A **past tense** — "I wrote".) Why does French build its past out of *have*? (Because the construction **began** as one about **having**.) Next: the fossil that construction left behind.

18.7 les lettres que j'ai écrites — the fossil

The possessive is gone from the meaning. It is not gone from the spelling, and the place it survives is one of the strangest rules in French.

Grammar Lens: the participle still agrees, when the object goes first

Normally the participle never changes:

J'ai écrit les lettres. — "I wrote the letters." *écrit*, plain.

Move the object in front of the verb, though, and the participle **agrees**

with it — feminine, plural, exactly as an adjective would:

> **Les lettres que j'ai écrites.** — "The letters that I wrote." *écrit**es**.*

That **-es** is the two-thousand-year-old adjective ending from *habeō litterās scriptās*, still doing the job it was doing in Latin. The meaning moved on; the agreement stayed behind.
Two things make this bearable. First, you can almost never **hear** it — *écrit* and *écrites* sound the same, so it is a writing rule far more than a speaking one. Second, it now has an explanation instead of being arbitrary: the participle agrees when the thing it describes comes **before** it, which is where an adjective could still see it.
French schoolchildren spend years on this rule and are taught it as a list of conditions. It is really one fact with a very long memory.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the plain order — "J'ai écrit les lettres"
- the object first — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- what the *-es* is — "an adjective ending, two thousand years old"
- the consolation — "you cannot hear it"

Before you move on

When does the past participle agree with the object? (When the object comes **before** the verb.) Why does it agree at all? (Because it was an **adjective** first, describing the thing that was possessed.) Can you hear the agreement in *écrites*? (**No** — it is a writing rule.) Next: all of it, together.

18.8 Practice — the past you actually say

> One tense, built from two things you already had. Run it, then take it apart again.

Your turn: build it

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, vous avez parlé, ils ont parlé"
- with your other verbs — "j'ai travaillé, nous avons habité"
- what moves and what does not — "avoir changes; the participle never does"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé"

Your turn: the three endings

Say these aloud:

- "é, i, u"
- the participles — "parlé, fini, vendu"
- the Latin — "-ātum, -ītum, -ūtum"; and English "finite, acute, statute"

Your turn: the sound trap and the fossil

Say these aloud:

- the three that sound alike — "parler, parlé, parlez"
- the old meaning — "I have letters, written ones"
- the fossil — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"

What you've built so far

- **a past tense**, made of a verb you already knew and one unchanging word.
- **three participle endings**, one per verb class, two inherited and one spread by analogy.
- **an explanation for the *have***: the construction began as plain possession — *I have letters, written ones* — and hardened into a

tense.

- **a fossil you can point at**: the agreement in *écrites* is an adjective ending that has outlived the grammar that required it.

Before you move on

Say "we spoke." (**Nous avons parlé**.) Which half changes with the person? (***avoir***.) Give the three participle vowels. (**-é, -i, -u**.) Which three forms of *parler* sound identical? (***parler, parlé, parlez***.) When does the participle agree? (When the **object comes first**.) Next: the other past tense — the one you will read and never say.

18.9 il parla — the past you read but never say

French has a **second** past tense. You will meet it on the first page of almost any novel and never once hear it in a conversation.

Grammar Lens: recognise it, do not produce it

It is called the **passé simple**, and it is one word where the compound past is two:

meaning	**passé simple**	**passé composé**
he spoke	*il parla*	*il a parlé*
they spoke	*ils parlèrent*	*ils ont parlé*
he had	*il eut*	*il a eu*

You do **not** need to produce these, and you should not try. Nobody says them. Using one out loud sounds roughly like announcing "thus spake he" in an English pub.

What you need is to **recognise** them, because they carry the past tense of essentially all French literature. A reader who stalls at *il parla* stalls on page one of everything.

So this is the first thing in this book that is deliberately **half**-learned, and that is a real distinction worth making: some things you learn to say, and some you learn only to understand. Treating those as the same job is what makes beginners feel they must master everything before reading anything.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "il parla … il a parlé"; same meaning, two registers
- the plural pair — "ils parlèrent … ils ont parlé"
- where you meet it — "in a novel, not a conversation"

Before you move on

What is *il parla*? (The **passé simple** — "he spoke".) Where will you meet it? (In **writing**, especially novels — never in speech.) Do you need to produce it? (**No** — recognition only.) What is the everyday equivalent? (***il a parlé***.) Next: who else kept this tense alive.

18.10 il parla · habló · falou — the same tense, four fates

The tense French retired to its libraries is a tense other people use to order coffee.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il parla comes from the plain Latin perfect, handed straight down with no rebuilding at all. Which means it is the **same tense** as these:

language	"he spoke"	status
French	*il parla*	books only
Spanish	*habló*	everyday speech
Portuguese	*falou*	everyday speech
Italian	*parlò*	regional

One Latin ancestor, four different fates. A Spaniard saying *habló* and a French novelist writing *il parla* are using the **same inherited form**, and only one of them sounds archaic doing it.

That is worth sitting with, because it undoes an assumption. A tense is not formal or informal, literary or everyday, by its nature. **Register is not a property of a form; it is a property of what a particular community of speakers happens to have kept.**

French did not decide *il parla* was fancy. It just stopped saying it, and the books did not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the sisters — "il parla, habló, falou, parlò"
- the split — "one of them is literary; the others are lunch"
- the finding — "register is not in the form, it is in the speakers"

Before you move on

What Latin tense is *il parla*? (The plain **perfect**, inherited directly.) Which languages still say it every day? (**Spanish** — *habló* — and **Portuguese** — *falou*.) So what makes a tense "literary"? (**Not the form** — what its speakers kept using.) Next: what pushed it out, and where else that happened.

18.11 the same retreat, three times over

French pushed its old past tense into books and replaced it with a compound built on *have*. It is not the only language that did.

Why it's said this way

language	the simple past	what replaced it in speech
French	*passé simple*	*passé composé* — *j'ai parlé*
German	*Präteritum*	*Perfekt* — *ich habe gesagt*
Italian	*passato remoto*	*passato prossimo* — *ho parlato*

Three languages, two Romance and one **Germanic**, each built a compound past out of "have," and each let that compound push the inherited simple past out of conversation and into writing.
The obvious reading is that this is a natural drift any language might

undergo. The better reading is geographical. **France, southern Germany and northern Italy form one connected block**, and the change spread through it by **contact**, over the same few centuries — carried by people who lived near each other, across language boundaries that were never barriers to anything.
Linguists call that an **areal** change: one that travels by neighbourhood rather than by descent. And the evidence is at the edges. **Spanish and Portuguese**, out at the western rim, largely **did not get it** — they kept their simple past in everyday speech, which is why *habló* is still ordinary. Though Spain's Spanish has begun drifting the same way, with *he hablado* taking ground: the change reaching the edge, late.
So the map explains what the family tree cannot. Italian and Spanish are close relatives that behave differently here, and French and German are distant relatives that behave the same — because what mattered was who was standing next to whom.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passé simple — *passé*, "passed", goes back to Latin *passus*, "a step"; *simple* ← Latin *simplex*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three retreats — "passé simple, Präteritum, passato remoto"
- the three replacements — "j'ai parlé, ich habe gesagt, ho parlato"
- the shape — "a connected block: France, southern Germany, northern Italy"
- the edge — "Spanish and Portuguese kept theirs"

Before you move on

Which three languages made the same swap? (**French**, **German**, **Italian**.) Was it three separate inventions? (**No** — one change spreading by **contact** across a connected block.) What is that kind of change called? (**Areal**.) Which languages at the edge kept their simple past? (**Spanish** and **Portuguese**.) Next: everything

together.

18.12 Practice — two pasts, and why

One tense to say and one to recognise. Run both, and keep the jobs separate.

Your turn: the one you say

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, vous avez parlé, ils ont parlé"
- "j'ai travaillé, nous avons habité"
- the three endings — "é, i, u"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, nous avons travaillé"

Your turn: the one you read

Say these aloud:

- the pairs — "il parla … il a parlé"; "ils parlèrent … ils ont parlé"
- the sisters — "il parla, habló, falou, parlò"
- the job — "recognise it; do not say it"

Your turn: the two histories

Say these aloud:

- where the tense came from — "I have letters, written ones"
- the fossil — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- the three retreats — "passé simple, Präteritum, passato remoto"

What you've built this chapter

- **the past tense you will actually use**, built from *avoir* and a participle that never moves.
- **three participle endings**, and the fact that one of them was spread by analogy rather than inherited.
- **an origin**: the tense began as plain possession and hardened, which is why it uses *have* at all — and why a participle still agrees when its object comes first.
- **a second past you only read**, and the reason it is only read: not because the form is fancy, but because a block of neighbouring languages stopped saying theirs at roughly the same time, and the ones at the edge did not.

Before you move on

Say "they worked." (**Ils ont travaillé**.) Which part of the compound past changes? (***avoir***.) Which three forms of *parler* are homophones? (***parler, parlé, parlez***.) What is *il parla*, and what do you do with it? (The **passé simple** — **recognise** it, never say it.) Why does the participle agree in *les lettres que j'ai écrites*? (It was an **adjective** first, and the object comes **before** it.)

Chapter 19

To Be, and the Three Verbs Inside It

Modes: **voice** (12) **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use all six forms of être, and explain why it has no pattern to find.
>
> *The most irregular verb in French, and the irregularity turns out to have a shape. There is no pattern in être because être is THREE verbs: es- from esse for the present and infinitive, fu- from fuī for the passé simple — the same root as English be — and ét- from stāre, 'to stand', which supplied a whole limb of participles and the imperfect. The patching is called suppletion, and English does it too, with go and went. Spanish inherited the same two Latin verbs and made the opposite choice: it kept ser and estar apart and made you pick.*

19.1 je suis — I am

The partner of *avoir*, and the most irregular verb in French. That irregularity is not carelessness; it is age.

Sounds you'll need

- **je suis** = *zhuh SWEE*. The **s** at the end is silent.
- The **ui** is a single glide: start at the tight **u** of *tu* and slide straight into *ee*.
- Do not hear an English *swiss*; there is no *s* at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suis is Latin **sum**, "I am."
Before you go looking for a pattern in this verb: **there is not one.** *être* is the most irregular verb in French, and it is irregular for the same reason English *be / am / is / was* is. These are among the **oldest word-shapes in Europe**, said millions of times a day for three thousand years, and constant use does not regularise a word — it protects it. Rare verbs get tidied up by analogy; the commonest ones are said too often for anyone to forget them, so they keep whatever shape history left them with.
So the six forms are six things to learn, and that is the honest situation. What this chapter can give you instead of a pattern is an **explanation** — because the irregularity turns out to have a shape once you know where the pieces came from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je suis" — *zhuh SWEE*, the final *s* silent
- a whole sentence — "Je suis fatigué"
- the Latin — "sum, suis"

Before you move on

How do you say "I am"? (**je suis**, *zhuh SWEE*.) Is the final **s** pronounced? (**No.**) What Latin word is it? (***sum***.) Why is this verb so irregular? (It is **very old and very common** — constant use protects a shape rather than tidying it.) Next: the same verb, to a friend.

19.2 tu es — you are

After *suis*, the shortest form in the verb — and one that is easy to swallow entirely.

Sounds you'll need

- **tu es** = *tü ay*. Two letters, one vowel sound.
- The **s** is silent, as it was in **tu as**.
- Careful: **tu es** and **tu as** differ only in that vowel — *ay* against *ah*. Say them back to back until the difference is deliberate.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

es is Latin **es**, unchanged. Latin said *es* for "you are" and French still does, which for a form this heavily used is unusual — most such words are ground down past recognition.
The pair to watch is not Latin, though. It is **tu es** against **tu as**: "you are" and "you have," one vowel apart, both extremely common, both with a silent **s**. English keeps them far apart; French does not.
That is the practical difficulty of this verb. Not the etymology — the fact that its forms are short, unstressed, and easily confused with *avoir*'s.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu es" — *tü ay*
- the pair to keep apart — "tu es, tu as"
- both verbs together — "je suis, j'ai"

Before you move on

How do you say "you are" to a friend? (**tu es**, *tü ay*.) Which other very common form does it nearly collide with? (***tu as***, "you have".) What is the difference? (Only the **vowel** — *ay* against *ah*.) What Latin word is *es*? (***es*** — unchanged.) Next: he and she.

19.3 il est, elle est — he is, she is

You have said this one already, many times, without knowing it was part of a verb.

Sounds you'll need

- **il est** = *ee-LAY*. The **s** and **t** are both silent, and the **l** of *il* runs into the vowel.
- Before a vowel the buried **t** wakes: **est-il ?** = *eh-TEEL*.
- **elle est** = *el-AY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

est is Latin **est**, also unchanged — and it is very probably the single most frequently said word-form in French.
You already own it. **il est trois heures**, "it is three o'clock," is this exact form; so is every time you have said what time it was. The clock chapter handed you a piece of *être* several chapters before the verb arrived, which is the ordinary way a language teaches itself: the commonest forms turn up inside fixed phrases long before anybody explains them.
Note also that **il** here is not "he." In *il est trois heures* it refers to nothing at all — French requires a subject even when there is nobody to be one. That is the same reason the pronoun cannot be dropped: the sentence needs the slot filled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il est, elle est"
- what you already knew — "il est trois heures"
- the three singulars — "je suis, tu es, il est"

Before you move on

How do you say "he is"? (**il est**, *ee-LAY*.) Where have you said this form before? (**Telling the time** — *il est trois heures*.) Who is *il* in that sentence? (**Nobody** — French needs the subject slot filled even when there is no subject.) Next: the plural, and a form with no French shape at all.

19.4 nous sommes — we are

Every verb you have met marks *nous* with **-ons**. Watch what this one does.

Sounds you'll need

- **nous sommes** = *noo SOM*. The **s** of *nous* buzzes across into the vowel.
- The final **-es** is silent; the word ends on the **m**.
- Compare **nous avons**, which ends in a nasal. This one does not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sommes is Latin **sumus**.
And notice what is missing. Every other verb you have met marks *nous* with **-ons**: *nous avons*, *nous parlons*. This verb does not. There is no *-ons* here at all, and no way to derive *sommes* from anything. That is the shape of this verb's irregularity: it does not bend the rules, it predates them. The **-ons** ending is a regularity French built up over centuries, and *être* was already too well-worn and too heavily used to be dragged into it.
So *sommes* is not an exception to a rule. It is a survival from before the rule existed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nous sommes" — *noo SOM*
- the missing ending — "nous avons, nous parlons, nous sommes"
- the reason — "it predates the rule, it does not break it"

Before you move on

How do you say "we are"? (**nous sommes**, *noo SOM*.) Which usual ending is missing? (**-ons**.) Why? (*être* is **older than that regularity** and was too common to be pulled into it.) What Latin word is it? (***sumus***.) Next: the form that keeps a hat.

19.5 vous êtes — you are

The politeness form, and the one that wears its history on the page.

Sounds you'll need

- **vous êtes** = *voo-ZET*. The **s** of *vous* buzzes into the vowel.
- `circumflex` — the hat on **ê** marks a **lost s**, the same gravestone you met on **août** and **âge**.
- The final **-es** is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

êtes is Latin **estis**, "you are" — and you can read the erosion straight off the page.
estis → *estes* → **êtes**. The **s** after the first vowel fell silent and then fell out of the spelling, and the circumflex was put there to mark where it had been. This is the third time you have met that hat doing exactly this job, and by now it should be a reflex: **see a circumflex, try putting an *s* back.**
Do it here and *êtes* becomes *estes*, which is visibly Latin *estis*. Do it on **août** and you get *aoust*. Do it on **âge** and you get *aage*, from *aetāticum*.
The infinitive works the same way: **être** was *estre*, from Vulgar Latin **essere*. The hat is not decoration on any of them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vous êtes" — *voo-ZET*
- put the *s* back — "êtes, estes, estis"
- the same trick on the infinitive — "être, estre"
- the two plurals — "nous sommes, vous êtes"

Before you move on

How do you say "you are" politely? (**vous êtes**, *voo-ZET*.) What does the circumflex mark? (A **lost s**.) Put it back — what do you get? (***estes***, from Latin *estis*.) And on the infinitive *être*? (***estre***.) Next: the last form, and the one you must not confuse with *avoir*.

19.6 ils sont, elles sont — they are

The sixth form, and the one you were warned about two chapters ago.

Sounds you'll need

- **ils sont** = *eel SO(N)*. The **on** is nasal; the **t** is silent.
- Here is the pair to drill: **ils sont** *hisses*, **ils ont** *buzzes*. *eel-**s**o(n)* against *eel-**z**o(n)*.
- That single consonant is the whole difference between **they are** and **they have**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sont is Latin **sunt**.
You now have both of the verbs French is built on, and their *ils* forms are one sound apart. That is worth two minutes of drilling on its own, because the two sentences it distinguishes are both things you will say constantly.
The full set, and you built every piece of it:
je suis · tu es · il est · nous sommes · vous êtes · ils sont
Six forms and no pattern — which is what the next three lessons are about, because the *reason* there is no pattern turns out to be more interesting than a pattern would have been.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ils sont" — *eel SO(N)*, hissing
- the pair — "ils sont, ils ont"; hiss for are, buzz for have

- all six — "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"

Before you move on

How do you say "they are"? (**ils sont**, *eel SO(N).*) How do you hear it against *ils ont*? (**A hiss** against a **buzz**.) Give all six forms of *être*. Is there a pattern in them? (**No** — and the next lessons explain why.) Next: where these forms actually came from.

19.7 esse — the first stem

Six forms with no pattern between them. Put them beside their Latin and something appears — not a pattern, but a **seam**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Every present form of *être* comes from Latin **esse**, "to be":

- **je suis** ← *sum* · **nous sommes** ← *sumus* · **ils sont** ← *sunt*
- and the two short ones, **tu es** ← *es*, **il est** ← *est*, arrived practically untouched

Say each pair aloud and the irregularity stops looking random. The **s-** is there every time, and the forms are **as scattered in Latin as they are in French** — *sum, es, est, sumus, estis, sunt* is not a tidy paradigm either. French did not break this verb. It **received** it broken, and Latin had received it broken too.
The infinitive comes from the same place, by a detour. Classical Latin's infinitive was *esse*, which is short and odd; Vulgar Latin rebuilt it on the ordinary pattern as ***essere**, and **essere* → *estre* → **être**.
So one stem, **es-**, accounts for the present tense and the infinitive. That is most of what you have learned so far. The rest of the verb comes from somewhere else entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pairs — "sum suis, sumus sommes, sunt sont"

- the stem — "es-, for the present and the infinitive"
- the rebuild — "esse, essere, estre, être"

Before you move on

Which Latin verb are all the present forms from? (***esse***.) Was Latin's version regular? (**No** — *sum, es, est, sumus, estis, sunt* is already scattered; French inherited the mess.) Where does the infinitive *être* come from? (Vulgar Latin ***essere**, a rebuild of *esse*.) Next: a part of the verb that is not from *esse* at all.

19.8 je fus — the second stem

The past of this verb does not begin with an **s**. That is not a sound change. It is a different verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The *passé simple* of *être* — the literary past you learned to recognise — is **je fus**, **il fut**.
There is no way to get *fus* from *suis*, and nobody has ever tried. It comes from Latin **fuī**, and *fuī* comes from Proto-Indo-European ***b^{h}uH-**, "to grow, to become."
That root went somewhere you will recognise. ***b^{h}uH-** is also the source of English **be**. So English's *be* and French's *fus* are the same ancient word, and neither of them is related to French *suis* — which is the cousin of English *is* and *am*.
English has exactly the same patchwork, and nobody notices because it is their own: **am** and **is** from one root, **be** from another, **was** and **were** from a third. French is doing what English does. It is only visible here because it is somebody else's language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the form — "je fus, il fut"
- the root — "fuī, from *b^{h}uH-: to grow, to become"

- the surprise — "that root is English *be*"
- the English patchwork — "am, is, be, was: three roots"

Before you move on

What is *je fus*? (The **passé simple** of *être* — "I was".) Is it related to *suis*? (**No** — different root entirely.) Which Latin word is it from? (***fuī***.) Which English word comes from the same root? (**be**.) Does English do the same thing? (**Yes** — *am*/*is*, *be*, and *was* come from **three** different roots.) Next: the third stem, and it is a verb about standing.

19.9 été — the third stem

Two stems so far. The third is the largest, and it is not a form of "to be" in any language — it is a verb about **standing**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The past participle of *être* is **été**. It has nothing to do with *suis* and nothing to do with *fus*. It comes from Latin **stāre**, "**to stand**."
And it is not one stray form. **Every** *être* form beginning **ét-** comes from the standing verb:

- **été** — the past participle ← *stātum*
- **étant** — the present participle ← *stantem*
- **j'étais**, **il était** — the imperfect ← *stābam*

That is a whole limb of the verb, borrowed wholesale from a different one.
The idea is not far-fetched. "How are you?" is *how do you stand?* in more languages than not — English still says *how do you stand on this*, and *standing* means status. A verb for standing drifting into a verb for being is one of the best-worn paths in language.
Stāre left French other things too, outside *être*: **rester** ← *re-stāre*, "to stay," and **coûter** ← *constāre*, "to cost." What it did **not** do in French is survive as a separate verb meaning "to be."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the participle — "été"
- the limb — "été, étant, j'étais": all from *stāre*
- the meaning — "to stand"
- its other children — "rester, coûter"

Before you move on

What is the past participle of *être*? (**été**.) Which Latin verb is it from? (***stāre***, "to **stand**".) Which other *être* forms come from the same place? (Every one beginning **ét-** — *étant*, *j'étais*, *il était*.) Name two French verbs outside *être* from *stāre*. (**rester**, **coûter**.) Next: the name for what this verb is doing.

19.10 suppletion — three verbs in a trench coat

You have three stems and three different origins. There is a name for this, and having the name makes it stop being strange.

Grammar Lens: a paradigm filled in from elsewhere

Lay out what *être* is made of:

- **es-** — the present tense and the infinitive, from *esse*
- **fu-** — the *passé simple*, from *fuī*
- **ét-** — the participles and the imperfect, from *stāre*

One verb, three ancestors, and the joins are invisible unless somebody points at them.
The name for this is **suppletion**: one verb's paradigm filled in with pieces of another. It is not a French disease and not a sign of decay. It happens to the **most used verbs in every language**, and only to them — a verb has to be extremely common for speakers to tolerate a completely unpredictable form, and extremely common verbs are also the ones people reach for when another verb is missing a form.

English does it constantly and you have never thought about it:

- **go / went** — *went* was stolen outright from *wend*
- **am / is / be / was** — the same three-way patchwork as *être*
- **good / better** — *better* is not from *good* at all

So the answer to "why is *être* so irregular?" is now complete. It is irregular because it is old, common, and **assembled from three verbs**. There was never a pattern to find, and the time you might have spent hunting for one is better spent on the six forms themselves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three stems — "es-, fu-, ét-"
- the word — "suppletion"
- the English case — "go, went; and went was taken from wend"
- the conclusion — "no pattern, because it is three verbs"

Before you move on

Name *être*'s three stems and what each covers. (**es-** present and infinitive, **fu-** the *passé simple*, **ét-** participles and imperfect.) What is the name for a paradigm filled in from another verb? (**Suppletion**.) Give an English example. (***go/went***, or *am/be/was*, or *good/better*.) Which verbs does it happen to? (The **most used ones** — only they are common enough to survive it.) Next: what Spanish did with the same two verbs.

19.11 être / ser · estar — the same two verbs, twice

Stāre should have rung a bell. If you have ever looked at Spanish, you have met it wearing its own name.

Why it's said this way

Spanish has **two** verbs for "to be," and choosing between them is famously the hardest thing about beginner Spanish:

- **ser** ← *esse*
- **estar** ← *stāre*

Those are the **same two Latin verbs** French has. French did not get a different inheritance; it made a different decision with the same one.

- **Spanish** kept them **apart** as two verbs, and made every speaker choose between them for the rest of their life.
- **French** kept **one** verb, *être* ← *esse*, and quietly **swallowed** a large limb of *stāre* — the *ét-* forms — into it.

Neither language invented anything. They took the same two words and resolved the overlap in opposite directions, and the result is that a French speaker never thinks about *stāre* while a Spanish speaker thinks about it every day.
This is worth carrying beyond this chapter, because it is the general shape of how related languages differ. They rarely differ because one has something the other lacks. They differ because both inherited the same crowded set of options and **tidied it up differently**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the Spanish pair — "ser, estar"
- their sources — "ser from esse, estar from stāre"
- the French answer — "one verb, être, which absorbed the ét- limb"
- the finding — "same two words, opposite solutions"

Before you move on

Which two Latin verbs lie behind Spanish *ser* and *estar*? (***esse*** and ***stāre***.) Are they the same two behind French *être*? (**Yes** — the identical inheritance.) What did each language do? (**Spanish kept them apart** as two verbs; **French kept one** and absorbed *stāre*'s *ét-* forms.) Why do related languages usually differ? (They inherited the **same options** and tidied them differently.) Next: all six forms, together.

19.12 Practice — the whole of être

Six forms and three ancestors. Run the forms first; the history is what makes them stay.

Your turn: the six

Say these aloud:

- "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"
- backwards — "ils sont, vous êtes, nous sommes, il est, tu es, je suis"
- two sentences — "Je suis français", "Je suis fatigué"

Twice through: "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"

Your turn: the two verbs side by side

Say these aloud:

- the buzz and the hiss — "ils ont, ils sont"
- the vowel pair — "tu as, tu es"
- both verbs from the top — "j'ai … je suis"

Your turn: the three stems

Say these aloud:

- "es- from esse: the present and the infinitive"

- "fu- from fuī: the passé simple, and English *be*"
- "ét- from stāre: to stand"
- the name — "suppletion"; and "go, went"

What you've built this chapter

- **the second verb the language rests on**, six forms, one lesson each.
- **an explanation instead of a pattern.** There is no pattern in *être* because it is **three verbs**: *esse*, *fuī* and *stāre*, patched into one paradigm.
- **a word for that** — **suppletion** — and the knowledge that English does exactly the same with *go/went* and *am/be/was*.
- **a comparison that generalises.** Spanish kept *ser* and *estar* apart; French kept one verb and absorbed the other's limb. Related languages usually differ not by what they inherited but by **how they tidied it**.

Before you move on

Give all six forms of *être*. How do you hear *ils sont* against *ils ont*? (**Hiss** against **buzz**.) Name the three stems and their sources. (**es-** ← *esse*, **fu-** ← *fuī*, **ét-** ← *stāre*.) What is the process called? (**Suppletion**.) Which Spanish verb is *stāre*? (***estar***.)

Chapter 20

The Past That Takes être

Modes: **voice** (10) **Hands-free start:** all 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can choose between avoir and être in the past, and say what the participle agrees with and why.
>
> *A short closed list of verbs refuses avoir and takes être, and it is easier as a shape than a list: arriving and leaving, in space or in life. Two corrections come with it — motion verbs like running take avoir, because motion is not transition, and five verbs switch to avoir the moment they take an object, which shows the rule is about the sentence rather than the verb. Then the agreement, which is audible for once: elle est morte. And underneath avoir's rule, être's rule and the pronominal rule sits one fact — the participle was an adjective, and it agrees with whatever it described.*

20.1 je suis allé — the past built from "be"

You built a past tense out of *avoir*. Now meet the verbs that will not have it.

Grammar Lens: some verbs take être instead

The recipe is the same shape as before, with the other verb in front:

être (conjugated) + **past participle**

aller, "to go," is the headline case. Its past is **not** *j'ai allé*. It is:

- **je suis allé** — I went
- **tu es allé** — you went

- **il est allé** — he went
- **nous sommes allés** — we went
- **ils sont allés** — they went

Say *j'ai allé* to a French speaker and it will land as clearly wrong, the way *I have went* lands in English.
So you now have two past tenses that are really one tense with two auxiliaries, and the only question a verb ever raises is: **which one?** For the vast majority it is *avoir*, and this chapter is about the short list that says otherwise — what is on it, what is deceptively not on it, and the visible thing that happens to the participle when *être* is used.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je suis allé, tu es allé, il est allé"
- the contrast — "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"
- the error, so you can hear it — "j'ai allé is wrong, like *I have went*"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"

Before you move on

How do you say "I went"? (**Je suis allé**.) Which auxiliary does *aller* take? (***être***.) What is wrong with *j'ai allé*? (**The wrong auxiliary** — it sounds like *I have went*.) Which auxiliary do most French verbs take? (***avoir***.) Next: which verbs are on the short list.

20.2 aller · venir · naître · mourir — the shape of the list

Textbooks give this as a list to memorise, usually a dozen verbs long. It is much easier to hold as a shape.

Grammar Lens: arriving and leaving

The verbs that take *être* are these: *aller* (go), *venir* (come), *partir* (leave), *arriver* (arrive), *entrer*, *sortir*, *monter*, *descendre*, *naître* (be born), *mourir* (die), *rester* (stay), *tomber* (fall).
Read them as a **shape** and the list stops needing memorising:

> **going, coming, being born, dying** — arriving and leaving, in space or in life.

Every one of them is about **crossing a threshold**. Entering or leaving a place; entering or leaving the world; going up, going down, falling, staying put at the end of a movement. They are not verbs about **doing** something. They are verbs about **ending up somewhere**. Hold on to that phrasing, because it is what makes the next two lessons make sense. It is also why the participle behaves the way it does: if the verb describes where you **ended up**, the participle is describing **you** — and you will see it agree with you accordingly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four corners — "going, coming, born, dying"
- the shape — "arriving and leaving, in space or in life"
- the test — "not doing something; ending up somewhere"
- "je suis allé, je suis venu, je suis resté"

Before you move on

Give the shape of the *être* list in one line. (**Arriving and leaving, in space or in life** — going, coming, being born, dying.) What do all these verbs have in common? (They cross a **threshold** — they are about **ending up somewhere**, not about doing something.) Name three. (*aller*, *venir*, *partir*, *naître*, *mourir*, *rester*, *tomber* — any three.) Next: the verbs that look like they belong and do not.

20.3 j'ai couru — not every motion verb qualifies

> "Verbs of motion take *être*" is the rule most learners are given, and it will mislead you within a week.

Grammar Lens: moving is not arriving

These are all motion verbs, and every one of them takes **avoir**:

- *j'ai marché* — I walked
- *j'ai couru* — I ran
- *j'ai nagé*, *j'ai dansé*, *j'ai voyagé* — I swam, danced, travelled

You can run for an hour and arrive nowhere. That is the whole distinction. The *être* verbs are not about **movement**; they are about **arriving, leaving and changing state** — crossing a threshold, as the last lesson put it.
J'ai couru describes what your legs did. *Je suis parti* describes that you are no longer here. The first is an activity; the second is a change in where you are, and it is the change that takes *être*.
So correct the rule in your head now, before it costs you anything: **not motion — transition.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the avoir ones — "j'ai marché, j'ai couru, j'ai dansé"
- against the être ones — "je suis parti, je suis arrivé"
- the corrected rule — "not motion, transition"
- the test — "you can run for an hour and arrive nowhere"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary does "to run" take? (***avoir*** — *j'ai couru*.) But is it not a motion verb? (**Yes** — which is why "motion verbs take *être*" is the **wrong rule**.) State the right one. (**Transition, not motion** — arriving, leaving, changing state.) Next: the verbs that use both.

20.4 je suis monté / j'ai monté les valises

A handful of verbs sit on both sides of the line, and which side they are on depends on the sentence rather than the verb.

Grammar Lens: an object flips the auxiliary

monter, **descendre**, **sortir**, **rentrer** and **passer** take *être* when they stand alone, and *avoir* the moment they take a **direct object**:

> **Je suis monté.** — "I went up." No object; *être*.
>
> **J'ai monté les valises.** — "I took the suitcases up." An object; *avoir*.

This looks like an extra rule to memorise. It is the opposite: it is the rule you already have, doing exactly what it said it would.
Je suis monté describes **where I ended up** — a transition, so *être*.
J'ai monté les valises describes **something I did to the suitcases** — an action on an object, so *avoir*. The verb has not changed its meaning much; what has changed is whether the sentence is about a transition or about an action, and that is the only thing the auxiliary has ever cared about.
So these verbs are not exceptions. They are the clearest demonstration that the rule is about the **sentence**, not the verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Je suis monté … J'ai monté les valises"
- the same for going out — "Je suis sorti … J'ai sorti le vin"
- the reason — "transition takes être; an action on an object takes avoir"
- the conclusion — "what decides it is the sentence, not the verb"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary in *je suis monté*? (***être*** — no object, a transition.) And in *j'ai monté les valises*? (***avoir*** — a **direct object**.) Is this a new rule? (**No** — it is the same rule: transition takes *être*, an action on an object takes *avoir*.) Next: what happens to the participle.

20.5 elle est allée — the participle agrees

With *avoir*, the participle almost never moved. With *être* it moves every time, and this is the one agreement in French you can actually hear.

Grammar Lens: it agrees with the subject

French	English
Il est **allé**.	He went.
Elle est **allée**.	She went.
Ils sont **allés**.	They went.
Elles sont **allées**.	They (f.) went.

The participle takes the **subject's** gender and number — exactly like an adjective.

And the reason is the same fossil you already met. *Elle est allée* began as a plain description: "**she is gone**," with *gone* describing **her**, in the same way *elle est fatiguée* describes her. It was never an action she performed on something. It was a **state she was in** — which is precisely the shape of every verb on this list. So the participle agreed with her, and it still does.

One practical note. With *aller* you cannot hear the difference: *allé* and *allée* are identical aloud. But some of these verbs end in a consonant, and then you can — *il est mort* against *elle est morte*, where the **t** wakes up. That makes this the rare French agreement rule that is not purely a spelling problem.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four — "il est allé, elle est allée, ils sont allés, elles sont allées"

- one you can hear — "il est mort, elle est morte"
- the reason — "she is gone: gone describes her"
- the parallel — "elle est fatiguée, elle est allée"

Before you move on

With *être*, what does the participle agree with? (The **subject**.) Say "she went." (**Elle est allée**.) Why does it agree? (It began as a **description of her** — "she is gone" — so it behaved like an **adjective**.) Which example lets you **hear** the agreement? (***il est mort*** against ***elle est morte***.) Next: the one rule under both auxiliaries.

20.6 une seule règle — both halves are the same fact

You now have two agreement rules that look unrelated. They are one rule, and seeing that is worth more than either of them.

Grammar Lens: the participle agrees with whatever it described

auxiliary	**the participle agrees with**	**because it was...**
avoir	a **preceding object** — *les lettres que j'ai écrites*	"I have letters, **written**"
être	the **subject** — *elle est allée*	"she is **gone**"

Two rules, two different targets — and one explanation covering both. The participle **was an adjective**, and an adjective agrees with the thing it describes. That is all either rule says.

- With *avoir*, the thing described was the **object you possessed**: the letters are the written ones. So the participle agrees with the object — and only when the object comes first, because that is where an adjective could still reach it.
- With *être*, the thing described was the **subject**: she is the gone

one. So the participle agrees with her.

Both are the same sentence-shape from Latin, one built on *habēre* and one built on *esse*, and in both the participle is doing an adjective's job. French textbooks teach these as two chapters and a long list of exceptions. They are one idea with a two-thousand-year memory, and once you have the idea most of those exceptions write themselves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the avoir case — "les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- the être case — "elle est allée"
- the single rule — "the participle agrees with whatever it described"
- the two old sentences — "I have letters written … she is gone"

Before you move on

With *avoir*, what does the participle agree with? (A **preceding object**.) With *être*? (The **subject**.) State the one rule underneath both. (The participle **was an adjective** and agrees with **whatever it described**.) Why does the *avoir* rule need the object to come first? (Because that is where an **adjective could still reach it**.) Next: the verbs that take *être* and ignore its rule.

20.7 je me suis levé — the pronominal family

The *être* list was short and closed. Here is one more family that takes *être*, and it has no end to it.

Grammar Lens: all of them, without exception

A **pronominal** verb is one carrying the little reflexive pronoun you met when you learned to give your name — the *me* of *je m'appelle*, the *se* of *s'appeler*.
Every one of them takes *être* in the past. No list, no shape to memorise, no exceptions:

je me suis levé — I got up

elle s'est lavée — she washed

Notice the word order: the reflexive pronoun comes **before** the auxiliary, not after it. *Je **me** suis levé*, not *je suis me levé*.
That gives you two ways into *être*, and they work differently. The verbs from the earlier list are a **closed set** you can hold as a shape. The pronominals are an **open class** identified by their form — if it has a *me*, *te* or *se*, it takes *être*, and you never have to ask.
But be careful with what comes next. They take *être*, and they do **not** follow *être*'s agreement rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je me suis levé"
- "elle s'est lavée"
- the word order — "je *me* suis levé"; the pronoun comes first
- the rule — "if it has me, te or se, it takes être"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary do pronominal verbs take? (***être*** — **all** of them.) How do you recognise one? (It carries **me, te** or **se**.) Where does that pronoun sit? (**Before the auxiliary** — *je me suis levé*.) Is this a closed list like the earlier one? (**No** — it is an **open class**.) Next: the trap in their agreement.

20.8 elle s'est lavée — the auxiliary lies about the rule

Pronominal verbs take *être*. Now watch them ignore *être*'s agreement rule completely.

Grammar Lens: être on the outside, avoir underneath

They agree with a **preceding direct object** — which is *avoir*'s rule, not *être*'s. Usually that object **is** the reflexive pronoun, and sometimes it is not:

> **Elle s'est lavée.** — She washed **herself**. *se* is the direct object, and it comes first, so the participle agrees.
>
> **Elle s'est lavé les mains.** — She washed **her hands**. The object is *les mains*, and it **follows**, so there is no agreement.
>
> **Elles se sont parlé.** — They spoke **to each other**. *se* is **indirect** — you speak *to* someone — so there is no agreement.

Which is, satisfyingly, the rule you already had. Nothing new has been introduced: the participle agrees with a preceding **direct** object, exactly as it did in *les lettres que j'ai écrites*.
The lesson to take is about **appearances**. The auxiliary looks like *être* and the agreement behaves like *avoir*, and if you let the first tell you about the second you will get it wrong every time. The auxiliary is not what decides agreement; it never was. What decides it is what the participle is describing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- agreement — "Elle s'est lavée"
- no agreement, object after — "Elle s'est lavé les mains"
- no agreement, indirect — "Elles se sont parlé"
- the warning — "the auxiliary looks like être; the agreement is avoir's"

Before you move on

Which agreement rule do pronominal verbs follow? (***avoir*'s** — a **preceding direct object**.) Why does *elle s'est lavée* agree? (*se* is

the **direct object** and comes **first**.) Why does *elle s'est lavé les mains* not? (The object is *les mains* and it **follows**.) Why does *elles se sont parlé* not? (*se* is **indirect** — you speak *to* someone.) Next: the group that escapes even this.

20.9 elles se sont souvenues — the verbs with no other form

One small group escapes even the rule you just learned, and it escapes for a reason you can work out rather than memorise.

Grammar Lens: no object to be an object of

A few verbs exist **only** in pronominal form. There is no plain version of them at all:

- **se souvenir** — to remember
- **s'enfuir** — to flee
- **s'évanouir** — to faint

There is no *souvenir quelqu'un*, no *enfuir quelque chose*. The *se* is not doing a job you could describe as direct or indirect, because there is no non-reflexive verb for it to be the object **of**. It is simply part of the word.
So the previous lesson's test cannot be run on them, and they fall back to agreeing with the **subject**:

> **Elles se sont souvenues.** — They remembered.

Which is where this chapter's whole argument lands. The agreement is not decided by the auxiliary, and not by a list of verb types. It is decided by **what the participle is describing** — and when there is no object in the picture at all, the only thing left for it to describe is the subject.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "se souvenir, s'enfuir, s'évanouir"
- the example — "Elles se sont souvenues"
- the reason — "no plain verb, so the *se* is not an object of anything"
- the landing — "what is left for the participle to describe is the subject"

Before you move on

What is special about *se souvenir*? (It exists **only** in pronominal form — there is no plain *souvenir* verb.) So what does its participle agree with? (The **subject** — *elles se sont souvenues.*) Why can the direct-object test not be applied? (There is **no non-reflexive verb** for *se* to be the object of.) Next: all of it together.

20.10 Practice — which auxiliary, and what agrees

Two questions cover this whole chapter: which auxiliary, and what does the participle describe. Run both.

Your turn: which auxiliary

Say these aloud:

- the contrast — "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"
- the shape of the list — "arriving and leaving, in space or in life"
- the trap — "j'ai couru, j'ai marché"; motion is not transition
- the switch — "je suis monté … j'ai monté les valises"

Twice through: "je suis allé, je suis venu, je suis resté"

Your turn: what the participle agrees with

Say these aloud:

- the four — "il est allé, elle est allée, ils sont allés, elles sont allées"

- the audible one — "il est mort, elle est morte"
- the avoir side — "les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- the single rule — "it agrees with whatever it described"

Your turn: the pronominals

Say these aloud:

- "je me suis levé"
- the three cases — "elle s'est lavée; elle s'est lavé les mains; elles se sont parlé"
- the group with no plain form — "elles se sont souvenues"

What you've built this chapter

- **a second auxiliary**, and a short closed list that is easier as a shape than a list: **arriving and leaving, in space or in life**.
- **two corrections to the rule you would have been given.** *Motion* verbs do not take *être* — **transition** verbs do; and five verbs switch the moment they take an object, which shows that what decides the auxiliary is the **sentence**, not the verb.
- **an agreement you can hear** — *il est mort*, *elle est morte*.
- **one rule under everything**: the participle was an adjective, and it agrees with whatever it described. *Avoir*'s rule, *être*'s rule and the pronominal rule are that one fact seen from three angles.

Before you move on

Say "she went." (**Elle est allée**.) Which auxiliary does "to run" take, and why? (***avoir*** — it is **motion**, not **transition**.) What flips *monter* to *avoir*? (A **direct object**.) Which agreement rule do pronominal verbs follow? (***avoir*'s** — a preceding **direct** object.) State the one rule under all of it. (The participle **agrees with whatever it described**.)

Chapter 21

Head and Hand

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the head and the hand in French with the right article, and point out the Latin manus hiding inside English manual, manufacture and maintain.
>
> *Say la main with its nasal -ain, then run the manus family out loud — manual, manuscript, maintenir — and land on manufacture, 'made by hand', now the name for the opposite.*

21.1 la tête — "the head"

The first body part, and one of the best etymologies in French. The word for *head* is not the Latin word for head.

You'll want to know: The word

la tête — the head. Feminine, so **la**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin's word for "head" was ***caput***. You can see it surviving all over Europe:

Portuguese	*cabeça*
Spanish	*cabeza*
Italian	*capo* (now "chief, boss")
English	**cap**tain, **cap**ital, de**cap**itate

French has *caput* too, and in two layers. **Inherited**, worn down by use: **chef** ("chief," originally "head"), **chapitre**, **cap** (a headland), **achever** ("to finish" — to bring to a head). **Re-borrowed** later, straight from written Latin: **capital**, **capitaine**, **décapiter**.
What French does *not* use it for is the thing on your shoulders. **Tête** comes from Latin ***testa***: an **earthenware pot**, a shell, a potsherd.

Why it's said this way

Soldiers' slang. Roman troops called the skull a *testa* the way English speakers say someone got hit on the **noggin** — a noggin being a small mug. It was a joke, it spread, and eventually the joke *replaced the real word* in Gaul and Italy.
So a French speaker saying *j'ai mal à la tête* is, historically, saying "my pot hurts."
Testa is still visible in English **test** — which began as the shallow pot an alchemist used to assay metals.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la tête"
- "j'ai mal à la tête" — "my head hurts"
- the joke — "*testa* = a **pot**"
- the receipt — "te**s**te → tê-te"

Before you move on

Say "the head." (*La tête* — feminine.) Does it come from Latin *caput*? (**No** — from ***testa***, an **earthenware pot**.) Why a pot?

(Roman soldiers' **slang** for the skull, which replaced the proper word.) Where did *caput* survive in French? (**Inherited** in *chef*, *chapitre*, *cap*, *achever*; **re-borrowed** in *capital*, *capitaine*, *décapiter* — just never for the head itself.) What does the circumflex on *tête* record? (**A lost *s*** — *teste*, still visible in English **test**.) Next: the hand.

21.2 (la tête, continued) — The circumflex is a receipt

Before going on: say **la tête** again, and what it means.

Sounds you'll need

Look at the accent: **tê**te. Chapter W01 taught what a circumflex records — a letter that used to be there, almost always an **s**.

testa → Old French **teste** → modern **tête**

The *s* stopped being pronounced, and the accent was put in to mark the grave. That is why English, which borrowed from Old French *before* the *s* fell, still has it in **test**.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **la tête**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **la tête**? Say it once more, without looking.

21.3 la main — "the hand"

Where *tête* abandoned its Latin ancestor, this one kept it — and then lent it to English several dozen times over.

Je suis monté, but *j'ai monté les valises*: a direct object flips the helper to *avoir*.

You'll want to know: The word

> **la main** — the hand. **Feminine**, and worth flagging: it ends in a consonant and still takes *la*. French gender is not predictable from the ending, which is why this book always gives you the article.

The *-ain* is the nasal vowel of *pain*, the bread — say them together: *pain*, *main*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Main comes from Latin ***manus***, "hand." That word is inside an enormous number of English words, and once you see it you cannot unsee it:

English	**literally**
manual	done by hand
manufacture	made by hand (*manus* + *facere* "to make")
manuscript	written by hand (*manus* + *scrībere*)
maintain	hold in the hand (*manū tenēre*)
manage	to handle — via Italian *maneggiare*, of horses
manoeuvre	work by hand (*manū operārī*)

Manufacture is the one worth pausing on. It means "made by hand" — and it now names precisely the thing that *isn't*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la main" — and hear *pain*, *main*
- "j'ai mal à la main"
- the family — "manual, manuscript, maintain — all a **hand**"
- the irony — "**manufacture** = made by hand"

Before you move on

Say "the hand." (*La main* — **feminine**, despite the consonant ending.) What Latin word is it from? (***Manus***.) Give three English words built on it. (*Manual*, *manufacture*, *manuscript*, *maintain*, *manage*, *manoeuvre*.) What does *manufacture* literally mean? ("**Made by hand**" — now the name for the opposite.) And *maintenir*? (*Manū tenēre*, "**hold in the hand**".) Next: the rest of the body.

21.4 (la main, continued) — French kept it too

Before going on: say **la main** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Maintenir / English **maintain** is Latin *manū tenēre*, "to hold in the hand" — a hand, plus the verb *tenēre*, "to hold."
So *maintenance* — the least romantic word in any office — is literally **keeping something in hand**.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **la main**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **la main**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 22

Yes and No

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer yes or no in French, send non through my nose as a nasal vowel, and recognise the ne … pas pair that carries negation inside a sentence.
>
> *The oui / non pair said back to back, non's -on nasal placed against bon and bonjour, and the ne … pas frame named as the sentence-level negation to come.*

22.1 oui — yes

> Where Spanish kept Latin's word for yes, French built a brand-new one — and named half a country after it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oui = **yes**. Just two sounds, *wee*.
Its Romance cousins (Spanish *sí*, Italian *sì*) come from Latin *sīc* "thus." **French took a different road entirely.** *oui* comes from Old French **oïl**, and *oïl* is a squeezed-down Latin phrase:

> **hoc ille** ("this [is] it") → *o-il* → **oui**

You answered "yes" by saying, in effect, "*that's the one.*"

Why it's said this way

This mattered so much it became a map. In the Middle Ages France was divided by how people said *yes*:

- the **north** said *oïl* → the **langue d'oïl** (which became modern French)
- the **south** said *oc* → the **langue d'oc** — still visible in the region name **Languedoc**, and in the language **Occitan**

One little answer-word, drawn as a border.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "oui" — *wee*
- the origin — "hoc ille → oïl → oui": *that's the one*
- the contradiction — "Tu ne viens pas ? — Si !"

Before you move on

How do you say yes in French? (**oui**.) What Latin phrase is it worn down from? (**hoc ille**, "this is it," via *oïl*.) What were the *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc* named after? (The two medieval words for **yes**.) When do you answer **si** instead of *oui*? (To **contradict a negative** — *Tu ne viens pas? — Si!*)

22.2 (oui, continued) — The other "yes," si

Before going on: say **oui** again, and what it means.

Grammar Lens: The other "yes," si

French keeps a **second** yes — **si** — for one special job: contradicting a **negative**. When someone says something *isn't* so and you insist it *is*, you answer **si**, not *oui*:

Tu ne viens pas ? ("You're not coming?") — ***Si !*** ("Yes I

am!")

(That *si* is the Latin *sīc* the Spanish *sí* also comes from — French kept it only for this contradicting move.)

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **oui**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **oui**? Say it once more, without looking.

22.3 non — no / not

After French's home-grown *oui*, its **no** is the family word, shared straight with Spanish — but said the French way, through the nose.

Every pronominal verb takes *être* in the past: *je me suis levé*, *elle s'est lavée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

non = **no**. It comes from Latin **nōn**, the same source as Spanish *no* and Italian *no*:

Latin *nōn*	→
Spanish	no
Italian	no
French	**non**

Spanish dropped the *n* and left a clean *no*. French **kept** the *n* — but turned it into a **nasal vowel**: you don't quite touch your tongue to say the final *n*, you send the vowel through your nose. That's the sound written **-on** in *non*, *bon*, *bonjour* — you've met it before.

Grammar Lens: The seed of French negation

The word that actually carries negation inside a French sentence isn't *non* but its **unstressed twin, ne** — both worn down from the same Latin *nōn*. Modern French usually reinforces *ne* with a second word,

giving the pair *ne … pas*:

> *Je* ***ne*** *parle* ***pas*** *français* = "I do **not** speak French."

For now, **non** on its own is your answer-word. In *ne … pas*, the **ne** is *non*'s cousin from *nōn*; the **pas** was added later — it originally meant "a step" (Latin *passus*), as in "not walk a *step*" — and simply stuck. That fuller sentence negation is something you'll build later.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "non" — nasal, through the nose, like the *-on* in *bon*
- the pair with yes — "oui / non"
- the family — Latin *nōn* → Spanish *no*, French *non*

Before you move on

How do you say no in French? (**non**.) What Latin word is it from, and which Spanish word is its twin? (**nōn**; Spanish **no**.) What did French do to the *n* that Spanish dropped? (Kept it as a **nasal vowel** — the *-on* sound.) What pair does full French negation usually wrap around the verb? (***ne … pas***.)

Chapter 23

Please

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say please in French and choose between s'il vous plaît and s'il te plaît depending on who I am speaking to.
>
> *Say s'il vous plaît with its silent final -t, take it apart into 'if it pleases you', then switch to s'il te plaît for a friend. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

23.1 s'il vous plaît — please

French doesn't order you to do things — it asks, very politely, *if it would please you.*

Some verbs exist only with *se*: *se souvenir*, to remember. *Elles se sont souvenues.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'il vous plaît = please — but taken apart it's a tiny sentence:

> **s'** (*si*, "if") + **il** ("it") + **vous** ("you") + **plaît** ("pleases")
> → "**if it pleases you.**"

You're not demanding; you're checking whether the favour would please them. It's the polite indirectness Spanish also uses in *por favor* ("for a favour") — same courtesy, built a different way.
The verb **plaît** is from Latin **placēre**, "to please" — which English borrowed wholesale: **please**, **pleasure**, **pleasant**, and (via "calm,

pleasing") even **placid**.

Grammar Lens: Formal and familiar

French chooses the word for "you" by who you're talking to — and *please* comes in both:

- **s'il vous plaît** — *vous*, the **formal / plural** you (a stranger, an elder, a room). Often written **SVP**.
- **s'il te plaît** — *te*, the **familiar** you (a friend, a child).

Two sounds to respect: the final **-t** of *plaît* is **silent** (*pleh*), and *plaît* itself carries the *ai* = *eh* you've met.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "s'il vous plaît" — final t silent, *see voo pleh*
- taken apart — "if it pleases you"
- familiar — "s'il te plaît" to a friend

Before you move on

How do you say please in French? (**s'il vous plaît**.) What does it literally mean? ("**If it pleases you.**") Which Latin verb is *plaît* from, and what English words come from it? (**placēre** — *please, pleasure, placid.*) When do you say **s'il te plaît** instead? (To someone you address as **tu** — a friend or child.)

Chapter 24

Sorry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise in French and pick between je suis désolé(e), pardon and excusez-moi for the situation I am actually in.
>
> *Say je suis désolé(e) knowing it literally means 'I am desolate', then place pardon as the quick reflex and excusez-moi as the attention-getter. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

24.1 je suis désolé(e) — "I'm sorry" (literally "I am desolate")

You already know **s'il vous plaît**, "please" — "if it pleases you." French's "sorry" is, secretly, a much bigger word than it sounds: **désolé** is the same word as English **desolate**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **je suis** = "**I am**."
- **désolé** (feminine **désolée**) = "**sorry**," but literally "**made utterly alone / devastated.**" It comes from Latin **dēsōlāre**, "to make solitary" — **dē-** ("thoroughly, completely") + **sōlus** ("alone"), the very root of English **sole**, **solo**, **solitary**, and **desolate** itself.

So **je suis désolé(e)** literally says "**I am desolate**" — French reaches

for a word of real devastation to say a plain "sorry," the way English keeps "terribly sorry" as an option rather than a requirement.

Why it's said this way

French keeps two more courtesy words for different jobs:

- **pardon** — a quick, all-purpose "sorry / pardon me" (bumping someone, a small slip). It comes from **pardonner**, Latin **per-** ("thoroughly") + **dōnāre** ("to give") — "to give completely," i.e. to forgive. The neat part isn't that French and Spanish coined this separately — it's that they **didn't have to**: **perdōnāre** was already one word in Late Latin, so French *pardonner* and Spanish *perdón/perdonar* are simply two children of the *same* inherited word, not two languages independently landing on the same idea.
- **excusez-moi** — "**excuse me**," from **excuser** < Latin **ex-** ("out of, free from") + **causa** ("cause, charge") — literally "to free from a charge." Reach for this to get someone's **attention**, not to apologize for a real fault.

Je suis désolé(e) carries the most **regret**; **pardon** is the quick, light reflex; **excusez-moi** is for getting attention. Native speakers slide between all three by feel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "désolé" — sorry / desolate — then "je suis désolé," I am sorry
- the quick one — "pardon"
- the attention one — "excusez-moi"

Before you move on

What does **désolé** literally mean, and what English word is it identical to? (**"Made utterly alone"** — the same word as English **desolate**.) What is **pardon** built from, and why does **Spanish perdón** look just like it? (**Per- "thoroughly" + dōnāre "to give"** — both simply inherited the *same* already-formed Latin

word, **perdōnāre**.) What's **excusez-moi** for? (**Getting someone's attention**, not apologizing for a real fault.)

Chapter 25

Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the weather in French — quel temps fait-il, il fait chaud, il fait froid, il pleut.
>
> *Use le temps in both its senses, build the weather with faire (il fait chaud / il fait froid), and say il pleut with the Latin pl- cluster French kept intact. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

25.1 le temps, il pleut — the same Latin word, a different fate for "rain"

> You've seen Spanish's *tiempo* mean both "time" and "weather" at once, from Latin *tempus*. French has the exact same word, the exact same double meaning — because this widening happened within Latin itself, before French and Spanish went their separate ways.

The two words: le temps — time and weather

le temps = both "**time**" and "**weather**" — from Latin **tempus**, same as Spanish's *tiempo* (English kept only the "time" half: **temporal, tempo**). So **quel temps fait-il ?** ("what's the weather like?") is literally "**what time does it make**?" — the identical construction inside Spanish's *¿qué tiempo hace?*.

Grammar Lens: il fait chaud / il fait froid

Il fait chaud. — "It's hot." — literally "it **makes** hot." **Il fait froid.** — "It's cold." — literally "it **makes** cold."

Same *hacer*-style periphrasis as Spanish, just with French's own **faire** ("to make/do").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le temps" — time, or weather, depending on context
- "il fait chaud. il fait froid." — it's hot/cold
- "il pleut" — it's raining, pl- kept intact from Latin

Before you move on

What two things does **le temps** mean, and where does this polysemy come from? (**"Time"** and **"weather"** — from Latin *tempus*, already double-sensed before French/Spanish split apart.) Does French's *il pleut* show the same *pl-* → *ll-* shift as Spanish's *llueve*? (**No** — French kept the *pl-* cluster intact; only Spanish underwent that shift.)

25.2 (le temps, il pleut, continued) — il pleut

Before going on: say **le temps, il pleut** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Il pleut. — "It's raining." — from **pleuvoir** ← Latin **pluere**, "to rain" — the **same** Latin verb behind Spanish's *llueve*. But here's the honest difference: Spanish underwent the **pl-** → **ll-** shift (*pluere* → *llover*), while French kept the **pl-** cluster fully intact — *pleuvoir* still visibly starts with *pl-*, just like the Latin original. So the same Latin verb took two different sound-change paths in its two daughters:

one eroded the cluster, one preserved it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **le temps, il pleut**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **le temps, il pleut**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 26

Dog and Cat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a dog and a cat in French and say why chien is the regular descendant of canis while chat is a word that travelled out of Egypt.
>
> *Say chien and check its ca- → cha- shift against champ and chanter, then say chat and place it beside Spanish gato and Italian gatto as one inherited cattus. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

26.1 chien, chat — the regular one, and the well-traveled one

You've met Spanish's *perro*, a genuine unsolved mystery, and Latin's own *canis/fēlēs→cattus* history. French's two animal words tell a cleaner story: one is perfectly regular, the other is the same well- documented word you already know.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chien ("**dog**") comes straight from Latin **canis** (accusative *canem*) — and unlike Spanish, French kept it. Two separate, regular changes are stacked here: the initial **c→ch** is the same **ca- → cha-** palatalization you can check against other Latin words — **campus → champ** ("field"), **cantāre → chanter** ("to sing"); the **a→ie** in the middle is a different, later shift specific to words like *canem* (known as Bartsch's Law — the outcome is completely regular and undisputed, even though

the precise phonetic trigger is still debated). Put together, *chien* is a fully **regular** sound change, following French's own rules predictably — a genuinely different story from Spanish, where the expected descendant (*can*) got pushed aside by the still-unexplained *perro*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "chien" — dog, the regular descendant of canis
- "champ, chanter" — the same ca- → cha- shift, in field and to sing
- "chat" — cat, the same word as Spanish's gato, from Egypt via Rome

Before you move on

Is *chien* a regular or irregular descendant of Latin *canis*? (**Regular** — the same *ca-* → *cha-* shift as *champ* and *chanter*.) Does French show the same *perro*-style mystery Spanish does for "dog"? (**No** — French kept the expected Latin word.) What word does *chat* continue, and where did that word most likely originate? (**Cattus**, most likely **Afro-Asiatic**, traveling with the cat out of **Egypt**.)

26.2 (chien, chat, continued) — chat

Before going on: say **chien, chat** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chat ("**cat**") continues **cattus**, the same Late Latin word — most likely ultimately **Afro-Asiatic** (compare Nubian *kadis*) — that spread along Roman trade routes as domestic cats themselves spread out of **Egypt**. This is the identical word behind Spanish's *gato* and Italian's *gatto* — French, Spanish, and Italian all independently inherited the exact same Late Latin replacement for Classical *fēlēs*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **chien, chat**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **chien, chat**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 27

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name green and yellow in French, and say how solid the claimed link between jaune and German gelb actually is.
>
> *Say vert as the ordinary Romance inheritance from viridis, say jaune as galbinus 'yellow-green', and state the jaune / gelb cousinhood as probable rather than certain. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

27.1 vert, jaune — the expected inheritance, and a hidden PIE-level cousin

French's green word is exactly what you'd expect. Its yellow word hides something you won't expect at all — a secret cousin sitting inside German.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vert ("**green**") ← Latin **viridis** — and this is genuinely the **standard** source of "green" across nearly every Romance language: Spanish *verde*, Italian *verde*, Portuguese *verde*, Catalan *verd*. No surprise here — a clean, shared inheritance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vert" — green, the standard Romance word
- "jaune" — yellow, literally "yellow-green"
- the probable cousin — "jaune, gelb" — likely the same ancient PIE root, two completely different paths, though the link isn't airtight

Before you move on

Is **vert** a typical or unusual Romance word for "green"? (**Typical** — the standard source across nearly all Romance languages.) What did Latin **galbinus**, the source of *jaune*, literally mean? ("**Yellow-green**.") What German word is usually called *jaune*'s deep PIE cousin, and how solid is that link? (**Gelb** — both usually traced to PIE **ghel-*, "to shine," though modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as genuinely unknown, so the connection is probable, not certain.)

27.2 (vert, jaune, continued) — jaune

Before going on: say **vert, jaune** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jaune ("**yellow**") ← Latin **galbinus**, which literally meant "**yellow-green**" — an extended form of **galbus**, from **Proto-Indo-European **ghel-***, "**to shine**" (with derivatives covering green, yellow, and gold alike — the same root gives Greek *khlōros*, "greenish-yellow"). Here's the genuinely surprising part: this **same PIE root**, ****ghel-***, is also usually cited as the source of **German**'s **gelb** and English's **yellow** — by a completely separate, Germanic path (Proto-Germanic ****gelwaz***). Honesty check, though: the *galbus*→**ghel-* link itself is **less secure** than it looks — some modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as unknown rather than confirming the connection. So *jaune* and *gelb* are **probably** cousins at the Proto-Indo-European level, despite one reaching French through Latin and the other reaching German directly through Germanic — just don't treat that link as airtight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **vert, jaune**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **vert, jaune**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 28

Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I take, ask, help and like or love in French, break prendre's stem the way its plural requires, and know that je t'aime bien is weaker than je t'aime rather than stronger.
>
> *Run the chapter's four verbs together with je — je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime — then turn aimer over: one verb covers like and love, the thing named decides which, and adding bien downgrades it. Reaches back past the chapter to re-say le chien and le chat from Chapter 22, le vert from Chapter 23, and the s'il vous plaît request from Chapter 19.*

28.1 prendre — "to take," the verb your hand does

> You already have **la main**, the hand. Here is the verb that hand performs — and it turns out to be hiding inside a surprising number of English words you use without thinking.

You'll want to know: the word

> **prendre** — to take. Said *PRAHN-druh*: the *-en-* is the **nasal** vowel of *an*, sent through the nose, not a clean *en*.
>
> **Je prends le pain.** — I take the bread.

The *-ds* of *je prends* is **silent**. You say *prahn*, and stop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prendre ← Latin **prehendere**, "to grasp, to seize," which Romans themselves shortened to **prendere**. That short form is the one French inherited — and English borrowed the family repeatedly:

- **prehensile** — a tail that grasps.
- **apprehend** — to seize (*ad-* "toward" + grasp); **reprehensible**, something to be seized back on.
- **prison** ← Latin *prehensiō*, "**a seizing**" — a jail is, literally, a taking-hold.
- **surprise** — French *sur-* "over" + *prendre*: an **over-taking**.
- **enterprise**, something undertaken; **apprentice**, one who takes on.
- **impregnable** — from Old French *imprenable*, "**not takeable**." Nothing to do with pregnancy.

Manus gave you a hand that **holds** — *manual*, *maintain*. *Prendere* gives you the hand that **closes**.

Grammar Lens: the stem that doubles

Prendre is irregular, and its irregularity is one clean rule: the stem **loses** its *d*, and in the *ils* form it **doubles its n**. Say the six:

- **je prends** — *prahn*
- **tu prends** — *prahn*
- **il prend** — *prahn* (all three identical to the ear)
- **nous prenons** — *pruh-NOHN*, and the nasal is **gone**
- **vous prenez** — *pruh-NAY*, nasal gone again
- **ils prennent** — *PREN*, a doubled *n* and a flat *e*

So the nasal survives in the singular and dies in the plural. That is the whole verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "prendre" — *PRAHN-druh*, nasal in the middle
- "je prends le pain" then "nous prenons le pain" — nasal, then no nasal
- "je prends la main" — I take the hand, the *manus* you already have
- the family — "prehensile, apprehend, prison, surprise" — all a **grasp**

Before you move on

Say "I take the bread." (*Je prends le pain* — and the *-ds* is silent.) What happens to the nasal in *nous prenons*? (It **disappears**; the stem flattens to *pruh-*.) What did Latin *prehendere* mean, and what is a *prison* literally? (**To grasp**; a prison is "**a seizing**".) And the hand that does the taking? (*La main.*)

28.2 demander — "to ask," and the trap it sets in English

Prendre was taking. This one is the opposite move: putting a question out. And it is the word most likely to make you sound furious when you meant to sound polite.

You'll want to know: the word

demander — to ask. Said *duh-mahn-DAY*: the *-an-* is that same nasal from *prendre*, and the *-er* ending is a clean *ay*.

Je demande l'heure. — I ask the time.

It is an ordinary **-er** verb, so nothing in it breaks: *je demande, tu demandes, il demande, nous demandons, vous demandez, ils demandent.* Only *nous* and *vous* are audible; the other four all sound *duh-MAHND.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

demander ← Latin **dēmandāre**, "to hand over, to entrust" — *dē-* plus **mandāre**. And *mandāre* is itself two words: ***manus***, "**hand**," plus ***dare***, "**to give**." Giving into the hand.
So the *manus* you met in *la main* is sitting inside this verb too:

- **mandate** — what was placed in someone's hands to carry out.
- **command** — *com-* + *mandāre*: to entrust an order; and **commandment**, ten of them.
- **mandatory** — handed over as an obligation; **remand**, handed back.

One family, two very different jobs: *manual* is work done **by** the hand, *mandate* is a charge given **into** it.

Why it's said this way

> **Careful.** French **demander** means simply "**to ask**." It is neutral, everyday and perfectly polite. English **demand** is forceful — a thing you insist on.

Je demande l'heure is "I'm asking the time," not "I demand the time." The English word drifted toward force; the French one never did. Translate *demander* as **ask**, every time, and you will never be rude by accident.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "demander" — *duh-mahn-DAY*, nasal in the middle
- "je demande l'heure" — I **ask** the time, not demand it
- "je prends, je demande" — take, then ask
- the family — "mandate, command, mandatory" — a **hand** and a **giving**

Before you move on

Say "I ask the time." (*Je demande l'heure.*) Does *demander* carry the force of English *demand*? (**No** — it is the ordinary, polite word for asking.) What two Latin words are inside *mandāre*, and which one do you already know? (***Manus*** "hand" — the source of *la main* — plus ***dare***, "to give.")

28.3 aider — "to help," and the English word that is really the same word

You can ask for something now. This is the verb for what you hope the other person then does — and it is one of the rare cases where the English cousin is not a distant relative but the very same word, spelled shorter.

You'll want to know: the word

aider — to help. Said *ay-DAY*: the *ai-* is a plain *ay*, the *-er* ending is another *ay*. Two of them in a row.

Vous m'aidez. — You are helping me.

Another ordinary **-er** verb: *j'aide, tu aides, il aide, nous aidons, vous aidez, ils aident*. The *j'* is the elision you already make in *j'ai*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aider ← Latin **adiūtāre**, a repeated-action form of **adiuvāre** — *ad-* "toward" plus **iuvāre**, "**to help**." English took the same verb through French and clipped it:

- **aid** — the noun and verb; **aide**, a person who is your help.
- **aide-de-camp** — literally a "camp helper," an officer's assistant.
- **adjutant**, the officer who assists; **adjuvant**, a substance in medicine that helps another one work.

Two honesty notes. English **help** is **Germanic** and has no connection to *aider* whatsoever. And **juvenile** is *not* in this family: that is Latin *iuvenis*, "young," a different word that merely resembles *iuvāre*.

Grammar Lens: asking for it politely

Put the verb together with the courtesy you already have:

> **Vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît.** — Help me, please. **Tu m'aides, s'il te plaît.** — the same request, to a friend.

The register has to match on **both** halves. *Vous* takes *s'il vous plaît*; *tu* takes *s'il te plaît*. Mixing them — *tu m'aides, s'il vous plaît* — is the mistake a beginner makes most, and a French ear catches it instantly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "aider" — *ay-DAY*, two *ay* sounds
- "j'aide" then "vous aidez"
- "vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît" — both halves formal
- "tu m'aides, s'il te plaît" — both halves familiar
- "je demande, vous aidez" — I ask, you help

Before you move on

Ask a stranger for help, politely. (*Vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît.*) And a friend? (*Tu m'aides, s'il te plaît* — both halves change together.) What Latin verb is *aider* from, and which English word is the same word? (**Adiūtāre**; English **aid**.) Is English *help* related? (**No** — it is Germanic, unrelated.)

28.4 aimer — one verb for "like" and "love," and the word that weakens it

Three verbs so far: *je prends*, *je demande*, *j'aide*. The fourth does a job English needs **two** words for — and the way you soften it is the opposite of what you would guess.

You'll want to know: the word

> **aimer** — to like **and** to love. Said *ay-MAY*: the *ai-* is *ay*, the *-mer* is *may*.
>
> **J'aime le chien.** — I like the dog. **J'aime le chat.** — I like the cat.

An ordinary **-er** verb: *j'aime, tu aimes, il aime, nous aimons, vous aimez, ils aiment*. French does not choose between "like" and "love" — the **thing you name** does. A dog, a colour, a food: that reads as *like*. A person: *love*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aimer ← Latin **amāre**, "to love," and English is full of it:

- **amateur** — one who does a thing **for love**, not for money.
- **amorous**, full of love; **enamoured**, in it; **paramour**, beside it.
- **amiable** and **amicable** — from *amīcus*, "friend"; **amity** between nations.

An honest stop, though: unlike *viridis* behind **vert**, *amāre* has **no agreed ancestor** beyond Latin. It is often guessed to be a nursery word, a baby's *amma*, but that is a guess. The trail genuinely ends at Latin.

Why it's said this way

> **Je t'aime.** — I love you. Full strength. **Je t'aime bien.** — I like you. **Much** weaker.

Every English speaker gets this backwards. *Bien* means "well," so *je t'aime bien* looks like it ought to be **more**. It is **less**. Adding *bien* downgrades love to friendly liking, which is exactly why *je t'aime bien* is the polite way to turn someone down.
With a thing, no such danger: *j'aime bien le chat* is simply "I quite like the cat." The trap only bites when the object is a **person**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "j'aime le chien" then "j'aime le chat" — liking, because they are animals
- "j'aime le vert" — I like green
- "je t'aime" then "je t'aime bien" — love, then only liking
- the four verbs — "je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime"
- "vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît" — the request, once more
- "aimer, amateur, amiable" — the *amāre* family, which stops at Latin

Before you move on

Which is stronger, *je t'aime* or *je t'aime bien*? (***Je t'aime*** — *bien* makes it **weaker**.) Say "I like the dog" and "I like green." (*J'aime le chien. J'aime le vert.*) What does *amateur* literally mean, and how far back does *amāre* go? (One who does it **for love**; the trail **stops at Latin**.) Say the chapter's four verbs with *je*. (*Je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime.*)

Chapter 29

Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I understand, think, read and write in French, and take comprendre apart into com- plus prendre — so understanding, in French, is grasping.
>
> *Say the chapter's four with je — je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris — and take écrire apart into scrībere 'to scratch' plus the propped-up é- that also made école and étoile. Reaches back past the chapter to la main and manus from Chapter 17, which meet écrire inside the single word manuscript, and to prendre and aimer from Chapter 24.*

29.1 comprendre — "to understand," which is just taking, together

This is the cheapest verb you will ever learn, because you already own all of it. *Prendre* was "to take." Put *com-* in front, and French tells you what it thinks understanding actually is.

You'll want to know: the word

comprendre — to understand. Said *kohn-PRAHN-druh*: two nasals in a row, *kohn* then *prahn*.

Je comprends. — I understand. **Vous comprenez ?** — Do you understand?

The *-ds* of *je comprends* is silent, exactly as in *je prends*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comprendre is **com-** ("together, with") + **prendre** ("to take"), and Latin had already built it: **comprehendere**, "to grasp several things at once." Nothing has been added since. To understand, in French, is to **get your hand around the whole of it**.
English took the long Latin form and the short French one both:

- **comprehend** — the full Latin spelling, straight through.
- **comprehensive** — having taken everything in; **comprehension**.
- **comprise** — from French *compris*, "taken together": what a thing takes in.

And you can hear the metaphor still alive in English: we say we **grasp** an idea, or that a point is **over our heads** — out of reach of the hand.

Grammar Lens: the same verb, so the same forms

Because *comprendre* **is** *prendre* with a prefix, it breaks in exactly the same places. Nothing new to memorise — say the six and hear the nasal die in the plural, just as before:

- **je comprends** — *kohn-PRAHN*
- **tu comprends** — *kohn-PRAHN*
- **il comprend** — *kohn-PRAHN* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous comprenons** — *kohn-pruh-NOHN*, nasal gone from the stem
- **vous comprenez** — *kohn-pruh-NAY*
- **ils comprennent** — *kohn-PREN*, the doubled *n* again

This is worth more than one verb. Every French verb built on *prendre* behaves this way, so the pattern you drilled once now pays out repeatedly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je prends" then "je comprends" — the second is the first, plus *com-*
- "nous prenons, nous comprenons" — both lose the nasal
- "vous comprenez ?" then answer "oui" and then "non"
- "comprendre, comprehend, comprise" — one family, two spellings

Before you move on

What two pieces is *comprendre* made of, and what does the whole literally mean? (*Com-* "together" + *prendre* "to take" — **to take together**.) Say "we understand." (*Nous comprenons* — nasal gone, like *nous prenons*.) Someone asks *vous comprenez ?* — give both possible answers. (***Oui*** or ***non***.)

29.2 penser — "to think," which began as weighing

Understanding, you saw with *comprendre*, is grasping. This verb says thinking is **weighing** — and once you know that, half a dozen English words you use in money and medicine suddenly line up behind it.

You'll want to know: the word

penser — to think. Said *pahn-SAY*: the *-en-* is the nasal you have been making since *prendre*, and *-er* is a clean *ay*.

Je pense. — I think. **Vous pensez ?** — Do you think so?

A completely regular **-er** verb after the strain of *comprendre*: *je pense, tu penses, il pense, nous pensons, vous pensez, ils pensent*. Four of the six sound identical — *pahns* — and only *nous* and *vous* stand out.

Sounds you'll need

Two nasals sit close together in French and beginners flatten them into one. Hold them apart by saying them back to back:

- **non** — the **-on** nasal, rounded, lips pushed forward.
- **pense** — the **-en** nasal, unrounded, mouth wider and flatter.

Same trick every time: your **lips** tell the two apart, not your tongue.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

penser ← Latin **pēnsāre**, "to weigh carefully," a repeated-action form of **pendere**, "to weigh, to hang." Roman weighing was done by hanging things from a balance, which is why one root covers both. English inherited the whole scale:

- **pensive** — weighing something in your mind.
- **compensate** — to weigh one thing **against** another until they balance; **expense** and **expend**, money **weighed out**; **dispense**, weighed apart.
- **pension** — originally a weighing-out, a payment; **poise**, a balance held.
- **suspend** and **pendant** — the hanging half of the same root.

The prettiest cousin is a flower. French **pensée** means "**a thought**" — and English borrowed it, sound and all, as **pansy**.
One honest note: English **think** is **Germanic** and is not related to any of this. The two words mean the same thing and share no history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "penser" — *pahn-SAY*
- "non, pense" — the round nasal, then the flat one
- "je pense" then "je comprends" — I think, I understand

- "penser, pensive, compensate, pansy" — all a **weighing**

Before you move on

Say "I think" and "do you think so." (*Je pense. Vous pensez ?*) What did Latin *pēnsāre* mean, and name three English cousins. (**To weigh** — *pensive, compensate, expense, pension, poise.*) What flower is French for "a thought"? (The **pansy**, from *pensée.*) Which of *non* and *pense* has the rounded lips? (***Non*** — *pense* is flat and wide.)

29.3 lire — "to read," which used to mean "to pick up"

A short word with an enormous family behind it. Before *lire* meant reading, its Latin ancestor meant **gathering** — and that older sense is why a dozen English words that seem unrelated turn out to be relatives.

You'll want to know: the word

lire — to read. Said *leer*, with the throaty French **r** at the end.

Je lis le français. — I read French.

Lire is irregular, and its stem grows an **s** in the plural. Say the six:

- **je lis** — *lee*, the *-s* silent
- **tu lis** — *lee*
- **il lit** — *lee* (three identical again)
- **nous lisons** — *lee-ZOHN*, and there is the *s*
- **vous lisez** — *lee-ZAY*
- **ils lisent** — *LEEZ*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lire ← Latin **legere**, whose first meaning was "**to gather, to pick out**." Reading was a later use of it: your eye picks the letters up off the page one after another. Both senses left English words behind. The reading half:

- **legible**, able to be picked out; **lecture**, "a reading"; **lesson**, from *lectiō*, the passage read aloud.
- **legend** — literally "**things which must be read**."

The gathering half, which is the surprise:

- **collect** — gather together; **select**, gather apart; **elect**, pick out; **neglect**, fail to pick up at all.
- **elegant** — originally "choosy," someone who picks well; **diligent**; **intellect**, what picks between things.

One honest limit. Greek's **legein** — the *-logy* in every science name — is a **cousin**, not a parent: it descends from the same ancient root alongside Latin *legere*, rather than from it. And French **le livre**, "book," is not in this family at all; that is Latin *liber*, a separate word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "lire" — *leer*, throaty *r*
- *Say it:* "je lis" then "nous lisons" — the *s* appears
- *Read aloud, gathering the words one by one:* "le chien, le chat"
- *Say it:* "je lis le français" then "je pense"
- *Say it:* "legible, lecture, collect, elect, elegant" — all a **picking out**

Before you move on

Say "I read French" and "we read." (*Je lis le français. Nous lisons* — the *s* only appears in the plural.) What did Latin *legere* mean first? (**To gather, to pick out** — reading came second.) Which of *collect*, *elegant* and *book* is **not** in this family? (**Book** — French

livre is from *liber*, a different word.) Now say these two aloud. (*Le chien, le chat.*)

29.4 écrire — "to write," born from a scratch

You can think, understand and read. The last of the four is the one that puts something back out — and its French spelling still carries a repair job the language did more than a thousand years ago.

You'll want to know: the word

écrire — to write. Said *ay-KREER*: the *é* is a sharp *ay*, then the throaty **r** at the end, as in *lire*.

J'écris le français. — I write French.

Irregular, and the stem grows a **v** in the plural:

- **j'écris** — *ay-KREE*
- **tu écris** — *ay-KREE*
- **il écrit** — *ay-KREE*
- **nous écrivons** — *ay-kree-VOHN*, and there is the *v*
- **vous écrivez** — *ay-kree-VAY*
- **ils écrivent** — *ay-KREEV*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écrire ← Latin **scrībere**, "**to scratch, to incise**." A Roman wrote by scratching a stylus across wax, and the verb never forgot it. English took the Latin form whole:

- **scribe**, **script**, **scripture**, **scribble**.
- **describe** — scratch it down; **prescribe**, **subscribe**, **inscribe**.

Now the *é*. Latin *scrībere* began with **sc-**, and a French-speaking mouth could not start a word that way, so it propped one up with a

vowel in front: *scrībere* → *escrire* → **écrire**. The same repair ran through the whole language — *schola* became *école*, *spatha* became *épée*, *stella* became *étoile*. That accent is not decoration: it is standing where an *s* used to be.
And the best cousin belongs to both halves of this chapter. **Manuscript** is *manus* + *scrībere* — "**scratched by hand**." **La main** and *écrire* meet inside one English word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "écrire" — *ay-KREER*
- "j'écris" then "nous écrivons" — the *v* appears in the plural
- the four of this chapter — "je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris"
- "j'écris à la main" — I write by hand; that is *manuscript*, taken apart
- "j'aime lire" then "j'aime écrire" — I like reading, I like writing
- "je prends le pain, et j'écris" — the taking verb, still there
- "lire, écrire" — gathering off the page, scratching onto it

Before you move on

Say "I write" and "we write." (*J'écris. Nous écrivons* — the *v* arrives in the plural.) What did *scrībere* literally mean, and why does *écrire* start with an *é*? (**To scratch**; French propped a vowel in front of Latin's *sc-*, the same repair that made *école* and *étoile*.) Pull *manuscript* apart. (*Manus* "**hand**" — your *la main* — plus *scrībere*, "scratched": **written by hand**.) Now say the four verbs of this chapter with *je*. (*Je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris*.)

Chapter 30

Hearing, Sleeping, Walking, Running

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I hear, sleep, walk and run in French, use ça marche for "that works," and say why entendre carries English's intend inside it while the Latin verb for hearing ended up in English instead.
>
> *Run the chapter's four verbs together with je — j'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours — then use courir's spelling to settle why canis became chien while currere stayed hard at the front: the ca- shift only ever struck c before a. Reaches back past the chapter to le chien and its palatalization from Chapter 22, le chat from the same chapter, il fait chaud and il pleut from Chapter 21, and the ne … pas negation from Chapter 18.*

30.1 entendre — "to hear," and the stretching inside it

You can think and understand. Now the ear — and French's word for it is English's *intend*.

You'll want to know: the word

entendre — to hear. Two nasal *an* sounds in a row, then the *-dre* of *prendre*: say it *ahn-TAHN-druh*.

J'entends le chien. — I hear the dog.

The *-ds* of *j'entends* is silent, as in *je prends*.

Grammar Lens: the nasal that stays put

Prendre's nasal dies in the plural. *Entendre* looks like its twin and does the opposite — the stem never moves:

- **j'entends** — *jahn-TAHN*
- **tu entends** — *ahn-TAHN*
- **il entend** — *ahn-TAHN* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous entendons** — *ahn-tahn-DOHN*, nasal still there
- **vous entendez** — *ahn-tahn-DAY*
- **ils entendent** — *ahn-TAHND*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entendre ← Latin **intendere** — **in-** "toward" plus **tendere**, "**to stretch**." To *intendere* was to stretch a thing out and aim it: a bowstring, a journey, your attention. English kept the family — **intend**, plainest of them, plus **intent**, **intense**, **tension**, a **tent** (a stretched skin), **extend** and **pretend**.
Set your three mind-verbs together: French pictures each as a different thing the body does.

- **comprendre** — to **grasp together**, built on *prendre*.
- **penser** — to **weigh**, from *pēnsāre*.
- **entendre** — to **stretch toward**.

Why it's said this way

From its oldest French records *entendre* already covers a span at once: to hear, to attend, to understand, to intend. Nothing arrived late. What happened since is that the other senses fell away and hearing took the word outright — because Latin's verb for hearing, **audīre**, wore down in French to *ouïr* and stopped being usable. English kept that family instead: **audio**, **audience**, **audible**, **audition**.
The abandoned senses survive in phrases French never rebuilt:

- **entendu** — "understood," "agreed."
- **s'entendre** — to hear one another, and so to **get along**.
- **l'entente** — an understanding between parties, borrowed into English whole in *Entente Cordiale*.

So the two languages split one Latin pair: French hears with the verb English uses for intending, and English hears with the verb French let go.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "entendre" — *ahn-TAHN-druh*, two nasals
- "j'entends le chien"
- "nous prenons" then "nous entendons" — one flattens, one holds
- "j'écris, je comprends, j'entends"
- the three pictures — stretching, grasping, weighing
- "intend, tension, tent" — all a stretching

Before you move on

Say "I hear the dog" and "we hear." (*J'entends le chien. Nous entendons* — and unlike *nous prenons*, nothing flattens.) What did *intendere* mean, and which English verb is its plainest survival? (**To stretch toward**; **intend**.) Why did French hand hearing to this verb? (Latin's *audīre* wore down to *ouïr* and fell out of use — English kept the *audīre* words instead.) What does *s'entendre* mean? (**To get along**.)

30.2 dormir — "to sleep," and the room named after it

After a verb that changed jobs, here is one that never changed. *Dormir* is Latin's word for sleeping, handed on almost untouched — and it hides one trap.

You'll want to know: the word

dormir — to sleep. Said *dor-MEER*, with the throaty French **r** in the middle and at the end.

Le chat dort. — The cat is sleeping.

French has no separate "is sleeping" form. *Il dort* covers both "he sleeps" and "he is sleeping"; the plain present does all the work.

Grammar Lens: the m that goes missing

The stem is *dorm-*, and in the singular French throws the **m** away. Listen for where it comes back:

- **je dors** — *dor*
- **tu dors** — *dor*
- **il dort** — *dor* (three identical, the *m* gone)
- **nous dormons** — *dor-MOHN*, and there it is
- **vous dormez** — *dor-MAY*
- **ils dorment** — *DORM*

One rule, and you have the whole verb: singular loses the last stem consonant, plural gets it back. A small family of *-ir* verbs shares the shape, so learning it once is worth more than one verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dormir ← Latin **dormīre**, "to sleep." Spanish kept *dormir*, Italian *dormire*, Portuguese *dormir* — the verb crossed into its daughter languages untouched, which is rarer than it sounds. English has no inherited descendant; it borrowed the family later, through French:

- **dormitory** ← *dormītōrium*, a sleeping place; French wore the identical word down to **dortoir**.
- **dormant** — Old French *dormant*, "sleeping"; a dormant volcano is asleep.
- **dormer** — a roof window, from Old French *dormeor*, because

the room behind it was where you slept.

And an honest stop. The **dormouse** looks like the best cousin of the lot and is not one. The story needs an Anglo-Norman word for "sleeper" that nobody has found in a text, and *dormouse*'s real origin is unknown. A guess in circulation, not an etymology.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dormir" — *dor-MEER*, throaty *r*
- "je dors" then "nous dormons" — the *m* vanishes, then returns
- "le chat dort" — the cat, the travelling word out of Egypt
- "j'entends le chat" then "le chat dort"
- "dormir, dormitory, dormant" — one Latin verb, borrowed back
- "je comprends" then "je dors"

Before you move on

Say "the cat is sleeping" and "we sleep." (*Le chat dort. Nous dormons* — the *m* is silent in the singular and audible in the plural.) Where does *dormitory* come from? (Latin *dormītōrium*, "a **sleeping place**" — and French wore the same word down to *dortoir*.) Is the **dormouse** in this family? (**No** — that is folk etymology; the word's real origin is unknown.) And *chat* — an inherited Latin word, or a traveller? (**A traveller**, from *cattus*, moving with the cat itself out of Egypt.)

30.3 marcher — "to walk," and the step hiding inside French negation

You can hear and you can sleep. Now move. This verb does a second job too, used dozens of times a day.

You'll want to know: the word

marcher — to walk. Said *mar-SHAY*: the *-er* is a clean *ay*, and the *ch* is *sh*, never *k*.

Je marche. — I walk.

After *dormir*'s vanishing *m*, this one asks nothing: an ordinary **-er** verb. *Je marche, tu marches, il marche, nous marchons, vous marchez, ils marchent* — four of the six sound identical, just *marsh*.

Why it's said this way

Marcher is also the everyday verb for a thing **working**. A machine, a plan, an arrangement: if it functions, it walks.

Ça marche. — "That works." Also "Fine," "Deal," "Sounds good." **Ça ne marche pas.** — "That doesn't work."

There is your *ne … pas* from the answer-word *non*, round a real verb at last. And *ça marche* alone is an agreement, two words long. *Entendre* once held several jobs and shed all but hearing. *Marcher* holds two right now.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Here the honest answer is that nobody is certain. Old French *marchier* first meant "**to trample, to tread on**," and two accounts compete:

- Frankish **markōn**, "to mark, to press a step in" — preferred by most reference works.
- Late Latin *marcāre*, from **marcus**, "**a hammer**" — a blow and a tread being one motion.

Three consequences, in falling order of certainty:

- English **march**, the verb, is borrowed straight **from** *marcher*. Secure whichever origin is right.
- English **mark** is Germanic, from Old English *mearc*. A relative **only if** the Frankish account holds — conditional, not a fact.

- French **la marche**, a borderland, with **marquis** and German **margrave**, comes from the Germanic **noun** *marka*, "boundary" — a separate arrival.

And one cousin you own already. The **pas** in *ne … pas* began as Latin *passus*, "**a step**." *Je ne marche pas* is, underneath, "I do not walk a step."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "marcher" — *mar-SHAY*, *sh* not *k*
- "je marche" then "nous marchons"
- "ça marche" — that works, that's fine
- "non", then "je ne marche pas" — and *pas* is a **step**
- "j'entends, je dors, je marche"
- "nous dormons, nous marchons" — one stem shifts, one never does

Before you move on

Say "I walk" and "that works." (*Je marche. Ça marche.*) What are the two competing origins? (Frankish **markōn**, ***"to press a step in," or Latin*** **marcus**, ***"a hammer." Genuinely unsettled.) Which English word is certainly related, and which only might be? (March, borrowed straight from*** **marcher**; ***mark only if the Frankish account is right.) What did*** **pas** ***mean before it meant "not"? (A step.)***

30.4 courir — "to run," and why it is not *chourir*

Hearing, sleeping, walking — and now the fastest of the four. Its Latin root is one of the busiest in English, and its spelling settles a question the dog raised.

You'll want to know: the word

courir — to run. Said *koo-REER*, throaty at both *r*s.

Le chien court. — The dog runs.

Grammar Lens: the same endings, a different stem

Courir takes *dormir*'s singular endings — **-s, -s, -t**, all silent:

- **je cours** — *koor*
- **tu cours** — *koor*
- **il court** — *koor*
- **nous courons** — *koo-ROHN*
- **vous courez** — *koo-RAY*
- **ils courent** — *KOOR*

But the resemblance stops there. *Dormir* **sheds** a consonant in the singular: *dorm-* becomes *dor-*. *Courir* sheds nothing — its stem *cour-* has nothing spare to lose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Marcher left a choice between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer. This one leaves none. **courir** ← Latin **currere**, "to run," which English mined harder than almost any other verb:

- **current** and **currency** both run; a **cursor** runs across a screen; a **course** is a run, a **corridor** a running-place.
- **courier**, one who runs; **curriculum**, literally "**a running**."
- **concur**, run together; **occur**, run up against; **excursion**.

Now the spelling question. *Chien* came from *canis*, and its **c** turned into **ch** — the shift that made *champ* and *chanter*. So why is this verb not *chourir*? Because that shift only struck **c** before **a**. *Currere* had **c** before **u**, untouched, so the *k* survived. One rule, two regular outcomes. One honest limit. Latin **carrus**, "wagon," gave English **car** and **cargo**, and descends from the same very old root. But Latin borrowed

carrus from Gaulish: a cousin by another road, not a word built out of *currere*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the chapter's four with *je* — "j'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours"
- "le chien court" then "le chat dort"
- "il fait chaud, je cours"
- "il pleut, je ne cours pas"
- "je dors, nous dormons" then "je cours, nous courons" — one sheds
- "chien" then "courir" — *ch* before *a*, *k* before *u*
- "current, course, courier, curriculum" — every one a running
- "ça marche" — the agreement, two words

Before you move on

Say the chapter's four verbs with *je*. (*J'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours.*) What does **curriculum** literally mean? (**A running** — from *currere*.) Why did *canis* become *chien* while *currere* stayed hard? (The shift only hit **c** before **a**.) Which of the four began as a **stretching**? (***Entendre*** — *intendere*, to stretch toward.) Now: "the dog runs" and "it is hot." (*Le chien court. Il fait chaud.*)

Chapter 31

Sitting, Standing, Opening, Closing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can sit down, get up, open and close in French, hold both accepted paradigms of s'asseoir apart, say why French needs two pieces — se lever and debout — where English has one verb "to stand," and know that ouvrir takes marcher's endings despite its -ir spelling.
>
> *Say the chapter's four with je — je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme — drill ouvrir and fermer as one pair now that both carry the same endings, and take fermer apart into firmāre, 'to make firm', the verb that gave Italian fermare 'to stop' and Spanish firmar 'to sign'. Reaches back past the chapter to open and close la main from Chapter 17, to close because il pleut from Chapter 21, and to ask in both registers and then apologise, from Chapters 19 and 20.*

31.1 s'asseoir — "to sit down," a verb you do to yourself

You have walked and you have run. Now stop. French does not say "I sit" — it says "**I seat myself**," and that extra word is one you own.

You'll want to know: the word

s'asseoir — to sit down. Said *sah-SWAHR*.

Je m'assieds. — I sit down. Said *juh mah-SYAY.*

The **m'** is the *me* inside *je m'appelle*: French treats sitting as something you do **to yourself**, so the pronoun is not optional.

Keep two ideas apart. *S'asseoir* is the **movement**, lowering yourself into a chair. **Je suis assis** is the **state** after it, "I am seated." English lets *sit* cover both; French makes you choose.

Grammar Lens: one verb, two accepted sets

The only verb in this book with **two** correct answers, both in dictionaries. Learn this series whole:

- **je m'assieds** — *mah-SYAY*
- **tu t'assieds** — *tah-SYAY*
- **il s'assied** — *sah-SYAY* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous nous asseyons** — *noo-zah-say-YOHN*
- **vous vous asseyez** — *voo-zah-say-YAY*
- **ils s'asseyent** — *sah-SAY*

Then recognise the rival singulars **je m'assois, tu t'assois, il s'assoit** — ordinary spoken French. Their plurals (*assoyons, assoyez*) are much rarer in France, so the series above is the safer one to own. Since 1990 the infinitive may also be spelled **s'assoir**. Nothing here is wrong; the language never chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'asseoir ← Vulgar Latin **adsedēre**, a remaking of Classical **adsidēre** — **ad-** "at" plus **sedēre**, "**to sit**." Latin had built the compound; French only wore it down. And *sedēre* is everywhere in English:

- **sedentary**, sitting work; a **session**, "a sitting"; **sediment**, what sits at the bottom.
- **reside**, sit back; **preside** and **president**, sitting in front; **assiduous**, sitting at a task.
- **siege** — an army sitting down before a city; **possess**, **obsess**,

subsidy.

- A bishop's **see** is his *sedēs*, his **seat**.

Dormir English only borrowed. This root it owns from birth too: **sit**, **seat** and **settle** come down the Germanic road from the same source.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "s'asseoir" — *sah-SWAHR*
- "je m'assieds" then "nous nous asseyons"
- "je m'appelle" then "je m'assieds" — the same little *m'*
- "je m'assieds" then "je suis assis" — movement, then state
- "je marche, je cours, je m'assieds, je dors"
- "j'entends" — the ear needs no chair
- "sedentary, session, siege" — every one a sitting

Before you move on

Say "I sit down" and "we sit down." (*Je m'assieds. Nous nous asseyons.*) Why is the pronoun there? (French sits you **yourself** down — the same *m'* as in *je m'appelle.*) What is a **siege**, literally? (**A sitting** — an army sitting down before a city.) Which English words are cousins of *sedēre* by birth rather than borrowing? (**Sit**, **seat**, **settle**.) Now the pair: "je cours" and "je dors."

31.2 se lever, debout — standing, which French says in two pieces

You sat down. Getting up is harder, because French has **no single verb** for "to stand." It splits the idea in two.

You'll want to know: the movement

se lever — to get up, to rise. Said *suh luh-VAY*.

Je me lève. — I get up. Said *juh muh LEV*.

Reflexive, as *s'asseoir* is: you raise **yourself**. After that verb's two paradigms this is a relief — an ordinary **-er** verb with one habit. Silent ending, and the *e* takes a **grave accent**; spoken ending, and it flattens:

- **je me lève** — *LEV*
- **tu te lèves** — *LEV*
- **il se lève** — *LEV*
- **nous nous levons** — *luh-VOHN*, flat
- **vous vous levez** — *luh-VAY*, flat
- **ils se lèvent** — *LEV*

You'll want to know: the state

debout — standing, upright. Said *duh-BOO*.

Je suis debout. — I am standing.

Se lever is the **movement**, *debout* the **state** — the split between sitting down and being seated. *Debout* is no verb: attach it to *être*.

Opened, it is transparent:

de + bout → debout

"**On end**": a *bout* is a tip or end, so standing is being set on your end. French did once have a plain verb for standing, *ester*; it survives only in a courtroom phrase, which is why the language builds this from pieces.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lever ← Latin **levāre**, "to raise" — built on **levis**, "**light in weight**." To raise a thing is to lighten it. Hence **elevate**, **elevator**, **levitate**, **levity**; a **lever**, which lightens a load; **alleviate**, **relieve**, **relief**; **leaven**.

So two of this book's verbs come from one corner of Roman thought. *Penser* is *pēnsāre*, "**to weigh**"; *lever* is *levāre*, "to make **light**."

Thinking weighs, rising un-weighs, and *sedēre* just sits there. One correction. **Bout** comes from *bouter*, "to strike," taken from Frankish — and its English relative by **descent** is **beat**. *Butt* looks closer but is a later **borrowing** back out of French.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "se lever" — *suh luh-VAY*
- "je me lève" then "nous nous levons" — sharp, then flat
- "je m'assieds" then "je me lève" — down, then up
- "je suis debout" — the state, on *être*
- "je me lève et je cours"
- "je pense" then "je me lève" — weighing, then lightening
- "elevate, lever, relief" — all a raising

Before you move on

Say "I get up" and "we get up." (*Je me lève. Nous nous levons* — the accent appears only when the ending is silent.) How does French say "I am standing"? (***Je suis debout*** — a state pinned to *être*, not a verb; *debout* is "**on end**.") *Penser* came from weighing; what does *lever* come from? (***Levis***, "**light in weight**".) And the opposite movement? (*Je m'assieds.*)

31.3 ouvrir — "to open," an -ir verb wearing -er endings

You can sit and rise. Now something for the hand. This verb is French conjugation's small trap: spelled like one family, behaving like another.

You'll want to know: the word

ouvrir — to open. Said *oo-VREER*.

J'ouvre la main. — I open my hand.

French says *la main* where English says "my hand"; with your own body the article does the work. And listen to that nasal — *pain*, *main* — the same *-ain* you have been making since the bread.

Grammar Lens: the endings it should not have

Ouvrir ends in **-ir**, so you would expect it to run like *dormir*. It does not. It takes the endings of **marcher**, an *-er* verb, exactly:

- **j'ouvre** — *JOOVR*
- **tu ouvres** — *OOVR*
- **il ouvre** — *OOVR*
- **nous ouvrons** — *oo-VROHN*
- **vous ouvrez** — *oo-VRAY*
- **ils ouvrent** — *OOVR*

Four identical to the ear, *nous* and *vous* audible: the shape of *je marche, nous marchons*. A small group of *-ir* verbs does this, and *ouvrir* is the one you meet most. The spelling promises one thing; listen to what the verb does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin's verb for opening was **aperīre**, which *ouvrir* does not look much like — because the word was remodelled on the way into popular Latin **operīre**. The likeliest cause is the pull of its own opposite, *cooperīre*, "to cover," which became French **couvrir**. Opening and covering ended up rhyming and have stayed matched since. The meaning stayed *aperīre*'s; only the shape moved.
English collected both ends:

- from *aperīre* — an **aperture**; an **aperitif**, the drink that **opens** a meal.

- from Old French *ovrir* — **overt**, its past participle "opened," and **overture**, *ouverture*.
- from the covering half — **curfew**, Old French *cuevrefeu*, "**cover-fire**," the bell that said to bank the hearth.

Set that beside the hand. *Maintenir* is *manū tenēre*, "**to hold in the hand**" — and *ouvrir la main* releases that grip.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ouvrir" — *oo-VREER*
- "j'ouvre la main" — and hear *pain*, *main*
- "je marche, nous marchons" then "j'ouvre, nous ouvrons" — one shape
- "je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre la main"
- "je suis debout et j'ouvre la main"
- "maintenir" then "ouvrir" — holding in the hand, then letting go
- "aperture, aperitif, overt, overture" — every one an opening

Before you move on

Say "I open my hand" and "we open." (*J'ouvre la main. Nous ouvrons.*) Which endings does *ouvrir* borrow, despite its spelling? (The **-er** set — *marcher*'s.) What is an **aperitif**, literally? (**The opener** — the drink that opens a meal.) Why does *ouvrir* not look like Latin *aperīre*? (It was **reshaped** to match its own opposite, the verb for covering.)

31.4 fermer — "to close," which in French means "to make firm"

The last of the four, and the opposite of the one before it. French chose an unexpected picture: to close a thing is to make it **firm**.

You'll want to know: the word

fermer — to close. Said *fer-MAY*.

Je ferme la main. — I close my hand. **Il pleut. Je ferme.** — It's raining. I'm closing up.

A regular **-er** verb: *je ferme, tu fermes, il ferme, nous fermons, vous fermez, ils ferment.*

Grammar Lens: two opposites, one set of endings

Ouvrir borrowed the *-er* endings against its own spelling. *Fermer* owns them outright. So the two opposites conjugate in step, and drill as one pair:

- **j'ouvre / je ferme**
- **nous ouvrons / nous fermons**
- **ils ouvrent / ils ferment**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fermer ← Latin **firmāre**, "to make firm," from **firmus**, "**firm**." A Roman door was not closed, it was **secured**. English took the adjective and left the verb: **firm**, **affirm**, **confirm**, **infirm** and the **infirmary**, the **firmament** — the sky as a solid vault.
Probably also **farm**. Old French *ferme* meant a **fixed rent**, from Medieval Latin *firma*, "a fixed payment," so a farm began as a lease and not a field. Etymologists call this history a confused one, because Old English *feorm*, "food-rent," sat nearby and may have pulled on it. Likely, not clean.
The best part is the split. One Latin verb, three languages, three jobs:

- French **fermer** — to **close**.
- Italian **fermare** — to **stop**.
- Spanish **firmar** — to **sign**, because a signature makes a paper firm.

And Spanish and Portuguese do not close with this verb at all. Their words come from Latin's **bolt**. So French shuts a door by making it solid while its neighbours slide a bar across.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "fermer" — *fer-MAY*
- "j'ouvre la main" then "je ferme la main"
- the chapter's four — "je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme"
- "je suis debout et je ferme"
- "il pleut, je ferme"
- "vous fermez, s'il vous plaît" then "tu fermes, s'il te plaît" — formal, then familiar
- "je suis désolé, je ferme" — the apology before the refusal
- "fermer, firm, affirm, confirm" — all a making-firm

Before you move on

Say the chapter's four with *je*. (*Je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme.*) What did *firmāre* mean, and what is a French door doing when it closes? (**Making firm** — being **secured**, not barred.) One Latin verb, three languages: Italian and Spanish? (*Fermare*, "to **stop**"; *firmar*, "to **sign**".) Now close politely in both registers, then apologise. (*Vous fermez, s'il vous plaît. Tu fermes, s'il te plaît. Je suis désolé.*) And the hand? (*J'ouvre la main, je ferme la main.*)

Chapter 32

Coffee, Tea, Milk, Sugar

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for coffee, tea, milk or sugar in French, and trace each word to the road it travelled to get there — one unbroken, one forked, one never borrowed, one from Sanskrit.
>
> *Ask for sugar, trace sucre to Sanskrit śárkarā through Arabic sukkar, and set the chapter's four masculine drink-words beside l'eau's lone feminine exception. Reaches back past the chapter to Chapter 18's si, the answer that contradicts a negative, and to the langue d'oïl / langue d'oc split behind oui itself.*

32.1 le café — coffee, one word the whole road agrees on

First, two words from the last chapter, taken apart. *Se lever* is built on a Latin word for what? (***Levis***, **light** — rising unweighs you, as in *elevate*.) And a Roman door was not closed, it was made what? (**Firm** — *firmāre*, the root of *confirm*.)

You already know how to ask nicely — **s'il vous plaît**. Now something worth asking for: the first of four everyday words for what's on the table.

You'll want to know: the word

le café — coffee. **Masculine**.

> **Un café, s'il vous plaît.** — "A coffee, please."

Café also names the **place** you drink it, exactly the way English *cafe* does — one word, two jobs, in both languages at once.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

café comes from Ottoman Turkish **kahve**, which comes from Arabic **qahwa**. Arabic lexicographers record *qahwa* as an older word for **wine** — it only attached to the coffee bean once the drink spread out of Yemen, in the fifteenth century.
From Ottoman *kahve*, the word crossed into Europe through Italian **caffè** — and stopped there. French **café**, English **coffee**, German **Kaffee**, Italian **caffè** itself: every one of these is the *same* borrowing, taken at a different stop on a *single* road out of the Ottoman Empire. Nobody translated it; everybody just repeated it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le café" — masculine
- "un café, s'il vous plaît"
- the road — "qahwa, kahve, caffè, café" — one word, four stops
- the surprise — "qahwa once meant **wine**"

Before you move on

Say "coffee, please." (***Un café, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Arabic word is *café* from, and what did it mean before coffee existed? (***Qahwa*** — "**wine**.") Name the road it travelled. (**Arabic qahwa → Ottoman kahve → Italian caffè → French café**, with English *coffee* and German *Kaffee* the same borrowing at other stops.) Is *s'il vous plaît* the right register here? (**Yes** — spoken, to someone you don't know well.)

32.2 le thé — tea, the word that took the other road

You just saw *café* travel Europe as one word, unchanged at every stop. Tea took the opposite kind of trip — it **split**.

You'll want to know: the word

le thé — tea. **Masculine**.

> **Un thé, s'il vous plaît.** — "A tea, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

China writes "tea" with one character everywhere, but doesn't say it the same way everywhere. In Mandarin it's **chá**. In the **Hokkien** of the south-eastern coast — the Amoy dialect — it's **tê**.
Traders who bought the leaf overland or through Mandarin-speaking ports carried home **chá**: it travelled into Persian, into Arabic, into Hindi. Dutch traders bought their tea specifically at **Amoy**, in Hokkien territory, and carried home **tê** instead — which became Dutch **thee**, then French **thé**, English **tea**, German **Tee**.
So *café* and *thé* make a matched pair with opposite stories: *café* is one word repeated unchanged at every stop; *thé* is the *same original word*, worn into two different shapes depending which Chinese port a trader happened to deal with.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le thé" — masculine
- "un café, un thé" — both masculine, both borrowed
- the fork — "chá overland, tê by Dutch ship"
- the pair — "café: one road. thé: two."

Before you move on

Say "tea, please." (***Un thé, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Chinese dialect gave French *thé* its shape, and by what route? (**Hokkien tê**, carried by **Dutch** ships from the port of **Amoy**.) What's the overland word that *chá*-family languages use instead? (**Chá**, into **Persian, Arabic, Hindi**.) How is *thé*'s story different from *café*'s? (*Café* stayed **one word** everywhere; *thé* **split in two** depending on the port.)

32.3 le lait — milk, the word French never had to borrow

Café and *thé* both crossed an ocean to reach French. This word never left home.

Je m'assieds, tu t'assieds, il s'assied: three forms, one sound.

You'll want to know: the word

le lait — milk. **Masculine**, like *café* and *thé*.

Du lait, s'il vous plaît. — "Some milk, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lait comes from Latin ***lac*** (stem ***lact-***) — a word Latin-speakers in Gaul simply kept saying, generation after generation, until it wore down into *lait*. No port, no trade route: this one was **inherited**, not borrowed, unlike *café*'s single road or *thé*'s forked one.
English shows the same split *tête* showed for "head": the **inherited**, everyday English word for this drink is **milk** — and it has **nothing to do with** *lac*. *Milk* descends from a completely different Proto-Indo-European root, one meaning "to milk a cow." English only meets *lac*'s stem *lact-* in **learned** words borrowed straight from written Latin much later: **lactic**, **lactose**, **lactate**. So French *lait* and English *lactic* are close cousins; French *lait* and English *milk* are not related at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le lait" — masculine
- "un café, un thé, du lait" — three drinks, one gender
- the cousins — "lait, lactic, lactose"
- the non-cousins — "lait and milk share no root at all"

Before you move on

Say "milk, please." (***Du lait, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is *lait* borrowed, like *café* and *thé*, or inherited straight from Latin? (**Inherited** — from *lac*, stem *lact-*.) Which English words are close cousins of *lait*? (**Lactic, lactose, lactate** — learned borrowings of the same stem.) Is English *milk* one of those cousins? (**No** — a completely different, unrelated root.)

32.4 le sucre — sugar, the longest road of the four

Coffee took one road, tea forked into two, milk never left home. Sugar's road is the longest of all — and it ends the chapter with a whole table's worth of masculine drink-words.

You'll want to know: the word

le sucre — sugar. **Masculine.**

Du sucre, s'il vous plaît. — "Some sugar, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sucre ← Old French **çucre** ← Arabic **sukkar** ← Persian **shakar** ← Sanskrit **śárkarā**, which first meant "**grit, gravel**" — crystallized sugar looked like gravel to whoever named it first.
Sucre passed through Arabic just like *café* did, but through a **different** Arabic word (*sukkar*, not *qahwa*): a shared **language of transmission**, not a shared root. Where *lait* is inherited straight from Latin, *sucre* is borrowed — from **further back** than *café* or *thé*, all the way to Sanskrit.

Grammar Lens: a lean, and its one loud exception

Four drink-words, four **masculine** articles: *le café, le thé, le lait, le sucre*. Not a rule to trust — a lean: French tends to make plain substances masculine. This lean has a loud exception: **l'eau**, "water," is **feminine**. You still learn each word with its article, the promise this book has kept since *la main*.

Why it's said this way

The **si** you learned — the "yes" for contradicting a negative — fits this table exactly:

> **Vous n'avez pas le sucre ?** — ***Si !*** ("You don't have the sugar? — Yes, I do!")

Plain **oui** here would agree you *don't* have it; *si* is what pushes back. That same *oui* once mattered enough to **split a country** — *langue d'oïl* in the north, *langue d'oc* in the south.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le sucre" — masculine
- all four — "le café, le thé, le lait, le sucre"
- the exception — "l'eau" — feminine, against the lean
- the contradiction — "Vous n'avez pas le sucre ? — Si !"

Before you move on

Say "sugar, please." (***Du sucre, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Trace *sucre* back to Sanskrit. (**Sukkar** ← **shakar** ← **śárkarā**, "**grit, gravel**.") Do *café* and *sucre* share a root? (**No** — a language of transmission, Arabic, not a root; *qahwa* and *sukkar* are different words.) What is the lean about French drink-words, and what breaks it? (**Masculine by default** — broken by **l'eau**, feminine.) When do you answer **si** instead of **oui**? (**Contradicting a negative** — the same word-pair that once **split France** into *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc*.)

Chapter 33

The People You Introduce

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce a friend, name my family, name a child and name any person, using French's four different relationships between grammatical gender and the person meant, and elide le or la to l' before a vowel.
>
> *Say la personne, always feminine even naming a man, then line the chapter's four words up by how each one handles gender: l'ami changes, la famille is fixed, l'enfant is one spelling with two articles, la personne is fixed regardless of sex. Reaches back to Chapter 18's non for a sound contrast (personne's double -nn- blocks the nasal non has) and to its ne … pas negation, which personne itself joins as "nobody."*

33.1 l'ami, l'amie — the friend, and why the article gives way

> The café chapter handed you *le lait* and *le sucre*, and three more things to ask for. Now the people you'd ask them with — starting with the one whose name teaches French's most useful spelling rule.

You'll want to know: the word

un ami — a (male) friend. **un**e **amie** — a (female) friend. Same sound, *ah-MEE*; the feminine just adds a silent **-e**. A regular swap: the article and ending follow **who the friend is**.

Grammar Lens: why it's l'ami, not le ami

Say **le ami** out loud: two vowels collide, *euh* then *ah*, and French won't stand for it. So **le** and **la** both drop their vowel before a word that starts with one, and glue on with an apostrophe: **l'ami**, **l'amie** — one form for both genders once the article elides. This is the *exact* same move as *l'eau* — French never tolerates *le* or *la* sitting next to another vowel sound. It also happens to a pronoun you already use daily: *je ai* became **j'ai** by the identical rule.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ami ← Latin **amicus**, "**friend**" — built on the verb **amāre**, "to love." English kept the adjective whole in **amicable**, **amiable**, and **amity** ("friendship" between nations). A French *ami* is, at the root, someone you **love**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un ami, une amie" — the regular swap
- "l'ami, l'amie" — never *le ami*
- the family — "l'eau, j'ai, l'ami" — one rule, three words
- "amicable, amiable, amity" — all built on **amāre**, to love

Before you move on

Give "a friend" for a man and for a woman. (**un ami, une amie**.) Why do you say *l'ami* instead of *le ami*? (**Two vowels can't sit together** — the article **elides**, the same rule behind *l'eau* and *j'ai*.) What Latin verb is *ami* built on, and what does it mean? (**Amāre**, "**to love**.")

33.2 la famille — the family, feminine no matter who's in it

L'ami changes shape with who it names. This word never does — whoever is in the family, the word itself stays exactly as it

is. (And before you had *l'ami*, you already had *le sucre* — every one of this book's nouns keeps its article.)

You'll want to know: the word

la famille — the family. **Feminine**, fixed — no elision here, since *famille* starts with a consonant: **la famille**, never *l'famille*.

The double **-ll-** after **i** is not said like an English L: **famille** is *fah-MEE-yuh*, the *-ille* landing as a **y**-sound, the *l* itself silent. You'll meet this **-ille** spelling again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

famille ← Latin **familia**, "**the household**" — built on **famulus**, "servant, slave." Roman *familia* named **everyone under one roof**: parents, children, and the servants who worked there, all together. It broadened to mean "blood relatives" only because relatives usually *were* the people sharing that roof. Where *ami* is built on **loving** someone, *famille* is built on **living with** them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la famille" — feminine, no elision
- the sound — "fa-MI-yuh," not "fa-MILL"
- the contrast — "un ami: loving. la famille: living together."

Before you move on

Say "the family." (***La famille*** — feminine.) Why doesn't it elide to *l'famille*? (**It starts with a consonant** — elision only happens before a vowel.) What did Latin *familia* originally include besides relatives? (**The household's servants**, from *famulus*.)

33.3 l'enfant — the child, one word for both

La famille stays fixed no matter who's in it. This member of it does something different again: **one spelling**, for a boy or a girl alike.

You'll want to know: the word

l'enfant — the child. Starts with a vowel, so the article **elides** again, exactly like *l'ami*: **un enfant** (a boy), **une enfant** (a girl) — but the *word itself* never changes. Only **un/une** tells you which.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfant ← Latin **īnfāns**, "**not speaking**" — **in-** "not" + **fāns**, "speaking" (from **fārī**, "to speak"). Literally, a baby too young to talk. But Romans already stretched *īnfāns* to cover children well past babyhood long before French existed, and French *enfant* simply inherited that wider sense — it didn't narrow English **infant** into something broader. The two words split apart in a different way: English kept the narrow, original "not-yet-speaking" sense for its borrowing, while French's everyday word carried the older, already-widened Latin meaning forward.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un enfant, une enfant" — one spelling, two articles
- the elision — "l'enfant," never *le enfant*
- "in- + fari" — not speaking
- the family so far — "l'ami, la famille, l'enfant"

Before you move on

How do you tell a boy child from a girl child in French, if the word itself never changes? (**The article** — *un enfant / une enfant.*) What does *enfant* literally mean, and where does that meaning come from? (**"Not speaking"** — *in-* + *fārī*, "to speak.") Does French narrow Latin's meaning or keep it wide? (**Keeps it wide** — Latin had already stretched *infans* past babyhood.)

33.4 la personne — the person, and the mask behind the word

> *L'ami* changes with its friend; *l'enfant* doesn't, but its article does. This last one is the strangest of the four: it never changes at all — **not even for a man**.

You'll want to know: the word

la personne — the person. **Always feminine** — grammatically, whether you mean a man, a woman, or anyone at all:

> **Cet homme est une bonne personne.** — "That man is a good person."

Homme is masculine; *personne* describing him stays **feminine** regardless. Grammatical gender here has come loose from the person's actual sex entirely — further even than *ami*, which at least tracks who's meant.

Sounds you'll need

Personne looks like it should rhyme with **non**'s nasal *-on* — it doesn't. Double **-nn-** blocks the nasal: **non** is nasal, said through the nose, but **personne** ends oral, *pehr-SUN*, the vowel staying in the mouth. One consonant, doubled, is the difference between a nasal ending and a plain one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

personne ← Latin **persona**, a **theatrical mask** — from Etruscan **phersu**, most likely from Greek **prósōpon**, "face." A tidy but doubted story derives it from *per-* + *sonāre*, "sound through" (the mask an actor's voice rang through); linguists reject it on the vowel length, so treat it as folk etymology, not fact.
Pair *personne* with **ne** and it flips to "**nobody**" — ***je ne vois personne*** = "I see **nobody**." Behind an empty mask, no one at all.

Grammar Lens: four people, four kinds of gender

The chapter's four words, side by side:

- **l'ami / l'amie** — **changes** with who's meant; elides either way.

- **la famille** — **fixed** feminine, whoever's in it; no elision.
- **l'enfant** — **one** spelling; only **un/une** shows which; elides.
- **la personne** — **fixed** feminine, even naming a man.

Four different relationships between gender and the person named — none of them the "normal" case. Each is its own rule, learned with the word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la personne" — always feminine
- "cet homme est une bonne personne"
- the contrast — "non" nasal, "personne" not
- the flip — "je ne vois personne" — nobody

Before you move on

Is *personne* ever masculine, even describing a man? (**No — always feminine**, grammatically.) Why doesn't *personne* nasalize like *non*? (**Double -nn-** blocks it.) What does *ne … personne* mean, and what does that use share with *ne … pas*? (**"Nobody"** — the same negation frame built around *ne*.) Is *persona* really built on "sounding through"? (**Probably not** — a folk etymology; the real root is likely Etruscan *phersu*, "**mask**.")

Chapter 34

Cheese, Butter, Salt, Egg

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for cheese, butter, salt or an egg in French, and say why un œuf keeps its final f while les œufs drops it.
>
> *Ask for an egg, hold un œuf's pronounced f against les œufs' silent one, and place œuf beside English egg as genuine cousins rather than a borrowing. Reaches back past the chapter to le sel, le beurre and le fromage, and to Chapter 29's elision rule, which l'œuf needs exactly as l'ami did.*

34.1 le fromage — cheese, named for its mould

> You can name *la personne* and *l'enfant* now. The café chapter asked politely for a drink; this chapter asks for what goes with it — starting with a word every other Romance language names completely differently.
>
> What did *personne* first name in Latin, and what does it become beside *ne*? (A theatre **mask**; *ne … personne* is **nobody**.)

You'll want to know: the word

le fromage — cheese. **Masculine.**

> **Du fromage, s'il vous plaît.** — "Some cheese, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fromage ← Medieval Latin **formāticum**, "**a thing made in a mould**" — built on **forma**, "shape, mould." Cheesemakers press curds into a mould to set their shape, and French named the finished cheese for **that step**.
Classical Latin's actual word for cheese was **caseus** — and that word is what survives in Spanish **queso** and Portuguese **queijo**, as well as English **casein** and Old English **cyse**, the ancestor of **cheese** itself. So French *fromage* and English *cheese* are **not** cousins: French walked away from *caseus* entirely and named the cheese for its mould instead, while Spanish, Portuguese and English all kept the old word for the curd.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le fromage" — masculine
- "du fromage, s'il vous plaît"
- the mould — "forma → fromage"
- the split — "fromage and cheese are not cousins; queso, queijo and cheese all come from caseus"

Before you move on

Say "cheese, please." (***Du fromage, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Latin word is *fromage* built on, and what did it mean? (**Forma**, "**shape, mould**.") Which Romance languages kept the older word for cheese instead, and what is it? (**Spanish queso, Portuguese queijo** — from Latin **caseus**, also behind English **casein** and **cheese**.)

34.2 le beurre — butter, one loanword twice

Fromage took a French road all its own. This word, French and English took **together** — the exact same borrowing, not two.

You'll want to know: the word

le beurre — butter. **Masculine.**

> **Du beurre, s'il vous plaît.** — "Some butter, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beurre ← Latin **būtyrum** ← Greek **boútūron**, usually broken down as **boûs** "cow" + **tyrós** "cheese" — "cow-cheese." But butter wasn't a Greek or Roman product; both cultures were oil cultures, and most likely imported both the substance and the word from further east, possibly from Scythian traders. Treat "cow-cheese" as a **folk reshaping** of a foreign word into familiar Greek pieces, not a certain compound.
Either way, English **butter** borrows the *identical* Latin word French **beurre** does. This isn't two languages separately naming the same thing — it's **one loanword, arriving twice**.

Why it's said this way

The courtesy words you already have fit right here:

> **Désolé, je n'ai pas le beurre.** — "Sorry, I don't have the butter."

Désolé — real regret, for letting someone down. If you'd only bumped the butter dish, **pardon** would do instead; to get someone's attention before asking for it at all, **excusez-moi**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le beurre" — masculine
- "du beurre, s'il vous plaît"
- "beurre, butter" — one word, borrowed twice
- "désolé, je n'ai pas le beurre"

Before you move on

Say "butter, please." (***Du beurre, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is "cow-cheese" a safe etymology for *boútūron*? (**Not certain** — likely a Greek reshaping of a foreign word, since butter wasn't native to Greece or Rome.) Is French *beurre* related to English *butter* by common descent or by borrowing? (**Borrowing** — the same Latin word, taken by both languages.) When would you reach for *pardon* instead of *désolé*? (**A small, quick slip** — not real regret.)

34.3 le sel — salt, a real cousin and a fake legend

Beurre was one word borrowed twice. This one is different again — a genuine family relative of its English counterpart, plus a famous story about it that isn't actually true.

You'll want to know: the word

le sel — salt. **Masculine.**

Du sel, s'il vous plaît. — "Some salt, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sel ← Latin **sal**, stem **sal-** — **inherited**, like *lait*, not borrowed like *café* or *sucre*. English **salt** is a genuine **cousin**: both words descend from the same Proto-Indo-European root, ***sal-**, inherited separately down the Latin and Germanic branches. Unlike *lait* and *milk*, which share no root at all, *sel* and *salt* really are family.
Latin **salārium** — English **salary** — is built on this same *sal*. You may have heard that Roman soldiers were literally paid in salt, which is where "salary" supposedly comes from. That claim appears in **no ancient source**; no Roman writer says it. *Salārium* genuinely is built on *sal* — that part is real — but the vivid soldiers-and-salt story attached to it later, and belongs with folk etymology, not fact.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le sel" — masculine

- "du sel, s'il vous plaît"
- the real cousins — "sel, salt — one PIE root, two branches"
- "beurre, fromage, sel" — three foods, all masculine

Before you move on

Say "salt, please." (***Du sel, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is *sel* related to English *salt* by common descent or by borrowing? (**Common descent** — both from PIE **sal-*, **a genuine cousin pair.) Is the "soldiers paid in salt" story behind *salary* true?** (No — **it appears in no ancient source; *salārium* really is built on *sal*, but the legend is later.)**

34.4 l'œuf — the egg, that loses its consonant only in the plural

Fromage, beurre, sel — three foods, three masculine articles. The fourth starts with a vowel, so this chapter closes the way it began: with the elision rule from *l'ami*.

You'll want to know: the word

l'œuf — the egg. **Masculine**, and it elides — never *le œuf*.

Un œuf, s'il vous plaît. — "An egg, please." Said with a clear final **f**: *un-EUF*.

Now the plural: **les œufs**. Spelled with the same *-fs*, but the **f disappears entirely** — *lay-ZEU*, not *lay-ZEUFS*. One noun, and its final consonant survives in the singular only to vanish in the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

œuf ← Latin **ovum**, from a Proto-Indo-European word for "egg," ***h₂ōwyóm**. English **egg** descends from the *same* root, by the Germanic road (Old Norse *egg*, from Proto-Germanic **ajja-*) — a real cousin pair, exactly like *sel* and *salt*, not a borrowing in either direction. The Latin-only learned family — **oval**, **ovary**, **ovum** itself — are the ones English took straight from written Latin, sitting beside

its own native *egg*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'œuf" — masculine, elided
- "un œuf" — f pronounced
- "les œufs" — f silent
- the cousins — "œuf, egg — same PIE root, two branches"

Before you move on

Say "an egg, please," then "the eggs." (***Un œuf, s'il vous plaît*** — f pronounced; ***les œufs*** — f silent.) Why does *l'œuf* elide? (**Vowel-initial** — same rule as *l'ami*.) Is *œuf* borrowed from Latin *ovum*, or a genuine cousin of it? (**A cousin** — both from PIE **h₂ōwyóm*, like English *egg*.) Name the chapter's four foods with their articles. (***Le fromage, le beurre, le sel, l'œuf*** — all masculine.)

Chapter 35

Eyes, Nose, Mouth, Stomach

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the eye and its irregular-looking plural yeux, the nose, the mouth and the stomach in French, extending Chapter 17's head and hand.
>
> *Say j'ai mal au ventre, take ventriloquist apart as "belly-speaker," and close the chapter's own four words (l'œil/les yeux, le nez, la bouche, le ventre) beside Chapter 17's head and hand. Reaches back past the chapter to la main's nasal -ain, contrasted with ventre's own different nasal vowel, and further back to le café, l'ami and l'œuf, one word from each of this book's four newest chapters.*

35.1 l'œil, les yeux — the eye, and a plural that only looks broken

> You have the head and the hand. This chapter fills in the rest of the body it left for later — starting above the mouth.

You'll want to know: the word

l'œil — the eye. **Masculine**, and it elides — never *le œil*. Its plural is completely different in **shape**: **les yeux**.

Tête, remember, is feminine even though it never looks like a body part should tell you its gender; *œil* is masculine, on the same body, right above it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

œil ← Vulgar Latin **oclus** (from **oculus**, "eye") — a heavily worn singular. **Yeux** ← Latin's plural **oculōs**, and *that* development is completely **regular** sound change, the ordinary path oculōs was always going to take.
So *les yeux* doesn't break the rules — *œil* does. The singular eroded further and faster than the plural did, and the two paths simply arrived looking unrelated. French has a small family of nouns built this way — *le ciel / les cieux* ("sky/skies"), *le travail / les travaux* ("work/works") — an odd-looking plural is often the **regular** one, standing next to a singular that took the shortcut.

Why it's said this way

You may remember *tête* itself came from **testa**, a soldier's joke for "pot" that replaced the real Latin word for head. *Œil* never had that kind of accident — it's simply the ordinary, expected descendant of *oculus*, sitting on the very pot the joke was about.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'œil" — one eye, masculine
- "les yeux" — both eyes, different shape
- "la tête, l'œil" — feminine pot, masculine eye
- the family — "le ciel/les cieux, œil/yeux" — same pattern

Before you move on

Say "the eye" and "the eyes." (***L'œil, les yeux.***) Which form is the *regular* sound outcome of Latin — *œil* or *yeux*? (***Yeux*** — from *oculōs*; *œil* is the one that eroded further.) What other French noun changes shape the same way between singular and plural? (**Le ciel / les cieux**, or **le travail / les travaux**.) What was *tête* originally a soldier's joke for? (**A pot.**)

35.2 le nez — the nose, another real cousin

Below the eye, the nose — and a third pair of true cousins, joining *sel/salt* and *œuf/egg*.

Comprendre is *prendre* with a prefix, so it breaks in the same places: *je comprends*, *nous comprenons*.

You'll want to know: the word

le nez — the nose. **Masculine**, final **z silent**: *NAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nez ← Latin **nāsus**, from PIE ***nas-**. English **nose** descends from the *same* root, down the Germanic branch — a genuine cousin, exactly the pattern *sel/salt* and *œuf/egg* already showed you.
English **nasal** is a *different* kind of relative: a **learned** borrowing of the Latin word itself, sitting beside native *nose* the same way *lactic* sits beside native *milk*. One root, French *nez* and English *nose* both inherited; one root, English separately borrowed as *nasal*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le nez" — silent z
- "l'œil, le nez" — eye, nose
- the cousins — "nez, nose — same PIE root"
- the borrowing — "nasal," taken later, straight from Latin

Before you move on

Say "the nose." (***Le nez*** — masculine, silent z.) Is *nez* related to English *nose* by inheritance or by borrowing? (**Inheritance** — both from PIE **nas-*, a genuine cousin pair.) Where does English *nasal* fit? (A **learned borrowing** of the Latin word, alongside native *nose* — the same relationship as *lactic* beside *milk*.)

35.3 la bouche — the mouth, which used to mean "cheek"

Tête wasn't Latin's word for head. This one wasn't Latin's word for mouth, either.

You'll want to know: the word

la bouche — the mouth. **Feminine.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Classical Latin's real word for "mouth" was **ōs**. But Latin's vowel lengths eventually stopped being pronounced, and short **os** "**bone**" and long **ōs** "**mouth**" **collapsed into the same sound**. Faced with that collision, speakers reached for a slangy stand-in instead: **bucca**, which had meant "**cheek**" — much the way an English speaker might call a mouth a "cheek" in passing. The slang stuck, and **bucca** became French's ordinary word for mouth: **bouche**.
English kept *bucca*'s **original** sense in one narrow technical word, **buccal** ("of the cheek," used mostly by dentists) — never demoted to "mouth" the way French's everyday word was.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la bouche" — feminine
- "le nez, la bouche" — nose, mouth
- the collision — "os 'bone', ōs 'mouth' — same sound"
- "bucca" — cheek, the slang that took over

Before you move on

Say "the mouth." (***La bouche*** — feminine.) What did Latin *bucca* originally mean? (**"Cheek."**) Why did *bucca* replace the real Latin word for mouth, *ōs*? (**It collided in sound with *os*, "bone,"** once vowel length stopped being pronounced.) Which English word still keeps *bucca*'s original "cheek" sense? (**Buccal.**)

35.4 le ventre — the stomach, closing four chapters of everyday words

Eye, nose, mouth — three words down. One more, and this book's body vocabulary reaches all the way from the head and the hand to here.

You'll want to know: the word

le ventre — the stomach, the belly. **Masculine.**

J'ai mal au ventre. — "My stomach hurts."

Say the nasal: **ven-**. It's a different vowel from *la main*'s *-ain*, even though both endings are written with a nasal consonant after the vowel — French has several distinct nasal vowels, and *main* and *ventre* use two of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ventre ← Latin **venter**, stem **ventr-**, "belly." English kept two learned words on this stem: **ventral** ("of the belly," the opposite of *dorsal*), and **ventriloquist** — *venter* + *loquī*, "to speak" — literally a "**belly-speaker**," someone whose voice seems to come from the stomach rather than the mouth.

Grammar Lens: five chapters, tied off

Before you close the book on this run, three threads from earlier chapters, tied off here:

- **la tête** is **feminine**, was Roman soldiers' slang for a **pot**, and wears a circumflex that marks a **lost *s***.
- **oui** once **split a country** into *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc*; its cousin **si** is the one you use to contradict a negative.
- and among this run's own new words — **le sel**, **la personne** — every one still carries the article that names its gender, exactly the promise this book made back at *la main*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le ventre" — masculine
- "j'ai mal au ventre"
- "main, ventre" — two different nasal vowels
- "ventriloquist" — the belly-speaker
- the whole run — "le café, l'ami, l'œuf, le ventre" — four chapters, one thread

Before you move on

Say "my stomach hurts." (***J'ai mal au ventre.***) What English word literally means "belly-speaker"? (**Ventriloquist** — *venter* + *loquī*.) Is *ventre*'s nasal the same vowel as *la main*'s? (**No** — a different nasal vowel, despite both being spelled with a nasal consonant.) Name the four body words this chapter added to the head and the hand. (***L'œil* (les yeux), *le nez*, *la bouche*, *le ventre***.)

35.5 The three marks, from cold

The word that closed four chapters of everyday nouns — the stomach. Say it with its article.

You'll want to know: le ventre, and the nasal it shares

le ventre — masculine, and nasal like **la main**, but reaching that nasal through a different vowel. Two body words, two routes to the same kind of sound, and the gender is not predictable from either.

Script: the three marks, thirty chapters later

ê ç ï

Cover the page and say what each one does before checking. They were taught three pages apart and have not been asked for since, which makes this the first real test of them:

- **ê** records a letter that is gone. English usually still has it.
- **ç** keeps a **c** soft where it would otherwise harden.
- **ï** splits two vowels that would otherwise be read as one.

One is history, one is sound, one is grouping. Sorting them that way is what stops them blurring into a single topic called *accents*.

Before you move on

Which mark is a piece of history rather than an instruction? (**The circumflex**.) Which one changes a consonant? (**The cédille**.) Which one changes how two letters group? (**The tréma**.) And what gender is **ventre**? (**Masculine** — and nothing about the word says so.)

Chapter 36

Asking a Question — Three Ways, and Which One to Use

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask a question in French three ways — by raising my voice, with est-ce que, and by inversion — choose between them by how formal the moment is, and ask where, when, how, how much and why.
>
> *The one question word that agrees with its noun, closing a chapter that began with the question costing no new words at all.*

36.1 une question — the question you make with your voice alone

You can say a great deal in French and cannot yet ask anything. This chapter fixes that, and the first way costs you no new words at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

French has three ways to ask a question. This is the first, the cheapest, and by far the commonest in speech — and it costs you **nothing new at all**.

> **Tu parles français.** — You speak French. **Tu parles français ?** — You speak French?

The words are identical. The order is identical. The only

difference is that the second one rises at the end, and in writing, a question mark.
That is a real question, correct and unremarkable, and it is what a French speaker uses with friends, family, in a shop, all day. Note the space before the question mark — French puts a thin space before `?`, `!`, `:` and `;`, which English does not.
Why start here. Textbooks usually open with the formal inversion, which is the rarest of the three and the hardest to build. You can ask about anything you can already say, right now, by lifting your voice. Everything after this lesson is about *register* and *precision*, not about being understood.

Your turn

- *Say it: une question*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

How do you turn a French statement into a question with no new words? (**Raise your voice** at the end.) Is that correct French, or a shortcut? (**Correct**, and the commonest form in speech.) And what does French put before a question mark? (A **space**.)

36.2 est-ce que — the phrase that announces a question before it starts

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

Vous m'aidez. An ordinary *-er* verb: *j'aide*, *nous aidons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The second way. Put **est-ce que** in front of a statement and it becomes a question:

Est-ce que tu parles français ?

Nothing else moves. The statement stays exactly as it was; the phrase sits in front of it like a flag.

It is worth taking apart, because it looks like three words and behaves like one. Literally it is *est-ce que* = "is it that…" — French built a question marker out of a tiny sentence, then wore it down until nobody hears the parts any more. A speaker says it as one word, roughly *ESS-kuh*.

When you would choose it. It is more neutral than the voice-only question and less formal than the inversion coming next — the safe middle. In writing, where your voice cannot rise, it is the ordinary way to ask.

English has no equivalent and does not need one, because English inverts instead: *do you speak…*. That English **do** is doing the same job — a meaningless word inserted to mark a question — so the device is familiar even though the word is not.

Your turn

- *Say it: est-ce que*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **est-ce que** do to a statement? (Turns it into a **question**, with nothing else moving.) What is it literally? (*Is it that…*) And which English word does the same job? (**Do**, as in *do you speak*.)

36.3 où — where

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

où — where

Où est la gare ? — Where is the station? **Tu vas où ?** — Where are you going?

Both are correct. The question word can open the sentence or sit at the end where the answer would go, and the second is what you will hear far more in speech.

Now the accent, which is not decoration. French has two words spelled *o-u*:

- **ou** — *or*
- **où** — *where*

The grave accent is the **only** difference in writing, and in speech there is no difference at all: both are *oo*. This is the one place in French where an accent does nothing to the sound and everything to the meaning, which is why it is never optional.
You now hold the first question word, and with it a question you can actually use on the first day in a French city.

Your turn

- *Say it: où*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **où** mean? (**Where**.) What is the same word without the accent? (**Or**.) And do they sound different? (**No** — the accent is meaning only.)

36.4 quand — when

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

Entendre once covered hearing, attending, understanding and intending. Hearing took the word when *ouïr* wore out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quand — when

Quand est-ce que tu arrives ? — When do you arrive?

The **d** is silent. *Quand* is *kahn*, nasal, with nothing on the end — until the next word begins with a vowel, and then it comes back **as a t**:

Quand est-ce que... — *kahn-TESS-kuh*

That is **liaison**, and it is one of the things that makes fast French hard to cut into words: the consonants at the ends of words are silent alone and audible in company. Nobody writes it down; every speaker does it. Latin **quando** is the ancestor, and it is worth spending: Spanish *cuándo*, Italian *quando*, Portuguese *quando* — and the *qu-* on all of them is the same Latin question-word opening you see in English **query**, **question** and **quest**.

Your turn

- *Say it: quand*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **quand** mean? (**When**.) Is the *d* pronounced? (**Not alone** — but it returns as a *t* before a vowel.) What is that called? (**Liaison**.)

36.5 comment — how

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comment — how

You already say it. **Comment allez-vous ?** is *how are you*, and you learned it before you knew it contained a question word.

Comment tu dis ça ? — How do you say that?
Comment ? — on its own: *Sorry? / Pardon?*

That last one is worth having. Used alone it is how a French speaker asks you to repeat — politer than *quoi ?*, which is the blunt *what?* The origin is Latin **quomodo**, "in what manner", and English took the same idea by a different road: **mode**, **modal** and **manner** are all from *modus*, the "how" half of it.

Your turn

- *Say it: comment*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **comment** mean? (**How**.) Which phrase you already knew contains it? (*Comment allez-vous* — how are you.) And what does **Comment ?** alone mean? (**Sorry? / Pardon?**)

36.6 combien — how much and how many

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

combien — how much, how many

C'est combien ? — How much is it? **Combien de personnes ?** — How many people?

English splits this and French does not. *Much* for things you measure, *many* for things you count — French uses **combien** for both and lets the noun sort it out. One word fewer to choose between, and one of the rare places French is simpler than English.
Note **combien de** before a noun. The *de* is not optional and does not change for number: *combien de personnes*, *combien d'argent*.
C'est combien ? is the single most useful question in this chapter for a traveller, and it is three words long.

Your turn

- *Say it: combien*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **combien** cover that English splits in two? (**How much** and **how many**.) What must follow it before a noun? (**de**.) And how do you ask a price? (*C'est combien ?*)

36.7 pourquoi — why

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourquoi — why

Take it apart:
pour ("for") + **quoi** ("what") → **pourquoi**
For what? French built its *why* out of two words you can still see inside it, and English does the same thing in *what for?*

Pourquoi ? — Why?

The answer, "because," is built to match — *by this that* against *for what* — and it gets a lesson of its own a few chapters on, where it joins two clauses into one sentence.
That gives you the last of the five question words.

Your turn

- *Say it: pourquoi*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What is **pourquoi** made of? (Two words, "for" and "what" — *for what?*) What does English build the same way? (*What for?*)

36.8 parlez-vous — the third way to ask

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The third and last way. Swap the verb and the subject, and join them with a hyphen:

> **Tu parles français. → Parles-tu français ? Vous parlez français. → Parlez-vous français ?**

This is **inversion**, and it is the form English used to have — *speak you French?* — and lost, keeping it only in *are you*, *have you*, *can you*.
Where the three ways differ is register, not meaning:

- **Tu parles français ?** — friends, family, shops. Commonest by far.
- **Est-ce que tu parles français ?** — neutral, and the default in writing.
- **Parlez-vous français ?** — formal, written, or deliberately polite.

A beginner is often taught inversion first and then sounds like a textbook in every conversation. It is the one you need to **recognise** immediately and can afford to **produce** last.
One sound rule: if the verb ends in a vowel and the subject begins with one, French inserts a **-t-** to keep them apart — *parle-t-il*, *a-t-elle*. It exists purely so two vowels do not collide.

Your turn

- *Say it: parlez-vous*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What are the three ways to ask a question? (**Voice**, **est-ce que**, **inversion**.) Which is commonest in speech? (**Voice**.) Which should you learn to recognise first and produce last? (**Inversion**.) And why the *-t-* in *parle-t-il*? (To keep **two vowels apart**.)

36.9 quel, quelle — which

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quel — which, what

Every question word so far has been invariable. This one is not: **quel is an adjective**, and like every French adjective it agrees with the noun it asks about.

> **Quel jour ?** — Which day? *(masculine)* **Quelle heure ?** — What time? *(feminine)* **Quels livres ?** — Which books? *(masculine plural)* **Quelles questions ?** — Which questions? *(feminine plural)*

All four sound identical. *Kell*, every time. The agreement is entirely written — which makes it a spelling problem rather than a speaking one, and it is one of the commonest places a French exam takes marks off.
You already use one of these without thinking: **Quelle heure est-il ?** — what time is it. *Heure* is feminine, so *quelle* takes two *l*s and an *e*. That is the fifth and last way this chapter teaches you to ask. Three structures, five question words, and one adjective that agrees.

Your turn

- *Say it: quel, quelle*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

Why does **quel** change and *où* does not? (**Quel is an adjective** and agrees with its noun.) Do the four forms sound different? (**No** — all *kell*.) So what kind of problem is it? (A **spelling** one.)

Chapter 37

Want, Can, Must

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want, what I can do and what I must do, put any verb I already know behind vouloir, pouvoir or devoir without changing it, and choose je voudrais over je veux when I am asking rather than stating.
>
> *Three verbs that between them open a sentence for every verb the reader already owns – and the point at which correct French used at the wrong moment is named as a harder mistake to hear than a grammatical one.*

37.1 vouloir — to want

Put **est-ce que** in front of a statement and it becomes a question. Hold that; you will need it in a moment.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vouloir — to want. Here are the singular forms, which is what you need first:
Say it as a chant, three beats:

je veux — tu veux — il veut

I want, you want, he wants. And notice what your ear reports: **all three sound identical**. *veux*, *veux*, *veut* — the spelling distinguishes them and the mouth does not. That is why French keeps the subject pronoun in front: without *je* or *tu*, nothing tells a listener who wants what.

Then a *want* needs something wanted, and it follows directly:

- **Je veux un café.** — I want a coffee.
- **Tu veux le pain ?** — Do you want the bread?

Why it's said this way

Now the part a phrasebook will not tell you, and the reason this word needs a warning where *parler* did not.
Je veux is blunt in a request. Said to a waiter or a shopkeeper it lands close to English *I want*, which is to say it lands badly. It is perfectly ordinary elsewhere — *je veux dire* is "I mean", and *je veux bien* is a cheerful "gladly" — so the problem is not the word, it is the counter. French has a softened form built for exactly this, and it is the one you should reach for by default:

je voudrais — *I would like*

Same verb, different shape. **Je voudrais un café** is what a French speaker actually says across a counter, and it is no harder to say than *je veux*.
So learn both, and learn when each belongs. *Je veux* is for a want you are simply stating — to a friend, to a child, about yourself. **Je voudrais is for asking anyone for anything.** If you are unsure which you are doing, you are asking, and you want *voudrais*.

Your turn

- *Say it: je veux, tu veux, il veut* — and hear that all three are the same sound
- *Say it: je voudrais un café*, as though to a stranger behind a counter
- *Ask: est-ce que tu veux un café ?*

Before you move on

Give the three singular forms. (***Veux, veux, veut*** — all said the same.) You are ordering coffee from someone you have never met: which form do you use? (***Je voudrais***, never *je veux*.)

37.2 pouvoir — can

Say *je voudrais un café*. That was a want, softened.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pouvoir — **to be able**, and in practice **can**. The singular:
Same chant, three beats:

je peux — tu peux — il peut

I can, you can, he can. The same pattern you just met: **all three sound alike**, and the pronoun carries the person.
That final *t* is silent — until you invert. **Peut-il ?** wakes it, and needs no added *-t-* the way *parle-t-il* did, because this verb already has one.
Peux, peux, peut — and note it rhymes with nothing in *vouloir*, but behaves identically.
What follows *pouvoir* is a **plain, unchanged verb**:

- **Je peux parler français.** — I can speak French.
- **Tu peux aider ?** — Can you help?

Nothing happens to *parler* or *aider*. They arrive in the dictionary form and stay there, which makes this one of the cheapest structures in French: every **plain** verb you know can be put behind *peux* with no change at all.
One group does change, and you already own two of them. A verb that carries *se* keeps it, and the *se* matches the person: **je peux m'asseoir**, **tu peux te lever**. The verb itself is still untouched; only its little pronoun follows you.

Why it's said this way

The reason *pouvoir* matters early has little to do with ability.
Asking someone to do something by telling them to do it is abrupt in French, as it is in English. What French reaches for instead is a **question about ability** — the same move English makes with *can you*:

Tu peux fermer la porte ? — Can you close the door?

Nobody is really asking whether the other person is capable. The question is the politeness, and it is why *pouvoir* buys you more than a translation would suggest.
For a stranger, soften it the same way *vouloir* softened into *voudrais* — the identical shift, on this verb:

Pourriez-vous fermer la porte ?

Your turn

- *Say it: je peux, tu peux, il peut* — again, one sound between them
- *Say it: je peux parler français*
- *Ask: tu peux aider ?*

Before you move on

What happens to the verb that follows *peux*? (**Nothing** — it stays in its dictionary form.) Why does a beginner need *pouvoir* early? (Because **asking whether someone can** is how French makes a polite request.)

37.3 devoir — must

Say *je peux parler français*. The second verb did not change.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devoir — **to have to**, **must**. The singular, and by now you can predict the shape of the problem:

je dois — tu dois — il doit

I must, you must, he must. **All three sound alike again.** Three verbs in a row have done this, which is the point worth carrying away: in the French present singular, the three persons are routinely one sound, and the pronoun is what tells them apart. This is not a quirk of these three words.
The exceptions are the three verbs you learned earliest, and they are exceptions because they are used constantly: *suis / es / est*, *ai / as /*

a, *vais / vas / va*. Everywhere else, expect one sound.
A plain verb follows, exactly as after *peux*:

- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.
- **Tu dois entendre.** — You must hear.

Why it's said this way

devoir comes from Latin ***dēbēre***, **to owe** — and it never stopped meaning that. The same French verb still does both jobs:

- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.
- **Je te dois dix euros.** — I owe you ten euros.

One word, two obligations — and the order matters. The owing came first: the Latin verb meant *to owe*, and the sense of *must* grew out of it, exactly as English *ought* grew out of *owed*.
That Latin *dēbēre* is also where English gets **debt**, **debit** and **due** — so a word you have never seen has been sitting in your own vocabulary all along, spelled differently and meaning the half of *devoir* that involves money.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *je dois, tu dois, il doit*
- *je dois partir*
- *je te dois dix euros* — the same verb, the other meaning

Before you move on

What two things does *devoir* mean? (**Must**, and **to owe**.) Which English words share its Latin root? (**Debt**, **debit**, **due**.)

37.4 Practice — want, can, must

Say *je dois partir*.

What you've built

Three verbs, one shape between them. Say each chant in turn:

je veux — tu veux — il veut

je peux — tu peux — il peut

je dois — tu dois — il doit

Every chant is three forms that sound identical, and between the three chants you have wanting, being able, and having to.
And all three do the same structural thing: **a plain verb follows, unchanged.**

- **Je veux partir.** — I want to leave.
- **Je peux partir.** — I can leave.
- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.

That is the payoff, and it is larger than three words. Every verb you have learned in this book — *parler*, *aider*, *fermer*, *ouvrir*, *écrire*, *lire*, *dormir* — can be dropped in behind any of these three with **no change of any kind**. You have not learned three expressions. You have learned three openings, and you already own everything that goes after them.

Why it's said this way

One caution carried forward, because it is the difference between sounding capable and sounding rude.

- Stating a want to a friend: **je veux**.
- Asking anyone for anything: **je voudrais**.
- Asking someone else to act: **tu peux…?** or **vous pouvez…?**

The blunt form is not wrong French. It is correct French used at the wrong moment, which is a harder mistake to hear and an easier one to make.

Your turn

- *Say it: je veux partir, je peux partir, je dois partir*
- *Say it:* the same three with *parler français* instead of *partir*
- *Ask: vous pouvez fermer la porte ?*

Before you move on

What happens to a verb placed after *veux*, *peux* or *dois*? (**Nothing** — it stays in its dictionary form.) You want to ask a stranger to close a window: which of the three do you start with? (***Vous pouvez…***)

Chapter 38

Five Ways to Point

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something exists, say what it is, hand somebody over, point at a noun, and answer the question where.
>
> *Everything the book owns is pointed at five ways: it exists, it is a thing, it is handed over, it is pointed at in front of its noun, and it is somewhere. One Latin word runs under four of the five – ecce, 'behold', which fused into ce, ici, voici and voila and then vanished inside all of them.*

38.1 il y a — "there is," built out of "it has there"

Say **il a** and **il est**. You have both verbs whole, and you still cannot say that something exists.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the three ways to ask a question — voice, *est-ce que*, inversion

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il y a — there is, there are.

Said *eel-ya*, three words run into two syllables.

Il y a du pain. — There is some bread.

Il y a un café. — There is a café.

Word for word it says **it has there**. The **il** stands for nobody — the same empty *il* as in *il est trois heures* — the **a** is *avoir*, and the **y** is the piece worth stopping on.
That **y** is Latin **ibi**, "there," and it survives in French almost nowhere else. Spanish welded the same *ibi* onto its own *ha* and got **hay**; French kept the two apart and writes them still. Two languages, one Latin adverb, one idea — and only French leaves the seam visible.
One shape covers both numbers. **Il y a un café** and **il y a deux cafés** use the identical phrase, so there is no *there are* to learn separately.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *il y a* — *eel-ya*
- with the partitive you already own — "Il y a du pain, du vin, de l'eau."
- with a count — "Il y a un café" and "Il y a deux cafés", the same phrase twice
- the three pieces, slowly — *il … y … a*
- with the chain from the last chapter, the second verb unchanged — "Je veux du pain" and "Il va y avoir du pain"

Before you move on

What does *il y a* say word for word? (**It has there.**) What is the **y**? (**Latin *ibi*, "there"** — the same word inside Spanish *hay*.) Does it change for plural? (**No.**) Say "there is some bread."

38.2 c'est — "this is," and the pointing phrase inside it

Il y a says a thing exists. It cannot say **what** the thing is. Say **il est** and **l'eau**, and watch the apostrophe do its usual work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

c'est — this is, that is. · **ce sont** — these are, those are.

ce is the pointing word, **est** is *être*, and the **e** of *ce* falls out in front of a vowel exactly as *le* becomes *l'*:

C'est du café. — That's coffee. · **C'est mon frère.** — That's my brother.

For a plural French switches the verb and stops eliding, because *sont* opens with a consonant:

Ce sont des cafés. — Those are cafés.

ce is Latin **ecce hoc** — *behold this* — a whole phrase worn down to two letters over fifteen centuries. The *ecce* half is still doing work elsewhere in this language, and the next two lessons will show where.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *c'est* — one syllable, *say*
- the table — "C'est du pain. C'est du fromage. C'est du café."
- people — "C'est mon frère. C'est ma sœur."
- the plural — "Ce sont des cafés."
- the pair — "Il y a un café" against "C'est un café"

Before you move on

What two words are inside *c'est*? (***Ce*** and ***est***.) What happens for a plural? (***Ce sont***, with no elision.) What Latin phrase is *ce*? (***Ecce hoc*** — "behold this".) What does *il y a* do that *c'est* does not? (**Say a thing exists without saying what it is.**)

38.3 ici, là, là-bas — three distances

You can ask **où ?**. You have had no way at all to answer it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ici — here. · **là** — there. · **là-bas** — over there, further off.

Où est le café ? — Ici.

ici is Latin **ecce hic**, "behold here" — the same **ecce**, "behold," that is buried inside **c'est**. French said its pointing word so often that it fused into several separate everyday words and then disappeared inside each of them; two more of them arrive in the next lesson.
là-bas is **là** plus **bas**, "low" — *there below.* The picture is of something further down a road, and it marks the far end of a three-step scale English can only manage with two words and a gesture.
The accent on **là** is doing real work: it separates the adverb from **la**, the article. Same letter, same sound, and the grave mark is the only difference on the page.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three, near to far — "ici, là, là-bas"
- the question and its answer — "Où est le café ? — Ici."
- "Le pain est là."
- "Il y a un café là-bas."
- the pair the accent separates — "la" the article, "là" the place
- with what it is — "C'est le café. Il est là."

Before you move on

Say the three distances. (***Ici, là, là-bas***.) What is *là-bas* made of? (***Là*** plus ***bas***, "low" — *there below.*) What does the accent on *là* separate it from? (**The article *la***.) Answer *où est le pain ?* three

ways.

38.4 voici — "here is," and introducing somebody else

You can give your own name, ask for somebody else's, and shake hands afterwards. Say all three. Then notice that you have never been able to introduce a third person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voici — here is, here are. · **voilà** — there is, there are.

Voici ma mère. — This is my mother.

Voilà mon père. — That's my father.

Both are frozen commands. **voici** is **vois** + **ci**, "see here"; **voilà** is **vois** + **là**, "see there". Nobody hears an order in them any more, and the verb inside has not been conjugated for centuries.
The **ci** and the **là** are the two words you took last lesson, and the *vois* in front of them carries the same Latin **ecce**, "behold," that is buried inside *ce* and *ici*. So French points four ways off one ancient root — *ce*, *ici*, *voici*, *voilà* — and each of the four froze at a different moment. Between them and *c'est*, you can now hand somebody over:

Voici ma sœur. — Enchanté.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *voici* and *voilà*
- the household — "Voici ma mère. Voici mon père."
- "Voici mon frère. Voici ma sœur."
- "Voici mon ami." then the reply, "Enchanté."
- the four pointing words in one breath — "ce, ici, voici, voilà"

- your own name, then somebody else's — "Je m'appelle…", "Voici…"

Before you move on

What two words are frozen inside *voici*? (***Vois*** and ***ci*** — "see here".) And inside *voilà*? (***Vois*** and ***là***.) Introduce your mother, and answer yourself. (**Voici ma mère. — Enchanté.**)

38.5 ce, cet, cette, ces — pointing at a noun

Say **le**, **la**, **les**. Those say *the*. Nothing you own says *this* in front of a noun — *c'est* and *voici* both need a whole sentence.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ce, **cet**, **cette**, **ces** — this, that, these, those, standing in front of a noun.

The choice follows the article you already know, one for one:

the noun takes	you say
le	**ce** pain
le, before a vowel	**cet** ami
la	**cette** mère
les	**ces** cafés

Only the second line is new machinery, and it is machinery you have already met from the other side. *Le ami* is impossible, so French writes **l'ami**. *Ce ami* is impossible for the identical reason — and here French borrows a **t** instead of eliding, giving **cet ami**.
The result is a small trap for the ear: **cet ami** and **cette amie** are pronounced exactly alike, and only the sentence around them says which was meant.
All four are Latin **ecce iste**, "behold that one" — the same **ecce** inside *ce*, *voici* and *voilà*, welded this time to a different second half.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the article first, then the pointer — "le pain, ce pain"

- "la mère, cette mère"
- "les cafés, ces cafés"
- the borrowed *t* — "l'ami, cet ami"
- the animals — "ce chien, ce chat"
- the two that sound alike — "cet ami", "cette amie"

Before you move on

Which shape goes in front of a *le*-word? (***Ce***.) A *la*-word? (***Cette***.) A plural? (***Ces***.) Why does *cet* exist? (**To keep two vowels apart**, the same job the apostrophe does in *l'ami*.) Which two of the four sound identical? (***Cet*** and ***cette***.)

38.6 Voici tout — the chapter, run cold

One Latin word is inside four things you learned this chapter. Name it, then name the four.

Your turn: the table, pointed at five ways

Everything the book has put on a table, pointed at five different ways. Say each line before you read the next.

Say these aloud:

- it exists — "Il y a du pain, du vin, de l'eau."
- what it is — "C'est du fromage. C'est du café. C'est du lait."
- handed over — "Voici le thé. Voici le sel. Voici le sucre."
- pointed at — "ce beurre, cet œuf, cette eau, ces cafés"
- the loan and the inheritance side by side — *café* and *thé* came from far away; *pain*, *vin* and *lait* never left

Your turn: the distant band — people, animals, the body

Now reach back. Every person, every animal and every part of the body this book has taught, introduced or pointed at.

Say these aloud:

- the household, handed over — "Voici ma mère, mon père, mon frère, ma sœur"
- the four Latin cousins those keep — *mater, pater, frater, soror*
- "Voici mon ami. Voici l'enfant. Voici la famille." then "Enchanté."
- the two animals, pointed at — "ce chien, ce chat"
- the body — "cette tête, cette main, ce nez, cet œil, cette bouche, ce ventre"
- the one that needed a borrowed *t*, and why — "cet œil"

Your turn: where

- *Say it:* "Où est le café ?" then all three answers — "Ici. Là. Là-bas."
- *Say it:* "Il y a un café là-bas."
- *Ask:* the same question the other two ways you know

Before you move on

Which phrase says a thing exists without saying what it is? (***Il y a.***) Which says what it is? (***C'est.***) Which hands it to somebody? (***Voici.***) Which points at it in front of its noun? (***Ce, cet, cette, ces.***) And what single Latin word is buried in *ce*, *ici*, *voici* and *voilà*? (***Ecce*** — "behold".)

Chapter 39

Where Two Words Melt Into One

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to, at, of and from, and I know which four combinations of preposition and article melt into a single word.
>
> *Every noun the book owns is put in somebody's hands and put somewhere. Two prepositions and four articles make eight combinations, four of which melt – and the rule that decides which is the one du already showed: le and les contract, la and l' do not. The u inside au was an l, which is the same eight-century-old change that made chevaux out of cheval.*

39.1 à — one letter, and the accent that saves it

Say **il a** and **il y a**. The **a** in both is the verb. This lesson takes the other one.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the three question words you took last — *comment*, *combien*, *pourquoi*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à — to, at.

à Paris — to Paris, in Paris. · **à trois heures** — at three o'clock.

Latin **ad** gave it, and the **d** wore off, leaving a single letter. English

kept the same *ad* in a hundred borrowed words — *advance*, *admit*, *adhere* — where it still means *toward*.
The grave accent has one job and no other: it separates this word from **a**, the verb. Same letter, same sound, and only the mark on the page says which is meant. French does this three times over — *a*/*à*, *ou*/*où*, *la*/*là* — and you have already met the third.
You have owned the clock since it was taught and had no way to say **at** a time. Now you have one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two *a*s — the verb "il a", the preposition "à Paris"
- the clock, at last — "à trois heures", "à midi", "à minuit"
- the three pairs the accent separates — "a/à", "ou/où", "la/là"
- ask for a time, then answer — "Quelle heure est-il ? — À midi."
- the three modals, each pointed at a time — "Je veux partir à midi. Je peux partir à midi. Je dois partir à midi." — and the second verb never moving

Before you move on

What Latin word is **à**? (***Ad.***) What is the accent for? (**To separate it from *a*, the verb** — nothing else.) Say "at midday" and "at three o'clock."

39.2 de — "of," and the word already hiding in *du*

Say **du pain**. You were told two words are inside it. Name them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de — of, from.

le café de Paris — the café of Paris. · **le frère de**

Marie — Marie's brother.

That second line is worth a moment. French owns nothing with an apostrophe: it says **the brother of Marie**, and it has said so since Latin. English is the odd one here — the possessive **'s** is a Germanic survival that Latin's daughters never had, so *Marie's brother* is the outlier and *le frère de Marie* is the ordinary European shape.
Before a vowel it elides, exactly as *le* does:

le livre d'Anne — Anne's book.

And you have been saying **de** since the food chapter without meeting it alone: *du pain* is **de** + **le**, and *de l'eau* is **de** with nothing to contract.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- possession, the French way — "le frère de Marie", "la mère de Anne"
- elided — "le café d'Anne"
- the two you already had — "du pain", "de l'eau"
- the pair — "à Paris" and "de Paris"

Before you move on

How does French say "Marie's brother"? (**Le frère de Marie** — of Marie.) Which language invented the apostrophe possessive? (**English**, and none of Latin's daughters has one.) What two words are inside *du*? (***De*** and ***le***.)

39.3 au, aux — where *à* and *le* melt together

De plus *le* gave you **du**. Predict what *à* plus *le* gives before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au = **à** + **le**. · **aux** = **à** + **les**.

au café — to the café. · **aux cafés** — to the cafés.

à la maison — no contraction, because *la* is not *le*.

Two of the four combinations melt and two do not, and the split is the same one *du* already showed you: **le** and **les** contract, **la** and **l'** stay apart.

The *u* in **au** was an *l*. French turned **al** into **au** across the whole language, and once you have seen it you find it everywhere:

older shape	**modern**
bel	**beau**
cheval	**chevaux**
journal	**journaux**

So the **x** on *aux* and the *x* on *chevaux* are the same story, and a plural that looks irregular is an *l* that turned into a *u* eight centuries ago. The **x** of *aux* is silent alone and comes back as a **z** before a vowel — *aux amis* is *oh-ZAH-mee*, the liaison you have had since the numbers.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four — "au café", "aux cafés", "à la maison", "à l'eau"
- the pair that melt the same way — "du café", "au café"
- the liaison — "aux amis", *oh-ZAH-mee*
- the *l* that became a *u* — "bel, beau; cheval, chevaux"

Before you move on

What is *au* made of? (***À*** plus ***le***.) And *aux*? (***À*** plus ***les***.) Which two never contract? (***La*** and ***l'***.) What was the *u* of *au* before it was a *u*? (**An *l***, the same one inside *chevaux*.)

39.4 de la — the half of the partitive that was missing

Say "some bread" and "some water". Both are yours. Now try "some milk" — *le lait* is a *le*-word, but **la viande**, meat, is not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de la — some, in front of a *la*-word.

du lait — some milk. · **de la viande** — some meat. · **de l'eau** — some water.

Three shapes, one rule, and it is a rule you already own from two other places: **de** plus the article, contracting only where *le* and *les* contract. That is worth stating plainly, because it looks like three separate things to memorise and is one:

the noun takes	**some...**
le	**du**
la	**de la**
l'	**de l'**

The food chapter taught the first and third and stopped, because every noun on its table happened to be a *le*-word or a vowel-word. The middle line was never missing from the language, only from the table.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three shapes — "du lait, de la viande, de l'eau"
- the table you already had — "du pain, du vin, du fromage"
- the two drinks — "du café, du thé"
- article first, then the partitive — "le lait → du lait"
- pointed at, then measured — "ce lait", then "du lait"; "cette eau", then "de l'eau"

Before you move on

Which shape goes with a *la*-word? (***De la***.) With a *le*-word? (***Du***.) Why does *de la* not contract? (**Only *le* and *les* ever contract** — the same rule behind *du* and *au*.)

39.5 des — the plural of *un*, and the last shape of *some*

un café is *a café*. Say the plural. English drops the word entirely — *cafés* — and French cannot.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

des — some; and the plural of **un** and **une**.

un café → des cafés · une amie → des amies

Il y a des cafés. — There are cafés.

des is **de** + **les**, contracted exactly as *du* is *de* + *le*. So it completes two systems at once and adds no new machinery to either.
Here English is the language with the hole. English has *a* and no plural of it, so it says *books*, *cafés*, *friends* with nothing in front. French will not leave the slot empty, and a sentence with a bare plural noun in it sounds unfinished to a French ear. That is the single commonest mistake an English speaker makes in French, and it is a missing word rather than a wrong one.
The **s** is silent, and it comes back as a **z** before a vowel: *des amies* is *day-ZAH-mee*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- singular then plural — "un café, des cafés"
- "un chien, des chiens; un chat, des chats"
- the liaison — "des amies", *day-ZAH-mee*

- existence and identity, in the plural — “Il y a des cafés.” “Ce sont des amis.”
- all four shapes of *some* — “du, de la, de l’, des”

Before you move on

What two words are inside *des*? (***De*** and ***les***.) What is the plural of *un café*? (***Des cafés***.) What does English put in that slot? (**Nothing** — it has no plural of *a*.) Say all four shapes of *some*.

39.6 Au café — the chapter, run cold

Two prepositions and four articles make eight combinations. Four melt into one word and four do not. Say which four melt, and say the one rule that decides it.

Your turn: the four that melt

Say these aloud:

- *à* melting — “au café”, “aux cafés”
- *de* melting — “du pain”, “des amis”
- the four that stay apart — “à la maison”, “à l’eau”, “de la viande”, “de l’eau”
- the two liaisons — “aux amis”, “des amis”

Your turn: the distant band — everything, placed and possessed

Every noun the book owns, put in somebody’s hands and put somewhere. Say these aloud:

- the table, possessed — “le pain de Marie, le vin de Paris, le café d’Anne”
- the table, in the plural — “des œufs, des cafés, du sel, du sucre, du beurre”

- the household, possessed — “la mère de Marie, le frère d’Anne, la sœur de Paul”
- the animals — “le chien de l’enfant, le chat de l’ami”
- the clock, at last with a preposition — “à midi”, “à minuit”, “à trois heures”
- put it all together — “Il y a des cafés là-bas. C’est le café de Marie. Je suis au café.”

Before you move on

Which two articles contract, and which two never do? (***Le*** and ***les*** contract; ***la*** and ***l’*** do not.) Name the four melted words. (***Au, aux, du, des***.) How does French say “Marie’s bread”? (**Le pain de Marie**.) And what does English have that French does not need? (**An apostrophe.**)

Chapter 40

Two Ideas, One Sentence

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the order a French sentence holds to, and join two thoughts with and, or, but and because.
>
> *Every verb the book owns is given a reason. The chapter also names the sentence shape the reader has been building for thirty-odd chapters without being told what it was, and says why French is stricter about word order than Latin ever was: Latin's endings said who did what, French wore them off, and position had to take the job.*

40.1 sujet, verbe, objet — the order that carries the meaning

You have been building French sentences for thirty-odd chapters and nobody has said what shape they are. Say **je parle français** and **parlez-vous français ?** and notice that only one of the two moves anything.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the phrase that says a thing exists — *il y a*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The doer comes first, the verb second, and what is done to comes third.

Marie mange le pain. — Marie eats the bread.

Turn those three around and you change who eats whom. French depends on the order, and the dependence has a cause.
Latin did not depend on it. *Maria panem edit* and *panem Maria edit* mean the same thing, because **panem** carries an ending that says *this is the thing being eaten* wherever it stands. French wore those endings off — *panem* became *pain*, and the *-em* that did the work went with it. Once the endings were gone, something had to say who did what, and position took the job. So French is **stricter** about word order than its own parent was, and the strictness is the price of the simpler nouns.
Two places already break the order, and you own both: a question by inversion puts the verb first, and *voici* and *voilà* have no subject at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the plain order — "Marie mange le pain."
- turn it round and hear the meaning turn — "Le pain mange Marie."
- "Je parle français."
- the doer named by a possessive phrase — "Le frère de Marie mange le pain."
- the two shapes that break the order — "Parlez-vous français ?" and "Voici le café."

Before you move on

What order does a French sentence hold to? (**Doer, verb, done-to.**) Why is French stricter about it than Latin? (**Latin's endings said who did what; French wore them off**, so position had to take over.) Name the two shapes you own that break the order.

40.2 et — "and," and the one *t* that never wakes

You have said **et vous ?** and **et toi ?** many times as glue in a conversation. It has never been a word of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

et — and.

du pain et du vin — bread and wine.

Latin **et**, unchanged in two thousand years, and the same word inside English **etcetera**.
It hides one genuine oddity. Every other final **t** in French comes back to life before a vowel — *quand est-ce que* is *kahn-TESS-kuh*, and you met that liaison with the numbers. The **t** of **et** never does:

du pain et un café — *pan … ay … uh café*, with a clean break.

Nobody can say why this one word refuses. It is old enough that grammarians record the exception and do not explain it, and it is worth knowing because the liaison you would naturally make there is the one liaison a French ear will notice as wrong.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *et*, and the break after it — "du pain et un café"
- the table joined — "du pain et du vin", "du café et du lait"
- the household joined — "mon frère et ma sœur"
- with the plural — "des cafés et des amis"

Before you move on

What Latin word is *et*? (***Et***, unchanged.) What does its **t** do before a vowel? (**Nothing** — it is the one final *t* in French that never comes back.) Say "bread and a coffee" with the break in the right place.

40.3 ou — "or," and the accent that is the only difference

You own **où**, "where." Say it. This lesson takes the word that is spelled the same and means something else entirely.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ou — or. · **où** — where.

du café ou du thé ? — coffee or tea?

The two have nothing to do with each other. **ou** is Latin **aut**, "or"; **où** is Latin **ubi**, "where." Two unrelated words wore down until they landed on the same three letters, and French put a grave accent on one of them to keep the page readable.
That is now the third such pair you have seen, and they work the same way every time: **a/à**, **la/là**, **ou/où**. The accent carries no sound at all in any of the three — it is punctuation for the eye.
Spoken French makes no distinction whatever. *Où est le café ?* and *ou est le café* are the same noise, and only the sentence settles it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the choice — "du café ou du thé ?"
- "du pain ou du vin ?", "un chien ou un chat ?"
- the two joiners together — "du pain et du vin", "du pain ou du vin"
- all three accent pairs — "a/à, la/là, ou/où"

Before you move on

Which Latin word is *ou*? (***Aut.***) And *où*? (***Ubi.***) Do they sound different? (**No** — the accent is for the eye.) Name the other two pairs the accent keeps apart. (***A/à*** and ***la/là.***)

40.4 mais — "but," and the Latin word for *more*

Et adds. *Ou* offers a choice. Neither can say that the second half disagrees with the first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mais — but.

Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué. — I'm well, but I'm tired.

Said *may*: the **ai** is the *e* sound you met in *lait*, and the **s** is silent. **mais** is Latin **magis**, which meant **more** — and that is worth a moment, because the same word is still doing the older job next door. Spanish inherited *magis* as **más** and it still means *more*; French inherited it and drifted it into *but*.
The road between the two is short. *"He is clever, more he is lazy"* is not far from *"he is clever, but he is lazy"* — a *more* used to add a second, competing fact turns into a contrast if you use it that way for long enough. One Latin adverb, two daughters, two different parts of speech.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mais* — *may*, the *s* silent
- "Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué."
- "Il y a du café, mais il n'y a pas de thé."
- the three joiners in a row — "et, ou, mais"

Before you move on

What did *mais* mean in Latin? (***More*** — *magis.*) Which language still uses that word for *more*? (**Spanish**, as *más.*) Say the three joiners.

40.5 parce que — "because," and the three words inside it

You can ask **pourquoi ?**. Nothing you own can answer it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parce que — because.

Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué.

Three words are welded in there: **par** ("by"), **ce** ("this") and **que** ("that"). *By this that…* — a phrase that pointed forward at the reason about to be given, said so often that the first two fused and the third stayed loose.
English built its own the same way. **Because** is **by** + **cause**, and the seam is still faintly visible if you look. Two languages, two prepositions, two pointing words, one job.
Before a vowel the **que** elides, exactly as *le* and *de* do:

parce qu'il est midi — because it's noon.

And the **ce** inside it is the same *ce* you took two chapters ago — the fourth place that one small pointing word has turned up.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the question and its answer — "Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué."
- elided — "parce qu'il est midi"
- the three pieces, slowly — *par … ce … que*
- all four joiners — "et, ou, mais, parce que"

Before you move on

What three words are inside *parce que*? (***Par***, ***ce***, ***que*** — "by this that".) How did English build *because*? (**By** plus **cause** — the same

trick.) What happens to *que* before a vowel? (**It elides** — *parce qu'il.*)

40.6 Deux idées — the chapter, run cold

Say the four joiners. Then say what French lost that made its word order compulsory.

Your turn: joined, chosen, contrasted, explained

Say these aloud:

- joined — "du pain et du vin", "du café et du lait"
- chosen — "du café ou du thé ?", "de l'eau ou du vin ?"
- contrasted — "Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué."
- explained — "Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué."
- all four in one breath — "et, ou, mais, parce que"

Your turn: the distant band — every verb, given a reason

Every verb this book owns can now carry a reason. Say the sentence, then say why.

Say these aloud:

- "Je parle français, parce que j'habite à Paris."
- "Je travaille, mais je suis fatigué."
- the verbs of the page — "Je lis et j'écris."
- the verbs of the body — "Je marche ou je cours."
- "J'entends, mais je ne comprends pas."
- with the three modals — "Je veux dormir, parce que je suis fatigué." "Je peux prendre le café." "Je dois travailler."
- "J'aime le café, mais je demande du thé."

Before you move on

Which joiner was Latin for *more*? (***Mais***, from *magis*.) Which one has three words inside it? (***Parce que***.) Which one's *t* never makes a liaison? (***Et***.) And which two are kept apart only by an accent? (***Ou*** and ***où***.)

Chapter 41

Three More Ways to Use a Verb

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a command, say what is about to happen, run the second regular verb family, drop the ne the way speakers do, and use on.
>
> *Every verb the book owns is commanded, put in the near future and refused. The imperative costs almost nothing because voici and voila have been frozen commands since the pointing chapter, and the near future costs nothing at all because it walks into the modal chain the reader already owns – a fourth verb in a slot built for three.*

41.1 Parle ! — the command, and the pronoun that goes missing

French insists on a subject pronoun in every sentence — you were told why: the endings are silent, so *je*, *tu* and *ils* carry the person alone. There is one place it lets the pronoun go.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four melted words — *au, aux, du, des*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

To tell somebody to do something, take the **tu** form and drop the **tu** — and, for an *-er* verb, drop the **-s** as well.

tu parles → Parle ! · **tu écoutes → Écoute !**

vous parlez → Parlez ! — the polite one, unchanged.

The lost **-s** is a spelling rule and nothing more: it was silent anyway, so the command sounds identical to the form it came from. Only the page changes.
And you have been doing this since the pointing chapter without being told. **voici** and **voilà** are **vois** — the command form of *voir*, "see" — welded to *ci* and *là*. The shape was in your mouth before it had a name.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the form, then the command — "tu parles → Parle !"
- "Écoute !" and the polite "Écoutez !"
- the *-er* verbs you own — "Travaille ! Habite ! Aime ! Demande ! Marche !"
- the command you have said all along — "Voici", and the *vois* inside it

Before you move on

How do you build a command? (**Take the *tu* form, drop the pronoun** — and the *-s* on an *-er* verb.) Does it sound different from *tu parles*? (**No** — the *s* was silent.) Which word you have said for two chapters is a frozen command? (***Voici***.)

41.2 je vais partir — the future made out of "go"

Aller is yours, and so is the rule that a second verb after *vouloir*, *pouvoir* or *devoir* never changes. Put those two together before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aller + an unchanged second verb says the thing is about to happen.

Je vais partir. — I'm going to leave.

Je vais travailler. — I'm going to work.

The second verb sits in its dictionary form and stays there, exactly as it does after *je veux*, *je peux* and *je dois*. So this is not a new construction; it is a fourth verb walking into a chain you already own. What makes it worth a lesson is that English does the identical thing and nobody notices. *I am* ***going to*** *leave* has no walking in it at all — the verb of motion has been emptied out and pointed at time. French emptied its own verb of motion the same way, separately, and the two languages arrived at the same idiom by the same road.
Spoken French uses this far more than the one-word future that grammars teach first. It is the ordinary way to talk about tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Je vais partir." and "Je vais travailler."
- with the verbs of the page — "Je vais lire. Je vais écrire."
- "Je vais dormir. Je vais marcher."
- the chain, four verbs deep — "je veux dormir, je peux dormir, je dois dormir, je vais dormir"

Before you move on

What two pieces make the near future? (***Aller* plus a verb in its dictionary form**.) What does English use for the same job? (***Going to*** — its own emptied verb of motion.) Say "I'm going to read."

41.3 finir — the second regular family

parler gave you the biggest verb family in French. **dormir** was irregular and had to be learned as itself. There is a second **regular** family between them, and it also ends in *-ir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

finir — to finish.

Latin **finire**, from **finis**, "end" — the same root inside English **final**, **finish**, **finite** and **define**.
Said *fee-NEER*, with the *r* sounded, which is where it differs from an *-er* infinitive: *parler* ends in a clean *ay* and *finir* ends in a real *r*.

Grammar Lens: the plural grows a syllable

In the singular the stem is **fini-**; in the plural an extra **-iss-** appears before the ending.

Singular: **je finis**, **tu finis**, **il finit** — all three the same noise, which is the ordinary French silence you have met on *parle*, *parles* and *parlent*.
Plural: **nous finissons**, **vous finissez**, **ils finissent** — an extra syllable in every one, and that syllable is what tells the ear a plural is happening.
The **-iss-** is a fossil. Latin had a suffix **-isc-** that meant *begin to*, and **finire** picked it up as **finiscere**, "to begin to end." The starting sense wore away completely; the syllable stayed. So *nous finissons* is carrying a meaning the verb has not had for fifteen hundred years. Dozens of everyday verbs run this pattern — *choisir*, *grandir*, *réussir* — and every one of them adds the same syllable in the same three places.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the infinitive, with its *r* sounded — "finir"
- the three singular forms, all one noise — "je finis, tu finis, il finit"
- the plural, hearing the extra syllable — "nous finissons, vous finissez, ils finissent"
- the three infinitive endings side by side — "parler, finir, dormir"
- with the near future — "Je vais finir."

Before you move on

What appears in the plural of *finir*? (**An extra *-iss-***.) What did that syllable once mean? (***Begin to*** — Latin's *-isc-*.) Name the three infinitive endings you now own. (***-er***, ***-ir***, and the irregular *-ir* of *dormir*.)

41.4 je sais pas — the *ne* that speech leaves out

Say **je ne comprends pas**. Two words wrap the verb. In ordinary speech one of them is usually gone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

In speech the **ne** drops and the **pas** carries the negative alone.

written: **Je ne sais pas.** · said: **Je sais pas.**

This is not slang and it is not careless. It is what most French speakers do most of the time, and a learner who says every *ne* sounds like a written page read aloud.

The reason it can happen at all is in the history of **pas**. That word was the noun for a **step**: *je ne marche pas* first meant *I do not walk a step*, with the step there for emphasis, exactly as English says *not a bit* or *not a jot*. French did the same with *point* (a dot) and *mie* (a crumb). Then the emphasiser took over. **Pas** spread to every verb, lost its meaning entirely, and ended up carrying the negation by itself — after which the original **ne** became the optional half. The word that was decoration is now the load bearer, and the word that did the work is the one that falls off.

Written, both. Spoken, one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- written, then spoken — "Je ne sais pas." / "Je sais pas."
- "Je ne comprends pas." / "Je comprends pas."

- with this chapter's verb — "Je ne finis pas." / "Je finis pas."
- the step that is no longer a step — *pas*, the noun
- the answer-words you keep — "non" and the one that contradicts a negative, "si"

Before you move on

Which half of the negative does speech drop? (**The *ne***.) What was *pas* before it was a negative? (**A step** — a noun, put in for emphasis.) Which two other nouns did French use the same way? (***Point*** and ***mie***.)

41.5 on — the pronoun that was a word for *man*

You own six subject pronouns and none of them can say *people in general*. Say **personne**, then take the pronoun built out of a word like it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

on — one, people, they — and in everyday speech, **we**.

On parle français ici. — French is spoken here. / People speak French here.

On y va. — Let's go. (Literally: *one goes there*.)

It takes the same ending as *il* and *elle*, so nothing new has to be learned to use it: **on parle**, **on finit**, **on va**.
on is Latin **homo**, "man," worn down to two letters. Two neighbours did the identical thing with their own words: German turned *Mann* into the pronoun **man**, and English turned *one* into the pronoun **one** — *one does not do such things*. Three languages, three words for a person, all promoted to mean *anybody at all*.
What French then did that the others did not is let it take over **nous**. *On y va* is what people actually say for *let's go*, and *nous* survives mostly in writing. So the pronoun for nobody in particular has quietly become the pronoun for **us**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *on* — one syllable, nasal
- "On parle français ici."
- the one everybody says — "On y va."
- with this chapter's verbs — "On finit." "On va travailler."
- with the dropped *ne* — "On sait pas."
- the three cousins — French *on*, German *man*, English *one*

Before you move on

What Latin word is *on*? (***Homo***, "man".) Which ending does it take? (**The same as *il*** — *on parle*.) What does it stand in for in everyday speech? (***Nous*** — "we".) Say "let's go."

41.6 On y va ! — the chapter, run cold

> Three of the five things in this chapter are shapes a verb can take and two are words. Sort them, then say which shape leaves the pronoun out and which word replaces one.

Your turn: every verb, three ways

Every verb the book owns, commanded, put in the near future, and refused. Say these aloud:

- commanded — "Parle ! Travaille ! Écoute ! Marche ! Demande !"
- about to happen — "Je vais lire. Je vais écrire. Je vais dormir. Je vais courir."
- refused, in speech — "Je comprends pas. J'entends pas. Je finis pas."
- the false friend, still false — *demander* asks, it does not demand
- the one that means both walk and work — *marcher*

Your turn: the distant band — on, and the whole table

The whole table, with *on* in front of it and the joiners between.

Say these aloud:

- "On va au café. On prend du pain et du fromage."
- "Il y a du café et du thé, mais il n'y a pas de lait."
- "On finit le pain, parce qu'on a faim."
- the whole table in the plural — "des œufs, du sel, du sucre, du beurre, de l'eau"
- "On parle français ici, mais on parle anglais là-bas."
- the three cousins of *on* — French *on*, German *man*, English *one*

Before you move on

How do you build a command? (**The *tu* form without its pronoun** — and without its *-s* on an *-er* verb.) What two pieces make the near future? (***Aller* plus a plain verb**.) What grows in the plural of *finir*? (**An extra *-iss-***.) Which half of the negative does speech drop? (**The *ne***.) And what was *on* in Latin? (***Homo***, "man".)

Chapter 42

What the Ear Cannot Hear

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I know why a written consonant at the end of a French word is silent, what the plural and the feminine do about it, and what happens to some after a negative.
>
> *One sound rule and the four spellings that hang off it. The chapter names the thing the reader has been working around since the numbers – a final consonant is silent – and then shows the plural, the feminine, the -x plural and the negative partitive as four consequences of it rather than four separate facts.*

42.1 la consonne finale — the rule under half this book

Say **quand**, **et**, **parlez**, **des**. Four words, four written consonants at the end, and not one of them sounded. Nobody has yet said why.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the joiner Latin used for *more* — *mais*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

> A consonant written at the end of a French word is normally **not pronounced**.

Salut is *sa-LU*. *Deux* is *deu*. *Trois* is *trwah*. *Nuit* is *nwee*. The letter is on the page and not in the mouth.

Those letters were once sounded. Old French said the *t* of *salut* and the *s* of *trois*, and over centuries the mouth dropped them while the spelling stayed where it was. Every silent consonant in French is a fossil of a sound the language used to make.
Two things bring them back to life, and you own both:

- **Liaison.** Before a vowel the consonant wakes up — *des amis* is *day-ZAH-mee*, *quand est-ce que* is *kahn-TESS-kuh*. You met this on the numbers.
- **A following -e.** Add an *-e* and the consonant is no longer final, so it is no longer silent. That is the next lesson.

There are exceptions worth naming, and the shortest way to hold them is the word **CaReFuL** — *c*, *r*, *f*, *l* are the four consonants that usually **do** sound at the end: *avec*, *bonjour*, *neuf*, *il*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- silent — "salut, deux, trois, nuit"
- woken by a vowel — "des amis", "quand est-ce que"
- the four that usually sound — "avec, bonjour, neuf, il"
- the one *t* that never wakes — "et un café"
- a silent letter you have been pointing with — "ces cafés", where the *s* is heard only before a vowel
- the accent that is not a sound either — "là", "là-bas"

Before you move on

What happens to a consonant written at the end of a French word? (**It is normally silent.**) What wakes it? (**A following vowel** — liaison.) Which four usually sound anyway? (***C, r, f, l*** — *careful.*) And which word refuses to make its liaison at all? (***Et.***)

42.2 le pluriel en -s — written, and never heard

A final consonant is silent. A plural is written with a final **s**. Put the two facts together before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

A French noun takes **-s** in the plural, and that **-s** is silent.

le café → **les cafés** — *luh ka-FAY* → *lay ka-FAY*

Say those two aloud and listen. The noun did not change at all. Only the article in front of it did.
That is the whole reason the article system matters so much here. **le**, **la**, **les**, **un**, **une**, **des** are not ornament — they are the **only** place a French listener can hear that more than one thing is meant. Drop the article, as English does with a bare plural, and a French sentence becomes genuinely ambiguous.
The **-s** does come back before a vowel, as a **z**: *les amis* is *lay-ZAH-mee*. So the plural is audible exactly when the next word begins with a vowel and inaudible otherwise, which is one more reason liaison is not optional politeness.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, listening for no difference — "le café, les cafés"
- "le chien, les chiens; le chat, les chats"
- the plural that IS audible — "les amis", *lay-ZAH-mee*
- with *des* — "des cafés, des chiens, des œufs"
- the article carrying the whole load — "le" against "les"

Before you move on

Is the plural *-s* pronounced? (**No** — it is a final consonant.) Then what tells a listener a plural is meant? (**The article** — *les*, *des*.) When does the *-s* come back? (**Before a vowel**, as a *z*.)

42.3 petit, petite — the ending that wakes the letter before it

Say **bon** and **bonne**. You have had both since page one, and the difference between them has never been named.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The feminine of an adjective adds **-e**. That **-e** is itself silent — and it makes the consonant in front of it audible.

petit — *puh-TEE.* · **petite** — *puh-TEET.* ("small")

vert — *vair.* · **verte** — *vairt.* ("green")

Nothing is added to the sound at the end. What changes is that the *t* stops being final, so the rule from two lessons ago no longer silences it. This is worth holding on to, because it makes the feminine **easier to hear than to see**. A French listener knows *petite* from *petit* instantly — one ends in a consonant and one does not — while a reader has to notice a letter that is never said.
The other colours you own behave the same way: *blanc* and *blanche*; *noir* and *noire*, where the *r* was already sounding and nothing changes at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, hearing the *t* arrive — "petit, petite"
- "vert, verte" — the *t* arrives again
- "blanc, blanche"
- the one that does not change — "noir, noire"
- with a noun behind it — "le vin blanc", "la maison blanche"
- the pair you have had since page one — "bon, bonne"

Before you move on

Is the feminine *-e* pronounced? (**No.**) Then what does it do? (**It stops the consonant before it being final**, so that consonant sounds.) Is the feminine easier to hear or to see? (**To hear** — the difference is a whole consonant.)

42.4 les bateaux — the plural that is not irregular

You were told that the *u* in **au** was once an *l*. That fact has been waiting two chapters to pay for itself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nouns ending in **-eau** and **-eu** take **-x** in the plural instead of **-s**, and nouns already ending in **-s**, **-x** or **-z** take nothing.

le bateau → les bateaux · le cheveu → les cheveux · le nez → les nez

The **x** is silent, exactly as the **s** is, so once again the article carries the whole plural.
Two of the three lines are the same story you already have. **Cheval** became **chevaux** because *-als* turned into *-aus*, and French wrote that *-aus* as *-aux*. That is the change that made **au** out of *à + le* — an *l* softening into a *u* somewhere around the twelfth century, right across the language.
So *chevaux* is not an irregular plural at all. It is a perfectly regular plural of a word whose *l* melted, and the strange-looking *x* is a spelling convention for a *u-s* that got there honestly.
The third line is simpler still: a word that already ends in *s*, *x* or *z* has nowhere to put another one, so it does not try. **Le nez** and **les nez** share the same three-letter noun.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — “le bateau, les bateaux”

- "le cheveu, les cheveux"
- the invariable — "le nez, les nez"
- the *l* that melted — "cheval, chevaux" and "à le, au"
- with the indefinite — "des bateaux, des cheveux"

Before you move on

Which endings take *-x*? (***-eau*** and ***-eu***.) Which take nothing at all? (**Words already ending in *s*, *x* or *z***.) Why is *chevaux* not really irregular? (**Its *l* melted into a *u***, the same change that made *au*.)

42.5 pas de pain — where the partitive collapses

Say the four shapes of *some*: **du**, **de la**, **de l'**, **des**. Now negate one of them and watch all four become the same word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

After a negative, **du**, **de la**, **de l'** and **des** all become a bare **de**.

J'ai du pain. → Je n'ai pas de pain.

Il y a des cafés. → Il n'y a pas de cafés.

Je bois de l'eau. → Je ne bois pas d'eau.

Four shapes, one replacement, and it elides before a vowel like everything else.

The reason is in what the partitive was doing. **Du pain** means *an amount of bread* — the article was measuring. A negative says the amount is **zero**, and there is nothing left to measure, so the measuring article drops out and only the bare *de* remains.

This does **not** happen to *le*, *la* and *les*. **Je n'aime pas le café** keeps its article, because that sentence is about coffee in general rather than a quantity of it. So the collapse is a test: if the article was measuring an amount, it goes.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "J'ai du pain." / "Je n'ai pas de pain."
- "Il y a du lait." / "Il n'y a pas de lait."
- elided — "Je ne bois pas d'eau."
- the one that keeps its article — "Je n'aime pas le café."
- with the *ne* dropped, as speech does — "Y a pas de pain."
- where you are going, and what is not there — "Je vais au café, mais il n'y a pas de café."
- about to happen, and refused — "Je vais prendre du pain." / "Je ne vais pas prendre de pain."

Before you move on

What do *du*, *de la*, *de l'* and *des* become after a negative? (**A bare *de*.**) Why? (**The article was measuring an amount, and the negative makes the amount zero.**) Which articles do **not** collapse? (***Le***, ***la***, ***les***.)

42.6 Ce qu'on n'entend pas — the chapter, run cold

One rule about sound runs under this whole chapter. State it. Then name the two things that bring a silent consonant back.

Your turn: silent, and woken

Say these aloud:

- silent — "salut, deux, trois, nuit"
- woken by a vowel — "des amis", "quand est-ce que", "six ans", "dix ans", "neuf ans"
- the four that sound anyway — "avec, bonjour, neuf, il"
- the one *t* that refuses — "et un café"

Your turn: the distant band — everything, in the plural and the feminine

Every noun the book owns, made plural — and listen for how little changes.

Say these aloud:

- the table — "les cafés, les pains, les œufs"
- the household and the animals — "les frères, les sœurs, les enfants, les chiens, les chats, les amis"
- the body — "les mains, les têtes, les nez, les bouches" — and the one that goes its own way, "l'œil, les yeux"
- the colours, masculine then feminine — "vert, verte; blanc, blanche; noir, noire; bon, bonne"
- the ones that never change in the feminine — "rouge, bleu, jaune"
- the article doing all the work — "le café" against "les cafés"

Your turn: and none of it

Say these aloud:

- the four shapes, then their one negative — "du, de la, de l', des" → "pas de"
- "Il n'y a pas de pain. Il n'y a pas de lait. Il n'y a pas d'eau."
- as speech says it — "Y a pas de café."

Before you move on

Why is the plural *-s* silent? (**Because every final consonant is.**) Why is the feminine *-e* audible even though it is silent? (**It stops the consonant before it being final.**) Why is *chevaux* not irregular? (**Its *l* became a *u*.**) And what do all four partitives become after a negative? (**A bare *de*.**)

Chapter 43

Standing Alone

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask who and what, and use the pronouns that stand on their own instead of leaning on a verb.
>
> *Every person and every thing the book owns is asked about and answered. One accident runs under three of the chapter's four pairs: a pronoun that lived unstressed in front of a verb wore down, and the one that stood alone kept its weight – which is why French has que and quoi, je and moi, tu and toi, and only one elle.*

43.1 qui — "who," the word Latin barely changed

Five question words are yours — *où, quand, comment, combien, pourquoi*. Every one of them asks about a circumstance. None of them can ask about a **person**.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the pronoun that was Latin for *man* — *on*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

qui — who.

Qui est-ce ? — Who is it? · **Qui est là ?** — Who's there?

Latin **quis**, and almost nothing has happened to it. That is unusual:

most French words are half the length of their Latin parents — *aqua* to *eau*, *calidus* to *chaud* — and this one lost a single consonant in two thousand years.
The **qu-** is the same opening that starts *quand*, *quel* and *combien*'s cousins, and English carries it in the borrowed words **query**, **question** and **quest**.
One thing to watch: **qui** never elides. *Qui est* stays two clean words where *que* would have become *qu'*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *qui* — one syllable, *kee*
- "Qui est-ce ?" and "Qui est là ?"
- ask, then answer with what you own — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est ma mère."
- "Qui est ici ? — Voici mon ami."
- asked about several people, with the plural you cannot hear — "Qui sont les amis ?"
- the six question words together — "qui, où, quand, comment, combien, pourquoi"

Before you move on

What Latin word is *qui*? (***Quis***, one letter shorter.) Does it elide before a vowel? (**No** — *qui est*, two clean words.) Ask who somebody is and answer with your mother.

43.2 que — "what," and the word that always elides

You have said **que** twice already without meeting it: inside **est-ce que** and inside **parce que**. Say both.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

que — what.

Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — What is it?

qui and **que** are Latin **quis** and **quid** — the *who* and the *what* of one pronoun, kept as a pair. French has both halves where English rebuilt its own from a different root.
Unlike *qui*, **que** always elides before a vowel, and that is why the commonest question in French looks so alarming on the page.
Qu'est-ce que c'est is four ordinary words: *que* + *est-ce* + *que* + *c'est* — "what is it that this is." Said aloud it is three syllables, *kess-kuh-SAY*, and it is the first thing a learner should be able to say without thinking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the big one, slowly, then fast — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?" → *kess-kuh-SAY*
- the four pieces — *que, est-ce, que, c'est*
- ask and answer — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — C'est du pain."
- the pair — "Qui est-ce ?" against "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?"
- ask about an action — "Qu'est-ce que tu finis ?" and the plural that grows a syllable, "Qu'est-ce que vous finissez ?"

Before you move on

Which of the pair elides? (***Que.***) What four words are inside *qu'est-ce que c'est*? (***Que, est-ce, que, c'est.***) Which asks about a person and which about a thing?

43.3 quoi — "what," standing on its own two feet

Say **que**. Now try to say it alone, as a one-word question. It cannot be done — the word is too light to stand up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quoi — what, when it has to carry weight.

Quoi ? — What? · **De quoi ?** — Of what? · **À quoi ?** — To what?

que and **quoi** are the same Latin **quid**, twice. One of them spent centuries unstressed in front of a verb and wore down to a single silent-*e* syllable; the other spent those centuries alone or after a preposition, where it had to be heard, and kept its weight.
So the split is not a rule somebody invented. It is one word that lived two different lives in two different positions.
The practical test is short: **que** leans on something and **quoi** does not. After a preposition — *de*, *à* — only *quoi* will do.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alone — "Quoi ?"
- after a preposition — "De quoi ?", "À quoi ?"
- the pair — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?" against "C'est quoi ?"
- all three pronouns — "qui, que, quoi"

Before you move on

Which of the two can stand alone? (***Quoi.***) Which one follows a preposition? (***Quoi.***) What single Latin word are both? (***Quid*** — worn two ways by two positions.) Say all three pronouns.

43.4 moi et toi — the pronouns that can stand alone

Je and **tu** cannot stand alone either — they must lean on a verb. You have seen that happen to *que* in the last lesson, and the same accident produced the same result here.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moi — me. · **toi** — you, informally.

Moi ? — Me? · **Et toi ?** — And you? · **C'est moi.** — It's me.

You have said **et toi ?** and **et vous ?** for a long time as a fixed piece of conversation. This is the word inside it.
je and **moi** are one Latin pronoun, **tu** and **toi** are another, and each split for the reason *que* and *quoi* split: the form that lived unstressed in front of a verb wore down, and the form that stood alone or after a preposition kept its weight. Three pairs, one accident.
The polite twin of *toi* is **vous**, which does both jobs and does not split — *et vous ?* is the same word as the *vous* in *vous parlez*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alone — "Moi ?" "Toi ?"
- the phrase you already had — "Ça va bien, et toi ?"
- politely — "Et vous ?"
- "C'est moi." "C'est toi."
- the three pairs the same accident made — "je/moi, tu/toi, que/quoi"
- in the order a sentence holds to, doer first — "Moi, je parle français."

Before you move on

Which form of *je* stands alone? (***Moi.***) And of *tu*? (***Toi.***) Which earlier pair split the same way? (***Que*** and ***quoi.***) What is the polite word that does not split? (***Vous.***)

43.5 lui et elle — the third pair, and the one that did not split

Je became *moi*, *tu* became *toi*. Predict what *il* becomes, then predict what *elle* becomes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lui — him, standing alone. · **elle** — her, and also *she*.

C'est lui. — It's him. · **C'est elle.** — It's her.

Only half the prediction comes true. **il** does split, into **lui** — and **elle** does not split at all. The same four letters do both jobs: *elle parle* and *c'est elle*.
Nothing decided that except which syllables happened to carry stress in Latin. *Illi* gave *lui*, *ille* gave *il*, and *illa* gave one *elle* that was heavy enough already. The masculine split and the feminine did not, and the language has lived with the asymmetry ever since.
That same *ille* family is where **le**, **la** and **les** came from, so the article and the pronoun in front of you are cousins several times over.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "C'est lui." "C'est elle."
- the four that stand alone — "moi, toi, lui, elle"
- the feminine doing both jobs — "elle parle" and "c'est elle"
- ask and answer — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est lui."
- the cousins — "il, elle, le, la", all from one Latin family
- offer a choice between them — "C'est lui ou c'est elle ?"
- the plural that takes an *x* — "les cheveux de lui", and "les bateaux"

Before you move on

What does *il* become when it stands alone? (***Lui.***) And *elle*? (***Elle*** — it does not change.) Which Latin family gave *il*, *elle*, *le* and *la*? (***Ille, illa, illi*** — one family.) Say the four standing pronouns.

43.6 Qui est-ce ? — the chapter, run cold

One accident made three of this chapter's pairs. Name the accident, then name the three pairs.

Your turn: asking about people and things

Every person and every thing the book owns, asked about and answered.

Say these aloud:

- about people — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est ma mère. C'est mon père. C'est mon frère. C'est ma sœur."
- "Qui est-ce ? — C'est mon ami. C'est l'enfant."
- about things — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — C'est du pain. C'est du café. C'est du fromage."
- the short spoken version — "C'est quoi ?"
- the three ways to ask, all still yours — voice, *est-ce que*, inversion

Your turn: the distant band — standing alone

The leaning pronouns and the standing ones, side by side.

Say these aloud:

- leaning — "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"
- standing — "moi, toi, lui, elle"
- the pairs — "je/moi, tu/toi, il/lui" — and the one that did not split, "elle"
- the same accident on a question word — "que/quoi"
- the phrase you have had all along — "Ça va bien, et toi ?" and politely, "Et vous ?"
- the pronoun that took over from *nous* — "On y va."
- contrasted — "Moi, oui, mais toi, non."

Before you move on

Which question pronoun never elides? (***Qui.***) Which one always does? (***Que.***) Which one stands alone and follows a preposition? (***Quoi.***) And which of the four standing pronouns is the same word as its leaning twin? (***Elle.***)

Chapter 44

How Much, and What to Call People

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lot, a little, very and enough, and address somebody the way French expects.
>
> *Combien ? has had no possible answer since it was taught, and now it has four. The chapter also finishes the bare-de rule: a quantity word is already measuring, so the measuring article drops – which is the same reason the partitive collapses after a negative, one chapter earlier.*

44.1 beaucoup — "a beautiful blow"

You can say *some* four ways and *none* one way. You have no way at all to say **a lot**.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four partitives collapsing after a negative — *pas de*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beaucoup — a lot, much, many.

beaucoup de café — a lot of coffee. · **beaucoup d'amis** — a lot of friends.

Note what follows it: a bare **de**, exactly as after a negative. Any word of quantity in French takes *de* and never *du* or *des*, for the same reason

— the quantity word is already doing the measuring, so the measuring article drops out.
beaucoup is **beau** + **coup**, "a **beautiful blow**." *Coup* is Latin **colaphus**, a punch on the ear, and English borrowed it far more politely as *coup d'état* and *a coup*. A word from a fistfight became the ordinary French for *a lot* — the promotion any word earns by carrying emphasis often enough.
The **p** is silent, as final consonants are: *boh-KOO*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *beaucoup* — *boh-KOO*, the *p* silent
- "beaucoup de café", "beaucoup de pain", "beaucoup d'amis"
- the three shapes of the same *de* — "du café", "pas de café", "beaucoup de café"
- the two words inside it — *beau* and *coup*
- asked and explained — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — Beaucoup de café, parce que j'ai beaucoup d'amis."

Before you move on

What follows *beaucoup*? (**A bare *de*** — never *du* or *des*.) Why? (**The quantity word is already measuring**, so the article drops.) What two words are inside it? (***Beau*** and ***coup*** — a beautiful blow.)

44.2 un peu — the other end of the scale

Beaucoup de café. Say it, and say what has to follow any word of quantity.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

un peu — a little.

un peu de café — a little coffee. · **un peu d'eau** — a

little water.

The same bare **de** follows it, because the same reasoning applies: the quantity is already stated.
peu is Latin **paucus**, "few," and English has it twice — in **paucity**, borrowed from the Latin directly, and buried in **poor**, which came through French from *pauper*. So the everyday French word for *a little* and the English word for *scarcity* are one Latin adjective that travelled by two roads.
un peu is also the standard modest answer to a question about what you can do:

Vous parlez français ? — Un peu.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, both ends of the scale — "beaucoup de café", "un peu de café"
- "un peu de pain", "un peu d'eau"
- the modest answer — "Vous parlez français ? — Un peu."
- asked short — "C'est quoi ? — Un peu de pain."

Before you move on

What follows *un peu*? (**A bare *de***, as after *beaucoup*.) What Latin word is *peu*? (***Paucus***, "few" — English *paucity*.) Answer *vous parlez français ?* modestly.

44.3 très — "very," and the line it crosses

Beaucoup and *un peu* measure a **thing** and both take *de*. This one measures a **quality**, and it takes nothing at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

très — very, in front of an adjective or an adverb.

très bien — very well. · **très bon** — very good.

No *de*, ever. That is the whole difference: *beaucoup* and *un peu* stand in front of a **noun** and need the bare *de*; *très* stands in front of an **adjective** and needs nothing.
très is Latin **trans**, "across, beyond" — the *trans* of *transport* and *translate*. To say a thing is *très bon* is to say it has gone **across a line** into another category, which is what every intensifier in every language is trying to do.
The **s** is silent and comes back as a **z** before a vowel: *très intéressant* is *tray-zan-tay-ress-AHN*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "très bien", "très bon"
- the feminine — "très bonne"
- the contrast — "beaucoup de café" against "très bon"
- the liaison — "très intéressant"
- the answer everybody gives — "Ça va ? — Très bien, merci."
- as a command — "Parle très bien !" and "Écoute !"
- standing alone — "Moi, très bien. Et toi ?"
- the weather, measured — "Il fait très chaud." "Il pleut", and *le temps*, which is both the time and the weather
- the colours, measured — "très vert", "très jaune", and the German cousin *gelb* that *jaune* is not

Before you move on

What does *très* stand in front of? (**An adjective or an adverb** — never a noun.) Does it take *de*? (**No.**) What Latin word is it? (***Trans***, "across".)

44.4 assez — "enough," and "rather"

Three quantity words are yours. Two take *de* and one does not. Say which is which before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assez — enough; and also *rather*, *fairly*.

assez de café — enough coffee. · **assez bon** — rather good.

It does both jobs, and which one it is doing depends on what follows it: before a **noun** it takes *de* and means *enough*; before an **adjective** it takes nothing and means *rather*.
So *assez* behaves like *beaucoup* in one position and like *très* in the other, which makes it the word that ties the chapter together.
assez is Latin **ad satis**, "to enough." That *satis* is the root inside English **satisfy**, **saturate** and **satiate** — so to be *satisfied* is literally to have been given **enough**.
The **z** is silent, like every final consonant, and unlike *très* it does not usually come back before a vowel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- with a noun — "assez de café", "assez de pain"
- with an adjective — "assez bon", "assez bien"
- all four, in order of size — "un peu, assez, beaucoup" and, for a quality, "très"
- the Latin inside it — *ad satis*, and English *satisfy*

- about to happen — “Je vais prendre assez de pain.”
- about him — “Lui ? Assez bien.”

Before you move on

When does *assez* take *de*? (**Before a noun**, where it means *enough*.) And when does it take nothing? (**Before an adjective**, where it means *rather*.) What Latin phrase is it? (***Ad satis*** — “to enough”.) Which English words share that root?

44.5 Monsieur, Madame — “my lord” and “my lady”

You have said **bonjour** since page one and **vous** since the second chapter. A bare *bonjour* to a stranger in France is slightly abrupt, and the word that fixes it is one you have never met.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Monsieur — sir. · **Madame** — madam. · **Mademoiselle** — miss.

Bonjour, Monsieur. · **Bonjour, Madame.**

Two possessives fused into titles. **Monsieur** is **mon sieur**, “my lord,” and **Madame** is **ma dame**, “my lady” — the same *dame* inside English *dame* and *damsel*, and the *sieur* is a worn-down *seigneur*, from Latin **senior**, “the elder.”
The spelling records a word the mouth stopped saying centuries ago. **Monsieur** is pronounced *muh-SYUH*: the *n* has gone nasal-free, the *s* is silent, and the ending is the *eu* vowel. Nothing about the sound follows from the letters, which is why it is worth learning as a noise first and a spelling second.
Where English attaches a surname — *good morning, Mr Dubois* — French attaches the bare title far more often. **Bonjour, Madame** to a shopkeeper is ordinary and expected; the surname is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the noise, not the spelling — "Monsieur", *muh-SYUH*
- the greeting, completed — "Bonjour, Monsieur." "Bonjour, Madame."
- at night — "Bonsoir, Madame."
- thanking and leaving — "Merci, Monsieur." "Au revoir, Madame."
- introducing — "Voici Madame Dubois."
- the two possessives inside them — *mon sieur*, *ma dame*
- closing a conversation — "Je finis, Monsieur." and "Nous finissons, Madame."
- the courtesy words, each with a title — "S'il vous plaît, Monsieur." "Je suis désolé, Madame." "Oui, Monsieur."
- admitting it politely — "Je ne comprends pas, Monsieur." and the stem it borrows from *prendre*

Before you move on

What two words are inside *Monsieur*? (***Mon*** and ***sieur*** — "my lord".) And inside *Madame*? (***Ma*** and ***dame***.) How is *Monsieur* said? (*Muh-SYUH* — the *s* silent.) Greet a shopkeeper properly.

44.6 Combien ? — the chapter, run cold

Four measures. Three take a bare *de* in at least one position and one never does. Sort them, then say the one rule that decides it.

Your turn: the answers combien was waiting for

Combien ? has had no answer since it was taught. Now it has four. Say these aloud:

- the whole table, measured — "beaucoup de café, un peu de lait, assez de pain, pas de vin"
- "beaucoup de fromage, un peu de sucre, assez de sel, pas de beurre"
- with the plural — "beaucoup d'œufs", "pas d'œufs"
- the four shapes of *de* in one breath — "du café, pas de café, beaucoup de café, un peu de café"

Your turn: the distant band — qualities, measured

Every adjective the book owns, intensified — and no *de* anywhere.
Say these aloud:

- "très bon, très bien, assez bon"
- the feminine — "très bonne", and the consonant it wakes
- the colours — "très rouge, très blanc, assez noir, très vert"
- with the noun behind — "un vin très rouge", "un pain très blanc"
- the everyday exchange — "Ça va ? — Très bien, merci."

Your turn: and the person you are talking to

Say these aloud:

- the greeting completed — "Bonjour, Monsieur." "Bonsoir, Madame."
- "Merci, Madame." "Au revoir, Monsieur."
- "Qui est-ce ? — C'est Madame Dubois." then "Voici Madame Dubois."
- written, then as speech says it — "Je ne sais pas, Monsieur." / "Je sais pas."

Before you move on

Which of the four measures refuses *de*? (***Très***.) Which one takes it before a noun and not before an adjective? (***Assez***.) Why do quantity words take a bare *de* at all? (**They are already measuring**, so the measuring article drops.) And what two words are inside *Monsieur*?

Chapter 45

Reading — Instructions, a Form, and a First Paragraph

Modes: **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read a French instruction, a line off a form, and a whole paragraph, without translating word by word.

Sixty-three words of French in a row with no new word in them, including the sentence that admits it did not follow everything and carries on anyway.

45.1 (reading) — six things you would be told

Every line below you have heard and said. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody says them first.

Read this

Parle ! Écoute ! On y va ! Un peu Beaucoup Merci

Read it: down the list once, without stopping
Read it: the list again, and notice that three of them end in an exclamation mark and three do not
French puts a space before it, which English does not.

Why it's said this way

Parle ! and **Écoute !** are the same verbs you conjugate, with the ending taken off and nothing put in its place. That is the whole imperative.
An instruction you can only recognise by ear is one somebody has to say to you. On a page it waits, which is why a classroom is the first place a beginner reads rather than listens.
Six lines, and half of them are one word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
What does French put before an exclamation mark? (**A space.**)

45.2 (reading) — six lines off a form

The last lesson gave you things somebody says. These are things somebody writes down.

Nothing here is new.

Read this

Nom : Marie Âge : vingt ans Lundi : le travail Mardi : un livre Une heure Dix minutes

Read it: the six lines down once, without stopping
Read it: the six lines again, and notice the colon
French puts a space before that too, and the space is the clearest signal on the page that a label has ended.

Why it's said this way

A form is the first thing a beginner can read end to end. It puts the label before the value every time, and it never asks for a verb.

That is why the last two lines are the hardest, not the first four. **Une heure** and **Dix minutes** have no label in front of them, so nothing tells you what they are for until you have read them.
Six lines, and four of them do half your work.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which two lines have no label? (**Une heure** and **Dix minutes**.)
What does French put before a colon? (**A space.**)

45.3 (reading) — the first paragraph

Six instructions, then six lines off a form. Now a whole paragraph.

Sixty-three words, and not one of them is new.

Read this

Bonjour ! Je m'appelle Marie. J'habite à Paris. J'ai un frère et une sœur. Je bois du café et je mange du pain. Le jour, je vais au travail. Je travaille beaucoup, mais j'aime ça. Le soir, je lis un livre. Le livre est très bon. Je ne comprends pas tout, mais ça va. Demain, je vais parler français. Merci et au revoir.

Read it: the passage once without stopping; do not translate as you go — let the sentences arrive
Read it: the passage again, and notice how little work it took

Why it's said this way

Look at what is holding it together, because it is not vocabulary. **Et** adds. **Mais** holds two true things apart, and it does it twice here — once about work and once about understanding. Each of those was

a chapter, and none of them is longer than four letters.
Notice the tenth line especially. **Je ne comprends pas tout, mais ça va.** Somebody has admitted they did not follow everything, and the paragraph carries on. That is the most useful sentence on this page. This is the first whole paragraph the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because everything in it was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the paragraph aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that paragraph were new? (**None.**)
Which word appears twice and turns the sentence both times? (**Mais.**)

Chapter 46

Writing — My Own Line

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write one line about myself from a closed supply of known words, with nothing to copy, and put every accent on.
>
> *Complete FR-W02-ma-propre-ligne: subject, verb and the rest, chosen rather than copied, with the accents checked before anything else.*

46.1 Your own line — the first writing with no model

> Everything you have written so far had something to reach for — a shape, a word, a sound.
>
> This does not. You choose the words, from a supply that is closed: only what this book has taught you.

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** about yourself. Subject, verb, then the rest — the order you already know.

One thing to decide deliberately rather than by accident before you start: **the accents are letters, not decoration.**

An acute on an **e** is not a flourish on the same letter; it makes a different sound and, often enough, a different word. A hand that writes French without accents has not written French untidily — it has written something else and hoped the reader would guess.

Write the line. Then read it back and check the accents **before** you check anything else.

Before you move on

Are French accents decoration? (**No** — they are part of the letter.) And what did you choose here that the earlier lessons chose for you? (**The words.**)

Chapter 47

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complete the DELF A1 writing paper's two parts inside its published thirty minutes, and write past the forty-word floor rather than up to it.
>
> *Complete FR-W03-avec-la-montre: ten minutes for the form and twenty for the message, then count the words against a floor that has no ceiling.*

47.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do.

Writing — timed production

What France Éducation international publishes. The DELF A1 writing paper runs **30 minutes** and holds **two** parts: a form to complete, and a personal message of **at least forty words**.

Those numbers are read out of `task-shapes/a1.json`, which transcribes the published materials. Note what is *not* there: the paper publishes a **minimum** for the message and no maximum. Forty is a floor, not a target.

Ten minutes for the form, starting now. Fill every field.

Now **twenty minutes** for the message. Forty words is the floor; write past it rather than up to it.

Stop when the time is up, even mid-word.

Before you move on

Count your words. **Under forty and the task has not been done** — this is the one number on the paper that is a hard floor rather than guidance.

Now the rule worth carrying out of this lesson, because it changes how you should study rather than how you should write today. DELF A1 passes on **50 out of 100 overall** — and **any single skill below 5 out of 25 is eliminatory.** A candidate with 45 across three papers and 4 in the fourth does not pass, whatever the total says.

So the paper that decides your result is **the one you are worst at**, not the average of four. If that is writing, no amount of reading practice repairs it.

Chapter 48

Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Moves Nothing

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write four connected lines to a named reader, joining with et and mais and giving a reason with parce que, keeping ordinary word order after it.
>
> *Complete FR-W04-quatre-lignes: four lines to one reader, at least one joined with et or mais and one with parce que, then check the words after parce que are in ordinary order.*

48.1 Four lines, and the joiner that moves nothing

> The last lesson asked for writing **finished on time**. This one asks for writing that **holds together**.
>
> Pick one person who will read it.

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can be connected; one long line can fail to be. What makes it connected is that a sentence stops standing on its own.

You hold three joiners. **et** adds. **mais** sets against. **parce que** gives the reason.

And here is the thing to notice, which is easiest to see by contrast. In German, the word for *because* drags the verb to the end of its clause: the join is visible in the word order. **French does nothing of the kind.**

After **parce que**, the words stand in exactly the order they would have stood in on their own — subject, verb, the rest. Nothing moves.

That makes French easier to *write* and harder to *hear*. Nothing in the shape of the second clause tells you a reason has started; only the two little words do. Which is why **parce que** has to be written in full, and why it is two words rather than one.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four lines** to the person you picked.

At least one must use **et** or **mais**. At least one must use **parce que** — both words, spelled out.

Use only words you already write. This lesson adds no vocabulary; the whole exercise is the joining.

Before you move on

Cover your first line and read the second alone. Does it still make sense without the first? If it does, you wrote a **list** — which is where you were one lesson ago.
Then find your **parce que** line and read the words after it. They should be in ordinary order. If you moved something, you were remembering a different language's rule.

Chapter 49

Arm, Leg, Foot, Finger, Tooth

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: I can name an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth.*

49.1 le bras — an arm

Before the new one: say the French for enough, then the French for sir.

You'll want to know: le bras

le bras — "an arm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bras ← Old French *bras* ← Latin *bracchium*, "arm" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bras*
- *Say it: le bras*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bras*
- *Recall:* say the French for enough, then the French for sir, then say *le bras* again

Before you move on

What does le bras mean? (“An arm”.) Say it once more.

49.2 la jambe — a leg

Before the new one: say the French for sir, then the French for an arm.

You’ll want to know: la jambe

la jambe — “a leg”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jambe ← Late Latin *gamba*, “a hoof, a leg” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: Latin *g* before *a* softened to the French *j*. EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *gamba* to the same Late Latin word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jambe*
- *Say it: la jambe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la jambe*
- *Recall:* say the French for sir, then the French for an arm, then say *la jambe* again

Before you move on

What does la jambe mean? (“A leg”.) Say it once more.

49.3 le pied — a foot

Before the new one: say the French for an arm, then the French for a leg.

You’ll want to know: le pied

le pied — “a foot”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pied ← Old French *pié* ← Latin *pes*, *pedis*, “foot” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pied*
- *Say it: le pied*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pied*
- *Recall:* say the French for an arm, then the French for a leg, then say *le pied* again

Before you move on

What does le pied mean? (“A foot”.) Say it once more.

49.4 le doigt — a finger

Before the new one: say the French for a leg, then the French for a foot.

You'll want to know: le doigt

le doigt — "a finger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doigt ← Old French *doit* ← Latin *digitus*, "finger" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The silent *g* was put back into the spelling later, to recall the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le doigt*
- *Say it: le doigt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le doigt*
- *Recall:* say the French for a leg, then the French for a foot, then say *le doigt* again

Before you move on

What does le doigt mean? ("A finger".) Say it once more.

49.5 la dent — a tooth

Before the new one: say the French for a foot, then the French for a finger.

You'll want to know: la dent

la dent — "a tooth". English *dentist* shares the root.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dent ← Latin *dens*, *dentis*, "tooth" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dent*
- *Say it: la dent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la dent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a foot, then the French for a finger, then say *la dent* again

Before you move on

What does la dent mean? ("A tooth".) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Neck, Shoulder, Knee, Face, Blood

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: I can name the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood.*

50.1 le cou — the neck

Before the new one: say the French for a finger, then the French for a tooth.

You'll want to know: le cou

le cou — "the neck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cou ← Latin *collum*, "neck" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Old French said *col*; the *l* later melted into a vowel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cou*
- *Say it: le cou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a finger, then the French for a tooth, then say *le cou* again

Before you move on

What does le cou mean? ("The neck".) Say it once more.

50.2 l'épaule — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the French for a tooth, then the French for the neck.

You'll want to know: l'épaule

l'épaule — "a shoulder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épaule ← Old French *espalle* ← Late Latin *spatula*, "a flat piece, a shoulder blade" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was: *espaule*, then *épaule*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épaule*
- *Say it: l'épaule*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'épaule*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tooth, then the French for the neck, then say *l'épaule* again

Before you move on

What does l'épaule mean? ("A shoulder".) Say it once more.

50.3 le genou — a knee

Before the new one: say the French for the neck, then the French for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: le genou

le genou — "a knee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

genou ← Vulgar Latin **genuculum*, "a little knee", from Latin *genu*, "knee" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records both Latin words.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le genou*
- *Say it: le genou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le genou*
- *Recall:* say the French for the neck, then the French for a shoulder, then say *le genou* again

Before you move on

What does le genou mean? ("A knee".) Say it once more.

50.4 le visage — the face

Before the new one: say the French for a shoulder, then the French for a knee.

You'll want to know: le visage

le visage — "the face".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

visage — built in Old French from *vis*, "face", with the ending *-age*. *vis* ← Latin *visus*, "a look, an appearance", from *videre*, "to see". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le visage*
- *Say it: le visage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le visage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shoulder, then the French for a knee, then say *le visage* again

Before you move on

What does le visage mean? ("The face".) Say it once more.

50.5 le sang — blood

Before the new one: say the French for a knee, then the French for the face.

You'll want to know: le sang

le sang — "blood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sang ← Old French *sanc* ← Latin *sanguis*, "blood", through a Vulgar Latin form **sanguem* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sang*
- *Say it: le sang*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sang*
- *Recall:* say the French for a knee, then the French for the face, then say *le sang* again

Before you move on

What does le sang mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Skin, Nail, Chin, Throat, Cheek

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name skin, a nail (finger or toe), the chin, the throat, a cheek.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: I can name skin, a nail (finger or toe), the chin, the throat, a cheek.*

51.1 la peau — skin

Before the new one: say the French for the face, then the French for blood.

You'll want to know: la peau

la peau — "skin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peau ← Old French *pel* ← Latin *pellis*, "skin, hide" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la peau*
- *Say it: la peau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la peau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the face, then the French for blood, then say *la peau* again

Before you move on

What does la peau mean? ("Skin".) Say it once more.

51.2 l'ongle — a nail (finger or toe)

Before the new one: say the French for blood, then the French for skin.

You'll want to know: l'ongle

l'ongle — "a nail (finger or toe)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ongle ← Latin *ungula*, "a claw, a hoof", from *unguis*, "nail" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *unghia* to the same *ungula*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ongle*
- *Say it: l'ongle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ongle*
- *Recall:* say the French for blood, then the French for skin, then say *l'ongle* again

Before you move on

What does l'ongle mean? ("A nail (finger or toe)".) Say it once more.

51.3 le menton — the chin

Before the new one: say the French for skin, then the French for a nail.

You'll want to know: le menton

le menton — "the chin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

menton ← Vulgar Latin **mento*, from Latin *mentum*, "chin" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le menton*
- *Say it: le menton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le menton*
- *Recall:* say the French for skin, then the French for a nail, then say *le menton* again

Before you move on

What does le menton mean? ("The chin".) Say it once more.

51.4 la gorge — the throat

Before the new one: say the French for a nail, then the French for the chin.

You'll want to know: la gorge

la gorge — "the throat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gorge ← Late Latin **gurga*, from Latin *gurges*, "a whirlpool, an abyss" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gorge*
- *Say it: la gorge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gorge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nail, then the French for the chin, then say *la gorge* again

Before you move on

What does la gorge mean? ("The throat".) Say it once more.

51.5 la joue — a cheek

Before the new one: say the French for the chin, then the French for the throat.

You'll want to know: la joue

la joue — "a cheek".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joue ← Old French *jode* ← Vulgar Latin **gauta*, "cheek" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). Where **gauta* came from is uncertain; Gaulish is the usual guess.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la joue*
- *Say it: la joue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la joue*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chin, then the French for the throat, then say *la joue* again

Before you move on

What does la joue mean? ("A cheek".) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Chest, Stomach, Ankle, Elbow, Wrist

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: I can name the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist.*

52.1 la poitrine — the chest

Before the new one: say the French for the throat, then the French for a cheek.

You'll want to know: la poitrine

la poitrine — "the chest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poitrine ← Old French *peitrine* ← Late Latin **pectorina*, from Latin *pectus*, *pectoris*, "chest" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poitrine*
- *Say it: la poitrine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poitrine*
- *Recall:* say the French for the throat, then the French for a cheek, then say *la poitrine* again

Before you move on

What does la poitrine mean? (“The chest”.) Say it once more.

52.2 l’estomac — the stomach

Before the new one: say the French for a cheek, then the French for the chest.

You’ll want to know: l’estomac

l’estomac — “the stomach”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

estomac ← Old French *estomac* ← Latin *stomachus*, from Greek *stomachos*, built on *stoma*, “mouth” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’estomac*
- *Say it: l’estomac*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’estomac*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cheek, then the French for the chest, then say *l’estomac* again

Before you move on

What does l'estomac mean? ("The stomach".) Say it once more.

52.3 la cheville — an ankle

Before the new one: say the French for the chest, then the French for the stomach.

You'll want to know: la cheville

la cheville — "an ankle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cheville ← Vulgar Latin **cavicula*, from Latin *clavicula*, "a little key, a peg" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1): the ankle bone was seen as the peg of the leg.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cheville*
- *Say it: la cheville*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cheville*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chest, then the French for the stomach, then say *la cheville* again

Before you move on

What does la cheville mean? ("An ankle".) Say it once more.

52.4 le coude — an elbow

Before the new one: say the French for the stomach, then the French for an ankle.

You'll want to know: le coude

le coude — "an elbow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coude ← Latin *cubitus*, "elbow" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited: once the *i* dropped out, *cubitu* became **cobdo*, the *b* was lost, and Old French had *code*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coude*
- *Say it: le coude*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le coude*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stomach, then the French for an ankle, then say *le coude* again

Before you move on

What does le coude mean? ("An elbow".) Say it once more.

52.5 le poignet — a wrist

Before the new one: say the French for an ankle, then the French for an elbow.

You'll want to know: le poignet

le poignet — "a wrist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poignet — built from the French word for "fist", which goes back to Latin *pugnus*, with the small-thing ending *-et*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poignet*
- *Say it: le poignet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poignet*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ankle, then the French for an elbow, then say *le poignet* again

Before you move on

What does le poignet mean? ("A wrist".) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

Pain, Fever, Cough, Medicine, Doctor

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: I can name pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor.

53.1 la douleur — pain

Before the new one: say the French for an elbow, then the French for a wrist.

You'll want to know: la douleur

la douleur — "pain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douleur ← Old French *dolor* ← Latin *dolor*, "pain, grief" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douleur*
- *Say it: la douleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elbow, then the French for a wrist, then say *la douleur* again

Before you move on

What does la douleur mean? (“Pain”.) Say it once more.

53.2 la fièvre — a fever

Before the new one: say the French for a wrist, then the French for pain.

You’ll want to know: la fièvre

la fièvre — “a fever”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fièvre ← Latin *febris*, “fever” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *e* broke into *ie*, and *b* became *v*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fièvre*
- *Say it: la fièvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fièvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wrist, then the French for pain, then say *la fièvre* again

Before you move on

What does la fièvre mean? ("A fever".) Say it once more.

53.3 la toux — a cough

Before the new one: say the French for pain, then the French for a fever.

You'll want to know: la toux

la toux — "a cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toux ← Old French *tous* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *tussis*, "a cough" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la toux*
- *Say it: la toux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la toux*
- *Recall:* say the French for pain, then the French for a fever, then say *la toux* again

Before you move on

What does la toux mean? ("A cough".) Say it once more.

53.4 le médicament — a medicine

Before the new one: say the French for a fever, then the French for a cough.

You'll want to know: le médicament

le médicament — "a medicine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

médicament ← Latin *medicamentum*, "a remedy", from *medicari*, "to heal" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le médicament*
- *Say it: le médicament*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le médicament*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fever, then the French for a cough, then say *le médicament* again

Before you move on

What does le médicament mean? ("A medicine".) Say it once more.

53.5 le médecin — a doctor

Before the new one: say the French for a cough, then the French for a medicine.

You'll want to know: le médecin

le médecin — "a doctor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

médecin — formed in French from the word for "medicine", which ← Latin *medicina*, "the art of healing", from *medicus*, "doctor" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le médecin*
- *Say it: le médecin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le médecin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cough, then the French for a medicine, then say *le médecin* again

Before you move on

What does le médecin mean? ("A doctor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Hospital, Illness, Thirst, Tiredness, Ill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: I can name a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill.

54.1 l'hôpital — a hospital

Before the new one: say the French for a medicine, then the French for a doctor.

You'll want to know: l'hôpital

l'hôpital — "a hospital".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hôpital ← Old French *hospital* ← Medieval Latin *hospitale*, "a guest house", from Latin *hospes*, "guest" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the *s* that French later stopped writing. The same Latin word, worn down in everyday speech, also gave French its word for "hotel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hôpital*
- *Say it: l'hôpital*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'hôpital*
- *Recall:* say the French for a medicine, then the French for a doctor, then say *l'hôpital* again

Before you move on

What does l'hôpital mean? ("A hospital".) Say it once more.

54.2 la maladie — an illness

Before the new one: say the French for a doctor, then the French for a hospital.

You'll want to know: la maladie

la maladie — "an illness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maladie — built in Old French from the adjective for "sick", with the ending *-ie*. That adjective goes back to Latin *male habitus*, "in poor condition". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la maladie*
- *Say it: la maladie*, once more

- *Say it:* say *la maladie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a doctor, then the French for a hospital, then say *la maladie* again

Before you move on

What does la maladie mean? ("An illness".) Say it once more.

54.3 la soif — thirst

Before the new one: say the French for a hospital, then the French for an illness.

You'll want to know: la soif

la soif — "thirst". **j'ai soif**: I am thirsty, with **avoir**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soif ← Old French *soif* ← Latin *sitis*, "thirst" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soif*
- *Say it: la soif*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soif*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hospital, then the French for an illness, then say *la soif* again

Before you move on

What does la soif mean? ("Thirst".) Say it once more.

54.4 la fatigue — tiredness

Before the new one: say the French for an illness, then the French for thirst.

You'll want to know: la fatigue

la fatigue — "tiredness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fatigue — formed from the verb for "to tire", a learned borrowing of Latin *fatigare*, "to weary". (EtymDB 2.1) The kept *g* shows the book word: in everyday speech it would have dropped out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fatigue*
- *Say it: la fatigue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fatigue*
- *Recall:* say the French for an illness, then the French for thirst, then say *la fatigue* again

Before you move on

What does la fatigue mean? ("Tiredness".) Say it once more.

54.5 malade — ill, sick

Before the new one: say the French for thirst, then the French for tiredness.

You'll want to know: malade

malade — "ill, sick".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malade ← Old French *malade* ← Latin *male habitus*, "in poor condition" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *malade*
- *Say it:* *malade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malade*
- *Recall:* say the French for thirst, then the French for tiredness, then say *malade* again

Before you move on

What does malade mean? ("Ill, sick".) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Happy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy.*

55.1 la joie — joy

Before the new one: say the French for tiredness, then the French for ill.

You'll want to know: la joie

la joie — "joy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joie ← Latin *gaudia*, "joys", the plural of *gaudium* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *g* became *j*, as in *jambe*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la joie*
- *Say it: la joie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la joie*
- *Recall:* say the French for tiredness, then the French for ill, then say *la joie* again

Before you move on

What does la joie mean? ("Joy".) Say it once more.

55.2 la peur — fear

Before the new one: say the French for ill, then the French for joy.

You'll want to know: la peur

la peur — "fear". **j'ai peur**: I am afraid.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peur ← Old French *peor* ← Latin *pavor*, "fear, fright" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the *v* between vowels dropped out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la peur*
- *Say it: la peur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la peur*
- *Recall:* say the French for ill, then the French for joy, then say *la peur* again

Before you move on

What does la peur mean? (“Fear”.) Say it once more.

55.3 la colère — anger

Before the new one: say the French for joy, then the French for fear.

You’ll want to know: la colère

la colère — “anger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colère ← Latin *cholera*, “a bilious illness”, from Greek *kholera*, built on *khole*, “bile” — a learned borrowing: anger was blamed on bile. (EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *collera* to the same Latin word.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la colère*
- *Say it: la colère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la colère*
- *Recall:* say the French for joy, then the French for fear, then say *la colère* again

Before you move on

What does la colère mean? (“Anger”.) Say it once more.

55.4 la tristesse — sadness

Before the new one: say the French for fear, then the French for anger.

You'll want to know: la tristesse

la tristesse — "sadness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tristesse ← Latin *tristitia*, "sadness", from *tristis*, "sad" — inherited; Latin *-itia* became French *-esse*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tristesse*
- *Say it: la tristesse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tristesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for fear, then the French for anger, then say *la tristesse* again

Before you move on

What does la tristesse mean? ("Sadness".) Say it once more.

55.5 heureux — happy

Before the new one: say the French for anger, then the French for sadness.

You'll want to know: heureux

heureux — "happy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heureux — built from Old French *eur*, "luck", with *-eux*, "full of": lucky, then happy. *eur* ← Latin *augurium*, "an omen". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heureux*
- *Say it: heureux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heureux*
- *Recall:* say the French for anger, then the French for sadness, then say *heureux* again

Before you move on

What does heureux mean? ("Happy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

Sad, Pleased, Daughter, Grandfather, Grandmother

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name sad, pleased, a daughter, a grandfather, a grandmother.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: I can name sad, pleased, a daughter, a grandfather, a grandmother.

56.1 triste — sad

Before the new one: say the French for sadness, then the French for happy.

You'll want to know: triste

triste — "sad". The adjective beside **la tristesse**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

triste ← Latin *tristis*, "sad, gloomy" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: triste*
- *Say it: triste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *triste*
- *Recall:* say the French for sadness, then the French for happy, then say *triste* again

Before you move on

What does triste mean? ("Sad".) Say it once more.

56.2 content — pleased, glad

Before the new one: say the French for happy, then the French for sad.

You'll want to know: content

content — "pleased, glad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

content ← Latin *contentus*, "satisfied", the past participle of *continere*, "to hold together" (Lewis & Short) — taken from written Latin; Old French already had it (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: content*
- *Say it: content*, once more
- *Say it:* say *content*
- *Recall:* say the French for happy, then the French for sad, then say *content* again

Before you move on

What does content mean? ("Pleased, glad".) Say it once more.

56.3 la fille — a daughter; a girl

Before the new one: say the French for sad, then the French for pleased.

You'll want to know: la fille

la fille — "a daughter; a girl".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fille ← Latin *filia*, "daughter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *figlia* to the same word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fille*
- *Say it: la fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for sad, then the French for pleased, then say *la fille* again

Before you move on

What does la fille mean? ("A daughter; a girl".) Say it once more.

56.4 le grand-père — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the French for pleased, then the French for a daughter; a girl.

You'll want to know: le grand-père

le grand-père — "a grandfather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grand-père — built from the French word for "big, great", from Latin *grandis* (EtymDB 2.1), and *père*, "father". English *grandfather* copied the French pattern.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le grand-père*
- *Say it: le grand-père*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le grand-père*
- *Recall:* say the French for pleased, then the French for a daughter; a girl, then say *le grand-père* again

Before you move on

What does le grand-père mean? ("A grandfather".) Say it once more.

56.5 la grand-mère — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the French for a daughter; a girl, then the French for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: la grand-mère

la grand-mère — "a grandmother".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grand-mère — built from the French word for "big, great", from Latin *grandis* (EtymDB 2.1), and *mère*, "mother". English

grandmother copied the French pattern.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grand-mère*
- *Say it: la grand-mère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grand-mère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a daughter; a girl, then the French for a grandfather, then say *la grand-mère* again

Before you move on

What does la grand-mère mean? ("A grandmother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Husband, Woman, Uncle, Aunt, Cousin

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a husband, a woman, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin (female).

Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: I can name a husband, a woman, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin (female).

57.1 le mari — a husband

Before the new one: say the French for a grandfather, then the French for a grandmother.

You'll want to know: le mari

le mari — "a husband".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mari ← Latin *maritus*, "husband" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mari*
- *Say it: le mari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mari*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandfather, then the French for a grandmother, then say *le mari* again

Before you move on

What does le mari mean? ("A husband".) Say it once more.

57.2 la femme — a woman; a wife

Before the new one: say the French for a grandmother, then the French for a husband.

You'll want to know: la femme

la femme — "a woman; a wife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

femme ← Latin *femina*, "woman" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la femme*
- *Say it: la femme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la femme*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandmother, then the French for a husband, then say *la femme* again

Before you move on

What does la femme mean? (“A woman; a wife”.) Say it once more.

57.3 l’oncle — an uncle

Before the new one: say the French for a husband, then the French for a woman; a wife.

You’ll want to know: l’oncle

l’oncle — “an uncle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oncle ← Vulgar Latin **aunculus* ← Latin *avunculus*, “mother’s brother” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’oncle*
- *Say it: l’oncle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’oncle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a husband, then the French for a woman; a wife, then say *l’oncle* again

Before you move on

What does l’oncle mean? (“An uncle”.) Say it once more.

57.4 la tante — an aunt

Before the new one: say the French for a woman; a wife, then the French for an uncle.

You'll want to know: la tante

la tante — "an aunt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tante ← Old French *ante* ← Latin *amita*, "father's sister" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *t-* at the front is usually explained as a child's way of saying "your aunt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tante*
- *Say it: la tante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tante*
- *Recall:* say the French for a woman; a wife, then the French for an uncle, then say *la tante* again

Before you move on

What does la tante mean? ("An aunt".) Say it once more.

57.5 la cousine — a cousin (female)

Before the new one: say the French for an uncle, then the French for an aunt.

You'll want to know: la cousine

la cousine — "a cousin (female)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cousine ← Latin *consobrina*, "a cousin on the mother's side" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cousine*
- *Say it: la cousine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cousine*
- *Recall:* say the French for an uncle, then the French for an aunt, then say *la cousine* again

Before you move on

What does la cousine mean? ("A cousin (female)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Neighbour, Guest, Baby, Grandson, Granddaughter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: I can name a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter.

58.1 le voisin — a neighbour

Before the new one: say the French for an aunt, then the French for a cousin.

You'll want to know: le voisin

le voisin — "a neighbour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voisin ← Latin *vicinus*, "neighbour", from *vicus*, "a village" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le voisin*
- *Say it: le voisin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le voisin*
- *Recall:* say the French for an aunt, then the French for a cousin, then say *le voisin* again

Before you move on

What does le voisin mean? ("A neighbour".) Say it once more.

58.2 l'invité — a guest

Before the new one: say the French for a cousin, then the French for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: l'invité

l'invité — "a guest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

invité is the past participle of the French verb for "to invite", used as a noun: one who is invited. The verb ← Latin *invitare* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'invité*
- *Say it: l'invité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'invité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cousin, then the French for a neighbour, then say *l'invité* again

Before you move on

What does l'invité mean? ("A guest".) Say it once more.

58.3 le bébé — a baby

Before the new one: say the French for a neighbour, then the French for a guest.

You'll want to know: le bébé

le bébé — "a baby".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bébé ← English *baby* — borrowed in the 19th century.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bébé*
- *Say it: le bébé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bébé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a neighbour, then the French for a guest, then say *le bébé* again

Before you move on

What does le bébé mean? ("A baby".) Say it once more.

58.4 le petit-fils — a grandson

Before the new one: say the French for a guest, then the French for a baby.

You'll want to know: le petit-fils

le petit-fils — "a grandson".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petit-fils — built from the French words for "little" and "son": a grandson. The "little" word ← Vulgar Latin **pittitus*, and the "son" word ← Latin *filius*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le petit-fils*
- *Say it: le petit-fils*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le petit-fils*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guest, then the French for a baby, then say *le petit-fils* again

Before you move on

What does le petit-fils mean? ("A grandson".) Say it once more.

58.5 la petite-fille — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the French for a baby, then the French for a grandson.

You'll want to know: la petite-fille

la petite-fille — "a granddaughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petite-fille — built from the French for "little", in its feminine form, and *fille*, "daughter": a granddaughter. The "little" word ← Vulgar Latin **pittitus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la petite-fille*
- *Say it: la petite-fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la petite-fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a baby, then the French for a grandson, then say *la petite-fille* again

Before you move on

What does la petite-fille mean? ("A granddaughter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Nephew, Niece, Pupil, Teacher, Laugh

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: I can name a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh.

59.1 le neveu — a nephew

Before the new one: say the French for a grandson, then the French for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: le neveu

le neveu — "a nephew".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neveu ← Latin *nepos*, *nepotis*, "grandson, nephew" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le neveu*
- *Say it: le neveu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le neveu*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandson, then the French for a granddaughter, then say *le neveu* again

Before you move on

What does le neveu mean? ("A nephew".) Say it once more.

59.2 la nièce — a niece

Before the new one: say the French for a granddaughter, then the French for a nephew.

You'll want to know: la nièce

la nièce — "a niece".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nièce ← Vulgar Latin **neptia*, from Latin *neptis*, "granddaughter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nièce*
- *Say it: la nièce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la nièce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a granddaughter, then the French for a nephew, then say *la nièce* again

Before you move on

What does la nièce mean? (“A niece”.) Say it once more.

59.3 l’élève — a pupil

Before the new one: say the French for a nephew, then the French for a niece.

You’ll want to know: l’élève

l’élève — “a pupil”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élève — formed from the verb for “to raise, to bring up” (EtymDB 2.1), on the model of Italian *allievo*, “pupil”. The verb is built on Latin *levare*, “to lift”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’élève*
- *Say it: l’élève*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’élève*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nephew, then the French for a niece, then say *l’élève* again

Before you move on

What does l’élève mean? (“A pupil”.) Say it once more.

59.4 le professeur — a teacher

Before the new one: say the French for a niece, then the French for a pupil.

You'll want to know: le professeur

le professeur — "a teacher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

professeur ← Latin *professor*, "a public teacher", from *profiteri*, "to declare in public" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le professeur*
- *Say it: le professeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le professeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a niece, then the French for a pupil, then say *le professeur* again

Before you move on

What does le professeur mean? ("A teacher".) Say it once more.

59.5 rire — to laugh

Before the new one: say the French for a pupil, then the French for a teacher.

You'll want to know: rire

rire — "to laugh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rire ← Latin *ridere*, "to laugh" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rire*
- *Say it: rire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pupil, then the French for a teacher, then say *rire* again

Before you move on

What does rire mean? (“To laugh”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Cry, Wash, Cook, Play, Learn

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: I can say to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn.*

60.1 pleurer — to cry

Before the new one: say the French for a teacher, then the French for to laugh.

You'll want to know: pleurer

pleurer — "to cry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pleurer ← Old French *plorer* ← Latin *plorare*, "to wail, to weep aloud" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pleurer*
- *Say it: pleurer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pleurer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a teacher, then the French for to laugh, then say *pleurer* again

Before you move on

What does pleurer mean? ("To cry".) Say it once more.

60.2 laver — to wash

Before the new one: say the French for to laugh, then the French for to cry.

You'll want to know: laver

laver — "to wash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laver ← Latin *lavare*, "to wash" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laver*
- *Say it: laver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to laugh, then the French for to cry, then say *laver* again

Before you move on

What does laver mean? ("To wash".) Say it once more.

60.3 cuisiner — to cook

Before the new one: say the French for to cry, then the French for to wash.

You'll want to know: cuisiner

cuisiner — "to cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisiner — built from the French word for "kitchen, cooking", which ← Vulgar Latin **cocina* ← Latin *coquina*, "kitchen", from *coquere*, "to cook". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuisiner*
- *Say it: cuisiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuisiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cry, then the French for to wash, then say *cuisiner* again

Before you move on

What does cuisiner mean? ("To cook".) Say it once more.

60.4 jouer — to play

Before the new one: say the French for to wash, then the French for to cook.

You'll want to know: jouer

jouer — "to play".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jouer ← Old French *joer* ← Latin *iocari*, "to jest, to joke" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jouer*
- *Say it: jouer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jouer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wash, then the French for to cook, then say *jouer* again

Before you move on

What does jouer mean? ("To play".) Say it once more.

60.5 apprendre — to learn

Before the new one: say the French for to cook, then the French for to play.

You'll want to know: apprendre

apprendre — "to learn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apprendre ← Old French *aprendre* ← Latin *apprehendere*, "to seize, to grasp" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to learn is to grasp. It is *prendre*, "to take", with *a-* in front.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *apprendre*
- *Say it:* *apprendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apprendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cook, then the French for to play, then say *apprendre* again

Before you move on

What does apprendre mean? ("To learn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Teach, Drink, Eat, Give, Live

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: I can say to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live.*

61.1 enseigner — to teach

Before the new one: say the French for to play, then the French for to learn.

You'll want to know: enseigner

enseigner — "to teach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enseigner ← Old French *enseignier* ← Vulgar Latin **insignare*, "to mark, to point out", from Latin *signum*, "a mark, a sign" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enseigner*
- *Say it: enseigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enseigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to play, then the French for to learn, then say *enseigner* again

Before you move on

What does enseigner mean? ("To teach".) Say it once more.

61.2 boire — to drink

Before the new one: say the French for to learn, then the French for to teach.

You'll want to know: boire

boire — "to drink".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boire ← Old French *boivre* ← Latin *bibere*, "to drink" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: boire*
- *Say it: boire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *boire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to learn, then the French for to teach, then say *boire* again

Before you move on

What does boire mean? (“To drink”.) Say it once more.

61.3 manger — to eat

Before the new one: say the French for to teach, then the French for to drink.

You’ll want to know: manger

manger — “to eat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manger ← Old French *mengier* ← Latin *manducare*, “to chew” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It replaced the older Latin verb for “to eat” in everyday speech.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manger*
- *Say it: manger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to teach, then the French for to drink, then say *manger* again

Before you move on

What does manger mean? (“To eat”.) Say it once more.

61.4 donner — to give

Before the new one: say the French for to drink, then the French for to eat.

You'll want to know: donner

donner — "to give".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

donner ← Latin *donare*, "to give as a gift", from *donum*, "a gift" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: donner*
- *Say it: donner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *donner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drink, then the French for to eat, then say *donner* again

Before you move on

What does donner mean? ("To give".) Say it once more.

61.5 vivre — to live

Before the new one: say the French for to eat, then the French for to give.

You'll want to know: vivre

vivre — "to live".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vivre ← Latin *vivere*, "to live" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vivre*
- *Say it: vivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to eat, then the French for to give, then say *vivre* again

Before you move on

What does vivre mean? (“To live”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Come back, Study, Pay, Use, Show

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: I can say to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show.*

62.1 revenir — to come back

Before the new one: say the French for to give, then the French for to live.

You'll want to know: revenir

revenir — "to come back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

revenir ← Latin *revenire*, "to come back", from *re-*, "back", and *venire*, "to come" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: revenir*
- *Say it: revenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *revenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give, then the French for to live, then say *revenir* again

Before you move on

What does revenir mean? ("To come back".) Say it once more.

62.2 étudier — to study

Before the new one: say the French for to live, then the French for to come back.

You'll want to know: étudier

étudier — "to study".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étudier ← Old French *estudier*, a medieval scholars' word built on Latin *studium*, "eagerness, study", from *studere*, "to be eager" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin verb.) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étudier*
- *Say it: étudier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étudier*

- *Recall:* say the French for to live, then the French for to come back, then say *étudier* again

Before you move on

What does étudier mean? (“To study”.) Say it once more.

62.3 payer — to pay

Before the new one: say the French for to come back, then the French for to study.

You’ll want to know: payer

payer — “to pay”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

payer ← Old French *paiier* ← Latin *pacare*, “to calm, to satisfy”, from *pax*, “peace” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to pay was to settle with someone.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payer*
- *Say it: payer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come back, then the French for to study, then say *payer* again

Before you move on

What does payer mean? (“To pay”.) Say it once more.

62.4 utiliser — to use

Before the new one: say the French for to study, then the French for to pay.

You'll want to know: utiliser

utiliser — "to use".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

utiliser — formed in French in the 18th century from the word for "useful", a borrowing of Latin *utilis*, "useful", from *uti*, "to use" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utiliser*
- *Say it: utiliser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utiliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to study, then the French for to pay, then say *utiliser* again

Before you move on

What does utiliser mean? ("To use".) Say it once more.

62.5 montrer — to show

Before the new one: say the French for to pay, then the French for to use.

You'll want to know: montrer

montrer — "to show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montrer ← Old French *monstrer* ← Latin *monstrare*, "to show", from *monere*, "to warn, to remind" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *montrer*
- *Say it:* *montrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *montrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pay, then the French for to use, then say *montrer* again

Before you move on

What does montrer mean? ("To show".) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Clean, Cut, Forget, Look for, Lose

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: I can say to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose.*

63.1 nettoyer — to clean

Before the new one: say the French for to use, then the French for to show.

You'll want to know: nettoyer

nettoyer — "to clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nettoyer ← Old French *nettoier*, built on the adjective for "clean, neat", which goes back to Latin *nitidus*, "shining". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nettoyer*
- *Say it: nettoyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nettoyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to use, then the French for to show, then say *nettoyer* again

Before you move on

What does nettoyer mean? (“To clean”.) Say it once more.

63.2 couper — to cut

Before the new one: say the French for to show, then the French for to clean.

You’ll want to know: couper

couper — “to cut”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couper — built on the French word for “a blow”, which ← Late Latin *colpus*, from Latin *colaphus*, “a punch”, from Greek *kolaphos*: to cut was first to strike. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: couper*
- *Say it: couper*, once more
- *Say it:* say *couper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to show, then the French for to clean, then say *couper* again

Before you move on

What does couper mean? (“To cut”.) Say it once more.

63.3 oublier — to forget

Before the new one: say the French for to clean, then the French for to cut.

You’ll want to know: oublier

oublier — “to forget”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oublier ← Old French *oblier* ← Vulgar Latin **oblitare*, from Latin *oblitus*, “forgotten”, the past participle of *oblivisci*, “to forget” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oublier*
- *Say it: oublier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oublier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clean, then the French for to cut, then say *oublier* again

Before you move on

What does oublier mean? (“To forget”.) Say it once more.

63.4 chercher — to look for

Before the new one: say the French for to cut, then the French for to forget.

You'll want to know: chercher

chercher — "to look for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chercher ← Old French *cerchier* ← Late Latin *circare*, "to go around", from *circus*, "a ring" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. English *search* came from the same Old French verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chercher*
- *Say it:* *chercher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chercher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cut, then the French for to forget, then say *chercher* again

Before you move on

What does chercher mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

63.5 perdre — to lose

Before the new one: say the French for to forget, then the French for to look for.

You'll want to know: perdre

perdre — "to lose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

perdre ← Latin *perdere*, "to destroy, to lose" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perdre*
- *Say it: perdre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perdre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to forget, then the French for to look for, then say *perdre* again

Before you move on

What does perdre mean? ("To lose".) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Look at, Listen to, Wait for, Buy, Know

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know (a fact).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: I can say to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know (a fact).*

64.1 regarder — "to look at, to watch"

> Before the new one: say the French for to look for, then the French for to lose.

You'll want to know: regarder

regarder — "to look at, to watch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

regarder — built from *re-* and the French verb for "to keep, to watch over", which ← Frankish **wardon*, "to watch". EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *guardare* to the same Frankish verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: regarder*
- *Say it: regarder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *regarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look for, then the French for to lose, then say *regarder* again

Before you move on

What does regarder mean? ("To look at, to watch".) Say it once more.

64.2 écouter — to listen to

Before the new one: say the French for to lose, then the French for to look at.

You'll want to know: écouter

écouter — "to listen to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écouter ← Old French *escouter* ← Latin *auscultare*, "to listen" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: écouter*
- *Say it: écouter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *écouter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lose, then the French for to look at, then say *écouter* again

Before you move on

What does écouter mean? (“To listen to”.) Say it once more.

64.3 attendre — to wait for

Before the new one: say the French for to look at, then the French for to listen to.

You’ll want to know: attendre

attendre — “to wait for”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

attendre ← Latin *attendere*, “to stretch toward, to pay heed” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: attendre*
- *Say it: attendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *attendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look at, then the French for to listen to, then say *attendre* again

Before you move on

What does attendre mean? (“To wait for”.) Say it once more.

64.4 acheter — to buy

Before the new one: say the French for to listen to, then the French for to wait for.

You'll want to know: acheter

acheter — "to buy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acheter ← Old French *acheter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **accaptare*, from Latin *captare*, "to try to catch" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became French *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: acheter*
- *Say it: acheter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acheter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to listen to, then the French for to wait for, then say *acheter* again

Before you move on

What does acheter mean? ("To buy".) Say it once more.

64.5 savoir — to know (a fact)

Before the new one: say the French for to wait for, then the French for to buy.

You'll want to know: savoir

savoir — "to know (a fact)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

savoir ← Latin *sapere*, "to taste, to be wise" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, through a Vulgar Latin **sapere* stressed on its middle syllable.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: savoir*
- *Say it: savoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *savoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wait for, then the French for to buy, then say *savoir* again

Before you move on

What does savoir mean? ("To know (a fact)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Leave, Carry, Send, Receive, Feel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to leave (something), to carry, to send, to receive, to feel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: I can say to leave (something), to carry, to send, to receive, to feel.*

65.1 laisser — to leave (something); to let

> Before the new one: say the French for to buy, then the French for to know.

You'll want to know: laisser

laisser — "to leave (something); to let".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laisser ← Old French *laissier* ← Latin *laxare*, "to loosen", from *laxus*, "slack" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laisser*
- *Say it: laisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to buy, then the French for to know, then say *laisser* again

Before you move on

What does laisser mean? ("To leave (something); to let".) Say it once more.

65.2 porter — to carry; to wear

Before the new one: say the French for to know, then the French for to leave.

You'll want to know: porter

porter — "to carry; to wear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

porter ← Latin *portare*, "to carry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: porter*
- *Say it: porter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *porter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to know, then the French for to leave, then say *porter* again

Before you move on

What does porter mean? (“To carry; to wear”.) Say it once more.

65.3 envoyer — to send

Before the new one: say the French for to leave, then the French for to carry; to wear.

You’ll want to know: envoyer

envoyer — “to send”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envoyer ← Old French *envoier* ← Late Latin *inviare*, “to put on the way”, from *via*, “a road” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *envoyer*
- *Say it:* *envoyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *envoyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to leave, then the French for to carry; to wear, then say *envoyer* again

Before you move on

What does envoyer mean? (“To send”.) Say it once more.

65.4 recevoir — to receive

Before the new one: say the French for to carry; to wear, then the French for to send.

You'll want to know: recevoir

recevoir — "to receive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recevoir ← Latin *recipere*, "to take back, to receive" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, through a Vulgar Latin form **recipere* stressed on its middle syllable.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: recevoir*
- *Say it: recevoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *recevoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to carry; to wear, then the French for to send, then say *recevoir* again

Before you move on

What does recevoir mean? ("To receive".) Say it once more.

65.5 sentir — to feel; to smell

Before the new one: say the French for to send, then the French for to receive.

You'll want to know: sentir

sentir — "to feel; to smell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sentir ← Latin *sentire*, "to feel, to perceive" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sentir*
- *Say it: sentir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to send, then the French for to receive, then say *sentir* again

Before you move on

What does sentir mean? ("To feel; to smell".) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

Draw, Paint, Count, Win, Hide

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to draw, to paint, to count, to win, to hide.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: I can say to draw, to paint, to count, to win, to hide.*

66.1 dessiner — to draw

Before the new one: say the French for to receive, then the French for to feel; to smell.

You'll want to know: dessiner

dessiner — "to draw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessiner ← Middle French *desseigner*, from Italian *disegnare*, "to draw", ← Latin *designare*, "to mark out" — borrowed from Italian. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Middle French and Latin forms.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessiner*
- *Say it: dessiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to receive, then the French for to feel; to smell, then say *dessiner* again

Before you move on

What does dessiner mean? ("To draw".) Say it once more.

66.2 peindre — to paint

Before the new one: say the French for to feel; to smell, then the French for to draw.

You'll want to know: peindre

peindre — "to paint".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peindre ← Old French *peindre* ← Latin *pingere*, "to paint" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peindre*
- *Say it: peindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to feel; to smell, then the French for to draw, then say *peindre* again

Before you move on

What does peindre mean? (“To paint”.) Say it once more.

66.3 compter — to count

Before the new one: say the French for to draw, then the French for to paint.

You’ll want to know: compter

compter — “to count”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compter ← Latin *computare*, “to reckon” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Old French wrote it *conter*; the *mp* was put back later to recall the Latin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: compter*
- *Say it: compter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *compter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to draw, then the French for to paint, then say *compter* again

Before you move on

What does compter mean? (“To count”.) Say it once more.

66.4 gagner — to win; to earn

Before the new one: say the French for to paint, then the French for to count.

You'll want to know: gagner

gagner — "to win; to earn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gagner ← Old French *gaaignier* ← Frankish **waidanjan*, "to hunt for food, to graze" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gagner*
- *Say it:* *gagner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gagner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to paint, then the French for to count, then say *gagner* again

Before you move on

What does gagner mean? ("To win; to earn".) Say it once more.

66.5 cacher — to hide

Before the new one: say the French for to count, then the French for to win; to earn.

You'll want to know: cacher

cacher — "to hide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cacher ← Old French *cachier* ← Vulgar Latin **coacticare*, "to press together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cacher*
- *Say it: cacher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to count, then the French for to win; to earn, then say *cacher* again

Before you move on

What does cacher mean? ("To hide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Find, Fish, Chicken, Fruit, Apple

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: I can name to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple.*

67.1 trouver — to find

Before the new one: say the French for to win; to earn, then the French for to hide.

You'll want to know: trouver

trouver — "to find".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trouver ← Old French *trover*, probably from Vulgar Latin **tropare*, "to compose a poem", from Latin *tropus*, "a figure of speech", from Greek *tropos*, "a turn" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). This is the usual account; it is not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trouver*
- *Say it: trouver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trouver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to win; to earn, then the French for to hide, then say *trouver* again

Before you move on

What does trouver mean? ("To find".) Say it once more.

67.2 le poisson — fish

Before the new one: say the French for to hide, then the French for to find.

You'll want to know: le poisson

le poisson — "fish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poisson ← Latin *piscis*, "fish", through a Vulgar Latin form **piscio* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poisson*
- *Say it: le poisson*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hide, then the French for to find, then say *le poisson* again

Before you move on

What does le poisson mean? ("Fish".) Say it once more.

67.3 le poulet — chicken

Before the new one: say the French for to find, then the French for fish.

You'll want to know: le poulet

le poulet — "chicken".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poulet — built from the French word for "hen", with *-et*, "little". The hen word ← Latin *pulla*, the feminine of *pullus*, "a young animal" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poulet*
- *Say it: le poulet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poulet*
- *Recall:* say the French for to find, then the French for fish, then say *le poulet* again

Before you move on

What does le poulet mean? ("Chicken".) Say it once more.

67.4 le fruit — a fruit

Before the new one: say the French for fish, then the French for chicken.

You'll want to know: le fruit

le fruit — "a fruit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fruit ← Old French *fruit* ← Latin *fructus*, "enjoyment, produce" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fruit*
- *Say it: le fruit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fruit*
- *Recall:* say the French for fish, then the French for chicken, then say *le fruit* again

Before you move on

What does le fruit mean? ("A fruit".) Say it once more.

67.5 la pomme — an apple

Before the new one: say the French for chicken, then the French for a fruit.

You'll want to know: la pomme

la pomme — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pomme ← Latin *poma*, "fruits", the plural of *pomum* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) In Latin *pomum* was any fruit; French narrowed it to the apple.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pomme*
- *Say it: la pomme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pomme*
- *Recall:* say the French for chicken, then the French for a fruit, then say *la pomme* again

Before you move on

What does la pomme mean? ("An apple".) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Banana, Orange, Potato, Tomato, Onion

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: I can name a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion.*

68.1 la banane — a banana

> Before the new one: say the French for a fruit, then the French for an apple.

You'll want to know: la banane

la banane — "a banana".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banane ← Portuguese *banana* (EtymDB 2.1), from a West African language, perhaps Wolof — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banane*
- *Say it: la banane*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banane*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fruit, then the French for an apple, then say *la banane* again

Before you move on

What does la banane mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

68.2 l'orange — an orange

Before the new one: say the French for an apple, then the French for a banana.

You'll want to know: l'orange

l'orange — "an orange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orange ← Old French *pome orenge*, "orange apple" (EtymDB 2.1), which came through Italian from Arabic *naranj* and Persian *narang* — borrowed. The *n-* fell away on the journey.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orange*
- *Say it: l'orange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'orange*
- *Recall:* say the French for an apple, then the French for a banana, then say *l'orange* again

Before you move on

What does l'orange mean? ("An orange".) Say it once more.

68.3 la pomme de terre — a potato

Before the new one: say the French for a banana, then the French for an orange.

You'll want to know: la pomme de terre

la pomme de terre — "a potato". Literally "apple of the earth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pomme de terre — "apple of the earth": *pomme*, "apple", *de*, "of", and *terre*, "earth", ← Latin *terra*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pomme de terre*
- *Say it: la pomme de terre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pomme de terre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a banana, then the French for an orange, then say *la pomme de terre* again

Before you move on

What does la pomme de terre mean? ("A potato".) Say it once more.

68.4 la tomate — a tomato

Before the new one: say the French for an orange, then the French for a potato.

You'll want to know: la tomate

la tomate — "a tomato".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tomate ← Spanish *tomate* ← Nahuatl *tomatl* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tomate*
- *Say it: la tomate*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tomate*
- *Recall:* say the French for an orange, then the French for a potato, then say *la tomate* again

Before you move on

What does la tomate mean? ("A tomato".) Say it once more.

68.5 l'oignon — an onion

Before the new one: say the French for a potato, then the French for a tomato.

You'll want to know: l'oignon

l'oignon — "an onion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oignon ← Old French *oingnon* ← Latin *unio*, *unionis*, a kind of onion that grows as a single bulb — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) *unio* is built on *unus*, "one" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oignon*
- *Say it: l'oignon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oignon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a potato, then the French for a tomato, then say *l'oignon* again

Before you move on

What does l'oignon mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Carrot, Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: I can name a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil.*

69.1 la carotte — a carrot

Before the new one: say the French for a tomato, then the French for an onion.

You'll want to know: la carotte

la carotte — "a carrot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carotte ← Latin *carota* ← Greek *karoton* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carotte*
- *Say it: la carotte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carotte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tomato, then the French for an onion, then say *la carotte* again

Before you move on

What does la carotte mean? ("A carrot".) Say it once more.

69.2 le gâteau — a cake

Before the new one: say the French for an onion, then the French for a carrot.

You'll want to know: le gâteau

le gâteau — "a cake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gâteau ← Old French *gastel* ← Frankish **wastil*, "food" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gâteau*
- *Say it: le gâteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gâteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an onion, then the French for a carrot, then say *le gâteau* again

Before you move on

What does le gâteau mean? ("A cake".) Say it once more.

69.3 la soupe — a soup

Before the new one: say the French for a carrot, then the French for a cake.

You'll want to know: la soupe

la soupe — "a soup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soupe ← Old French *sope* ← Late Latin *suppa*, "bread soaked in broth" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1); Late Latin had taken *suppa* from a Germanic language.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soupe*
- *Say it: la soupe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soupe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a carrot, then the French for a cake, then say *la soupe* again

Before you move on

What does la soupe mean? ("A soup".) Say it once more.

69.4 le miel — honey

Before the new one: say the French for a cake, then the French for a soup.

You'll want to know: le miel

le miel — "honey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

miel ← Latin *mel*, "honey" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *e* broke into *ie*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le miel*
- *Say it: le miel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le miel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cake, then the French for a soup, then say *le miel* again

Before you move on

What does le miel mean? ("Honey".) Say it once more.

69.5 l'huile — oil

Before the new one: say the French for a soup, then the French for honey.

You'll want to know: l'huile

l'huile — "oil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

huile ← Old French *oile* ← Latin *oleum*, "olive oil", from Greek *elaion* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *h* was added to the spelling only.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'huile*
- *Say it: l'huile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'huile*
- *Recall:* say the French for a soup, then the French for honey, then say *l'huile* again

Before you move on

What does l'huile mean? ("Oil".) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Lunch, Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: I can name lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear.

70.1 le déjeuner — lunch

Before the new one: say the French for honey, then the French for oil.

You'll want to know: le déjeuner

le déjeuner — "lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déjeuner ← Vulgar Latin **disieiunare*, "to break the fast" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin verb.) The French word for "dinner" comes from the same verb by another path.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le déjeuner*
- *Say it: le déjeuner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le déjeuner*
- *Recall:* say the French for honey, then the French for oil, then say *le déjeuner* again

Before you move on

What does le déjeuner mean? (“Lunch”.) Say it once more.

70.2 le dîner — dinner

Before the new one: say the French for oil, then the French for lunch.

You’ll want to know: le dîner

le dîner — “dinner”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dîner ← Old French *disner* ← Vulgar Latin **disiunare*, from *disieiunare*, “to break the fast” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It is the same verb as *déjeuner*, worn down differently.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dîner*
- *Say it: le dîner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dîner*
- *Recall:* say the French for oil, then the French for lunch, then say *le dîner* again

Before you move on

What does le dîner mean? ("Dinner".) Say it once more.

70.3 le petit-déjeuner — breakfast

Before the new one: say the French for lunch, then the French for dinner.

You'll want to know: le petit-déjeuner

le petit-déjeuner — "breakfast". Literally "little lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petit-déjeuner — built from the French word for "little" and *déjeuner*: the small first breaking of the fast, as English *breakfast* is.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le petit-déjeuner*
- *Say it: le petit-déjeuner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le petit-déjeuner*
- *Recall:* say the French for lunch, then the French for dinner, then say *le petit-déjeuner* again

Before you move on

What does le petit-déjeuner mean? ("Breakfast".) Say it once more.

70.4 le riz — rice

Before the new one: say the French for dinner, then the French for breakfast.

You'll want to know: le riz

le riz — "rice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

riz ← Old French *ris* ← Italian *riso* ← Latin *oryza*, from Greek *oryza* — borrowed from Italian. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le riz*
- *Say it: le riz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le riz*
- *Recall:* say the French for dinner, then the French for breakfast, then say *le riz* again

Before you move on

What does le riz mean? ("Rice".) Say it once more.

70.5 la poire — a pear

Before the new one: say the French for breakfast, then the French for rice.

You'll want to know: la poire

la poire — "a pear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poire ← Old French *peire* ← Vulgar Latin **pira*, from Latin *pirum*, "pear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poire*
- *Say it: la poire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poire*
- *Recall:* say the French for breakfast, then the French for rice, then say *la poire* again

Before you move on

What does la poire mean? ("A pear".) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Lemon, Grapes, Jam, Yoghurt, Ham

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: I can name a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham.*

71.1 le citron — a lemon

> Before the new one: say the French for rice, then the French for a pear.

You'll want to know: le citron

le citron — "a lemon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

citron — formed from Latin *citrus*, "the citron tree" (EtymDB 2.1), with the ending *-on*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le citron*
- *Say it: le citron*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le citron*
- *Recall:* say the French for rice, then the French for a pear, then say *le citron* again

Before you move on

What does le citron mean? ("A lemon".) Say it once more.

71.2 le raisin — grapes

Before the new one: say the French for a pear, then the French for a lemon.

You'll want to know: le raisin

le raisin — "grapes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raisin ← Vulgar Latin **racimus* ← Latin *racemus*, "a cluster of grapes" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le raisin*
- *Say it: le raisin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le raisin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pear, then the French for a lemon, then say *le raisin* again

Before you move on

What does le raisin mean? (“Grapes”.) Say it once more.

71.3 la confiture — jam

Before the new one: say the French for a lemon, then the French for grapes.

You’ll want to know: la confiture

la confiture — “jam”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confiture — built on Old French *confire*, “to preserve”, ← Latin *conficere*, “to prepare”. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Latin *confectura*, “a preparing”.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la confiture*
- *Say it: la confiture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la confiture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lemon, then the French for grapes, then say *la confiture* again

Before you move on

What does la confiture mean? (“Jam”.) Say it once more.

71.4 le yaourt — a yoghurt

Before the new one: say the French for grapes, then the French for jam.

You'll want to know: le yaourt

le yaourt — "a yoghurt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

yaourt ← Turkish *yogurt* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le yaourt*
- *Say it: le yaourt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le yaourt*
- *Recall:* say the French for grapes, then the French for jam, then say *le yaourt* again

Before you move on

What does le yaourt mean? ("A yoghurt".) Say it once more.

71.5 le jambon — ham

Before the new one: say the French for jam, then the French for a yoghurt.

You'll want to know: le jambon

le jambon — "ham".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jambon — built from *jambe*, "leg", with *-on*: the leg of the pig. *jambe* ← Late Latin *gamba*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jambon*
- *Say it: le jambon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jambon*
- *Recall:* say the French for jam, then the French for a yoghurt, then say *le jambon* again

Before you move on

What does le jambon mean? (“Ham”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Salad, Pasta, Cream, Pepper, Walnut

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a salad, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: I can name a salad, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut.*

72.1 la salade — a salad; lettuce

> Before the new one: say the French for a yoghurt, then the French for ham.

You'll want to know: la salade

la salade — "a salad; lettuce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salade ← Italian *salata*, "salted", that is, salted greens (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; behind it is Latin *sal*, "salt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salade*
- *Say it: la salade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a yoghurt, then the French for ham, then say *la salade* again

Before you move on

What does la salade mean? ("A salad; lettuce".) Say it once more.

72.2 les pâtes — pasta

Before the new one: say the French for ham, then the French for a salad; lettuce.

You'll want to know: les pâtes

les pâtes — "pasta".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pâtes is the plural of the French word for "dough, paste", which ← Old French *paste* ← Late Latin *pasta*, "dough", from Greek *pasta*, "barley porridge" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les pâtes*
- *Say it: les pâtes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les pâtes*
- *Recall:* say the French for ham, then the French for a salad; lettuce, then say *les pâtes* again

Before you move on

What does les pâtes mean? ("Pasta".) Say it once more.

72.3 la crème — cream

Before the new one: say the French for a salad; lettuce, then the French for pasta.

You'll want to know: la crème

la crème — "cream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crème ← Old French *cresme* ← Late Latin *crama*, "cream", probably a Gaulish word (EtymDB 2.1); its spelling was later pulled toward Church Latin *chrisma*, "anointing oil".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crème*
- *Say it: la crème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la crème*
- *Recall:* say the French for a salad; lettuce, then the French for pasta, then say *la crème* again

Before you move on

What does la crème mean? ("Cream".) Say it once more.

72.4 le poivre — pepper

Before the new one: say the French for pasta, then the French for cream.

You'll want to know: le poivre

le poivre — "pepper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poivre ← Old French *peivre* ← Latin *piper*, from Greek *peperi* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The word travelled with the spice from India: Sanskrit has *pippali*, "long pepper".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poivre*
- *Say it: le poivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for pasta, then the French for cream, then say *le poivre* again

Before you move on

What does le poivre mean? ("Pepper".) Say it once more.

72.5 la noix — a walnut, a nut

Before the new one: say the French for cream, then the French for pepper.

You'll want to know: la noix

la noix — "a walnut, a nut".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noix ← Old French *nois* ← Latin *nux*, *nucis*, "nut" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la noix*
- *Say it: la noix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la noix*
- *Recall:* say the French for cream, then the French for pepper, then say *la noix* again

Before you move on

What does la noix mean? ("A walnut, a nut".) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Kitchen, Window, Chair, Key, Wall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a kitchen, a window, a chair, a key, a wall.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: I can name a kitchen, a window, a chair, a key, a wall.

73.1 la cuisine — a kitchen; cooking

Before the new one: say the French for pepper, then the French for a walnut.

You'll want to know: la cuisine

la cuisine — "a kitchen; cooking". The noun behind **cuisiner**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisine ← Vulgar Latin **cocina* ← Latin *coquina*, "kitchen", from *coquere*, "to cook" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuisine*
- *Say it: la cuisine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cuisine*
- *Recall:* say the French for pepper, then the French for a walnut, then say *la cuisine* again

Before you move on

What does la cuisine mean? ("A kitchen; cooking".) Say it once more.

73.2 la fenêtre — a window

Before the new one: say the French for a walnut, then the French for a kitchen; cooking.

You'll want to know: la fenêtre

la fenêtre — "a window".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fenêtre ← Old French *fenestre* ← Latin *fenestra*, "window" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fenêtre*
- *Say it: la fenêtre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fenêtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a walnut, then the French for a kitchen; cooking, then say *la fenêtre* again

Before you move on

What does la fenêtre mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

73.3 la chaise — a chair

Before the new one: say the French for a kitchen; cooking, then the French for a window.

You’ll want to know: la chaise

la chaise — “a chair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaise ← Latin *cathedra*, “a seat”, from Greek *kathedra* (Lewis & Short) — inherited. Old French said *chaiere*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to *cathedra*; Paris speech turned its *r* into a *z*. The older form lives on in the French word for a pulpit.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chaise*
- *Say it: la chaise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chaise*
- *Recall:* say the French for a kitchen; cooking, then the French for a window, then say *la chaise* again

Before you move on

What does la chaise mean? (“A chair”.) Say it once more.

73.4 la clé — a key

Before the new one: say the French for a window, then the French for a chair.

You'll want to know: la clé

la clé — "a key".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clé ← Old French *clef* ← Latin *clavis*, "key" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la clé*
- *Say it: la clé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la clé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a window, then the French for a chair, then say *la clé* again

Before you move on

What does la clé mean? ("A key".) Say it once more.

73.5 le mur — a wall

Before the new one: say the French for a chair, then the French for a key.

You'll want to know: le mur

le mur — "a wall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mur ← Latin *murus*, "wall" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mur*
- *Say it: le mur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a chair, then the French for a key, then say *le mur* again

Before you move on

What does le mur mean? ("A wall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Roof, Garden, Lamp, Bathroom, Bedroom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: I can name a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom.

74.1 le toit — a roof

Before the new one: say the French for a key, then the French for a wall.

You'll want to know: le toit

le toit — "a roof".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toit ← Latin *tectum*, "roof", from *tegere*, "to cover" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited: Latin *-ct-* became French *-it*, as in *lait* from Latin *lac*, *lactis*, through Vulgar Latin **lacte*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le toit*
- *Say it: le toit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le toit*
- *Recall:* say the French for a key, then the French for a wall, then say *le toit* again

Before you move on

What does le toit mean? (“A roof”.) Say it once more.

74.2 le jardin — a garden

Before the new one: say the French for a wall, then the French for a roof.

You’ll want to know: le jardin

le jardin — “a garden”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jardin ← Old French *jardin* (EtymDB 2.1), from Frankish **gardo*, “an enclosure” — borrowed from the Franks.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jardin*
- *Say it: le jardin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jardin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wall, then the French for a roof, then say *le jardin* again

Before you move on

What does le jardin mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

74.3 la lampe — a lamp

Before the new one: say the French for a roof, then the French for a garden.

You’ll want to know: la lampe

la lampe — “a lamp”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lampe ← Late Latin *lampada* ← Latin *lampas*, “a torch”, from Greek *lampas* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lampe*
- *Say it: la lampe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lampe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a roof, then the French for a garden, then say *la lampe* again

Before you move on

What does la lampe mean? (“A lamp”.) Say it once more.

74.4 la salle de bain — a bathroom

Before the new one: say the French for a garden, then the French for a lamp.

You'll want to know: la salle de bain

la salle de bain — "a bathroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle de bain — "room of bath": *salle*, "a room", ← Frankish **sal*, "a hall" (EtymDB 2.1); *de*, "of"; *bain*, "bath", ← Latin *balneum* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle de bain*
- *Say it: la salle de bain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle de bain*
- *Recall:* say the French for a garden, then the French for a lamp, then say *la salle de bain* again

Before you move on

What does la salle de bain mean? ("A bathroom".) Say it once more.

74.5 la chambre — a bedroom

Before the new one: say the French for a lamp, then the French for a bathroom.

You'll want to know: la chambre

la chambre — "a bedroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chambre ← Latin *camera*, "a vaulted room", from Greek *kamara* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became French *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chambre*
- *Say it: la chambre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chambre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lamp, then the French for a bathroom, then say *la chambre* again

Before you move on

What does la chambre mean? ("A bedroom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 75

Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Living room, Sofa

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: I can name the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa.

75.1 le sol — the floor, the ground

Before the new one: say the French for a bathroom, then the French for a bedroom.

You'll want to know: le sol

le sol — "the floor, the ground".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sol ← Latin *solum*, "ground, floor" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sol*
- *Say it: le sol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sol*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bathroom, then the French for a bedroom, then say *le sol* again

Before you move on

What does le sol mean? ("The floor, the ground".) Say it once more.

75.2 l'escalier — the stairs

Before the new one: say the French for a bedroom, then the French for the floor.

You'll want to know: l'escalier

l'escalier — "the stairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escalier ← Occitan *escalier* ← Latin *scalaria*, "steps", from *scala*, "a ladder" — borrowed from the south in the 1500s. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Middle French form.) The word French inherited from *scala* is the one for "ladder".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escalier*
- *Say it: l'escalier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'escalier*

- *Recall:* say the French for a bedroom, then the French for the floor, then say *l'escalier* again

Before you move on

What does l'escalier mean? ("The stairs".) Say it once more.

75.3 le miroir — a mirror

Before the new one: say the French for the floor, then the French for the stairs.

You'll want to know: le miroir

le miroir — "a mirror".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

miroir — built in Old French from the verb *mirer*, "to look at", ← Latin *mirari*, "to wonder at". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le miroir*
- *Say it: le miroir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le miroir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the floor, then the French for the stairs, then say *le miroir* again

Before you move on

What does le miroir mean? ("A mirror".) Say it once more.

75.4 le salon — a living room

Before the new one: say the French for the stairs, then the French for a mirror.

You'll want to know: le salon

le salon — "a living room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salon ← Italian *salone*, "a large hall", from *sala*, "a hall", a Germanic word — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le salon*
- *Say it: le salon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le salon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stairs, then the French for a mirror, then say *le salon* again

Before you move on

What does le salon mean? ("A living room".) Say it once more.

75.5 le canapé — a sofa

Before the new one: say the French for a mirror, then the French for a living room.

You'll want to know: le canapé

le canapé — "a sofa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

canapé ← Medieval Latin *canapeum* ← Latin *conopeum*, "a bed with a mosquito net", from Greek *konopeion*, built on *konops*, "mosquito" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le canapé*
- *Say it: le canapé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le canapé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mirror, then the French for a living room, then say *le canapé* again

Before you move on

What does le canapé mean? ("A sofa".) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Cupboard, Ceiling, Corridor, Glass, Plate

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: I can name a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate.*

76.1 le placard — a cupboard

> Before the new one: say the French for a living room, then the French for a sofa.

You'll want to know: le placard

le placard — "a cupboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

placard — built from the verb for "to stick on, to plate", with *-ard*; the verb comes from Middle Dutch *placken*, "to patch". A placard was first a notice stuck on a wall, then a cupboard set into one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le placard*
- *Say it: le placard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le placard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a living room, then the French for a sofa, then say *le placard* again

Before you move on

What does le placard mean? (“A cupboard”.) Say it once more.

76.2 le plafond — a ceiling

Before the new one: say the French for a sofa, then the French for a cupboard.

You’ll want to know: le plafond

le plafond — “a ceiling”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plafond — built from the French words for “flat” and “bottom”: the flat underside of the floor above. The second ← Latin *fundus*, “bottom”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plafond*
- *Say it: le plafond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plafond*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sofa, then the French for a cupboard, then say *le plafond* again

Before you move on

What does le plafond mean? ("A ceiling".) Say it once more.

76.3 le couloir — a corridor

Before the new one: say the French for a cupboard, then the French for a ceiling.

You'll want to know: le couloir

le couloir — "a corridor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couloir — built from the verb for "to flow", with *-oir*, "a place for": a passage things flow along. The verb ← Latin *colare*, "to strain, to filter" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couloir*
- *Say it: le couloir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le couloir*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cupboard, then the French for a ceiling, then say *le couloir* again

Before you move on

What does le couloir mean? ("A corridor".) Say it once more.

76.4 le verre — a glass

Before the new one: say the French for a ceiling, then the French for a corridor.

You'll want to know: le verre

le verre — "a glass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verre ← Latin *vitrum*, "glass" — inherited; the *t* between vowels dropped out. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le verre*
- *Say it: le verre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le verre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ceiling, then the French for a corridor, then say *le verre* again

Before you move on

What does le verre mean? ("A glass".) Say it once more.

76.5 l'assiette — a plate

Before the new one: say the French for a corridor, then the French for a glass.

You'll want to know: l'assiette

l'assiette — "a plate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assiette ← Vulgar Latin **assedita*, "a seating", from Latin *assidere*, "to sit beside" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: first a place at table, then the plate set there.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'assiette*
- *Say it: l'assiette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'assiette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a corridor, then the French for a glass, then say *l'assiette* again

Before you move on

What does l'assiette mean? ("A plate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Spoon, Knife, Fork, Bottle, Cup

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: I can name a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup.*

77.1 la cuillère — a spoon

Before the new one: say the French for a glass, then the French for a plate.

You'll want to know: la cuillère

la cuillère — "a spoon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuillère ← Latin *cochlearium*, "a spoon", from *cochlear*, a pointed spoon for getting snails out of their shells, and *cochlea*, "a snail", from Greek *kokhlias* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuillère*
- *Say it: la cuillère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cuillère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a glass, then the French for a plate, then say *la cuillère* again

Before you move on

What does la cuillère mean? ("A spoon".) Say it once more.

77.2 le couteau — a knife

Before the new one: say the French for a plate, then the French for a spoon.

You'll want to know: le couteau

le couteau — "a knife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couteau ← Old French *coutel* ← Latin *cultellus*, "a little knife", from *culter*, "knife" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couteau*
- *Say it: le couteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le couteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plate, then the French for a spoon, then say *le couteau* again

Before you move on

What does le couteau mean? (“A knife”.) Say it once more.

77.3 la fourchette — a fork

Before the new one: say the French for a spoon, then the French for a knife.

You’ll want to know: la fourchette

la fourchette — “a fork”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fourchette — built from the French word for “pitchfork”, with *-ette*, “little”. The pitchfork word ← Old French *furche* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *furca*, “a two-pronged fork” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fourchette*
- *Say it: la fourchette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fourchette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a spoon, then the French for a knife, then say *la fourchette* again

Before you move on

What does la fourchette mean? (“A fork”.) Say it once more.

77.4 la bouteille — a bottle

Before the new one: say the French for a knife, then the French for a fork.

You'll want to know: la bouteille

la bouteille — "a bottle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouteille ← Medieval Latin *butticula*, from Late Latin *buttis*, "a cask" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bouteille*
- *Say it: la bouteille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bouteille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a knife, then the French for a fork, then say *la bouteille* again

Before you move on

What does la bouteille mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

77.5 la tasse — a cup

Before the new one: say the French for a fork, then the French for a bottle.

You'll want to know: la tasse

la tasse — "a cup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tasse ← Arabic *tas*, "a bowl, a cup", itself from Persian — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tasse*
- *Say it: la tasse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tasse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fork, then the French for a bottle, then say *la tasse* again

Before you move on

What does la tasse mean? ("A cup".) Say it once more.

77.6 The body, family, doing and food — a first pass

Say the words for a bottle and a cup.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth
- the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood
- skin, a nail, the chin, the throat, a cheek
- the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist
- pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor
- a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill
- joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy
- sad, pleased, a daughter; a girl, a grandfather, a grandmother

- a husband, a woman; a wife, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin
- a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter
- a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh
- to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn
- to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live
- to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show

Before you move on

An arm? (**le bras**.) A leg? (**la jambe**.) A foot? (**le pied**.) A finger? (**le doigt**.) A tooth? (**la dent**.) The neck? (**le cou**.) A shoulder? (**l'épaule**.) A knee? (**le genou**.) The face? (**le visage**.) Blood? (**le sang**.) Skin? (**la peau**.) A nail? (**l'ongle**.) The chin? (**le menton**.) The throat? (**la gorge**.) A cheek? (**la joue**.) The chest? (**la poitrine**.) The stomach? (**l'estomac**.) An ankle? (**la cheville**.) An elbow? (**le coude**.) A wrist? (**le poignet**.) Pain? (**la douleur**.) A fever? (**la fièvre**.) A cough? (**la toux**.) A medicine? (**le médicament**.) A doctor? (**le médecin**.) A hospital? (**l'hôpital**.) An illness? (**la maladie**.) Thirst? (**la soif**.) Tiredness? (**la fatigue**.) Ill? (**malade**.) Joy? (**la joie**.) Fear? (**la peur**.) Anger? (**la colère**.) Sadness? (**la tristesse**.) Happy? (**heureux**.) Sad? (**triste**.) Pleased? (**content**.) A daughter; a girl? (**la fille**.) A grandfather? (**le grand-père**.) A grandmother? (**la grand-mère**.) A husband? (**le mari**.) A woman; a wife? (**la femme**.) An uncle? (**l'oncle**.) An aunt? (**la tante**.) A cousin? (**la cousine**.) A neighbour? (**le voisin**.) A guest? (**l'invité**.) A baby? (**le bébé**.) A grandson? (**le petit-fils**.) A granddaughter? (**la petite-fille**.) A nephew? (**le neveu**.) A niece? (**la nièce**.) A pupil? (**l'élève**.) A teacher? (**le professeur**.) To laugh? (**rire**.) To cry? (**pleurer**.) To wash? (**laver**.) To cook? (**cuisiner**.) To play? (**jouer**.) To learn? (**apprendre**.) To teach? (**enseigner**.) To drink? (**boire**.) To eat? (**manger**.) To give? (**donner**.) To live? (**vivre**.) To come back? (**revenir**.) To study? (**étudier**.) To pay? (**payer**.) To use? (**utiliser**.) To show? (**montrer**.)

77.7 The house, the table and things — a second pass

Say the words for to clean and to cut.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose
- to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know
- to leave, to carry; to wear, to send, to receive, to feel; to smell
- to draw, to paint, to count, to win; to earn, to hide
- to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple
- a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion
- a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil
- lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear
- a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham
- a salad; lettuce, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut
- a kitchen; cooking, a window, a chair, a key, a wall
- a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom
- the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa
- a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate
- a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup

Before you move on

To clean? (**nettoyer**.) To cut? (**couper**.) To forget? (**oublier**.) To look for? (**chercher**.) To lose? (**perdre**.) To look at? (**regarder**.) To listen to? (**écouter**.) To wait for? (**attendre**.) To buy? (**acheter**.) To know? (**savoir**.) To leave? (**laisser**.) To carry; to

wear? (**porter**.) To send? (**envoyer**.) To receive? (**recevoir**.) To feel; to smell? (**sentir**.) To draw? (**dessiner**.) To paint? (**peindre**.) To count? (**compter**.) To win; to earn? (**gagner**.) To hide? (**cacher**.) To find? (**trouver**.) Fish? (**le poisson**.) Chicken? (**le poulet**.) A fruit? (**le fruit**.) An apple? (**la pomme**.) A banana? (**la banane**.) An orange? (**l'orange**.) A potato? (**la pomme de terre**.) A tomato? (**la tomate**.) An onion? (**l'oignon**.) A carrot? (**la carotte**.) A cake? (**le gâteau**.) A soup? (**la soupe**.) Honey? (**le miel**.) Oil? (**l'huile**.) Lunch? (**le déjeuner**.) Dinner? (**le dîner**.) Breakfast? (**le petit-déjeuner**.) Rice? (**le riz**.) A pear? (**la poire**.) A lemon? (**le citron**.) Grapes? (**le raisin**.) Jam? (**la confiture**.) A yoghurt? (**le yaourt**.) Ham? (**le jambon**.) A salad; lettuce? (**la salade**.) Pasta? (**les pâtes**.) Cream? (**la crème**.) Pepper? (**le poivre**.) A walnut? (**la noix**.) A kitchen; cooking? (**la cuisine**.) A window? (**la fenêtre**.) A chair? (**la chaise**.) A key? (**la clé**.) A wall? (**le mur**.) A roof? (**le toit**.) A garden? (**le jardin**.) A lamp? (**la lampe**.) A bathroom? (**la salle de bain**.) A bedroom? (**la chambre**.) The floor? (**le sol**.) The stairs? (**l'escalier**.) A mirror? (**le miroir**.) A living room? (**le salon**.) A sofa? (**le canapé**.) A cupboard? (**le placard**.) A ceiling? (**le plafond**.) A corridor? (**le couloir**.) A glass? (**le verre**.) A plate? (**l'assiette**.) A spoon? (**la cuillère**.) A knife? (**le couteau**.) A fork? (**la fourchette**.) A bottle? (**la bouteille**.) A cup? (**la tasse**.)

Chapter 78

Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil, Bag

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: I can name a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag.*

78.1 le stylo — a pen

Before the new one: say the French for a bottle, then the French for a cup.

You'll want to know: le stylo

le stylo — "a pen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stylo — short for *stylographe*, a 19th-century name for a fountain pen, built from Latin *stilus*, "a writing stick" (EtymDB 2.1), and Greek *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stylo*
- *Say it: le stylo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le stylo*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bottle, then the French for a cup, then say *le stylo* again

Before you move on

What does le stylo mean? (“A pen”.) Say it once more.

78.2 le papier — paper

Before the new one: say the French for a cup, then the French for a pen.

You’ll want to know: le papier

le papier — “paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

papier ← Latin *papyrus*, from Greek *papyros*, “papyrus” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le papier*
- *Say it: le papier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le papier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cup, then the French for a pen, then say *le papier* again

Before you move on

What does le papier mean? (“Paper”.) Say it once more.

78.3 le cahier — a notebook

Before the new one: say the French for a pen, then the French for paper.

You’ll want to know: le cahier

le cahier — “a notebook”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cahier ← Old French *quaer* ← Vulgar Latin **quaternum*, from Latin *quaterni*, “four at a time” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: a booklet made of four folded sheets.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cahier*
- *Say it: le cahier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cahier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pen, then the French for paper, then say *le cahier* again

Before you move on

What does le cahier mean? (“A notebook”.) Say it once more.

78.4 le crayon — a pencil

Before the new one: say the French for paper, then the French for a notebook.

You'll want to know: le crayon

le crayon — "a pencil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crayon — built from the French word for "chalk", with *-on*. The chalk word ← Latin *creta*, "chalk, clay". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le crayon*
- *Say it: le crayon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le crayon*
- *Recall:* say the French for paper, then the French for a notebook, then say *le crayon* again

Before you move on

What does le crayon mean? ("A pencil".) Say it once more.

78.5 le sac — a bag

Before the new one: say the French for a notebook, then the French for a pencil.

You'll want to know: le sac

le sac — "a bag".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sac ← Latin *saccus*, from Greek *sakkos*, "a coarse bag" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sac*
- *Say it: le sac*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sac*
- *Recall:* say the French for a notebook, then the French for a pencil, then say *le sac* again

Before you move on

What does le sac mean? ("A bag".) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

Phone, Umbrella, Money, Present, Glasses

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a phone, an umbrella, money, a present, glasses.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: I can name a phone, an umbrella, money, a present, glasses.

79.1 le téléphone — a phone

Before the new one: say the French for a pencil, then the French for a bag.

You'll want to know: le téléphone

le téléphone — "a phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphone — a 19th-century coinage from Greek *tele*, "far off", and *phone*, "voice, sound" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le téléphone*
- *Say it: le téléphone*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le téléphone*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pencil, then the French for a bag, then say *le téléphone* again

Before you move on

What does le téléphone mean? ("A phone".) Say it once more.

79.2 le parapluie — an umbrella

Before the new one: say the French for a bag, then the French for a phone.

You'll want to know: le parapluie

le parapluie — "an umbrella". Literally "guard-rain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parapluie — built from *para-*, "guarding against", and the French word for "rain". *para-* came from Italian *parare*, "to shield", ← Latin *parare*, "to prepare". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parapluie*
- *Say it: le parapluie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parapluie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bag, then the French for a phone, then say *le parapluie* again

Before you move on

What does le parapluie mean? (“An umbrella”.) Say it once more.

79.3 l’argent — money; silver

Before the new one: say the French for a phone, then the French for an umbrella.

You’ll want to know: l’argent

l’argent — “money; silver”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

argent ← Latin *argentum*, “silver” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Coins were silver, so the word came to mean money.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’argent*
- *Say it: l’argent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’argent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a phone, then the French for an umbrella, then say *l’argent* again

Before you move on

What does l’argent mean? (“Money; silver”.) Say it once more.

79.4 le cadeau — a present, a gift

Before the new one: say the French for an umbrella, then the French for money; silver.

You'll want to know: le cadeau

le cadeau — "a present, a gift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cadeau ← Old Provençal *capdel*, "a chief; a capital letter", ← Latin *capitellum*, "a little head" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1) It meant a flourished capital letter, then a flourish, a treat, and finally a gift.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cadeau*
- *Say it: le cadeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cadeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an umbrella, then the French for money; silver, then say *le cadeau* again

Before you move on

What does le cadeau mean? ("A present, a gift".) Say it once more.

79.5 les lunettes — glasses

Before the new one: say the French for money; silver, then the French for a present.

You'll want to know: les lunettes

les lunettes — "glasses".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lunettes — built from *lune*, "moon", with *-ette*, "little": the round lenses were little moons. *lune* ← Latin *luna*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les lunettes*
- *Say it: les lunettes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les lunettes*
- *Recall:* say the French for money; silver, then the French for a present, then say *les lunettes* again

Before you move on

What does les lunettes mean? ("Glasses".) Say it once more.

Chapter 80

Box, Suitcase, Ticket, Map, Photo

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a box, a suitcase, a ticket, a map, a photo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: I can name a box, a suitcase, a ticket, a map, a photo.*

80.1 la boîte — a box

Before the new one: say the French for a present, then the French for glasses.

You'll want to know: la boîte

la boîte — "a box".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boîte ← Old French *boiste* ← Vulgar Latin **buxita*, from Late Latin *buxis*, "a box" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boîte*
- *Say it: la boîte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boîte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a present, then the French for glasses, then say *la boîte* again

Before you move on

What does la boîte mean? ("A box".) Say it once more.

80.2 la valise — a suitcase

Before the new one: say the French for glasses, then the French for a box.

You'll want to know: la valise

la valise — "a suitcase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valise ← Italian *valigia* — borrowed in the 1500s. Where the Italian word came from is uncertain. (EtymDB 2.1 records Medieval Latin *valisia*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la valise*
- *Say it: la valise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la valise*
- *Recall:* say the French for glasses, then the French for a box, then say *la valise* again

Before you move on

What does la valise mean? (“A suitcase”.) Say it once more.

80.3 le billet — a ticket; a banknote

Before the new one: say the French for a box, then the French for a suitcase.

You’ll want to know: le billet

le billet — “a ticket; a banknote”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

billet ← Old French *billette*, a little form of *bille*, “a written note”, from Medieval Latin *bulla*, “a seal, a sealed document”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le billet*
- *Say it: le billet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le billet*
- *Recall:* say the French for a box, then the French for a suitcase, then say *le billet* again

Before you move on

What does le billet mean? (“A ticket; a banknote”.) Say it once more.

80.4 la carte — a map; a card

Before the new one: say the French for a suitcase, then the French for a ticket; a banknote.

You'll want to know: la carte

la carte — "a map; a card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte ← Latin *charta*, "a sheet of paper", from Greek *chartes* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: an inherited form would begin with *ch-*. The worn-down form gave French its word for a charter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte*
- *Say it: la carte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a suitcase, then the French for a ticket; a banknote, then say *la carte* again

Before you move on

What does la carte mean? ("A map; a card".) Say it once more.

80.5 la photo — a photo

Before the new one: say the French for a ticket; a banknote, then the French for a map; a card.

You'll want to know: la photo

la photo — "a photo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photo — short for *photographie* (EtymDB 2.1), a 19th-century coinage from Greek *phos*, *photos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la photo*
- *Say it: la photo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la photo*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ticket; a banknote, then the French for a map; a card, then say *la photo* again

Before you move on

What does la photo mean? ("A photo".) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain, River

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, a mountain, a river.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, a mountain, a river.*

81.1 l'arbre — a tree

> Before the new one: say the French for a map; a card, then the French for a photo.

You'll want to know: l'arbre

l'arbre — "a tree".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arbre ← Latin *arbor*, "tree" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arbre*
- *Say it: l'arbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a map; a card, then the French for a photo, then say *l'arbre* again

Before you move on

What does l'arbre mean? ("A tree".) Say it once more.

81.2 la fleur — a flower

Before the new one: say the French for a photo, then the French for a tree.

You'll want to know: la fleur

la fleur — "a flower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleur ← Old French *flur* ← Latin *flos*, *floris*, "flower" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fleur*
- *Say it: la fleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a photo, then the French for a tree, then say *la fleur* again

Before you move on

What does la fleur mean? (“A flower”.) Say it once more.

81.3 la feuille — a leaf; a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the French for a tree, then the French for a flower.

You’ll want to know: la feuille

la feuille — “a leaf; a sheet of paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feuille ← Late Latin *folia*, “leaves”, the plural of *folium*, used as a singular — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la feuille*
- *Say it: la feuille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la feuille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tree, then the French for a flower, then say *la feuille* again

Before you move on

What does la feuille mean? (“A leaf; a sheet of paper”.) Say it once more.

81.4 la montagne — a mountain

Before the new one: say the French for a flower, then the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: la montagne

la montagne — "a mountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montagne ← Vulgar Latin **montanea*, from Latin *mons*, *montis*, "mountain" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la montagne*
- *Say it: la montagne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la montagne*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flower, then the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then say *la montagne* again

Before you move on

What does la montagne mean? ("A mountain".) Say it once more.

81.5 la rivière — a river

Before the new one: say the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the French for a mountain.

You'll want to know: la rivière

la rivière — "a river".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rivière ← Vulgar Latin **riparia*, "a riverbank", from Latin *ripa*, "bank" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rivière*
- *Say it: la rivière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la rivière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the French for a mountain, then say *la rivière* again

Before you move on

What does la rivière mean? ("A river".) Say it once more.

Chapter 82

Sea, Stone, Sand, Beach, Island

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: I can name the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island.*

82.1 la mer — the sea

> Before the new one: say the French for a mountain, then the French for a river.

You'll want to know: la mer

la mer — "the sea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mer ← Latin *mare*, "sea" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin's stressed *a* became *e*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mer*

- *Say it:* *la mer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mountain, then the French for a river, then say *la mer* again

Before you move on

What does la mer mean? ("The sea".) Say it once more.

82.2 la pierre — a stone

Before the new one: say the French for a river, then the French for the sea.

You'll want to know: la pierre

la pierre — "a stone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pierre ← Latin *petra*, "rock", from Greek *petra* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la pierre*
- *Say it:* *la pierre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pierre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a river, then the French for the sea, then say *la pierre* again

Before you move on

What does la pierre mean? ("A stone".) Say it once more.

82.3 le sable — sand

Before the new one: say the French for the sea, then the French for a stone.

You'll want to know: le sable

le sable — "sand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sable ← Latin *sabulum*, "coarse sand" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sable*
- *Say it: le sable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sable*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sea, then the French for a stone, then say *le sable* again

Before you move on

What does le sable mean? ("Sand".) Say it once more.

82.4 la plage — a beach

Before the new one: say the French for a stone, then the French for sand.

You'll want to know: la plage

la plage — "a beach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plage ← Italian *piaggia*, "a sloping shore" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plage*
- *Say it: la plage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stone, then the French for sand, then say *la plage* again

Before you move on

What does la plage mean? ("A beach".) Say it once more.

82.5 l'île — an island

Before the new one: say the French for sand, then the French for a beach.

You'll want to know: l'île

l'île — "an island".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

île ← Old French *isle* ← Latin *insula*, "island" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited. The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'île*
- *Say it: l'île*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'île*
- *Recall:* say the French for sand, then the French for a beach, then say *l'île* again

Before you move on

What does l'île mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Sun, Star, Cloud, Rain, Snow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: I can name the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow.*

83.1 le soleil — the sun

> Before the new one: say the French for a beach, then the French for an island.

You'll want to know: le soleil

le soleil — "the sun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soleil ← Vulgar Latin **soliculus*, "a little sun", from Latin *sol*, "sun" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soleil*
- *Say it: le soleil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le soleil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a beach, then the French for an island, then say *le soleil* again

Before you move on

What does le soleil mean? ("The sun".) Say it once more.

83.2 l'étoile — a star

Before the new one: say the French for an island, then the French for the sun.

You'll want to know: l'étoile

l'étoile — "a star".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étoile ← Old French *estoile* ← Latin *stella*, "star" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étoile*
- *Say it: l'étoile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étoile*
- *Recall:* say the French for an island, then the French for the sun, then say *l'étoile* again

Before you move on

What does l'étoile mean? ("A star".) Say it once more.

83.3 le nuage — a cloud

Before the new one: say the French for the sun, then the French for a star.

You'll want to know: le nuage

le nuage — "a cloud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nuage — built from Old French *nue*, "a cloud", with *-age*; *nue* ← Vulgar Latin **nuba* ← Latin *nubes*, "cloud". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le nuage*
- *Say it: le nuage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le nuage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sun, then the French for a star, then say *le nuage* again

Before you move on

What does le nuage mean? ("A cloud".) Say it once more.

83.4 la pluie — rain

Before the new one: say the French for a star, then the French for a cloud.

You'll want to know: la pluie

la pluie — "rain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pluie ← Vulgar Latin **ploia* ← Latin *pluvia*, "rain" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the same root as *il pleut*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pluie*
- *Say it: la pluie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pluie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a star, then the French for a cloud, then say *la pluie* again

Before you move on

What does la pluie mean? ("Rain".) Say it once more.

83.5 la neige — snow

Before the new one: say the French for a cloud, then the French for rain.

You'll want to know: la neige

la neige — "snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neige — formed from the verb for "to snow", which ← Vulgar Latin **nivicare*, from Latin *nix*, *nivis*, "snow" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la neige*
- *Say it: la neige*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la neige*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cloud, then the French for rain, then say *la neige* again

Before you move on

What does la neige mean? ("Snow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

Wind, Fire, Hill, Desert, Wave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: I can name the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave.*

84.1 le vent — the wind

> Before the new one: say the French for rain, then the French for snow.

You'll want to know: le vent

le vent — "the wind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vent ← Latin *ventus*, "wind" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vent*

- *Say it:* *le vent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vent*
- *Recall:* say the French for rain, then the French for snow, then say *le vent* again

Before you move on

What does le vent mean? (“The wind”.) Say it once more.

84.2 le feu — fire

Before the new one: say the French for snow, then the French for the wind.

You’ll want to know: le feu

le feu — “fire”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feu ← Old French *fu* ← Latin *focus*, “a hearth” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le feu*
- *Say it:* *le feu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le feu*
- *Recall:* say the French for snow, then the French for the wind, then say *le feu* again

Before you move on

What does le feu mean? (“Fire”.) Say it once more.

84.3 la colline — a hill

Before the new one: say the French for the wind, then the French for fire.

You'll want to know: la colline

la colline — "a hill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colline ← Italian *collina*, from Latin *collis*, "hill" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la colline*
- *Say it: la colline*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la colline*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wind, then the French for fire, then say *la colline* again

Before you move on

What does la colline mean? ("A hill".) Say it once more.

84.4 le désert — a desert

Before the new one: say the French for fire, then the French for a hill.

You'll want to know: le désert

le désert — "a desert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désert ← Latin *desertum*, "a wasteland", from *desertus*, "abandoned" — taken from Church Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le désert*
- *Say it: le désert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le désert*
- *Recall:* say the French for fire, then the French for a hill, then say *le désert* again

Before you move on

What does le désert mean? ("A desert".) Say it once more.

84.5 la vague — a wave

Before the new one: say the French for a hill, then the French for a desert.

You'll want to know: la vague

la vague — "a wave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vague ← Old French *wague*, from Old Norse *vagr*, "sea, wave" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from the Norse settlers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vague*
- *Say it: la vague*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vague*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hill, then the French for a desert, then say *la vague* again

Before you move on

What does la vague mean? (“A wave”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Cow, Pig, Bird, Mouse, Wolf

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 85: I can name a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf.*

85.1 la vache — a cow

Before the new one: say the French for a desert, then the French for a wave.

You'll want to know: la vache

la vache — "a cow". It gives **le lait**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vache ← Latin *vacca*, "cow" — inherited: Latin *ca* became French *che*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vache*
- *Say it: la vache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vache*
- *Recall:* say the French for a desert, then the French for a wave, then say *la vache* again

Before you move on

What does la vache mean? ("A cow".) Say it once more.

85.2 le cochon — a pig

Before the new one: say the French for a wave, then the French for a cow.

You'll want to know: le cochon

le cochon — "a pig".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cochon — its origin is uncertain; the usual account is that it grew from a call used to summon pigs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cochon*
- *Say it: le cochon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cochon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wave, then the French for a cow, then say *le cochon* again

Before you move on

What does le cochon mean? (“A pig”.) Say it once more.

85.3 l’oiseau — a bird

Before the new one: say the French for a cow, then the French for a pig.

You’ll want to know: l’oiseau

l’oiseau — “a bird”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oiseau ← Old French *oisel* ← Vulgar Latin **aucellus*, “a little bird”, from Latin *avis*, “bird” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin words.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’oiseau*
- *Say it: l’oiseau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’oiseau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cow, then the French for a pig, then say *l’oiseau* again

Before you move on

What does l’oiseau mean? (“A bird”.) Say it once more.

85.4 la souris — a mouse

Before the new one: say the French for a pig, then the French for a bird.

You'll want to know: la souris

la souris — "a mouse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souris ← Latin *sorex*, *soricis*, "a shrew", through Vulgar Latin *soricem* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la souris*
- *Say it: la souris*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la souris*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pig, then the French for a bird, then say *la souris* again

Before you move on

What does la souris mean? ("A mouse".) Say it once more.

85.5 le loup — a wolf

Before the new one: say the French for a bird, then the French for a mouse.

You'll want to know: le loup

le loup — "a wolf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loup ← Latin *lupus*, "wolf" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le loup*
- *Say it: le loup*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le loup*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bird, then the French for a mouse, then say *le loup* again

Before you move on

What does le loup mean? (“A wolf”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Bear, Fox, Snake, Hen, Duck

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 86: I can name a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck.*

86.1 l'ours — a bear

> Before the new one: say the French for a mouse, then the French for a wolf.

You'll want to know: l'ours

l'ours — "a bear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ours ← Old French *urs* ← Latin *ursus*, "bear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ours*
- *Say it: l'ours*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ours*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mouse, then the French for a wolf, then say *l'ours* again

Before you move on

What does l'ours mean? ("A bear".) Say it once more.

86.2 le renard — a fox

Before the new one: say the French for a wolf, then the French for a bear.

You'll want to know: le renard

le renard — "a fox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renard — named after *Renart*, the cunning fox of the medieval *Roman de Renart*; his name is the Germanic personal name *Reginhard*. It replaced the Old French word *goupil*, from Latin *vulpecula*, "little fox".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le renard*
- *Say it: le renard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le renard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wolf, then the French for a bear, then say *le renard* again

Before you move on

What does le renard mean? ("A fox".) Say it once more.

86.3 le serpent — a snake

Before the new one: say the French for a bear, then the French for a fox.

You'll want to know: le serpent

le serpent — "a snake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serpent ← Latin *serpens*, *serpentis*, "snake", from *serpere*, "to creep" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le serpent*
- *Say it: le serpent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le serpent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bear, then the French for a fox, then say *le serpent* again

Before you move on

What does le serpent mean? ("A snake".) Say it once more.

86.4 la poule — a hen

Before the new one: say the French for a fox, then the French for a snake.

You'll want to know: la poule

la poule — "a hen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poule ← Latin *pulla*, the feminine of *pullus*, "a young animal" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poule*
- *Say it: la poule*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poule*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fox, then the French for a snake, then say *la poule* again

Before you move on

What does la poule mean? ("A hen".) Say it once more.

86.5 le canard — a duck

Before the new one: say the French for a snake, then the French for a hen.

You'll want to know: le canard

le canard — "a duck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

canard — built from Old French *cane*, "a duck", with *-ard* (EtymDB 2.1). Where *cane* itself came from is uncertain; it is usually taken to imitate the bird's cackle.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le canard*
- *Say it: le canard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le canard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a snake, then the French for a hen, then say *le canard* again

Before you move on

What does le canard mean? ("A duck".) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey, Bee

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: I can name a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee.*

87.1 le mouton — a sheep

> Before the new one: say the French for a hen, then the French for a duck.

You'll want to know: le mouton

le mouton — "a sheep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouton ← Old French *mouton* ← Medieval Latin **multo*, from Gaulish **multon-*, "sheep" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, a Celtic word that came into French through Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mouton*
- *Say it: le mouton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mouton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hen, then the French for a duck, then say *le mouton* again

Before you move on

What does le mouton mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

87.2 la chèvre — a goat

Before the new one: say the French for a duck, then the French for a sheep.

You’ll want to know: la chèvre

la chèvre — “a goat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chèvre ← Old French *chievre* ← Latin *capra*, “she-goat” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *che-*, and *p* became *v*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chèvre*
- *Say it: la chèvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chèvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a duck, then the French for a sheep, then say *la chèvre* again

Before you move on

What does la chèvre mean? (“A goat”.) Say it once more.

87.3 le lion — a lion

Before the new one: say the French for a sheep, then the French for a goat.

You’ll want to know: le lion

le lion — “a lion”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lion ← Latin *leo*, *leonis*, from Greek *leon* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lion*
- *Say it: le lion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le lion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheep, then the French for a goat, then say *le lion* again

Before you move on

What does le lion mean? (“A lion”.) Say it once more.

87.4 le singe — a monkey

Before the new one: say the French for a goat, then the French for a lion.

You'll want to know: le singe

le singe — "a monkey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

singe ← Latin *simius*, "an ape", a form of *simia*, built on *simus*, "snub-nosed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le singe*
- *Say it: le singe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le singe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a goat, then the French for a lion, then say *le singe* again

Before you move on

What does le singe mean? ("A monkey".) Say it once more.

87.5 l'abeille — a bee

Before the new one: say the French for a lion, then the French for a monkey.

You'll want to know: l'abeille

l'abeille — "a bee". It makes **le miel**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abeille ← Old Provençal *abelha* ← Latin *apicula*, "a little bee", from *apis*, "bee" — borrowed from the south. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'abeille*
- *Say it: l'abeille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'abeille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lion, then the French for a monkey, then say *l'abeille* again

Before you move on

What does l'abeille mean? ("A bee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

Ant, Elephant, Rabbit, Frog, Tiger

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: I can name an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger.*

88.1 la fourmi — an ant

Before the new one: say the French for a monkey, then the French for a bee.

You'll want to know: la fourmi

la fourmi — "an ant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fourmi ← Old French *furmi* ← Vulgar Latin **formicus* ← Latin *formica*, "ant" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fourmi*
- *Say it: la fourmi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fourmi*
- *Recall:* say the French for a monkey, then the French for a bee, then say *la fourmi* again

Before you move on

What does la fourmi mean? ("An ant".) Say it once more.

88.2 l'éléphant — an elephant

Before the new one: say the French for a bee, then the French for an ant.

You'll want to know: l'éléphant

l'éléphant — "an elephant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éléphant ← Latin *elephantus*, from Greek *elephas*, "elephant, ivory" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éléphant*
- *Say it: l'éléphant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'éléphant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bee, then the French for an ant, then say *l'éléphant* again

Before you move on

What does l'éléphant mean? ("An elephant".) Say it once more.

88.3 le lapin — a rabbit

Before the new one: say the French for an ant, then the French for an elephant.

You'll want to know: le lapin

le lapin — "a rabbit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lapin — its origin is uncertain. The usual account ties it to Middle French *laperiau*, "a young rabbit" (EtymDB 2.1), from a pre-Latin root of Spain and southern France.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lapin*
- *Say it: le lapin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le lapin*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ant, then the French for an elephant, then say *le lapin* again

Before you move on

What does le lapin mean? ("A rabbit".) Say it once more.

88.4 la grenouille — a frog

Before the new one: say the French for an elephant, then the French for a rabbit.

You'll want to know: la grenouille

la grenouille — "a frog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grenouille ← Old French *grenoille* (EtymDB 2.1), from Vulgar Latin **ranucula*, "a little frog", from Latin *rana*, "frog" (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the *g-* in front is usually put down to imitation of the croak.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grenouille*
- *Say it: la grenouille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grenouille*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elephant, then the French for a rabbit, then say *la grenouille* again

Before you move on

What does la grenouille mean? ("A frog".) Say it once more.

88.5 le tigre — a tiger

Before the new one: say the French for a rabbit, then the French for a frog.

You'll want to know: le tigre

le tigre — "a tiger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tigre ← Latin *tigris*, from Greek *tigris* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tigre*
- *Say it: le tigre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tigre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rabbit, then the French for a frog, then say *le tigre* again

Before you move on

What does le tigre mean? ("A tiger".) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Tortoise, New, Old, Fast, Easy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: I can name a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy.*

89.1 la tortue — a tortoise

Before the new one: say the French for a frog, then the French for a tiger.

You'll want to know: la tortue

la tortue — "a tortoise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tortue ← Old Provençal *tortuga* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1) The usual account takes it to Late Latin *tartaruchus*, "of the underworld", a name for a creature thought demonic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tortue*
- *Say it: la tortue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tortue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a frog, then the French for a tiger, then say *la tortue* again

Before you move on

What does la tortue mean? (“A tortoise”.) Say it once more.

89.2 nouveau — new

Before the new one: say the French for a tiger, then the French for a tortoise.

You’ll want to know: nouveau

nouveau — “new”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nouveau ← Old French *novel* ← Latin *novellus*, “new, young”, from *novus*, “new” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nouveau*
- *Say it: nouveau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nouveau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tiger, then the French for a tortoise, then say *nouveau* again

Before you move on

What does nouveau mean? (“New”.) Say it once more.

89.3 vieux — old

Before the new one: say the French for a tortoise, then the French for new.

You’ll want to know: vieux

vieux — “old”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vieux ← Old French *viel* ← Vulgar Latin **veclus* ← Latin *vetulus*, “oldish”, from *vetus*, “old” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vieux*
- *Say it: vieux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vieux*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tortoise, then the French for new, then say *vieux* again

Before you move on

What does vieux mean? (“Old”.) Say it once more.

89.4 rapide — fast

Before the new one: say the French for new, then the French for old.

You'll want to know: rapide

rapide — "fast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rapide ← Latin *rapidus*, "swift, snatching", from *rapere*, "to seize" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rapide*
- *Say it: rapide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rapide*
- *Recall:* say the French for new, then the French for old, then say *rapide* again

Before you move on

What does rapide mean? ("Fast".) Say it once more.

89.5 facile — easy

Before the new one: say the French for old, then the French for fast.

You'll want to know: facile

facile — "easy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facile ← Latin *facilis*, "easy to do", from *facere*, "to do, to make" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: facile*
- *Say it: facile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *facile*
- *Recall:* say the French for old, then the French for fast, then say *facile* again

Before you move on

What does facile mean? ("Easy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Difficult, Dear, High, Full, Empty

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name difficult, dear, high, full, empty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: I can name difficult, dear, high, full, empty.*

90.1 difficile — difficult

Before the new one: say the French for fast, then the French for easy.

You'll want to know: difficile

difficile — "difficult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

difficile ← Latin *difficilis*, "hard to do": *facile* with *dis-*, "not", in front — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: difficile*
- *Say it: difficile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *difficile*
- *Recall:* say the French for fast, then the French for easy, then say *difficile* again

Before you move on

What does difficile mean? ("Difficult".) Say it once more.

90.2 cher — dear; expensive

Before the new one: say the French for easy, then the French for difficult.

You'll want to know: cher

cher — "dear; expensive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cher ← Latin *carus*, "dear, beloved, costly" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cher*
- *Say it: cher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cher*
- *Recall:* say the French for easy, then the French for difficult, then say *cher* again

Before you move on

What does cher mean? (“Dear; expensive”.) Say it once more.

90.3 haut — high, tall

Before the new one: say the French for difficult, then the French for dear; expensive.

You’ll want to know: haut

haut — “high, tall”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

haut ← Latin *altus*, “high”, blended with Frankish **hauh*, “high”, which gave it its *h* (EtymDB 2.1 gives the Frankish side) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haut*
- *Say it: haut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haut*
- *Recall:* say the French for difficult, then the French for dear; expensive, then say *haut* again

Before you move on

What does haut mean? (“High, tall”.) Say it once more.

90.4 plein — full

Before the new one: say the French for dear; expensive, then the French for high.

You'll want to know: plein

plein — "full".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plein ← Latin *plenus*, "full" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plein*
- *Say it: plein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plein*
- *Recall:* say the French for dear; expensive, then the French for high, then say *plein* again

Before you move on

What does plein mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

90.5 vide — empty

Before the new one: say the French for high, then the French for full.

You'll want to know: vide

vide — "empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vide ← Old French *vuit* ← Vulgar Latin **vocitus*, "empty" (EtymDB 2.1), related to Latin *vacuus*, "empty" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vide*
- *Say it: vide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vide*
- *Recall:* say the French for high, then the French for full, then say *vide* again

Before you move on

What does vide mean? (“Empty”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Strong, Weak, Rich, Poor, Grey

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name strong, weak, rich, poor, grey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: I can name strong, weak, rich, poor, grey.*

91.1 fort — strong

Before the new one: say the French for full, then the French for empty.

You'll want to know: fort

fort — "strong".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fort ← Latin *fortis*, "strong" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fort*

- *Say it: fort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fort*
- *Recall:* say the French for full, then the French for empty, then say *fort* again

Before you move on

What does fort mean? (“Strong”.) Say it once more.

91.2 faible — weak

Before the new one: say the French for empty, then the French for strong.

You’ll want to know: faible

faible — “weak”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faible ← Old French *feble* ← Latin *flebilis*, “to be wept over, pitiable” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faible*
- *Say it: faible*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faible*
- *Recall:* say the French for empty, then the French for strong, then say *faible* again

Before you move on

What does faible mean? (“Weak”.) Say it once more.

91.3 riche — rich

Before the new one: say the French for strong, then the French for weak.

You'll want to know: riche

riche — "rich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

riche ← Frankish **riki*, "powerful" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: riche*
- *Say it: riche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *riche*
- *Recall:* say the French for strong, then the French for weak, then say *riche* again

Before you move on

What does riche mean? ("Rich".) Say it once more.

91.4 pauvre — poor

Before the new one: say the French for weak, then the French for rich.

You'll want to know: pauvre

pauvre — "poor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pauvre ← Old French *povre* ← Latin *pauper*, "poor" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pauvre*
- *Say it: pauvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pauvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for weak, then the French for rich, then say *pauvre* again

Before you move on

What does pauvre mean? ("Poor".) Say it once more.

91.5 gris — grey

Before the new one: say the French for rich, then the French for poor.

You'll want to know: gris

gris — "grey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gris ← Old French *gris*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Vulgar Latin **grisus*; behind it is Frankish **gris*, "grey" — borrowed from the Franks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gris*
- *Say it: gris*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gris*
- *Recall:* say the French for rich, then the French for poor, then say *gris* again

Before you move on

What does gris mean? (“Grey”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Soft, Dirty, Young, Kind, Narrow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name soft, dirty, young, kind, narrow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: I can name soft, dirty, young, kind, narrow.*

92.1 doux — soft; mild; sweet

Before the new one: say the French for poor, then the French for grey.

You'll want to know: doux

doux — "soft; mild; sweet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doux ← Old French *dous* ← Latin *dulcis*, "sweet" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: doux*
- *Say it: doux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *doux*
- *Recall:* say the French for poor, then the French for grey, then say *doux* again

Before you move on

What does doux mean? ("Soft; mild; sweet".) Say it once more.

92.2 sale — dirty

Before the new one: say the French for grey, then the French for soft; mild; sweet.

You'll want to know: sale

sale — "dirty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sale ← Frankish **salo*, "dull, dirty grey" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sale*
- *Say it: sale*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sale*
- *Recall:* say the French for grey, then the French for soft; mild; sweet, then say *sale* again

Before you move on

What does sale mean? ("Dirty".) Say it once more.

92.3 jeune — young

Before the new one: say the French for soft; mild; sweet, then the French for dirty.

You'll want to know: jeune

jeune — "young".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeune ← Latin *iuvenis*, "young" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jeune*
- *Say it: jeune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jeune*
- *Recall:* say the French for soft; mild; sweet, then the French for dirty, then say *jeune* again

Before you move on

What does jeune mean? ("Young".) Say it once more.

92.4 gentil — kind, nice

Before the new one: say the French for dirty, then the French for young.

You'll want to know: gentil

gentil — "kind, nice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gentil ← Latin *gentilis*, "of the same clan", from *gens*, "a clan" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) In Old French it meant "high-born, noble".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gentil*
- *Say it: gentil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gentil*
- *Recall:* say the French for dirty, then the French for young, then say *gentil* again

Before you move on

What does gentil mean? ("Kind, nice".) Say it once more.

92.5 étroit — narrow

Before the new one: say the French for young, then the French for kind.

You'll want to know: étroit

étroit — "narrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étroit ← Old French *estroit* ← Latin *strictus*, "drawn tight" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étroit*
- *Say it: étroit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étroit*
- *Recall:* say the French for young, then the French for kind, then say *étroit* again

Before you move on

What does étroit mean? ("Narrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

Thin, Big, Heavy, Light, Sweet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name thin, big, heavy, light (not heavy), sweet (with sugar).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: I can name thin, big, heavy, light (not heavy), sweet (with sugar).*

93.1 mince — thin, slim

Before the new one: say the French for kind, then the French for narrow.

You'll want to know: mince

mince — "thin, slim".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mince — formed from the Old French verb *mincier*, "to cut fine", from Vulgar Latin **minutiare*, built on Latin *minutus*, "small" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mince*
- *Say it: mince*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mince*
- *Recall:* say the French for kind, then the French for narrow, then say *mince* again

Before you move on

What does mince mean? ("Thin, slim".) Say it once more.

93.2 gros — big, fat

Before the new one: say the French for narrow, then the French for thin.

You'll want to know: gros

gros — "big, fat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gros ← Late Latin *grossus*, "thick, coarse" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gros*
- *Say it: gros*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gros*
- *Recall:* say the French for narrow, then the French for thin, then say *gros* again

Before you move on

What does gros mean? (“Big, fat”.) Say it once more.

93.3 lourd — heavy

Before the new one: say the French for thin, then the French for big.

You’ll want to know: lourd

lourd — “heavy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lourd ← Old French *lourt*, “dull, stupid”, usually traced to Latin *luridus*, “sallow, ghastly” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The sense moved from dull to heavy.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lourd*
- *Say it: lourd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lourd*
- *Recall:* say the French for thin, then the French for big, then say *lourd* again

Before you move on

What does lourd mean? (“Heavy”.) Say it once more.

93.4 léger — light (not heavy)

Before the new one: say the French for big, then the French for heavy.

You'll want to know: léger

léger — "light (not heavy)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

léger ← Vulgar Latin **leviarius*, from Latin *levis*, "light" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: léger*
- *Say it: léger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *léger*
- *Recall:* say the French for big, then the French for heavy, then say *léger* again

Before you move on

What does léger mean? ("Light (not heavy)".) Say it once more.

93.5 sucré — sweet (with sugar)

Before the new one: say the French for heavy, then the French for light.

You'll want to know: sucré

sucré — "sweet (with sugar)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sucré is the past participle of the verb for "to sugar", made from *sucre*, "sugar": sugared.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sucré*
- *Say it: sucré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sucré*
- *Recall:* say the French for heavy, then the French for light, then say *sucré* again

Before you move on

What does sucré mean? ("Sweet (with sugar)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

Salty, Bitter, Round, Square, Dry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name salty, bitter, round, square, dry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: I can name salty, bitter, round, square, dry.*

94.1 salé — salty

Before the new one: say the French for light, then the French for sweet.

You'll want to know: salé

salé — "salty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salé is the past participle of the verb for "to salt", made from *sel*, "salt", ← Latin *sal*: salted.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: salé*
- *Say it: salé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *salé*
- *Recall:* say the French for light, then the French for sweet, then say *salé* again

Before you move on

What does salé mean? ("Salty".) Say it once more.

94.2 amer — bitter

Before the new one: say the French for sweet, then the French for salty.

You'll want to know: amer

amer — "bitter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amer ← Latin *amarus*, "bitter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amer*
- *Say it: amer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amer*
- *Recall:* say the French for sweet, then the French for salty, then say *amer* again

Before you move on

What does amer mean? (“Bitter”.) Say it once more.

94.3 rond — round

Before the new one: say the French for salty, then the French for bitter.

You’ll want to know: rond

rond — “round”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rond ← Old French *reont* ← Vulgar Latin **retundus* ← Latin *rotundus*, “round”, from *rota*, “a wheel” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rond*
- *Say it: rond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rond*
- *Recall:* say the French for salty, then the French for bitter, then say *rond* again

Before you move on

What does rond mean? (“Round”.) Say it once more.

94.4 carré — square

Before the new one: say the French for bitter, then the French for round.

You'll want to know: carré

carré — "square".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carré ← Old French *quarré* ← Latin *quadratus*, "squared" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: carré*
- *Say it: carré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *carré*
- *Recall:* say the French for bitter, then the French for round, then say *carré* again

Before you move on

What does carré mean? ("Square".) Say it once more.

94.5 sec — dry

Before the new one: say the French for round, then the French for square.

You'll want to know: sec

sec — "dry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sec ← Latin *siccus*, "dry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sec*
- *Say it: sec*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sec*
- *Recall:* say the French for round, then the French for square, then say *sec* again

Before you move on

What does sec mean? (“Dry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Wet, Week, Month, Morning, Always

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name wet, a week, a month, the morning, always.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: I can name wet, a week, a month, the morning, always.

95.1 mouillé — wet

Before the new one: say the French for square, then the French for dry.

You'll want to know: mouillé

mouillé — "wet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouillé is the past participle of the verb for "to wet", from Vulgar Latin **molliare*, "to soften", built on Latin *mollis*, "soft" (Lewis & Short): bread was softened by soaking.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mouillé*
- *Say it: mouillé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mouillé*
- *Recall:* say the French for square, then the French for dry, then say *mouillé* again

Before you move on

What does mouillé mean? ("Wet".) Say it once more.

95.2 la semaine — a week

Before the new one: say the French for dry, then the French for wet.

You'll want to know: la semaine

la semaine — "a week".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semaine ← Latin *septimana*, "a set of seven", from *septimus*, "seventh", and *septem*, "seven" — inherited. *sept* is the same Latin number. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la semaine*
- *Say it: la semaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la semaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for dry, then the French for wet, then say *la semaine* again

Before you move on

What does la semaine mean? (“A week”.) Say it once more.

95.3 le mois — a month

Before the new one: say the French for wet, then the French for a week.

You’ll want to know: le mois

le mois — “a month”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mois ← Old French *mois* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *mensis*, “month” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mois*
- *Say it: le mois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mois*
- *Recall:* say the French for wet, then the French for a week, then say *le mois* again

Before you move on

What does le mois mean? (“A month”.) Say it once more.

95.4 le matin — the morning

Before the new one: say the French for a week, then the French for a month.

You'll want to know: le matin

le matin — "the morning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

matin ← Latin *matutinum*, "the early part of the day", from *matutinus*, "of the morning" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le matin*
- *Say it: le matin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le matin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a week, then the French for a month, then say *le matin* again

Before you move on

What does le matin mean? ("The morning".) Say it once more.

95.5 toujours — always; still

Before the new one: say the French for a month, then the French for the morning.

You'll want to know: toujours

toujours — "always; still".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toujours ← Old French *toz jorz*, "all days": the word for "all" with *jours*, "days". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toujours*
- *Say it: toujours*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toujours*
- *Recall:* say the French for a month, then the French for the morning, then say *toujours* again

Before you move on

What does toujours mean? ("Always; still".) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Never, Now, Then, Far, Near

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name never, now, then, far, near.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: I can name never, now, then, far, near.*

96.1 jamais — never; ever

> Before the new one: say the French for the morning, then the French for always; still.

You'll want to know: jamais

jamais — "never; ever".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jamais ← Old French *ja mais*, "ever more" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *iam*, "already", and *magis*, "more" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jamais*
- *Say it: jamais*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jamais*
- *Recall:* say the French for the morning, then the French for always; still, then say *jamais* again

Before you move on

What does jamais mean? (“Never; ever”.) Say it once more.

96.2 maintenant — now

Before the new one: say the French for always; still, then the French for never; ever.

You’ll want to know: maintenant

maintenant — “now”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maintenant is the present participle of the verb “to maintain”, from Latin *manu tenere*, “to hold in the hand”: the moment at hand. The *main-* is *main*, “hand”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maintenant*
- *Say it: maintenant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maintenant*
- *Recall:* say the French for always; still, then the French for never; ever, then say *maintenant* again

Before you move on

What does maintenant mean? (“Now”.) Say it once more.

96.3 puis — then

Before the new one: say the French for never; ever, then the French for now.

You’ll want to know: puis

puis — “then”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

puis ← Vulgar Latin **postius*, from Latin *post*, “after” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puis*
- *Say it: puis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puis*
- *Recall:* say the French for never; ever, then the French for now, then say *puis* again

Before you move on

What does puis mean? (“Then”.) Say it once more.

96.4 loin — far

Before the new one: say the French for now, then the French for then.

You'll want to know: loin

loin — "far".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loin ← Latin *longe*, "far off", from *longus*, "long" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: loin*
- *Say it: loin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *loin*
- *Recall:* say the French for now, then the French for then, then say *loin* again

Before you move on

What does loin mean? ("Far".) Say it once more.

96.5 près — near

Before the new one: say the French for then, then the French for far.

You'll want to know: près

près — "near".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

près ← Old French *pres* ← Latin *presse*, "closely", from *pressus*, "pressed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: près*
- *Say it: près*, once more
- *Say it:* say *près*
- *Recall:* say the French for then, then the French for far, then say *près* again

Before you move on

What does près mean? ("Near".) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

On top, Underneath, Inside, Outside, Today

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name on top, underneath, inside, outside, today.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: I can name on top, underneath, inside, outside, today.*

97.1 dessus — on top

> Before the new one: say the French for far, then the French for near.

You'll want to know: dessus

dessus — "on top".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessus — built from *de*, "of, from", and Old French *sus*, "up, above", ← Latin *sursum*, "upward". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessus*
- *Say it: dessus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessus*
- *Recall:* say the French for far, then the French for near, then say *dessus* again

Before you move on

What does dessus mean? (“On top”.) Say it once more.

97.2 dessous — underneath

Before the new one: say the French for near, then the French for on top.

You’ll want to know: dessous

dessous — “underneath”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessous — built from *de*, “of, from”, and the word for “under”, from Latin *de* and *subtus*, “below”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessous*
- *Say it: dessous*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessous*
- *Recall:* say the French for near, then the French for on top, then say *dessous* again

Before you move on

What does dessous mean? (“Underneath”.) Say it once more.

97.3 dedans — inside

Before the new one: say the French for on top, then the French for underneath.

You’ll want to know: dedans

dedans — “inside”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dedans — built from *de*, “of, from”, and Old French *denz*, “within”, ← Latin *de intus*, “from inside” (Lewis & Short for *intus*).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dedans*
- *Say it:* *dedans*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dedans*
- *Recall:* say the French for on top, then the French for underneath, then say *dedans* again

Before you move on

What does dedans mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

97.4 dehors — outside

Before the new one: say the French for underneath, then the French for inside.

You'll want to know: dehors

dehors — "outside".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dehors ← Old French *defors* ← Late Latin *deforis*, "from outside", from *foris*, "outside" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dehors*
- *Say it: dehors*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dehors*
- *Recall:* say the French for underneath, then the French for inside, then say *dehors* again

Before you move on

What does dehors mean? ("Outside".) Say it once more.

97.5 aujourd'hui — today

Before the new one: say the French for inside, then the French for outside.

You'll want to know: aujourd'hui

aujourd'hui — "today".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aujourd'hui — "on the day of today": *au*, *jour*, and Old French *hui*, "today", ← Latin *hodie*, "today" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word). The word holds "today" two times over.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aujourd'hui*
- *Say it: aujourd'hui*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aujourd'hui*
- *Recall:* say the French for inside, then the French for outside, then say *aujourd'hui* again

Before you move on

What does aujourd'hui mean? ("Today".) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Yesterday, Often, Sometimes, Town, Street

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: I can name yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street.

98.1 hier — yesterday

Before the new one: say the French for outside, then the French for today.

You'll want to know: hier

hier — "yesterday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hier ← Old French *ier* ← Latin *heri*, "yesterday" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hier*
- *Say it: hier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hier*
- *Recall:* say the French for outside, then the French for today, then say *hier* again

Before you move on

What does hier mean? ("Yesterday".) Say it once more.

98.2 souvent — often

Before the new one: say the French for today, then the French for yesterday.

You'll want to know: souvent

souvent — "often".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souvent ← Old French *suvent* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *subinde*, "soon after, time after time" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: souvent*
- *Say it: souvent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *souvent*
- *Recall:* say the French for today, then the French for yesterday, then say *souvent* again

Before you move on

What does souvent mean? (“Often”.) Say it once more.

98.3 parfois — sometimes

Before the new one: say the French for yesterday, then the French for often.

You’ll want to know: parfois

parfois — “sometimes”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parfois — built from the word for “by” and the word for “a time, an occasion”, ← Latin *vices*, “turns” (Lewis & Short): by times.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parfois*
- *Say it: parfois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parfois*
- *Recall:* say the French for yesterday, then the French for often, then say *parfois* again

Before you move on

What does parfois mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

98.4 la ville — a town, a city

Before the new one: say the French for often, then the French for sometimes.

You'll want to know: la ville

la ville — "a town, a city".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ville ← Latin *villa*, "a country house, a farm" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ville*
- *Say it: la ville*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la ville*
- *Recall:* say the French for often, then the French for sometimes, then say *la ville* again

Before you move on

What does la ville mean? ("A town, a city".) Say it once more.

98.5 la rue — a street

Before the new one: say the French for sometimes, then the French for a town.

You'll want to know: la rue

la rue — "a street".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rue ← Latin *ruga*, "a wrinkle, a furrow" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: a street was a furrow between houses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rue*
- *Say it: la rue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la rue*
- *Recall:* say the French for sometimes, then the French for a town, then say *la rue* again

Before you move on

What does la rue mean? ("A street".) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Shop, School, Bank, Train, Aeroplane

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can name a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane.

99.1 le magasin — a shop

Before the new one: say the French for a town, then the French for a street.

You'll want to know: le magasin

le magasin — "a shop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

magasin ← Italian *magazzino*, "a storehouse", from Arabic *makhazin*, "storehouses" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le magasin*
- *Say it: le magasin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le magasin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a town, then the French for a street, then say *le magasin* again

Before you move on

What does le magasin mean? ("A shop".) Say it once more.

99.2 l'école — a school

Before the new one: say the French for a street, then the French for a shop.

You'll want to know: l'école

l'école — "a school".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

école ← Old French *escole* ← Latin *schola*, from Greek *schole*, "leisure, a place for talk" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: a fully inherited form would have broken the *o* into *ue*. The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'école*
- *Say it: l'école*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'école*
- *Recall:* say the French for a street, then the French for a shop, then say *l'école* again

Before you move on

What does l'école mean? ("A school".) Say it once more.

99.3 la banque — a bank

Before the new one: say the French for a shop, then the French for a school.

You'll want to know: la banque

la banque — "a bank".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banque ← Italian *banca*, "a bench", the money-changer's table — borrowed. The Italian word is Germanic, from Lombardic **bank*, "bench". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Lombardic step, through Italian *banco*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banque*
- *Say it: la banque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banque*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shop, then the French for a school, then say *la banque* again

Before you move on

What does la banque mean? ("A bank".) Say it once more.

99.4 le train — a train

Before the new one: say the French for a school, then the French for a bank.

You'll want to know: le train

le train — "a train".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

train — formed from the verb for "to drag, to pull along", which ← Vulgar Latin **traginare*, from Latin *trahere*, "to draw" (Lewis & Short): a train is a line of things pulled along.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le train*
- *Say it: le train*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le train*
- *Recall:* say the French for a school, then the French for a bank, then say *le train* again

Before you move on

What does le train mean? ("A train".) Say it once more.

99.5 l'avion — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the French for a bank, then the French for a train.

You'll want to know: l'avion

l'avion — "an aeroplane".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avion — coined in the 1890s by the engineer Clément Ader from Latin *avis*, "bird" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avion*
- *Say it: l'avion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank, then the French for a train, then say *l'avion* again

Before you move on

What does l'avion mean? ("An aeroplane".) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Car, Bridge, Park, Church, Museum

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can name a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum.*

100.1 la voiture — a car

> Before the new one: say the French for a train, then the French for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: la voiture

la voiture — "a car".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voiture ← Old French *veiture* ← Latin *vectura*, "a carrying, transport", from *vehere*, "to carry" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la voiture*
- *Say it: la voiture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la voiture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a train, then the French for an aeroplane, then say *la voiture* again

Before you move on

What does la voiture mean? ("A car".) Say it once more.

100.2 le pont — a bridge

Before the new one: say the French for an aeroplane, then the French for a car.

You'll want to know: le pont

le pont — "a bridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pont ← Latin *pons*, *pontis*, "bridge" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pont*
- *Say it: le pont*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pont*
- *Recall:* say the French for an aeroplane, then the French for a car, then say *le pont* again

Before you move on

What does le pont mean? (“A bridge”.) Say it once more.

100.3 le parc — a park

Before the new one: say the French for a car, then the French for a bridge.

You’ll want to know: le parc

le parc — “a park”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parc ← Old French *parc*, “a pen for animals” ← Medieval Latin *parricus*, “an enclosure”, probably from Frankish **parrik* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parc*
- *Say it: le parc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parc*
- *Recall:* say the French for a car, then the French for a bridge, then say *le parc* again

Before you move on

What does le parc mean? (“A park”.) Say it once more.

100.4 l’église — a church

Before the new one: say the French for a bridge, then the French for a park.

You'll want to know: l'église

l'église — "a church".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

église ← Latin *ecclesia*, from Greek *ekklesia*, "an assembly" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned, a Church word: a fully inherited form would show *-oi-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'église*
- *Say it: l'église*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'église*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bridge, then the French for a park, then say *l'église* again

Before you move on

What does l'église mean? ("A church".) Say it once more.

100.5 le musée — a museum

Before the new one: say the French for a park, then the French for a church.

You'll want to know: le musée

le musée — "a museum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

musée ← Latin *museum*, from Greek *mouseion*, "a shrine of the Muses" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le musée*
- *Say it: le musée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le musée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a park, then the French for a church, then say *le musée* again

Before you move on

What does le musée mean? ("A museum".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

Restaurant, Hotel, Pharmacy, Village, Post office

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can name a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office.

101.1 le restaurant — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the French for a church, then the French for a museum.

You'll want to know: le restaurant

le restaurant — "a restaurant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

restaurant is the present participle of the verb for "to restore", a learned borrowing of Latin *restaurare* (EtymDB 2.1): first a restoring broth, then the place that served it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le restaurant*
- *Say it: le restaurant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le restaurant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a church, then the French for a museum, then say *le restaurant* again

Before you move on

What does le restaurant mean? ("A restaurant".) Say it once more.

101.2 l'hôtel — a hotel

Before the new one: say the French for a museum, then the French for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: l'hôtel

l'hôtel — "a hotel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hôtel ← Old French *hostel* ← Late Latin *hospitale*, "a guest house", from *hospes*, "guest" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) *hôpital* is the same Latin word taken in by scholars; *hôtel* is the one worn down in speech.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hôtel*
- *Say it: l'hôtel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'hôtel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a museum, then the French for a restaurant, then say *l'hôtel* again

Before you move on

What does l'hôtel mean? ("A hotel".) Say it once more.

101.3 la pharmacie — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the French for a restaurant, then the French for a hotel.

You'll want to know: la pharmacie

la pharmacie — "a pharmacy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pharmacie ← Medieval Latin *pharmacia*, from Greek *pharmakeia*, "the use of drugs", built on *pharmakon*, "a drug" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pharmacie*
- *Say it: la pharmacie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pharmacie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a restaurant, then the French for a hotel, then say *la pharmacie* again

Before you move on

What does la pharmacie mean? ("A pharmacy".) Say it once more.

101.4 le village — a village

Before the new one: say the French for a hotel, then the French for a pharmacy.

You'll want to know: le village

le village — "a village".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

village — built from *ville*, which then meant "a farm, an estate", with *-age*: the cluster of houses around it. (EtymDB 2.1 traces it to Latin *villa*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le village*
- *Say it: le village*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le village*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hotel, then the French for a pharmacy, then say *le village* again

Before you move on

What does le village mean? ("A village".) Say it once more.

101.5 la poste — the post office

Before the new one: say the French for a pharmacy, then the French for a village.

You'll want to know: la poste

la poste — "the post office".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poste ← Italian *posta*, "a relay station", from Latin *posita*, "placed", the past participle of *ponere*, "to put" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poste*
- *Say it: la poste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pharmacy, then the French for a village, then say *la poste* again

Before you move on

What does la poste mean? ("The post office".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Police, Theatre, Library, Bakery, Town hall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can name the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall.*

102.1 la police — the police

> Before the new one: say the French for a village, then the French for the post office.

You'll want to know: la police

la police — "the police".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

police ← Latin *politia*, "government, citizenship", from Greek *politeia*, built on *polis*, "a city" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la police*
- *Say it: la police*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la police*
- *Recall:* say the French for a village, then the French for the post office, then say *la police* again

Before you move on

What does la police mean? ("The police".) Say it once more.

102.2 le théâtre — a theatre

Before the new one: say the French for the post office, then the French for the police.

You'll want to know: le théâtre

le théâtre — "a theatre".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

théâtre ← Latin *theatrum*, from Greek *theatron*, "a place for viewing" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le théâtre*
- *Say it: le théâtre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le théâtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the post office, then the French for the police, then say *le théâtre* again

Before you move on

What does le théâtre mean? (“A theatre”.) Say it once more.

102.3 la bibliothèque — a library

Before the new one: say the French for the police, then the French for a theatre.

You’ll want to know: la bibliothèque

la bibliothèque — “a library”. A false friend: a bookshop is **la librairie**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bibliothèque ← Latin *bibliotheca*, from Greek *bibliotheke*, “a case for books”, built on *biblion*, “a book” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bibliothèque*
- *Say it: la bibliothèque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bibliothèque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the police, then the French for a theatre, then say *la bibliothèque* again

Before you move on

What does la bibliothèque mean? (“A library”.) Say it once more.

102.4 la boulangerie — a bakery

Before the new one: say the French for a theatre, then the French for a library.

You'll want to know: la boulangerie

la boulangerie — "a bakery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boulangerie — built from the word for "baker", with *-erie*, "a place for". The baker word came from Picard *boulenc*, probably from Middle Dutch *bolle*, "a round loaf".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boulangerie*
- *Say it: la boulangerie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boulangerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a theatre, then the French for a library, then say *la boulangerie* again

Before you move on

What does la boulangerie mean? ("A bakery".) Say it once more.

102.5 la mairie — the town hall

Before the new one: say the French for a library, then the French for a bakery.

You'll want to know: la mairie

la mairie — "the town hall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mairie — built from the word for "mayor", with *-ie*: the mayor's house. The mayor word ← Latin *maior*, "greater" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mairie*
- *Say it: la mairie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mairie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a library, then the French for a bakery, then say *la mairie* again

Before you move on

What does la mairie mean? ("The town hall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

District, Airport, Clothes, Shirt, Dress

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can name a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress.*

103.1 le quartier — a district, a neighbourhood

> Before the new one: say the French for a bakery, then the French for the town hall.

You'll want to know: le quartier

le quartier — "a district, a neighbourhood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quartier ← Latin *quartarius*, "a fourth part", from *quartus*, "fourth" — first a quarter of something, then a part of a town. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le quartier*
- *Say it: le quartier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le quartier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bakery, then the French for the town hall, then say *le quartier* again

Before you move on

What does le quartier mean? ("A district, a neighbourhood".) Say it once more.

103.2 l'aéroport — an airport

Before the new one: say the French for the town hall, then the French for a district.

You'll want to know: l'aéroport

l'aéroport — "an airport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aéroport — a 20th-century coinage from *aéro-*, "air", from Greek *aer*, and Old French *port*, "harbour", ← Latin *portus* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aéroport*
- *Say it: l'aéroport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'aéroport*
- *Recall:* say the French for the town hall, then the French for a district, then say *l'aéroport* again

Before you move on

What does l'aéroport mean? ("An airport".) Say it once more.

103.3 les vêtements — clothes

Before the new one: say the French for a district, then the French for an airport.

You'll want to know: les vêtements

les vêtements — "clothes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vêtements is the plural of the word for "a garment" ← Old French *vestement* ← Latin *vestimentum*, "clothing", from *vestire*, "to clothe" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les vêtements*
- *Say it: les vêtements*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les vêtements*
- *Recall:* say the French for a district, then the French for an airport, then say *les vêtements* again

Before you move on

What does les vêtements mean? ("Clothes".) Say it once more.

103.4 la chemise — a shirt

Before the new one: say the French for an airport, then the French for clothes.

You'll want to know: la chemise

la chemise — "a shirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chemise ← Late Latin *camisia*, "a shirt", probably a Gaulish word (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chemise*
- *Say it: la chemise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chemise*
- *Recall:* say the French for an airport, then the French for clothes, then say *la chemise* again

Before you move on

What does la chemise mean? ("A shirt".) Say it once more.

103.5 la robe — a dress

Before the new one: say the French for clothes, then the French for a shirt.

You'll want to know: la robe

la robe — "a dress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

robe ← Old French *robe*, "booty, a garment", from Frankish **rauba*, "plunder" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: clothes were the first spoils of a raid.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la robe*
- *Say it: la robe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la robe*
- *Recall:* say the French for clothes, then the French for a shirt, then say *la robe* again

Before you move on

What does la robe mean? ("A dress".) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

Trousers, Shoes, Hat, Coat, Skirt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can name trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt.*

104.1 le pantalon — trousers

Before the new one: say the French for a shirt, then the French for a dress.

You'll want to know: le pantalon

le pantalon — "trousers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pantalon — named after *Pantalone* (EtymDB 2.1), the old Venetian of Italian comedy, who wore long trousers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pantalon*
- *Say it: le pantalon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pantalon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shirt, then the French for a dress, then say *le pantalon* again

Before you move on

What does le pantalon mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

104.2 les chaussures — shoes

Before the new one: say the French for a dress, then the French for trousers.

You'll want to know: les chaussures

les chaussures — "shoes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaussures is the plural of the word for "footwear", built from the verb for "to put on shoes", which ← Latin *calceare*, from *calceus*, "a shoe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les chaussures*
- *Say it: les chaussures*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les chaussures*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dress, then the French for trousers, then say *les chaussures* again

Before you move on

What does les chaussures mean? (“Shoes”.) Say it once more.

104.3 le chapeau — a hat

Before the new one: say the French for trousers, then the French for shoes.

You’ll want to know: le chapeau

le chapeau — “a hat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chapeau ← Old French *chapel* ← Vulgar Latin **cappellus*, from Late Latin *cappa*, “a hooded cloak” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chapeau*
- *Say it: le chapeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chapeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for trousers, then the French for shoes, then say *le chapeau* again

Before you move on

What does le chapeau mean? (“A hat”.) Say it once more.

104.4 le manteau — a coat

Before the new one: say the French for shoes, then the French for a hat.

You'll want to know: le manteau

le manteau — "a coat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manteau ← Old French *mantel* ← Latin *mantellum*, "a cloak" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le manteau*
- *Say it: le manteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le manteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for shoes, then the French for a hat, then say *le manteau* again

Before you move on

What does le manteau mean? ("A coat".) Say it once more.

104.5 la jupe — a skirt

Before the new one: say the French for a hat, then the French for a coat.

You'll want to know: la jupe

la jupe — "a skirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jupe ← Italian *giubba*, from Arabic *jubba*, "a long garment" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jupe*
- *Say it: la jupe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la jupe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hat, then the French for a coat, then say *la jupe* again

Before you move on

What does la jupe mean? ("A skirt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 105

Socks, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can name socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred.

105.1 les chaussettes — socks

Before the new one: say the French for a coat, then the French for a skirt.

You'll want to know: les chaussettes

les chaussettes — "socks".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaussettes is the plural of a little form of Old French *chauce*, "hose", ← Latin *calceus*, "a shoe" (Lewis & Short), with *-ette*, "little".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les chaussettes*
- *Say it: les chaussettes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les chaussettes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coat, then the French for a skirt, then say *les chaussettes* again

Before you move on

What does les chaussettes mean? (“Socks”.) Say it once more.

105.2 trente — thirty

Before the new one: say the French for a skirt, then the French for socks.

You’ll want to know: trente

trente — “thirty”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trente ← Latin *triginta*, “thirty” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trente*
- *Say it: trente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trente*
- *Recall:* say the French for a skirt, then the French for socks, then say *trente* again

Before you move on

What does trente mean? (“Thirty”.) Say it once more.

105.3 quarante — forty

Before the new one: say the French for socks, then the French for thirty.

You’ll want to know: quarante

quarante — “forty”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quarante ← Latin *quadraginta*, “forty” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: quarante*
- *Say it: quarante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *quarante*
- *Recall:* say the French for socks, then the French for thirty, then say *quarante* again

Before you move on

What does quarante mean? (“Forty”.) Say it once more.

105.4 cinquante — fifty

Before the new one: say the French for thirty, then the French for forty.

You'll want to know: cinquante

cinquante — "fifty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinquante ← Vulgar Latin **cinquaginta* ← Latin *quinquaginta*, "fifty" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cinquante*
- *Say it: cinquante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cinquante*
- *Recall:* say the French for thirty, then the French for forty, then say *cinquante* again

Before you move on

What does cinquante mean? ("Fifty".) Say it once more.

105.5 cent — a hundred

Before the new one: say the French for forty, then the French for fifty.

You'll want to know: cent

cent — "a hundred".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cent ← Latin *centum*, "a hundred" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cent*
- *Say it: cent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cent*
- *Recall:* say the French for forty, then the French for fifty, then say *cent* again

Before you move on

What does cent mean? ("A hundred".) Say it once more.

105.6 Nature, animals and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for fifty and a hundred.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag
- a phone, an umbrella, money; silver, a present, glasses
- a box, a suitcase, a ticket; a banknote, a map; a card, a photo
- a tree, a flower, a leaf; a sheet of paper, a mountain, a river
- the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island
- the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow
- the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave
- a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf
- a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck
- a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee
- an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger

- a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy
- difficult, dear; expensive, high, full, empty
- strong, weak, rich, poor, grey

Before you move on

A pen? (**le stylo**.) Paper? (**le papier**.) A notebook? (**le cahier**.) A pencil? (**le crayon**.) A bag? (**le sac**.) A phone? (**le téléphone**.) An umbrella? (**le parapluie**.) Money; silver? (**l'argent**.) A present? (**le cadeau**.) Glasses? (**les lunettes**.) A box? (**la boîte**.) A suitcase? (**la valise**.) A ticket; a banknote? (**le billet**.) A map; a card? (**la carte**.) A photo? (**la photo**.) A tree? (**l'arbre**.) A flower? (**la fleur**.) A leaf; a sheet of paper? (**la feuille**.) A mountain? (**la montagne**.) A river? (**la rivière**.) The sea? (**la mer**.) A stone? (**la pierre**.) Sand? (**le sable**.) A beach? (**la plage**.) An island? (**l'île**.) The sun? (**le soleil**.) A star? (**l'étoile**.) A cloud? (**le nuage**.) Rain? (**la pluie**.) Snow? (**la neige**.) The wind? (**le vent**.) Fire? (**le feu**.) A hill? (**la colline**.) A desert? (**le désert**.) A wave? (**la vague**.) A cow? (**la vache**.) A pig? (**le cochon**.) A bird? (**l'oiseau**.) A mouse? (**la souris**.) A wolf? (**le loup**.) A bear? (**l'ours**.) A fox? (**le renard**.) A snake? (**le serpent**.) A hen? (**la poule**.) A duck? (**le canard**.) A sheep? (**le mouton**.) A goat? (**la chèvre**.) A lion? (**le lion**.) A monkey? (**le singe**.) A bee? (**l'abeille**.) An ant? (**la fourmi**.) An elephant? (**l'éléphant**.) A rabbit? (**le lapin**.) A frog? (**la grenouille**.) A tiger? (**le tigre**.) A tortoise? (**la tortue**.) New? (**nouveau**.) Old? (**vieux**.) Fast? (**rapide**.) Easy? (**facile**.) Difficult? (**difficile**.) Dear; expensive? (**cher**.) High? (**haut**.) Full? (**plein**.) Empty? (**vide**.) Strong? (**fort**.) Weak? (**faible**.) Rich? (**riche**.) Poor? (**pauvre**.) Grey? (**gris**.)

105.7 Time, the town, clothes and numbers — a second pass

Say the words for soft; mild; sweet and dirty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- soft; mild; sweet, dirty, young, kind, narrow
- thin, big, heavy, light, sweet
- salty, bitter, round, square, dry
- wet, a week, a month, the morning, always; still
- never; ever, now, then, far, near
- on top, underneath, inside, outside, today
- yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street
- a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane
- a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum
- a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office
- the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall
- a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress
- trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt
- socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred

Before you move on

Soft; mild; sweet? (**doux**.) Dirty? (**sale**.) Young? (**jeune**.) Kind? (**gentil**.) Narrow? (**étroit**.) Thin? (**mince**.) Big? (**gros**.) Heavy? (**lourd**.) Light? (**léger**.) Sweet? (**sucré**.) Salty? (**salé**.) Bitter? (**amer**.) Round? (**rond**.) Square? (**carré**.) Dry? (**sec**.) Wet? (**mouillé**.) A week? (**la semaine**.) A month? (**le mois**.) The morning? (**le matin**.) Always; still? (**toujours**.) Never; ever? (**jamais**.) Now? (**maintenant**.) Then? (**puis**.) Far? (**loin**.) Near? (**près**.) On top? (**dessus**.) Underneath? (**dessous**.) Inside? (**dedans**.) Outside? (**dehors**.) Today? (**aujourd'hui**.) Yesterday? (**hier**.) Often? (**souvent**.) Sometimes? (**parfois**.) A town? (**la ville**.) A street? (**la rue**.) A shop? (**le magasin**.) A school?

(**l'école**.) A bank? (**la banque**.) A train? (**le train**.) An aeroplane? (**l'avion**.) A car? (**la voiture**.) A bridge? (**le pont**.) A park? (**le parc**.) A church? (**l'église**.) A museum? (**le musée**.) A restaurant? (**le restaurant**.) A hotel? (**l'hôtel**.) A pharmacy? (**la pharmacie**.) A village? (**le village**.) The post office? (**la poste**.) The police? (**la police**.) A theatre? (**le théâtre**.) A library? (**la bibliothèque**.) A bakery? (**la boulangerie**.) The town hall? (**la mairie**.) A district? (**le quartier**.) An airport? (**l'aéroport**.) Clothes? (**les vêtements**.) A shirt? (**la chemise**.) A dress? (**la robe**.) Trousers? (**le pantalon**.) Shoes? (**les chaussures**.) A hat? (**le chapeau**.) A coat? (**le manteau**.) A skirt? (**la jupe**.) Socks? (**les chaussettes**.) Thirty? (**trente**.) Forty? (**quarante**.) Fifty? (**cinquante**.) A hundred? (**cent**.)

Chapter 106

Bicycle, Underground, Taxi, Car park, Lift

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can name a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift.

106.1 le vélo — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the French for fifty, then the French for a hundred.

You'll want to know: le vélo

le vélo — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vélo — short for *vélocipède*, a 19th-century coinage from Latin *velox*, "swift", and *pes*, *pedis*, "foot" (EtymDB 2.1 gives the two Latin parts).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vélo*
- *Say it: le vélo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vélo*
- *Recall:* say the French for fifty, then the French for a hundred, then say *le vélo* again

Before you move on

What does le vélo mean? (“A bicycle”.) Say it once more.

106.2 le métro — the underground, the metro

Before the new one: say the French for a hundred, then the French for a bicycle.

You’ll want to know: le métro

le métro — “the underground, the metro”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

métro — short for *métropolitain*, the city railway, from Greek *metropolis*, “a mother city”, built from *meter*, “mother”, and *polis*, “city”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le métro*
- *Say it: le métro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le métro*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hundred, then the French for a bicycle, then say *le métro* again

Before you move on

What does le métro mean? (“The underground, the metro”.) Say it once more.

106.3 le taxi — a taxi

Before the new one: say the French for a bicycle, then the French for the underground.

Ask for a taxi: *je demande un taxi*. **Demander** is to ask, never to demand.

You’ll want to know: le taxi

le taxi — “a taxi”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taxi — short for *taximètre*, the fare meter, built from Medieval Latin *taxa*, “a charge”, and Greek *metron*, “measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le taxi*
- *Say it: le taxi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le taxi*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bicycle, then the French for the underground, then say *le taxi* again

Before you move on

What does le taxi mean? (“A taxi”.) Say it once more.

106.4 le parking — a car park

Before the new one: say the French for the underground, then the French for a taxi.

You'll want to know: le parking

le parking — "a car park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parking ← English *parking* — borrowed in the 20th century; English itself says *car park*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parking*
- *Say it: le parking*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parking*
- *Recall:* say the French for the underground, then the French for a taxi, then say *le parking* again

Before you move on

What does le parking mean? ("A car park".) Say it once more.

106.5 l'ascenseur — a lift, an elevator

Before the new one: say the French for a taxi, then the French for a car park.

You'll want to know: l'ascenseur

l'ascenseur — "a lift, an elevator".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ascenseur ← Latin *ascensor*, "one who climbs", from *ascendere*, "to climb up" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ascenseur*
- *Say it: l'ascenseur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ascenseur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a taxi, then the French for a car park, then say *l'ascenseur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ascenseur mean? ("A lift, an elevator".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

Supermarket, Cinema, Stadium, Swimming pool, Grocer's shop

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can name a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop.

107.1 le supermarché — a supermarket

Before the new one: say the French for a car park, then the French for a lift.

You'll want to know: le supermarché

le supermarché — "a supermarket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supermarché — built from *super-*, Latin for "above", and the French word for "market", which ← Latin *mercatus*, "trade" (Lewis & Short); modelled on English *supermarket*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le supermarché*
- *Say it: le supermarché*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le supermarché*
- *Recall:* say the French for a car park, then the French for a lift, then say *le supermarché* again

Before you move on

What does le supermarché mean? ("A supermarket".) Say it once more.

107.2 le cinéma — a cinema

Before the new one: say the French for a lift, then the French for a supermarket.

You'll want to know: le cinéma

le cinéma — "a cinema".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinéma — short for *cinématographe*, a coinage of the 1890s from Greek *kinema*, "movement" (EtymDB 2.1), and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cinéma*
- *Say it: le cinéma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cinéma*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lift, then the French for a supermarket, then say *le cinéma* again

Before you move on

What does le cinéma mean? (“A cinema”.) Say it once more.

107.3 le stade — a stadium

Before the new one: say the French for a supermarket, then the French for a cinema.

You’ll want to know: le stade

le stade — “a stadium”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stade ← Latin *stadium*, from Greek *stadion*, a measure of length and the racecourse of that length — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stade*
- *Say it: le stade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le stade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a supermarket, then the French for a cinema, then say *le stade* again

Before you move on

What does le stade mean? (“A stadium”.) Say it once more.

107.4 la piscine — a swimming pool

Before the new one: say the French for a cinema, then the French for a stadium.

You'll want to know: la piscine

la piscine — "a swimming pool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piscine ← Latin *piscina*, "a fishpond", from *piscis*, "fish" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: the same Latin fish as *poisson*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la piscine*
- *Say it: la piscine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la piscine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cinema, then the French for a stadium, then say *la piscine* again

Before you move on

What does la piscine mean? ("A swimming pool".) Say it once more.

107.5 l'épicerie — a grocer's shop

Before the new one: say the French for a stadium, then the French for a swimming pool.

You'll want to know: l'épicerie

l'épicerie — "a grocer's shop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épicerie — built from the French word for "spice", with *-erie*, "a shop for". The spice word ← Latin *species*, "a kind; wares" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épicerie*
- *Say it: l'épicerie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'épicerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stadium, then the French for a swimming pool, then say *l'épicerie* again

Before you move on

What does l'épicerie mean? ("A grocer's shop".) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Office, Factory, Pavement, Crossroads, Red light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name an office, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can name an office, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light.

108.1 le bureau — an office; a desk

Before the new one: say the French for a swimming pool, then the French for a grocer's shop.

You'll want to know: le bureau

le bureau — "an office; a desk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bureau ← Old French *burel*, "coarse woollen cloth", from Old French *bure*, ← Latin *burra*, "shaggy cloth" (EtymDB 2.1): the cloth on a desk, then the desk, then the room.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bureau*
- *Say it: le bureau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bureau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a swimming pool, then the French for a grocer's shop, then say *le bureau* again

Before you move on

What does le bureau mean? ("An office; a desk".) Say it once more.

108.2 l'usine — a factory

Before the new one: say the French for a grocer's shop, then the French for an office; a desk.

You'll want to know: l'usine

l'usine — "a factory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

usine ← northern dialect *wisine*, from Latin *officina*, "a workshop" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'usine*
- *Say it: l'usine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'usine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grocer's shop, then the French for an office; a desk, then say *l'usine* again

Before you move on

What does l'usine mean? ("A factory".) Say it once more.

108.3 le trottoir — a pavement

Before the new one: say the French for an office; a desk, then the French for a factory.

You'll want to know: le trottoir

le trottoir — "a pavement".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trottoir — built from the verb for "to trot", from Frankish **trotton*, "to run" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-oir*, "a place for": a place to walk.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trottoir*
- *Say it: le trottoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le trottoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for an office; a desk, then the French for a factory, then say *le trottoir* again

Before you move on

What does le trottoir mean? ("A pavement".) Say it once more.

108.4 le carrefour — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the French for a factory, then the French for a pavement.

You'll want to know: le carrefour

le carrefour — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carrefour ← Old French *quarrefourc* ← Late Latin *quadrifurcum*, "a place with four forks", from *quattuor*, "four", and *furca*, "a fork" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carrefour*
- *Say it: le carrefour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le carrefour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a factory, then the French for a pavement, then say *le carrefour* again

Before you move on

What does le carrefour mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

108.5 le feu rouge — a red light

Before the new one: say the French for a pavement, then the French for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: le feu rouge

le feu rouge — "a red light". **le feu** is a fire; at a crossing it is the traffic light.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feu rouge — "red fire": *feu*, "fire", ← Latin *focus*, and *rouge*, "red", ← Latin *rubeus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le feu rouge*
- *Say it: le feu rouge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le feu rouge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pavement, then the French for a crossroads, then say *le feu rouge* again

Before you move on

What does le feu rouge mean? ("A red light".) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Border, North, South, West, Letterbox

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can name a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox.

109.1 la frontière — a border

Before the new one: say the French for a crossroads, then the French for a red light.

You'll want to know: la frontière

la frontière — "a border".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frontière — built from Old French *front*, "forehead, the front line", ← Latin *frons*, *frontis* (Lewis & Short), with *-ière*: the line an army faced.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la frontière*
- *Say it: la frontière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la frontière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a crossroads, then the French for a red light, then say *la frontière* again

Before you move on

What does la frontière mean? (“A border”.) Say it once more.

109.2 le nord — the north

Before the new one: say the French for a red light, then the French for a border.

You’ll want to know: le nord

le nord — “the north”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nord ← Old English *north* — borrowed in the Middle Ages, like the other compass points. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le nord*
- *Say it: le nord*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le nord*
- *Recall:* say the French for a red light, then the French for a border, then say *le nord* again

Before you move on

What does le nord mean? ("The north".) Say it once more.

109.3 le sud — the south

Before the new one: say the French for a border, then the French for the north.

You'll want to know: le sud

le sud — "the south".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sud ← Old French *su* ← Old English *suth*, "south" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sud*
- *Say it: le sud*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sud*
- *Recall:* say the French for a border, then the French for the north, then say *le sud* again

Before you move on

What does le sud mean? ("The south".) Say it once more.

109.4 l'ouest — the west

Before the new one: say the French for the north, then the French for the south.

You'll want to know: l'ouest

l'ouest — "the west".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouest ← Old French *west* ← Old English *west* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ouest*
- *Say it: l'ouest*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ouest*
- *Recall:* say the French for the north, then the French for the south, then say *l'ouest* again

Before you move on

What does l'ouest mean? ("The west".) Say it once more.

109.5 la boîte aux lettres — a letterbox, a postbox

Before the new one: say the French for the south, then the French for the west.

You'll want to know: la boîte aux lettres

la boîte aux lettres — "a letterbox, a postbox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boîte aux lettres — "box for the letters": *boîte*, "box", with *aux*, "to the", and the word for "letters", ← Latin *littera*, "a letter of the alphabet" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boîte aux lettres*
- *Say it: la boîte aux lettres*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boîte aux lettres*
- *Recall:* say the French for the south, then the French for the west, then say *la boîte aux lettres* again

Before you move on

What does la boîte aux lettres mean? ("A letterbox, a postbox".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Right, Left, World, Journey, Holidays

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can name the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays.

110.1 la droite — the right

Before the new one: say the French for the west, then the French for a letterbox.

You'll want to know: la droite

la droite — "the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

droite is the feminine of the word for "right, straight", ← Latin *directus*, "straight" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la droite*
- *Say it: la droite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la droite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the west, then the French for a letterbox, then say *la droite* again

Before you move on

What does la droite mean? ("The right".) Say it once more.

110.2 la gauche — the left

Before the new one: say the French for a letterbox, then the French for the right.

You'll want to know: la gauche

la gauche — "the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gauche — formed from the Old French verb *gauchir*, "to veer, to warp" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Frankish **walkan*, "to trample". The left was the clumsy hand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gauche*
- *Say it: la gauche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gauche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a letterbox, then the French for the right, then say *la gauche* again

Before you move on

What does la gauche mean? (“The left”.) Say it once more.

110.3 le monde — the world

Before the new one: say the French for the right, then the French for the left.

You’ll want to know: le monde

le monde — “the world”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monde ← Latin *mundus*, “the world” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le monde*
- *Say it: le monde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le monde*
- *Recall:* say the French for the right, then the French for the left, then say *le monde* again

Before you move on

What does le monde mean? (“The world”.) Say it once more.

110.4 le voyage — a journey, a trip

Before the new one: say the French for the left, then the French for the world.

You'll want to know: le voyage

le voyage — "a journey, a trip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voyage ← Old French *voiage* ← Latin *viaticum*, "money and food for a journey", from *via*, "a road" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le voyage*
- *Say it: le voyage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le voyage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the left, then the French for the world, then say *le voyage* again

Before you move on

What does le voyage mean? ("A journey, a trip".) Say it once more.

110.5 les vacances — holidays

Before the new one: say the French for the world, then the French for a journey.

The holiday month: say *en août*.

You'll want to know: les vacances

les vacances — "holidays". Always plural in this sense.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vacances ← Latin *vacantia*, "empty, free times", from *vacare*, "to be empty, to be free" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les vacances*
- *Say it: les vacances*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les vacances*
- *Recall:* say the French for the world, then the French for a journey, then say *les vacances* again

Before you move on

What does les vacances mean? ("Holidays".) Say it once more.

Chapter 111

Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Radio

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can name a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio.*

111.1 le tapis — a rug, a carpet

Before the new one: say the French for a journey, then the French for holidays.

You'll want to know: le tapis

le tapis — "a rug, a carpet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tapis ← Old French *tapiz* ← Byzantine Greek *tapetion*, from Greek *tapes*, "a carpet" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tapis*
- *Say it: le tapis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tapis*
- *Recall:* say the French for a journey, then the French for holidays, then say *le tapis* again

Before you move on

What does le tapis mean? ("A rug, a carpet".) Say it once more.

111.2 la télévision — a television

Before the new one: say the French for holidays, then the French for a rug.

You'll want to know: la télévision

la télévision — "a television".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

télévision — a 20th-century coinage from Greek *tele*, "far off", and *vision*, ← Latin *visio*, "seeing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la télévision*
- *Say it: la télévision*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la télévision*
- *Recall:* say the French for holidays, then the French for a rug, then say *la télévision* again

Before you move on

What does la télévision mean? ("A television".) Say it once more.

111.3 l'ordinateur — a computer

Before the new one: say the French for a rug, then the French for a television.

You'll want to know: l'ordinateur

l'ordinateur — "a computer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ordinateur ← Latin *ordinator*, "one who sets in order" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing, chosen in 1955 as the French name for the computer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ordinateur*
- *Say it: l'ordinateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ordinateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rug, then the French for a television, then say *l'ordinateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ordinateur mean? ("A computer".) Say it once more.

111.4 le réfrigérateur — a fridge

Before the new one: say the French for a television, then the French for a computer.

You'll want to know: le réfrigérateur

le réfrigérateur — "a fridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réfrigérateur — formed from the verb for "to chill", a learned borrowing of Latin *refrigerare*, "to make cool", from *frigus*, "cold" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réfrigérateur*
- *Say it: le réfrigérateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le réfrigérateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a television, then the French for a computer, then say *le réfrigérateur* again

Before you move on

What does le réfrigérateur mean? ("A fridge".) Say it once more.

111.5 la radio — a radio

Before the new one: say the French for a computer, then the French for a fridge.

You'll want to know: la radio

la radio — "a radio".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

radio — short for *radiotélégraphie*, built on Latin *radius*, "a rod, a ray" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la radio*
- *Say it: la radio*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la radio*
- *Recall:* say the French for a computer, then the French for a fridge, then say *la radio* again

Before you move on

What does la radio mean? ("A radio".) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Shower, Bathtub, Wardrobe, Shelf, Curtain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can name a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain.

112.1 la douche — a shower

Before the new one: say the French for a fridge, then the French for a radio.

You'll want to know: la douche

la douche — "a shower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douche ← Italian *doccia*, "a water pipe", from Latin *ductus*, "a leading, a conduit", from *ducere*, "to lead" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douche*
- *Say it: la douche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fridge, then the French for a radio, then say *la douche* again

Before you move on

What does la douche mean? ("A shower".) Say it once more.

112.2 la baignoire — a bathtub

Before the new one: say the French for a radio, then the French for a shower.

You'll want to know: la baignoire

la baignoire — "a bathtub".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baignoire — built from the verb for "to bathe", with *-oire*, "a thing for". The verb ← Latin *balneare*, from *balneum*, "a bath" (EtymDB 2.1 records *balneum*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la baignoire*
- *Say it: la baignoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la baignoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a radio, then the French for a shower, then say *la baignoire* again

Before you move on

What does la baignoire mean? (“A bathtub”.) Say it once more.

112.3 l’armoire — a wardrobe

Before the new one: say the French for a shower, then the French for a bathtub.

You’ll want to know: l’armoire

l’armoire — “a wardrobe”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

armoire ← Old French *armaire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *armarium*, “a cupboard, a chest”, from *arma*, “tools, arms” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’armoire*
- *Say it: l’armoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’armoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shower, then the French for a bathtub, then say *l’armoire* again

Before you move on

What does l’armoire mean? (“A wardrobe”.) Say it once more.

112.4 l’étagère — a shelf

Before the new one: say the French for a bathtub, then the French for a wardrobe.

You'll want to know: l'étagère

l'étagère — "a shelf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étagère — built from the word for "a level, a storey", with *-ère* (EtymDB 2.1). That word goes back to Latin *stare*, "to stand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étagère*
- *Say it: l'étagère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étagère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bathtub, then the French for a wardrobe, then say *l'étagère* again

Before you move on

What does l'étagère mean? ("A shelf".) Say it once more.

112.5 le rideau — a curtain

Before the new one: say the French for a wardrobe, then the French for a shelf.

You'll want to know: le rideau

le rideau — "a curtain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rideau ← Old French *ridel*, "a pleated cloth", from *rider*, "to pleat, to wrinkle". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rideau*
- *Say it: le rideau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rideau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wardrobe, then the French for a shelf, then say *le rideau* again

Before you move on

What does le rideau mean? ("A curtain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Pillow, Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a pillow, a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can name a pillow, a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush.

113.1 l'oreiller — a pillow

Before the new one: say the French for a shelf, then the French for a curtain.

You'll want to know: l'oreiller

l'oreiller — "a pillow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oreiller ← Old French *orillier* (EtymDB 2.1), built from the word for "ear", ← Latin *auricula*, "a little ear", with *-ier*: the thing for the ear.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oreiller*
- *Say it: l'oreiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oreiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shelf, then the French for a curtain, then say *l'oreiller* again

Before you move on

What does l'oreiller mean? ("A pillow".) Say it once more.

113.2 la couverture — a blanket

Before the new one: say the French for a curtain, then the French for a pillow.

You'll want to know: la couverture

la couverture — "a blanket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couverture ← Late Latin *coopertura*, "a covering", from *coopertus*, "covered", the past participle of *cooperire* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couverture*
- *Say it: la couverture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la couverture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a curtain, then the French for a pillow, then say *la couverture* again

Before you move on

What does la couverture mean? (“A blanket”.) Say it once more.

113.3 la serviette — a towel; a napkin

Before the new one: say the French for a pillow, then the French for a blanket.

You’ll want to know: la serviette

la serviette — “a towel; a napkin”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serviette — built from the verb for “to serve”, with *-ette*: a little thing for serving. The verb ← Latin *servire*, “to be a servant”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la serviette*
- *Say it: la serviette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la serviette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pillow, then the French for a blanket, then say *la serviette* again

Before you move on

What does la serviette mean? (“A towel; a napkin”.) Say it once more.

113.4 le savon — soap

Before the new one: say the French for a blanket, then the French for a towel; a napkin.

You'll want to know: le savon

le savon — "soap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

savon ← Old French *savon* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *sapo*, *saponis*, "soap", a Germanic word in Latin (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le savon*
- *Say it: le savon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le savon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a blanket, then the French for a towel; a napkin, then say *le savon* again

Before you move on

What does le savon mean? ("Soap".) Say it once more.

113.5 la brosse à dents — a toothbrush

Before the new one: say the French for a towel; a napkin, then the French for soap.

You'll want to know: la brosse à dents

la brosse à dents — "a toothbrush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brosse à dents — "brush for teeth": *brosse*, "brush", first "brushwood" in Old French (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; *à*, "for"; and *dents*, "teeth", ← Latin *dens*, *dentis*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brosse à dents*
- *Say it: la brosse à dents*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la brosse à dents*
- *Recall:* say the French for a towel; a napkin, then the French for soap, then say *la brosse à dents* again

Before you move on

What does la brosse à dents mean? ("A toothbrush".) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Toothpaste, Shampoo, Comb, Bin, Broom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can name toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom.

114.1 le dentifrice — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the French for soap, then the French for a toothbrush.

You'll want to know: le dentifrice

le dentifrice — "toothpaste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dentifrice ← Latin *dentifricium*, "tooth powder", from *dens*, "tooth", and *fricare*, "to rub" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dentifrice*
- *Say it: le dentifrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dentifrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for soap, then the French for a toothbrush, then say *le dentifrice* again

Before you move on

What does le dentifrice mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

114.2 le shampooing — shampoo

Before the new one: say the French for a toothbrush, then the French for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: le shampooing

le shampooing — "shampoo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

shampooing ← English *shampooing*, from Hindi *champo*, "press! knead!" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le shampooing*
- *Say it: le shampooing*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le shampooing*
- *Recall:* say the French for a toothbrush, then the French for toothpaste, then say *le shampooing* again

Before you move on

What does le shampooing mean? ("Shampoo".) Say it once more.

114.3 le peigne — a comb

Before the new one: say the French for toothpaste, then the French for shampoo.

You'll want to know: le peigne

le peigne — "a comb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peigne ← Old French *peigne* ← Latin *pecten*, *pectinis*, "a comb" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le peigne*
- *Say it: le peigne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le peigne*
- *Recall:* say the French for toothpaste, then the French for shampoo, then say *le peigne* again

Before you move on

What does le peigne mean? ("A comb".) Say it once more.

114.4 la poubelle — a bin

Before the new one: say the French for shampoo, then the French for a comb.

You'll want to know: la poubelle

la poubelle — "a bin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poubelle — named after Eugène Poubelle, the prefect of Paris who made lidded bins compulsory in 1884.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poubelle*
- *Say it: la poubelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poubelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for shampoo, then the French for a comb, then say *la poubelle* again

Before you move on

What does la poubelle mean? ("A bin".) Say it once more.

114.5 le balai — a broom

Before the new one: say the French for a comb, then the French for a bin.

You'll want to know: le balai

le balai — "a broom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balai ← Old French *balain*, from Breton *balan*, "broom", the shrub that brooms were made of — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le balai*
- *Say it: le balai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le balai*
- *Recall:* say the French for a comb, then the French for a bin, then say *le balai* again

Before you move on

What does le balai mean? ("A broom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Vacuum, Laundry, Washing powder, Iron, Pocket

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder, iron, a pocket.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can name a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder, iron, a pocket.*

115.1 l'aspirateur — a vacuum cleaner

> Before the new one: say the French for a bin, then the French for a broom.

You'll want to know: l'aspirateur

l'aspirateur — "a vacuum cleaner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aspirateur — built from the verb for "to breathe in, to suck in", with *-ateur*, "a thing that does". The verb ← Latin *aspirare*, "to breathe upon", from *spirare*, "to breathe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aspirateur*
- *Say it: l'aspirateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'aspirateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bin, then the French for a broom, then say *l'aspirateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'aspirateur mean? ("A vacuum cleaner".) Say it once more.

115.2 le linge — laundry, linen

Before the new one: say the French for a broom, then the French for a vacuum cleaner.

You'll want to know: le linge

le linge — "laundry, linen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

linge ← Latin *lineus*, "made of flax", from *linum*, "flax" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le linge*
- *Say it: le linge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le linge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a broom, then the French for a vacuum cleaner, then say *le linge* again

Before you move on

What does le linge mean? ("Laundry, linen".) Say it once more.

115.3 la lessive — washing powder; the washing

Before the new one: say the French for a vacuum cleaner, then the French for laundry.

You'll want to know: la lessive

la lessive — "washing powder; the washing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lessive ← Old French *lissive* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *lixivus*, "made into lye", from *lix*, "ashes, lye" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: clothes were washed in lye.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lessive*
- *Say it: la lessive*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lessive*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vacuum cleaner, then the French for laundry, then say *la lessive* again

Before you move on

What does la lessive mean? ("Washing powder; the washing".) Say it once more.

115.4 le fer — iron; an iron (for clothes)

Before the new one: say the French for laundry, then the French for washing powder; the washing.

You'll want to know: le fer

le fer — "iron; an iron (for clothes)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fer ← Latin *ferrum*, "iron" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fer*
- *Say it: le fer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fer*
- *Recall:* say the French for laundry, then the French for washing powder; the washing, then say *le fer* again

Before you move on

What does le fer mean? ("Iron; an iron (for clothes)".) Say it once more.

115.5 la poche — a pocket

Before the new one: say the French for washing powder; the washing, then the French for iron; an iron.

You'll want to know: la poche

la poche — "a pocket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poche ← Frankish **pokka*, "a bag" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1 has Old French *poche*, "a bag".)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poche*
- *Say it: la poche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poche*
- *Recall:* say the French for washing powder; the washing, then the French for iron; an iron, then say *la poche* again

Before you move on

What does la poche mean? ("A pocket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Jacket, Tie, Belt, Gloves, Scarf

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can name a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf.*

116.1 la veste — a jacket

Before the new one: say the French for iron; an iron, then the French for a pocket.

You'll want to know: la veste

la veste — "a jacket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

veste ← Italian *veste*, "a garment", from Latin *vestis*, "clothing" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la veste*
- *Say it: la veste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la veste*
- *Recall:* say the French for iron; an iron, then the French for a pocket, then say *la veste* again

Before you move on

What does la veste mean? ("A jacket".) Say it once more.

116.2 la cravate — a tie

Before the new one: say the French for a pocket, then the French for a jacket.

You'll want to know: la cravate

la cravate — "a tie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cravate — an old French form of the word for "a Croat" (EtymDB 2.1): Croatian soldiers in 17th-century France wore knotted neck scarves, and the fashion took their name.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cravate*
- *Say it: la cravate*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cravate*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pocket, then the French for a jacket, then say *la cravate* again

Before you move on

What does la cravate mean? (“A tie”.) Say it once more.

116.3 la ceinture — a belt

Before the new one: say the French for a jacket, then the French for a tie.

You’ll want to know: la ceinture

la ceinture — “a belt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ceinture ← Latin *cinctura*, “a girdle”, from *cingere*, “to gird” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-nct-* became *-int-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ceinture*
- *Say it: la ceinture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la ceinture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a jacket, then the French for a tie, then say *la ceinture* again

Before you move on

What does la ceinture mean? (“A belt”.) Say it once more.

116.4 les gants — gloves

Before the new one: say the French for a tie, then the French for a belt.

You'll want to know: les gants

les gants — "gloves".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gants is the plural of the word for "glove" ← Old French *guant* ← Frankish **want*, "glove" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les gants*
- *Say it: les gants*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les gants*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tie, then the French for a belt, then say *les gants* again

Before you move on

What does les gants mean? ("Gloves".) Say it once more.

116.5 l'écharpe — a scarf

Before the new one: say the French for a belt, then the French for gloves.

You'll want to know: l'écharpe

l'écharpe — "a scarf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écharpe ← Old French *escharpe*, a pilgrim's bag on a strap, from Frankish **skirpja*, "a bag of rushes" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écharpe*
- *Say it: l'écharpe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écharpe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a belt, then the French for gloves, then say *l'écharpe* again

Before you move on

What does l'écharpe mean? ("A scarf".) Say it once more.

116.6 Getting around and the town — a first pass

Say the words for gloves and a scarf.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift
- a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop
- an office; a desk, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light
- a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox
- the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays

Before you move on

A bicycle? (**le vélo**.) The underground? (**le métro**.) A taxi? (**le taxi**.) A car park? (**le parking**.) A lift? (**l'ascenseur**.) A supermarket? (**le supermarché**.) A cinema? (**le cinéma**.) A

stadium? (**le stade**.) A swimming pool? (**la piscine**.) A grocer's shop? (**l'épicerie**.) An office; a desk? (**le bureau**.) A factory? (**l'usine**.) A pavement? (**le trottoir**.) A crossroads? (**le carrefour**.) A red light? (**le feu rouge**.) A border? (**la frontière**.) The north? (**le nord**.) The south? (**le sud**.) The west? (**l'ouest**.) A letterbox? (**la boîte aux lettres**.) The right? (**la droite**.) The left? (**la gauche**.) The world? (**le monde**.) A journey? (**le voyage**.) Holidays? (**les vacances**.)

116.7 The house — a second pass

Say the words for a rug and a television.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio
- a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain
- a pillow, a blanket, a towel; a napkin, soap, a toothbrush
- toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom
- a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder; the washing, iron; an iron, a pocket
- a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf

Before you move on

A rug? (**le tapis**.) A television? (**la télévision**.) A computer? (**l'ordinateur**.) A fridge? (**le réfrigérateur**.) A radio? (**la radio**.) A shower? (**la douche**.) A bathtub? (**la baignoire**.) A wardrobe? (**l'armoire**.) A shelf? (**l'étagère**.) A curtain? (**le rideau**.) A pillow? (**l'oreiller**.) A blanket? (**la couverture**.) A towel; a napkin? (**la serviette**.) Soap? (**le savon**.) A toothbrush? (**la brosse à dents**.) Toothpaste? (**le dentifrice**.) Shampoo? (**le shampooing**.) A comb? (**le peigne**.) A bin? (**la poubelle**.) A broom? (**le balai**.) A vacuum cleaner? (**l'aspirateur**.) Laundry?

(**le linge**.) Washing powder; the washing? (**la lessive**.) Iron; an iron? (**le fer**.) A pocket? (**la poche**.) A jacket? (**la veste**.) A tie? (**la cravate**.) A belt? (**la ceinture**.) Gloves? (**les gants**.) A scarf? (**l'écharpe**.)

Chapter 117

Boots, Cap, Swimsuit, Size, Wallet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name boots, a cap, a swimsuit, size, a wallet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can name boots, a cap, a swimsuit, size, a wallet.*

117.1 les bottes — boots

Before the new one: say the French for gloves, then the French for a scarf.

You'll want to know: les bottes

les bottes — "boots".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bottes is the plural of the word for "boot", whose origin is uncertain. EtymDB 2.1 records Old French *bote*, "a high, thick shoe", and offers a Frankish source that is not secure.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les bottes*
- *Say it: les bottes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les bottes*
- *Recall:* say the French for gloves, then the French for a scarf, then say *les bottes* again

Before you move on

What does les bottes mean? ("Boots".) Say it once more.

117.2 la casquette — a cap

Before the new one: say the French for a scarf, then the French for boots.

You'll want to know: la casquette

la casquette — "a cap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casquette — a little form of the French word for "helmet", with *-ette*. That word came from Spanish *casco*, "skull, helmet" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la casquette*
- *Say it: la casquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la casquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scarf, then the French for boots, then say *la casquette* again

Before you move on

What does la casquette mean? (“A cap”.) Say it once more.

117.3 le maillot — a swimsuit; a sports shirt

Before the new one: say the French for boots, then the French for a cap.

You’ll want to know: le maillot

le maillot — “a swimsuit; a sports shirt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maillot ← Old French *mailloel*, a swaddling band, from *maille*, “a stitch, a mesh”, ← Latin *macula*, “a spot, a mesh”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maillot*
- *Say it: le maillot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le maillot*
- *Recall:* say the French for boots, then the French for a cap, then say *le maillot* again

Before you move on

What does le maillot mean? (“A swimsuit; a sports shirt”.) Say it once more.

117.4 la taille — size; the waist

Before the new one: say the French for a cap, then the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt.

You'll want to know: la taille

la taille — "size; the waist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taille — formed from the verb for "to cut", ← Late Latin *taliare*, from *talea*, "a cutting, a twig" (EtymDB 2.1): the cut of a garment, then its size.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la taille*
- *Say it: la taille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la taille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cap, then the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then say *la taille* again

Before you move on

What does la taille mean? ("Size; the waist".) Say it once more.

117.5 le portefeuille — a wallet

Before the new one: say the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then the French for size; the waist.

You'll want to know: le portefeuille

le portefeuille — "a wallet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portefeuille — "carry-leaves": *porte*, from *porter*, "to carry", and *feuille*, "a leaf, a sheet": a case for carrying papers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le portefeuille*
- *Say it: le portefeuille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le portefeuille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then the French for size; the waist, then say *le portefeuille* again

Before you move on

What does le portefeuille mean? ("A wallet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Jewel, Ring, Necklace, Perfume, Letter

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can name a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter.*

118.1 le bijou — a jewel, a piece of jewellery

> Before the new one: say the French for size; the waist, then the French for a wallet.

You'll want to know: le bijou

le bijou — "a jewel, a piece of jewellery". Plural **les bijoux**, with an x.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bijou ← Breton *bizou*, "a ring", from *biz*, "finger" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bijou*
- *Say it: le bijou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bijou*
- *Recall:* say the French for size; the waist, then the French for a wallet, then say *le bijou* again

Before you move on

What does le bijou mean? (“A jewel, a piece of jewellery”.) Say it once more.

118.2 la bague — a ring

Before the new one: say the French for a wallet, then the French for a jewel.

You’ll want to know: la bague

la bague — “a ring”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bague — its origin is uncertain; Middle Dutch *bagge*, “a ring”, is the usual guess. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bague*
- *Say it: la bague*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bague*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wallet, then the French for a jewel, then say *la bague* again

Before you move on

What does la bague mean? (“A ring”.) Say it once more.

118.3 le collier — a necklace

Before the new one: say the French for a jewel, then the French for a ring.

You’ll want to know: le collier

le collier — “a necklace”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

collier ← Late Latin *collare*, “a band for the neck”, from *collum*, “neck” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the same *collum* as *cou*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le collier*
- *Say it: le collier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le collier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a jewel, then the French for a ring, then say *le collier* again

Before you move on

What does le collier mean? (“A necklace”.) Say it once more.

118.4 le parfum — perfume

Before the new one: say the French for a ring, then the French for a necklace.

You'll want to know: le parfum

le parfum — "perfume".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parfum — formed from the verb for "to scent", which came from Italian *perfumare*, "to smoke through", from Latin *per*, "through", and *fumare*, "to smoke". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin parts.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parfum*
- *Say it: le parfum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parfum*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ring, then the French for a necklace, then say *le parfum* again

Before you move on

What does le parfum mean? ("Perfume".) Say it once more.

118.5 la lettre — a letter

Before the new one: say the French for a necklace, then the French for perfume.

You'll want to know: la lettre

la lettre — "a letter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lettre ← Old French *letre* ← Latin *littera*, "a letter of the alphabet" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lettre*
- *Say it: la lettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a necklace, then the French for perfume, then say *la lettre* again

Before you move on

What does la lettre mean? ("A letter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom, Beans, Cucumber

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name beef, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can name beef, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber.

119.1 le bœuf — beef; an ox

Before the new one: say the French for perfume, then the French for a letter.

Le bœuf is written with **œ**, the joined o and e. *Write it: bœuf* once

You'll want to know: le bœuf

le bœuf — "beef; an ox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bœuf ← Latin *bos*, *bovis*, "ox" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *o* became *œu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bœuf*
- *Say it: le bœuf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bœuf*
- *Recall:* say the French for perfume, then the French for a letter, then say *le bœuf* again

Before you move on

What does le bœuf mean? ("Beef; an ox".) Say it once more.

119.2 les légumes — vegetables

Before the new one: say the French for a letter, then the French for beef; an ox.

You'll want to know: les légumes

les légumes — "vegetables".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

légumes is the plural of the word for "a vegetable", ← Latin *legumen*, "a pulse, a bean" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les légumes*
- *Say it: les légumes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les légumes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a letter, then the French for beef; an ox, then say *les légumes* again

Before you move on

What does les légumes mean? ("Vegetables".) Say it once more.

119.3 le champignon — a mushroom

Before the new one: say the French for beef; an ox, then the French for vegetables.

You'll want to know: le champignon

le champignon — "a mushroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

champignon ← Vulgar Latin **campaniolus*, "growing in the fields", from Latin *campania*, "level country", and *campus*, "a field" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le champignon*
- *Say it: le champignon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le champignon*
- *Recall:* say the French for beef; an ox, then the French for vegetables, then say *le champignon* again

Before you move on

What does le champignon mean? ("A mushroom".) Say it once more.

119.4 les haricots — beans

Before the new one: say the French for vegetables, then the French for a mushroom.

You'll want to know: les haricots

les haricots — "beans".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

haricots is the plural of the word for "bean", whose origin is uncertain. It first named a meat stew, from an Old French verb meaning "to chop up"; the bean sense may owe something to Nahuatl *ayacotli*, "bean".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les haricots*
- *Say it: les haricots*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les haricots*
- *Recall:* say the French for vegetables, then the French for a mushroom, then say *les haricots* again

Before you move on

What does les haricots mean? ("Beans".) Say it once more.

119.5 le concombre — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the French for a mushroom, then the French for beans.

You'll want to know: le concombre

le concombre — "a cucumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concombre ← Old Provençal *cocombre* ← Latin *cucumis*, *cucumeris*, "cucumber" — borrowed from the south. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le concombre*
- *Say it: le concombre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le concombre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mushroom, then the French for beans, then say *le concombre* again

Before you move on

What does le concombre mean? ("A cucumber".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Strawberry, Cherry, Melon, Garlic, Flour

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can name a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour.

120.1 la fraise — a strawberry

Before the new one: say the French for beans, then the French for a cucumber.

You'll want to know: la fraise

la fraise — "a strawberry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fraise ← Latin *fraga*, "strawberries" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. The *-s-* is unexplained; it may come from the French word for "raspberry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fraise*
- *Say it: la fraise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fraise*
- *Recall:* say the French for beans, then the French for a cucumber, then say *la fraise* again

Before you move on

What does la fraise mean? ("A strawberry".) Say it once more.

120.2 la cerise — a cherry

Before the new one: say the French for a cucumber, then the French for a strawberry.

You'll want to know: la cerise

la cerise — "a cherry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cerise ← Vulgar Latin **ceresia* ← Latin *cerasium*, from Greek *kerasion*, "cherry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cerise*
- *Say it: la cerise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cerise*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cucumber, then the French for a strawberry, then say *la cerise* again

Before you move on

What does la cerise mean? ("A cherry".) Say it once more.

120.3 le melon — a melon

Before the new one: say the French for a strawberry, then the French for a cherry.

You'll want to know: le melon

le melon — "a melon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

melon ← Late Latin *melo*, *melonis*, short for *melopepo*, from Greek *melopepon*, "apple-gourd" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le melon*
- *Say it: le melon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le melon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a strawberry, then the French for a cherry, then say *le melon* again

Before you move on

What does le melon mean? ("A melon".) Say it once more.

120.4 l'ail — garlic

Before the new one: say the French for a cherry, then the French for a melon.

You'll want to know: l'ail

l'ail — "garlic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ail ← Latin *allium*, "garlic" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ail*
- *Say it: l'ail*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ail*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cherry, then the French for a melon, then say *l'ail* again

Before you move on

What does l'ail mean? ("Garlic".) Say it once more.

120.5 la farine — flour

Before the new one: say the French for a melon, then the French for garlic.

You'll want to know: la farine

la farine — "flour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

farine ← Latin *farina*, "flour, meal", from *far*, "spelt" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la farine*
- *Say it: la farine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la farine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a melon, then the French for garlic, then say *la farine* again

Before you move on

What does la farine mean? (“Flour”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Beer, Juice, Ice cream, Chocolate, Biscuit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name beer, juice, ice cream, chocolate, a biscuit.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can name beer, juice, ice cream, chocolate, a biscuit.

121.1 la bière — beer

Before the new one: say the French for garlic, then the French for flour.

You'll want to know: la bière

la bière — "beer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bière ← Middle Dutch *bier* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed in the 1400s, with hopped beer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bière*
- *Say it: la bière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bière*
- *Recall:* say the French for garlic, then the French for flour, then say *la bière* again

Before you move on

What does la bière mean? (“Beer”.) Say it once more.

121.2 le jus — juice

Before the new one: say the French for flour, then the French for beer.

You’ll want to know: le jus

le jus — “juice”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jus ← Latin *ius*, “broth, sauce” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *i-* before a vowel regularly became French *j-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jus*
- *Say it: le jus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jus*
- *Recall:* say the French for flour, then the French for beer, then say *le jus* again

Before you move on

What does le jus mean? (“Juice”.) Say it once more.

121.3 la glace — ice cream; ice; a mirror

Before the new one: say the French for beer, then the French for juice.

You’ll want to know: la glace

la glace — “ice cream; ice; a mirror”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glace ← Vulgar Latin **glacia* ← Latin *glacies*, “ice” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la glace*
- *Say it: la glace*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la glace*
- *Recall:* say the French for beer, then the French for juice, then say *la glace* again

Before you move on

What does la glace mean? (“Ice cream; ice; a mirror”.) Say it once more.

121.4 le chocolat — chocolate

Before the new one: say the French for juice, then the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror.

You'll want to know: le chocolat

le chocolat — "chocolate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chocolat ← Spanish *chocolate*, from Nahuatl, often given as *xocolatl* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; the Nahuatl form is debated.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chocolat*
- *Say it: le chocolat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chocolat*
- *Recall:* say the French for juice, then the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then say *le chocolat* again

Before you move on

What does le chocolat mean? ("Chocolate".) Say it once more.

121.5 le biscuit — a biscuit

Before the new one: say the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then the French for chocolate.

You'll want to know: le biscuit

le biscuit — "a biscuit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

biscuit ← Old French *bescuit*, "cooked two times": *bes-*, "two times", ← Latin *bis*, and the word for "cooked", ← Latin *coctus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le biscuit*
- *Say it: le biscuit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le biscuit*
- *Recall:* say the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then the French for chocolate, then say *le biscuit* again

Before you move on

What does le biscuit mean? ("A biscuit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Sandwich, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can name a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal.*

122.1 le sandwich — a sandwich

> Before the new one: say the French for chocolate, then the French for a biscuit.

You'll want to know: le sandwich

le sandwich — "a sandwich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sandwich ← English *sandwich*, named after the Earl of Sandwich — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sandwich*
- *Say it: le sandwich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sandwich*
- *Recall:* say the French for chocolate, then the French for a biscuit, then say *le sandwich* again

Before you move on

What does le sandwich mean? ("A sandwich".) Say it once more.

122.2 la sauce — a sauce

Before the new one: say the French for a biscuit, then the French for a sandwich.

You'll want to know: la sauce

la sauce — "a sauce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauce ← Vulgar Latin **salsa*, "salted", from Latin *salsus*, from *sal*, "salt" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sauce*
- *Say it: la sauce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sauce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a biscuit, then the French for a sandwich, then say *la sauce* again

Before you move on

What does la sauce mean? ("A sauce".) Say it once more.

122.3 le vinaigre — vinegar

Before the new one: say the French for a sandwich, then the French for a sauce.

You'll want to know: le vinaigre

le vinaigre — "vinegar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vinaigre — "sour wine": *vin*, "wine", and Old French *aigre*, "sour", ← Latin *acer*, "sharp". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vinaigre*
- *Say it: le vinaigre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vinaigre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sandwich, then the French for a sauce, then say *le vinaigre* again

Before you move on

What does le vinaigre mean? ("Vinegar".) Say it once more.

122.4 le dessert — a dessert

Before the new one: say the French for a sauce, then the French for vinegar.

You'll want to know: le dessert

le dessert — "a dessert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessert — formed from the verb for "to clear the table", built from *des-* and the verb for "to serve" (EtymDB 2.1): what comes once the table is cleared.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dessert*
- *Say it: le dessert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dessert*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sauce, then the French for vinegar, then say *le dessert* again

Before you move on

What does le dessert mean? ("A dessert".) Say it once more.

122.5 le repas — a meal

Before the new one: say the French for vinegar, then the French for a dessert.

You'll want to know: le repas

le repas — "a meal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repas ← Old French *repast*, from Late Latin *repascere*, "to feed", built on Latin *pascere*, "to feed, to graze" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le repas*
- *Say it: le repas*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le repas*
- *Recall:* say the French for vinegar, then the French for a dessert, then say *le repas* again

Before you move on

What does le repas mean? ("A meal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can name a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer.

123.1 l'infirmière — a nurse

Before the new one: say the French for a dessert, then the French for a meal.

You'll want to know: l'infirmière

l'infirmière — "a nurse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

infirmière — built from the old word for "a sick ward", with *-ière*; behind it is Latin *infirmus*, "weak, sick", from *firmus*, "strong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'infirmière*
- *Say it: l'infirmière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'infirmière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dessert, then the French for a meal, then say *l'infirmière* again

Before you move on

What does l'infirmière mean? ("A nurse".) Say it once more.

123.2 le cuisinier — a cook

Before the new one: say the French for a meal, then the French for a nurse.

You'll want to know: le cuisinier

le cuisinier — "a cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisinier — built from *cuisine*, "kitchen", with *-ier*, "one who works at".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cuisinier*
- *Say it: le cuisinier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cuisinier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a meal, then the French for a nurse, then say *le cuisinier* again

Before you move on

What does le cuisinier mean? (“A cook”.) Say it once more.

123.3 le policier — a police officer

Before the new one: say the French for a nurse, then the French for a cook.

You’ll want to know: le policier

le policier — “a police officer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

policier — built from *police* with *-ier*, “one who works at”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le policier*
- *Say it: le policier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le policier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nurse, then the French for a cook, then say *le policier* again

Before you move on

What does le policier mean? (“A police officer”.) Say it once more.

123.4 le vendeur — a shop assistant

Before the new one: say the French for a cook, then the French for a police officer.

You'll want to know: le vendeur

le vendeur — "a shop assistant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vendeur — built from the verb for "to sell", with *-eur*, "one who". The verb ← Latin *vendere*, "to sell" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vendeur*
- *Say it: le vendeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vendeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cook, then the French for a police officer, then say *le vendeur* again

Before you move on

What does le vendeur mean? ("A shop assistant".) Say it once more.

123.5 l'agriculteur — a farmer

Before the new one: say the French for a police officer, then the French for a shop assistant.

You'll want to know: l'agriculteur

l'agriculteur — "a farmer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agriculteur ← Latin *agricultor*, "a farmer", from *ager*, "a field", and *cultor*, "a tiller" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'agriculteur*
- *Say it: l'agriculteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'agriculteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a police officer, then the French for a shop assistant, then say *l'agriculteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'agriculteur mean? ("A farmer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Baker, Student, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer, an engineer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can name a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer, an engineer.*

124.1 le boulanger — a baker

> Before the new one: say the French for a shop assistant, then the French for a farmer.

You'll want to know: le boulanger

le boulanger — "a baker". The person behind **la boulangerie**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boulanger ← Picard *boulenc*, probably from Middle Dutch *bolle*, "a round loaf": a maker of round loaves. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le boulanger*
- *Say it: le boulanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le boulanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shop assistant, then the French for a farmer, then say *le boulanger* again

Before you move on

What does le boulanger mean? ("A baker".) Say it once more.

124.2 l'étudiant — a student

Before the new one: say the French for a farmer, then the French for a baker.

You'll want to know: l'étudiant

l'étudiant — "a student".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étudiant is the present participle of *étudier*, "to study", used as a noun: one who is studying.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étudiant*
- *Say it: l'étudiant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étudiant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a farmer, then the French for a baker, then say *l'étudiant* again

Before you move on

What does l'étudiant mean? ("A student".) Say it once more.

124.3 le chauffeur — a driver

Before the new one: say the French for a baker, then the French for a student.

You'll want to know: le chauffeur

le chauffeur — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffeur — built from the verb for "to heat", with *-eur*: first the stoker of a steam engine, then the driver. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chauffeur*
- *Say it: le chauffeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chauffeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a baker, then the French for a student, then say *le chauffeur* again

Before you move on

What does le chauffeur mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

124.4 l'avocat — a lawyer; an avocado

Before the new one: say the French for a student, then the French for a driver.

You'll want to know: l'avocat

l'avocat — "a lawyer; an avocado".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avocat — two words in one. The lawyer ← Latin *advocatus*, "one called in to help" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing. The fruit ← Spanish *aguacate*, from Nahuatl *ahuacatl* (EtymDB 2.1), reshaped to look like the lawyer word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avocat*
- *Say it: l'avocat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avocat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a student, then the French for a driver, then say *l'avocat* again

Before you move on

What does l'avocat mean? ("A lawyer; an avocado".) Say it once more.

124.5 l'ingénieur — an engineer

Before the new one: say the French for a driver, then the French for a lawyer; an avocado.

You'll want to know: l'ingénieur

l'ingénieur — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ingénieur — built from Old French *engin*, "a clever device, a war machine", ← Latin *ingenium*, "talent" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-eur*, later respelt after the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ingénieur*
- *Say it: l'ingénieur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ingénieur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a driver, then the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then say *l'ingénieur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ingénieur mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Firefighter, Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can name a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till.

125.1 le pompier — a firefighter

Before the new one: say the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then the French for an engineer.

You'll want to know: le pompier

le pompier — "a firefighter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pompier — built from the word for "a pump", with *-ier*: the one who works the pump.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pompier*
- *Say it: le pompier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pompier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then the French for an engineer, then say *le pompier* again

Before you move on

What does le pompier mean? ("A firefighter".) Say it once more.

125.2 le facteur — a postman, a postwoman

Before the new one: say the French for an engineer, then the French for a firefighter.

You'll want to know: le facteur

le facteur — "a postman, a postwoman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facteur ← Latin *factor*, "a maker, a doer", from *facere*, "to make, to do" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the agent who delivers became the postman.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le facteur*
- *Say it: le facteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le facteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an engineer, then the French for a firefighter, then say *le facteur* again

Before you move on

What does le facteur mean? (“A postman, a postwoman”.) Say it once more.

125.3 le serveur — a waiter

Before the new one: say the French for a firefighter, then the French for a postman.

You’ll want to know: le serveur

le serveur — “a waiter”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serveur — built from the verb for “to serve”, ← Latin *servire*, with *-eur*, “one who”. (EtymDB 2.1 records the verb.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le serveur*
- *Say it: le serveur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le serveur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a firefighter, then the French for a postman, then say *le serveur* again

Before you move on

What does le serveur mean? (“A waiter”.) Say it once more.

125.4 le client — a customer

Before the new one: say the French for a postman, then the French for a waiter.

You'll want to know: le client

le client — "a customer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

client ← Latin *cliens*, *clientis*, "a dependant, a follower" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le client*
- *Say it: le client*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le client*
- *Recall:* say the French for a postman, then the French for a waiter, then say *le client* again

Before you move on

What does le client mean? ("A customer".) Say it once more.

125.5 la caisse — a till, a checkout

Before the new one: say the French for a waiter, then the French for a customer.

You'll want to know: la caisse

la caisse — "a till, a checkout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caisse ← Old Provençal *caissa* ← Latin *capsa*, "a box" — borrowed from the south: an inherited form would begin with *ch-*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la caisse*
- *Say it: la caisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la caisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a waiter, then the French for a customer, then say *la caisse* again

Before you move on

What does la caisse mean? ("A till, a checkout".) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Class, Lesson, Exam, Word, Board

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a class, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can name a class, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board.*

126.1 la classe — a class; a classroom

> Before the new one: say the French for a customer, then the French for a till.

You'll want to know: la classe

la classe — "a class; a classroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

classe ← Latin *classis*, "a division of the people, a class" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la classe*
- *Say it: la classe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la classe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a customer, then the French for a till, then say *la classe* again

Before you move on

What does la classe mean? (“A class; a classroom”.) Say it once more.

126.2 la leçon — a lesson

Before the new one: say the French for a till, then the French for a class; a classroom.

Read it: the instruction and do it — *Dites « la classe ».*

Read it: le stylo, le cahier, le crayon aloud as one line, without stopping between the words

You’ll want to know: la leçon

la leçon — “a lesson”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leçon ← Latin *lectio*, “a reading”, from *legere*, “to read” (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: the *-ct-* did not become *-it-*, as it did in the word for “bed” from *lectum*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la leçon*
- *Say it: la leçon*, once more

- *Say it:* say *la leçon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a till, then the French for a class; a classroom, then say *la leçon* again

Before you move on

What does la leçon mean? ("A lesson".) Say it once more.

126.3 l'examen — an exam

Before the new one: say the French for a class; a classroom, then the French for a lesson.

You'll want to know: l'examen

l'examen — "an exam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

examen ← Latin *examen*, "the tongue of a balance, a weighing" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'examen*
- *Say it: l'examen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'examen*
- *Recall:* say the French for a class; a classroom, then the French for a lesson, then say *l'examen* again

Before you move on

What does l'examen mean? ("An exam".) Say it once more.

126.4 le mot — a word

Before the new one: say the French for a lesson, then the French for an exam.

You'll want to know: le mot

le mot — "a word".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mot ← Late Latin *muttum*, "a grunt, a sound", from *muttire*, "to mutter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mot*
- *Say it: le mot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mot*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lesson, then the French for an exam, then say *le mot* again

Before you move on

What does le mot mean? ("A word".) Say it once more.

126.5 le tableau — a board; a painting

Before the new one: say the French for an exam, then the French for a word.

You'll want to know: le tableau

le tableau — "a board; a painting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tableau ← Old French *tablel*, a little form of the word for "table", ← Latin *tabula*, "a board, a plank". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tableau*
- *Say it: le tableau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tableau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an exam, then the French for a word, then say *le tableau* again

Before you move on

What does le tableau mean? ("A board; a painting".) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Rubber, Homework, Answer, Idea, Problem

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can name a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem.

127.1 la gomme — a rubber, an eraser

Before the new one: say the French for a word, then the French for a board; a painting.

You'll want to know: la gomme

la gomme — "a rubber, an eraser".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gomme ← Late Latin *gumma* ← Latin *gummi*, from Greek *kommi*, a word from Egyptian — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gomme*
- *Say it: la gomme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gomme*
- *Recall:* say the French for a word, then the French for a board; a painting, then say *la gomme* again

Before you move on

What does la gomme mean? ("A rubber, an eraser".) Say it once more.

127.2 les devoirs — homework

Before the new one: say the French for a board; a painting, then the French for a rubber.

You'll want to know: les devoirs

les devoirs — "homework".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devoirs is the plural of *devoir*, "to have to", used as a noun: duties, the work one owes. The verb ← Latin *debere*, "to owe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les devoirs*
- *Say it: les devoirs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les devoirs*

- *Recall:* say the French for a board; a painting, then the French for a rubber, then say *les devoirs* again

Before you move on

What does les devoirs mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

127.3 la réponse — an answer

Before the new one: say the French for a rubber, then the French for homework.

Read it: La leçon est à neuf heures, dans la classe douze aloud as one line

Then answer from it: at what time is the lesson? (**À neuf heures.**)

You'll want to know: la réponse

la réponse — "an answer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réponse ← Old French *response*, from Latin *responsa*, "answers", from *respondere*, "to answer" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réponse*
- *Say it: la réponse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réponse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rubber, then the French for homework, then say *la réponse* again

Before you move on

What does la réponse mean? ("An answer".) Say it once more.

127.4 l'idée — an idea

Before the new one: say the French for homework, then the French for an answer.

You'll want to know: l'idée

l'idée — "an idea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

idée ← Latin *idea*, from Greek *idea*, "a form, a pattern", from *idein*, "to see" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'idée*
- *Say it: l'idée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'idée*
- *Recall:* say the French for homework, then the French for an answer, then say *l'idée* again

Before you move on

What does l'idée mean? ("An idea".) Say it once more.

127.5 le problème — a problem

Before the new one: say the French for an answer, then the French for an idea.

You'll want to know: le problème

le problème — "a problem".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

problème ← Latin *problema*, from Greek *problema*, "a thing put forward", from *proballein*, "to throw forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le problème*
- *Say it: le problème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le problème*
- *Recall:* say the French for an answer, then the French for an idea, then say *le problème* again

Before you move on

What does le problème mean? ("A problem".) Say it once more.

127.6 Clothes and things you carry — a first pass

Say the words for an idea and a problem.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- boots, a cap, a swimsuit; a sports shirt, size; the waist, a wallet
- a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter
- beef; an ox, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber
- a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour

- beer, juice, ice cream; ice; a mirror, chocolate, a biscuit

Before you move on

Boots? (**les bottes**.) A cap? (**la casquette**.) A swimsuit; a sports shirt? (**le maillot**.) Size; the waist? (**la taille**.) A wallet? (**le portefeuille**.) A jewel? (**le bijou**.) A ring? (**la bague**.) A necklace? (**le collier**.) Perfume? (**le parfum**.) A letter? (**la lettre**.) Beef; an ox? (**le bœuf**.) Vegetables? (**les légumes**.) A mushroom? (**le champignon**.) Beans? (**les haricots**.) A cucumber? (**le concombre**.) A strawberry? (**la fraise**.) A cherry? (**la cerise**.) A melon? (**le melon**.) Garlic? (**l'ail**.) Flour? (**la farine**.) Beer? (**la bière**.) Juice? (**le jus**.) Ice cream; ice; a mirror? (**la glace**.) Chocolate? (**le chocolat**.) A biscuit? (**le biscuit**.)

127.7 Food and work — a second pass

Say the words for a sandwich and a sauce.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal
- a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer
- a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer; an avocado, an engineer
- a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till
- a class; a classroom, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board; a painting
- a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem

Before you move on

A sandwich? (**le sandwich**.) A sauce? (**la sauce**.) Vinegar? (**le vinaigre**.) A dessert? (**le dessert**.) A meal? (**le repas**.) A nurse? (**l'infirmière**.) A cook? (**le cuisinier**.) A police officer? (**le policier**.) A shop assistant? (**le vendeur**.) A farmer?

(**l'agriculteur**.) A baker? (**le boulanger**.) A student? (**l'étudiant**.) A driver? (**le chauffeur**.) A lawyer; an avocado? (**l'avocat**.) An engineer? (**l'ingénieur**.) A firefighter? (**le pompier**.) A postman? (**le facteur**.) A waiter? (**le serveur**.) A customer? (**le client**.) A till? (**la caisse**.) A class; a classroom? (**la classe**.) A lesson? (**la leçon**.) An exam? (**l'examen**.) A word? (**le mot**.) A board; a painting? (**le tableau**.) A rubber? (**la gomme**.) Homework? (**les devoirs**.) An answer? (**la réponse**.) An idea? (**l'idée**.) A problem? (**le problème**.)

Chapter 128

Music, Sport, Game, Film, Song

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name music, sport, a game, a film, a song.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can name music, sport, a game, a film, a song.*

128.1 la musique — music

Before the new one: say the French for an idea, then the French for a problem.

Say *j'aime bien la musique*. **Aimer bien** is to like, softer than **aimer**.

You'll want to know: la musique

la musique — "music".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

musique ← Latin *musica*, from Greek *mousike*, "the art of the Muses" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la musique*
- *Say it: la musique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la musique*
- *Recall:* say the French for an idea, then the French for a problem, then say *la musique* again

Before you move on

What does la musique mean? ("Music".) Say it once more.

128.2 le sport — sport

Before the new one: say the French for a problem, then the French for music.

Sport on a Sunday: say *dimanche*.

You'll want to know: le sport

le sport — "sport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sport ← English *sport* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed in the 19th century. English had shortened it from Old French *desport*, "a pastime".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sport*
- *Say it: le sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a problem, then the French for music, then say *le sport* again

Before you move on

What does le sport mean? ("Sport".) Say it once more.

128.3 le jeu — a game

Before the new one: say the French for music, then the French for sport.

You'll want to know: le jeu

le jeu — "a game". Plural **les jeux**, with an x.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeu ← Old French *geu* ← Latin *iocus*, "a joke, a jest" — inherited. It is the noun beside *jouer*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jeu*
- *Say it: le jeu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jeu*
- *Recall:* say the French for music, then the French for sport, then say *le jeu* again

Before you move on

What does le jeu mean? ("A game".) Say it once more.

128.4 le film — a film

Before the new one: say the French for sport, then the French for a game.

You'll want to know: le film

le film — "a film".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

film ← English *film*, "a thin skin, a membrane", then the coated strip a camera uses — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le film*
- *Say it: le film*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le film*
- *Recall:* say the French for sport, then the French for a game, then say *le film* again

Before you move on

What does le film mean? ("A film".) Say it once more.

128.5 la chanson — a song

Before the new one: say the French for a game, then the French for a film.

You'll want to know: la chanson

la chanson — "a song".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chanson ← Old French *chançon* ← Latin *cantio*, *cantionis*, "a song", from *canere*, "to sing" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chanson*
- *Say it: la chanson*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chanson*
- *Recall:* say the French for a game, then the French for a film, then say *la chanson* again

Before you move on

What does la chanson mean? ("A song".) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Drawing, Life, Time, Colour, Price

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can name a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price.*

129.1 le dessin — a drawing

Before the new one: say the French for a film, then the French for a song.

You'll want to know: le dessin

le dessin — "a drawing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessin — formed from *dessiner*, "to draw": a drawing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dessin*

- *Say it: le dessin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dessin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a film, then the French for a song, then say *le dessin* again

Before you move on

What does le dessin mean? ("A drawing".) Say it once more.

129.2 la vie — life

Before the new one: say the French for a song, then the French for a drawing.

You'll want to know: la vie

la vie — "life".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vie ← Latin *vita*, "life" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *t* between vowels dropped out. It shares its root with *vivre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vie*
- *Say it: la vie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a song, then the French for a drawing, then say *la vie* again

Before you move on

What does la vie mean? ("Life".) Say it once more.

129.3 la fois — a time, an occasion

Before the new one: say the French for a drawing, then the French for life.

You'll want to know: la fois

la fois — "a time, an occasion". **une fois**: once; **deux fois**: twice.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fois ← Old French *foiz* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *vices*, "turns, changes" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fois*
- *Say it: la fois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fois*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drawing, then the French for life, then say *la fois* again

Before you move on

What does la fois mean? ("A time, an occasion".) Say it once more.

129.4 la couleur — a colour

Before the new one: say the French for life, then the French for a time.

Ask for the colour: *Quelle couleur ?* **Quel** takes an -le before a feminine noun.

You'll want to know: la couleur

la couleur — "a colour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couleur ← Latin *color*, *coloris*, "colour" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couleur*
- *Say it: la couleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la couleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for life, then the French for a time, then say *la couleur* again

Before you move on

What does la couleur mean? ("A colour".) Say it once more.

129.5 le prix — a price; a prize

Before the new one: say the French for a time, then the French for a colour.

You'll want to know: le prix

le prix — "a price; a prize".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prix ← Old French *pris* ← Latin *pretium*, "worth, price, reward" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le prix*
- *Say it: le prix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le prix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a time, then the French for a colour, then say *le prix* again

Before you move on

What does le prix mean? (“A price; a prize”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Pink, Purple, Brown (chestnut), Brown (of hair, Pretty

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name pink, purple, brown (chestnut), brown (of hair, pretty.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can name pink, purple, brown (chestnut), brown (of hair, pretty.

130.1 rose — pink

Before the new one: say the French for a colour, then the French for a price; a prize.

Before the new colours, one from before: **jaune**, which sits beside German *gelb*. Say *jaune*.

You'll want to know: rose

rose — "pink".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rose — the colour named after the flower, *rose*, ← Latin *rosa*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rose*
- *Say it: rose*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rose*
- *Recall:* say the French for a colour, then the French for a price; a prize, then say *rose* again

Before you move on

What does rose mean? ("Pink".) Say it once more.

130.2 violet — purple

Before the new one: say the French for a price; a prize, then the French for pink.

You'll want to know: violet

violet — "purple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

violet — the colour named after the flower, the violet, a little form of Old French *viole*, ← Latin *viola*, "a violet" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: violet*
- *Say it: violet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *violet*
- *Recall:* say the French for a price; a prize, then the French for pink, then say *violet* again

Before you move on

What does violet mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

130.3 marron — brown (chestnut)

Before the new one: say the French for pink, then the French for purple.

You'll want to know: marron

marron — "brown (chestnut)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marron ← Italian *marrone*, "a large chestnut" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; the colour is named after the nut. The Italian word's own origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marron*
- *Say it: marron*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marron*
- *Recall:* say the French for pink, then the French for purple, then say *marron* again

Before you move on

What does marron mean? ("Brown (chestnut)".) Say it once more.

130.4 brun — brown (of hair, skin)

Before the new one: say the French for purple, then the French for brown.

You'll want to know: brun

brun — "brown (of hair, skin)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brun ← Old French *brun*, "brown, shiny" ← Frankish **brun*, "brown" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *brun*
- *Say it:* *brun*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brun*
- *Recall:* say the French for purple, then the French for brown, then say *brun* again

Before you move on

What does brun mean? ("Brown (of hair, skin)".) Say it once more.

130.5 joli — pretty

Before the new one: say the French for brown, then the French for brown.

You'll want to know: joli

joli — "pretty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joli ← Old French *jolif*, "merry, festive" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; the usual guess is Old Norse *jol*, the midwinter feast.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joli*
- *Say it: joli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joli*
- *Recall:* say the French for brown, then the French for brown, then say *joli* again

Before you move on

What does joli mean? ("Pretty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Busy, Free, Open, Closed, Calm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name busy, free, open, closed, calm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can name busy, free, open, closed, calm.*

131.1 occupé — busy

Before the new one: say the French for brown, then the French for pretty.

You'll want to know: occupé

occupé — "busy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

occupé is the past participle of the verb for "to occupy", a learned borrowing of Latin *occupare*, "to seize", from *ob* and *capere*, "to take" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: occupé*
- *Say it: occupé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *occupé*
- *Recall:* say the French for brown, then the French for pretty, then say *occupé* again

Before you move on

What does occupé mean? (“Busy”.) Say it once more.

131.2 libre — free

Before the new one: say the French for pretty, then the French for busy.

You’ll want to know: libre

libre — “free”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

libre ← Latin *liber*, “free” (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: libre*
- *Say it: libre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *libre*
- *Recall:* say the French for pretty, then the French for busy, then say *libre* again

Before you move on

What does libre mean? (“Free”.) Say it once more.

131.3 ouvert — open

Before the new one: say the French for busy, then the French for free.

Ouvert belongs to **ouvrir**, to open, which takes the endings of a verb in -er: *j’ouvre*. Say *j’ouvre*, then its opposite, *je ferme*.

You’ll want to know: ouvert

ouvert — “open”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouvert is the past participle of *ouvrir*, “to open”: opened. It goes back to Vulgar Latin **opertus*, from Latin *apertus*, “open”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ouvert*
- *Say it:* *ouvert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ouvert*
- *Recall:* say the French for busy, then the French for free, then say *ouvert* again

Before you move on

What does ouvert mean? (“Open”.) Say it once more.

131.4 fermé — closed

Before the new one: say the French for free, then the French for open.

Fermé is the closed form of **fermer**, to close. Say *fermer*, then *fermé*.

You'll want to know: fermé

fermé — "closed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fermé is the past participle of *fermer*, "to close": closed. The verb ← Latin *firmare*, "to make firm, to fasten" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fermé*
- *Say it: fermé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fermé*
- *Recall:* say the French for free, then the French for open, then say *fermé* again

Before you move on

What does fermé mean? ("Closed".) Say it once more.

131.5 calme — calm, quiet

Before the new one: say the French for open, then the French for closed.

You'll want to know: calme

calme — "calm, quiet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

calme ← Italian *calma* ← Late Latin *cauma*, "the heat of midday", from Greek *kauma*, "burning heat" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the still hour when the sun was hottest.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *calme*
- *Say it:* *calme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calme*
- *Recall:* say the French for open, then the French for closed, then say *calme* again

Before you move on

What does calme mean? ("Calm, quiet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Noisy, Last, Next, Famous, Funny

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name noisy, last, next, famous, funny.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can name noisy, last, next, famous, funny.*

132.1 bruyant — noisy

> Before the new one: say the French for closed, then the French for calm.

You'll want to know: bruyant

bruyant — "noisy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bruyant is the present participle of the Old French verb *bruire*, "to roar, to rustle", usually traced to Latin *rugire*, "to roar" (Lewis & Short), with a changed start.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bruyant*
- *Say it: bruyant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bruyant*
- *Recall:* say the French for closed, then the French for calm, then say *bruyant* again

Before you move on

What does bruyant mean? ("Noisy".) Say it once more.

132.2 dernier — last

Before the new one: say the French for calm, then the French for noisy.

You'll want to know: dernier

dernier — "last".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dernier — built in Old French on *derrain*, "last", from Vulgar Latin **deretranus*, built on Latin *retro*, "behind" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dernier*
- *Say it: dernier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dernier*
- *Recall:* say the French for calm, then the French for noisy, then say *dernier* again

Before you move on

What does dernier mean? (“Last”.) Say it once more.

132.3 prochain — next

Before the new one: say the French for noisy, then the French for last.

You’ll want to know: prochain

prochain — “next”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prochain ← Vulgar Latin **propeanus*, from Latin *prope*, “near” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prochain*
- *Say it: prochain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prochain*
- *Recall:* say the French for noisy, then the French for last, then say *prochain* again

Before you move on

What does prochain mean? (“Next”.) Say it once more.

132.4 célèbre — famous

Before the new one: say the French for last, then the French for next.

You'll want to know: célèbre

célèbre — "famous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célèbre ← Latin *celeber*, "crowded, much spoken of" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *célèbre*
- *Say it:* *célèbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *célèbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for last, then the French for next, then say *célèbre* again

Before you move on

What does célèbre mean? ("Famous".) Say it once more.

132.5 drôle — funny

Before the new one: say the French for next, then the French for famous.

You'll want to know: drôle

drôle — "funny".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drôle ← Middle Dutch *drol*, "a little fellow, a goblin" — borrowed; it first meant "a rascal", then "a comic".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *drôle*
- *Say it:* *drôle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *drôle*
- *Recall:* say the French for next, then the French for famous, then say *drôle* again

Before you move on

What does drôle mean? ("Funny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Nice, Nasty, Heat, Storm, Fog

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can name nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog.*

133.1 sympathique — nice, friendly

> Before the new one: say the French for famous, then the French for funny.

You'll want to know: sympathique

sympathique — "nice, friendly". Often shortened to **sympa**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sympathique — built from the word for "sympathy", ← Latin *sympathia*, from Greek *sympatheia*, "fellow feeling". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sympathique*
- *Say it: sympathique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sympathique*
- *Recall:* say the French for famous, then the French for funny, then say *sympathique* again

Before you move on

What does sympathique mean? ("Nice, friendly".) Say it once more.

133.2 méchant — nasty, mean

Before the new one: say the French for funny, then the French for nice.

You'll want to know: méchant

méchant — "nasty, mean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

méchant is the present participle of Old French *mescheoir*, "to turn out badly": *mes-*, "badly", and *cheoir*, "to fall", ← Latin *cadere* (Lewis & Short). Ill-fated, then wicked.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: méchant*
- *Say it: méchant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *méchant*
- *Recall:* say the French for funny, then the French for nice, then say *méchant* again

Before you move on

What does méchant mean? (“Nasty, mean”.) Say it once more.

133.3 la chaleur — heat

Before the new one: say the French for nice, then the French for nasty.

Heat belongs to a season: say *en été*, then *au printemps*.

You’ll want to know: la chaleur

la chaleur — “heat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaleur ← Old French *chalor* ← Latin *calor*, “heat” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chaleur*
- *Say it: la chaleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chaleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for nice, then the French for nasty, then say *la chaleur* again

Before you move on

What does la chaleur mean? (“Heat”.) Say it once more.

133.4 l’orage — a storm

Before the new one: say the French for nasty, then the French for heat.

You'll want to know: l'orage

l'orage — "a storm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orage — built from Old French *ore*, "a wind", ← Latin *aura*, "a breeze", from Greek *aura*, with *-age*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orage*
- *Say it: l'orage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'orage*
- *Recall:* say the French for nasty, then the French for heat, then say *l'orage* again

Before you move on

What does l'orage mean? ("A storm".) Say it once more.

133.5 le brouillard — fog

Before the new one: say the French for heat, then the French for a storm.

You'll want to know: le brouillard

le brouillard — "fog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brouillard — built from Old French *broillas*, "fog", from the verb for "to blur, to mix up", ← Vulgar Latin **brodiculare*, "to jumble together" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-ard*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le brouillard*
- *Say it: le brouillard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le brouillard*
- *Recall:* say the French for heat, then the French for a storm, then say *le brouillard* again

Before you move on

What does le brouillard mean? ("Fog".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name grass, an ear, a lip, a number (on a door, an address.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can name grass, an ear, a lip, a number (on a door, an address.

134.1 l'herbe — grass

Before the new one: say the French for a storm, then the French for fog.

You'll want to know: l'herbe

l'herbe — "grass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

herbe ← Old French *erbe* ← Latin *herba*, "grass, a plant" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *h* was put back later, from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'herbe*
- *Say it: l'herbe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'herbe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a storm, then the French for fog, then say *l'herbe* again

Before you move on

What does l'herbe mean? ("Grass".) Say it once more.

134.2 l'oreille — an ear

Before the new one: say the French for fog, then the French for grass.

You'll want to know: l'oreille

l'oreille — "an ear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oreille ← Vulgar Latin **oricla* ← Latin *auricula*, "a little ear", from *auris*, "ear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oreille*
- *Say it: l'oreille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oreille*
- *Recall:* say the French for fog, then the French for grass, then say *l'oreille* again

Before you move on

What does l'oreille mean? ("An ear".) Say it once more.

134.3 la lèvre — a lip

Before the new one: say the French for grass, then the French for an ear.

You'll want to know: la lèvre

la lèvre — "a lip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lèvre ← Latin *labra*, "lips", the plural of *labrum* (Lewis & Short) — inherited: stressed *a* became *e*, and *b* became *v*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lèvre*
- *Say it: la lèvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lèvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for grass, then the French for an ear, then say *la lèvre* again

Before you move on

What does la lèvre mean? ("A lip".) Say it once more.

134.4 le numéro — a number (on a door, a phone)

Before the new one: say the French for an ear, then the French for a lip.

You'll want to know: le numéro

le numéro — "a number (on a door, a phone)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

numéro ← Italian *numero* ← Latin *numerus*, "a number" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le numéro*
- *Say it: le numéro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le numéro*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ear, then the French for a lip, then say *le numéro* again

Before you move on

What does le numéro mean? ("A number (on a door, a phone)".) Say it once more.

134.5 l'adresse — an address

Before the new one: say the French for a lip, then the French for a number.

You'll want to know: l'adresse

l'adresse — "an address".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adresse — formed from the verb for "to direct, to send", ← Vulgar Latin **addirectiare*, built on Latin *directus*, "straight" (Lewis & Short): where a letter is sent.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adresse*
- *Say it: l'adresse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'adresse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lip, then the French for a number, then say *l'adresse* again

Before you move on

What does l'adresse mean? ("An address".) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Second, Change (coins), Date, Century, Email

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a second, change (coins), a date, a century, an email.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can name a second, change (coins), a date, a century, an email.

135.1 la seconde — a second

Before the new one: say the French for a number, then the French for an address.

A time from before: say *deux heures moins le quart*.

You'll want to know: la seconde

la seconde — "a second".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seconde ← Medieval Latin *secunda*, short for *secunda minuta*, "the second small part" of an hour — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la seconde*
- *Say it: la seconde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la seconde*
- *Recall:* say the French for a number, then the French for an address, then say *la seconde* again

Before you move on

What does la seconde mean? ("A second".) Say it once more.

135.2 la monnaie — change (coins); currency

Before the new one: say the French for an address, then the French for a second.

You'll want to know: la monnaie

la monnaie — "change (coins); currency".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monnaie ← Old French *moneie* ← Latin *moneta*, "a mint, coin", from Juno *Moneta*, in whose temple Rome struck its coins — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la monnaie*
- *Say it: la monnaie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la monnaie*
- *Recall:* say the French for an address, then the French for a second, then say *la monnaie* again

Before you move on

What does la monnaie mean? (“Change (coins); currency”.) Say it once more.

135.3 la date — a date

Before the new one: say the French for a second, then the French for change.

You’ll want to know: la date

la date — “a date”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

date ← Late Latin *data*, “given”, the first word of a dated letter: “given at Rome on…” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la date*
- *Say it: la date*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la date*
- *Recall:* say the French for a second, then the French for change, then say *la date* again

Before you move on

What does la date mean? (“A date”.) Say it once more.

135.4 le siècle — a century

Before the new one: say the French for change, then the French for a date.

You'll want to know: le siècle

le siècle — "a century".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siècle ← Church Latin *saeculum*, "a generation, an age" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin in a half-learned form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le siècle*
- *Say it: le siècle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le siècle*
- *Recall:* say the French for change, then the French for a date, then say *le siècle* again

Before you move on

What does le siècle mean? ("A century".) Say it once more.

135.5 le courriel — an email

Before the new one: say the French for a date, then the French for a century.

You'll want to know: le courriel

le courriel — "an email".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courriel — coined in Quebec in the 1990s from *courrier électronique*, "electronic mail".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le courriel*
- *Say it: le courriel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le courriel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a date, then the French for a century, then say *le courriel* again

Before you move on

What does le courriel mean? ("An email".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Zero, Sixty, Seventy, Ninety, Thousand

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can name zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand.

136.1 zéro — zero

Before the new one: say the French for a century, then the French for an email.

You'll want to know: zéro

zéro — "zero".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zéro ← Italian *zero* ← Medieval Latin *zephirum*, from Arabic *sifr*, "empty" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zéro*
- *Say it:* *zéro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zéro*
- *Recall:* say the French for a century, then the French for an email, then say *zéro* again

Before you move on

What does zéro mean? ("Zero".) Say it once more.

136.2 soixante — sixty

Before the new one: say the French for an email, then the French for zero.

You'll want to know: soixante

soixante — "sixty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soixante ← Old French *soissante* ← Latin *sexaginta*, "sixty" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *soixante*
- *Say it:* *soixante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soixante*
- *Recall:* say the French for an email, then the French for zero, then say *soixante* again

Before you move on

What does soixante mean? (“Sixty”.) Say it once more.

136.3 soixante-dix — seventy

Before the new one: say the French for zero, then the French for sixty.

You’ll want to know: soixante-dix

soixante-dix — “seventy”. Literally “sixty-ten”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soixante-dix — “sixty-ten”: *soixante*, “sixty”, and *dix*, “ten”. France counts the seventies on from sixty.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soixante-dix*
- *Say it: soixante-dix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soixante-dix*
- *Recall:* say the French for zero, then the French for sixty, then say *soixante-dix* again

Before you move on

What does soixante-dix mean? (“Seventy”.) Say it once more.

136.4 quatre-vingt-dix — ninety

Before the new one: say the French for sixty, then the French for seventy.

You'll want to know: quatre-vingt-dix

quatre-vingt-dix — "ninety". Literally "four-twenties-ten".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatre-vingt-dix — "four-twenties-ten": *quatre*, *vingt* and *dix*. Old French often counted in twenties.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *quatre-vingt-dix*
- *Say it:* *quatre-vingt-dix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *quatre-vingt-dix*
- *Recall:* say the French for sixty, then the French for seventy, then say *quatre-vingt-dix* again

Before you move on

What does quatre-vingt-dix mean? ("Ninety".) Say it once more.

136.5 mille — a thousand

Before the new one: say the French for seventy, then the French for ninety.

You'll want to know: mille

mille — "a thousand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mille ← Latin *mille*, "a thousand" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mille*
- *Say it: mille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mille*
- *Recall:* say the French for seventy, then the French for ninety, then say *mille* again

Before you move on

What does mille mean? (“A thousand”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to begin, to visit (a place), to answer, to put, to believe.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say to begin, to visit (a place), to answer, to put, to believe.

137.1 commencer — to begin

Before the new one: say the French for ninety, then the French for a thousand.

You'll want to know: commencer

commencer — "to begin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commencer ← Old French *comencier* ← Vulgar Latin **cominitiare*, from *com-* and Latin *initiare*, "to begin" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: commencer*
- *Say it: commencer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *commencer*
- *Recall:* say the French for ninety, then the French for a thousand, then say *commencer* again

Before you move on

What does commencer mean? ("To begin".) Say it once more.

137.2 visiter — to visit (a place)

Before the new one: say the French for a thousand, then the French for to begin.

You'll want to know: visiter

visiter — "to visit (a place)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

visiter ← Latin *visitare*, "to go to see", from *videre*, "to see" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: visiter*
- *Say it: visiter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *visiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thousand, then the French for to begin, then say *visiter* again

Before you move on

What does visiter mean? (“To visit (a place)”.) Say it once more.

137.3 répondre — to answer

Before the new one: say the French for to begin, then the French for to visit.

You’ll want to know: répondre

répondre — “to answer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

répondre ← Old French *respondre* ← Latin *respondere*, “to answer, to pledge back” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: répondre*
- *Say it: répondre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *répondre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to begin, then the French for to visit, then say *répondre* again

Before you move on

What does répondre mean? (“To answer”.) Say it once more.

137.4 mettre — to put; to put on

Before the new one: say the French for to visit, then the French for to answer.

You'll want to know: mettre

mettre — "to put; to put on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mettre ← Old French *metre* ← Latin *mittere*, "to send, to let go" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mettre*
- *Say it: mettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to visit, then the French for to answer, then say *mettre* again

Before you move on

What does mettre mean? ("To put; to put on".) Say it once more.

137.5 croire — to believe

Before the new one: say the French for to answer, then the French for to put; to put on.

You'll want to know: croire

croire — "to believe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

croire ← Old French *creire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *credere*, "to believe" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *croire*
- *Say it:* *croire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *croire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to answer, then the French for to put; to put on, then say *croire* again

Before you move on

What does croire mean? ("To believe".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to know (a person, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say to know (a person, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed.*

138.1 connaître — to know (a person, a place)

> Before the new one: say the French for to put; to put on, then the French for to believe.

You'll want to know: connaître

connaître — "to know (a person, a place)". **savoir** knows a fact; **connaître** knows a person or a place.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

connaître ← Old French *conoistre* ← Latin *cognoscere*, "to get to know" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks a lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: connaître*
- *Say it: connaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *connaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put; to put on, then the French for to believe, then say *connaître* again

Before you move on

What does connaître mean? ("To know (a person, a place)".) Say it once more.

138.2 préférer — to prefer

Before the new one: say the French for to believe, then the French for to know.

You'll want to know: préférer

préférer — "to prefer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préférer ← Latin *praeferre*, "to carry before, to put first" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: préférer*
- *Say it: préférer*, once more

- *Say it:* say *préférer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to believe, then the French for to know, then say *préférer* again

Before you move on

What does préférer mean? ("To prefer".) Say it once more.

138.3 espérer — to hope

Before the new one: say the French for to know, then the French for to prefer.

You'll want to know: espérer

espérer — "to hope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espérer ← Latin *sperare*, "to hope" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, with an *e-* added in front of *sp-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: espérer*
- *Say it: espérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *espérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to know, then the French for to prefer, then say *espérer* again

Before you move on

What does espérer mean? ("To hope".) Say it once more.

138.4 conduire — to drive

Before the new one: say the French for to prefer, then the French for to hope.

You'll want to know: conduire

conduire — "to drive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conduire ← Old French *conduire* ← Latin *conducere*, "to lead together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: conduire*
- *Say it: conduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *conduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prefer, then the French for to hope, then say *conduire* again

Before you move on

What does conduire mean? ("To drive".) Say it once more.

138.5 s'habiller — to get dressed

Before the new one: say the French for to hope, then the French for to drive.

You'll want to know: s'habiller

s'habiller — "to get dressed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'habiller ← Old French *abiller*, "to prepare, to trim" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to the word for "a log"; its *h* and its sense of dressing came from the word for a garment, ← Latin *habitus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'habiller*
- *Say it: s'habiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'habiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hope, then the French for to drive, then say *s'habiller* again

Before you move on

What does s'habiller mean? ("To get dressed".) Say it once more.

138.6 School and free time — a first pass

Say the words for to drive and to get dressed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- music, sport, a game, a film, a song
- a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price; a prize
- pink, purple, brown, brown, pretty
- busy, free, open, closed, calm
- noisy, last, next, famous, funny

Before you move on

Music? (**la musique**.) Sport? (**le sport**.) A game? (**le jeu**.) A film? (**le film**.) A song? (**la chanson**.) A drawing? (**le dessin**.) Life? (**la vie**.) A time? (**la fois**.) A colour? (**la couleur**.) A price; a prize? (**le prix**.) Pink? (**rose**.) Purple? (**violet**.) Brown? (**marron**.) Brown? (**brun**.) Pretty? (**joli**.) Busy? (**occupé**.) Free? (**libre**.) Open? (**ouvert**.) Closed? (**fermé**.) Calm? (**calme**.) Noisy? (**bruyant**.) Last? (**dernier**.) Next? (**prochain**.) Famous? (**célèbre**.) Funny? (**drôle**.)

138.7 Describing words, time, numbers and verbs — a second pass

Say the words for nice and nasty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog
- grass, an ear, a lip, a number, an address
- a second, change, a date, a century, an email
- zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand
- to begin, to visit, to answer, to put; to put on, to believe
- to know, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed

Before you move on

Nice? (**sympathique**.) Nasty? (**méchant**.) Heat? (**la chaleur**.) A storm? (**l'orage**.) Fog? (**le brouillard**.) Grass? (**l'herbe**.) An ear? (**l'oreille**.) A lip? (**la lèvre**.) A number? (**le numéro**.) An address? (**l'adresse**.) A second? (**la seconde**.) Change? (**la monnaie**.) A date? (**la date**.) A century? (**le siècle**.) An email? (**le courriel**.) Zero? (**zéro**.) Sixty? (**soixante**.) Seventy? (**soixante-dix**.) Ninety? (**quatre-vingt-dix**.) A thousand?

(**mille**.) To begin? (**commencer**.) To visit? (**visiter**.) To answer? (**répondre**.) To put; to put on? (**mettre**.) To believe? (**croire**.) To know? (**connaître**.) To prefer? (**préférer**.) To hope? (**espérer**.) To drive? (**conduire**.) To get dressed? (**s'habiller**.)

Chapter 139

Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that there is nothing and none, ask which one, and answer "me neither".
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say that there is nothing and none, ask which one, and answer "me neither".*

139.1 rien — nothing

Before the new one: say the French for to drive, then the French for to get dressed.

You'll want to know: rien

rien — "nothing". With a verb it takes **ne** in front: **Je ne comprends rien.** — "I understand nothing." On its own it answers a question: **Rien.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rien ← Latin *rem*, "a thing", the accusative of *res* (Lewis & Short) — inherited: "a thing" became "anything", then, in negative sentences, "nothing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rien*
- *Say it: rien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rien*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drive, then the French for to get dressed, then say *rien* again

Before you move on

What does rien mean? ("Nothing".) Say it once more.

139.2 aucun / aucune — none, not a single

Before the new one: say the French for to get dressed, then the French for nothing.

You'll want to know: aucun / aucune

aucun / aucune — "none, not a single". It agrees with its noun and also takes **ne**: **Il n'y a aucun train lundi.** — "There is no train at all on Monday."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aucun ← Old French *alcun* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **alicunus*, from Latin *aliquis*, "someone", and *unus*, "one" — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aucun / aucune*
- *Say it: aucun / aucune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aucun / aucune*

- *Recall:* say the French for to get dressed, then the French for nothing, then say *aucun / aucune* again

Before you move on

What does aucun / aucune mean? (“None, not a single”.) Say it once more.

139.3 non plus — neither, not either

Before the new one: say the French for nothing, then the French for none.

You’ll want to know: non plus

non plus — “neither, not either”. The answer to a negative: **Je ne travaille pas samedi.** — **Moi non plus.** — “Me neither.” After a yes, French says **moi aussi** instead.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

non plus — *non*, “no, not”, and *plus*, “more”, ← Latin *plus* (EtymDB 2.1): “not more”, that is, not either.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: non plus*
- *Say it: non plus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *non plus*
- *Recall:* say the French for nothing, then the French for none, then say *non plus* again

Before you move on

What does non plus mean? (“Neither, not either”.) Say it once more.

139.4 lequel / laquelle — which one

Before the new one: say the French for none, then the French for neither.

You’ll want to know: lequel / laquelle

lequel / laquelle — “which one”. A question that picks from a set, and it agrees with what is picked: **Lequel ?** for a train, **Laquelle ?** for a chambre.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lequel — *le* and *quel*, “which”, ← Latin *qualis*, “of what kind” (Lewis & Short): “the which”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lequel / laquelle*
- *Say it: lequel / laquelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lequel / laquelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for none, then the French for neither, then say *lequel / laquelle* again

Before you move on

What does lequel / laquelle mean? (“Which one”.) Say it once more.

139.5 n'importe quoi — anything at all

Before the new one: say the French for neither, then the French for which one.

You'll want to know: n'importe quoi

n'importe quoi — "anything at all". **Je lis n'importe quoi.** — "I read anything at all." Said of what someone claims, it means "nonsense".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

n'importe quoi — "it does not matter what": *n'*, "not", the verb for "to matter", ← Italian *importare*, and *quoi*, "what".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: n'importe quoi*
- *Say it: n'importe quoi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *n'importe quoi*
- *Recall:* say the French for neither, then the French for which one, then say *n'importe quoi* again

Before you move on

What does n'importe quoi mean? ("Anything at all".) Say it once more.

Chapter 140

Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what happened, and when: already, recently, the day before yesterday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say what happened, and when: already, recently, the day before yesterday.*

140.1 déjà — already

Before the new one: say the French for which one, then the French for anything at all.

You'll want to know: déjà

déjà — "already". It sits between **avoir** and the participle: **J'ai déjà parlé.** — "I have already spoken."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déjà ← Middle French *desja*, from *des*, "from", and Old French *ja*, "now, already", ← Latin *iam* — the *ja* of *jamais*. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déjà*
- *Say it: déjà*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déjà*
- *Recall:* say the French for which one, then the French for anything at all, then say *déjà* again

Before you move on

What does déjà mean? ("Already".) Say it once more.

140.2 récemment — recently

Before the new one: say the French for anything at all, then the French for already.

You'll want to know: récemment

récemment — "recently". **Récemment, j'ai beaucoup lu.** — "Recently I have read a lot." The ending **-ment** makes an adverb, the way English uses -ly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

récemment — built from the word for "recent", ← Latin *recens*, *recentis* (Lewis & Short), with the adverb ending *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: récemment*
- *Say it: récemment*, once more
- *Say it:* say *récemment*

- *Recall:* say the French for anything at all, then the French for already, then say *récemment* again

Before you move on

What does récemment mean? (“Recently”.) Say it once more.

140.3 avant-hier — the day before yesterday

Before the new one: say the French for already, then the French for recently.

You’ll want to know: avant-hier

avant-hier — “the day before yesterday”. One day further back than **hier**: **Avant-hier, j’ai écrit une lettre.** — “The day before yesterday I wrote a letter.”

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avant-hier — *avant*, “before”, ← Late Latin *abante*, and *hier*, “yesterday”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avant-hier*
- *Say it: avant-hier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avant-hier*
- *Recall:* say the French for already, then the French for recently, then say *avant-hier* again

Before you move on

What does avant-hier mean? (“The day before yesterday”.) Say it once more.

140.4 autrefois — formerly, in the old days

Before the new one: say the French for recently, then the French for the day before yesterday.

You'll want to know: autrefois

autrefois — "formerly, in the old days". It points to a time long past rather than a single day: **Autrefois, le magasin était ici.** — "In the old days the shop was here."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autrefois — "another time": the word for "other", ← Latin *alter*, and *fois*, "a time". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: autrefois*
- *Say it: autrefois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *autrefois*
- *Recall:* say the French for recently, then the French for the day before yesterday, then say *autrefois* again

Before you move on

What does autrefois mean? ("Formerly, in the old days".) Say it once more.

140.5 se produire — to happen, to occur

Before the new one: say the French for the day before yesterday, then the French for formerly.

You'll want to know: se produire

se produire — "to happen, to occur". Its past takes **être**, like **aller**: **Qu'est-ce qui s'est produit ?** — "What happened?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se produire — "to produce itself": *produire* ← Latin *producere*, "to lead forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se produire*
- *Say it: se produire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se produire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the day before yesterday, then the French for formerly, then say *se produire* again

Before you move on

What does se produire mean? ("To happen, to occur".) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what will happen, and when: this evening, next week, in a year.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say what will happen, and when: this evening, next week, in a year.

141.1 l'avenir — the future

Before the new one: say the French for formerly, then the French for to happen.

You'll want to know: l'avenir

l'avenir — "the future". French builds the future on the infinitive: **parler** becomes **je parlerai** — "I will speak" — then **tu parleras**, **il parlera**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avenir is the old verb *avenir*, "to come about", used as a noun: what is to come. It ← Latin *advenire*, "to come to", from *venire*, "to come". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avenir*
- *Say it: l'avenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for formerly, then the French for to happen, then say *l'avenir* again

Before you move on

What does l'avenir mean? ("The future".) Say it once more.

141.2 ce soir — this evening

Before the new one: say the French for to happen, then the French for the future.

You'll want to know: ce soir

ce soir — "this evening". The time word can stand first: **Ce soir, je travaillerai.** — "This evening I will work." **Dans** a length of time gives "in": **dans deux jours** — "in two days".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ce soir — *ce*, "this", ← Latin *ecce hoc*, "look, this" (Lewis & Short for *ecce*), and *soir*, "evening".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ce soir*
- *Say it: ce soir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ce soir*

- *Recall:* say the French for to happen, then the French for the future, then say *ce soir* again

Before you move on

What does ce soir mean? ("This evening".) Say it once more.

141.3 le projet — a plan, a project

Before the new one: say the French for the future, then the French for this evening.

You'll want to know: le projet

le projet — "a plan, a project". **Quels sont tes projets pour le week-end ?** — "What are your plans for the weekend?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

projet — formed from the verb for "to throw forward", reshaped after Latin *proiectus*, "thrown forward" (EtymDB 2.1): a plan cast ahead.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le projet*
- *Say it: le projet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le projet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the future, then the French for this evening, then say *le projet* again

Before you move on

What does le projet mean? ("A plan, a project".) Say it once more.

141.4 prévoir — to foresee, to plan for

Before the new one: say the French for this evening, then the French for a plan.

You'll want to know: prévoir

prévoir — "to foresee, to plan for". **voir** with **pré-**, "before": seeing a thing before it comes. The future of **être** is irregular: **je serai**, **tu seras**, **il sera**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévoir ← Old French *preveoir*, modelled on Latin *praevidere*, "to see beforehand", from *videre*, "to see". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prévoir*
- *Say it: prévoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prévoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for this evening, then the French for a plan, then say *prévoir* again

Before you move on

What does prévoir mean? ("To foresee, to plan for".) Say it once more.

141.5 organiser — to organise

Before the new one: say the French for a plan, then the French for to foresee.

You'll want to know: organiser

organiser — "to organise". A regular **-er** verb, so the future follows **parler**: **J'organiserai tout.** — "I will organise everything."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

organiser ← Medieval Latin *organizare*, from *organum*, "an instrument", from Greek *organon*, "a tool" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: organiser*
- *Say it: organiser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *organiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plan, then the French for to foresee, then say *organiser* again

Before you move on

What does organiser mean? ("To organise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read opening hours, a notice, an advert and a bill, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can read opening hours, a notice, an advert and a bill, and act on what they say.*

142.1 l'horaire — opening hours, a timetable

> Before the new one: say the French for to foresee, then the French for to organise.

You'll want to know: l'horaire

l'horaire — "opening hours, a timetable".

Read it: the door

The door says **Horaire : lundi – vendredi, 9 h – 18 h.** Open on weekdays from nine to six: not on **samedi**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

horaire ← Latin *horarius*, "of the hours", from *hora*, "hour", the Latin of *heure* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1 records *hora*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'horaire*
- *Say it: l'horaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'horaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to foresee, then the French for to organise, then say *l'horaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'horaire mean? ("Opening hours, a timetable".) Say it once more.

142.2 l'avis — a notice, an opinion

Before the new one: say the French for to organise, then the French for opening hours.

You'll want to know: l'avis

l'avis — "a notice, an opinion".

Read it: the notice

The notice says **Avis : le magasin est fermé aujourd'hui.** The shop is closed today, so come back another day.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avis ← Old French *avis*, built on *vis*, "a view", ← Latin *visus*, "a look" (EtymDB 2.1): how a matter looks to you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avis*
- *Say it: l'avis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avis*
- *Recall:* say the French for to organise, then the French for opening hours, then say *l'avis* again

Before you move on

What does l'avis mean? ("A notice, an opinion".) Say it once more.

142.3 le loyer — the rent

Before the new one: say the French for opening hours, then the French for a notice.

You'll want to know: le loyer

le loyer — "the rent". The money for a **chambre**, paid every **mois**: **Le loyer est de 400 euros par mois.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loyer ← Old French *loier* ← Latin *locarium*, "rent for a place", from *locus*, "a place" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le loyer*
- *Say it: le loyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le loyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for opening hours, then the French for a notice, then say *le loyer* again

Before you move on

What does le loyer mean? ("The rent".) Say it once more.

142.4 l'annonce — an advert, an announcement

Before the new one: say the French for a notice, then the French for the rent.

You'll want to know: l'annonce

l'annonce — "an advert, an announcement".

Read it: the advert

The advert says **Chambre libre. Loyer : 400 euros.** A room is free, at 400 a month.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annonce — formed from the verb for "to announce", ← Latin *annuntiare*, "to make known", from *nuntius*, "a messenger" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'annonce*
- *Say it: l'annonce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'annonce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a notice, then the French for the rent, then say *l'annonce* again

Before you move on

What does l'annonce mean? ("An advert, an announcement".) Say it once more.

142.5 la facture — a bill, an invoice

Before the new one: say the French for the rent, then the French for an advert.

You'll want to know: la facture

la facture — "a bill, an invoice".

Read it: the bill

The bill says **Facture : loyer, 400 euros. À payer avant lundi.** Pay it before Monday.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facture ← Latin *factura*, "a making" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the bill is the account of work made.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la facture*
- *Say it: la facture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la facture*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rent, then the French for an advert, then say *la facture* again

Before you move on

What does la facture mean? ("A bill, an invoice".) Say it once more.

142.6 Saying no and looking back — a first pass

Say the words for an advert and a bill.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nothing, none, neither, which one, anything at all
- already, recently, the day before yesterday, formerly, to happen

Before you move on

Nothing? (**rien**.) None? (**aucun / aucune**.) Neither? (**non plus**.) Which one? (**lequel / laquelle**.) Anything at all? (**n'importe quoi**.) Already? (**déjà**.) Recently? (**récemment**.) The day before yesterday? (**avant-hier**.) Formerly? (**autrefois**.) To happen? (**se produire**.)

142.7 Looking ahead and reading notices — a second pass

Say the words for the future and this evening.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the future, this evening, a plan, to foresee, to organise
- opening hours, a notice, the rent, an advert, a bill

Before you move on

The future? (**l'avenir**.) This evening? (**ce soir**.) A plan? (**le projet**.) To foresee? (**prévoir**.) To organise? (**organiser**.) Opening hours? (**l'horaire**.) A notice? (**l'avis**.) The rent? (**le loyer**.) An advert? (**l'annonce**.) A bill? (**la facture**.)

Chapter 143

To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile and to shout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile and to shout.*

143.1 allumer — to switch on, to light

Before the new one: say the French for an advert, an announcement, then the French for a bill, an invoice.

You'll want to know: allumer

allumer — "to switch on, to light".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

allumer ← Old French *allumer* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **alluminare*, from Latin *lumen*, "light" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: allumer*
- *Say it: allumer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *allumer*
- *Recall:* say the French for an advert, an announcement, then the French for a bill, an invoice, then say *allumer* again

Before you move on

What does allumer mean? ("To switch on, to light".) Say it once more.

143.2 éteindre — to switch off, to put out

Before the new one: say the French for a bill, an invoice, then the French for to switch on.

You'll want to know: éteindre

éteindre — "to switch off, to put out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éteindre ← Old French *esteindre* ← Latin *exstinguere*, "to put out" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: éteindre*
- *Say it: éteindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *éteindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bill, an invoice, then the French for to switch on, then say *éteindre* again

Before you move on

What does éteindre mean? ("To switch off, to put out".) Say it once more.

143.3 sauter — to jump

Before the new one: say the French for to switch on, then the French for to switch off.

You'll want to know: sauter

sauter — "to jump".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauter ← Latin *saltare*, "to dance, to leap" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the *l* melted into a vowel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauter*
- *Say it: sauter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to switch on, then the French for to switch off, then say *sauter* again

Before you move on

What does sauter mean? ("To jump".) Say it once more.

143.4 sourire — to smile

Before the new one: say the French for to switch off, then the French for to jump.

You'll want to know: sourire

sourire — "to smile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sourire ← Latin *subridere*, "to smile": *rire* with *sou-*, "under", in front (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sourire*
- *Say it: sourire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sourire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to switch off, then the French for to jump, then say *sourire* again

Before you move on

What does sourire mean? ("To smile".) Say it once more.

143.5 crier — to shout

Before the new one: say the French for to jump, then the French for to smile.

You'll want to know: crier

crier — "to shout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crier ← Old French *crier* (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Latin *quiritare*, "to call for help" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *crier*
- *Say it:* *crier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *crier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to jump, then the French for to smile, then say *crier* again

Before you move on

What does crier mean? ("To shout".) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to explain, to translate, to decide, to try and to continue.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say to explain, to translate, to decide, to try and to continue.*

144.1 expliquer — to explain

> Before the new one: say the French for to smile, then the French for to shout.

You'll want to know: expliquer

expliquer — "to explain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expliquer ← Latin *explicare*, "to unfold" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *expliquer*
- *Say it:* *expliquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *expliquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to smile, then the French for to shout, then say *expliquer* again

Before you move on

What does expliquer mean? (“To explain”.) Say it once more.

144.2 traduire — to translate

Before the new one: say the French for to shout, then the French for to explain.

You’ll want to know: traduire

traduire — “to translate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traduire ← Latin *traducere*, “to lead across” (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing of the 1500s.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *traduire*
- *Say it:* *traduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *traduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to shout, then the French for to explain, then say *traduire* again

Before you move on

What does traduire mean? (“To translate”.) Say it once more.

144.3 décider — to decide

Before the new one: say the French for to explain, then the French for to translate.

You’ll want to know: décider

décider — “to decide”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décider ← Latin *decidere*, “to cut off, to settle” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: décider*
- *Say it: décider*, once more
- *Say it:* say *décider*
- *Recall:* say the French for to explain, then the French for to translate, then say *décider* again

Before you move on

What does décider mean? (“To decide”.) Say it once more.

144.4 essayer — to try

Before the new one: say the French for to translate, then the French for to decide.

You'll want to know: essayer

essayer — "to try".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

essayer ← Vulgar Latin **exagiare*, from Late Latin *exagium*, "a weighing" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: to try was to weigh up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *essayer*
- *Say it:* *essayer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *essayer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to translate, then the French for to decide, then say *essayer* again

Before you move on

What does essayer mean? ("To try".) Say it once more.

144.5 continuer — to continue

Before the new one: say the French for to decide, then the French for to try.

You'll want to know: continuer

continuer — "to continue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

continuer ← Latin *continuare*, "to join together" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: continuer*
- *Say it: continuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *continuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to decide, then the French for to try, then say *continuer* again

Before you move on

What does continuer mean? ("To continue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss and to quarrel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss and to quarrel.*

145.1 signer — to sign

> Before the new one: say the French for to try, then the French for to continue.

You'll want to know: signer

signer — "to sign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

signer ← Latin *signare*, "to mark", from *signum*, "a sign" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: signer*
- *Say it: signer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *signer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to try, then the French for to continue, then say *signer* again

Before you move on

What does signer mean? ("To sign".) Say it once more.

145.2 remplir un formulaire — to fill in a form

Before the new one: say the French for to continue, then the French for to sign.

You'll want to know: remplir un formulaire

remplir un formulaire — "to fill in a form".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplir un formulaire — *remplir*, "to fill", is *re-* and Old French *emplir*, ← Latin *implere* (EtymDB 2.1); *un*, "a"; *formulaire*, "a form", ← Latin *formularium* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplir un formulaire*
- *Say it: remplir un formulaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplir un formulaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to continue, then the French for to sign, then say *remplir un formulaire* again

Before you move on

What does remplir un formulaire mean? ("To fill in a form".) Say it once more.

145.3 téléphoner — to phone

Before the new one: say the French for to sign, then the French for to fill in a form.

You'll want to know: téléphoner

téléphoner — "to phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphoner — formed from *téléphone* with the verb ending *-er*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: téléphoner*
- *Say it: téléphoner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *téléphoner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sign, then the French for to fill in a form, then say *téléphoner* again

Before you move on

What does téléphoner mean? ("To phone".) Say it once more.

145.4 discuter — to discuss

Before the new one: say the French for to fill in a form, then the French for to phone.

You'll want to know: discuter

discuter — "to discuss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

discuter ← Latin *discutere*, "to shake apart" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing: to examine by taking apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: discuter*
- *Say it: discuter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *discuter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fill in a form, then the French for to phone, then say *discuter* again

Before you move on

What does discuter mean? ("To discuss".) Say it once more.

145.5 se disputer — to quarrel

Before the new one: say the French for to phone, then the French for to discuss.

You'll want to know: se disputer

se disputer — "to quarrel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se disputer ← Latin *disputare*, "to weigh up, to argue" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se disputer*
- *Say it: se disputer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se disputer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to phone, then the French for to discuss, then say *se disputer* again

Before you move on

What does se disputer mean? ("To quarrel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry and to smoke.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry and to smoke.*

146.1 s'ennuyer — to be bored

> Before the new one: say the French for to discuss, then the French for to quarrel.

You'll want to know: s'ennuyer

s'ennuyer — "to be bored".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'ennuyer ← Vulgar Latin **inodiare*, from Latin *in odio*, "in hatred" (Lewis & Short for *odium*) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'ennuyer*
- *Say it: s'ennuyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'ennuyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to discuss, then the French for to quarrel, then say *s'ennuyer* again

Before you move on

What does s'ennuyer mean? ("To be bored".) Say it once more.

146.2 s'amuser — to have fun

Before the new one: say the French for to quarrel, then the French for to be bored.

You'll want to know: s'amuser

s'amuser — "to have fun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'amuser ← Old French *amuser*, "to keep idle", built from *a-* and *muser*, "to gape, to dawdle". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'amuser*
- *Say it: s'amuser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'amuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to quarrel, then the French for to be bored, then say *s'amuser* again

Before you move on

What does s'amuser mean? ("To have fun".) Say it once more.

146.3 se fâcher — to get angry

Before the new one: say the French for to be bored, then the French for to have fun.

You'll want to know: se fâcher

se fâcher — "to get angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se fâcher — its origin is uncertain; the usual account derives it from Vulgar Latin **fasticare*, built on Latin *fastidium*, "disgust".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se fâcher*
- *Say it: se fâcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se fâcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be bored, then the French for to have fun, then say *se fâcher* again

Before you move on

What does se fâcher mean? ("To get angry".) Say it once more.

146.4 s'inquiéter — to worry

Before the new one: say the French for to have fun, then the French for to get angry.

You'll want to know: s'inquiéter

s'inquiéter — "to worry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'inquiéter ← Latin *inquietare*, "to disturb", from *inquietus*, "restless" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'inquiéter*
- *Say it: s'inquiéter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'inquiéter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to have fun, then the French for to get angry, then say *s'inquiéter* again

Before you move on

What does s'inquiéter mean? ("To worry".) Say it once more.

146.5 fumer — to smoke

Before the new one: say the French for to get angry, then the French for to worry.

You'll want to know: fumer

fumer — "to smoke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fumer ← Latin *fumare*, "to smoke" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fumer*
- *Say it: fumer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fumer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get angry, then the French for to worry, then say *fumer* again

Before you move on

What does fumer mean? (“To smoke”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise and to prove.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise and to prove.*

147.1 comparer — to compare

> Before the new one: say the French for to worry, then the French for to smoke.

You'll want to know: comparer

comparer — "to compare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comparer ← Latin *comparare*, "to pair together", from *par*, "equal" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: comparer*
- *Say it: comparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *comparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to worry, then the French for to smoke, then say *comparer* again

Before you move on

What does comparer mean? ("To compare".) Say it once more.

147.2 conseiller — to advise

Before the new one: say the French for to smoke, then the French for to compare.

You'll want to know: conseiller

conseiller — "to advise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conseiller ← Old French *consellier* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *consiliari*, "to take counsel", from *consilium*, "advice" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: conseiller*
- *Say it: conseiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *conseiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to smoke, then the French for to compare, then say *conseiller* again

Before you move on

What does conseiller mean? ("To advise".) Say it once more.

147.3 convaincre — to convince

Before the new one: say the French for to compare, then the French for to advise.

You'll want to know: convaincre

convaincre — "to convince".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

convaincre ← Latin *convincere*, "to overcome, to prove wrong", from *vincere*, "to conquer" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: convaincre*
- *Say it: convaincre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *convaincre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to compare, then the French for to advise, then say *convaincre* again

Before you move on

What does convaincre mean? ("To convince".) Say it once more.

147.4 critiquer — to criticise

Before the new one: say the French for to advise, then the French for to convince.

You'll want to know: critiquer

critiquer — "to criticise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

critiquer — formed from the word for "criticism", ← Latin *criticus*, from Greek *kritikos*, "able to judge". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *critiquer*
- *Say it:* *critiquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *critiquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to advise, then the French for to convince, then say *critiquer* again

Before you move on

What does critiquer mean? ("To criticise".) Say it once more.

147.5 démontrer — to prove

Before the new one: say the French for to convince, then the French for to criticise.

You'll want to know: démontrer

démontrer — "to prove".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démontrer ← Old French *demonstrer* ← Latin *demonstrare*, "to point out" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *montrer* with *dé-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: démontrer*
- *Say it: démontrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *démontrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to convince, then the French for to criticise, then say *démontrer* again

Before you move on

What does démontrer mean? ("To prove".) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold and to own.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold and to own.*

148.1 observer — to observe

> Before the new one: say the French for to criticise, then the French for to prove.

You'll want to know: observer

observer — "to observe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

observer ← Latin *observare*, "to watch, to heed" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: observer*
- *Say it: observer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *observer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to criticise, then the French for to prove, then say *observer* again

Before you move on

What does observer mean? ("To observe".) Say it once more.

148.2 participer — to take part

Before the new one: say the French for to prove, then the French for to observe.

You'll want to know: participer

participer — "to take part".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

participer ← Latin *participare*, "to share in", from *pars*, "a part", and *capere*, "to take" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: participer*
- *Say it: participer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *participer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prove, then the French for to observe, then say *participer* again

Before you move on

What does participer mean? (“To take part”.) Say it once more.

148.3 se promener — to go for a walk

Before the new one: say the French for to observe, then the French for to take part.

You’ll want to know: se promener

se promener — “to go for a walk”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se promener ← Old French *pormener*, “to lead around”, built on *mener*, “to lead”, ← Latin *minare*, “to drive cattle” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se promener*
- *Say it: se promener*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se promener*
- *Recall:* say the French for to observe, then the French for to take part, then say *se promener* again

Before you move on

What does se promener mean? (“To go for a walk”.) Say it once more.

148.4 plier — to fold

Before the new one: say the French for to take part, then the French for to go for a walk.

You'll want to know: plier

plier — "to fold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plier ← Latin *plicare*, "to fold" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plier*
- *Say it: plier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take part, then the French for to go for a walk, then say *plier* again

Before you move on

What does plier mean? ("To fold".) Say it once more.

148.5 posséder — to own

Before the new one: say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to fold.

You'll want to know: posséder

posséder — "to own".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

posséder ← Latin *possidere*, "to hold, to own" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: posséder*
- *Say it: posséder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *posséder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to fold, then say *posséder* again

Before you move on

What does posséder mean? (“To own”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 149

To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer and to dream.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer and to dream.*

149.1 découvrir — to discover

Before the new one: say the French for to fold, then the French for to own.

You'll want to know: découvrir

découvrir — "to discover".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

découvrir ← Old French *descovrir*, "to uncover", from *des-* and the verb for "to cover", ← Latin *cooperire*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: découvrir*
- *Say it: découvrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *découvrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fold, then the French for to own, then say *découvrir* again

Before you move on

What does découvrir mean? (“To discover”.) Say it once more.

149.2 sembler — to seem

Before the new one: say the French for to own, then the French for to discover.

You’ll want to know: sembler

sembler — “to seem”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sembler ← Late Latin *similare*, “to be like”, from *similis*, “like” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sembler*
- *Say it: sembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to own, then the French for to discover, then say *sembler* again

Before you move on

What does sembler mean? (“To seem”.) Say it once more.

149.3 servir — to serve

Before the new one: say the French for to discover, then the French for to seem.

You’ll want to know: servir

servir — “to serve”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

servir ← Latin *servire*, “to be a servant”, from *servus*, “a slave” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: servir*
- *Say it: servir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *servir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to discover, then the French for to seem, then say *servir* again

Before you move on

What does servir mean? (“To serve”.) Say it once more.

149.4 souffrir — to suffer

Before the new one: say the French for to seem, then the French for to serve.

You'll want to know: souffrir

souffrir — "to suffer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souffrir ← Vulgar Latin **sufferire* ← Latin *sufferre*, "to bear up under" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: souffrir*
- *Say it: souffrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *souffrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to seem, then the French for to serve, then say *souffrir* again

Before you move on

What does souffrir mean? ("To suffer".) Say it once more.

149.5 rêver — to dream

Before the new one: say the French for to serve, then the French for to suffer.

You'll want to know: rêver

rêver — "to dream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rêver ← Old French *resver*, "to wander, to be delirious" (EtymDB 2.1), whose origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rêver*
- *Say it: rêver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rêver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to serve, then the French for to suffer, then say *rêver* again

Before you move on

What does rêver mean? ("To dream".) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in and to deliver.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in and to deliver.*

150.1 s'éloigner — to move away

> Before the new one: say the French for to suffer, then the French for to dream.

You'll want to know: s'éloigner

s'éloigner — "to move away".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'éloigner ← Old French *esloignier*, built on *loing*, "far", the old spelling of *loin* (EtymDB 2.1): to put far off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'éloigner*
- *Say it: s'éloigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'éloigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suffer, then the French for to dream, then say *s'éloigner* again

Before you move on

What does s'éloigner mean? ("To move away".) Say it once more.

150.2 s'approcher — to come near

Before the new one: say the French for to dream, then the French for to move away.

You'll want to know: s'approcher

s'approcher — "to come near".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'approcher ← Late Latin *appropiare*, "to draw near", from *prope*, "near", the Latin of *prochain* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'approcher*
- *Say it: s'approcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'approcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dream, then the French for to move away, then say *s'approcher* again

Before you move on

What does s'approcher mean? ("To come near".) Say it once more.

150.3 bavarder — to chat

Before the new one: say the French for to move away, then the French for to come near.

You'll want to know: bavarder

bavarder — "to chat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bavarder — built from the word for "chatty", which comes from the word for "drool", probably imitative: to chatter is to slobber words.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bavarder*
- *Say it: bavarder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bavarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move away, then the French for to come near, then say *bavarder* again

Before you move on

What does bavarder mean? ("To chat".) Say it once more.

150.4 brancher — to plug in

Before the new one: say the French for to come near, then the French for to chat.

You'll want to know: brancher

brancher — "to plug in".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brancher — built from the word for "a branch", ← Late Latin *branca*, "a paw" (EtymDB 2.1): to join on like a branch.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brancher*
- *Say it: brancher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brancher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come near, then the French for to chat, then say *brancher* again

Before you move on

What does brancher mean? ("To plug in".) Say it once more.

150.5 livrer — to deliver

Before the new one: say the French for to chat, then the French for to plug in.

You'll want to know: livrer

livrer — "to deliver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

livrer ← Latin *liberare*, "to set free", the Latin of *libre* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to hand over was to release.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: livrer*
- *Say it: livrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *livrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chat, then the French for to plug in, then say *livrer* again

Before you move on

What does livrer mean? ("To deliver".) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down and to breathe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down and to breathe.*

151.1 héberger — to put up (a guest)

Before the new one: say the French for to plug in, then the French for to deliver.

You'll want to know: héberger

héberger — "to put up (a guest)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

héberger ← Old French *herbergier*, "to shelter", a Germanic word: Old High German has *heribergan*, from *heri*, "army", and *bergan*, "to shelter" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: héberger*
- *Say it: héberger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *héberger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to plug in, then the French for to deliver, then say *héberger* again

Before you move on

What does héberger mean? ("To put up (a guest)".) Say it once more.

151.2 prier — to pray

Before the new one: say the French for to deliver, then the French for to put up.

You'll want to know: prier

prier — "to pray".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prier ← Old French *preier* ← Latin *precari*, "to pray, to beg" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prier*
- *Say it: prier*, once more

- *Say it:* say *prier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deliver, then the French for to put up, then say *prier* again

Before you move on

What does prier mean? (“To pray”.) Say it once more.

151.3 recommander — to recommend

Before the new one: say the French for to put up, then the French for to pray.

You’ll want to know: recommander

recommander — “to recommend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recommander — built from *re-* and the verb for “to order, to entrust”, ← Vulgar Latin **commandare* ← Latin *commendare*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: recommander*
- *Say it: recommander*, once more
- *Say it:* say *recommander*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put up, then the French for to pray, then say *recommander* again

Before you move on

What does recommander mean? (“To recommend”.) Say it once more.

151.4 ralentir — to slow down

Before the new one: say the French for to pray, then the French for to recommend.

You'll want to know: ralentir

ralentir — "to slow down".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ralentir — built from *re-*, *a-* and the word for "slow", ← Latin *lentus*, "pliant, slow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ralentir*
- *Say it: ralentir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ralentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pray, then the French for to recommend, then say *ralentir* again

Before you move on

What does ralentir mean? ("To slow down".) Say it once more.

151.5 respirer — to breathe

Before the new one: say the French for to recommend, then the French for to slow down.

You'll want to know: respirer

respirer — "to breathe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

respirer ← Latin *respirare*, "to breathe back, to breathe" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: respirer*
- *Say it: respirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *respirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recommend, then the French for to slow down, then say *respirer* again

Before you move on

What does respirer mean? ("To breathe".) Say it once more.

151.6 Words from chapters 143-146 — a first pass

Say the words for to slow down and to breathe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile, to shout
- to explain, to translate, to decide, to try, to continue
- to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss, to quarrel
- to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry, to smoke

Before you move on

To switch on? (**allumer**.) To switch off? (**éteindre**.) To jump? (**sauter**.) To smile? (**sourire**.) To shout? (**crier**.) To explain? (**expliquer**.) To translate? (**traduire**.) To decide? (**décider**.) To try? (**essayer**.) To continue? (**continuer**.) To sign? (**signer**.) To fill in a form? (**remplir un formulaire**.) To phone? (**téléphoner**.) To discuss? (**discuter**.) To quarrel? (**se disputer**.) To be bored? (**s'ennuyer**.) To have fun? (**s'amuser**.) To get angry? (**se fâcher**.) To worry? (**s'inquiéter**.) To smoke? (**fumer**.)

151.7 Words from chapters 147-151 — a second pass

Say the words for to compare and to advise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise, to prove
- to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold, to own
- to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer, to dream
- to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in, to deliver
- to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down, to breathe

Before you move on

To compare? (**comparer**.) To advise? (**conseiller**.) To convince? (**convaincre**.) To criticise? (**critiquer**.) To prove? (**démontrer**.) To observe? (**observer**.) To take part? (**participer**.) To go for a walk? (**se promener**.) To fold? (**plier**.) To own? (**posséder**.) To discover? (**découvrir**.) To seem? (**sembler**.) To serve? (**servir**.) To suffer? (**souffrir**.) To dream? (**rêver**.) To move away? (**s'éloigner**.) To come near? (**s'approcher**.) To chat? (**bavarder**.) To plug in? (**brancher**.) To deliver? (**livrer**.) To put up? (**héberger**.) To pray? (**prier**.) To recommend? (**recommander**.)

To slow down? (**ralentir**.) To breathe? (**respirer**.)

Chapter 152

To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back and to lower.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back and to lower.*

152.1 admirer — to admire

> Before the new one: say the French for to slow down, then the French for to breathe.

You'll want to know: admirer

admirer — "to admire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

admirer ← Latin *admirari*, "to wonder at" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: admirer*
- *Say it: admirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *admirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to slow down, then the French for to breathe, then say *admirer* again

Before you move on

What does admirer mean? ("To admire".) Say it once more.

152.2 agir — to act

Before the new one: say the French for to breathe, then the French for to admire.

You'll want to know: agir

agir — "to act".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agir ← Latin *agere*, "to do, to drive" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: agir*
- *Say it: agir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *agir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to breathe, then the French for to admire, then say *agir* again

Before you move on

What does agir mean? (“To act”.) Say it once more.

152.3 avancer — to move forward

Before the new one: say the French for to admire, then the French for to act.

You’ll want to know: avancer

avancer — “to move forward”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avancer ← Old French *avancer* ← Late Latin *abante*, “in front”, from *ab* and *ante*, “before” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avancer*
- *Say it: avancer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to admire, then the French for to act, then say *avancer* again

Before you move on

What does avancer mean? (“To move forward”.) Say it once more.

152.4 reculer — to move back

Before the new one: say the French for to act, then the French for to move forward.

You'll want to know: reculer

reculer — "to move back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reculer — built from *re-*, "back", and the word for "backside", ← Latin *culus* (Lewis & Short): to go back rear first.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reculer*
- *Say it: reculer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reculer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to act, then the French for to move forward, then say *reculer* again

Before you move on

What does reculer mean? ("To move back".) Say it once more.

152.5 baisser — to lower

Before the new one: say the French for to move forward, then the French for to move back.

You'll want to know: baisser

baisser — "to lower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baisser ← Vulgar Latin **bassiare*, from Late Latin *bassus*, "low" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baisser*
- *Say it: baisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move forward, then the French for to move back, then say *baisser* again

Before you move on

What does baisser mean? ("To lower".) Say it once more.

Chapter 153

To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush and to bleed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush and to bleed.*

153.1 remarquer — to notice

Before the new one: say the French for to move back, then the French for to lower.

You'll want to know: remarquer

remarquer — "to notice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remarquer — built from *re-* and the verb for "to mark", whose noun came from a Germanic word for "a sign".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remarquer*
- *Say it: remarquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remarquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move back, then the French for to lower, then say *remarquer* again

Before you move on

What does remarquer mean? (“To notice”.) Say it once more.

153.2 remplacer — to replace

Before the new one: say the French for to lower, then the French for to notice.

You’ll want to know: remplacer

remplacer — “to replace”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplacer — built from *re-*, *en-* and the word for “a place”, ← Latin *platea*, “a broad street” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplacer*
- *Say it: remplacer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lower, then the French for to notice, then say *remplacer* again

Before you move on

What does remplacer mean? ("To replace".) Say it once more.

153.3 rencontrer — to meet

Before the new one: say the French for to notice, then the French for to replace.

You'll want to know: rencontrer

rencontrer — "to meet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rencontrer — built from *re-* and Old French *encontrer*, "to meet", from *encontre*, "against", ← Latin *in contra* (Lewis & Short for *contra*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rencontrer*
- *Say it: rencontrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rencontrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to notice, then the French for to replace, then say *rencontrer* again

Before you move on

What does rencontrer mean? ("To meet".) Say it once more.

153.4 rougir — to blush

Before the new one: say the French for to replace, then the French for to meet.

You'll want to know: rougir

rougir — "to blush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rougir — built from *rouge*, "red", with the verb ending *-ir*: to go red. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rougir*
- *Say it: rougir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rougir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to replace, then the French for to meet, then say *rougir* again

Before you move on

What does rougir mean? ("To blush".) Say it once more.

153.5 saigner — to bleed

Before the new one: say the French for to meet, then the French for to blush.

You'll want to know: saigner

saigner — "to bleed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saigner ← Latin *sanguinare*, "to bleed", from *sanguis*, the Latin of *sang* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saigner*
- *Say it: saigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to meet, then the French for to blush, then say *saigner* again

Before you move on

What does saigner mean? ("To bleed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say health, the brain, a lung, the liver and a kidney.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say health, the brain, a lung, the liver and a kidney.*

154.1 la santé — health

Before the new one: say the French for to blush, then the French for to bleed.

You'll want to know: la santé

la santé — "health".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

santé ← Old French *santé* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *sanitas*, *sanitatis*, "soundness of body", from *sanus*, "healthy" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la santé*
- *Say it: la santé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la santé*
- *Recall:* say the French for to blush, then the French for to bleed, then say *la santé* again

Before you move on

What does la santé mean? (“Health”.) Say it once more.

154.2 le cerveau — the brain

Before the new one: say the French for to bleed, then the French for health.

You’ll want to know: le cerveau

le cerveau — “the brain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cerveau ← Old French *cervel* ← Latin *cerebellum*, “a little brain”, from *cerebrum*, “brain” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cerveau*
- *Say it: le cerveau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cerveau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bleed, then the French for health, then say *le cerveau* again

Before you move on

What does le cerveau mean? ("The brain".) Say it once more.

154.3 le poumon — a lung

Before the new one: say the French for health, then the French for the brain.

You'll want to know: le poumon

le poumon — "a lung".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poumon ← Latin *pulmo*, *pulmonis*, "lung" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poumon*
- *Say it: le poumon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poumon*
- *Recall:* say the French for health, then the French for the brain, then say *le poumon* again

Before you move on

What does le poumon mean? ("A lung".) Say it once more.

154.4 le foie — the liver

Before the new one: say the French for the brain, then the French for a lung.

You'll want to know: le foie

le foie — "the liver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

foie ← Late Latin *ficatum*, short for *iecur ficatum*, "liver fattened on figs", from *ficus*, "fig" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le foie*
- *Say it: le foie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le foie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the brain, then the French for a lung, then say *le foie* again

Before you move on

What does le foie mean? ("The liver".) Say it once more.

154.5 le rein — a kidney

Before the new one: say the French for a lung, then the French for the liver.

You'll want to know: le rein

le rein — "a kidney".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rein ← Old French *rein* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *renes*, "the kidneys" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rein*
- *Say it: le rein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rein*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lung, then the French for the liver, then say *le rein* again

Before you move on

What does le rein mean? ("A kidney".) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety and love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety and love.*

155.1 le repos — rest

Before the new one: say the French for the liver, then the French for a kidney.

You'll want to know: le repos

le repos — "rest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repos — formed from the verb for "to rest", ← Late Latin *repausare*, "to rest", from *pausare*, "to pause". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le repos*
- *Say it: le repos*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le repos*
- *Recall:* say the French for the liver, then the French for a kidney, then say *le repos* again

Before you move on

What does le repos mean? (“Rest”.) Say it once more.

155.2 le sommeil — sleep

Before the new one: say the French for a kidney, then the French for rest.

You’ll want to know: le sommeil

le sommeil — “sleep”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sommeil ← Vulgar Latin **somniculus*, “a little sleep”, from Latin *somnus*, “sleep” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sommeil*
- *Say it: le sommeil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sommeil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a kidney, then the French for rest, then say *le sommeil* again

Before you move on

What does le sommeil mean? (“Sleep”.) Say it once more.

155.3 le rêve — a dream

Before the new one: say the French for rest, then the French for sleep.

You’ll want to know: le rêve

le rêve — “a dream”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rêve — formed from *rêver*, “to dream”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rêve*
- *Say it: le rêve*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rêve*
- *Recall:* say the French for rest, then the French for sleep, then say *le rêve* again

Before you move on

What does le rêve mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

155.4 l’angoisse — anxiety

Before the new one: say the French for sleep, then the French for a dream.

You'll want to know: l'angoisse

l'angoisse — "anxiety".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

angoisse ← Latin *angustia*, "narrowness, distress", from *angustus*, "narrow" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'angoisse*
- *Say it: l'angoisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'angoisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for sleep, then the French for a dream, then say *l'angoisse* again

Before you move on

What does l'angoisse mean? ("Anxiety".) Say it once more.

155.5 l'amour — love

Before the new one: say the French for a dream, then the French for anxiety.

You'll want to know: l'amour

l'amour — "love".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amour ← Old French *amor* ← Latin *amor*, "love" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). Its *-our*, where French usually has *-eur* as in *douleur*, is often put down to the love poetry of the south.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amour*
- *Say it: l'amour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dream, then the French for anxiety, then say *l'amour* again

Before you move on

What does l'amour mean? ("Love".) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on and still.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on and still.*

156.1 rarement — rarely

Before the new one: say the French for anxiety, then the French for love.

You'll want to know: rarement

rarement — "rarely".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rarement — built from the word for "rare", ← Latin *rarus*, "thin, scattered" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rarement*
- *Say it: rarement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rarement*
- *Recall:* say the French for anxiety, then the French for love, then say *rarement* again

Before you move on

What does rarement mean? ("Rarely".) Say it once more.

156.2 ensuite — afterwards, next

Before the new one: say the French for love, then the French for rarely.

You'll want to know: ensuite

ensuite — "afterwards, next".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ensuite — *en*, "in", and the word for "what follows", ← Vulgar Latin **sequita*, from Latin *sequi*, "to follow" (Lewis & Short): in what follows.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ensuite*
- *Say it: ensuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ensuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for love, then the French for rarely, then say *ensuite* again

Before you move on

What does ensuite mean? ("Afterwards, next".) Say it once more.

156.3 enfin — finally

Before the new one: say the French for rarely, then the French for afterwards.

You'll want to know: enfin

enfin — "finally".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfin — *en*, "in", and the word for "end", ← Latin *finis*, the *fin* of *finir*: in the end.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enfin*
- *Say it:* *enfin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enfin*
- *Recall:* say the French for rarely, then the French for afterwards, then say *enfin* again

Before you move on

What does enfin mean? ("Finally".) Say it once more.

156.4 désormais — from now on

Before the new one: say the French for afterwards, then the French for finally.

You'll want to know: désormais

désormais — "from now on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désormais — "from now on more": Old French *des*, "from", *ore*, "now", ← Latin *hora*, "hour", and *mais*, "more", ← Latin *magis* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: désormais*
- *Say it: désormais*, once more
- *Say it:* say *désormais*
- *Recall:* say the French for afterwards, then the French for finally, then say *désormais* again

Before you move on

What does désormais mean? ("From now on".) Say it once more.

156.5 encore — still, again

Before the new one: say the French for finally, then the French for from now on.

You'll want to know: encore

encore — "still, again".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

encore — its origin is not settled: the usual account takes it to Latin *hinc ad horam*, "from here to the hour", or *hanc horam*, "this hour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *encore*
- *Say it:* *encore*, once more
- *Say it:* say *encore*
- *Recall:* say the French for finally, then the French for from now on, then say *encore* again

Before you move on

What does encore mean? ("Still, again".) Say it once more.

Chapter 157

Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say above, below, in front, behind and beside.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say above, below, in front, behind and beside.*

157.1 au-dessus — above

Before the new one: say the French for from now on, then the French for still.

You'll want to know: au-dessus

au-dessus — "above".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au-dessus — *au*, "at the", and *dessus*, "on top".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au-dessus*
- *Say it: au-dessus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au-dessus*
- *Recall:* say the French for from now on, then the French for still, then say *au-dessus* again

Before you move on

What does au-dessus mean? ("Above".) Say it once more.

157.2 au-dessous — below

Before the new one: say the French for still, then the French for above.

You'll want to know: au-dessous

au-dessous — "below".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au-dessous — *au*, "at the", and *dessous*, "underneath".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au-dessous*
- *Say it: au-dessous*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au-dessous*
- *Recall:* say the French for still, then the French for above, then say *au-dessous* again

Before you move on

What does au-dessous mean? (“Below”.) Say it once more.

157.3 devant — in front

Before the new one: say the French for above, then the French for below.

You’ll want to know: devant

devant — “in front”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devant — *de* and the word for “before”, ← Late Latin *abante*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: devant*
- *Say it: devant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *devant*
- *Recall:* say the French for above, then the French for below, then say *devant* again

Before you move on

What does devant mean? (“In front”.) Say it once more.

157.4 derrière — behind

Before the new one: say the French for below, then the French for in front.

You'll want to know: derrière

derrière — "behind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

derrière ← Late Latin *de retro*, "from behind" (Lewis & Short for *retro*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: derrière*
- *Say it: derrière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *derrière*
- *Recall:* say the French for below, then the French for in front, then say *derrière* again

Before you move on

What does derrière mean? ("Behind".) Say it once more.

157.5 à côté — beside

Before the new one: say the French for in front, then the French for behind.

You'll want to know: à côté

à côté — "beside".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à côté — *à*, "at", and *côté*, "side", ← Latin *costatum*, from *costa*, "a rib" (EtymDB 2.1): at the side, by the ribs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: à côté*
- *Say it: à côté*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à côté*
- *Recall:* say the French for in front, then the French for behind, then say *à côté* again

Before you move on

What does à côté mean? ("Beside".) Say it once more.

Chapter 158

So, However, Anyway, On the contrary, Although

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say so, however, anyway, on the contrary and although.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say so, however, anyway, on the contrary and although.*

158.1 donc — so, therefore

Before the new one: say the French for behind, then the French for beside.

You'll want to know: donc

donc — "so, therefore".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

donc ← Late Latin *dunc*, "then, so" — inherited. How *dunc* was formed is debated; the usual account blends *tunc*, "then", with *dum*, "while". (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: donc*
- *Say it: donc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *donc*
- *Recall:* say the French for behind, then the French for beside, then say *donc* again

Before you move on

What does donc mean? ("So, therefore".) Say it once more.

158.2 pourtant — however, yet

Before the new one: say the French for beside, then the French for so.

You'll want to know: pourtant

pourtant — "however, yet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourtant — the words for "for" and "so much", the second ← Latin *tantum* (Lewis & Short): "for all that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pourtant*
- *Say it: pourtant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pourtant*
- *Recall:* say the French for beside, then the French for so, then say *pourtant* again

Before you move on

What does pourtant mean? (“However, yet”.) Say it once more.

158.3 de toute façon — anyway

Before the new one: say the French for so, then the French for however.

You’ll want to know: de toute façon

de toute façon — “anyway”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de toute façon — *de*, “in, of”, *toute*, “every”, ← Latin *totus*, and *façon*, “a way”, ← Latin *factio*, *factionis*, “a making” (EtymDB 2.1): in every way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: de toute façon*
- *Say it: de toute façon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *de toute façon*
- *Recall:* say the French for so, then the French for however, then say *de toute façon* again

Before you move on

What does de toute façon mean? (“Anyway”.) Say it once more.

158.4 au contraire — on the contrary

Before the new one: say the French for however, then the French for anyway.

You'll want to know: au contraire

au contraire — "on the contrary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au contraire — *au*, "to the", and *contraire*, "opposite", ← Latin *contrarius*, "lying opposite" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au contraire*
- *Say it: au contraire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au contraire*
- *Recall:* say the French for however, then the French for anyway, then say *au contraire* again

Before you move on

What does au contraire mean? ("On the contrary".) Say it once more.

158.5 bien que — although

Before the new one: say the French for anyway, then the French for on the contrary.

You'll want to know: bien que

bien que — "although".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bien que — *bien*, "well", ← Latin *bene*, and *que*, "that" (EtymDB 2.1): "well that", granted that.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bien que*
- *Say it: bien que*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bien que*
- *Recall:* say the French for anyway, then the French for on the contrary, then say *bien que* again

Before you move on

What does bien que mean? ("Although".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Comfortable, Uncomfortable, Polite, Rude, Unpleasant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude and unpleasant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude and unpleasant.*

159.1 confortable — comfortable

> Before the new one: say the French for on the contrary, then the French for although.

You'll want to know: confortable

confortable — "comfortable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confortable ← English *comfortable* — borrowed in the 1700s. English had built it on Old French *conforter*, "to strengthen", from Latin *fortis*, "strong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: confortable*
- *Say it: confortable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *confortable*
- *Recall:* say the French for on the contrary, then the French for although, then say *confortable* again

Before you move on

What does confortable mean? ("Comfortable".) Say it once more.

159.2 inconfortable — uncomfortable

Before the new one: say the French for although, then the French for comfortable.

You'll want to know: inconfortable

inconfortable — "uncomfortable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inconfortable — *in-*, "not", and *confortable*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inconfortable*
- *Say it: inconfortable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inconfortable*
- *Recall:* say the French for although, then the French for comfortable, then say *inconfortable* again

Before you move on

What does inconfortable mean? (“Uncomfortable”.) Say it once more.

159.3 poli / polie — polite

Before the new one: say the French for comfortable, then the French for uncomfortable.

You’ll want to know: poli / polie

poli / polie — “polite”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poli is the past participle of the verb for “to polish”, ← Latin *polire*, “to smooth” (EtymDB 2.1 gives *politus*, “polished”): good manners are polish.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poli / polie*
- *Say it: poli / polie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poli / polie*
- *Recall:* say the French for comfortable, then the French for uncomfortable, then say *poli / polie* again

Before you move on

What does poli / polie mean? (“Polite”.) Say it once more.

159.4 impoli / impolie — rude

Before the new one: say the French for uncomfortable, then the French for polite.

You'll want to know: impoli / impolie

impoli / impolie — "rude".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impoli — *im-*, "not", and *poli*, "polite".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: impoli / impolie*
- *Say it: impoli / impolie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *impoli / impolie*
- *Recall:* say the French for uncomfortable, then the French for polite, then say *impoli / impolie* again

Before you move on

What does impoli / impolie mean? ("Rude".) Say it once more.

159.5 désagréable — unpleasant

Before the new one: say the French for polite, then the French for rude.

You'll want to know: désagréable

désagréable — "unpleasant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désagréable — *dés-*, "not", and the word for "pleasant", built on Old French *gré*, "liking", ← Latin *gratum*, "pleasing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: désagréable*
- *Say it: désagréable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *désagréable*
- *Recall:* say the French for polite, then the French for rude, then say *désagréable* again

Before you move on

What does désagréable mean? ("Unpleasant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

Deep, Low, Unknown, Dangerous, Safe

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say deep, low, unknown, dangerous and safe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say deep, low, unknown, dangerous and safe.*

160.1 profond / profonde — deep

> Before the new one: say the French for rude, then the French for unpleasant.

You'll want to know: profond / profonde

profond / profonde — "deep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

profond ← Old French *profont* ← Latin *profundus*, "deep", from *pro* and *fundus*, "bottom" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: profond / profonde*
- *Say it: profond / profonde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *profond / profonde*
- *Recall:* say the French for rude, then the French for unpleasant, then say *profond / profonde* again

Before you move on

What does profond / profonde mean? (“Deep”.) Say it once more.

160.2 bas / basse — low

Before the new one: say the French for unpleasant, then the French for deep.

You’ll want to know: bas / basse

bas / basse — “low”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bas ← Late Latin *bassus*, “low, stout” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the adjective behind *baisser*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bas / basse*
- *Say it: bas / basse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bas / basse*
- *Recall:* say the French for unpleasant, then the French for deep, then say *bas / basse* again

Before you move on

What does bas / basse mean? (“Low”.) Say it once more.

160.3 inconnu / inconnue — unknown

Before the new one: say the French for deep, then the French for low.

You’ll want to know: inconnu / inconnue

inconnu / inconnue — “unknown”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inconnu — *in-*, “not”, and *connu*, the past participle of *connaître*: not known.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inconnu / inconnue*
- *Say it: inconnu / inconnue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inconnu / inconnue*
- *Recall:* say the French for deep, then the French for low, then say *inconnu / inconnue* again

Before you move on

What does inconnu / inconnue mean? (“Unknown”.) Say it once more.

160.4 dangereux / dangereuse — dangerous

Before the new one: say the French for low, then the French for unknown.

You'll want to know: dangereux / dangereuse

dangereux / dangereuse — "dangerous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dangereux — built from the word for "danger", with *-eux* (EtymDB 2.1). That word was Old French *dangier*, "the power to harm", from Vulgar Latin **dominiarium*, built on *dominus*, "lord".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dangereux / dangereuse*
- *Say it: dangereux / dangereuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dangereux / dangereuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for low, then the French for unknown, then say *dangereux / dangereuse* again

Before you move on

What does dangereux / dangereuse mean? ("Dangerous".) Say it once more.

160.5 sûr / sûre — safe, sure

Before the new one: say the French for unknown, then the French for dangerous.

You'll want to know: sûr / sûre

sûr / sûre — "safe, sure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sûr ← Old French *seür* ← Latin *securus*, "free from care", from *se-*, "without", and *cura*, "care" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sûr / sûre*
- *Say it: sûr / sûre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sûr / sûre*
- *Recall:* say the French for unknown, then the French for dangerous, then say *sûr / sûre* again

Before you move on

What does sûr / sûre mean? ("Safe, sure".) Say it once more.

160.6 Words from chapters 152-155 — a first pass

Say the words for dangerous and safe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back, to lower
- to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush, to bleed
- health, the brain, a lung, the liver, a kidney
- rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety, love

Before you move on

To admire? (**admirer**.) To act? (**agir**.) To move forward? (**avancer**.) To move back? (**reculer**.) To lower? (**baisser**.) To notice? (**remarquer**.) To replace? (**remplacer**.) To meet? (**rencontrer**.) To blush? (**rougir**.) To bleed? (**saigner**.) Health? (**la santé**.) The brain? (**le cerveau**.) A lung? (**le poumon**.) The

liver? (**le foie**.) A kidney? (**le rein**.) Rest? (**le repos**.) Sleep? (**le sommeil**.) A dream? (**le rêve**.) Anxiety? (**l'angoisse**.) Love? (**l'amour**.)

160.7 Words from chapters 156-160 — a second pass

Say the words for rarely and afterwards.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on, still
- above, below, in front, behind, beside
- so, however, anyway, on the contrary, although
- comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude, unpleasant
- deep, low, unknown, dangerous, safe

Before you move on

Rarely? (**rarement**.) Afterwards? (**ensuite**.) Finally? (**enfin**.) From now on? (**désormais**.) Still? (**encore**.) Above? (**au-dessus**.) Below? (**au-dessous**.) In front? (**devant**.) Behind? (**derrière**.) Beside? (**à côté**.) So? (**donc**.) However? (**pourtant**.) Anyway? (**de toute façon**.) On the contrary? (**au contraire**.) Although? (**bien que**.) Comfortable? (**confortable**.) Uncomfortable? (**inconfortable**.) Polite? (**poli / polie**.) Rude? (**impoli / impolie**.) Unpleasant? (**désagréable**.) Deep? (**profond / profonde**.) Low? (**bas / basse**.) Unknown? (**inconnu / inconnue**.) Dangerous? (**dangereux / dangereuse**.) Safe? (**sûr / sûre**.)

Chapter 161

Modern, Former, Fresh, Spicy, Raw

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say modern, former, fresh, spicy and raw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say modern, former, fresh, spicy and raw.*

161.1 moderne — modern

> Before the new one: say the French for dangerous, then the French for safe, sure.

You'll want to know: moderne

moderne — "modern".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moderne ← Late Latin *modernus*, "of now", from *modo*, "lately" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moderne*
- *Say it: moderne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moderne*
- *Recall:* say the French for dangerous, then the French for safe, sure, then say *moderne* again

Before you move on

What does moderne mean? ("Modern".) Say it once more.

161.2 ancien / ancienne — former, ancient

Before the new one: say the French for safe, sure, then the French for modern.

You'll want to know: ancien / ancienne

ancien / ancienne — "former, ancient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ancien ← Old French *ancien* ← Vulgar Latin **anteanus*, from Latin *ante*, "before" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ancien / ancienne*
- *Say it: ancien / ancienne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ancien / ancienne*
- *Recall:* say the French for safe, sure, then the French for modern, then say *ancien / ancienne* again

Before you move on

What does ancien / ancienne mean? (“Former, ancient”.) Say it once more.

161.3 frais / fraîche — fresh, cool

Before the new one: say the French for modern, then the French for former.

You’ll want to know: frais / fraîche

frais / fraîche — “fresh, cool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frais ← Old French *fres* ← Frankish **frisk*, “fresh” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frais / fraîche*
- *Say it: frais / fraîche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frais / fraîche*
- *Recall:* say the French for modern, then the French for former, then say *frais / fraîche* again

Before you move on

What does frais / fraîche mean? (“Fresh, cool”.) Say it once more.

161.4 épicé / épicée — spicy

Before the new one: say the French for former, then the French for fresh.

You'll want to know: épicé / épicée

épicé / épicée — "spicy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épicé is the past participle of the verb for "to spice", from the word for "spice", ← Latin *species*, "wares, spices" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: épicé / épicée*
- *Say it: épicé / épicée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *épicé / épicée*
- *Recall:* say the French for former, then the French for fresh, then say *épicé / épicée* again

Before you move on

What does épicé / épicée mean? ("Spicy".) Say it once more.

161.5 cru / crue — raw

Before the new one: say the French for fresh, then the French for spicy.

You'll want to know: cru / crue

cru / crue — "raw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cru ← Latin *crudus*, "raw, bloody" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cru / crue*
- *Say it: cru / crue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cru / crue*
- *Recall:* say the French for fresh, then the French for spicy, then say *cru / crue* again

Before you move on

What does cru / crue mean? (“Raw”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

Worried, With a cold, Single, Married, Divorced

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say worried, with a cold, single, married and divorced.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say worried, with a cold, single, married and divorced.*

162.1 inquiet / inquiète — worried

> Before the new one: say the French for spicy, then the French for raw.

You'll want to know: inquiet / inquiète

inquiet / inquiète — "worried".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inquiet ← Latin *inquietus*, "restless", from *in-*, "not", and *quietus*, "calm" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inquiet / inquiète*
- *Say it: inquiet / inquiète*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inquiet / inquiète*
- *Recall:* say the French for spicy, then the French for raw, then say *inquiet / inquiète* again

Before you move on

What does inquiet / inquiète mean? ("Worried".) Say it once more.

162.2 enrhumé / enrhumée — with a cold

Before the new one: say the French for raw, then the French for worried.

You'll want to know: enrhumé / enrhumée

enrhumé / enrhumée — "with a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enrhumé is the past participle of the verb for "to give a cold", built on the word for "a cold", ← Latin *rheuma*, from Greek *rheuma*, "a flow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enrhumé / enrhumée*
- *Say it: enrhumé / enrhumée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enrhumé / enrhumée*
- *Recall:* say the French for raw, then the French for worried, then say *enrhumé / enrhumée* again

Before you move on

What does enrhumé / enrhumée mean? (“With a cold”.) Say it once more.

162.3 célibataire — single

Before the new one: say the French for worried, then the French for with a cold.

You’ll want to know: célibataire

célibataire — “single”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célibataire — built from the word for “celibacy”, ← Latin *caelibatus*, from *caelebs*, “unmarried”, with *-aire*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: célibataire*
- *Say it: célibataire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *célibataire*
- *Recall:* say the French for worried, then the French for with a cold, then say *célibataire* again

Before you move on

What does célibataire mean? (“Single”.) Say it once more.

162.4 marié / mariée — married

Before the new one: say the French for with a cold, then the French for single.

You'll want to know: marié / mariée

marié / mariée — "married".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marié is the past participle of the verb for "to marry", ← Latin *maritare*, from *maritus*, the Latin of *mari* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marié / mariée*
- *Say it: marié / mariée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marié / mariée*
- *Recall:* say the French for with a cold, then the French for single, then say *marié / mariée* again

Before you move on

What does marié / mariée mean? ("Married".) Say it once more.

162.5 divorcé / divorcée — divorced

Before the new one: say the French for single, then the French for married.

You'll want to know: divorcé / divorcée

divorcé / divorcée — "divorced".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

divorcé is the past participle of the verb for "to divorce", from the noun, ← Latin *divortium*, "a separation" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: divorcé / divorcée*
- *Say it: divorcé / divorcée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *divorcé / divorcée*
- *Recall:* say the French for single, then the French for married, then say *divorcé / divorcée* again

Before you move on

What does divorcé / divorcée mean? ("Divorced".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

Flat, Dining room, Balcony, Lock, Doorbell

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock and a doorbell.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock and a doorbell.

163.1 l'appartement — a flat

Before the new one: say the French for married, then the French for divorced.

You'll want to know: l'appartement

l'appartement — "a flat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

appartement ← Italian *appartamento* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; built on Latin *ad* and *pars*, "a part": a set of rooms apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'appartement*
- *Say it: l'appartement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'appartement*
- *Recall:* say the French for married, then the French for divorced, then say *l'appartement* again

Before you move on

What does l'appartement mean? ("A flat".) Say it once more.

163.2 la salle à manger — a dining room

Before the new one: say the French for divorced, then the French for a flat.

You'll want to know: la salle à manger

la salle à manger — "a dining room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle à manger — "room for eating": *salle*, "a room", *à*, "for", and *manger*, "to eat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle à manger*
- *Say it: la salle à manger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle à manger*
- *Recall:* say the French for divorced, then the French for a flat, then say *la salle à manger* again

Before you move on

What does la salle à manger mean? (“A dining room”.) Say it once more.

163.3 le balcon — a balcony

Before the new one: say the French for a flat, then the French for a dining room.

You’ll want to know: le balcon

le balcon — “a balcony”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balcon ← Italian *balcone*, from Lombardic **balko*, “a beam” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le balcon*
- *Say it: le balcon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le balcon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flat, then the French for a dining room, then say *le balcon* again

Before you move on

What does le balcon mean? (“A balcony”.) Say it once more.

163.4 la serrure — a lock

Before the new one: say the French for a dining room, then the French for a balcony.

You'll want to know: la serrure

la serrure — "a lock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serrure — built from the verb for "to squeeze, to shut", ← Late Latin *serare*, "to bolt", from *sera*, "a door bar" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la serrure*
- *Say it: la serrure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la serrure*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dining room, then the French for a balcony, then say *la serrure* again

Before you move on

What does la serrure mean? ("A lock".) Say it once more.

163.5 la sonnette — a doorbell

Before the new one: say the French for a balcony, then the French for a lock.

You'll want to know: la sonnette

la sonnette — "a doorbell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sonnette — built from the verb for "to ring", ← Latin *sonare*, "to sound", with *-ette*, "little". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sonnette*
- *Say it: la sonnette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sonnette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a balcony, then the French for a lock, then say *la sonnette* again

Before you move on

What does la sonnette mean? ("A doorbell".) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

Passport, Customs, Booking, Butcher's, Large river

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's and a large river.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's and a large river.

164.1 le passeport — a passport

Before the new one: say the French for a lock, then the French for a doorbell.

You'll want to know: le passeport

le passeport — "a passport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passeport — the verb for "to pass" and Old French *port*, "a harbour", ← Latin *portus*: leave to pass through a port. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le passeport*
- *Say it: le passeport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le passeport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lock, then the French for a doorbell, then say *le passeport* again

Before you move on

What does le passeport mean? (“A passport”.) Say it once more.

164.2 la douane — customs

Before the new one: say the French for a doorbell, then the French for a passport.

You’ll want to know: la douane

la douane — “customs”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douane ← Old Italian *doana* ← Arabic *diwan*, “a register, an office”, from Persian — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douane*
- *Say it: la douane*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douane*
- *Recall:* say the French for a doorbell, then the French for a passport, then say *la douane* again

Before you move on

What does la douane mean? ("Customs".) Say it once more.

164.3 la réservation — a booking

Before the new one: say the French for a passport, then the French for customs.

You'll want to know: la réservation

la réservation — "a booking".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réservation — built from the verb for "to book", ← Latin *reservare*, "to keep back" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réservation*
- *Say it: la réservation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réservation*
- *Recall:* say the French for a passport, then the French for customs, then say *la réservation* again

Before you move on

What does la réservation mean? ("A booking".) Say it once more.

164.4 la boucherie — a butcher's

Before the new one: say the French for customs, then the French for a booking.

You'll want to know: la boucherie

la boucherie — "a butcher's".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boucherie — built from the word for "butcher", with *-ie*. The butcher was first a seller of goat's meat, from the word for "he-goat". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boucherie*
- *Say it: la boucherie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boucherie*
- *Recall:* say the French for customs, then the French for a booking, then say *la boucherie* again

Before you move on

What does la boucherie mean? ("A butcher's".) Say it once more.

164.5 le fleuve — a large river

Before the new one: say the French for a booking, then the French for a butcher's.

You'll want to know: le fleuve

le fleuve — "a large river".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleuve ← Middle French *fleuve* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *fluvius*, "a river" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fleuve*
- *Say it: le fleuve*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fleuve*
- *Recall:* say the French for a booking, then the French for a butcher's, then say *le fleuve* again

Before you move on

What does le fleuve mean? ("A large river".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

War, Peace, Army, Soldier, Tradition

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say war, peace, an army, a soldier and a tradition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say war, peace, an army, a soldier and a tradition.*

165.1 la guerre — war

Before the new one: say the French for a butcher's, then the French for a large river.

You'll want to know: la guerre

la guerre — "war".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guerre ← Old French *guerre* ← Medieval Latin *werra* (EtymDB 2.1), from Frankish **werra*, "strife" — borrowed from the Franks; Germanic *w-* became French *gu-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guerre*
- *Say it: la guerre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la guerre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butcher's, then the French for a large river, then say *la guerre* again

Before you move on

What does la guerre mean? ("War".) Say it once more.

165.2 la paix — peace

Before the new one: say the French for a large river, then the French for war.

You'll want to know: la paix

la paix — "peace".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paix ← Old French *pais* ← Latin *pax*, *pacis*, "peace" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *pax* behind *payer*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la paix*
- *Say it: la paix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la paix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a large river, then the French for war, then say *la paix* again

Before you move on

What does la paix mean? (“Peace”.) Say it once more.

165.3 l’armée — an army

Before the new one: say the French for war, then the French for peace.

You’ll want to know: l’armée

l’armée — “an army”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

armée is the past participle of the verb for “to arm”, used as a noun: a force that is armed. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Medieval Latin *armata*, “an armed force”.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’armée*
- *Say it: l’armée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’armée*
- *Recall:* say the French for war, then the French for peace, then say *l’armée* again

Before you move on

What does l’armée mean? (“An army”.) Say it once more.

165.4 le soldat — a soldier

Before the new one: say the French for peace, then the French for an army.

You'll want to know: le soldat

le soldat — "a soldier".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soldat ← Italian *soldato*, "one who is paid", from *soldo*, "pay", ← Late Latin *solidus*, a gold coin — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soldat*
- *Say it: le soldat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le soldat*
- *Recall:* say the French for peace, then the French for an army, then say *le soldat* again

Before you move on

What does le soldat mean? ("A soldier".) Say it once more.

165.5 la tradition — a tradition

Before the new one: say the French for an army, then the French for a soldier.

You'll want to know: la tradition

la tradition — "a tradition".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tradition ← Old French *tradicion* ← Latin *traditio*, "a handing over" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tradition*
- *Say it: la tradition*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tradition*
- *Recall:* say the French for an army, then the French for a soldier, then say *la tradition* again

Before you move on

What does la tradition mean? ("A tradition".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

Photographer, Journalist, Architect, Dentist, Pharmacist

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist and a pharmacist.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist and a pharmacist.

166.1 le photographe — a photographer

Before the new one: say the French for a soldier, then the French for a tradition.

You'll want to know: le photographe

le photographe — "a photographer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photographe — built like *photo*, from Greek *phos*, *photos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write": one who writes with light.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le photographe*
- *Say it: le photographe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le photographe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a soldier, then the French for a tradition, then say *le photographe* again

Before you move on

What does le photographe mean? ("A photographer".) Say it once more.

166.2 le journaliste — a journalist

Before the new one: say the French for a tradition, then the French for a photographer.

You'll want to know: le journaliste

le journaliste — "a journalist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

journaliste — built from the word for "a newspaper", itself built on *jour*, "day": a daily record.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le journaliste*
- *Say it: le journaliste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le journaliste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tradition, then the French for a photographer, then say *le journaliste* again

Before you move on

What does le journaliste mean? (“A journalist”.) Say it once more.

166.3 l’architecte — an architect

Before the new one: say the French for a photographer, then the French for a journalist.

You’ll want to know: l’architecte

l’architecte — “an architect”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

architecte ← Latin *architectus*, from Greek *architekton*, “chief builder” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’architecte*
- *Say it: l’architecte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’architecte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a photographer, then the French for a journalist, then say *l’architecte* again

Before you move on

What does l’architecte mean? (“An architect”.) Say it once more.

166.4 le dentiste — a dentist

Before the new one: say the French for a journalist, then the French for an architect.

You'll want to know: le dentiste

le dentiste — "a dentist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dentiste — *dent*, "tooth", with *-iste*, "one who works with".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dentiste*
- *Say it: le dentiste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dentiste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a journalist, then the French for an architect, then say *le dentiste* again

Before you move on

What does le dentiste mean? ("A dentist".) Say it once more.

166.5 le pharmacien — a pharmacist

Before the new one: say the French for an architect, then the French for a dentist.

You'll want to know: le pharmacien

le pharmacien — "a pharmacist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pharmacien — *pharmacie* with *-ien*, "one who works in".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pharmacien*
- *Say it: le pharmacien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pharmacien*
- *Recall:* say the French for an architect, then the French for a dentist, then say *le pharmacien* again

Before you move on

What does le pharmacien mean? (“A pharmacist”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

Mother-in-law, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law, Fiancé, Fiancée

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé and a fiancée.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé and a fiancée.*

167.1 la belle-mère — a mother-in-law

> Before the new one: say the French for a dentist, then the French for a pharmacist.

You'll want to know: la belle-mère

la belle-mère — "a mother-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

belle-mère — the feminine of the word for "beautiful", ← Latin *bella*, used as a courtesy, and *mère*, "mother".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la belle-mère*
- *Say it: la belle-mère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la belle-mère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dentist, then the French for a pharmacist, then say *la belle-mère* again

Before you move on

What does la belle-mère mean? ("A mother-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.2 le gendre — a son-in-law

Before the new one: say the French for a pharmacist, then the French for a mother-in-law.

You'll want to know: le gendre

le gendre — "a son-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gendre ← Latin *gener*, "son-in-law" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; French slipped a *d* between *n* and *r*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gendre*
- *Say it: le gendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pharmacist, then the French for a mother-in-law, then say *le gendre* again

Before you move on

What does le gendre mean? ("A son-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.3 la belle-fille — a daughter-in-law

Before the new one: say the French for a mother-in-law, then the French for a son-in-law.

You'll want to know: la belle-fille

la belle-fille — "a daughter-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

belle-fille — the feminine of the word for "beautiful", ← Latin *bella*, used as a courtesy, and *fille*, "daughter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la belle-fille*
- *Say it: la belle-fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la belle-fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mother-in-law, then the French for a son-in-law, then say *la belle-fille* again

Before you move on

What does la belle-fille mean? ("A daughter-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.4 le fiancé — a fiancé

Before the new one: say the French for a son-in-law, then the French for a daughter-in-law.

You'll want to know: le fiancé

le fiancé — "a fiancé".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiancé is the past participle of the verb for "to betroth", built on Old French *fiance*, "a promise", from Vulgar Latin **fidare*, "to trust", from Latin *fides*, "faith" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fiancé*
- *Say it: le fiancé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fiancé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a son-in-law, then the French for a daughter-in-law, then say *le fiancé* again

Before you move on

What does le fiancé mean? ("A fiancé".) Say it once more.

167.5 la fiancée — a fiancée

Before the new one: say the French for a daughter-in-law, then the French for a fiancé.

You'll want to know: la fiancée

la fiancée — "a fiancée".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiancée is the feminine of *fiancé*: the woman promised in marriage.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fiancée*
- *Say it: la fiancée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fiancée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a daughter-in-law, then the French for a fiancé, then say *la fiancée* again

Before you move on

What does la fiancée mean? ("A fiancée".) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

Rule, Permission, Ban, Safety, Advice

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rule, permission, a ban, safety and advice.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say a rule, permission, a ban, safety and advice.

168.1 la règle — a rule

Before the new one: say the French for a fiancé, then the French for a fiancée.

You'll want to know: la règle

la règle — "a rule".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

règle ← Latin *regula*, "a straight stick, a rule", from *regere*, "to guide" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la règle*
- *Say it: la règle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la règle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fiancé, then the French for a fiancée, then say *la règle* again

Before you move on

What does la règle mean? ("A rule".) Say it once more.

168.2 la permission — permission

Before the new one: say the French for a fiancée, then the French for a rule.

You'll want to know: la permission

la permission — "permission".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permission ← Latin *permissio*, "a letting go, leave", from *permittere* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la permission*
- *Say it: la permission*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la permission*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fiancée, then the French for a rule, then say *la permission* again

Before you move on

What does la permission mean? ("Permission".) Say it once more.

168.3 l'interdiction — a ban

Before the new one: say the French for a rule, then the French for permission.

You'll want to know: l'interdiction

l'interdiction — "a ban".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interdiction ← Latin *interdictio*, "a forbidding", from *interdicere* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'interdiction*
- *Say it: l'interdiction*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'interdiction*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rule, then the French for permission, then say *l'interdiction* again

Before you move on

What does l'interdiction mean? ("A ban".) Say it once more.

168.4 la sécurité — safety

Before the new one: say the French for permission, then the French for a ban.

You'll want to know: la sécurité

la sécurité — "safety".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sécurité ← Latin *securitas*, "freedom from care", from *securus* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the same *securus* wore down into *sûr*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sécurité*
- *Say it: la sécurité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sécurité*
- *Recall:* say the French for permission, then the French for a ban, then say *la sécurité* again

Before you move on

What does la sécurité mean? ("Safety".) Say it once more.

168.5 le conseil — advice

Before the new one: say the French for a ban, then the French for safety.

You'll want to know: le conseil

le conseil — "advice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conseil ← Old French *conseil* ← Latin *consilium*, "advice, a plan, a council" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le conseil*
- *Say it: le conseil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le conseil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ban, then the French for safety, then say *le conseil* again

Before you move on

What does le conseil mean? ("Advice".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Postcard, Folder, Pay slip, Label, Guide

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label and a guide.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label and a guide.*

169.1 la carte postale — a postcard

> Before the new one: say the French for safety, then the French for advice.

You'll want to know: la carte postale

la carte postale — "a postcard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte postale — "postal card": *carte*, "card", and the adjective made from *poste*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte postale*
- *Say it: la carte postale*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte postale*
- *Recall:* say the French for safety, then the French for advice, then say *la carte postale* again

Before you move on

What does la carte postale mean? ("A postcard".) Say it once more.

169.2 le dossier — a folder, a file

Before the new one: say the French for advice, then the French for a postcard.

You'll want to know: le dossier

le dossier — "a folder, a file".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dossier — built from the word for "back", ← Latin *dorsum* (Lewis & Short), with *-ier*: a bundle labelled on its back.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dossier*
- *Say it: le dossier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dossier*
- *Recall:* say the French for advice, then the French for a postcard, then say *le dossier* again

Before you move on

What does le dossier mean? (“A folder, a file”.) Say it once more.

169.3 la fiche de paie — a pay slip

Before the new one: say the French for a postcard, then the French for a folder.

You’ll want to know: la fiche de paie

la fiche de paie — “a pay slip”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiche de paie — “slip of pay”: *fiche*, “a slip, a peg”, from the verb for “to fix” (EtymDB 2.1); *de*, “of”; and *paie*, “pay”, from *payer*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fiche de paie*
- *Say it: la fiche de paie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fiche de paie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a postcard, then the French for a folder, then say *la fiche de paie* again

Before you move on

What does la fiche de paie mean? (“A pay slip”.) Say it once more.

169.4 l’étiquette — a label

Before the new one: say the French for a folder, then the French for a pay slip.

You'll want to know: l'étiquette

l'étiquette — "a label".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étiquette ← Old French *estiquette*, "a note stuck on", from *estechier*, "to stick, to attach", a Germanic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étiquette*
- *Say it: l'étiquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étiquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a folder, then the French for a pay slip, then say *l'étiquette* again

Before you move on

What does l'étiquette mean? ("A label".) Say it once more.

169.5 le guide — a guide, a guidebook

Before the new one: say the French for a pay slip, then the French for a label.

You'll want to know: le guide

le guide — "a guide, a guidebook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guide ← Old Provençal *guida*, from *guidar*, "to guide", from Frankish **witan*, "to show the way" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le guide*
- *Say it: le guide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le guide*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pay slip, then the French for a label, then say *le guide* again

Before you move on

What does le guide mean? ("A guide, a guidebook".) Say it once more.

169.6 Words from chapters 161-164 — a first pass

Say the words for a label and a guide.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- modern, former, fresh, spicy, raw
- worried, with a cold, single, married, divorced
- a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock, a doorbell
- a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's, a large river

Before you move on

Modern? (**moderne**.) Former? (**ancien / ancienne**.) Fresh? (**frais / fraîche**.) Spicy? (**épicé / épicée**.) Raw? (**cru / crue**.) Worried? (**inquiet / inquiète**.) With a cold? (**enrhumé / enrhumée**.) Single? (**célibataire**.) Married? (**marié / mariée**.)

Divorced? (**divorcé / divorcée**.) A flat? (**l'appartement**.) A dining room? (**la salle à manger**.) A balcony? (**le balcon**.) A lock? (**la serrure**.) A doorbell? (**la sonnette**.) A passport? (**le passeport**.) Customs? (**la douane**.) A booking? (**la réservation**.) A butcher's? (**la boucherie**.) A large river? (**le fleuve**.)

169.7 Words from chapters 165-169 — a second pass

Say the words for war and peace.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- war, peace, an army, a soldier, a tradition
- a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist, a pharmacist
- a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé, a fiancée
- a rule, permission, a ban, safety, advice
- a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label, a guide

Before you move on

War? (**la guerre**.) Peace? (**la paix**.) An army? (**l'armée**.) A soldier? (**le soldat**.) A tradition? (**la tradition**.) A photographer? (**le photographe**.) A journalist? (**le journaliste**.) An architect? (**l'architecte**.) A dentist? (**le dentiste**.) A pharmacist? (**le pharmacien**.) A mother-in-law? (**la belle-mère**.) A son-in-law? (**le gendre**.) A daughter-in-law? (**la belle-fille**.) A fiancé? (**le fiancé**.) A fiancée? (**la fiancée**.) A rule? (**la règle**.) Permission? (**la permission**.) A ban? (**l'interdiction**.) Safety? (**la sécurité**.) Advice? (**le conseil**.) A postcard? (**la carte postale**.) A folder? (**le dossier**.) A pay slip? (**la fiche de paie**.) A label? (**l'étiquette**.) A guide? (**le guide**.)

Chapter 170

Castle, Tower, Monument, Statue, Fountain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue and a fountain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue and a fountain.*

170.1 le château — a castle

> Before the new one: say the French for a label, then the French for a guide, a guidebook.

You'll want to know: le château

le château — "a castle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

château ← Old French *chastel* ← Latin *castellum*, "a fort" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*, and the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le château*
- *Say it: le château*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le château*
- *Recall:* say the French for a label, then the French for a guide, a guidebook, then say *le château* again

Before you move on

What does le château mean? (“A castle”.) Say it once more.

170.2 la tour — a tower

Before the new one: say the French for a guide, a guidebook, then the French for a castle.

You’ll want to know: la tour

la tour — “a tower”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tour ← Old French *tor* ← Latin *turris*, “a tower”, from Greek — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tour*
- *Say it: la tour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guide, a guidebook, then the French for a castle, then say *la tour* again

Before you move on

What does la tour mean? (“A tower”.) Say it once more.

170.3 le monument — a monument

Before the new one: say the French for a castle, then the French for a tower.

You’ll want to know: le monument

le monument — “a monument”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monument ← Latin *monumentum*, “a memorial”, from *monere*, “to remind” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le monument*
- *Say it: le monument*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le monument*
- *Recall:* say the French for a castle, then the French for a tower, then say *le monument* again

Before you move on

What does le monument mean? (“A monument”.) Say it once more.

170.4 la statue — a statue

Before the new one: say the French for a tower, then the French for a monument.

You'll want to know: la statue

la statue — "a statue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

statue ← Latin *statua*, "a standing image", from *stare*, "to stand" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la statue*
- *Say it: la statue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la statue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tower, then the French for a monument, then say *la statue* again

Before you move on

What does la statue mean? ("A statue".) Say it once more.

170.5 la fontaine — a fountain

Before the new one: say the French for a monument, then the French for a statue.

You'll want to know: la fontaine

la fontaine — "a fountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fontaine ← Late Latin *fontana*, from *fons*, *fontis*, "a spring" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fontaine*
- *Say it: la fontaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fontaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a monument, then the French for a statue, then say *la fontaine* again

Before you move on

What does la fontaine mean? ("A fountain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock and a pebble.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock and a pebble.*

171.1 le volcan — a volcano

Before the new one: say the French for a statue, then the French for a fountain.

You'll want to know: le volcan

le volcan — "a volcano".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

volcan ← Italian *vulcano*, from Latin *Vulcanus*, the god of fire — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin name.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le volcan*
- *Say it: le volcan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le volcan*
- *Recall:* say the French for a statue, then the French for a fountain, then say *le volcan* again

Before you move on

What does le volcan mean? (“A volcano”.) Say it once more.

171.2 la plaine — a plain

Before the new one: say the French for a fountain, then the French for a volcano.

You’ll want to know: la plaine

la plaine — “a plain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plaine ← Latin *plana*, “flat”, the feminine of *planus* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plaine*
- *Say it: la plaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fountain, then the French for a volcano, then say *la plaine* again

Before you move on

What does la plaine mean? ("A plain".) Say it once more.

171.3 la cascade — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the French for a volcano, then the French for a plain.

You'll want to know: la cascade

la cascade — "a waterfall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cascade ← Italian *cascata*, from *cascare*, "to fall" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cascade*
- *Say it: la cascade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cascade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a volcano, then the French for a plain, then say *la cascade* again

Before you move on

What does la cascade mean? ("A waterfall".) Say it once more.

171.4 le rocher — a rock

Before the new one: say the French for a plain, then the French for a waterfall.

You'll want to know: le rocher

le rocher — "a rock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rocher ← Old French *rochier*, built from the word for "rock", ← Medieval Latin *rocca*, whose origin is unknown. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rocher*
- *Say it: le rocher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rocher*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plain, then the French for a waterfall, then say *le rocher* again

Before you move on

What does le rocher mean? ("A rock".) Say it once more.

171.5 le caillou — a pebble

Before the new one: say the French for a waterfall, then the French for a rock.

You'll want to know: le caillou

le caillou — "a pebble".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caillou ← Norman French *caillou* (EtymDB 2.1), from a Gaulish word for "stone" — borrowed from the dialects.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caillou*
- *Say it: le caillou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le caillou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a waterfall, then the French for a rock, then say *le caillou* again

Before you move on

What does le caillou mean? ("A pebble".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Plastic, Cotton, Wool, Silk, Leather

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say plastic, cotton, wool, silk and leather.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say plastic, cotton, wool, silk and leather.*

172.1 le plastique — plastic

> Before the new one: say the French for a rock, then the French for a pebble.

You'll want to know: le plastique

le plastique — "plastic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plastique ← Latin *plasticus*, "of moulding", from Greek *plastikos* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plastique*
- *Say it: le plastique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plastique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rock, then the French for a pebble, then say *le plastique* again

Before you move on

What does le plastique mean? ("Plastic".) Say it once more.

172.2 le coton — cotton

Before the new one: say the French for a pebble, then the French for plastic.

You'll want to know: le coton

le coton — "cotton".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coton ← Italian *cotone* ← Arabic *qutn* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coton*
- *Say it: le coton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le coton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pebble, then the French for plastic, then say *le coton* again

Before you move on

What does le coton mean? (“Cotton”.) Say it once more.

172.3 la laine — wool

Before the new one: say the French for plastic, then the French for cotton.

You’ll want to know: la laine

la laine — “wool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laine ← Old French *lainne* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *lana*, “wool” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the stressed *a* became *ai*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la laine*
- *Say it: la laine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la laine*
- *Recall:* say the French for plastic, then the French for cotton, then say *la laine* again

Before you move on

What does la laine mean? (“Wool”.) Say it once more.

172.4 la soie — silk

Before the new one: say the French for cotton, then the French for wool.

You'll want to know: la soie

la soie — "silk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soie ← Latin *saeta*, "a bristle, a stiff hair", later a silk thread — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soie*
- *Say it: la soie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soie*
- *Recall:* say the French for cotton, then the French for wool, then say *la soie* again

Before you move on

What does la soie mean? ("Silk".) Say it once more.

172.5 le cuir — leather

Before the new one: say the French for wool, then the French for silk.

You'll want to know: le cuir

le cuir — "leather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuir ← Latin *corium*, "hide, leather" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cuir*
- *Say it: le cuir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cuir*
- *Recall:* say the French for wool, then the French for silk, then say *le cuir* again

Before you move on

What does le cuir mean? (“Leather”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming and a victory.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming and a victory.*

173.1 le ballon — a ball

> Before the new one: say the French for silk, then the French for leather.

You'll want to know: le ballon

le ballon — "a ball".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ballon ← Italian *pallone*, "a big ball", reshaped after the French word for "ball" — borrowed in the 1500s. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le ballon*
- *Say it: le ballon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le ballon*
- *Recall:* say the French for silk, then the French for leather, then say *le ballon* again

Before you move on

What does le ballon mean? (“A ball”.) Say it once more.

173.2 la raquette — a racket

Before the new one: say the French for leather, then the French for a ball.

You’ll want to know: la raquette

la raquette — “a racket”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raquette ← Medieval Latin *rasceta*, from Arabic *raha*, “the palm of the hand” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la raquette*
- *Say it: la raquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la raquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for leather, then the French for a ball, then say *la raquette* again

Before you move on

What does la raquette mean? (“A racket”.) Say it once more.

173.3 la salle de sport — a gym

Before the new one: say the French for a ball, then the French for a racket.

You’ll want to know: la salle de sport

la salle de sport — “a gym”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle de sport — “room of sport”: *salle*, *de* and *sport*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle de sport*
- *Say it: la salle de sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle de sport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ball, then the French for a racket, then say *la salle de sport* again

Before you move on

What does la salle de sport mean? (“A gym”.) Say it once more.

173.4 la natation — swimming

Before the new one: say the French for a racket, then the French for a gym.

You'll want to know: la natation

la natation — "swimming".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

natation ← Latin *natatio*, "swimming", from *natare*, "to swim" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la natation*
- *Say it: la natation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la natation*
- *Recall:* say the French for a racket, then the French for a gym, then say *la natation* again

Before you move on

What does la natation mean? ("Swimming".) Say it once more.

173.5 la victoire — a victory

Before the new one: say the French for a gym, then the French for swimming.

You'll want to know: la victoire

la victoire — "a victory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

victoire ← Latin *victoria*, "victory", from *vincere*, "to conquer" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la victoire*
- *Say it: la victoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la victoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a gym, then the French for swimming, then say *la victoire* again

Before you move on

What does la victoire mean? ("A victory".) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting and a contract.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting and a contract.*

174.1 l'entreprise — a company

> Before the new one: say the French for swimming, then the French for a victory.

You'll want to know: l'entreprise

l'entreprise — "a company".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entreprise is the past participle of the verb for "to undertake", built from *entre-* and *prendre*, "to take": a thing taken in hand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entreprise*
- *Say it: l'entreprise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entreprise*
- *Recall:* say the French for swimming, then the French for a victory, then say *l'entreprise* again

Before you move on

What does l'entreprise mean? ("A company".) Say it once more.

174.2 le collègue — a colleague

Before the new one: say the French for a victory, then the French for a company.

You'll want to know: le collègue

le collègue — "a colleague".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

collègue ← Latin *collega*, "a partner in office" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le collègue*
- *Say it: le collègue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le collègue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a victory, then the French for a company, then say *le collègue* again

Before you move on

What does le collègue mean? (“A colleague”.) Say it once more.

174.3 le salaire — a salary

Before the new one: say the French for a company, then the French for a colleague.

You’ll want to know: le salaire

le salaire — “a salary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salaire ← Latin *salarium*, “wages”, first “salt money”, from *sal*, “salt” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le salaire*
- *Say it: le salaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le salaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a company, then the French for a colleague, then say *le salaire* again

Before you move on

What does le salaire mean? (“A salary”.) Say it once more.

174.4 la réunion — a meeting

Before the new one: say the French for a colleague, then the French for a salary.

You'll want to know: la réunion

la réunion — "a meeting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réunion — formed from the verb for "to reunite", built on the verb for "to unite", ← Latin *unire*, from *unus*, "one". (EtymDB 2.1 links it to the verb.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réunion*
- *Say it: la réunion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réunion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a colleague, then the French for a salary, then say *la réunion* again

Before you move on

What does la réunion mean? ("A meeting".) Say it once more.

174.5 le contrat — a contract

Before the new one: say the French for a salary, then the French for a meeting.

You'll want to know: le contrat

le contrat — "a contract".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contrat ← Old French *contract* ← Latin *contractum*, "a thing drawn together, an agreement" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le contrat*
- *Say it: le contrat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le contrat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a salary, then the French for a meeting, then say *le contrat* again

Before you move on

What does le contrat mean? ("A contract".) Say it once more.

174.6 Words from chapters 170-171 — a first pass

Say the words for a meeting and a contract.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue, a fountain
- a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock, a pebble

Before you move on

A castle? (**le château**.) A tower? (**la tour**.) A monument? (**le monument**.) A statue? (**la statue**.) A fountain? (**la fontaine**.) A volcano? (**le volcan**.) A plain? (**la plaine**.) A waterfall? (**la cascade**.) A rock? (**le rocher**.) A pebble? (**le caillou**.)

174.7 Words from chapters 172-174 — a second pass

Say the words for plastic and cotton.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- plastic, cotton, wool, silk, leather
- a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming, a victory
- a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting, a contract

Before you move on

Plastic? (**le plastique**.) Cotton? (**le coton**.) Wool? (**la laine**.) Silk? (**la soie**.) Leather? (**le cuir**.) A ball? (**le ballon**.) A racket? (**la raquette**.) A gym? (**la salle de sport**.) Swimming? (**la natation**.) A victory? (**la victoire**.) A company? (**l'entreprise**.) A colleague? (**le collègue**.) A salary? (**le salaire**.) A meeting? (**la réunion**.) A contract? (**le contrat**.)

Chapter 175

To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite and to park.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite and to park.*

175.1 embrasser — to kiss

> Before the new one: say the French for a meeting, then the French for a contract.

You'll want to know: embrasser

embrasser — "to kiss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embrasser — built from *em-*, "into", and *bras*, "arm": to take into the arms, now to kiss.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: embrasser*
- *Say it: embrasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *embrasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a meeting, then the French for a contract, then say *embrasser* again

Before you move on

What does embrasser mean? ("To kiss".) Say it once more.

175.2 saluer — to greet

Before the new one: say the French for a contract, then the French for to kiss.

You'll want to know: saluer

saluer — "to greet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saluer ← Latin *salutare*, "to greet, to wish health", from *salus*, "health" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saluer*
- *Say it: saluer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saluer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a contract, then the French for to kiss, then say *saluer* again

Before you move on

What does saluer mean? (“To greet”.) Say it once more.

175.3 remercier — to thank

Before the new one: say the French for to kiss, then the French for to greet.

You’ll want to know: remercier

remercier — “to thank”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remercier — built from *re-* and the old verb for “to thank”, made from *merci*, “thank you”. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remercier*
- *Say it: remercier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remercier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to kiss, then the French for to greet, then say *remercier* again

Before you move on

What does remercier mean? (“To thank”.) Say it once more.

175.4 inviter — to invite

Before the new one: say the French for to greet, then the French for to thank.

You'll want to know: inviter

inviter — "to invite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inviter ← Latin *invitare*, "to invite" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inviter*
- *Say it: inviter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inviter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to greet, then the French for to thank, then say *inviter* again

Before you move on

What does inviter mean? ("To invite".) Say it once more.

175.5 garer — to park

Before the new one: say the French for to thank, then the French for to invite.

You'll want to know: garer

garer — "to park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garer ← Old French *garer*, *warer*, "to shelter, to guard" (EtymDB 2.1), from a Germanic verb meaning "to watch over" — borrowed: to park is to put in shelter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: garer*
- *Say it: garer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to thank, then the French for to invite, then say *garer* again

Before you move on

What does garer mean? ("To park".) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to stop, to change, to move, to take off and to hold.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say to stop, to change, to move, to take off and to hold.

176.1 arrêter — to stop

Before the new one: say the French for to invite, then the French for to park.

You'll want to know: arrêter

arrêter — "to stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrêter ← Old French *arester* ← Vulgar Latin **arrestare*, from *ad* and *restare*, "to stay back" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arrêter*
- *Say it: arrêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arrêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to invite, then the French for to park, then say *arrêter* again

Before you move on

What does arrêter mean? ("To stop".) Say it once more.

176.2 changer — to change

Before the new one: say the French for to park, then the French for to stop.

You'll want to know: changer

changer — "to change".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

changer ← Old French *changier* ← Late Latin *cambiare*, "to exchange", a word Latin took from Gaulish — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: changer*
- *Say it: changer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *changer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to park, then the French for to stop, then say *changer* again

Before you move on

What does changer mean? ("To change".) Say it once more.

176.3 déplacer — to move (something)

Before the new one: say the French for to stop, then the French for to change.

You'll want to know: déplacer

déplacer — "to move (something)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déplacer — built from *dé-* and the word for "a place", ← Latin *platea*, "a broad street" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déplacer*
- *Say it: déplacer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déplacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stop, then the French for to change, then say *déplacer* again

Before you move on

What does déplacer mean? ("To move (something)".) Say it once more.

176.4 enlever — to take off, to remove

Before the new one: say the French for to change, then the French for to move.

You'll want to know: enlever

enlever — "to take off, to remove".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enlever — built from *en*, "away", and *lever*, "to lift", ← Latin *levare*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enlever*
- *Say it: enlever*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enlever*
- *Recall:* say the French for to change, then the French for to move, then say *enlever* again

Before you move on

What does enlever mean? ("To take off, to remove".) Say it once more.

176.5 tenir — to hold

Before the new one: say the French for to move, then the French for to take off.

You'll want to know: tenir

tenir — "to hold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tenir ← Vulgar Latin **tenire* ← Latin *tenere*, "to hold" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tenir*
- *Say it: tenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move, then the French for to take off, then say *tenir* again

Before you move on

What does tenir mean? ("To hold".) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect and to rescue.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect and to rescue.

177.1 promettre — to promise

Before the new one: say the French for to take off, then the French for to hold.

You'll want to know: promettre

promettre — "to promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

promettre ← Old French *prometre* ← Latin *promittere*, "to send forward, to promise" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *mettre* with *pro-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: promettre*
- *Say it: promettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *promettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take off, then the French for to hold, then say *promettre* again

Before you move on

What does promettre mean? ("To promise".) Say it once more.

177.2 permettre — to allow

Before the new one: say the French for to hold, then the French for to promise.

You'll want to know: permettre

permettre — "to allow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permettre ← Latin *permittere*, "to let through, to allow" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, reshaped on *mettre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: permettre*
- *Say it: permettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *permettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hold, then the French for to promise, then say *permettre* again

Before you move on

What does permettre mean? (“To allow”.) Say it once more.

177.3 interdire — to forbid

Before the new one: say the French for to promise, then the French for to allow.

You’ll want to know: interdire

interdire — “to forbid”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interdire ← Latin *interdicere*, “to forbid”, from *inter*, “between”, and *dicere*, “to say” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interdire*
- *Say it: interdire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interdire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to promise, then the French for to allow, then say *interdire* again

Before you move on

What does interdire mean? (“To forbid”.) Say it once more.

177.4 protéger — to protect

Before the new one: say the French for to allow, then the French for to forbid.

You'll want to know: protéger

protéger — "to protect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

protéger ← Latin *protegere*, "to cover in front" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: protéger*
- *Say it: protéger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *protéger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to allow, then the French for to forbid, then say *protéger* again

Before you move on

What does protéger mean? ("To protect".) Say it once more.

177.5 sauver — to rescue

Before the new one: say the French for to forbid, then the French for to protect.

You'll want to know: sauver

sauver — "to rescue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauver ← Late Latin *salvare*, "to save", from *salvus*, "safe" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauver*
- *Say it: sauver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to forbid, then the French for to protect, then say *sauver* again

Before you move on

What does sauver mean? ("To rescue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to snow, to go with, to add, to announce and to appear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say to snow, to go with, to add, to announce and to appear.*

178.1 neiger — to snow

Before the new one: say the French for to protect, then the French for to rescue.

You'll want to know: neiger

neiger — "to snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neiger ← Vulgar Latin **nivicare*, from Latin *nix*, *nivis*, "snow" — inherited; *neige* was made from it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neiger*
- *Say it: neiger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neiger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to protect, then the French for to rescue, then say *neiger* again

Before you move on

What does neiger mean? (“To snow”.) Say it once more.

178.2 accompagner — to go with

Before the new one: say the French for to rescue, then the French for to snow.

You’ll want to know: accompagner

accompagner — “to go with”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accompagner ← Old French *acompagner*, built on *compaing*, “a companion” (EtymDB 2.1), from Late Latin *companio*, “one who shares bread”, from *panis*, the Latin of *pain*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: accompagner*
- *Say it: accompagner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *accompagner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rescue, then the French for to snow, then say *accompagner* again

Before you move on

What does accompagner mean? ("To go with".) Say it once more.

178.3 ajouter — to add

Before the new one: say the French for to snow, then the French for to go with.

You'll want to know: ajouter

ajouter — "to add".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ajouter ← Old French *ajouster* ← Vulgar Latin **adiuxtare*, "to put beside", from Latin *iuxta*, "next to" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ajouter*
- *Say it: ajouter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ajouter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to snow, then the French for to go with, then say *ajouter* again

Before you move on

What does ajouter mean? ("To add".) Say it once more.

178.4 annoncer — to announce

Before the new one: say the French for to go with, then the French for to add.

You'll want to know: annoncer

annoncer — "to announce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annoncer ← Old French *anoncier* ← Latin *annuntiare*, "to make known", from *nuntius*, "a messenger" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: annoncer*
- *Say it: annoncer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *annoncer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go with, then the French for to add, then say *annoncer* again

Before you move on

What does annoncer mean? ("To announce".) Say it once more.

178.5 apparaître — to appear

Before the new one: say the French for to add, then the French for to announce.

You'll want to know: apparaître

apparaître — "to appear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apparaître ← Old French *aparoistre* ← Late Latin *apparescere*, from Latin *apparere*, "to appear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *apparaître*
- *Say it:* *apparaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apparaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to add, then the French for to announce, then say *apparaître* again

Before you move on

What does apparaître mean? ("To appear".) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw and to turn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw and to turn.*

179.1 dépendre — to depend

Before the new one: say the French for to announce, then the French for to appear.

You'll want to know: dépendre

dépendre — "to depend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépendre ← Latin *dependere*, "to hang from" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dépendre*
- *Say it:* *dépendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to announce, then the French for to appear, then say *dépendre* again

Before you move on

What does dépendre mean? ("To depend".) Say it once more.

179.2 partager — to share

Before the new one: say the French for to appear, then the French for to depend.

You'll want to know: partager

partager — "to share".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partager — built from the word for "a share", from the word for "a part", ← Latin *pars*, *partis* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *partager*
- *Say it:* *partager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partager*
- *Recall:* say the French for to appear, then the French for to depend, then say *partager* again

Before you move on

What does partager mean? ("To share".) Say it once more.

179.3 éviter — to avoid

Before the new one: say the French for to depend, then the French for to share.

You'll want to know: éviter

éviter — "to avoid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éviter ← Latin *evitare*, "to shun" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: éviter*
- *Say it: éviter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *éviter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to depend, then the French for to share, then say *éviter* again

Before you move on

What does éviter mean? ("To avoid".) Say it once more.

179.4 lancer — to throw

Before the new one: say the French for to share, then the French for to avoid.

You'll want to know: lancer

lancer — "to throw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lancer ← Old French *lancier* ← Late Latin *lanceare*, "to wield a lance", from *lancea*, "a lance" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lancer*
- *Say it: lancer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to share, then the French for to avoid, then say *lancer* again

Before you move on

What does lancer mean? ("To throw".) Say it once more.

179.5 tourner — to turn

Before the new one: say the French for to avoid, then the French for to throw.

You'll want to know: tourner

tourner — "to turn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tourner ← Old French *torner* ← Latin *tornare*, "to turn on a lathe", from *tornus*, "a lathe" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tourner*
- *Say it: tourner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to avoid, then the French for to throw, then say *tourner* again

Before you move on

What does tourner mean? ("To turn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose and to pick up.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose and to pick up.

180.1 préparer — to prepare

Before the new one: say the French for to throw, then the French for to turn.

You'll want to know: préparer

préparer — "to prepare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préparer ← Latin *praeparare*, "to make ready beforehand" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: préparer*
- *Say it: préparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *préparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to throw, then the French for to turn, then say *préparer* again

Before you move on

What does préparer mean? ("To prepare".) Say it once more.

180.2 présenter — to introduce

Before the new one: say the French for to turn, then the French for to prepare.

You'll want to know: présenter

présenter — "to introduce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

présenter ← Latin *praesentare*, "to show, to place before" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: présenter*
- *Say it: présenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *présenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn, then the French for to prepare, then say *présenter* again

Before you move on

What does présenter mean? (“To introduce”.) Say it once more.

180.3 prêter — to lend

Before the new one: say the French for to prepare, then the French for to introduce.

You’ll want to know: prêter

prêter — “to lend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêter ← Middle French *prester* ← Latin *praestare*, “to provide, to vouch for” (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prêter*
- *Say it: prêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prepare, then the French for to introduce, then say *prêter* again

Before you move on

What does prêter mean? (“To lend”.) Say it once more.

180.4 proposer — to propose

Before the new one: say the French for to introduce, then the French for to lend.

You'll want to know: proposer

proposer — "to propose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

proposer ← Old French *proposer*, after Latin *proponere*, "to put forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proposer*
- *Say it: proposer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proposer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to introduce, then the French for to lend, then say *proposer* again

Before you move on

What does proposer mean? ("To propose".) Say it once more.

180.5 ramasser — to pick up

Before the new one: say the French for to lend, then the French for to propose.

You'll want to know: ramasser

ramasser — "to pick up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ramasser — built from *re-* and the verb for "to heap up", from the word for "a mass", ← Latin *massa*, "a lump" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ramasser*
- *Say it: ramasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ramasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lend, then the French for to propose, then say *ramasser* again

Before you move on

What does ramasser mean? ("To pick up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to look like, to push, to pull, to waste and to overtake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say to look like, to push, to pull, to waste and to overtake.*

181.1 ressembler — to look like

Before the new one: say the French for to propose, then the French for to pick up.

You'll want to know: ressembler

ressembler — "to look like".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ressembler — built from *re-* and *sembler*, "to seem": to seem like.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ressembler*
- *Say it: ressembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ressembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to propose, then the French for to pick up, then say *ressembler* again

Before you move on

What does ressembler mean? ("To look like".) Say it once more.

181.2 pousser — to push

Before the new one: say the French for to pick up, then the French for to look like.

You'll want to know: pousser

pousser — "to push".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pousser ← Latin *pulsare*, "to push, to beat" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pousser*
- *Say it: pousser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pousser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pick up, then the French for to look like, then say *pousser* again

Before you move on

What does pousser mean? (“To push”.) Say it once more.

181.3 tirer — to pull

Before the new one: say the French for to look like, then the French for to push.

You’ll want to know: tirer

tirer — “to pull”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tirer ← Old French *tirer*, “to draw out” (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; EtymDB links it to Gothic *tairan*, “to tear”, one of several proposals.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirer*
- *Say it: tirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look like, then the French for to push, then say *tirer* again

Before you move on

What does tirer mean? (“To pull”.) Say it once more.

181.4 gaspiller — to waste

Before the new one: say the French for to push, then the French for to pull.

You'll want to know: gaspiller

gaspiller — "to waste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gaspiller — from a dialect word for scattering chaff (EtymDB 2.1 has Old French *gaspail*, "chaff of wheat"); its deeper origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaspiller*
- *Say it: gaspiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gaspiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to push, then the French for to pull, then say *gaspiller* again

Before you move on

What does gaspiller mean? ("To waste".) Say it once more.

181.5 dépasser — to overtake

Before the new one: say the French for to pull, then the French for to waste.

You'll want to know: dépasser

dépasser — "to overtake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépasser — built from *dé-*, "beyond", and the verb for "to pass", ← Vulgar Latin **passare*, from Latin *passus*, "a step" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dépasser*
- *Say it: dépasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pull, then the French for to waste, then say *dépasser* again

Before you move on

What does dépasser mean? ("To overtake".) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate and to celebrate.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate and to celebrate.

182.1 corriger — to correct

Before the new one: say the French for to waste, then the French for to overtake.

You'll want to know: corriger

corriger — "to correct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

corriger ← Latin *corrigere*, "to set straight" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: corriger*
- *Say it: corriger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *corriger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to waste, then the French for to overtake, then say *corriger* again

Before you move on

What does corriger mean? ("To correct".) Say it once more.

182.2 diriger — to direct

Before the new one: say the French for to overtake, then the French for to correct.

You'll want to know: diriger

diriger — "to direct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diriger ← Latin *dirigere*, "to set straight, to direct" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diriger*
- *Say it: diriger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diriger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to overtake, then the French for to correct, then say *diriger* again

Before you move on

What does diriger mean? ("To direct".) Say it once more.

182.3 détruire — to destroy

Before the new one: say the French for to correct, then the French for to direct.

You'll want to know: détruire

détruire — "to destroy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détruire ← Old French *destruire* ← Vulgar Latin **destrugere* ← Latin *destruere*, "to pull down" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: détruire*
- *Say it: détruire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *détruire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to correct, then the French for to direct, then say *détruire* again

Before you move on

What does détruire mean? ("To destroy".) Say it once more.

182.4 exagérer — to exaggerate

Before the new one: say the French for to direct, then the French for to destroy.

You'll want to know: exagérer

exagérer — "to exaggerate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exagérer ← Latin *exaggerare*, "to heap up" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exagérer*
- *Say it: exagérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exagérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to direct, then the French for to destroy, then say *exagérer* again

Before you move on

What does exagérer mean? ("To exaggerate".) Say it once more.

182.5 fêter — to celebrate

Before the new one: say the French for to destroy, then the French for to exaggerate.

You'll want to know: fêter

fêter — "to celebrate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fêter ← Old French *fester* (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "a feast", ← Latin *festa*, "festivals" (Lewis & Short); the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fêter*
- *Say it: fêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to destroy, then the French for to exaggerate, then say *fêter* again

Before you move on

What does fêter mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski and to slip.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski and to slip.*

183.1 renoncer — to give up

Before the new one: say the French for to exaggerate, then the French for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: renoncer

renoncer — "to give up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renoncer ← Latin *renuntiare*, "to send back word, to give up" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: renoncer*
- *Say it: renoncer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *renoncer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exaggerate, then the French for to celebrate, then say *renoncer* again

Before you move on

What does renoncer mean? ("To give up".) Say it once more.

183.2 échanger — to exchange

Before the new one: say the French for to celebrate, then the French for to give up.

You'll want to know: échanger

échanger — "to exchange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échanger ← Old French *eschangier* ← Vulgar Latin **excambiare* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *changer* with *é-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: échanger*
- *Say it: échanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *échanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to celebrate, then the French for to give up, then say *échanger* again

Before you move on

What does échanger mean? (“To exchange”.) Say it once more.

183.3 télécharger — to download

Before the new one: say the French for to give up, then the French for to exchange.

You’ll want to know: télécharger

télécharger — “to download”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

télécharger — *télé-*, “far off”, from Greek *tele*, and the verb for “to load”, ← Late Latin *carricare* (EtymDB 2.1), from *carrus*, “a wagon”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: télécharger*
- *Say it: télécharger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *télécharger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give up, then the French for to exchange, then say *télécharger* again

Before you move on

What does télécharger mean? (“To download”.) Say it once more.

183.4 skier — to ski

Before the new one: say the French for to exchange, then the French for to download.

You'll want to know: skier

skier — "to ski".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

skier — formed from the word for "ski", ← Norwegian *ski*, from Old Norse *skid*, "a stick of wood, a snowshoe". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skier*
- *Say it: skier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exchange, then the French for to download, then say *skier* again

Before you move on

What does skier mean? ("To ski".) Say it once more.

183.5 glisser — to slip

Before the new one: say the French for to download, then the French for to ski.

You'll want to know: glisser

glisser — "to slip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glisser ← Old French *glicier*, "to slip, to glide" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Frankish **glidan*, "to glide".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glisser*
- *Say it: glisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to download, then the French for to ski, then say *glisser* again

Before you move on

What does glisser mean? ("To slip".) Say it once more.

183.6 Words from chapters 175-178 — a first pass

Say the words for to ski and to slip.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite, to park
- to stop, to change, to move, to take off, to hold
- to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect, to rescue
- to snow, to go with, to add, to announce, to appear

Before you move on

To kiss? (**embrasser**.) To greet? (**saluer**.) To thank? (**remercier**.) To invite? (**inviter**.) To park? (**garer**.) To stop? (**arrêter**.) To change? (**changer**.) To move? (**déplacer**.) To take off? (**enlever**.) To hold? (**tenir**.) To promise? (**promettre**.) To allow? (**permettre**.) To forbid? (**interdire**.) To protect?

(**protéger**.) To rescue? (**sauver**.) To snow? (**neiger**.) To go with? (**accompagner**.) To add? (**ajouter**.) To announce? (**annoncer**.) To appear? (**apparaître**.)

183.7 Words from chapters 179-183 — a second pass

Say the words for to depend and to share.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw, to turn
- to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose, to pick up
- to look like, to push, to pull, to waste, to overtake
- to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate, to celebrate
- to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski, to slip

Before you move on

To depend? (**dépendre**.) To share? (**partager**.) To avoid? (**éviter**.) To throw? (**lancer**.) To turn? (**tourner**.) To prepare? (**préparer**.) To introduce? (**présenter**.) To lend? (**prêter**.) To propose? (**proposer**.) To pick up? (**ramasser**.) To look like? (**ressembler**.) To push? (**pousser**.) To pull? (**tirer**.) To waste? (**gaspiller**.) To overtake? (**dépasser**.) To correct? (**corriger**.) To direct? (**diriger**.) To destroy? (**détruire**.) To exaggerate? (**exagérer**.) To celebrate? (**fêter**.) To give up? (**renoncer**.) To exchange? (**échanger**.) To download? (**télécharger**.) To ski? (**skier**.) To slip? (**glisser**.)

Chapter 184

To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear and to borrow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear and to borrow.*

184.1 bouger — to stir, to move

> Before the new one: say the French for to ski, then the French for to slip.

You'll want to know: bouger

bouger — "to stir, to move".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouger ← Vulgar Latin **bullicare*, "to bubble, to stir", from Latin *bullire*, "to boil" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bouger*
- *Say it: bouger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bouger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to ski, then the French for to slip, then say *bouger* again

Before you move on

What does bouger mean? ("To stir, to move".) Say it once more.

184.2 cueillir — to pick (flowers, fruit)

Before the new one: say the French for to slip, then the French for to stir.

You'll want to know: cueillir

cueillir — "to pick (flowers, fruit)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cueillir ← Old French *coillir* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *colligere*, "to gather together" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cueillir*
- *Say it: cueillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cueillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to slip, then the French for to stir, then say *cueillir* again

Before you move on

What does cueillir mean? (“To pick (flowers, fruit)”.) Say it once more.

184.3 défendre — to defend

Before the new one: say the French for to stir, then the French for to pick.

You’ll want to know: défendre

défendre — “to defend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défendre ← Latin *defendere*, “to ward off” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: défendre*
- *Say it: défendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *défendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stir, then the French for to pick, then say *défendre* again

Before you move on

What does défendre mean? (“To defend”.) Say it once more.

184.4 disparaître — to disappear

Before the new one: say the French for to pick, then the French for to defend.

You'll want to know: disparaître

disparaître — "to disappear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

disparaître — built from *dis-*, "apart", and the verb for "to appear": the opposite of *apparaître*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *disparaître*
- *Say it:* *disparaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *disparaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pick, then the French for to defend, then say *disparaître* again

Before you move on

What does disparaître mean? ("To disappear".) Say it once more.

184.5 emprunter — to borrow

Before the new one: say the French for to defend, then the French for to disappear.

You'll want to know: emprunter

emprunter — "to borrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emprunter ← Middle French *emprunter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **imprumutare*, from Latin *promutuum*, "a loan paid in advance" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *emprunter*
- *Say it:* *emprunter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *emprunter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to defend, then the French for to disappear, then say *emprunter* again

Before you move on

What does emprunter mean? ("To borrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Muscle, Thumb, Wound, Scar, Cold

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar and a cold.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar and a cold.*

185.1 le muscle — a muscle

> Before the new one: say the French for to disappear, then the French for to borrow.

You'll want to know: le muscle

le muscle — "a muscle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

muscle ← Latin *musculus*, "a little mouse", from *mus*, "mouse" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: a flexing muscle looked like a mouse under the skin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le muscle*
- *Say it: le muscle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le muscle*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disappear, then the French for to borrow, then say *le muscle* again

Before you move on

What does le muscle mean? (“A muscle”.) Say it once more.

185.2 le pouce — a thumb

Before the new one: say the French for to borrow, then the French for a muscle.

You’ll want to know: le pouce

le pouce — “a thumb”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pouce ← Old French *pouce* ← Latin *pollex*, *pollicis*, “thumb” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pouce*
- *Say it: le pouce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pouce*
- *Recall:* say the French for to borrow, then the French for a muscle, then say *le pouce* again

Before you move on

What does le pouce mean? (“A thumb”.) Say it once more.

185.3 la blessure — a wound

Before the new one: say the French for a muscle, then the French for a thumb.

You’ll want to know: la blessure

la blessure — “a wound”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blessure — built from the verb for “to wound”, ← Old French *blecier*, from Frankish **blettjan*, “to bruise”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la blessure*
- *Say it: la blessure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la blessure*
- *Recall:* say the French for a muscle, then the French for a thumb, then say *la blessure* again

Before you move on

What does la blessure mean? (“A wound”.) Say it once more.

185.4 la cicatrice — a scar

Before the new one: say the French for a thumb, then the French for a wound.

You'll want to know: la cicatrice

la cicatrice — "a scar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cicatrice ← Latin *cicatrix*, "a scar" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cicatrice*
- *Say it: la cicatrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cicatrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thumb, then the French for a wound, then say *la cicatrice* again

Before you move on

What does la cicatrice mean? ("A scar".) Say it once more.

185.5 le rhume — a cold

Before the new one: say the French for a wound, then the French for a scar.

You'll want to know: le rhume

le rhume — "a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rhume ← Latin *rheuma*, "a flow", from Greek *rheuma* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rhume*
- *Say it: le rhume*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rhume*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wound, then the French for a scar, then say *le rhume* again

Before you move on

What does le rhume mean? ("A cold".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Friendship, Hope, Trust, Courage, Shame

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say friendship, hope, trust, courage and shame.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say friendship, hope, trust, courage and shame.

186.1 l'amitié — friendship

Before the new one: say the French for a scar, then the French for a cold.

You'll want to know: l'amitié

l'amitié — "friendship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amitié ← Old French *amistié* ← Vulgar Latin **amicitas*, from *amicus*, the Latin of *ami* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amitié*
- *Say it: l'amitié*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amitié*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scar, then the French for a cold, then say *l'amitié* again

Before you move on

What does l'amitié mean? ("Friendship".) Say it once more.

186.2 l'espoir — hope

Before the new one: say the French for a cold, then the French for friendship.

You'll want to know: l'espoir

l'espoir — "hope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espoir — formed from *espérer*, "to hope".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'espoir*
- *Say it: l'espoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'espoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cold, then the French for friendship, then say *l'espoir* again

Before you move on

What does l'espoir mean? ("Hope".) Say it once more.

186.3 la confiance — trust

Before the new one: say the French for friendship, then the French for hope.

You'll want to know: la confiance

la confiance — "trust".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confiance — built on the verb for "to entrust", with *-ance*; behind it is Latin *confidere*, "to trust fully". (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Latin *confidentia*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la confiance*
- *Say it: la confiance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la confiance*
- *Recall:* say the French for friendship, then the French for hope, then say *la confiance* again

Before you move on

What does la confiance mean? ("Trust".) Say it once more.

186.4 le courage — courage

Before the new one: say the French for hope, then the French for trust.

You'll want to know: le courage

le courage — "courage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courage — built in Old French from *cuer*, "heart", ← Latin *cor* (EtymDB 2.1), with *-age*: heart in action.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le courage*
- *Say it: le courage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le courage*
- *Recall:* say the French for hope, then the French for trust, then say *le courage* again

Before you move on

What does le courage mean? ("Courage".) Say it once more.

186.5 la honte — shame

Before the new one: say the French for trust, then the French for courage.

You'll want to know: la honte

la honte — "shame".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

honte ← Frankish **haunitha*, "scorn" — borrowed from the Franks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la honte*
- *Say it: la honte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la honte*
- *Recall:* say the French for trust, then the French for courage, then say *la honte* again

Before you move on

What does la honte mean? (“Shame”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say in that case, late, suddenly, until and since.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say in that case, late, suddenly, until and since.*

187.1 alors — in that case, so

> Before the new one: say the French for courage, then the French for shame.

You'll want to know: alors

alors — "in that case, so".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alors — *à* and Old French *lors*, "then", ← Latin *illa hora*, "at that hour". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alors*
- *Say it:* *alors*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alors*
- *Recall:* say the French for courage, then the French for shame, then say *alors* again

Before you move on

What does alors mean? (“In that case, so”.) Say it once more.

187.2 tard — late

Before the new one: say the French for shame, then the French for in that case.

You’ll want to know: tard

tard — “late”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tard ← Latin *tarde*, “slowly”, from *tardus*, “slow” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tard*
- *Say it:* *tard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tard*
- *Recall:* say the French for shame, then the French for in that case, then say *tard* again

Before you move on

What does tard mean? ("Late".) Say it once more.

187.3 soudain — suddenly

Before the new one: say the French for in that case, then the French for late.

You'll want to know: soudain

soudain — "suddenly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soudain ← Old French *sodain* ← Vulgar Latin **subitanus* ← Latin *subitaneus*, "sudden", from *subitus* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soudain*
- *Say it: soudain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soudain*
- *Recall:* say the French for in that case, then the French for late, then say *soudain* again

Before you move on

What does soudain mean? ("Suddenly".) Say it once more.

187.4 jusqu'à — until

Before the new one: say the French for late, then the French for suddenly.

You'll want to know: jusqu'à

jusqu'à — "until".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jusqu'à — Old French *josque*, from Latin *de usque*, "right up to" (Lewis & Short for *usque*), and *à*, "to".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jusqu'à*
- *Say it: jusqu'à*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jusqu'à*
- *Recall:* say the French for late, then the French for suddenly, then say *jusqu'à* again

Before you move on

What does jusqu'à mean? ("Until".) Say it once more.

187.5 depuis — since, for

Before the new one: say the French for suddenly, then the French for until.

You'll want to know: depuis

depuis — "since, for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

depuis — *de*, "from", and *puis*, "then": from then on. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: depuis*
- *Say it: depuis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *depuis*
- *Recall:* say the French for suddenly, then the French for until, then say *depuis* again

Before you move on

What does depuis mean? (“Since, for”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right and on the left.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right and on the left.

188.1 près de — near to

Before the new one: say the French for until, then the French for since.

You'll want to know: près de

près de — "near to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

près de — *près*, "near", and *de*, "of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: près de*
- *Say it: près de*, once more
- *Say it:* say *près de*
- *Recall:* say the French for until, then the French for since, then say *près de* again

Before you move on

What does près de mean? (“Near to”.) Say it once more.

188.2 loin de — far from

Before the new one: say the French for since, then the French for near to.

You’ll want to know: loin de

loin de — “far from”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loin de — *loin*, “far”, and *de*, “from”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: loin de*
- *Say it: loin de*, once more
- *Say it:* say *loin de*
- *Recall:* say the French for since, then the French for near to, then say *loin de* again

Before you move on

What does loin de mean? (“Far from”.) Say it once more.

188.3 au fond — at the bottom, at the back

Before the new one: say the French for near to, then the French for far from.

You’ll want to know: au fond

au fond — “at the bottom, at the back”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au fond — *au*, “at the”, and *fond*, “bottom”, ← Latin *fundus*, “bottom”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au fond*
- *Say it: au fond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au fond*
- *Recall:* say the French for near to, then the French for far from, then say *au fond* again

Before you move on

What does au fond mean? (“At the bottom, at the back”.) Say it once more.

188.4 à droite — on the right

Before the new one: say the French for far from, then the French for at the bottom.

You'll want to know: à droite

à droite — "on the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à droite — *à*, "on", and *droite*, "the right".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: à droite*
- *Say it: à droite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à droite*
- *Recall:* say the French for far from, then the French for at the bottom, then say *à droite* again

Before you move on

What does à droite mean? ("On the right".) Say it once more.

188.5 à gauche — on the left

Before the new one: say the French for at the bottom, then the French for on the right.

You'll want to know: à gauche

à gauche — "on the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à gauche — *à*, "on", and *gauche*, "the left".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: à gauche*
- *Say it: à gauche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à gauche*
- *Recall:* say the French for at the bottom, then the French for on the right, then say *à gauche* again

Before you move on

What does à gauche mean? (“On the left”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly and really.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly and really.*

189.1 malgré — despite

> Before the new one: say the French for on the right, then the French for on the left.

You'll want to know: malgré

malgré — "despite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malgré ← Middle French *maugré*, from Old French *mal*, "bad", and *gré*, "liking", ← Latin *gratum*, "pleasing" (EtymDB 2.1): against one's liking.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: malgré*
- *Say it: malgré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malgré*
- *Recall:* say the French for on the right, then the French for on the left, then say *malgré* again

Before you move on

What does malgré mean? ("Despite".) Say it once more.

189.2 malheureusement — unfortunately

Before the new one: say the French for on the left, then the French for despite.

You'll want to know: malheureusement

malheureusement — "unfortunately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malheureusement — *heureux*, "lucky", with *mal-*, "badly", in front and the adverb ending *-ment*: unluckily.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: malheureusement*
- *Say it: malheureusement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malheureusement*
- *Recall:* say the French for on the left, then the French for despite, then say *malheureusement* again

Before you move on

What does malheureusement mean? (“Unfortunately”.) Say it once more.

189.3 heureusement — luckily

Before the new one: say the French for despite, then the French for unfortunately.

You’ll want to know: heureusement

heureusement — “luckily”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heureusement — *heureux*, “lucky”, with the adverb ending *-ment*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heureusement*
- *Say it: heureusement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heureusement*
- *Recall:* say the French for despite, then the French for unfortunately, then say *heureusement* again

Before you move on

What does heureusement mean? (“Luckily”.) Say it once more.

189.4 certainement — certainly

Before the new one: say the French for unfortunately, then the French for luckily.

You'll want to know: certainement

certainement — "certainly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

certainement — the word for "certain", ← Vulgar Latin **certanus*, from Latin *certus*, "sure" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*; Old French already had it (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: certainement*
- *Say it: certainement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *certainement*
- *Recall:* say the French for unfortunately, then the French for luckily, then say *certainement* again

Before you move on

What does certainement mean? ("Certainly".) Say it once more.

189.5 vraiment — really

Before the new one: say the French for luckily, then the French for certainly.

You'll want to know: vraiment

vraiment — "really".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vraiment ← Old French *veraiement* (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "true", ← Vulgar Latin **veracus*, from Latin *verus*, "true", with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vraiment*
- *Say it: vraiment*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vraiment*
- *Recall:* say the French for luckily, then the French for certainly, then say *vraiment* again

Before you move on

What does vraiment mean? ("Really".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cheerful, serious, shy, brave and fearful.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say cheerful, serious, shy, brave and fearful.*

190.1 joyeux / joyeuse — cheerful

> Before the new one: say the French for certainly, then the French for really.

You'll want to know: joyeux / joyeuse

joyeux / joyeuse — "cheerful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joyeux — *joie*, "joy", with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joyeux / joyeuse*
- *Say it: joyeux / joyeuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joyeux / joyeuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for certainly, then the French for really, then say *joyeux / joyeuse* again

Before you move on

What does joyeux / joyeuse mean? ("Cheerful".) Say it once more.

190.2 sérieux / sérieuse — serious

Before the new one: say the French for really, then the French for cheerful.

You'll want to know: sérieux / sérieuse

sérieux / sérieuse — "serious".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sérieux ← Medieval Latin *seriosus*, from *serius*, "earnest" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sérieux / sérieuse*
- *Say it: sérieux / sérieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sérieux / sérieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for really, then the French for cheerful, then say *sérieux / sérieuse* again

Before you move on

What does sérieux / sérieuse mean? (“Serious”.) Say it once more.

190.3 timide — shy

Before the new one: say the French for cheerful, then the French for serious.

You’ll want to know: timide

timide — “shy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

timide ← Latin *timidus*, “fearful”, from *timere*, “to fear” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: timide*
- *Say it: timide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *timide*
- *Recall:* say the French for cheerful, then the French for serious, then say *timide* again

Before you move on

What does timide mean? (“Shy”.) Say it once more.

190.4 courageux / courageuse — brave

Before the new one: say the French for serious, then the French for shy.

You'll want to know: courageux / courageuse

courageux / courageuse — "brave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courageux — *courage* with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: courageux / courageuse*
- *Say it: courageux / courageuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *courageux / courageuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for serious, then the French for shy, then say *courageux / courageuse* again

Before you move on

What does courageux / courageuse mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

190.5 peureux / peureuse — fearful

Before the new one: say the French for shy, then the French for brave.

You'll want to know: peureux / peureuse

peureux / peureuse — "fearful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peureux — *peur*, "fear", with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peureux / peureuse*
- *Say it: peureux / peureuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peureux / peureuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for shy, then the French for brave, then say *peureux / peureuse* again

Before you move on

What does peureux / peureuse mean? (“Fearful”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

Simple, Complicated, Necessary, Useful, Useless

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say simple, complicated, necessary, useful and useless.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say simple, complicated, necessary, useful and useless.*

191.1 simple — simple

Before the new one: say the French for brave, then the French for fearful.

You'll want to know: simple

simple — "simple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

simple ← Latin *simplex*, "single, plain" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: simple*
- *Say it: simple*, once more
- *Say it:* say *simple*
- *Recall:* say the French for brave, then the French for fearful, then say *simple* again

Before you move on

What does simple mean? ("Simple".) Say it once more.

191.2 compliqué / compliquée — complicated

Before the new one: say the French for fearful, then the French for simple.

You'll want to know: compliqué / compliquée

compliqué / compliquée — "complicated".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compliqué is the past participle of the verb for "to complicate", ← Latin *complicare*, "to fold together" (Lewis & Short): folded in on itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: compliqué / compliquée*
- *Say it: compliqué / compliquée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *compliqué / compliquée*
- *Recall:* say the French for fearful, then the French for simple, then say *compliqué / compliquée* again

Before you move on

What does compliqué / compliquée mean? (“Complicated”.) Say it once more.

191.3 nécessaire — necessary

Before the new one: say the French for simple, then the French for complicated.

You’ll want to know: nécessaire

nécessaire — “necessary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nécessaire ← Latin *necessarius*, “unavoidable”, from *necesse*, “needful” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nécessaire*
- *Say it: nécessaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nécessaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for simple, then the French for complicated, then say *nécessaire* again

Before you move on

What does nécessaire mean? (“Necessary”.) Say it once more.

191.4 utile — useful

Before the new one: say the French for complicated, then the French for necessary.

You'll want to know: utile

utile — "useful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

utile ← Latin *utilis*, "useful", from *uti*, "to use" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *utile*
- *Say it:* *utile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utile*
- *Recall:* say the French for complicated, then the French for necessary, then say *utile* again

Before you move on

What does utile mean? ("Useful".) Say it once more.

191.5 inutile — useless

Before the new one: say the French for necessary, then the French for useful.

You'll want to know: inutile

inutile — "useless".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inutile ← Latin *inutilis*, "useless": *utile* with *in-*, "not" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inutile*
- *Say it: inutile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inutile*
- *Recall:* say the French for necessary, then the French for useful, then say *inutile* again

Before you move on

What does inutile mean? ("Useless".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Cooked, Ripe, Dark, Clear, Distant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cooked, ripe, dark, clear and distant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say cooked, ripe, dark, clear and distant.*

192.1 cuit / cuite — cooked

Before the new one: say the French for useful, then the French for useless.

You'll want to know: cuit / cuite

cuit / cuite — "cooked".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuit ← Old French *cuit* ← Latin *coctus*, "cooked", the past participle of *coquere* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuit / cuite*
- *Say it: cuit / cuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuit / cuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for useful, then the French for useless, then say *cuit / cuite* again

Before you move on

What does cuit / cuite mean? ("Cooked".) Say it once more.

192.2 mûr / mûre — ripe

Before the new one: say the French for useless, then the French for cooked.

You'll want to know: mûr / mûre

mûr / mûre — "ripe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mûr ← Old French *meür* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *maturus*, "ripe" (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the *t* between vowels dropped out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mûr / mûre*
- *Say it: mûr / mûre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mûr / mûre*
- *Recall:* say the French for useless, then the French for cooked, then say *mûr / mûre* again

Before you move on

What does mûr / mûre mean? ("Ripe".) Say it once more.

192.3 sombre — dark

Before the new one: say the French for cooked, then the French for ripe.

You'll want to know: sombre

sombre — "dark".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sombre ← Old French *sombre*, "dark" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; it is usually linked to Late Latin *subumbrare*, "to shade", from *umbra*, "shadow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sombre*
- *Say it: sombre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sombre*
- *Recall:* say the French for cooked, then the French for ripe, then say *sombre* again

Before you move on

What does sombre mean? ("Dark".) Say it once more.

192.4 clair / claire — clear, light (of a colour)

Before the new one: say the French for ripe, then the French for dark.

You'll want to know: clair / claire

clair / claire — "clear, light (of a colour)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clair ← Old French *cler* ← Latin *clarus*, "bright, clear" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *a* became *e*; the *ai* spelling was put back later to look more like the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *clair / claire*
- *Say it:* *clair / claire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *clair / claire*
- *Recall:* say the French for ripe, then the French for dark, then say *clair / claire* again

Before you move on

What does clair / claire mean? ("Clear, light (of a colour)".) Say it once more.

192.5 lointain / lointaine — distant

Before the new one: say the French for dark, then the French for clear.

You'll want to know: lointain / lointaine

lointain / lointaine — "distant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lointain ← Old French *loingtien* ← Vulgar Latin **longitanus*, from Latin *longe*, "far off", the Latin of *loin* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lointain / lointaine*
- *Say it: lointain / lointaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lointain / lointaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for dark, then the French for clear, then say *lointain / lointaine* again

Before you move on

What does lointain / lointaine mean? ("Distant".) Say it once more.

192.6 Words from chapters 184-187 — a first pass

Say the words for clear and distant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear, to borrow
- a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar, a cold
- friendship, hope, trust, courage, shame
- in that case, late, suddenly, until, since

Before you move on

To stir? (**bouger**.) To pick? (**cueillir**.) To defend? (**défendre**.) To disappear? (**disparaître**.) To borrow? (**emprunter**.) A muscle? (**le muscle**.) A thumb? (**le pouce**.) A wound? (**la blessure**.) A scar? (**la cicatrice**.) A cold? (**le rhume**.) Friendship? (**l'amitié**.) Hope? (**l'espoir**.) Trust? (**la confiance**.) Courage? (**le courage**.)

Shame? (**la honte**.) In that case? (**alors**.) Late? (**tard**.) Suddenly? (**soudain**.) Until? (**jusqu'à**.) Since? (**depuis**.)

192.7 Words from chapters 188-192 — a second pass

Say the words for near to and far from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right, on the left
- despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly, really
- cheerful, serious, shy, brave, fearful
- simple, complicated, necessary, useful, useless
- cooked, ripe, dark, clear, distant

Before you move on

Near to? (**près de**.) Far from? (**loin de**.) At the bottom? (**au fond**.) On the right? (**à droite**.) On the left? (**à gauche**.) Despite? (**malgré**.) Unfortunately? (**malheureusement**.) Luckily? (**heureusement**.) Certainly? (**certainement**.) Really? (**vraiment**.) Cheerful? (**joyeux / joyeuse**.) Serious? (**sérieux / sérieuse**.) Shy? (**timide**.) Brave? (**courageux / courageuse**.) Fearful? (**peureux / peureuse**.) Simple? (**simple**.) Complicated? (**compliqué / compliquée**.) Necessary? (**nécessaire**.) Useful? (**utile**.) Useless? (**inutile**.) Cooked? (**cuit / cuite**.) Ripe? (**mûr / mûre**.) Dark? (**sombre**.) Clear? (**clair / claire**.) Distant? (**lointain / lointaine**.)

Chapter 193

Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan and a frying pan.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan and a frying pan.*

193.1 le drap — a sheet

> Before the new one: say the French for clear, light (of a colour), then the French for distant.

You'll want to know: le drap

le drap — "a sheet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drap ← Late Latin *drappus*, "cloth", probably a Gaulish word — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le drap*
- *Say it: le drap*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le drap*
- *Recall:* say the French for clear, light (of a colour), then the French for distant, then say *le drap* again

Before you move on

What does le drap mean? ("A sheet".) Say it once more.

193.2 le tiroir — a drawer

Before the new one: say the French for distant, then the French for a sheet.

You'll want to know: le tiroir

le tiroir — "a drawer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tiroir — *tirer*, "to pull", with *-oir*, "a thing for": the thing you pull out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tiroir*
- *Say it: le tiroir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tiroir*
- *Recall:* say the French for distant, then the French for a sheet, then say *le tiroir* again

Before you move on

What does le tiroir mean? (“A drawer”.) Say it once more.

193.3 le fauteuil — an armchair

Before the new one: say the French for a sheet, then the French for a drawer.

You’ll want to know: le fauteuil

le fauteuil — “an armchair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fauteuil ← Old French *faudestuel* ← Frankish **faldistol*, “a folding stool” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fauteuil*
- *Say it: le fauteuil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fauteuil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheet, then the French for a drawer, then say *le fauteuil* again

Before you move on

What does le fauteuil mean? (“An armchair”.) Say it once more.

193.4 la casserole — a saucepan

Before the new one: say the French for a drawer, then the French for an armchair.

You'll want to know: la casserole

la casserole — "a saucepan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casserole — built from an older word for "a pan", from Old Provençal *cassa*, with a little-thing ending. *cassa* goes back to Medieval Latin *cattia*, "a ladle, a pan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la casserole*
- *Say it: la casserole*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la casserole*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drawer, then the French for an armchair, then say *la casserole* again

Before you move on

What does la casserole mean? ("A saucepan".) Say it once more.

193.5 la poêle — a frying pan

Before the new one: say the French for an armchair, then the French for a saucepan.

You'll want to know: la poêle

la poêle — "a frying pan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poêle ← Old French *paelle* ← Latin *patella*, "a small pan" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poêle*
- *Say it: la poêle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poêle*
- *Recall:* say the French for an armchair, then the French for a saucepan, then say *la poêle* again

Before you move on

What does la poêle mean? ("A frying pan".) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly and a mosquito.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly and a mosquito.

194.1 la vallée — a valley

Before the new one: say the French for a saucepan, then the French for a frying pan.

You'll want to know: la vallée

la vallée — "a valley".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vallée — built in Old French from *val*, "a valley", ← Latin *vallis*, with *-ée*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vallée*
- *Say it: la vallée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vallée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a saucepan, then the French for a frying pan, then say *la vallée* again

Before you move on

What does la vallée mean? ("A valley".) Say it once more.

194.2 la température — temperature

Before the new one: say the French for a frying pan, then the French for a valley.

You'll want to know: la température

la température — "temperature".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

température ← Latin *temperatura*, "due measure, a mixing", from *temperare*, "to mix in proportion" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la température*
- *Say it: la température*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la température*
- *Recall:* say the French for a frying pan, then the French for a valley, then say *la température* again

Before you move on

What does la température mean? ("Temperature".) Say it once more.

194.3 le papillon — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the French for a valley, then the French for temperature.

You'll want to know: le papillon

le papillon — "a butterfly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

papillon ← Latin *papilio*, *papilionis*, "a butterfly" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: it kept its middle *p*. The fully inherited twin, with *v*, became the word for a tent, English *pavilion*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le papillon*
- *Say it: le papillon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le papillon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a valley, then the French for temperature, then say *le papillon* again

Before you move on

What does le papillon mean? ("A butterfly".) Say it once more.

194.4 la mouche — a fly

Before the new one: say the French for temperature, then the French for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: la mouche

la mouche — "a fly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouche ← Old French *mousche* ← Latin *musca*, "a fly" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mouche*
- *Say it: la mouche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mouche*
- *Recall:* say the French for temperature, then the French for a butterfly, then say *la mouche* again

Before you move on

What does la mouche mean? ("A fly".) Say it once more.

194.5 le moustique — a mosquito

Before the new one: say the French for a butterfly, then the French for a fly.

You'll want to know: le moustique

le moustique — "a mosquito".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moustique ← Spanish *mosquito*, "a little fly", from *mosca*, ← Latin *musca* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le moustique*
- *Say it: le moustique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le moustique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butterfly, then the French for a fly, then say *le moustique* again

Before you move on

What does le moustique mean? ("A mosquito".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen and a keyboard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen and a keyboard.*

195.1 le dialecte — a dialect

> Before the new one: say the French for a fly, then the French for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: le dialecte

le dialecte — "a dialect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dialecte ← Latin *dialectos*, from Greek *dialektos*, "a way of speaking" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dialecte*
- *Say it: le dialecte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dialecte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fly, then the French for a mosquito, then say *le dialecte* again

Before you move on

What does le dialecte mean? ("A dialect".) Say it once more.

195.2 la nouvelle — a piece of news

Before the new one: say the French for a mosquito, then the French for a dialect.

You'll want to know: la nouvelle

la nouvelle — "a piece of news".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nouvelle ← Old French *novele* ← Vulgar Latin *novella*, "new things" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the feminine of the word behind *nouveau*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nouvelle*
- *Say it: la nouvelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la nouvelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mosquito, then the French for a dialect, then say *la nouvelle* again

Before you move on

What does la nouvelle mean? (“A piece of news”.) Say it once more.

195.3 la publicité — advertising

Before the new one: say the French for a dialect, then the French for a piece of news.

You’ll want to know: la publicité

la publicité — “advertising”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

publicité ← Medieval Latin *publicitas*, from *publicus*, “of the people” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la publicité*
- *Say it: la publicité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la publicité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dialect, then the French for a piece of news, then say *la publicité* again

Before you move on

What does la publicité mean? (“Advertising”.) Say it once more.

195.4 l’écran — a screen

Before the new one: say the French for a piece of news, then the French for advertising.

You'll want to know: l'écran

l'écran — "a screen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écran ← Old French *escran*, from Middle Dutch *scherm*, "a shield, a screen" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écran*
- *Say it: l'écran*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écran*
- *Recall:* say the French for a piece of news, then the French for advertising, then say *l'écran* again

Before you move on

What does l'écran mean? ("A screen".) Say it once more.

195.5 le clavier — a keyboard

Before the new one: say the French for advertising, then the French for a screen.

You'll want to know: le clavier

le clavier — "a keyboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clavier — built from Latin *clavis*, "key", the Latin of *clé*, with *-ier*: a row of keys. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clavier*
- *Say it: le clavier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le clavier*
- *Recall:* say the French for advertising, then the French for a screen, then say *le clavier* again

Before you move on

What does le clavier mean? ("A keyboard".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber and a worker.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber and a worker.*

196.1 le boucher — a butcher

> Before the new one: say the French for a screen, then the French for a keyboard.

You'll want to know: le boucher

le boucher — "a butcher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boucher ← Old French *bouchier*, built from *bouc*, "a he-goat" (EtymDB 2.1): first a seller of goat's meat.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le boucher*
- *Say it: le boucher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le boucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for a screen, then the French for a keyboard, then say *le boucher* again

Before you move on

What does le boucher mean? (“A butcher”.) Say it once more.

196.2 le mécanicien — a mechanic

Before the new one: say the French for a keyboard, then the French for a butcher.

You’ll want to know: le mécanicien

le mécanicien — “a mechanic”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mécanicien — built from the word for “mechanics”, ← Latin *mechanicus*, from Greek *mekhanikos*, “of machines” (Lewis & Short), with *-ien*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mécanicien*
- *Say it: le mécanicien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mécanicien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a keyboard, then the French for a butcher, then say *le mécanicien* again

Before you move on

What does le mécanicien mean? ("A mechanic".) Say it once more.

196.3 l'électricien — an electrician

Before the new one: say the French for a butcher, then the French for a mechanic.

You'll want to know: l'électricien

l'électricien — "an electrician".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

électricien — built from the word for "electric", from Latin *electrum*, "amber", from Greek *elektron* (Lewis & Short): rubbed amber draws things to it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'électricien*
- *Say it: l'électricien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'électricien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butcher, then the French for a mechanic, then say *l'électricien* again

Before you move on

What does l'électricien mean? ("An electrician".) Say it once more.

196.4 le plombier — a plumber

Before the new one: say the French for a mechanic, then the French for an electrician.

You'll want to know: le plombier

le plombier — "a plumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plombier — built from the word for "lead", ← Latin *plumbum* (Lewis & Short), with *-ier*: pipes were once lead.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plombier*
- *Say it: le plombier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plombier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mechanic, then the French for an electrician, then say *le plombier* again

Before you move on

What does le plombier mean? ("A plumber".) Say it once more.

196.5 l'ouvrier — a worker

Before the new one: say the French for an electrician, then the French for a plumber.

You'll want to know: l'ouvrier

l'ouvrier — "a worker".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouvrier ← Old French *ovrier* ← Latin *operarius*, "a labourer", from *opus*, *operis*, "work" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ouvrier*
- *Say it: l'ouvrier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ouvrier*
- *Recall:* say the French for an electrician, then the French for a plumber, then say *l'ouvrier* again

Before you move on

What does l'ouvrier mean? ("A worker".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success and failure.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success and failure.

197.1 le marié — a bridegroom

Before the new one: say the French for a plumber, then the French for a worker.

You'll want to know: le marié

le marié — "a bridegroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marié — the adjective *marié*, "married", used as a noun: the man being married.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marié*
- *Say it: le marié*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le marié*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plumber, then the French for a worker, then say *le marié* again

Before you move on

What does le marié mean? ("A bridegroom".) Say it once more.

197.2 la mariée — a bride

Before the new one: say the French for a worker, then the French for a bridegroom.

You'll want to know: la mariée

la mariée — "a bride".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mariée — the feminine of *marié*, used as a noun: the bride.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mariée*
- *Say it: la mariée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mariée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a worker, then the French for a bridegroom, then say *la mariée* again

Before you move on

What does la mariée mean? (“A bride”.) Say it once more.

197.3 le veuf — a widower

Before the new one: say the French for a bridegroom, then the French for a bride.

You’ll want to know: le veuf

le veuf — “a widower”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

veuf ← Latin *viduus*, “bereaved” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le veuf*
- *Say it: le veuf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le veuf*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bridegroom, then the French for a bride, then say *le veuf* again

Before you move on

What does le veuf mean? (“A widower”.) Say it once more.

197.4 le succès — success

Before the new one: say the French for a bride, then the French for a widower.

You'll want to know: le succès

le succès — "success".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

succès ← Latin *successus*, "an outcome", from *succedere*, "to come after" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le succès*
- *Say it: le succès*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le succès*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bride, then the French for a widower, then say *le succès* again

Before you move on

What does le succès mean? ("Success".) Say it once more.

197.5 l'échec — failure

Before the new one: say the French for a widower, then the French for success.

You'll want to know: l'échec

l'échec — "failure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échec ← Old French *eschec*, "check" in chess, from Arabic, from Persian *shah*, "king" — borrowed: a check is a setback.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échec*
- *Say it: l'échec*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'échec*
- *Recall:* say the French for a widower, then the French for success, then say *l'échec* again

Before you move on

What does l'échec mean? ("Failure".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

Promise, Discount, Sales, Coin, Banknote

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin and a banknote.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin and a banknote.

198.1 la promesse — a promise

Before the new one: say the French for success, then the French for failure.

You'll want to know: la promesse

la promesse — "a promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

promesse ← Latin *promissa*, "things promised" — inherited: the noun beside *promettre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la promesse*
- *Say it: la promesse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la promesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for success, then the French for failure, then say *la promesse* again

Before you move on

What does la promesse mean? ("A promise".) Say it once more.

198.2 la réduction — a discount

Before the new one: say the French for failure, then the French for a promise.

You'll want to know: la réduction

la réduction — "a discount".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réduction ← Latin *reductio*, "a leading back", from *reducere* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réduction*
- *Say it: la réduction*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réduction*
- *Recall:* say the French for failure, then the French for a promise, then say *la réduction* again

Before you move on

What does la réduction mean? ("A discount".) Say it once more.

198.3 les soldes — the sales

Before the new one: say the French for a promise, then the French for a discount.

You'll want to know: les soldes

les soldes — "the sales".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soldes — from the verb for "to settle an account", ← Italian *saldare*, from *saldo*, "solid", ← Latin *solidus* — borrowed: goods sold off to settle up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les soldes*
- *Say it: les soldes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les soldes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a promise, then the French for a discount, then say *les soldes* again

Before you move on

What does les soldes mean? ("The sales".) Say it once more.

198.4 la pièce — a coin, a room

Before the new one: say the French for a discount, then the French for the sales.

You'll want to know: la pièce

la pièce — "a coin, a room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pièce ← Old French *piece* ← Late Latin *pettia*, "a piece", from Gaulish — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pièce*
- *Say it: la pièce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pièce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a discount, then the French for the sales, then say *la pièce* again

Before you move on

What does la pièce mean? ("A coin, a room".) Say it once more.

198.5 le billet de banque — a banknote

Before the new one: say the French for the sales, then the French for a coin.

You'll want to know: le billet de banque

le billet de banque — "a banknote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

billet de banque — *billet*, "a note", *de*, "of", and *banque*, "bank".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le billet de banque*
- *Say it: le billet de banque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le billet de banque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sales, then the French for a coin, then say *le billet de banque* again

Before you move on

What does le billet de banque mean? ("A banknote".) Say it once more.

198.6 Words from chapters 193-195 — a first pass

Say the words for a coin and a banknote.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan, a frying pan
- a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly, a mosquito
- a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen, a keyboard

Before you move on

A sheet? (**le drap**.) A drawer? (**le tiroir**.) An armchair? (**le fauteuil**.) A saucepan? (**la casserole**.) A frying pan? (**la poêle**.) A valley? (**la vallée**.) Temperature? (**la température**.) A butterfly? (**le papillon**.) A fly? (**la mouche**.) A mosquito? (**le moustique**.) A dialect? (**le dialecte**.) A piece of news? (**la nouvelle**.) Advertising? (**la publicité**.) A screen? (**l'écran**.) A keyboard? (**le clavier**.)

198.7 Words from chapters 196-198 — a second pass

Say the words for a butcher and a mechanic.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber, a worker
- a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success, failure
- a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin, a banknote

Before you move on

A butcher? (**le boucher**.) A mechanic? (**le mécanicien**.) An electrician? (**l'électricien**.) A plumber? (**le plombier**.) A worker? (**l'ouvrier**.) A bridegroom? (**le marié**.) A bride? (**la mariée**.) A widower? (**le veuf**.) Success? (**le succès**.) Failure? (**l'échec**.) A promise? (**la promesse**.) A discount? (**la réduction**.) The sales? (**les soldes**.) A coin? (**la pièce**.) A banknote? (**le billet de banque**.)

Chapter 199

Entrance, Exit, Luggage, Seat, Steering wheel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat and a steering wheel.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat and a steering wheel.

199.1 l'entrée — an entrance

Before the new one: say the French for a coin, a room, then the French for a banknote.

You'll want to know: l'entrée

l'entrée — "an entrance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entrée is the past participle of the verb for "to enter", used as a noun, ← Latin *intrare* (Lewis & Short): the way in.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entrée*
- *Say it: l'entrée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entrée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coin, a room, then the French for a banknote, then say *l'entrée* again

Before you move on

What does l'entrée mean? ("An entrance".) Say it once more.

199.2 la sortie — an exit

Before the new one: say the French for a banknote, then the French for an entrance.

You'll want to know: la sortie

la sortie — "an exit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sortie is the past participle of the verb for "to go out", used as a noun: the way out. The verb's origin is uncertain; the usual guess is Latin *sortiri*, "to draw lots".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sortie*
- *Say it: la sortie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sortie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a banknote, then the French for an entrance, then say *la sortie* again

Before you move on

What does la sortie mean? (“An exit”.) Say it once more.

199.3 les bagages — luggage

Before the new one: say the French for an entrance, then the French for an exit.

You’ll want to know: les bagages

les bagages — “luggage”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bagages — built from Old French *bague*, “a bundle” (EtymDB 2.1), with *-age*; *bague*’s own origin is uncertain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les bagages*
- *Say it: les bagages*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les bagages*
- *Recall:* say the French for an entrance, then the French for an exit, then say *les bagages* again

Before you move on

What does les bagages mean? (“Luggage”.) Say it once more.

199.4 le siège — a seat

Before the new one: say the French for an exit, then the French for luggage.

You'll want to know: le siège

le siège — "a seat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siège ← Old French *siege* ← Vulgar Latin **sedicum*, from Latin *sedes*, "a seat" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le siège*
- *Say it: le siège*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le siège*
- *Recall:* say the French for an exit, then the French for luggage, then say *le siège* again

Before you move on

What does le siège mean? ("A seat".) Say it once more.

199.5 le volant — a steering wheel

Before the new one: say the French for luggage, then the French for a seat.

You'll want to know: le volant

le volant — "a steering wheel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

volant is the present participle of the verb for "to fly", ← Latin *volare* (Lewis & Short), used as a noun: a thing that spins freely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le volant*
- *Say it: le volant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le volant*
- *Recall:* say the French for luggage, then the French for a seat, then say *le volant* again

Before you move on

What does le volant mean? ("A steering wheel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 200

Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic and a vegetable garden.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic and a vegetable garden.

200.1 le portail — a gate

Before the new one: say the French for a seat, then the French for a steering wheel.

You'll want to know: le portail

le portail — "a gate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portail — built from the word for "door", ← Latin *porta*, "a gate" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-ail*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le portail*
- *Say it: le portail*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le portail*
- *Recall:* say the French for a seat, then the French for a steering wheel, then say *le portail* again

Before you move on

What does le portail mean? (“A gate”.) Say it once more.

200.2 la clôture — a fence

Before the new one: say the French for a steering wheel, then the French for a gate.

You’ll want to know: la clôture

la clôture — “a fence”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clôture ← Old French *closture* ← Late Latin *clausura*, “a bar, a lock”, from *clausus*, “closed” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la clôture*
- *Say it: la clôture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la clôture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a steering wheel, then the French for a gate, then say *la clôture* again

Before you move on

What does la clôture mean? (“A fence”.) Say it once more.

200.3 la cave — a cellar

Before the new one: say the French for a gate, then the French for a fence.

You’ll want to know: la cave

la cave — “a cellar”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cave ← Latin *cava*, “hollow places”, from *cavus*, “hollow” — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cave*
- *Say it: la cave*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cave*
- *Recall:* say the French for a gate, then the French for a fence, then say *la cave* again

Before you move on

What does la cave mean? (“A cellar”.) Say it once more.

200.4 le grenier — an attic

Before the new one: say the French for a fence, then the French for a cellar.

You'll want to know: le grenier

le grenier — "an attic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grenier ← Old French *grenier* ← Latin *granarium*, "a granary", from *granum*, "grain" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le grenier*
- *Say it: le grenier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le grenier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fence, then the French for a cellar, then say *le grenier* again

Before you move on

What does le grenier mean? ("An attic".) Say it once more.

200.5 le potager — a vegetable garden

Before the new one: say the French for a cellar, then the French for an attic.

You'll want to know: le potager

le potager — "a vegetable garden".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

potager — built from the word for "soup", Old French *potage*, "what goes in the pot", from *pot*, ← Vulgar Latin **pottum* (EtymDB 2.1), with *-er*: the garden that fills the pot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le potager*
- *Say it: le potager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le potager*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cellar, then the French for an attic, then say *le potager* again

Before you move on

What does le potager mean? ("A vegetable garden".) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say earth, mud, dust, smoke and a flame.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say earth, mud, dust, smoke and a flame.*

201.1 la terre — earth, land

Before the new one: say the French for an attic, then the French for a vegetable garden.

You'll want to know: la terre

la terre — "earth, land".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

terre ← Old French *terre* ← Latin *terra*, "earth, land" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la terre*
- *Say it: la terre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la terre*
- *Recall:* say the French for an attic, then the French for a vegetable garden, then say *la terre* again

Before you move on

What does la terre mean? ("Earth, land".) Say it once more.

201.2 la boue — mud

Before the new one: say the French for a vegetable garden, then the French for earth.

You'll want to know: la boue

la boue — "mud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boue ← Gaulish **bawa*, "dirt" — a Celtic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boue*
- *Say it: la boue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vegetable garden, then the French for earth, then say *la boue* again

Before you move on

What does la boue mean? (“Mud”.) Say it once more.

201.3 la poussière — dust

Before the new one: say the French for earth, then the French for mud.

You’ll want to know: la poussière

la poussière — “dust”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poussière — built from Old French *pous*, “dust”, ← Vulgar Latin **pulvus*, from Latin *pulvis*, “dust” (Lewis & Short), with *-ière*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poussière*
- *Say it: la poussière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poussière*
- *Recall:* say the French for earth, then the French for mud, then say *la poussière* again

Before you move on

What does la poussière mean? (“Dust”.) Say it once more.

201.4 la fumée — smoke

Before the new one: say the French for mud, then the French for dust.

You'll want to know: la fumée

la fumée — "smoke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fumée is the past participle of *fumer*, "to smoke", used as a noun: what is smoked out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fumée*
- *Say it: la fumée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fumée*
- *Recall:* say the French for mud, then the French for dust, then say *la fumée* again

Before you move on

What does la fumée mean? ("Smoke".) Say it once more.

201.5 la flamme — a flame

Before the new one: say the French for dust, then the French for smoke.

You'll want to know: la flamme

la flamme — "a flame".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flamme ← Old French *flame* ← Latin *flamma*, "a flame" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la flamme*
- *Say it: la flamme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la flamme*
- *Recall:* say the French for dust, then the French for smoke, then say *la flamme* again

Before you move on

What does la flamme mean? ("A flame".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

Natural rubber, Metal, Brick, Small bag, Rope

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag and a rope.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag and a rope.

202.1 le caoutchouc — natural rubber

Before the new one: say the French for smoke, then the French for a flame.

You'll want to know: le caoutchouc

le caoutchouc — "natural rubber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caoutchouc ← Spanish *caucho* ← Quechua *kawchu* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caoutchouc*
- *Say it: le caoutchouc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le caoutchouc*
- *Recall:* say the French for smoke, then the French for a flame, then say *le caoutchouc* again

Before you move on

What does le caoutchouc mean? ("Natural rubber".) Say it once more.

202.2 le métal — metal

Before the new one: say the French for a flame, then the French for natural rubber.

You'll want to know: le métal

le métal — "metal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

métal ← Latin *metallum*, "a mine, a metal", from Greek *metallon* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le métal*
- *Say it: le métal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le métal*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flame, then the French for natural rubber, then say *le métal* again

Before you move on

What does le métal mean? (“Metal”.) Say it once more.

202.3 la brique — a brick

Before the new one: say the French for natural rubber, then the French for metal.

You’ll want to know: la brique

la brique — “a brick”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brique ← Middle Dutch *bricke* — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brique*
- *Say it: la brique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la brique*
- *Recall:* say the French for natural rubber, then the French for metal, then say *la brique* again

Before you move on

What does la brique mean? (“A brick”.) Say it once more.

202.4 le sachet — a small bag

Before the new one: say the French for metal, then the French for a brick.

You'll want to know: le sachet

le sachet — "a small bag".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sachet — *sac*, "bag", with *-et*, "little".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sachet*
- *Say it: le sachet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sachet*
- *Recall:* say the French for metal, then the French for a brick, then say *le sachet* again

Before you move on

What does le sachet mean? ("A small bag".) Say it once more.

202.5 la corde — a rope

Before the new one: say the French for a brick, then the French for a small bag.

You'll want to know: la corde

la corde — "a rope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

corde ← Old French *corde* ← Latin *chorda*, "a string of gut", from Greek *chorde* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la corde*
- *Say it: la corde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la corde*
- *Recall:* say the French for a brick, then the French for a small bag, then say *la corde* again

Before you move on

What does la corde mean? (“A rope”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach and a connection.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach and a connection.

203.1 la défaite — a defeat

Before the new one: say the French for a small bag, then the French for a rope.

You'll want to know: la défaite

la défaite — "a defeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défaite is the past participle of the verb for "to undo", used as a noun: an undoing. Old French had *desfait*, "undone" (EtymDB 2.1); the verb is built on Latin *facere*, "to do".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la défaite*
- *Say it: la défaite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la défaite*
- *Recall:* say the French for a small bag, then the French for a rope, then say *la défaite* again

Before you move on

What does la défaite mean? ("A defeat".) Say it once more.

203.2 le championnat — a championship

Before the new one: say the French for a rope, then the French for a defeat.

You'll want to know: le championnat

le championnat — "a championship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

championnat — built from the word for "champion", ← Medieval Latin *campio*, "a fighter in a duel", which EtymDB 2.1 takes from Frankish **kampjo*, "a fighter", with *-at*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le championnat*
- *Say it: le championnat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le championnat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rope, then the French for a defeat, then say *le championnat* again

Before you move on

What does le championnat mean? (“A championship”.) Say it once more.

203.3 le joueur — a player

Before the new one: say the French for a defeat, then the French for a championship.

You’ll want to know: le joueur

le joueur — “a player”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joueur — *jouer*, “to play”, with *-eur*, “one who”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le joueur*
- *Say it: le joueur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le joueur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a defeat, then the French for a championship, then say *le joueur* again

Before you move on

What does le joueur mean? (“A player”.) Say it once more.

203.4 l’entraîneur — a coach

Before the new one: say the French for a championship, then the French for a player.

You'll want to know: l'entraîneur

l'entraîneur — "a coach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entraîneur — built from the verb for "to train, to draw along", from *en-* and the verb for "to drag", ← Vulgar Latin **traginare*, from Latin *trahere*, "to draw" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entraîneur*
- *Say it: l'entraîneur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entraîneur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a championship, then the French for a player, then say *l'entraîneur* again

Before you move on

What does l'entraîneur mean? ("A coach".) Say it once more.

203.5 la correspondance — a connection

Before the new one: say the French for a player, then the French for a coach.

You'll want to know: la correspondance

la correspondance — "a connection".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

correspondance — built from the verb for "to correspond", ← Medieval Latin *correspondere*, from *com-* and *respondere*, "to answer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la correspondance*
- *Say it: la correspondance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la correspondance*
- *Recall:* say the French for a player, then the French for a coach, then say *la correspondance* again

Before you move on

What does la correspondance mean? ("A connection".) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

204.1 l'entretien — an interview

Before the new one: say the French for a coach, then the French for a connection.

You'll want to know: l'entretien

l'entretien — "an interview".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entretien — built from *entre-*, "between", and *tenir*, "to hold": a talk held between two.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entretien*
- *Say it: l'entretien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entretien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coach, then the French for a connection, then say *l'entretien* again

Before you move on

What does l'entretien mean? ("An interview".) Say it once more.

204.2 la carrière — a career

Before the new one: say the French for a connection, then the French for an interview.

You'll want to know: la carrière

la carrière — "a career".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carrière — the "career" sense ← Old Provençal *carreira*, "a road, a racecourse", from Late Latin *carraria*, "a cart road", from *carrus*, "a wagon" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carrière*
- *Say it: la carrière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carrière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a connection, then the French for an interview, then say *la carrière* again

Before you move on

What does la carrière mean? (“A career”.) Say it once more.

204.3 l’imprimante — a printer

Before the new one: say the French for an interview, then the French for a career.

You’ll want to know: l’imprimante

l’imprimante — “a printer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imprimante — the feminine present participle of the verb for “to print”, ← Latin *imprimere*, “to press into” (Lewis & Short): the printing machine.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’imprimante*
- *Say it: l’imprimante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’imprimante*
- *Recall:* say the French for an interview, then the French for a career, then say *l’imprimante* again

Before you move on

What does l’imprimante mean? (“A printer”.) Say it once more.

204.4 le téléphone portable — a mobile phone

Before the new one: say the French for a career, then the French for a printer.

You'll want to know: le téléphone portable

le téléphone portable — "a mobile phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphone portable — *téléphone* and *portable*, "that can be carried", ← Latin *portabilis*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le téléphone portable*
- *Say it: le téléphone portable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le téléphone portable*
- *Recall:* say the French for a career, then the French for a printer, then say *le téléphone portable* again

Before you move on

What does le téléphone portable mean? ("A mobile phone".) Say it once more.

204.5 la feuille de papier — a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the French for a printer, then the French for a mobile phone.

You'll want to know: la feuille de papier

la feuille de papier — "a sheet of paper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feuille de papier — *feuille*, "a leaf, a sheet", *de*, "of", and *papier*, "paper".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la feuille de papier*
- *Say it: la feuille de papier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la feuille de papier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a printer, then the French for a mobile phone, then say *la feuille de papier* again

Before you move on

What does la feuille de papier mean? ("A sheet of paper".) Say it once more.

204.6 Words from chapters 199-201 — a first pass

Say the words for a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat, a steering wheel
- a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic, a vegetable garden
- earth, mud, dust, smoke, a flame

Before you move on

An entrance? (**l'entrée**.) An exit? (**la sortie**.) Luggage? (**les bagages**.) A seat? (**le siège**.) A steering wheel? (**le volant**.) A gate? (**le portail**.) A fence? (**la clôture**.) A cellar? (**la cave**.) An attic? (**le grenier**.) A vegetable garden? (**le potager**.) Earth? (**la terre**.) Mud? (**la boue**.) Dust? (**la poussière**.) Smoke? (**la fumée**.) A flame? (**la flamme**.)

204.7 Words from chapters 202-204 — a second pass

Say the words for natural rubber and metal.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag, a rope
- a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach, a connection
- an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone, a sheet of paper

Before you move on

Natural rubber? (**le caoutchouc**.) Metal? (**le métal**.) A brick? (**la brique**.) A small bag? (**le sachet**.) A rope? (**la corde**.) A defeat? (**la défaite**.) A championship? (**le championnat**.) A player? (**le joueur**.) A coach? (**l'entraîneur**.) A connection? (**la correspondance**.) An interview? (**l'entretien**.) A career? (**la carrière**.) A printer? (**l'imprimante**.) A mobile phone? (**le téléphone portable**.) A sheet of paper? (**la feuille de papier**.)

Chapter 205

To book, To spend, To save, To order, To dry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to book, to spend, to save, to order and to dry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say to book, to spend, to save, to order and to dry.*

205.1 réserver — to book

Before the new one: say the French for a mobile phone, then the French for a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: réserver

réserver — "to book".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réserver ← Latin *reservare*, "to keep back" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réserver*
- *Say it: réserver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réserver*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mobile phone, then the French for a sheet of paper, then say *réserver* again

Before you move on

What does réserver mean? ("To book".) Say it once more.

205.2 dépenser — to spend (money)

Before the new one: say the French for a sheet of paper, then the French for to book.

You'll want to know: dépenser

dépenser — "to spend (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépenser ← Old French *despenser* ← Latin *dispensare*, "to weigh out, to pay out" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dépenser*
- *Say it: dépenser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépenser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheet of paper, then the French for to book, then say *dépenser* again

Before you move on

What does dépenser mean? ("To spend (money)".) Say it once more.

205.3 économiser — to save (money)

Before the new one: say the French for to book, then the French for to spend.

You'll want to know: économiser

économiser — "to save (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

économiser — built from the word for "economy", ← Latin *oeconomia*, from Greek *oikonomia*, "running a household" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-iser*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *économiser*
- *Say it:* *économiser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *économiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to book, then the French for to spend, then say *économiser* again

Before you move on

What does économiser mean? ("To save (money)".) Say it once more.

205.4 commander — to order

Before the new one: say the French for to spend, then the French for to save.

You'll want to know: commander

commander — "to order".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commander ← Old French *comander* ← Vulgar Latin **commandare*, from Latin *commendare*, "to entrust" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *commander*
- *Say it:* *commander*, once more
- *Say it:* say *commander*
- *Recall:* say the French for to spend, then the French for to save, then say *commander* again

Before you move on

What does commander mean? ("To order".) Say it once more.

205.5 sécher — to dry

Before the new one: say the French for to save, then the French for to order.

You'll want to know: sécher

sécher — "to dry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sécher ← Old French *secher* ← Latin *siccare*, "to dry", from *siccus*, the Latin of *sec* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sécher*
- *Say it: sécher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sécher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to save, then the French for to order, then say *sécher* again

Before you move on

What does sécher mean? ("To dry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 206

To break, To touch, To taste, To heat, To cool down

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to break, to touch, to taste, to heat and to cool down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say to break, to touch, to taste, to heat and to cool down.*

206.1 casser — to break

Before the new one: say the French for to order, then the French for to dry.

You'll want to know: casser

casser — "to break".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casser ← Old French *quasser* ← Latin *quassare*, "to shake hard, to shatter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: casser*
- *Say it: casser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *casser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to order, then the French for to dry, then say *casser* again

Before you move on

What does casser mean? ("To break".) Say it once more.

206.2 toucher — to touch

Before the new one: say the French for to dry, then the French for to break.

You'll want to know: toucher

toucher — "to touch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toucher ← Vulgar Latin **toccare*, "to knock", imitating the sound of a tap — inherited; the account is the usual one, not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toucher*
- *Say it: toucher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dry, then the French for to break, then say *toucher* again

Before you move on

What does toucher mean? (“To touch”.) Say it once more.

206.3 goûter — to taste

Before the new one: say the French for to break, then the French for to touch.

You’ll want to know: goûter

goûter — “to taste”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

goûter ← Old French *goster* ← Latin *gustare*, “to taste” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: goûter*
- *Say it: goûter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *goûter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to break, then the French for to touch, then say *goûter* again

Before you move on

What does goûter mean? (“To taste”.) Say it once more.

206.4 chauffer — to heat

Before the new one: say the French for to touch, then the French for to taste.

You'll want to know: chauffer

chauffer — "to heat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffer ← Old French *chauffer* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **calefare*, from Latin *calefacere*, "to make warm" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chauffer*
- *Say it: chauffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chauffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to touch, then the French for to taste, then say *chauffer* again

Before you move on

What does chauffer mean? ("To heat".) Say it once more.

206.5 refroidir — to cool down

Before the new one: say the French for to taste, then the French for to heat.

You'll want to know: refroidir

refroidir — "to cool down".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

refroidir — built from *re-* and the word for "cold", ← Latin *frigidus* (EtymDB 2.1), with the verb ending *-ir*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: refroidir*
- *Say it: refroidir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *refroidir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to taste, then the French for to heat, then say *refroidir* again

Before you move on

What does refroidir mean? ("To cool down".) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

To be born, To die, To grow old, To marry, To divorce

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry and to divorce.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry and to divorce.*

207.1 naître — to be born

Before the new one: say the French for to heat, then the French for to cool down.

You'll want to know: naître

naître — "to be born".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naître ← Old French *naistre* ← Vulgar Latin **nascere* ← Latin *nasci*, "to be born" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naître*
- *Say it:* *naître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to heat, then the French for to cool down, then say *naître* again

Before you move on

What does naître mean? (“To be born”.) Say it once more.

207.2 mourir — to die

Before the new one: say the French for to cool down, then the French for to be born.

You’ll want to know: mourir

mourir — “to die”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mourir ← Old French *morir* ← Vulgar Latin **morire* ← Latin *mori*, “to die” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mourir*
- *Say it:* *mourir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mourir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cool down, then the French for to be born, then say *mourir* again

Before you move on

What does mourir mean? (“To die”.) Say it once more.

207.3 vieillir — to grow old

Before the new one: say the French for to be born, then the French for to die.

You’ll want to know: vieillir

vieillir — “to grow old”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vieillir — built from *vieux*, “old”, with the verb ending *-ir*: to grow old. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vieillir*
- *Say it: vieillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vieillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be born, then the French for to die, then say *vieillir* again

Before you move on

What does vieillir mean? (“To grow old”.) Say it once more.

207.4 épouser — to marry

Before the new one: say the French for to die, then the French for to grow old.

You'll want to know: épouser

épouser — "to marry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épouser ← Old French *espouser* ← Latin *sponsare*, "to betroth" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *épouser*
- *Say it:* *épouser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *épouser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to die, then the French for to grow old, then say *épouser* again

Before you move on

What does épouser mean? ("To marry".) Say it once more.

207.5 divorcer — to divorce

Before the new one: say the French for to grow old, then the French for to marry.

You'll want to know: divorcer

divorcer — "to divorce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

divorcer — formed from the noun for "a divorce", the noun behind *divorcé*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: divorcer*
- *Say it: divorcer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *divorcer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to grow old, then the French for to marry, then say *divorcer* again

Before you move on

What does divorcer mean? ("To divorce".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

To applaud, To cross, To increase, To decrease, To warn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease and to warn.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease and to warn.

208.1 applaudir — to applaud

Before the new one: say the French for to marry, then the French for to divorce.

You'll want to know: applaudir

applaudir — "to applaud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

applaudir ← Latin *applaudere*, "to clap the hands" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: applaudir*
- *Say it: applaudir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *applaudir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to marry, then the French for to divorce, then say *applaudir* again

Before you move on

What does applaudir mean? ("To applaud".) Say it once more.

208.2 traverser — to cross

Before the new one: say the French for to divorce, then the French for to applaud.

You'll want to know: traverser

traverser — "to cross".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traverser ← Vulgar Latin **transversare*, from Latin *transversus*, "turned across" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: traverser*
- *Say it: traverser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *traverser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to divorce, then the French for to applaud, then say *traverser* again

Before you move on

What does traverser mean? ("To cross".) Say it once more.

208.3 augmenter — to increase

Before the new one: say the French for to applaud, then the French for to cross.

You'll want to know: augmenter

augmenter — "to increase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

augmenter ← Late Latin *augmentare*, from *augere*, "to increase" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: augmenter*
- *Say it: augmenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *augmenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to applaud, then the French for to cross, then say *augmenter* again

Before you move on

What does augmenter mean? ("To increase".) Say it once more.

208.4 diminuer — to decrease

Before the new one: say the French for to cross, then the French for to increase.

You'll want to know: diminuer

diminuer — "to decrease".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diminuer ← Latin *diminuere*, "to break into small pieces" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diminuer*
- *Say it: diminuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diminuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cross, then the French for to increase, then say *diminuer* again

Before you move on

What does diminuer mean? ("To decrease".) Say it once more.

208.5 prévenir — to warn

Before the new one: say the French for to increase, then the French for to decrease.

You'll want to know: prévenir

prévenir — "to warn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévenir ← Latin *praevenire*, "to come before" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: to warn is to get there first.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prévenir*
- *Say it: prévenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prévenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to increase, then the French for to decrease, then say *prévenir* again

Before you move on

What does prévenir mean? ("To warn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

To enjoy, To imagine, To point out, To inform, To complain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform and to complain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform and to complain.*

209.1 profiter — to enjoy, to make the most of

> Before the new one: say the French for to decrease, then the French for to warn.

You'll want to know: profiter

profiter — "to enjoy, to make the most of".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

profiter — formed from the word for "profit", ← Latin *profectus*, "progress, gain" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: profiter*
- *Say it: profiter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *profiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to decrease, then the French for to warn, then say *profiter* again

Before you move on

What does profiter mean? (“To enjoy, to make the most of”.) Say it once more.

209.2 imaginer — to imagine

Before the new one: say the French for to warn, then the French for to enjoy.

You’ll want to know: imaginer

imaginer — “to imagine”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imaginer ← Latin *imaginari*, “to picture”, from *imago*, “an image” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: imaginer*
- *Say it: imaginer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *imaginer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to warn, then the French for to enjoy, then say *imaginer* again

Before you move on

What does imaginer mean? ("To imagine".) Say it once more.

209.3 indiquer — to point out

Before the new one: say the French for to enjoy, then the French for to imagine.

You'll want to know: indiquer

indiquer — "to point out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

indiquer ← Latin *indicare*, "to point out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: indiquer*
- *Say it: indiquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *indiquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to enjoy, then the French for to imagine, then say *indiquer* again

Before you move on

What does indiquer mean? ("To point out".) Say it once more.

209.4 informer — to inform

Before the new one: say the French for to imagine, then the French for to point out.

You'll want to know: informer

informer — "to inform".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

informer ← Latin *informare*, "to give shape to, to describe" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: informer*
- *Say it: informer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *informer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to imagine, then the French for to point out, then say *informer* again

Before you move on

What does informer mean? ("To inform".) Say it once more.

209.5 se plaindre — to complain

Before the new one: say the French for to point out, then the French for to inform.

You'll want to know: se plaindre

se plaindre — "to complain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se plaindre ← Latin *plangere*, "to beat the breast, to lament" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se plaindre*
- *Say it: se plaindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se plaindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to point out, then the French for to inform, then say *se plaindre* again

Before you move on

What does se plaindre mean? ("To complain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

To reach, To achieve, To give a present, To give back, To recognise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back and to recognise.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back and to recognise.

210.1 atteindre — to reach

Before the new one: say the French for to inform, then the French for to complain.

You'll want to know: atteindre

atteindre — "to reach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atteindre ← Old French *ateindre* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *attingere*, "to touch upon, to reach" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atteindre*
- *Say it: atteindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atteindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to inform, then the French for to complain, then say *atteindre* again

Before you move on

What does atteindre mean? ("To reach".) Say it once more.

210.2 réaliser — to achieve

Before the new one: say the French for to complain, then the French for to reach.

You'll want to know: réaliser

réaliser — "to achieve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réaliser — built from the word for "real", ← Late Latin *realis*, from *res*, "a thing", with *-iser*: to make real. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réaliser*
- *Say it: réaliser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réaliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to complain, then the French for to reach, then say *réaliser* again

Before you move on

What does réaliser mean? (“To achieve”.) Say it once more.

210.3 offrir un cadeau — to give a present

Before the new one: say the French for to reach, then the French for to achieve.

You’ll want to know: offrir un cadeau

offrir un cadeau — “to give a present”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

offrir un cadeau — *offrir*, “to offer”, ← Latin *offerre* (EtymDB 2.1), *un*, “a”, and *cadeau*, “a present”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: offrir un cadeau*
- *Say it: offrir un cadeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *offrir un cadeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reach, then the French for to achieve, then say *offrir un cadeau* again

Before you move on

What does offrir un cadeau mean? (“To give a present”.) Say it once more.

210.4 rendre — to give back

Before the new one: say the French for to achieve, then the French for to give a present.

You'll want to know: rendre

rendre — "to give back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rendre ← Vulgar Latin **rendere* ← Latin *reddere*, "to give back" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, its *-n-* taken from the Latin verb for "to take".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rendre*
- *Say it: rendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to achieve, then the French for to give a present, then say *rendre* again

Before you move on

What does rendre mean? ("To give back".) Say it once more.

210.5 reconnaître — to recognise

Before the new one: say the French for to give a present, then the French for to give back.

You'll want to know: reconnaître

reconnaître — "to recognise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reconnaître ← Old French *reconoistre* ← Latin *recognoscere*, "to know anew" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *connaître* with *re-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *reconnaître*
- *Say it:* *reconnaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reconnaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give a present, then the French for to give back, then say *reconnaître* again

Before you move on

What does reconnaître mean? ("To recognise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

To be silent, To fear, To attempt, To transport, To kill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport and to kill.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport and to kill.

211.1 se taire — to be silent

Before the new one: say the French for to give back, then the French for to recognise.

You'll want to know: se taire

se taire — "to be silent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se taire ← Old French *taire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *tacere*, "to be silent" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se taire*
- *Say it: se taire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se taire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give back, then the French for to recognise, then say *se taire* again

Before you move on

What does se taire mean? ("To be silent".) Say it once more.

211.2 craindre — to fear

Before the new one: say the French for to recognise, then the French for to be silent.

You'll want to know: craindre

craindre — "to fear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

craindre — usually traced to Latin *tremere*, "to tremble" (Lewis & Short), whose *t-* became *c-*, perhaps under a Gaulish word — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: craindre*
- *Say it: craindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *craindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recognise, then the French for to be silent, then say *craindre* again

Before you move on

What does craindre mean? (“To fear”.) Say it once more.

211.3 tenter — to attempt

Before the new one: say the French for to be silent, then the French for to fear.

You’ll want to know: tenter

tenter — “to attempt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tenter ← Latin *temptare*, “to test, to try” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-mpt-* regularly became *-nt-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tenter*
- *Say it: tenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be silent, then the French for to fear, then say *tenter* again

Before you move on

What does tenter mean? (“To attempt”.) Say it once more.

211.4 transporter — to transport

Before the new one: say the French for to fear, then the French for to attempt.

You'll want to know: transporter

transporter — "to transport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

transporter ← Latin *transportare*, "to carry across" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: transporter*
- *Say it: transporter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *transporter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fear, then the French for to attempt, then say *transporter* again

Before you move on

What does transporter mean? ("To transport".) Say it once more.

211.5 tuer — to kill

Before the new one: say the French for to attempt, then the French for to transport.

You'll want to know: tuer

tuer — "to kill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tuer ← Old French *tuer* ← Vulgar Latin **tutare*, "to put out (a fire)", from Latin *tutari*, "to guard" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuer*
- *Say it: tuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to attempt, then the French for to transport, then say *tuer* again

Before you move on

What does tuer mean? ("To kill".) Say it once more.

Chapter 212

To fix, To brake, To function, To float, To chase

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fix, to brake, to function, to float and to chase.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say to fix, to brake, to function, to float and to chase.*

212.1 fixer — to fix, to stare at

> Before the new one: say the French for to transport, then the French for to kill.

You'll want to know: fixer

fixer — "to fix, to stare at".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fixer — built from the word for "fixed", ← Latin *fixus*, from *figere*, "to fasten". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fixer*
- *Say it: fixer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fixer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to transport, then the French for to kill, then say *fixer* again

Before you move on

What does fixer mean? ("To fix, to stare at".) Say it once more.

212.2 freiner — to brake

Before the new one: say the French for to kill, then the French for to fix.

You'll want to know: freiner

freiner — "to brake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

freiner — built from the word for "a bit, a brake", ← Latin *frenum*, "a bridle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: freiner*
- *Say it: freiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *freiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to kill, then the French for to fix, then say *freiner* again

Before you move on

What does freiner mean? ("To brake".) Say it once more.

212.3 fonctionner — to function, to work

Before the new one: say the French for to fix, then the French for to brake.

You'll want to know: fonctionner

fonctionner — "to function, to work".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fonctionner — built from the word for "function", ← Latin *functio*, "a performing", with *-er*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fonctionner*
- *Say it: fonctionner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fonctionner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fix, then the French for to brake, then say *fonctionner* again

Before you move on

What does fonctionner mean? ("To function, to work".) Say it once more.

212.4 flotter — to float

Before the new one: say the French for to brake, then the French for to function.

You'll want to know: flotter

flotter — "to float".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flotter ← Old French *floter* ← Frankish **flotan*, "to float" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: flotter*
- *Say it: flotter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *flotter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to brake, then the French for to function, then say *flotter* again

Before you move on

What does flotter mean? ("To float".) Say it once more.

212.5 poursuivre — to chase

Before the new one: say the French for to function, then the French for to float.

You'll want to know: poursuivre

poursuivre — "to chase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poursuivre ← Old French *porsivre* (EtymDB 2.1), from *pour-*, "forward", and the verb for "to follow", ← Latin *sequi* — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poursuivre*
- *Say it: poursuivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poursuivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to function, then the French for to float, then say *poursuivre* again

Before you move on

What does poursuivre mean? ("To chase".) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

To lift, To surprise, To suspect, To squeeze, To suggest

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze and to suggest.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze and to suggest.

213.1 soulever — to lift

Before the new one: say the French for to float, then the French for to chase.

You'll want to know: soulever

soulever — "to lift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soulever — *sou-*, "under", and *lever*, "to lift": to lift from beneath.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soulever*
- *Say it: soulever*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soulever*
- *Recall:* say the French for to float, then the French for to chase, then say *soulever* again

Before you move on

What does soulever mean? ("To lift".) Say it once more.

213.2 surprendre — to surprise

Before the new one: say the French for to chase, then the French for to lift.

You'll want to know: surprendre

surprendre — "to surprise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

surprendre ← Old French *sorprendre*, "to overtake": *sur-*, "over", and *prendre*, "to take". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: surprendre*
- *Say it: surprendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *surprendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chase, then the French for to lift, then say *surprendre* again

Before you move on

What does surprendre mean? ("To surprise".) Say it once more.

213.3 soupçonner — to suspect

Before the new one: say the French for to lift, then the French for to surprise.

You'll want to know: soupçonner

soupçonner — "to suspect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soupçonner — built from the word for "suspicion", ← Late Latin *suspectio*, from *suspicere*, "to look up at, to suspect" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soupçonner*
- *Say it: soupçonner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soupçonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lift, then the French for to surprise, then say *soupçonner* again

Before you move on

What does soupçonner mean? ("To suspect".) Say it once more.

213.4 serrer — to squeeze

Before the new one: say the French for to surprise, then the French for to suspect.

You'll want to know: serrer

serrer — "to squeeze".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serrer ← Old French *serrer* ← Vulgar Latin **serrare* ← Late Latin *serare*, "to bolt", from *sera*, "a bar" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb behind *serrure*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: serrer*
- *Say it: serrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *serrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to surprise, then the French for to suspect, then say *serrer* again

Before you move on

What does serrer mean? ("To squeeze".) Say it once more.

213.5 suggérer — to suggest

Before the new one: say the French for to suspect, then the French for to squeeze.

You'll want to know: suggérer

suggérer — "to suggest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suggérer ← Latin *suggerere*, "to bring up, to supply" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suggérer*
- *Say it: suggérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suggérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suspect, then the French for to squeeze, then say *suggérer* again

Before you move on

What does suggérer mean? ("To suggest".) Say it once more.

213.6 Words from chapters 205-208 — a first pass

Say the words for to squeeze and to suggest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to book, to spend, to save, to order, to dry
- to break, to touch, to taste, to heat, to cool down
- to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry, to divorce
- to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease, to warn

Before you move on

To book? (**réserver**.) To spend? (**dépenser**.) To save? (**économiser**.) To order? (**commander**.) To dry? (**sécher**.) To break? (**casser**.) To touch? (**toucher**.) To taste? (**goûter**.) To heat? (**chauffer**.) To cool down? (**refroidir**.) To be born? (**naître**.) To die? (**mourir**.) To grow old? (**vieillir**.) To marry?

(**épouser**.) To divorce? (**divorcer**.) To applaud? (**applaudir**.) To cross? (**traverser**.) To increase? (**augmenter**.) To decrease? (**diminuer**.) To warn? (**prévenir**.)

213.7 Words from chapters 209-213 — a second pass

Say the words for to enjoy and to imagine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform, to complain
- to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back, to recognise
- to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport, to kill
- to fix, to brake, to function, to float, to chase
- to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze, to suggest

Before you move on

To enjoy? (**profiter**.) To imagine? (**imaginer**.) To point out? (**indiquer**.) To inform? (**informer**.) To complain? (**se plaindre**.) To reach? (**atteindre**.) To achieve? (**réaliser**.) To give a present? (**offrir un cadeau**.) To give back? (**rendre**.) To recognise? (**reconnaître**.) To be silent? (**se taire**.) To fear? (**craindre**.) To attempt? (**tenter**.) To transport? (**transporter**.) To kill? (**tuer**.) To fix? (**fixer**.) To brake? (**freiner**.) To function? (**fonctionner**.) To float? (**flotter**.) To chase? (**poursuivre**.) To lift? (**soulever**.) To surprise? (**surprendre**.) To suspect? (**soupçonner**.) To squeeze? (**serrer**.) To suggest? (**suggérer**.)

Chapter 214

To record, To maintain, To exist, To express, To put on weight

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to record, to maintain, to exist, to express and to put on weight.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say to record, to maintain, to exist, to express and to put on weight.*

214.1 enregistrer — to record

> Before the new one: say the French for to squeeze, then the French for to suggest.

You'll want to know: enregistrer

enregistrer — "to record".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enregistrer — built from *en-*, the word for "a register", ← Medieval Latin *registrum* (EtymDB 2.1), and *-er*: to put in the register.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enregistrer*
- *Say it:* *enregistrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enregistrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to squeeze, then the French for to suggest, then say *enregistrer* again

Before you move on

What does enregistrer mean? ("To record".) Say it once more.

214.2 entretenir — to maintain

Before the new one: say the French for to suggest, then the French for to record.

You'll want to know: entretenir

entretenir — "to maintain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entretenir ← Old French *entretenir*: *entre-*, "between", and *tenir*, "to hold". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *entretenir*
- *Say it:* *entretenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *entretenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suggest, then the French for to record, then say *entretenir* again

Before you move on

What does entretenir mean? ("To maintain".) Say it once more.

214.3 exister — to exist

Before the new one: say the French for to record, then the French for to maintain.

You'll want to know: exister

exister — "to exist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exister ← Latin *existere*, "to stand out, to arise" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exister*
- *Say it: exister*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exister*
- *Recall:* say the French for to record, then the French for to maintain, then say *exister* again

Before you move on

What does exister mean? ("To exist".) Say it once more.

214.4 exprimer — to express

Before the new one: say the French for to maintain, then the French for to exist.

You'll want to know: exprimer

exprimer — "to express".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exprimer ← Latin *exprimere*, "to press out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exprimer*
- *Say it: exprimer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exprimer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to maintain, then the French for to exist, then say *exprimer* again

Before you move on

What does exprimer mean? ("To express".) Say it once more.

214.5 grossir — to put on weight

Before the new one: say the French for to exist, then the French for to express.

You'll want to know: grossir

grossir — "to put on weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grossir — *gros*, "fat", with the verb ending *-ir*: to grow fat.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grossir*
- *Say it: grossir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grossir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exist, then the French for to express, then say *grossir* again

Before you move on

What does grossir mean? (“To put on weight”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Flu, Prescription, Tablet, Syrup, Ointment

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup and an ointment.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup and an ointment.

215.1 la grippe — flu

Before the new one: say the French for to express, then the French for to put on weight.

You'll want to know: la grippe

la grippe — "flu".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grippe — formed from the verb for "to seize", from Frankish **gripan*, "to grab" (EtymDB 2.1): the illness that grabs you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grippe*
- *Say it: la grippe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grippe*
- *Recall:* say the French for to express, then the French for to put on weight, then say *la grippe* again

Before you move on

What does la grippe mean? ("Flu".) Say it once more.

215.2 l'ordonnance — a prescription

Before the new one: say the French for to put on weight, then the French for flu.

You'll want to know: l'ordonnance

l'ordonnance — "a prescription".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ordonnance — built from the verb for "to arrange, to order", ← Latin *ordinare*, from *ordo*, "order" (Lewis & Short), with *-ance*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ordonnance*
- *Say it: l'ordonnance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ordonnance*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put on weight, then the French for flu, then say *l'ordonnance* again

Before you move on

What does l'ordonnance mean? ("A prescription".) Say it once more.

215.3 le comprimé — a tablet (medicine)

Before the new one: say the French for flu, then the French for a prescription.

You'll want to know: le comprimé

le comprimé — "a tablet (medicine)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comprimé is the past participle of the verb for "to compress", ← Latin *comprimere*, "to press together" (Lewis & Short): a pressed tablet.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le comprimé*
- *Say it: le comprimé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le comprimé*
- *Recall:* say the French for flu, then the French for a prescription, then say *le comprimé* again

Before you move on

What does le comprimé mean? ("A tablet (medicine)".) Say it once more.

215.4 le sirop — a syrup

Before the new one: say the French for a prescription, then the French for a tablet.

You'll want to know: le sirop

le sirop — "a syrup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sirop ← Medieval Latin *siruppus*, from Arabic *sharab*, "a drink" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sirop*
- *Say it: le sirop*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sirop*
- *Recall:* say the French for a prescription, then the French for a tablet, then say *le sirop* again

Before you move on

What does le sirop mean? ("A syrup".) Say it once more.

215.5 la pommade — an ointment

Before the new one: say the French for a tablet, then the French for a syrup.

You'll want to know: la pommade

la pommade — "an ointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pommade ← Italian *pomata*, from *pomo*, "apple", ← Latin *pomum* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the first ointments were made with apples.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pommade*
- *Say it: la pommade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pommade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tablet, then the French for a syrup, then say *la pommade* again

Before you move on

What does la pommade mean? ("An ointment".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Around, Everywhere, Elsewhere, Up there, Suburbs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there and the suburbs.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there and the suburbs.

216.1 autour — around

Before the new one: say the French for a syrup, then the French for an ointment.

You'll want to know: autour

autour — "around".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autour — *au* and the word for "a turn", ← Latin *tornus*, "a lathe": round about. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: autour*
- *Say it: autour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *autour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a syrup, then the French for an ointment, then say *autour* again

Before you move on

What does autour mean? ("Around".) Say it once more.

216.2 partout — everywhere

Before the new one: say the French for an ointment, then the French for around.

You'll want to know: partout

partout — "everywhere".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partout — the words for "through" and "all", the second ← Latin *totus* (EtymDB 2.1): through all places.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: partout*
- *Say it: partout*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partout*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ointment, then the French for around, then say *partout* again

Before you move on

What does partout mean? ("Everywhere".) Say it once more.

216.3 ailleurs — elsewhere

Before the new one: say the French for around, then the French for everywhere.

You'll want to know: ailleurs

ailleurs — "elsewhere".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ailleurs ← Old French *aillors* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *aliorsum*, "toward another place" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ailleurs*
- *Say it: ailleurs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ailleurs*
- *Recall:* say the French for around, then the French for everywhere, then say *ailleurs* again

Before you move on

What does ailleurs mean? ("Elsewhere".) Say it once more.

216.4 là-haut — up there

Before the new one: say the French for everywhere, then the French for elsewhere.

You'll want to know: là-haut

là-haut — "up there".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

là-haut — *là*, "there", and *haut*, "high".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: là-haut*
- *Say it: là-haut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *là-haut*
- *Recall:* say the French for everywhere, then the French for elsewhere, then say *là-haut* again

Before you move on

What does là-haut mean? ("Up there".) Say it once more.

216.5 la banlieue — the suburbs

Before the new one: say the French for elsewhere, then the French for up there.

You'll want to know: la banlieue

la banlieue — "the suburbs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banlieue ← Medieval Latin *banleuca*: *ban*, "a lord's rule", a Frankish word, and *leuca*, "a league", a Gaulish one — the land within a league of a town. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banlieue*
- *Say it: la banlieue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banlieue*
- *Recall:* say the French for elsewhere, then the French for up there, then say *la banlieue* again

Before you move on

What does la banlieue mean? ("The suburbs".) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Almost, About, Only, Together, Nevertheless

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say almost, about, only, together and nevertheless.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say almost, about, only, together and nevertheless.

217.1 presque — almost

Before the new one: say the French for up there, then the French for the suburbs.

You'll want to know: presque

presque — "almost".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

presque — *près*, "near", and *que*, "that": nearly.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: presque*
- *Say it: presque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *presque*
- *Recall:* say the French for up there, then the French for the suburbs, then say *presque* again

Before you move on

What does presque mean? ("Almost".) Say it once more.

217.2 environ — about, approximately

Before the new one: say the French for the suburbs, then the French for almost.

You'll want to know: environ

environ — "about, approximately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

environ — *en*, "in", and Old French *viron*, "a circuit", from the verb for "to turn": in the round of.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: environ*
- *Say it: environ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *environ*
- *Recall:* say the French for the suburbs, then the French for almost, then say *environ* again

Before you move on

What does environ mean? ("About, approximately".) Say it once more.

217.3 seulement — only

Before the new one: say the French for almost, then the French for about.

You'll want to know: seulement

seulement — "only".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seulement — the word for "alone", ← Latin *solus* (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: seulement*
- *Say it: seulement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *seulement*
- *Recall:* say the French for almost, then the French for about, then say *seulement* again

Before you move on

What does seulement mean? ("Only".) Say it once more.

217.4 ensemble — together

Before the new one: say the French for about, then the French for only.

You'll want to know: ensemble

ensemble — "together".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ensemble ← Late Latin *insimul*, "at the same time", from *simul*, "together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ensemble*
- *Say it: ensemble*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ensemble*
- *Recall:* say the French for about, then the French for only, then say *ensemble* again

Before you move on

What does ensemble mean? ("Together".) Say it once more.

217.5 cependant — nevertheless, however

Before the new one: say the French for only, then the French for together.

You'll want to know: cependant

cependant — "nevertheless, however".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cependant — *ce*, "this", and the word for "during", from the verb for "to hang", ← Latin *pendere* (EtymDB 2.1): "during this".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cependant*
- *Say it:* *cependant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cependant*
- *Recall:* say the French for only, then the French for together, then say *cependant* again

Before you move on

What does cependant mean? ("Nevertheless, however".) Say it once more.

Chapter 218

Curious, Jealous, Proud, Nervous, Quiet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say curious, jealous, proud, nervous and quiet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say curious, jealous, proud, nervous and quiet.

218.1 curieux / curieuse — curious

Before the new one: say the French for together, then the French for nevertheless.

You'll want to know: curieux / curieuse

curieux / curieuse — "curious".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

curieux ← Latin *curiosus*, "careful, inquisitive", from *cura*, "care" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: curieux / curieuse*
- *Say it: curieux / curieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *curieux / curieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for together, then the French for nevertheless, then say *curieux / curieuse* again

Before you move on

What does curieux / curieuse mean? ("Curious".) Say it once more.

218.2 jaloux / jalouse — jealous

Before the new one: say the French for nevertheless, then the French for curious.

You'll want to know: jaloux / jalouse

jaloux / jalouse — "jealous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jaloux ← Old French *jalous* ← Late Latin *zelosus*, from *zelus*, "zeal", from Greek *zelos* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jaloux / jalouse*
- *Say it: jaloux / jalouse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jaloux / jalouse*
- *Recall:* say the French for nevertheless, then the French for curious, then say *jaloux / jalouse* again

Before you move on

What does jaloux / jalouse mean? ("Jealous".) Say it once more.

218.3 fier / fière — proud

Before the new one: say the French for curious, then the French for jealous.

You'll want to know: fier / fière

fier / fière — "proud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fier ← Latin *ferus*, "wild, untamed" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: fierce first, then proud.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fier / fière*
- *Say it: fier / fière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fier / fière*
- *Recall:* say the French for curious, then the French for jealous, then say *fier / fière* again

Before you move on

What does fier / fière mean? ("Proud".) Say it once more.

218.4 nerveux / nerveuse — nervous

Before the new one: say the French for jealous, then the French for proud.

You'll want to know: nerveux / nerveuse

nerveux / nerveuse — "nervous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nerveux ← Old French *nerveus* ← Latin *nervosus*, "sinewy", from *nervus*, "a sinew" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nerveux / nerveuse*
- *Say it: nerveux / nerveuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nerveux / nerveuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for jealous, then the French for proud, then say *nerveux / nerveuse* again

Before you move on

What does nerveux / nerveuse mean? ("Nervous".) Say it once more.

218.5 tranquille — quiet, peaceful

Before the new one: say the French for proud, then the French for nervous.

You'll want to know: tranquille

tranquille — "quiet, peaceful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tranquille ← Latin *tranquillus*, "calm" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tranquille*
- *Say it: tranquille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tranquille*
- *Recall:* say the French for proud, then the French for nervous, then say *tranquille* again

Before you move on

What does tranquille mean? ("Quiet, peaceful".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Boring, Fun, Strange, Different, Same

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say boring, fun, strange, different and the same.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say boring, fun, strange, different and the same.

219.1 ennuyeux / ennuyeuse — boring

Before the new one: say the French for nervous, then the French for quiet.

You'll want to know: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse

ennuyeux / ennuyeuse — "boring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ennuyeux — built from the noun beside *s'ennuyer*, with *-eux*, "full of": full of boredom.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
- *Say it: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for nervous, then the French for quiet, then say *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse* again

Before you move on

What does ennuyeux / ennuyeuse mean? ("Boring".) Say it once more.

219.2 amusant / amusante — fun, amusing

Before the new one: say the French for quiet, then the French for boring.

You'll want to know: amusant / amusante

amusant / amusante — "fun, amusing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amusant is the present participle of the verb in *s'amuser*, "to amuse": amusing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amusant / amusante*
- *Say it: amusant / amusante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amusant / amusante*
- *Recall:* say the French for quiet, then the French for boring, then say *amusant / amusante* again

Before you move on

What does amusant / amusante mean? ("Fun, amusing".) Say it once more.

219.3 étrange — strange

Before the new one: say the French for boring, then the French for fun.

You'll want to know: étrange

étrange — "strange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étrange ← Old French *estrange* ← Latin *extraneus*, "from outside, foreign" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étrange*
- *Say it: étrange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étrange*
- *Recall:* say the French for boring, then the French for fun, then say *étrange* again

Before you move on

What does étrange mean? ("Strange".) Say it once more.

219.4 différent / différente — different

Before the new one: say the French for fun, then the French for strange.

You'll want to know: différent / différente

différent / différente — "different".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

différent ← Latin *differens*, "carrying apart", from *differre* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: différent / différente*
- *Say it: différent / différente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *différent / différente*
- *Recall:* say the French for fun, then the French for strange, then say *différent / différente* again

Before you move on

What does différent / différente mean? ("Different".) Say it once more.

219.5 pareil / pareille — the same

Before the new one: say the French for strange, then the French for different.

You'll want to know: pareil / pareille

pareil / pareille — "the same".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pareil ← Middle French *pareil* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **pariculus*, from Latin *par*, "equal" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pareil / pareille*
- *Say it: pareil / pareille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pareil / pareille*
- *Recall:* say the French for strange, then the French for different, then say *pareil / pareille* again

Before you move on

What does pareil / pareille mean? ("The same".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

Punctual, Foreign, Friendly, Honest, Patient

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say punctual, foreign, friendly, honest and patient.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say punctual, foreign, friendly, honest and patient.*

220.1 ponctuel / ponctuelle — punctual

> Before the new one: say the French for different, then the French for the same.

You'll want to know: ponctuel / ponctuelle

ponctuel / ponctuelle — "punctual".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ponctuel ← Medieval Latin *punctualis*, from *punctus*, "a point" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ponctuel / ponctuelle*
- *Say it: ponctuel / ponctuelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ponctuel / ponctuelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for different, then the French for the same, then say *ponctuel / ponctuelle* again

Before you move on

What does ponctuel / ponctuelle mean? ("Punctual".) Say it once more.

220.2 étranger / étrangère — foreign

Before the new one: say the French for the same, then the French for punctual.

You'll want to know: étranger / étrangère

étranger / étrangère — "foreign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étranger — built from *étrange*, then meaning "foreign", with *-ier*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étranger / étrangère*
- *Say it: étranger / étrangère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étranger / étrangère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the same, then the French for punctual, then say *étranger / étrangère* again

Before you move on

What does étranger / étrangère mean? (“Foreign”.) Say it once more.

220.3 aimable — friendly

Before the new one: say the French for punctual, then the French for foreign.

You’ll want to know: aimable

aimable — “friendly”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aimable ← Latin *amabilis*, “lovable” (Lewis & Short) — inherited, reshaped on *aimer*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aimable*
- *Say it: aimable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aimable*
- *Recall:* say the French for punctual, then the French for foreign, then say *aimable* again

Before you move on

What does aimable mean? (“Friendly”.) Say it once more.

220.4 honnête — honest

Before the new one: say the French for foreign, then the French for friendly.

You'll want to know: honnête

honnête — "honest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

honnête ← Old French *honeste* ← Latin *honestus*, "honourable", from *honor* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: honnête*
- *Say it: honnête*, once more
- *Say it:* say *honnête*
- *Recall:* say the French for foreign, then the French for friendly, then say *honnête* again

Before you move on

What does honnête mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

220.5 patient / patiente — patient

Before the new one: say the French for friendly, then the French for honest.

You'll want to know: patient / patiente

patient / patiente — "patient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patient ← Latin *patiens*, *patientis*, "enduring", from *pati*, "to suffer" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patient / paciente*
- *Say it: patient / paciente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patient / paciente*
- *Recall:* say the French for friendly, then the French for honest, then say *patient / paciente* again

Before you move on

What does patient / paciente mean? ("Patient".) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Scissors, Watch, Pyjamas, Button, Peach

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button and a peach.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button and a peach.

221.1 les ciseaux — scissors

Before the new one: say the French for honest, then the French for patient.

You'll want to know: les ciseaux

les ciseaux — "scissors".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ciseaux is the plural of the word for "a chisel", usually traced to Late Latin *cisorium*, "a cutting tool", from *caedere*, "to cut" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les ciseaux*
- *Say it: les ciseaux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les ciseaux*
- *Recall:* say the French for honest, then the French for patient, then say *les ciseaux* again

Before you move on

What does les ciseaux mean? ("Scissors".) Say it once more.

221.2 la montre — a watch

Before the new one: say the French for patient, then the French for scissors.

You'll want to know: la montre

la montre — "a watch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montre — formed from *montrer*, "to show": the thing that shows the time.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la montre*
- *Say it: la montre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la montre*
- *Recall:* say the French for patient, then the French for scissors, then say *la montre* again

Before you move on

What does la montre mean? (“A watch”.) Say it once more.

221.3 le pyjama — pyjamas

Before the new one: say the French for scissors, then the French for a watch.

You’ll want to know: le pyjama

le pyjama — “pyjamas”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pyjama ← English *pyjamas*, from Hindi *pajama*, from Persian, “a leg garment” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pyjama*
- *Say it: le pyjama*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pyjama*
- *Recall:* say the French for scissors, then the French for a watch, then say *le pyjama* again

Before you move on

What does le pyjama mean? (“Pyjamas”.) Say it once more.

221.4 le bouton — a button

Before the new one: say the French for a watch, then the French for pyjamas.

You'll want to know: le bouton

le bouton — "a button".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouton ← Old French *boton*, built from *boter*, "to push, to sprout" (EtymDB 2.1): a bud, then a button.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bouton*
- *Say it: le bouton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bouton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a watch, then the French for pyjamas, then say *le bouton* again

Before you move on

What does le bouton mean? ("A button".) Say it once more.

221.5 la pêche — a peach

Before the new one: say the French for pyjamas, then the French for a button.

You'll want to know: la pêche

la pêche — "a peach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pêche ← Old French *pesche* ← Vulgar Latin **pessica*, from Latin *persica*, "the Persian (apple)" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pêche*
- *Say it: la pêche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pêche*
- *Recall:* say the French for pyjamas, then the French for a button, then say *la pêche* again

Before you move on

What does la pêche mean? ("A peach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Society, Government, Law, Court, Judge

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say society, the government, a law, a court and a judge.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say society, the government, a law, a court and a judge.

222.1 la société — society

Before the new one: say the French for a button, then the French for a peach.

You'll want to know: la société

la société — "society".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

société ← Latin *societas*, "fellowship", from *socius*, "a companion" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la société*
- *Say it: la société*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la société*
- *Recall:* say the French for a button, then the French for a peach, then say *la société* again

Before you move on

What does la société mean? ("Society".) Say it once more.

222.2 le gouvernement — the government

Before the new one: say the French for a peach, then the French for society.

You'll want to know: le gouvernement

le gouvernement — "the government".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gouvernement — built from the verb for "to govern", ← Latin *gubernare*, "to steer a ship" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gouvernement*
- *Say it: le gouvernement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gouvernement*
- *Recall:* say the French for a peach, then the French for society, then say *le gouvernement* again

Before you move on

What does le gouvernement mean? ("The government".) Say it once more.

222.3 la loi — a law

Before the new one: say the French for society, then the French for the government.

You'll want to know: la loi

la loi — "a law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loi ← Old French *loi* ← Latin *lex*, *legis*, "law" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la loi*
- *Say it: la loi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la loi*
- *Recall:* say the French for society, then the French for the government, then say *la loi* again

Before you move on

What does la loi mean? ("A law".) Say it once more.

222.4 le tribunal — a court

Before the new one: say the French for the government, then the French for a law.

You'll want to know: le tribunal

le tribunal — "a court".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tribunal ← Latin *tribunal*, "the raised seat of the tribunes" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tribunal*
- *Say it: le tribunal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tribunal*
- *Recall:* say the French for the government, then the French for a law, then say *le tribunal* again

Before you move on

What does le tribunal mean? ("A court".) Say it once more.

222.5 le juge — a judge

Before the new one: say the French for a law, then the French for a court.

You'll want to know: le juge

le juge — "a judge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juge ← Old French *juge* ← Latin *iudex*, *iudicis*, "a judge", from *ius*, "law", and *dicere*, "to say" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le juge*
- *Say it: le juge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le juge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a law, then the French for a court, then say *le juge* again

Before you move on

What does le juge mean? ("A judge".) Say it once more.

222.6 Words from chapters 214-217 — a first pass

Say the words for a court and a judge.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to record, to maintain, to exist, to express, to put on weight
- flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup, an ointment
- around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there, the suburbs
- almost, about, only, together, nevertheless

Before you move on

To record? (**enregistrer**.) To maintain? (**entretenir**.) To exist? (**exister**.) To express? (**exprimer**.) To put on weight? (**grossir**.) Flu? (**la grippe**.) A prescription? (**l'ordonnance**.) A tablet? (**le comprimé**.) A syrup? (**le sirop**.) An ointment? (**la pommade**.) Around? (**autour**.) Everywhere? (**partout**.) Elsewhere?

(**ailleurs**.) Up there? (**là-haut**.) The suburbs? (**la banlieue**.) Almost? (**presque**.) About? (**environ**.) Only? (**seulement**.) Together? (**ensemble**.) Nevertheless? (**cependant**.)

222.7 Words from chapters 218-222 — a second pass

Say the words for curious and jealous.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- curious, jealous, proud, nervous, quiet
- boring, fun, strange, different, the same
- punctual, foreign, friendly, honest, patient
- scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button, a peach
- society, the government, a law, a court, a judge

Before you move on

Curious? (**curieux / curieuse**.) Jealous? (**jaloux / jalouse**.) Proud? (**fier / fière**.) Nervous? (**nerveux / nerveuse**.) Quiet? (**tranquille**.) Boring? (**ennuyeux / ennuyeuse**.) Fun? (**amusant / amusante**.) Strange? (**étrange**.) Different? (**différent / différente**.) The same? (**pareil / pareille**.) Punctual? (**ponctuel / ponctuelle**.) Foreign? (**étranger / étrangère**.) Friendly? (**aimable**.) Honest? (**honnête**.) Patient? (**patient / patiente**.) Scissors? (**les ciseaux**.) A watch? (**la montre**.) Pyjamas? (**le pyjama**.) A button? (**le bouton**.) A peach? (**la pêche**.) Society? (**la société**.) The government? (**le gouvernement**.) A law? (**la loi**.) A court? (**le tribunal**.) A judge? (**le juge**.)

Chapter 223

Battery, Charger, Singer, Concert, Show

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert and a show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert and a show.*

223.1 la batterie — a battery

Before the new one: say the French for a court, then the French for a judge.

You'll want to know: la batterie

la batterie — "a battery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

batterie — built from the verb for "to beat", ← Latin *battuere*, with *-erie* (EtymDB 2.1): guns firing together, then cells working together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la batterie*
- *Say it: la batterie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la batterie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a court, then the French for a judge, then say *la batterie* again

Before you move on

What does la batterie mean? (“A battery”.) Say it once more.

223.2 le chargeur — a charger

Before the new one: say the French for a judge, then the French for a battery.

You’ll want to know: le chargeur

le chargeur — “a charger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chargeur — built from the verb for “to load”, ← Late Latin *carricare* (EtymDB 2.1), from *carrus*, “a wagon”, with *-eur*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chargeur*
- *Say it: le chargeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chargeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a judge, then the French for a battery, then say *le chargeur* again

Before you move on

What does le chargeur mean? (“A charger”.) Say it once more.

223.3 le chanteur — a singer

Before the new one: say the French for a battery, then the French for a charger.

You’ll want to know: le chanteur

le chanteur — “a singer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chanteur ← Old French *chanteor* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *cantator*, *cantatoris*, “a singer”, from *cantare*, “to sing” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the same root as *chanson*. Latin *cantor* gave a different word, the one for a church precentor.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chanteur*
- *Say it: le chanteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chanteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a battery, then the French for a charger, then say *le chanteur* again

Before you move on

What does le chanteur mean? (“A singer”.) Say it once more.

223.4 le concert — a concert

Before the new one: say the French for a charger, then the French for a singer.

You'll want to know: le concert

le concert — "a concert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concert ← Italian *concerto*, "an agreement, a concert" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le concert*
- *Say it: le concert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le concert*
- *Recall:* say the French for a charger, then the French for a singer, then say *le concert* again

Before you move on

What does le concert mean? ("A concert".) Say it once more.

223.5 le spectacle — a show

Before the new one: say the French for a singer, then the French for a concert.

You'll want to know: le spectacle

le spectacle — "a show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spectacle ← Latin *spectaculum*, "a show", from *spectare*, "to watch" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le spectacle*
- *Say it: le spectacle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le spectacle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a singer, then the French for a concert, then say *le spectacle* again

Before you move on

What does le spectacle mean? ("A show".) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

Employee, Pilot, Accountant, Scientist, Researcher

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist and a researcher.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist and a researcher.*

224.1 l'employé — an employee

> Before the new one: say the French for a concert, then the French for a show.

You'll want to know: l'employé

l'employé — "an employee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

employé is the past participle of the verb for "to employ", ← Latin *implicare*, "to involve" (Lewis & Short), used as a noun: one employed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'employé*
- *Say it: l'employé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'employé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a concert, then the French for a show, then say *l'employé* again

Before you move on

What does l'employé mean? ("An employee".) Say it once more.

224.2 le pilote — a pilot

Before the new one: say the French for a show, then the French for an employee.

You'll want to know: le pilote

le pilote — "a pilot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pilote ← Italian *pilota*, from a Medieval Greek word for "steersman", built on *pedon*, "an oar" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pilote*
- *Say it: le pilote*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pilote*
- *Recall:* say the French for a show, then the French for an employee, then say *le pilote* again

Before you move on

What does le pilote mean? ("A pilot".) Say it once more.

224.3 le comptable — an accountant

Before the new one: say the French for an employee, then the French for a pilot.

You'll want to know: le comptable

le comptable — "an accountant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comptable — *compter*, "to count", with *-able*: one who keeps the counts.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le comptable*
- *Say it: le comptable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le comptable*
- *Recall:* say the French for an employee, then the French for a pilot, then say *le comptable* again

Before you move on

What does le comptable mean? ("An accountant".) Say it once more.

224.4 le scientifique — a scientist

Before the new one: say the French for a pilot, then the French for an accountant.

You'll want to know: le scientifique

le scientifique — "a scientist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

scientifique ← Latin *scientificus*, "making knowledge", from *scientia*, "knowledge" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le scientifique*
- *Say it: le scientifique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le scientifique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pilot, then the French for an accountant, then say *le scientifique* again

Before you move on

What does le scientifique mean? ("A scientist".) Say it once more.

224.5 le chercheur — a researcher

Before the new one: say the French for an accountant, then the French for a scientist.

You'll want to know: le chercheur

le chercheur — "a researcher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chercheur — *chercher*, "to look for", with *-eur*: one who searches.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chercheur*
- *Say it: le chercheur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chercheur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an accountant, then the French for a scientist, then say *le chercheur* again

Before you move on

What does le chercheur mean? (“A researcher”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 225

Experience, Choice, Decision, Possibility, Reason

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility and a reason.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility and a reason.*

225.1 l'expérience — experience

> Before the new one: say the French for a scientist, then the French for a researcher.

You'll want to know: l'expérience

l'expérience — "experience".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expérience ← Latin *experientia*, "a trial, a test", from *experiri*, "to try" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'expérience*
- *Say it: l'expérience*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'expérience*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scientist, then the French for a researcher, then say *l'expérience* again

Before you move on

What does l'expérience mean? ("Experience".) Say it once more.

225.2 le choix — a choice

Before the new one: say the French for a researcher, then the French for experience.

You'll want to know: le choix

le choix — "a choice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

choix ← Old French *chois*, formed from the verb for "to choose" (EtymDB 2.1), which came from a Germanic verb meaning "to test, to taste".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le choix*
- *Say it: le choix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le choix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a researcher, then the French for experience, then say *le choix* again

Before you move on

What does le choix mean? ("A choice".) Say it once more.

225.3 la décision — a decision

Before the new one: say the French for experience, then the French for a choice.

You'll want to know: la décision

la décision — "a decision".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décision ← Latin *decisio*, "a settling", the noun beside *décider* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la décision*
- *Say it: la décision*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la décision*
- *Recall:* say the French for experience, then the French for a choice, then say *la décision* again

Before you move on

What does la décision mean? ("A decision".) Say it once more.

225.4 la possibilité — a possibility

Before the new one: say the French for a choice, then the French for a decision.

You'll want to know: la possibilité

la possibilité — "a possibility".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

possibilité ← Latin *possibilitas*, from *possibilis*, "possible", from *posse*, "to be able" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la possibilité*
- *Say it: la possibilité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la possibilité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a choice, then the French for a decision, then say *la possibilité* again

Before you move on

What does la possibilité mean? ("A possibility".) Say it once more.

225.5 la raison — a reason

Before the new one: say the French for a decision, then the French for a possibility.

You'll want to know: la raison

la raison — "a reason".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raison ← Latin *ratio*, *rationis*, "reckoning, reason" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la raison*
- *Say it: la raison*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la raison*
- *Recall:* say the French for a decision, then the French for a possibility, then say *la raison* again

Before you move on

What does la raison mean? ("A reason".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

Bank card, Cash machine, Bank account, Loan, Debt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan and a debt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan and a debt.

226.1 la carte bancaire — a bank card

Before the new one: say the French for a possibility, then the French for a reason.

You'll want to know: la carte bancaire

la carte bancaire — "a bank card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte bancaire — *carte*, "card", and the adjective made from *banque*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte bancaire*
- *Say it: la carte bancaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte bancaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a possibility, then the French for a reason, then say *la carte bancaire* again

Before you move on

What does la carte bancaire mean? ("A bank card".) Say it once more.

226.2 le distributeur — a cash machine

Before the new one: say the French for a reason, then the French for a bank card.

You'll want to know: le distributeur

le distributeur — "a cash machine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

distributeur ← Late Latin *distributor*, "one who hands out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le distributeur*
- *Say it: le distributeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le distributeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a reason, then the French for a bank card, then say *le distributeur* again

Before you move on

What does le distributeur mean? ("A cash machine".) Say it once more.

226.3 le compte bancaire — a bank account

Before the new one: say the French for a bank card, then the French for a cash machine.

You'll want to know: le compte bancaire

le compte bancaire — "a bank account".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compte bancaire — *compte*, "an account", from *compter*, and the adjective made from *banque*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le compte bancaire*
- *Say it: le compte bancaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le compte bancaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank card, then the French for a cash machine, then say *le compte bancaire* again

Before you move on

What does le compte bancaire mean? ("A bank account".) Say it once more.

226.4 le prêt — a loan

Before the new one: say the French for a cash machine, then the French for a bank account.

You'll want to know: le prêt

le prêt — "a loan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêt — formed from *prêter*, "to lend": a thing lent.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le prêt*
- *Say it: le prêt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le prêt*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cash machine, then the French for a bank account, then say *le prêt* again

Before you move on

What does le prêt mean? ("A loan".) Say it once more.

226.5 la dette — a debt

Before the new one: say the French for a bank account, then the French for a loan.

You'll want to know: la dette

la dette — "a debt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dette ← Latin *debita*, "things owed", from *debere*, the Latin of *devoir* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dette*
- *Say it: la dette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la dette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank account, then the French for a loan, then say *la dette* again

Before you move on

What does la dette mean? ("A debt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

Wheel, Engine, Toll, Motorway, Fine

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway and a fine.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway and a fine.*

227.1 la roue — a wheel

> Before the new one: say the French for a loan, then the French for a debt.

You'll want to know: la roue

la roue — "a wheel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

roue ← Old French *ruee* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *rota*, "a wheel" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la roue*
- *Say it: la roue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la roue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a loan, then the French for a debt, then say *la roue* again

Before you move on

What does la roue mean? ("A wheel".) Say it once more.

227.2 le moteur — an engine

Before the new one: say the French for a debt, then the French for a wheel.

You'll want to know: le moteur

le moteur — "an engine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moteur ← Latin *motor*, "a mover", from *movere*, "to move" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le moteur*
- *Say it: le moteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le moteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a debt, then the French for a wheel, then say *le moteur* again

Before you move on

What does le moteur mean? (“An engine”.) Say it once more.

227.3 le péage — a toll

Before the new one: say the French for a wheel, then the French for an engine.

You’ll want to know: le péage

le péage — “a toll”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

péage ← Medieval Latin *pedaticum*, “the right to set foot”, from *pes*, *pedis*, the Latin of *pied* — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le péage*
- *Say it: le péage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le péage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wheel, then the French for an engine, then say *le péage* again

Before you move on

What does le péage mean? (“A toll”.) Say it once more.

227.4 l’autoroute — a motorway

Before the new one: say the French for an engine, then the French for a toll.

You'll want to know: l'autoroute

l'autoroute — "a motorway".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autoroute — *auto-*, from the word for "motor car", and the word for "a road", ← Latin *via rupta*, "a road broken through" (Lewis & Short for *rumpere*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'autoroute*
- *Say it: l'autoroute*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'autoroute*
- *Recall:* say the French for an engine, then the French for a toll, then say *l'autoroute* again

Before you move on

What does l'autoroute mean? ("A motorway".) Say it once more.

227.5 l'amende — a fine

Before the new one: say the French for a toll, then the French for a motorway.

You'll want to know: l'amende

l'amende — "a fine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amende — formed from the verb for "to make amends", ← Latin *emendare*, "to correct" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amende*
- *Say it: l'amende*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amende*
- *Recall:* say the French for a toll, then the French for a motorway, then say *l'amende* again

Before you move on

What does l'amende mean? ("A fine".) Say it once more.

227.6 Words from chapters 223-224 — a first pass

Say the words for a motorway and a fine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert, a show
- an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist, a researcher

Before you move on

A battery? (**la batterie**.) A charger? (**le chargeur**.) A singer? (**le chanteur**.) A concert? (**le concert**.) A show? (**le spectacle**.) An employee? (**l'employé**.) A pilot? (**le pilote**.) An accountant? (**le comptable**.) A scientist? (**le scientifique**.) A researcher? (**le chercheur**.)

227.7 Words from chapters 225-227 — a second pass

Say the words for experience and a choice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility, a reason
- a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan, a debt
- a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway, a fine

Before you move on

Experience? (**l'expérience**.) A choice? (**le choix**.) A decision? (**la décision**.) A possibility? (**la possibilité**.) A reason? (**la raison**.) A bank card? (**la carte bancaire**.) A cash machine? (**le distributeur**.) A bank account? (**le compte bancaire**.) A loan? (**le prêt**.) A debt? (**la dette**.) A wheel? (**la roue**.) An engine? (**le moteur**.) A toll? (**le péage**.) A motorway? (**l'autoroute**.) A fine? (**l'amende**.)

Chapter 228

Vase, Plant, Seed, Root, Branch

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a vase, a plant, a seed, a root and a branch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say a vase, a plant, a seed, a root and a branch.*

228.1 le vase — a vase

Before the new one: say the French for a motorway, then the French for a fine.

You'll want to know: le vase

le vase — "a vase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vase ← Latin *vas*, *vasis*, "a vessel" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vase*
- *Say it: le vase*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vase*
- *Recall:* say the French for a motorway, then the French for a fine, then say *le vase* again

Before you move on

What does le vase mean? (“A vase”.) Say it once more.

228.2 la plante — a plant

Before the new one: say the French for a fine, then the French for a vase.

You’ll want to know: la plante

la plante — “a plant”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plante ← Latin *planta*, “a sprout, a cutting” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plante*
- *Say it: la plante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plante*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fine, then the French for a vase, then say *la plante* again

Before you move on

What does la plante mean? (“A plant”.) Say it once more.

228.3 la graine — a seed

Before the new one: say the French for a vase, then the French for a plant.

You’ll want to know: la graine

la graine — “a seed”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

graine ← Vulgar Latin *grana*, “grains”, the plural of *granum* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la graine*
- *Say it: la graine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la graine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vase, then the French for a plant, then say *la graine* again

Before you move on

What does la graine mean? (“A seed”.) Say it once more.

228.4 la racine — a root

Before the new one: say the French for a plant, then the French for a seed.

You'll want to know: la racine

la racine — "a root".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

racine ← Late Latin **radicina*, from *radix*, *radicis*, "a root" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la racine*
- *Say it: la racine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la racine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plant, then the French for a seed, then say *la racine* again

Before you move on

What does la racine mean? ("A root".) Say it once more.

228.5 la branche — a branch

Before the new one: say the French for a seed, then the French for a root.

You'll want to know: la branche

la branche — "a branch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

branche ← Late Latin *branca*, "a paw" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the noun behind *brancher*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la branche*
- *Say it: la branche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la branche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a seed, then the French for a root, then say *la branche* again

Before you move on

What does la branche mean? ("A branch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

Lightning, Thunder, Climate, Environment, Pollution

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment and pollution.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment and pollution.

229.1 l'éclair — lightning

Before the new one: say the French for a root, then the French for a branch.

You'll want to know: l'éclair

l'éclair — "lightning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éclair — formed from the verb for "to light up", built on *clair*, "bright".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éclair*
- *Say it: l'éclair*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'éclair*
- *Recall:* say the French for a root, then the French for a branch, then say *l'éclair* again

Before you move on

What does l'éclair mean? ("Lightning".) Say it once more.

229.2 le tonnerre — thunder

Before the new one: say the French for a branch, then the French for lightning.

You'll want to know: le tonnerre

le tonnerre — "thunder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tonnerre ← Old French *tuneire* ← Latin *tonitrus*, "thunder" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tonnerre*
- *Say it: le tonnerre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tonnerre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a branch, then the French for lightning, then say *le tonnerre* again

Before you move on

What does le tonnerre mean? (“Thunder”.) Say it once more.

229.3 le climat — the climate

Before the new one: say the French for lightning, then the French for thunder.

You’ll want to know: le climat

le climat — “the climate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

climat ← Latin *clima*, from Greek *klima*, “a slope, a zone of latitude” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le climat*
- *Say it: le climat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le climat*
- *Recall:* say the French for lightning, then the French for thunder, then say *le climat* again

Before you move on

What does le climat mean? (“The climate”.) Say it once more.

229.4 l’environnement — the environment

Before the new one: say the French for thunder, then the French for the climate.

You'll want to know: l'environnement

l'environnement — "the environment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

environnement — built from *environ*, "round about", with *-ment*: what lies around.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'environnement*
- *Say it: l'environnement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'environnement*
- *Recall:* say the French for thunder, then the French for the climate, then say *l'environnement* again

Before you move on

What does l'environnement mean? ("The environment".) Say it once more.

229.5 la pollution — pollution

Before the new one: say the French for the climate, then the French for the environment.

You'll want to know: la pollution

la pollution — "pollution".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pollution ← Latin *pollutio*, "a defiling" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pollution*
- *Say it: la pollution*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pollution*
- *Recall:* say the French for the climate, then the French for the environment, then say *la pollution* again

Before you move on

What does la pollution mean? ("Pollution".) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

Thread, Needle, Nail for hammering, Hammer, Ladder

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer and a ladder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer and a ladder.*

230.1 le fil — a thread, a wire

> Before the new one: say the French for the environment, then the French for pollution.

You'll want to know: le fil

le fil — "a thread, a wire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fil ← Old French *fil* ← Latin *filum*, "a thread" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fil*
- *Say it: le fil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fil*
- *Recall:* say the French for the environment, then the French for pollution, then say *le fil* again

Before you move on

What does le fil mean? (“A thread, a wire”.) Say it once more.

230.2 l’aiguille — a needle

Before the new one: say the French for pollution, then the French for a thread.

You’ll want to know: l’aiguille

l’aiguille — “a needle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aiguille ← Old French *aguille* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **acucula*, “a little needle”, from Latin *acus*, “a needle” — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’aiguille*
- *Say it: l’aiguille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’aiguille*
- *Recall:* say the French for pollution, then the French for a thread, then say *l’aiguille* again

Before you move on

What does l'aiguille mean? ("A needle".) Say it once more.

230.3 le clou — a nail for hammering

Before the new one: say the French for a thread, then the French for a needle.

You'll want to know: le clou

le clou — "a nail for hammering".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clou ← Old French *clou* ← Latin *clavus*, "a nail" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clou*
- *Say it: le clou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le clou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thread, then the French for a needle, then say *le clou* again

Before you move on

What does le clou mean? ("A nail for hammering".) Say it once more.

230.4 le marteau — a hammer

Before the new one: say the French for a needle, then the French for a nail for hammering.

You'll want to know: le marteau

le marteau — "a hammer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marteau ← Vulgar Latin **martellus* ← Latin *martulus*, "a hammer" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marteau*
- *Say it: le marteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le marteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a needle, then the French for a nail for hammering, then say *le marteau* again

Before you move on

What does le marteau mean? ("A hammer".) Say it once more.

230.5 l'échelle — a ladder

Before the new one: say the French for a nail for hammering, then the French for a hammer.

You'll want to know: l'échelle

l'échelle — "a ladder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échelle ← Old French *eschele*, *eschiele* ← Latin *scala*, "a ladder" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; *escalier* came later from a word built on the same *scala*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échelle*
- *Say it: l'échelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'échelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nail for hammering, then the French for a hammer, then say *l'échelle* again

Before you move on

What does l'échelle mean? ("A ladder".) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

Return, Arrival, Departure, Destination, Landscape

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the return, arrival, departure, a destination and a landscape.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say the return, arrival, departure, a destination and a landscape.*

231.1 le retour — the return

> Before the new one: say the French for a hammer, then the French for a ladder.

You'll want to know: le retour

le retour — "the return".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retour — formed from the verb for "to return", *re-* with *tourner*, "to turn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le retour*
- *Say it: le retour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le retour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hammer, then the French for a ladder, then say *le retour* again

Before you move on

What does le retour mean? ("The return".) Say it once more.

231.2 l'arrivée — arrival

Before the new one: say the French for a ladder, then the French for the return.

You'll want to know: l'arrivée

l'arrivée — "arrival".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrivée is the past participle of the verb for "to arrive", ← Vulgar Latin **arripare*, "to reach the shore", from *ripa*, "a bank", the Latin of *rivière*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrivée*
- *Say it: l'arrivée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arrivée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ladder, then the French for the return, then say *l'arrivée* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrivée mean? ("Arrival".) Say it once more.

231.3 le départ — departure

Before the new one: say the French for the return, then the French for arrival.

You'll want to know: le départ

le départ — "departure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

départ — formed from Old French *departir*, "to divide, to go away", from *de-* and Old French *partir*, "to share out", ← Latin *partire*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le départ*
- *Say it: le départ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le départ*
- *Recall:* say the French for the return, then the French for arrival, then say *le départ* again

Before you move on

What does le départ mean? ("Departure".) Say it once more.

231.4 la destination — a destination

Before the new one: say the French for arrival, then the French for departure.

You'll want to know: la destination

la destination — "a destination".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

destination ← Latin *destinatio*, "a fixing, a purpose", from *destinare*, "to make fast" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la destination*
- *Say it: la destination*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la destination*
- *Recall:* say the French for arrival, then the French for departure, then say *la destination* again

Before you move on

What does la destination mean? ("A destination".) Say it once more.

231.5 le paysage — a landscape

Before the new one: say the French for departure, then the French for a destination.

You'll want to know: le paysage

le paysage — "a landscape".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paysage — built from the word for "country", ← Late Latin *pagensis*, from *pagus*, "a district" (Lewis & Short), with *-age*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le paysage*
- *Say it: le paysage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le paysage*
- *Recall:* say the French for departure, then the French for a destination, then say *le paysage* again

Before you move on

What does le paysage mean? ("A landscape".) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

Magazine, Dictionary, University, Mistake, History

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake and history.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake and history.*

232.1 le magazine — a magazine

Before the new one: say the French for a destination, then the French for a landscape.

You'll want to know: le magazine

le magazine — "a magazine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

magazine ← English *magazine*, a storehouse of writings (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed back: English had taken it from *magasin*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le magazine*
- *Say it: le magazine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le magazine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a destination, then the French for a landscape, then say *le magazine* again

Before you move on

What does le magazine mean? ("A magazine".) Say it once more.

232.2 le dictionnaire — a dictionary

Before the new one: say the French for a landscape, then the French for a magazine.

You'll want to know: le dictionnaire

le dictionnaire — "a dictionary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dictionnaire ← Medieval Latin *dictionarium*, from *dictio*, "a saying, a word" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dictionnaire*
- *Say it: le dictionnaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dictionnaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a landscape, then the French for a magazine, then say *le dictionnaire* again

Before you move on

What does le dictionnaire mean? (“A dictionary”.) Say it once more.

232.3 l’université — a university

Before the new one: say the French for a magazine, then the French for a dictionary.

You’ll want to know: l’université

l’université — “a university”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

université ← Latin *universitas*, “the whole, a corporation”, from *universus*, “all together” (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’université*
- *Say it: l’université*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’université*
- *Recall:* say the French for a magazine, then the French for a dictionary, then say *l’université* again

Before you move on

What does l’université mean? (“A university”.) Say it once more.

232.4 l’erreur — a mistake

Before the new one: say the French for a dictionary, then the French for a university.

You'll want to know: l'erreur

l'erreur — "a mistake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erreur ← Latin *error*, "a wandering", from *errare*, "to wander" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'erreur*
- *Say it: l'erreur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'erreur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dictionary, then the French for a university, then say *l'erreur* again

Before you move on

What does l'erreur mean? ("A mistake".) Say it once more.

232.5 l'histoire — history, a story

Before the new one: say the French for a university, then the French for a mistake.

You'll want to know: l'histoire

l'histoire — "history, a story".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

histoire ← Latin *historia*, from Greek *historia*, "inquiry, a narrative" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'histoire*
- *Say it: l'histoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'histoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a university, then the French for a mistake, then say *l'histoire* again

Before you move on

What does l'histoire mean? ("History, a story".) Say it once more.

232.6 Words from chapters 228-229 — a first pass

Say the words for a mistake and history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a vase, a plant, a seed, a root, a branch
- lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment, pollution

Before you move on

A vase? (**le vase**.) A plant? (**la plante**.) A seed? (**la graine**.) A root? (**la racine**.) A branch? (**la branche**.) Lightning? (**l'éclair**.) Thunder? (**le tonnerre**.) The climate? (**le climat**.) The environment? (**l'environnement**.) Pollution? (**la pollution**.)

232.7 Words from chapters 230-232 — a second pass

Say the words for a thread and a needle.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer, a ladder
- the return, arrival, departure, a destination, a landscape
- a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake, history

Before you move on

A thread? (**le fil**.) A needle? (**l'aiguille**.) A nail for hammering? (**le clou**.) A hammer? (**le marteau**.) A ladder? (**l'échelle**.) The return? (**le retour**.) Arrival? (**l'arrivée**.) Departure? (**le départ**.) A destination? (**la destination**.) A landscape? (**le paysage**.) A magazine? (**le magazine**.) A dictionary? (**le dictionnaire**.) A university? (**l'université**.) A mistake? (**l'erreur**.) History? (**l'histoire**.)

Chapter 233

To iron, To repair, To build, To photograph, To repeat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph and to repeat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph and to repeat.*

233.1 repasser — to iron

Before the new one: say the French for a mistake, then the French for history, a story.

You'll want to know: repasser

repasser — "to iron".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repasser — built from *re-* and the verb for "to pass", ← Vulgar Latin **passare* (EtymDB 2.1): to pass the hot iron over the cloth.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: repasser*
- *Say it: repasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *repasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mistake, then the French for history, a story, then say *repasser* again

Before you move on

What does repasser mean? ("To iron".) Say it once more.

233.2 réparer — to repair

Before the new one: say the French for history, a story, then the French for to iron.

You'll want to know: réparer

réparer — "to repair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réparer ← Latin *reparare*, "to restore" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réparer*
- *Say it: réparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for history, a story, then the French for to iron, then say *réparer* again

Before you move on

What does réparer mean? (“To repair”.) Say it once more.

233.3 construire — to build

Before the new one: say the French for to iron, then the French for to repair.

You’ll want to know: construire

construire — “to build”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

construire ← Latin *construere*, “to heap together, to build” — taken from Latin and shaped like *détruire*. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: construire*
- *Say it: construire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *construire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to iron, then the French for to repair, then say *construire* again

Before you move on

What does construire mean? (“To build”.) Say it once more.

233.4 photographier — to photograph

Before the new one: say the French for to repair, then the French for to build.

You'll want to know: photographier

photographier — "to photograph".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photographier — formed from the word for "photography", built like *photo* from Greek *phos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: photographier*
- *Say it: photographier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *photographier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repair, then the French for to build, then say *photographier* again

Before you move on

What does photographier mean? ("To photograph".) Say it once more.

233.5 répéter — to repeat

Before the new one: say the French for to build, then the French for to photograph.

You'll want to know: répéter

répéter — "to repeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

répéter ← Latin *repetere*, "to go back to, to seek once more" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: répéter*
- *Say it: répéter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *répéter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to build, then the French for to photograph, then say *répéter* again

Before you move on

What does répéter mean? ("To repeat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 234

To fill, To empty, To measure, To weigh, To check

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh and to check.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh and to check.*

234.1 remplir — to fill

Before the new one: say the French for to photograph, then the French for to repeat.

You'll want to know: remplir

remplir — "to fill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplir ← Old French *remplir*: *re-* and *emplir*, "to fill", ← Latin *implere*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplir*
- *Say it: remplir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to photograph, then the French for to repeat, then say *remplir* again

Before you move on

What does remplir mean? ("To fill".) Say it once more.

234.2 vider — to empty

Before the new one: say the French for to repeat, then the French for to fill.

You'll want to know: vider

vider — "to empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vider ← Old French *vuidier* ← Vulgar Latin **vocitare*, "to empty" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *vide*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vider*
- *Say it: vider*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vider*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repeat, then the French for to fill, then say *vider* again

Before you move on

What does vider mean? (“To empty”.) Say it once more.

234.3 mesurer — to measure

Before the new one: say the French for to fill, then the French for to empty.

You’ll want to know: mesurer

mesurer — “to measure”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mesurer ← Late Latin *mensurare*, from *mensura*, “a measure” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mesurer*
- *Say it: mesurer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mesurer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fill, then the French for to empty, then say *mesurer* again

Before you move on

What does mesurer mean? (“To measure”.) Say it once more.

234.4 peser — to weigh

Before the new one: say the French for to empty, then the French for to measure.

You'll want to know: peser

peser — "to weigh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peser ← Vulgar Latin **pesare* ← Latin *pensare*, "to weigh, to ponder" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peser*
- *Say it: peser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to empty, then the French for to measure, then say *peser* again

Before you move on

What does peser mean? ("To weigh".) Say it once more.

234.5 vérifier — to check

Before the new one: say the French for to measure, then the French for to weigh.

You'll want to know: vérifier

vérifier — "to check".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vérifier ← Medieval Latin *verificare*, "to make true", from *verus*, "true" — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vérifier*
- *Say it: vérifier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vérifier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to measure, then the French for to weigh, then say *vérifier* again

Before you move on

What does vérifier mean? ("To check".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

To move house, To rent, To rest, To wake up, To do one's hair

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up and to do one's hair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up and to do one's hair.*

235.1 déménager — to move house

Before the new one: say the French for to weigh, then the French for to check.

You'll want to know: déménager

déménager — "to move house".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déménager — built from *dé-*, "out", and the word for "a household", from Old French *maisnie*, "a household", ← Vulgar Latin **mansionata*, from *mansio*, "a dwelling": to take the household out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déménager*
- *Say it: déménager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déménager*
- *Recall:* say the French for to weigh, then the French for to check, then say *déménager* again

Before you move on

What does déménager mean? ("To move house".) Say it once more.

235.2 louer — to rent

Before the new one: say the French for to check, then the French for to move house.

You'll want to know: louer

louer — "to rent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

louer ← Latin *locare*, "to place, to hire out" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) A second *louer*, "to praise", comes from Latin *laudare*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: louer*
- *Say it: louer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *louer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to check, then the French for to move house, then say *louer* again

Before you move on

What does louer mean? (“To rent”.) Say it once more.

235.3 se reposer — to rest

Before the new one: say the French for to move house, then the French for to rent.

You’ll want to know: se reposer

se reposer — “to rest”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se reposer ← Late Latin *repausare*, “to rest” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *repos*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se reposer*
- *Say it: se reposer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se reposer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move house, then the French for to rent, then say *se reposer* again

Before you move on

What does se reposer mean? (“To rest”.) Say it once more.

235.4 se réveiller — to wake up

Before the new one: say the French for to rent, then the French for to rest.

You'll want to know: se réveiller

se réveiller — "to wake up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se réveiller — *re-* and the verb for "to wake", ← Vulgar Latin **exvigilare*, from Latin *vigilare*, "to keep watch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se réveiller*
- *Say it: se réveiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se réveiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rent, then the French for to rest, then say *se réveiller* again

Before you move on

What does se réveiller mean? ("To wake up".) Say it once more.

235.5 se coiffer — to do one's hair

Before the new one: say the French for to rest, then the French for to wake up.

You'll want to know: se coiffer

se coiffer — "to do one's hair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se coiffer — formed from the word for "a cap", ← Late Latin *cofia*, a Germanic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se coiffer*
- *Say it: se coiffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se coiffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rest, then the French for to wake up, then say *se coiffer* again

Before you move on

What does se coiffer mean? ("To do one's hair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

To be enough, To burn, To throw away, To calculate, To hit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate and to hit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate and to hit.*

236.1 suffire — to be enough

Before the new one: say the French for to wake up, then the French for to do one's hair.

You'll want to know: suffire

suffire — "to be enough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suffire ← Latin *sufficere*, "to be enough" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suffire*
- *Say it: suffire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suffire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wake up, then the French for to do one's hair, then say *suffire* again

Before you move on

What does suffire mean? ("To be enough".) Say it once more.

236.2 brûler — to burn

Before the new one: say the French for to do one's hair, then the French for to be enough.

You'll want to know: brûler

brûler — "to burn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brûler — its origin is uncertain. The usual account mixes Latin *ustulare*, "to scorch", with a Germanic verb for "to burn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brûler*
- *Say it: brûler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brûler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to do one's hair, then the French for to be enough, then say *brûler* again

Before you move on

What does brûler mean? (“To burn”.) Say it once more.

236.3 jeter — to throw away

Before the new one: say the French for to be enough, then the French for to burn.

You’ll want to know: jeter

jeter — “to throw away”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeter ← Old French *jeter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **iectare* ← Latin *iactare*, “to throw about” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jeter*
- *Say it: jeter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jeter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be enough, then the French for to burn, then say *jeter* again

Before you move on

What does jeter mean? (“To throw away”.) Say it once more.

236.4 calculer — to calculate

Before the new one: say the French for to burn, then the French for to throw away.

You'll want to know: calculer

calculer — "to calculate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

calculer ← Late Latin *calculare*, from *calculus*, "a pebble" (Lewis & Short): sums were done with counting stones — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *calculer*
- *Say it:* *calculer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calculer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to burn, then the French for to throw away, then say *calculer* again

Before you move on

What does calculer mean? ("To calculate".) Say it once more.

236.5 frapper — to hit, to knock

Before the new one: say the French for to throw away, then the French for to calculate.

You'll want to know: frapper

frapper — "to hit, to knock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frapper ← Old French *fraper*, "to strike" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; it may imitate the sound of a blow.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frapper*
- *Say it: frapper*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frapper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to throw away, then the French for to calculate, then say *frapper* again

Before you move on

What does frapper mean? ("To hit, to knock".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

To miss, To deserve, To improve, To get worse, To offer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse and to offer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse and to offer.

237.1 manquer — to miss, to be missing

Before the new one: say the French for to calculate, then the French for to hit.

You'll want to know: manquer

manquer — "to miss, to be missing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manquer ← Italian *mancare*, "to be lacking", from *manco*, "maimed", ← Latin *mancus* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manquer*
- *Say it: manquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to calculate, then the French for to hit, then say *manquer* again

Before you move on

What does manquer mean? ("To miss, to be missing".) Say it once more.

237.2 mériter — to deserve

Before the new one: say the French for to hit, then the French for to miss.

You'll want to know: mériter

mériter — "to deserve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mériter — formed from the word for "merit", ← Latin *meritum*, "what one has earned". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mériter*
- *Say it: mériter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mériter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hit, then the French for to miss, then say *mériter* again

Before you move on

What does mériter mean? ("To deserve".) Say it once more.

237.3 améliorer — to improve

Before the new one: say the French for to miss, then the French for to deserve.

You'll want to know: améliorer

améliorer — "to improve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

améliorer — built on the word for "better", ← Latin *melior*, "better". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: améliorer*
- *Say it: améliorer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *améliorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to miss, then the French for to deserve, then say *améliorer* again

Before you move on

What does améliorer mean? ("To improve".) Say it once more.

237.4 empirer — to get worse

Before the new one: say the French for to deserve, then the French for to improve.

You'll want to know: empirer

empirer — "to get worse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empirer — built from *em-* and the word for "worse", ← Latin *peior*, "worse" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *empirer*
- *Say it:* *empirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *empirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deserve, then the French for to improve, then say *empirer* again

Before you move on

What does empirer mean? ("To get worse".) Say it once more.

237.5 offrir — to offer

Before the new one: say the French for to improve, then the French for to get worse.

You'll want to know: offrir

offrir — "to offer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

offrir ← Old French *ofrir* ← Vulgar Latin **offerire* ← Latin *offerre*, "to bring before" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: offrir*
- *Say it: offrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *offrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to improve, then the French for to get worse, then say *offrir* again

Before you move on

What does offrir mean? ("To offer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

To reduce, To refuse, To risk, To solve, To fly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve and to fly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve and to fly.*

238.1 réduire — to reduce

Before the new one: say the French for to get worse, then the French for to offer.

You'll want to know: réduire

réduire — "to reduce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réduire ← Old French *reduire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *reducere*, "to lead back" (Lewis & Short) — inherited, like *conduire*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réduire*
- *Say it: réduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get worse, then the French for to offer, then say *réduire* again

Before you move on

What does réduire mean? ("To reduce".) Say it once more.

238.2 refuser — to refuse

Before the new one: say the French for to offer, then the French for to reduce.

You'll want to know: refuser

refuser — "to refuse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

refuser — usually traced to Vulgar Latin **refusare*, a blend of Latin *refutare*, "to rebut", and *recusare*, "to decline" — the account is not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: refuser*
- *Say it: refuser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *refuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to offer, then the French for to reduce, then say *refuser* again

Before you move on

What does refuser mean? ("To refuse".) Say it once more.

238.3 risquer — to risk

Before the new one: say the French for to reduce, then the French for to refuse.

You'll want to know: risquer

risquer — "to risk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

risquer — formed from the word for "risk", ← Old Italian *risco* (EtymDB 2.1), whose own origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: risquer*
- *Say it: risquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *risquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reduce, then the French for to refuse, then say *risquer* again

Before you move on

What does risquer mean? ("To risk".) Say it once more.

238.4 résoudre — to solve

Before the new one: say the French for to refuse, then the French for to risk.

You'll want to know: résoudre

résoudre — "to solve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résoudre ← Latin *resolvere*, "to loosen, to untie" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: résoudre*
- *Say it: résoudre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *résoudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to refuse, then the French for to risk, then say *résoudre* again

Before you move on

What does résoudre mean? ("To solve".) Say it once more.

238.5 voler — to fly, to steal

Before the new one: say the French for to risk, then the French for to solve.

You'll want to know: voler

voler — "to fly, to steal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voler ← Latin *volare*, "to fly" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. "To steal" grew out of falconry: a hawk flew at its prey.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voler*
- *Say it: voler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to risk, then the French for to solve, then say *voler* again

Before you move on

What does voler mean? ("To fly, to steal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

To unite, To be worth, To get used to, To realise, To hurry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise and to hurry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise and to hurry.*

239.1 unir — to unite

> Before the new one: say the French for to solve, then the French for to fly.

You'll want to know: unir

unir — "to unite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unir ← Latin *unire*, "to make one", from *unus*, "one" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unir*
- *Say it: unir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to solve, then the French for to fly, then say *unir* again

Before you move on

What does unir mean? (“To unite”.) Say it once more.

239.2 valoir — to be worth

Before the new one: say the French for to fly, then the French for to unite.

You’ll want to know: valoir

valoir — “to be worth”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valoir ← Old French *valoir* ← Latin *valere*, “to be strong, to be worth” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: valoir*
- *Say it: valoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *valoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fly, then the French for to unite, then say *valoir* again

Before you move on

What does valoir mean? ("To be worth".) Say it once more.

239.3 s'habituer — to get used to

Before the new one: say the French for to unite, then the French for to be worth.

You'll want to know: s'habituer

s'habituer — "to get used to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'habituer ← Late Latin *habituare*, "to bring into a condition", from *habitus*, "a state, a habit" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'habituer*
- *Say it: s'habituer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'habituer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to unite, then the French for to be worth, then say *s'habituer* again

Before you move on

What does s'habituer mean? ("To get used to".) Say it once more.

239.4 se rendre compte — to realise

Before the new one: say the French for to be worth, then the French for to get used to.

You'll want to know: se rendre compte

se rendre compte — "to realise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se rendre compte — "to render oneself an account": *rendre*, "to give back", and *compte*, "an account".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se rendre compte*
- *Say it: se rendre compte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se rendre compte*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be worth, then the French for to get used to, then say *se rendre compte* again

Before you move on

What does se rendre compte mean? ("To realise".) Say it once more.

239.5 se dépêcher — to hurry

Before the new one: say the French for to get used to, then the French for to realise.

You'll want to know: se dépêcher

se dépêcher — "to hurry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se dépêcher — built in Old French as the opposite of the verb for "to hinder", ← Late Latin *impedicare*, "to catch, to entangle" (Lewis & Short): to get free and go.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se dépêcher*
- *Say it: se dépêcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se dépêcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get used to, then the French for to realise, then say *se dépêcher* again

Before you move on

What does se dépêcher mean? ("To hurry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

To insist, To interrupt, To tie, To mix, To obey

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix and to obey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix and to obey.*

240.1 insister — to insist

> Before the new one: say the French for to realise, then the French for to hurry.

You'll want to know: insister

insister — "to insist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

insister ← Latin *insistere*, "to stand on, to press on" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: insister*
- *Say it: insister*, once more
- *Say it:* say *insister*
- *Recall:* say the French for to realise, then the French for to hurry, then say *insister* again

Before you move on

What does insister mean? ("To insist".) Say it once more.

240.2 interrompre — to interrupt

Before the new one: say the French for to hurry, then the French for to insist.

You'll want to know: interrompre

interrompre — "to interrupt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interrompre ← Latin *interrumpere*, "to break apart" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interrompre*
- *Say it: interrompre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interrompre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hurry, then the French for to insist, then say *interrompre* again

Before you move on

What does interrompre mean? ("To interrupt".) Say it once more.

240.3 attacher — to tie, to fasten

Before the new one: say the French for to insist, then the French for to interrupt.

You'll want to know: attacher

attacher — "to tie, to fasten".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

attacher ← Old French *atachier*, built on the word for "a nail, a fastener", which came from a Germanic word for "a stake". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: attacher*
- *Say it: attacher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *attacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to insist, then the French for to interrupt, then say *attacher* again

Before you move on

What does attacher mean? ("To tie, to fasten".) Say it once more.

240.4 mélanger — to mix

Before the new one: say the French for to interrupt, then the French for to tie.

You'll want to know: mélanger

mélanger — "to mix".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mélanger — built from the verb for "to mix", ← Vulgar Latin **misculare*, from Latin *miscere*, "to mix" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mélanger*
- *Say it: mélanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mélanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to interrupt, then the French for to tie, then say *mélanger* again

Before you move on

What does mélanger mean? ("To mix".) Say it once more.

240.5 obéir — to obey

Before the new one: say the French for to tie, then the French for to mix.

You'll want to know: obéir

obéir — "to obey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

obéir ← Old French *obeir* ← Latin *oboedire*, "to obey" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obéir*
- *Say it: obéir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obéir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tie, then the French for to mix, then say *obéir* again

Before you move on

What does obéir mean? ("To obey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

To cough, To tremble, To scream, To vote, To welcome

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote and to welcome.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote and to welcome.

241.1 tousser — to cough

Before the new one: say the French for to mix, then the French for to obey.

You'll want to know: tousser

tousser — "to cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tousser ← Latin *tussire*, "to cough" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *toux*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tousser*
- *Say it: tousser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tousser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to mix, then the French for to obey, then say *tousser* again

Before you move on

What does tousser mean? ("To cough".) Say it once more.

241.2 trembler — to tremble

Before the new one: say the French for to obey, then the French for to cough.

You'll want to know: trembler

trembler — "to tremble".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trembler ← Old French *trembler* ← Vulgar Latin **tremulare*, from Latin *tremulus*, "trembling" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trembler*
- *Say it: trembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to obey, then the French for to cough, then say *trembler* again

Before you move on

What does trembler mean? ("To tremble".) Say it once more.

241.3 hurler — to scream

Before the new one: say the French for to cough, then the French for to tremble.

You'll want to know: hurler

hurler — "to scream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hurler ← Latin *ululare*, "to howl" (Lewis & Short) — inherited, with its first *l* turned to *r*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hurler*
- *Say it: hurler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hurler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cough, then the French for to tremble, then say *hurler* again

Before you move on

What does hurler mean? ("To scream".) Say it once more.

241.4 voter — to vote

Before the new one: say the French for to tremble, then the French for to scream.

You'll want to know: voter

voter — "to vote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voter — formed from the word for "a vote", ← English *vote*, from Latin *votum*, "a vow, a wish" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voter*
- *Say it: voter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tremble, then the French for to scream, then say *voter* again

Before you move on

What does voter mean? ("To vote".) Say it once more.

241.5 accueillir — to welcome

Before the new one: say the French for to scream, then the French for to vote.

You'll want to know: accueillir

accueillir — "to welcome".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accueillir ← Old French *acoillir* ← Vulgar Latin **accolligere* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *cueillir* with *ac-*, "to".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: accueillir*
- *Say it: accueillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *accueillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to scream, then the French for to vote, then say *accueillir* again

Before you move on

What does accueillir mean? ("To welcome".) Say it once more.

241.6 Words from chapters 233-236 — a first pass

Say the words for to vote and to welcome.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph, to repeat
- to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh, to check
- to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up, to do one's hair
- to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate, to hit

Before you move on

To iron? (**repasser**.) To repair? (**réparer**.) To build? (**construire**.) To photograph? (**photographier**.) To repeat? (**répéter**.) To fill? (**remplir**.) To empty? (**vider**.) To measure? (**mesurer**.) To weigh? (**peser**.) To check? (**vérifier**.) To move house? (**déménager**.) To rent? (**louer**.) To rest? (**se reposer**.)

To wake up? (**se réveiller**.) To do one's hair? (**se coiffer**.) To be enough? (**suffire**.) To burn? (**brûler**.) To throw away? (**jeter**.) To calculate? (**calculer**.) To hit? (**frapper**.)

241.7 Words from chapters 237-241 — a second pass

Say the words for to miss and to deserve.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse, to offer
- to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve, to fly
- to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise, to hurry
- to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix, to obey
- to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote, to welcome

Before you move on

To miss? (**manquer**.) To deserve? (**mériter**.) To improve? (**améliorer**.) To get worse? (**empirer**.) To offer? (**offrir**.) To reduce? (**réduire**.) To refuse? (**refuser**.) To risk? (**risquer**.) To solve? (**résoudre**.) To fly? (**voler**.) To unite? (**unir**.) To be worth? (**valoir**.) To get used to? (**s'habituer**.) To realise? (**se rendre compte**.) To hurry? (**se dépêcher**.) To insist? (**insister**.) To interrupt? (**interrompre**.) To tie? (**attacher**.) To mix? (**mélanger**.) To obey? (**obéir**.) To cough? (**tousser**.) To tremble? (**trembler**.) To scream? (**hurler**.) To vote? (**voter**.) To welcome? (**accueillir**.)

Chapter 242

To lose weight, To feed, To go on holiday, To joke, To tidy up

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke and to tidy up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke and to tidy up.*

242.1 maigrir — to lose weight

> Before the new one: say the French for to vote, then the French for to welcome.

You'll want to know: maigrir

maigrir — "to lose weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maigrir — built from the word for "thin", ← Latin *macer*, "lean" (Lewis & Short), with the verb ending *-ir*. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Old French form of the adjective.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maigrir*
- *Say it: maigrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maigrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to vote, then the French for to welcome, then say *maigrir* again

Before you move on

What does maigrir mean? ("To lose weight".) Say it once more.

242.2 nourrir — to feed

Before the new one: say the French for to welcome, then the French for to lose weight.

You'll want to know: nourrir

nourrir — "to feed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nourrir ← Old French *norrir* ← Latin *nutrire*, "to suckle, to feed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nourrir*
- *Say it: nourrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nourrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to welcome, then the French for to lose weight, then say *nourrir* again

Before you move on

What does nourrir mean? (“To feed”.) Say it once more.

242.3 partir en vacances — to go on holiday

Before the new one: say the French for to lose weight, then the French for to feed.

You’ll want to know: partir en vacances

partir en vacances — “to go on holiday”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partir en vacances — *partir*, “to leave”, first “to divide”, ← Latin *partire*, “to share out” (EtymDB 2.1); *en*, “on”; and *vacances*, “holidays”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: partir en vacances*
- *Say it: partir en vacances*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partir en vacances*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lose weight, then the French for to feed, then say *partir en vacances* again

Before you move on

What does partir en vacances mean? (“To go on holiday”.) Say it once more.

242.4 plaisanter — to joke

Before the new one: say the French for to feed, then the French for to go on holiday.

You'll want to know: plaisanter

plaisanter — "to joke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plaisanter — built from the word for "pleasing", from the verb for "to please", ← Latin *placere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plaisanter*
- *Say it: plaisanter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plaisanter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to feed, then the French for to go on holiday, then say *plaisanter* again

Before you move on

What does plaisanter mean? ("To joke".) Say it once more.

242.5 ranger — to tidy up

Before the new one: say the French for to go on holiday, then the French for to joke.

You'll want to know: ranger

ranger — "to tidy up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ranger — built from the word for “a row, a rank”, ← Frankish **hring*, “a ring”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ranger*
- *Say it:* *ranger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ranger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go on holiday, then the French for to joke, then say *ranger* again

Before you move on

What does ranger mean? (“To tidy up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 243

Plaster, Emergency department, Emergency, Medical appointment, Diet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment and a diet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment and a diet.

243.1 le pansement — a plaster, a dressing

Before the new one: say the French for to joke, then the French for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: le pansement

le pansement — "a plaster, a dressing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pansement — built from the verb for "to dress a wound", once the same verb as *penser*, "to think": to tend is to think of. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to the verb.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pansement*
- *Say it: le pansement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pansement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to joke, then the French for to tidy up, then say *le pansement* again

Before you move on

What does le pansement mean? ("A plaster, a dressing".) Say it once more.

243.2 les urgences — the emergency department

Before the new one: say the French for to tidy up, then the French for a plaster.

You'll want to know: les urgences

les urgences — "the emergency department".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

urgences is the plural of the word for "an emergency", ← Latin *urgens*, "pressing", from *urgere*, "to press" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les urgences*
- *Say it: les urgences*, once more

- *Say it:* say *les urgences*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tidy up, then the French for a plaster, then say *les urgences* again

Before you move on

What does les urgences mean? ("The emergency department".) Say it once more.

243.3 l'urgence — an emergency

Before the new one: say the French for a plaster, then the French for the emergency department.

You'll want to know: l'urgence

l'urgence — "an emergency".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

urgence — built from the word for "urgent", ← Latin *urgens*, "pressing", from *urgere*, "to press" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'urgence*
- *Say it: l'urgence*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'urgence*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plaster, then the French for the emergency department, then say *l'urgence* again

Before you move on

What does l'urgence mean? ("An emergency".) Say it once more.

243.4 la consultation — a medical appointment

Before the new one: say the French for the emergency department, then the French for an emergency.

You'll want to know: la consultation

la consultation — "a medical appointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

consultation ← Latin *consultatio*, "a deliberation" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la consultation*
- *Say it: la consultation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la consultation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the emergency department, then the French for an emergency, then say *la consultation* again

Before you move on

What does la consultation mean? ("A medical appointment".) Say it once more.

243.5 le régime — a diet

Before the new one: say the French for an emergency, then the French for a medical appointment.

You'll want to know: le régime

le régime — "a diet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

régime ← Latin *regimen*, "guidance, rule", from *regere*, "to rule" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le régime*
- *Say it:* *le régime*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le régime*
- *Recall:* say the French for an emergency, then the French for a medical appointment, then say *le régime* again

Before you move on

What does le régime mean? ("A diet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

Silent, Clean, Hard, Smooth, Rough

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say silent, clean, hard, smooth and rough.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say silent, clean, hard, smooth and rough.*

244.1 silencieux / silencieuse — silent

> Before the new one: say the French for a medical appointment, then the French for a diet.

You'll want to know: silencieux / silencieuse

silencieux / silencieuse — "silent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

silencieux — built from the word for "silence", ← Latin *silentium* (Lewis & Short), with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: silencieux / silencieuse*
- *Say it: silencieux / silencieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *silencieux / silencieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a medical appointment, then the French for a diet, then say *silencieux / silencieuse* again

Before you move on

What does silencieux / silencieuse mean? ("Silent".) Say it once more.

244.2 propre — clean

Before the new one: say the French for a diet, then the French for silent.

You'll want to know: propre

propre — "clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

propre ← Latin *proprius*, "one's own" (EtymDB 2.1) — taken from Latin; "clean" grew out of "proper".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: propre*
- *Say it: propre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *propre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a diet, then the French for silent, then say *propre* again

Before you move on

What does propre mean? (“Clean”.) Say it once more.

244.3 dur / dure — hard

Before the new one: say the French for silent, then the French for clean.

You’ll want to know: dur / dure

dur / dure — “hard”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dur ← Latin *durus*, “hard” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dur / dure*
- *Say it: dur / dure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dur / dure*
- *Recall:* say the French for silent, then the French for clean, then say *dur / dure* again

Before you move on

What does dur / dure mean? (“Hard”.) Say it once more.

244.4 lisse — smooth

Before the new one: say the French for clean, then the French for hard.

You'll want to know: lisse

lisse — "smooth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lisse — formed from the verb for "to smooth", whose origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lisse*
- *Say it: lisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for clean, then the French for hard, then say *lisse* again

Before you move on

What does lisse mean? ("Smooth".) Say it once more.

244.5 rugueux / rugueuse — rough

Before the new one: say the French for hard, then the French for smooth.

You'll want to know: rugueux / rugueuse

rugueux / rugueuse — "rough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rugueux ← Latin *rugosus*, "wrinkled", from *ruga*, the Latin of *rue* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rugueux / rugueuse*
- *Say it: rugueux / rugueuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rugueux / rugueuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for hard, then the French for smooth, then say *rugueux / rugueuse* again

Before you move on

What does rugueux / rugueuse mean? ("Rough".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Similar, Fair, False, Ready, Free of charge

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say similar, fair, false, ready and free of charge.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say similar, fair, false, ready and free of charge.*

245.1 semblable — similar

> Before the new one: say the French for smooth, then the French for rough.

You'll want to know: semblable

semblable — "similar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semblable — *sembler* with *-able*: seeming alike.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: semblable*
- *Say it: semblable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *semblable*
- *Recall:* say the French for smooth, then the French for rough, then say *semblable* again

Before you move on

What does semblable mean? ("Similar".) Say it once more.

245.2 juste — fair, right

Before the new one: say the French for rough, then the French for similar.

You'll want to know: juste

juste — "fair, right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juste ← Latin *iustus*, "lawful, right", from *ius*, "law" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: juste*
- *Say it: juste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *juste*
- *Recall:* say the French for rough, then the French for similar, then say *juste* again

Before you move on

What does juste mean? (“Fair, right”.) Say it once more.

245.3 faux / fausse — false, wrong

Before the new one: say the French for similar, then the French for fair.

You’ll want to know: faux / fausse

faux / fausse — “false, wrong”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faux ← Old French *faus* ← Latin *falsus*, “deceived, false”, from *fallere*, “to deceive” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faux / fausse*
- *Say it: faux / fausse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faux / fausse*
- *Recall:* say the French for similar, then the French for fair, then say *faux / fausse* again

Before you move on

What does faux / fausse mean? (“False, wrong”.) Say it once more.

245.4 prêt / prête — ready

Before the new one: say the French for fair, then the French for false.

You'll want to know: prêt / prête

prêt / prête — "ready".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêt ← Late Latin *praestus*, "at hand", from *praesto*, "ready" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. It is a different word from *prêt*, "a loan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *prêt / prête*
- *Say it:* *prêt / prête*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prêt / prête*
- *Recall:* say the French for fair, then the French for false, then say *prêt / prête* again

Before you move on

What does prêt / prête mean? ("Ready".) Say it once more.

245.5 gratuit / gratuite — free of charge

Before the new one: say the French for false, then the French for ready.

You'll want to know: gratuit / gratuite

gratuit / gratuite — "free of charge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gratuit ← Latin *gratuitus*, "freely given", from *gratia*, "favour" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gratuit / gratuite*
- *Say it: gratuit / gratuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gratuit / gratuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for false, then the French for ready, then say *gratuit / gratuite* again

Before you move on

What does gratuit / gratuite mean? ("Free of charge".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Generous, Lazy, Hard-working, Talkative, Angry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative and angry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative and angry.

246.1 généreux / généreuse — generous

Before the new one: say the French for ready, then the French for free of charge.

You'll want to know: généreux / généreuse

généreux / généreuse — "generous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

généreux ← Latin *generosus*, "of noble birth", from *genus*, "birth, kind" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: généreux / généreuse*
- *Say it: généreux / généreuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *généreux / généreuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for ready, then the French for free of charge, then say *généreux / généreuse* again

Before you move on

What does généreux / généreuse mean? ("Generous".) Say it once more.

246.2 paresseux / paresseuse — lazy

Before the new one: say the French for free of charge, then the French for generous.

You'll want to know: paresseux / paresseuse

paresseux / paresseuse — "lazy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paresseux — built from the word for "laziness", ← Latin *pigritia*, "sloth" (Lewis & Short), with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paresseux / paresseuse*
- *Say it: paresseux / paresseuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paresseux / paresseuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for free of charge, then the French for generous, then say *paresseux / paresseuse* again

Before you move on

What does paresseux / paresseuse mean? (“Lazy”.) Say it once more.

246.3 travailleur / travailleuse — hard-working

Before the new one: say the French for generous, then the French for lazy.

You’ll want to know: travailleur / travailleuse

travailleur / travailleuse — “hard-working”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

travailleur — *travailler*, “to work”, with *-eur*, “one who”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: travailleur / travailleuse*
- *Say it: travailleur / travailleuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *travailleur / travailleuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for generous, then the French for lazy, then say *travailleur / travailleuse* again

Before you move on

What does travailleur / travailleuse mean? (“Hard-working”.) Say it once more.

246.4 bavard / bavarde — talkative

Before the new one: say the French for lazy, then the French for hard-working.

You'll want to know: bavard / bavarde

bavard / bavarde — "talkative".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bavard — built from the word for "drool", with *-ard*: the adjective behind *bavarder*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bavard / bavarde*
- *Say it: bavard / bavarde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bavard / bavarde*
- *Recall:* say the French for lazy, then the French for hard-working, then say *bavard / bavarde* again

Before you move on

What does bavard / bavarde mean? ("Talkative".) Say it once more.

246.5 fâché / fâchée — angry

Before the new one: say the French for hard-working, then the French for talkative.

You'll want to know: fâché / fâchée

fâché / fâchée — "angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fâché is the past participle of the verb in *se fâcher*, "to get angry": angered.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fâché / fâchée*
- *Say it: fâché / fâchée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fâché / fâchée*
- *Recall:* say the French for hard-working, then the French for talkative, then say *fâché / fâchée* again

Before you move on

What does fâché / fâchée mean? ("Angry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Bill, Tip, Stop, Motorbike, Platform

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike and a platform.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike and a platform.*

247.1 l'addition — the bill

Before the new one: say the French for talkative, then the French for angry.

You'll want to know: l'addition

l'addition — "the bill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

addition ← Latin *additio*, "an adding", from *addere*, "to add" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: the bill adds it all up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'addition*
- *Say it: l'addition*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'addition*
- *Recall:* say the French for talkative, then the French for angry, then say *l'addition* again

Before you move on

What does l'addition mean? ("The bill".) Say it once more.

247.2 le pourboire — a tip

Before the new one: say the French for angry, then the French for the bill.

You'll want to know: le pourboire

le pourboire — "a tip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourboire — the word for "for" and *boire*, "to drink": money for a drink.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pourboire*
- *Say it: le pourboire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pourboire*
- *Recall:* say the French for angry, then the French for the bill, then say *le pourboire* again

Before you move on

What does le pourboire mean? ("A tip".) Say it once more.

247.3 l'arrêt — a stop

Before the new one: say the French for the bill, then the French for a tip.

You'll want to know: l'arrêt

l'arrêt — "a stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrêt — formed from *arrêter*, "to stop": a stop. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrêt*
- *Say it: l'arrêt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arrêt*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bill, then the French for a tip, then say *l'arrêt* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrêt mean? ("A stop".) Say it once more.

247.4 la moto — a motorbike

Before the new one: say the French for a tip, then the French for a stop.

You'll want to know: la moto

la moto — "a motorbike".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moto — short for *motocyclette*, built from the word for "motor", as in *moteur*, and the word for "cycle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la moto*
- *Say it: la moto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la moto*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tip, then the French for a stop, then say *la moto* again

Before you move on

What does la moto mean? ("A motorbike".) Say it once more.

247.5 le quai — a platform

Before the new one: say the French for a stop, then the French for a motorbike.

You'll want to know: le quai

le quai — "a platform".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quai ← Old French *cai* ← Gaulish **caio-*, "an enclosure" — a Celtic word that came into French through the northern dialects. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le quai*
- *Say it: le quai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le quai*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stop, then the French for a motorbike, then say *le quai* again

Before you move on

What does le quai mean? ("A platform".) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

Mayor, Elections, Vote, Politics, Economy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a mayor, elections, a vote, politics and the economy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say a mayor, elections, a vote, politics and the economy.

248.1 le maire — a mayor

Before the new one: say the French for a motorbike, then the French for a platform.

You'll want to know: le maire

le maire — "a mayor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maire ← Old French *maire* ← Latin *maior*, "greater" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the noun behind *mairie*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maire*
- *Say it: le maire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le maire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a motorbike, then the French for a platform, then say *le maire* again

Before you move on

What does le maire mean? ("A mayor".) Say it once more.

248.2 les élections — elections

Before the new one: say the French for a platform, then the French for a mayor.

You'll want to know: les élections

les élections — "elections".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élections is the plural of the word for "an election", ← Latin *electio*, "a choosing", from *eligere*, "to pick out" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les élections*
- *Say it: les élections*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les élections*
- *Recall:* say the French for a platform, then the French for a mayor, then say *les élections* again

Before you move on

What does les élections mean? ("Elections".) Say it once more.

248.3 le vote — a vote

Before the new one: say the French for a mayor, then the French for elections.

You'll want to know: le vote

le vote — "a vote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vote ← English *vote* ← Latin *votum*, "a vow, a wish" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vote*
- *Say it: le vote*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vote*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mayor, then the French for elections, then say *le vote* again

Before you move on

What does le vote mean? ("A vote".) Say it once more.

248.4 la politique — politics

Before the new one: say the French for elections, then the French for a vote.

You'll want to know: la politique

la politique — "politics".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

politique ← Latin *politicus*, from Greek *politikos*, "of citizens", from the same *polis*, "city", as *police* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la politique*
- *Say it: la politique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la politique*
- *Recall:* say the French for elections, then the French for a vote, then say *la politique* again

Before you move on

What does la politique mean? ("Politics".) Say it once more.

248.5 l'économie — the economy

Before the new one: say the French for a vote, then the French for politics.

You'll want to know: l'économie

l'économie — "the economy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

économie ← Latin *oeconomia*, from Greek *oikonomia*, "running a household", from *oikos*, "house" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'économie*
- *Say it: l'économie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'économie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vote, then the French for politics, then say *l'économie* again

Before you move on

What does l'économie mean? ("The economy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

Actor, Actress, Poem, Writer, Painter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer and a painter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer and a painter.*

249.1 l'acteur — an actor

Before the new one: say the French for politics, then the French for the economy.

You'll want to know: l'acteur

l'acteur — "an actor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acteur ← Latin *actor*, "a doer, a performer", from *agere*, the Latin of *agir* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'acteur*
- *Say it: l'acteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'acteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for politics, then the French for the economy, then say *l'acteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'acteur mean? ("An actor".) Say it once more.

249.2 l'actrice — an actress

Before the new one: say the French for the economy, then the French for an actor.

You'll want to know: l'actrice

l'actrice — "an actress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

actrice ← Latin *actrix*, the feminine of *actor*: the feminine of *acteur* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'actrice*
- *Say it: l'actrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'actrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the economy, then the French for an actor, then say *l'actrice* again

Before you move on

What does l'actrice mean? ("An actress".) Say it once more.

249.3 le poème — a poem

Before the new one: say the French for an actor, then the French for an actress.

You'll want to know: le poème

le poème — "a poem".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poème ← Latin *poema*, from Greek *poiema*, "a thing made", from *poiein*, "to make" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poème*
- *Say it: le poème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poème*
- *Recall:* say the French for an actor, then the French for an actress, then say *le poème* again

Before you move on

What does le poème mean? ("A poem".) Say it once more.

249.4 l'écrivain — a writer

Before the new one: say the French for an actress, then the French for a poem.

You'll want to know: l'écrivain

l'écrivain — "a writer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écrivain ← Old French *escrivain* ← Vulgar Latin **scribanem*, from Latin *scriba*, "a clerk", from *scribere*, the Latin of *écrire* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écrivain*
- *Say it: l'écrivain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écrivain*
- *Recall:* say the French for an actress, then the French for a poem, then say *l'écrivain* again

Before you move on

What does l'écrivain mean? ("A writer".) Say it once more.

249.5 le peintre — a painter

Before the new one: say the French for a poem, then the French for a writer.

You'll want to know: le peintre

le peintre — "a painter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peintre ← Old French *peintre* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **pinctor* ← Latin *pictor*, "a painter" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the noun beside *peindre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le peintre*
- *Say it: le peintre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le peintre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a poem, then the French for a writer, then say *le peintre* again

Before you move on

What does le peintre mean? ("A painter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

Foreigner, Tourist, Adult, Elderly person, Twin

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person and a twin.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person and a twin.

250.1 l'étranger — a foreigner

Before the new one: say the French for a writer, then the French for a painter.

You'll want to know: l'étranger

l'étranger — "a foreigner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étranger — the adjective *étranger*, "foreign", used as a noun: a foreigner.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étranger*
- *Say it: l'étranger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étranger*
- *Recall:* say the French for a writer, then the French for a painter, then say *l'étranger* again

Before you move on

What does l'étranger mean? ("A foreigner".) Say it once more.

250.2 le touriste — a tourist

Before the new one: say the French for a painter, then the French for a foreigner.

You'll want to know: le touriste

le touriste — "a tourist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

touriste ← English *tourist*, built on English *tour*, "a circuit", which English had taken from French — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le touriste*
- *Say it: le touriste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le touriste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a painter, then the French for a foreigner, then say *le touriste* again

Before you move on

What does le touriste mean? ("A tourist".) Say it once more.

250.3 l'adulte — an adult

Before the new one: say the French for a foreigner, then the French for a tourist.

You'll want to know: l'adulte

l'adulte — "an adult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adulte ← Latin *adultus*, "grown up", from *adolescere*, "to grow up" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adulte*
- *Say it: l'adulte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'adulte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a foreigner, then the French for a tourist, then say *l'adulte* again

Before you move on

What does l'adulte mean? ("An adult".) Say it once more.

250.4 la personne âgée — an elderly person

Before the new one: say the French for a tourist, then the French for an adult.

You'll want to know: la personne âgée

la personne âgée — "an elderly person".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

personne âgée — *personne*, "a person", and *âgée*, "aged", from *âge*, "age", ← Vulgar Latin **aetaticum*, from Latin *aetas*, "age" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la personne âgée*
- *Say it: la personne âgée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la personne âgée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tourist, then the French for an adult, then say *la personne âgée* again

Before you move on

What does la personne âgée mean? ("An elderly person".) Say it once more.

250.5 le jumeau — a twin

Before the new one: say the French for an adult, then the French for an elderly person.

You'll want to know: le jumeau

le jumeau — "a twin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jumeau ← Old French *jumel* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *gemellus*, "twin-born", a little form of *geminus*, "a twin" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jumeau*
- *Say it: le jumeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jumeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an adult, then the French for an elderly person, then say *le jumeau* again

Before you move on

What does le jumeau mean? ("A twin".) Say it once more.

250.6 Words from chapters 242-245 — a first pass

Say the words for an elderly person and a twin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke, to tidy up
- a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment, a diet
- silent, clean, hard, smooth, rough
- similar, fair, false, ready, free of charge

Before you move on

To lose weight? (**maigrir**.) To feed? (**nourrir**.) To go on holiday? (**partir en vacances**.) To joke? (**plaisanter**.) To tidy up? (**ranger**.) A plaster? (**le pansement**.) The emergency department? (**les urgences**.) An emergency? (**l'urgence**.) A

medical appointment? (**la consultation**.) A diet? (**le régime**.) Silent? (**silencieux / silencieuse**.) Clean? (**propre**.) Hard? (**dur / dure**.) Smooth? (**lisse**.) Rough? (**rugueux / rugueuse**.) Similar? (**semblable**.) Fair? (**juste**.) False? (**faux / fausse**.) Ready? (**prêt / prête**.) Free of charge? (**gratuit / gratuite**.)

250.7 Words from chapters 246-250 — a second pass

Say the words for generous and lazy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative, angry
- the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike, a platform
- a mayor, elections, a vote, politics, the economy
- an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer, a painter
- a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person, a twin

Before you move on

Generous? (**généreux / généreuse**.) Lazy? (**paresseux / paresseuse**.) Hard-working? (**travailleur / travailleuse**.) Talkative? (**bavard / bavarde**.) Angry? (**fâché / fâchée**.) The bill? (**l'addition**.) A tip? (**le pourboire**.) A stop? (**l'arrêt**.) A motorbike? (**la moto**.) A platform? (**le quai**.) A mayor? (**le maire**.) Elections? (**les élections**.) A vote? (**le vote**.) Politics? (**la politique**.) The economy? (**l'économie**.) An actor? (**l'acteur**.) An actress? (**l'actrice**.) A poem? (**le poème**.) A writer? (**l'écrivain**.) A painter? (**le peintre**.) A foreigner? (**l'étranger**.) A tourist? (**le touriste**.) An adult? (**l'adulte**.) An elderly person? (**la personne âgée**.) A twin? (**le jumeau**.)

Chapter 251

Result, Difference, Example, Truth, Lie

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a result, a difference, an example, the truth and a lie.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say a result, a difference, an example, the truth and a lie.

251.1 le résultat — a result

Before the new one: say the French for an elderly person, then the French for a twin.

You'll want to know: le résultat

le résultat — "a result".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résultat ← Medieval Latin *resultatum*, from *resultare*, "to spring back" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le résultat*
- *Say it: le résultat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le résultat*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elderly person, then the French for a twin, then say *le résultat* again

Before you move on

What does le résultat mean? ("A result".) Say it once more.

251.2 la différence — a difference

Before the new one: say the French for a twin, then the French for a result.

You'll want to know: la différence

la différence — "a difference".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

différence ← Latin *differentia*, "a difference" — the noun beside *différent*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la différence*
- *Say it: la différence*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la différence*
- *Recall:* say the French for a twin, then the French for a result, then say *la différence* again

Before you move on

What does la différence mean? ("A difference".) Say it once more.

251.3 l'exemple — an example

Before the new one: say the French for a result, then the French for a difference.

You'll want to know: l'exemple

l'exemple — "an example".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exemple ← Latin *exemplum*, "a sample, a pattern" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'exemple*
- *Say it: l'exemple*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'exemple*
- *Recall:* say the French for a result, then the French for a difference, then say *l'exemple* again

Before you move on

What does l'exemple mean? ("An example".) Say it once more.

251.4 la vérité — the truth

Before the new one: say the French for a difference, then the French for an example.

You'll want to know: la vérité

la vérité — "the truth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vérité ← Old French *verité* ← Latin *veritas*, "truth", from *verus*, "true" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vérité*
- *Say it: la vérité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vérité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a difference, then the French for an example, then say *la vérité* again

Before you move on

What does la vérité mean? ("The truth".) Say it once more.

251.5 le mensonge — a lie

Before the new one: say the French for an example, then the French for the truth.

You'll want to know: le mensonge

le mensonge — "a lie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mensonge ← Old French *mençonge* (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Vulgar Latin **mentionica*, built on Latin *mentiri*, "to lie" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mensonge*
- *Say it: le mensonge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mensonge*
- *Recall:* say the French for an example, then the French for the truth, then say *le mensonge* again

Before you move on

What does le mensonge mean? ("A lie".) Say it once more.

Chapter 252

Tax, Form, Envelope, Stamp, Parcel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp and a parcel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp and a parcel.*

252.1 l'impôt — a tax

> Before the new one: say the French for the truth, then the French for a lie.

You'll want to know: l'impôt

l'impôt — "a tax".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impôt ← Middle French *impost* ← Medieval Latin *impositum*, "a thing laid on", from *imponere* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the circumflex marks the *s* French later stopped writing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'impôt*
- *Say it: l'impôt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'impôt*
- *Recall:* say the French for the truth, then the French for a lie, then say *l'impôt* again

Before you move on

What does l'impôt mean? ("A tax".) Say it once more.

252.2 le formulaire — a form

Before the new one: say the French for a lie, then the French for a tax.

You'll want to know: le formulaire

le formulaire — "a form".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

formulaire ← Latin *formularium*, "a book of forms", from *formula*, "a little form" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le formulaire*
- *Say it: le formulaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le formulaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lie, then the French for a tax, then say *le formulaire* again

Before you move on

What does le formulaire mean? (“A form”.) Say it once more.

252.3 l’enveloppe — an envelope

Before the new one: say the French for a tax, then the French for a form.

You’ll want to know: l’enveloppe

l’enveloppe — “an envelope”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enveloppe — formed from the verb for “to wrap up” (EtymDB 2.1), built from *en-* and an Old French verb for “to wrap” of uncertain origin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’enveloppe*
- *Say it: l’enveloppe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’enveloppe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tax, then the French for a form, then say *l’enveloppe* again

Before you move on

What does l’enveloppe mean? (“An envelope”.) Say it once more.

252.4 le timbre — a stamp

Before the new one: say the French for a form, then the French for an envelope.

You'll want to know: le timbre

le timbre — "a stamp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

timbre ← Old French *timbre*, "a drum, a bell" ← Latin *tympanum*, from Greek *tympanon*, "a drum" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1): then the mark struck on a letter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le timbre*
- *Say it: le timbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le timbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a form, then the French for an envelope, then say *le timbre* again

Before you move on

What does le timbre mean? ("A stamp".) Say it once more.

252.5 le colis — a parcel

Before the new one: say the French for an envelope, then the French for a stamp.

You'll want to know: le colis

le colis — "a parcel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colis ← Italian *colli*, "loads", the plural of *collo*, "a neck, a load carried on it", ← Latin *collum*, the Latin of *cou* — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le colis*
- *Say it: le colis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le colis*
- *Recall:* say the French for an envelope, then the French for a stamp, then say *le colis* again

Before you move on

What does le colis mean? ("A parcel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

Driving licence, Helmet, Tunnel, Building site, Block of flats

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site and a block of flats.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can say a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site and a block of flats.

253.1 le permis de conduire — a driving licence

Before the new one: say the French for a stamp, then the French for a parcel.

You'll want to know: le permis de conduire

le permis de conduire — "a driving licence".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permis de conduire — *permis*, "permitted", from *permettre*, *de*, "of", and *conduire*, "to drive": leave to drive.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le permis de conduire*
- *Say it: le permis de conduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le permis de conduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stamp, then the French for a parcel, then say *le permis de conduire* again

Before you move on

What does le permis de conduire mean? ("A driving licence".) Say it once more.

253.2 le casque — a helmet

Before the new one: say the French for a parcel, then the French for a driving licence.

You'll want to know: le casque

le casque — "a helmet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casque ← Spanish *casco*, "a skull, a helmet", from *cascar*, "to break", ← Latin *quassare*, "to shatter" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le casque*
- *Say it: le casque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le casque*
- *Recall:* say the French for a parcel, then the French for a driving licence, then say *le casque* again

Before you move on

What does le casque mean? ("A helmet".) Say it once more.

253.3 le tunnel — a tunnel

Before the new one: say the French for a driving licence, then the French for a helmet.

You'll want to know: le tunnel

le tunnel — "a tunnel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tunnel ← English *tunnel* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed back: English had taken it from Old French *tonel*, "a cask".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tunnel*
- *Say it: le tunnel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tunnel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a driving licence, then the French for a helmet, then say *le tunnel* again

Before you move on

What does le tunnel mean? ("A tunnel".) Say it once more.

253.4 le chantier — a building site

Before the new one: say the French for a helmet, then the French for a tunnel.

You'll want to know: le chantier

le chantier — "a building site".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chantier ← Latin *cantherius*, "a gelding; a rafter, a trestle" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: first a timber support, then a work yard.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chantier*
- *Say it: le chantier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chantier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a helmet, then the French for a tunnel, then say *le chantier* again

Before you move on

What does le chantier mean? ("A building site".) Say it once more.

253.5 l'immeuble — a block of flats

Before the new one: say the French for a tunnel, then the French for a building site.

You'll want to know: l'immeuble

l'immeuble — "a block of flats".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

immeuble ← Latin *immobilis*, "that cannot be moved" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing: first property in land and buildings.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'immeuble*
- *Say it: l'immeuble*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'immeuble*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tunnel, then the French for a building site, then say *l'immeuble* again

Before you move on

What does l'immeuble mean? ("A block of flats".) Say it once more.

Chapter 254

Trunk, Thorn, Lawn, Path, Cave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path and a cave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path and a cave.*

254.1 le tronc — a trunk

> Before the new one: say the French for a building site, then the French for a block of flats.

You'll want to know: le tronc

le tronc — "a trunk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tronc ← Latin *truncus*, "a trunk, a stem" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tronc*

- *Say it:* *le tronc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tronc*
- *Recall:* say the French for a building site, then the French for a block of flats, then say *le tronc* again

Before you move on

What does le tronc mean? (“A trunk”.) Say it once more.

254.2 l’épine — a thorn

Before the new one: say the French for a block of flats, then the French for a trunk.

You’ll want to know: l’épine

l’épine — “a thorn”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épine ← Old French *espine* ← Latin *spina*, “a thorn” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *l’épine*
- *Say it:* *l’épine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’épine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a block of flats, then the French for a trunk, then say *l’épine* again

Before you move on

What does l’épine mean? (“A thorn”.) Say it once more.

254.3 la pelouse — a lawn

Before the new one: say the French for a trunk, then the French for a thorn.

You'll want to know: la pelouse

la pelouse — "a lawn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pelouse — from a southern word for "hairy", ← Latin *pilosus*, "hairy", from *pilus*, "a hair" (Lewis & Short): short grass like hair.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pelouse*
- *Say it: la pelouse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pelouse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a trunk, then the French for a thorn, then say *la pelouse* again

Before you move on

What does la pelouse mean? ("A lawn".) Say it once more.

254.4 le sentier — a path

Before the new one: say the French for a thorn, then the French for a lawn.

You'll want to know: le sentier

le sentier — "a path".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sentier ← Old French *sentier* ← Vulgar Latin **semitarius*, from Latin *semita*, "a path" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sentier*
- *Say it: le sentier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sentier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thorn, then the French for a lawn, then say *le sentier* again

Before you move on

What does le sentier mean? ("A path".) Say it once more.

254.5 la grotte — a cave

Before the new one: say the French for a lawn, then the French for a path.

You'll want to know: la grotte

la grotte — "a cave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grotte ← Italian *grotta* ← Latin *crypta*, from Greek *krypte*, "a hidden place" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grotte*
- *Say it: la grotte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grotte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lawn, then the French for a path, then say *la grotte* again

Before you move on

What does la grotte mean? (“A cave”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

Rubbish, Recycling, Energy, Electricity, Gas

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity and gas.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can say rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity and gas.

255.1 les déchets — rubbish

Before the new one: say the French for a path, then the French for a cave.

You'll want to know: les déchets

les déchets — "rubbish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déchets is the plural of a word formed from the verb for "to fall away", built on Latin *cadere*, "to fall" (Lewis & Short): what falls away.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les déchets*
- *Say it: les déchets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les déchets*
- *Recall:* say the French for a path, then the French for a cave, then say *les déchets* again

Before you move on

What does les déchets mean? ("Rubbish".) Say it once more.

255.2 le recyclage — recycling

Before the new one: say the French for a cave, then the French for rubbish.

You'll want to know: le recyclage

le recyclage — "recycling".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recyclage — built from *re-*, the word for "cycle", ← Latin *cyclus*, from Greek *kyklos*, "a circle" (Lewis & Short), and *-age*; modelled on English *recycling*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le recyclage*
- *Say it: le recyclage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le recyclage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cave, then the French for rubbish, then say *le recyclage* again

Before you move on

What does le recyclage mean? ("Recycling".) Say it once more.

255.3 l'énergie — energy

Before the new one: say the French for rubbish, then the French for recycling.

You'll want to know: l'énergie

l'énergie — "energy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

énergie ← Late Latin *energia*, from Greek *energeia*, "activity", built on *ergon*, "work" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'énergie*
- *Say it: l'énergie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'énergie*
- *Recall:* say the French for rubbish, then the French for recycling, then say *l'énergie* again

Before you move on

What does l'énergie mean? ("Energy".) Say it once more.

255.4 l'électricité — electricity

Before the new one: say the French for recycling, then the French for energy.

You'll want to know: l'électricité

l'électricité — "electricity".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

électricité ← English *electricity* (EtymDB 2.1), built on Latin *electrum*, "amber" — borrowed in the 1700s.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'électricité*
- *Say it: l'électricité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'électricité*
- *Recall:* say the French for recycling, then the French for energy, then say *l'électricité* again

Before you move on

What does l'électricité mean? ("Electricity".) Say it once more.

255.5 le gaz — gas

Before the new one: say the French for energy, then the French for electricity.

You'll want to know: le gaz

le gaz — "gas".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gaz — coined in the 1600s by the Flemish chemist Jan Baptist van Helmont from Greek *khaos*, "empty space" (EtymDB 2.1 links Dutch *gas* to *khaos*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gaz*
- *Say it: le gaz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gaz*
- *Recall:* say the French for energy, then the French for electricity, then say *le gaz* again

Before you move on

What does le gaz mean? ("Gas".) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

Tool, Guitar, Piano, Violin, Drum

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin and a drum.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can say a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin and a drum.*

256.1 l'outil — a tool

> Before the new one: say the French for electricity, then the French for gas.

You'll want to know: l'outil

l'outil — "a tool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

outil ← Old French *ustil* ← Late Latin **usitilium*, "a tool", from *uti*, "to use" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'outil*
- *Say it: l'outil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'outil*
- *Recall:* say the French for electricity, then the French for gas, then say *l'outil* again

Before you move on

What does l'outil mean? ("A tool".) Say it once more.

256.2 la guitare — a guitar

Before the new one: say the French for gas, then the French for a tool.

You'll want to know: la guitare

la guitare — "a guitar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guitare ← Spanish *guitarra* ← Arabic *qitara*, from Greek *kithara*, "a lyre" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guitare*
- *Say it: la guitare*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la guitare*
- *Recall:* say the French for gas, then the French for a tool, then say *la guitare* again

Before you move on

What does la guitare mean? (“A guitar”.) Say it once more.

256.3 le piano — a piano

Before the new one: say the French for a tool, then the French for a guitar.

You’ll want to know: le piano

le piano — “a piano”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piano ← Italian *piano*, short for *pianoforte*, “soft-loud”; *piano*, “soft”, ← Latin *planus*, “flat, smooth” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le piano*
- *Say it: le piano*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le piano*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tool, then the French for a guitar, then say *le piano* again

Before you move on

What does le piano mean? (“A piano”.) Say it once more.

256.4 le violon — a violin

Before the new one: say the French for a guitar, then the French for a piano.

You'll want to know: le violon

le violon — "a violin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

violon — built from Old French *viole*, a stringed instrument, with *-on*, under the influence of Italian *violino*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le violon*
- *Say it: le violon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le violon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guitar, then the French for a piano, then say *le violon* again

Before you move on

What does le violon mean? ("A violin".) Say it once more.

256.5 le tambour — a drum

Before the new one: say the French for a piano, then the French for a violin.

You'll want to know: le tambour

le tambour — "a drum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tambour ← Old French *tabour*, from Arabic *tunbur* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tambour*
- *Say it: le tambour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tambour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a piano, then the French for a violin, then say *le tambour* again

Before you move on

What does le tambour mean? ("A drum".) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

Geography, Mathematics, Art, Team, Birthday

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say geography, mathematics, art, a team and a birthday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can say geography, mathematics, art, a team and a birthday.*

257.1 la géographie — geography

> Before the new one: say the French for a violin, then the French for a drum.

You'll want to know: la géographie

la géographie — "geography".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

géographie ← Latin *geographia*, from Greek *geographia*, "a description of the earth" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la géographie*
- *Say it: la géographie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la géographie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a violin, then the French for a drum, then say *la géographie* again

Before you move on

What does la géographie mean? ("Geography".) Say it once more.

257.2 les mathématiques — mathematics

Before the new one: say the French for a drum, then the French for geography.

You'll want to know: les mathématiques

les mathématiques — "mathematics".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mathématiques ← Latin *mathematicus*, "of mathematics" (Lewis & Short), from Greek *mathematikos*, built on *mathema*, "a thing learned" — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les mathématiques*
- *Say it: les mathématiques*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les mathématiques*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drum, then the French for geography, then say *les mathématiques* again

Before you move on

What does les mathématiques mean? ("Mathematics".) Say it once more.

257.3 l'art — art

Before the new one: say the French for geography, then the French for mathematics.

You'll want to know: l'art

l'art — "art".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

art ← Latin *ars*, *artis*, "skill, craft" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'art*
- *Say it: l'art*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'art*
- *Recall:* say the French for geography, then the French for mathematics, then say *l'art* again

Before you move on

What does l'art mean? ("Art".) Say it once more.

257.4 l'équipe — a team

Before the new one: say the French for mathematics, then the French for art.

You'll want to know: l'équipe

l'équipe — "a team".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

équipe — formed from the verb for "to fit out", first "to fit out a ship" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Old Norse *skipa*, from *skip*, "a ship".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'équipe*
- *Say it: l'équipe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'équipe*
- *Recall:* say the French for mathematics, then the French for art, then say *l'équipe* again

Before you move on

What does l'équipe mean? ("A team".) Say it once more.

257.5 l'anniversaire — a birthday

Before the new one: say the French for art, then the French for a team.

You'll want to know: l'anniversaire

l'anniversaire — "a birthday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anniversaire ← Latin *anniversarius*, "coming round each year", from *annus*, the Latin of *an*, and *vertere*, "to turn" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'anniversaire*
- *Say it: l'anniversaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'anniversaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for art, then the French for a team, then say *l'anniversaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'anniversaire mean? ("A birthday".) Say it once more.

257.6 Words from chapters 251-253 — a first pass

Say the words for a team and a birthday.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a result, a difference, an example, the truth, a lie
- a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp, a parcel
- a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site, a block of flats

Before you move on

A result? (**le résultat**.) A difference? (**la différence**.) An example? (**l'exemple**.) The truth? (**la vérité**.) A lie? (**le mensonge**.) A tax? (**l'impôt**.) A form? (**le formulaire**.) An envelope? (**l'enveloppe**.) A stamp? (**le timbre**.) A parcel? (**le colis**.) A driving licence? (**le permis de conduire**.) A helmet? (**le casque**.) A tunnel? (**le tunnel**.) A building site? (**le chantier**.) A block of flats? (**l'immeuble**.)

257.7 Words from chapters 254-257 — a second pass

Say the words for a trunk and a thorn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path, a cave
- rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity, gas
- a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin, a drum
- geography, mathematics, art, a team, a birthday

Before you move on

A trunk? (**le tronc**.) A thorn? (**l'épine**.) A lawn? (**la pelouse**.) A path? (**le sentier**.) A cave? (**la grotte**.) Rubbish? (**les déchets**.) Recycling? (**le recyclage**.) Energy? (**l'énergie**.) Electricity? (**l'électricité**.) Gas? (**le gaz**.) A tool? (**l'outil**.) A guitar? (**la guitare**.) A piano? (**le piano**.) A violin? (**le violon**.) A drum? (**le tambour**.) Geography? (**la géographie**.) Mathematics? (**les mathématiques**.) Art? (**l'art**.) A team? (**l'équipe**.) A birthday? (**l'anniversaire**.)

Pronunciation — a reference, not a chapter

A **reference**, not a chapter. Each lesson tells you the sounds you need for its word and links here for more. French spelling hides more sound than Spanish does — silent letters, nasal vowels, liaison — so this page is worth dipping into, but never a gate to pass before Lesson 1.

Ids (e.g. `silent-final`) are cited in each lesson's frontmatter `sounds:` field.

The big three habits (unlearn Spanish/English here)

- `silent-final` — **most final consonants are silent.** *salut* → *sa-LU* (no *t*); *vous* → *voo* and *les* → *lay* (no *s*). Common exceptions kept: final *c, r, f, l* (the word "CaReFuL"). *bonjour*'s *r* is pronounced.
- `liaison` — a normally-silent final consonant **reconnects** onto a following vowel: *vous* + *avez* → *vou-zavez*. Comes later; just know it exists.
- `nasal` — some vowels are **nasal**: air through the nose, and the *n*/*m* itself goes silent. *bon* is not "bon" but a nasal *bõ*; *bien* is a nasal *byẽ*. See below.

Vowels

- `vowel-ou` — **ou** = *oo* as in *food*: *jour* (*zhoor*), *vous*, *bonjour*.

- `vowel-u` — **u** = a front-rounded *ee* with rounded lips (say *ee*, then purse your lips): *salut*, *tu*. No English equivalent; not *oo*.
- `vowel-oi` — **oi** = *wa*: *soir* (*swahr*), *bonsoir*, *moi* (*mwah*).
- `vowel-e-acute` — **é** = a crisp *ay* (no glide): *enchanté*.
- `vowel-e-grave` — **è / ê** = an open *eh* as in *bed*: *très*.

Nasal vowels

- `nasal-on` — **on / om** = nasal *õ* (like *song* without the *g*): *bon*, *bonjour*, *bonsoir*, *nom*.
- `nasal-in` — **in / ain / ien** = nasal *ẽ*: *bien* (*byẽ*), *matin*, *bientôt*.
- `nasal-an` — **an / en** = nasal *ã*: *enchanté* (*ã-shã-TAY*), *comment*.
- `double-n-blocks-nasal` — a doubled *nn*/*mm* **cancels** the nasal and the vowel goes back through the mouth: *bon* (*bõ*) vs. *bonne* (*bun*).

Consonants that differ

- `j-zh` — **j** = the soft *zh* of *measure*: *jour* (*zhoor*), *je* (*zhuh*).
- `soft-g` — **g** before *e*/*i* = the same *zh*: *âge*.
- `r-uvular` — **r** = a soft guttural sound at the back of the throat, not the Spanish tap/trill nor the English *r*. *bonjour*, *soir*.
- `h-silent` — **h** is always silent (as in Spanish): *heure* → *euhr*.
- `ch-sh` — **ch** = English *sh*: *enchanté* (*ã-**sh**ã-tay*).
- `gn` — **gn** = the *ny* of *canyon* (= Spanish *ñ*): *signe*.

Accents & spelling marks

- `accent-marks` — French accents mostly change **vowel quality**, not stress: *é* (closed *ay*), *è*/*ê* (open *eh*), *à*/*ù* (distinguish words), *ç* (soft *s*). Unlike Spanish, they do **not** mark which syllable is stressed — French stresses the **last** syllable of a group, lightly and evenly.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

(s')appeler
to call / to call oneself
Introduced in Chapter 2.

à
to, at — one letter, Latin ad, and the accent that keeps it apart from the verb a
Introduced in Chapter 39.

à bientôt
see you soon (literally "to well-soon")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

à côté
beside
Introduced in Chapter 157.

à demain
see you tomorrow (literally "to tomorrow")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

à droite
on the right
Introduced in Chapter 188.

à gauche
on the left
Introduced in Chapter 188.

à plus tard
see you later (literally "to more late")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

accompagner
to go with
Introduced in Chapter 178.

accueillir
to welcome
Introduced in Chapter 241.

acheter
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 64.

admirer
to admire
Introduced in Chapter 152.

agir
to act
Introduced in Chapter 152.

aider
to help — English aid arriving by the Latin road, while English help came by the Germanic one; the two words are unrelated
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ailleurs
elsewhere
Introduced in Chapter 216.

aimable
friendly
Introduced in Chapter 220.

aimer
to like AND to love — one French verb where English keeps two, so the strength comes from what follows it, and adding bien makes it WEAKER
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ajouter
to add
Introduced in Chapter 178.

aller
to go (and, oddly, "to be" in "how are you?")
Introduced in Chapter 3.

allumer
to switch on, to light
Introduced in Chapter 143.

alors
in that case, so
Introduced in Chapter 187.

améliorer
to improve
Introduced in Chapter 237.

amer
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 94.

amusant / amusante
fun, amusing
Introduced in Chapter 219.

ancien / ancienne
former, ancient
Introduced in Chapter 161.

annoncer
to announce
Introduced in Chapter 178.

août
August — the month renamed for the emperor Augustus
Introduced in Chapter 10.

apparaître
to appear
Introduced in Chapter 178.

applaudir
to applaud
Introduced in Chapter 208.

apprendre
to learn
Introduced in Chapter 60.

arrêter
to stop
Introduced in Chapter 176.

assez
enough, and rather — one word doing both jobs, and it takes de before a noun and nothing before an adjective
Introduced in Chapter 44.

attacher
to tie, to fasten
Introduced in Chapter 240.

atteindre
to reach
Introduced in Chapter 210.

attendre
to wait for
Introduced in Chapter 64.

au contraire
on the contrary
Introduced in Chapter 158.

au fond
at the bottom, at the back
Introduced in Chapter 188.

au revoir
goodbye (literally "until the seeing-again")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

au-dessous
below
Introduced in Chapter 157.

au-dessus
above
Introduced in Chapter 157.

aucun / aucune
none, not a single
Introduced in Chapter 139.

augmenter
to increase
Introduced in Chapter 208.

aujourd'hui
today
Introduced in Chapter 97.

autour
around
Introduced in Chapter 216.

autrefois
formerly, in the old days
Introduced in Chapter 140.

avancer
to move forward
Introduced in Chapter 152.

avant-hier
the day before yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 140.

avril
April — perhaps the opening month
Introduced in Chapter 9.

baisser
to lower
Introduced in Chapter 152.

bas / basse
low
Introduced in Chapter 160.

bavard / bavarde
talkative
Introduced in Chapter 246.

bavarder
to chat
Introduced in Chapter 150.

beaucoup
a lot — a beautiful blow, two words fused, and the p that never sounds
Introduced in Chapter 44.

bien
well / good / fine
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bien que
although
Introduced in Chapter 158.

blanc
white — a Germanic word in a Latin language, running against the traffic
Introduced in Chapter 16.

bleu
blue — a Germanic word that went to France, changed clothes, and came back
Introduced in Chapter 16.

bleu, blanc, rouge
the flag, in order — and two of its three colours are loanwords
Introduced in Chapter 16.

boire
to drink
Introduced in Chapter 61.

bon / bonne
good (adjective)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonjour
hello / good day
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonne nuit
good night (going to bed)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonsoir
good evening
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bouger
to stir, to move
Introduced in Chapter 184.

brancher
to plug in
Introduced in Chapter 150.

brûler
to burn
Introduced in Chapter 236.

brun
brown (of hair, skin)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

bruyant
noisy
Introduced in Chapter 132.

c'est
this is, that is — ce plus est, with the elision you have been hearing since l'eau
Introduced in Chapter 38.

cacher
to hide
Introduced in Chapter 66.

calculer
to calculate
Introduced in Chapter 236.

calme
calm, quiet
Introduced in Chapter 131.

carré
square
Introduced in Chapter 94.

casser
to break
Introduced in Chapter 206.

ce soir
this evening
Introduced in Chapter 141.

célèbre
famous
Introduced in Chapter 132.

célibataire
single
Introduced in Chapter 162.

cent
a hundred
Introduced in Chapter 105.

cependant
nevertheless, however
Introduced in Chapter 217.

certainement
certainly
Introduced in Chapter 189.

changer
to change
Introduced in Chapter 176.

chauffer
to heat
Introduced in Chapter 206.

cher
dear; expensive
Introduced in Chapter 90.

chercher
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 63.

chien, chat
dog and cat — chien is the REGULAR, expected descendant of canis (unlike Spanish's mysterious perro); chat continues cattus, the same Egypt-to-Rome story as Spanish's gato
Introduced in Chapter 26.

cinq
five
Introduced in Chapter 6.

cinquante
fifty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

clair / claire
clear, light (of a colour)
Introduced in Chapter 192.

combien
how much and how many — one word where English needs two
Introduced in Chapter 36.

commander
to order
Introduced in Chapter 205.

comme ci, comme ça
so-so (literally "like this, like that")
Introduced in Chapter 3.

commencer
to begin
Introduced in Chapter 137.

comment
how
Introduced in Chapter 2.

comment
how — a word you have been using since your first lesson
Introduced in Chapter 36.

comment ça va ?
how are you? — the neutral everyday question
Introduced in Chapter 3.

comment vous appelez-vous?
what's your name? (literally "how do you call yourself?")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

comparer
to compare
Introduced in Chapter 147.

compliqué / compliquée
complicated
Introduced in Chapter 191.

comprendre
to understand — literally com- + prendre, "to take together," so in French understanding IS grasping, and the verb conjugates exactly like the one it is built from
Introduced in Chapter 29.

compter
to count
Introduced in Chapter 66.

conduire
to drive
Introduced in Chapter 138.

confortable
comfortable
Introduced in Chapter 159.

connaître
to know (a person, a place)
Introduced in Chapter 138.

conseiller
to advise
Introduced in Chapter 147.

construire
to build
Introduced in Chapter 233.

content
pleased, glad
Introduced in Chapter 56.

continuer
to continue
Introduced in Chapter 144.

convaincre
to convince
Introduced in Chapter 147.

corriger
to correct
Introduced in Chapter 182.

couper
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 63.

courageux / courageuse
brave
Introduced in Chapter 190.

courir
to run — Latin currere, the root under current, course, courier and curriculum, and the verb that shows why chien palatalized its c and courir did not
Introduced in Chapter 30.

craindre
to fear
Introduced in Chapter 211.

crier
to shout
Introduced in Chapter 143.

critiquer
to criticise
Introduced in Chapter 147.

croire
to believe
Introduced in Chapter 137.

cru / crue
raw
Introduced in Chapter 161.

cueillir
to pick (flowers, fruit)
Introduced in Chapter 184.

cuisiner
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 60.

cuit / cuite
cooked
Introduced in Chapter 192.

curieux / curieuse
curious
Introduced in Chapter 218.

dangereux / dangereuse
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 160.

de
of, from — the word already inside du, and the one that does what English does with an apostrophe
Introduced in Chapter 39.

de rien
you're welcome (literally "of nothing")
Introduced in Chapter 3.

de toute façon
anyway
Introduced in Chapter 158.

décembre
December — the month that still says "ten"
Introduced in Chapter 10.

décider
to decide
Introduced in Chapter 144.

découvrir
to discover
Introduced in Chapter 149.

dedans
inside
Introduced in Chapter 97.

défendre
to defend
Introduced in Chapter 184.

dehors
outside
Introduced in Chapter 97.

déjà
already
Introduced in Chapter 140.

demander
to ask — an ordinary, polite, everyday word, and one of the sharpest false friends French holds for an English speaker
Introduced in Chapter 28.

déménager
to move house
Introduced in Chapter 235.

démontrer
to prove
Introduced in Chapter 147.

dépasser
to overtake
Introduced in Chapter 181.

dépendre
to depend
Introduced in Chapter 179.

dépenser
to spend (money)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

déplacer
to move (something)
Introduced in Chapter 176.

depuis
since, for
Introduced in Chapter 187.

dernier
last
Introduced in Chapter 132.

derrière
behind
Introduced in Chapter 157.

désagréable
unpleasant
Introduced in Chapter 159.

désormais
from now on
Introduced in Chapter 156.

dessiner
to draw
Introduced in Chapter 66.

dessous
underneath
Introduced in Chapter 97.

dessus
on top
Introduced in Chapter 97.

détruire
to destroy
Introduced in Chapter 182.

deux
two
Introduced in Chapter 6.

devant
in front
Introduced in Chapter 157.

devoir
must — the third of the set, and the one with a debt inside it
Introduced in Chapter 37.

différent / différente
different
Introduced in Chapter 219.

difficile
difficult
Introduced in Chapter 90.

dimanche
Sunday — the Lord's day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

diminuer
to decrease
Introduced in Chapter 208.

diriger
to direct
Introduced in Chapter 182.

discuter
to discuss
Introduced in Chapter 145.

disparaître
to disappear
Introduced in Chapter 184.

divorcé / divorcée
divorced
Introduced in Chapter 162.

divorcer
to divorce
Introduced in Chapter 207.

dix
ten
Introduced in Chapter 6.

dix-huit
eighteen — free, once you have the rule
Introduced in Chapter 15.

dix-neuf
nineteen — the last number before the system changes again
Introduced in Chapter 15.

dix-sept
seventeen — the number where French stops inheriting and starts building
Introduced in Chapter 15.

donc
so, therefore
Introduced in Chapter 158.

donner
to give
Introduced in Chapter 61.

dormir
to sleep — Latin dormīre, unchanged in French, and the source of dormitory and dormant, though not of the dormouse
Introduced in Chapter 30.

doux
soft; mild; sweet
Introduced in Chapter 92.

douze
twelve — the second welded teen, and the one that shows the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 14.

drôle
funny
Introduced in Chapter 132.

dur / dure
hard
Introduced in Chapter 244.

échanger
to exchange
Introduced in Chapter 183.

économiser
to save (money)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

écouter
to listen to
Introduced in Chapter 64.

écrire
to write — Latin scrībere, "to scratch," with a propped-up é- that French added in front of every borrowed sc-, sp- and st- word
Introduced in Chapter 29.

embrasser
to kiss
Introduced in Chapter 175.

empirer
to get worse
Introduced in Chapter 237.

emprunter
to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 184.

enchanté(e)
pleased to meet you (literally "enchanted")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

encore
still, again
Introduced in Chapter 156.

enfin
finally
Introduced in Chapter 156.

enlever
to take off, to remove
Introduced in Chapter 176.

ennuyeux / ennuyeuse
boring
Introduced in Chapter 219.

enregistrer
to record
Introduced in Chapter 214.

enrhumé / enrhumée
with a cold
Introduced in Chapter 162.

enseigner
to teach
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ensemble
together
Introduced in Chapter 217.

ensuite
afterwards, next
Introduced in Chapter 156.

entendre
to hear — from a Latin verb meaning "to stretch toward," so English's intend is its closest surviving cousin, and French still keeps the older sense in entendu and s'entendre
Introduced in Chapter 30.

entretenir
to maintain
Introduced in Chapter 214.

environ
about, approximately
Introduced in Chapter 217.

envoyer
to send
Introduced in Chapter 65.

épicé / épicée
spicy
Introduced in Chapter 161.

épouser
to marry
Introduced in Chapter 207.

espérer
to hope
Introduced in Chapter 138.

essayer
to try
Introduced in Chapter 144.

et
and — Latin et unchanged, and a t that never joins to the next word
Introduced in Chapter 40.

et demie
half past — literally "and a half"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

et quart
quarter past — literally "and a quarter"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

éteindre
to switch off, to put out
Introduced in Chapter 143.

étrange
strange
Introduced in Chapter 219.

étranger / étrangère
foreign
Introduced in Chapter 220.

être / ser · estar
the same two Latin verbs, and the opposite solution — Spanish kept them apart
Introduced in Chapter 19.

étroit
narrow
Introduced in Chapter 92.

étudier
to study
Introduced in Chapter 62.

éviter
to avoid
Introduced in Chapter 179.

exagérer
to exaggerate
Introduced in Chapter 182.

exister
to exist
Introduced in Chapter 214.

expliquer
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 144.

exprimer
to express
Introduced in Chapter 214.

fâché / fâchée
angry
Introduced in Chapter 246.

facile
easy
Introduced in Chapter 89.

faible
weak
Introduced in Chapter 91.

faux / fausse
false, wrong
Introduced in Chapter 245.

fermé
closed
Introduced in Chapter 131.

fermer
to close — from Latin firmāre, "to make firm," so a French door is not shut but made fast; the same verb gave Italian "to stop" and Spanish "to sign"
Introduced in Chapter 31.

fêter
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 182.

février
February — the month of the purification festival
Introduced in Chapter 9.

fier / fière
proud
Introduced in Chapter 218.

finir
to finish — and the second regular family, which grows an extra syllable in the plural
Introduced in Chapter 41.

fixer
to fix, to stare at
Introduced in Chapter 212.

flotter
to float
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fonctionner
to function, to work
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fort
strong
Introduced in Chapter 91.

frais / fraîche
fresh, cool
Introduced in Chapter 161.

frapper
to hit, to knock
Introduced in Chapter 236.

freiner
to brake
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fumer
to smoke
Introduced in Chapter 146.

gagner
to win; to earn
Introduced in Chapter 66.

garer
to park
Introduced in Chapter 175.

gaspiller
to waste
Introduced in Chapter 181.

généreux / généreuse
generous
Introduced in Chapter 246.

gentil
kind, nice
Introduced in Chapter 92.

glisser
to slip
Introduced in Chapter 183.

goûter
to taste
Introduced in Chapter 206.

gratuit / gratuite
free of charge
Introduced in Chapter 245.

gris
grey
Introduced in Chapter 91.

gros
big, fat
Introduced in Chapter 93.

grossir
to put on weight
Introduced in Chapter 214.

habiter
to live / to dwell (a second -er verb — same pattern)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

haut
high, tall
Introduced in Chapter 90.

héberger
to put up (a guest)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

heure
hour (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 8.

heureusement
luckily
Introduced in Chapter 189.

heureux
happy
Introduced in Chapter 55.

hier
yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 98.

honnête
honest
Introduced in Chapter 220.

huit
eight
Introduced in Chapter 6.

hurler
to scream
Introduced in Chapter 241.

ici, là, là-bas
here, there, over there — three distances, and the same ci and la already frozen inside voici and voila
Introduced in Chapter 38.

il a, elle a
he has, she has — the verb worn down to a single letter
Introduced in Chapter 17.

il est, ... heures
"it is … o'clock" — the frame that tells the time
Introduced in Chapter 8.

il est, elle est
he is, she is — the most frequently said word in the language
Introduced in Chapter 19.

il y a
there is, there are — literally it has there, and the y is a Latin word for there that survives nowhere else
Introduced in Chapter 38.

ils ont, elles ont
they have — the form that refuses to look like the rest
Introduced in Chapter 17.

ils sont, elles sont
they are — the hiss against ils ont's buzz
Introduced in Chapter 19.

imaginer
to imagine
Introduced in Chapter 209.

impoli / impolie
rude
Introduced in Chapter 159.

inconfortable
uncomfortable
Introduced in Chapter 159.

inconnu / inconnue
unknown
Introduced in Chapter 160.

indiquer
to point out
Introduced in Chapter 209.

informer
to inform
Introduced in Chapter 209.

inquiet / inquiète
worried
Introduced in Chapter 162.

insister
to insist
Introduced in Chapter 240.

interdire
to forbid
Introduced in Chapter 177.

interrompre
to interrupt
Introduced in Chapter 240.

inutile
useless
Introduced in Chapter 191.

inviter
to invite
Introduced in Chapter 175.

j'ai
I have — one syllable, one vowel, and all that is left of Latin habeō
Introduced in Chapter 17.

j'ai vingt ans / I am twenty
a clean split down Europe — Romance HAS its years, Germanic IS its years
Introduced in Chapter 17.

jaloux / jalouse
jealous
Introduced in Chapter 218.

jamais
never; ever
Introduced in Chapter 96.

janvier
January — the month of Janus, god of doorways
Introduced in Chapter 9.

je
I
Introduced in Chapter 2.

je m'appelle...
my name is… (literally "I call myself")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

Je parle français
"I speak French" — your first full sentence (français = French)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

je suis
I am — from Latin sum, and one of the oldest word-shapes in Europe
Introduced in Chapter 19.

je suis désolé(e)
I'm sorry (literally "I am desolate")
Introduced in Chapter 24.

jeter
to throw away
Introduced in Chapter 236.

jeudi
Thursday — the day of Jupiter
Introduced in Chapter 7.

jeune
young
Introduced in Chapter 92.

joli
pretty
Introduced in Chapter 130.

jouer
to play
Introduced in Chapter 60.

jour
day (le jour — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

joyeux / joyeuse
cheerful
Introduced in Chapter 190.

juillet
July — the month renamed for Julius Caesar
Introduced in Chapter 10.

juin
June — the month of Juno, queen of the gods
Introduced in Chapter 9.

jusqu'à
until
Introduced in Chapter 187.

juste
fair, right
Introduced in Chapter 245.

l'abeille
a bee
Introduced in Chapter 87.

l'acteur
an actor
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'actrice
an actress
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'addition
the bill
Introduced in Chapter 247.

l'adresse
an address
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'adulte
an adult
Introduced in Chapter 250.

l'aéroport
an airport
Introduced in Chapter 103.

l'agriculteur
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 123.

l'aiguille
a needle
Introduced in Chapter 230.

l'ail
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 120.

l'amende
a fine
Introduced in Chapter 227.

l'ami, l'amie
friend — masculine or feminine by a regular swap, and the reason le/la elides to l' before a vowel
Introduced in Chapter 33.

l'amitié
friendship
Introduced in Chapter 186.

l'amour
love
Introduced in Chapter 155.

l'angoisse
anxiety
Introduced in Chapter 155.

l'anniversaire
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'annonce
an advert, an announcement
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'appartement
a flat
Introduced in Chapter 163.

l'arbre
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 81.

l'architecte
an architect
Introduced in Chapter 166.

l'argent
money; silver
Introduced in Chapter 79.

l'armée
an army
Introduced in Chapter 165.

l'armoire
a wardrobe
Introduced in Chapter 112.

l'arrêt
a stop
Introduced in Chapter 247.

l'arrivée
arrival
Introduced in Chapter 231.

l'art
art
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'ascenseur
a lift, an elevator
Introduced in Chapter 106.

l'aspirateur
a vacuum cleaner
Introduced in Chapter 115.

l'assiette
a plate
Introduced in Chapter 76.

l'automne
autumn — the season English borrowed whole
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'autoroute
a motorway
Introduced in Chapter 227.

l'avenir
the future
Introduced in Chapter 141.

l'avion
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 99.

l'avis
a notice, an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'avocat
a lawyer; an avocado
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'eau
water — the most worn-down word French ever took from Latin
Introduced in Chapter 13.

l'écharpe
a scarf
Introduced in Chapter 116.

l'échec
failure
Introduced in Chapter 197.

l'échelle
a ladder
Introduced in Chapter 230.

l'éclair
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 229.

l'école
a school
Introduced in Chapter 99.

l'économie
the economy
Introduced in Chapter 248.

l'écran
a screen
Introduced in Chapter 195.

l'écrivain
a writer
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'église
a church
Introduced in Chapter 100.

l'électricien
an electrician
Introduced in Chapter 196.

l'électricité
electricity
Introduced in Chapter 255.

l'éléphant
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

l'élève
a pupil
Introduced in Chapter 59.

l'employé
an employee
Introduced in Chapter 224.

l'énergie
energy
Introduced in Chapter 255.

l'enfant
child — one spelling for both genders, the article alone showing which; literally "not yet speaking"
Introduced in Chapter 33.

l'entraîneur
a coach
Introduced in Chapter 203.

l'entrée
an entrance
Introduced in Chapter 199.

l'entreprise
a company
Introduced in Chapter 174.

l'entretien
an interview
Introduced in Chapter 204.

l'enveloppe
an envelope
Introduced in Chapter 252.

l'environnement
the environment
Introduced in Chapter 229.

l'épaule
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 50.

l'épicerie
a grocer's shop
Introduced in Chapter 107.

l'épine
a thorn
Introduced in Chapter 254.

l'équipe
a team
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'erreur
a mistake
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'escalier
the stairs
Introduced in Chapter 75.

l'espoir
hope
Introduced in Chapter 186.

l'estomac
the stomach
Introduced in Chapter 52.

l'étagère
a shelf
Introduced in Chapter 112.

l'été
summer — literally "the heat"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'étiquette
a label
Introduced in Chapter 169.

l'étoile
a star
Introduced in Chapter 83.

l'étranger
a foreigner
Introduced in Chapter 250.

l'étudiant
a student
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'examen
an exam
Introduced in Chapter 126.

l'exemple
an example
Introduced in Chapter 251.

l'expérience
experience
Introduced in Chapter 225.

l'herbe
grass
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'histoire
history, a story
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'hiver
winter — literally "the wintry season"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'hôpital
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 54.

l'horaire
opening hours, a timetable
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'hôtel
a hotel
Introduced in Chapter 101.

l'huile
oil
Introduced in Chapter 69.

l'idée
an idea
Introduced in Chapter 127.

l'île
an island
Introduced in Chapter 82.

l'immeuble
a block of flats
Introduced in Chapter 253.

l'impôt
a tax
Introduced in Chapter 252.

l'imprimante
a printer
Introduced in Chapter 204.

l'infirmière
a nurse
Introduced in Chapter 123.

l'ingénieur
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'interdiction
a ban
Introduced in Chapter 168.

l'invité
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 58.

l'oignon
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 68.

l'oiseau
a bird
Introduced in Chapter 85.

l'oncle
an uncle
Introduced in Chapter 57.

l'ongle
a nail (finger or toe)
Introduced in Chapter 51.

l'orage
a storm
Introduced in Chapter 133.

l'orange
an orange
Introduced in Chapter 68.

l'ordinateur
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 111.

l'ordonnance
a prescription
Introduced in Chapter 215.

l'oreille
an ear
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'oreiller
a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 113.

l'ouest
the west
Introduced in Chapter 109.

l'ours
a bear
Introduced in Chapter 86.

l'outil
a tool
Introduced in Chapter 256.

l'ouvrier
a worker
Introduced in Chapter 196.

l'université
a university
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'urgence
an emergency
Introduced in Chapter 243.

l'usine
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 108.

l'œil, les yeux
eye — masculine, with a plural that looks irregular but is the REGULAR outcome of Latin oculos; œil's own singular is the piece that changed
Introduced in Chapter 35.

l'œuf, les œufs
egg — masculine, a genuine cousin of English egg, and the one French noun whose final consonant vanishes only in the plural
Introduced in Chapter 34.

la bague
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 118.

la baignoire
a bathtub
Introduced in Chapter 112.

la banane
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la banlieue
the suburbs
Introduced in Chapter 216.

la banque
a bank
Introduced in Chapter 99.

la batterie
a battery
Introduced in Chapter 223.

la belle-fille
a daughter-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la belle-mère
a mother-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la bibliothèque
a library
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la bière
beer
Introduced in Chapter 121.

la blessure
a wound
Introduced in Chapter 185.

la boîte
a box
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la boîte aux lettres
a letterbox, a postbox
Introduced in Chapter 109.

la bouche
mouth — feminine, and originally the Latin word for cheek, not mouth at all
Introduced in Chapter 35.

la boucherie
a butcher's
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la boue
mud
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la boulangerie
a bakery
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la bouteille
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la branche
a branch
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la brique
a brick
Introduced in Chapter 202.

la brosse à dents
a toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la caisse
a till, a checkout
Introduced in Chapter 125.

la carotte
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 69.

la carrière
a career
Introduced in Chapter 204.

la carte
a map; a card
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la carte bancaire
a bank card
Introduced in Chapter 226.

la carte postale
a postcard
Introduced in Chapter 169.

la cascade
a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 171.

la casquette
a cap
Introduced in Chapter 117.

la casserole
a saucepan
Introduced in Chapter 193.

la cave
a cellar
Introduced in Chapter 200.

la ceinture
a belt
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la cerise
a cherry
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la chaise
a chair
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la chaleur
heat
Introduced in Chapter 133.

la chambre
a bedroom
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la chanson
a song
Introduced in Chapter 128.

la chemise
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 103.

la cheville
an ankle
Introduced in Chapter 52.

la chèvre
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 87.

la cicatrice
a scar
Introduced in Chapter 185.

la classe
a class; a classroom
Introduced in Chapter 126.

la clé
a key
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la clôture
a fence
Introduced in Chapter 200.

la colère
anger
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la colline
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 84.

la confiance
trust
Introduced in Chapter 186.

la confiture
jam
Introduced in Chapter 71.

la consultation
a medical appointment
Introduced in Chapter 243.

la corde
a rope
Introduced in Chapter 202.

la correspondance
a connection
Introduced in Chapter 203.

la couleur
a colour
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la cousine
a cousin (female)
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la couverture
a blanket
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la cravate
a tie
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la crème
cream
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la cuillère
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la cuisine
a kitchen; cooking
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la date
a date
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la décision
a decision
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la défaite
a defeat
Introduced in Chapter 203.

la dent
a tooth
Introduced in Chapter 49.

la destination
a destination
Introduced in Chapter 231.

la dette
a debt
Introduced in Chapter 226.

la différence
a difference
Introduced in Chapter 251.

la douane
customs
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la douche
a shower
Introduced in Chapter 112.

la douleur
pain
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la droite
the right
Introduced in Chapter 110.

la facture
a bill, an invoice
Introduced in Chapter 142.

la famille
family — feminine and fixed, whoever is in it, and once meant the household's servants
Introduced in Chapter 33.

la farine
flour
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la fatigue
tiredness
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la femme
a woman; a wife
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la fenêtre
a window
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la feuille
a leaf; a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la feuille de papier
a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 204.

la fiancée
a fiancée
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la fiche de paie
a pay slip
Introduced in Chapter 169.

la fièvre
a fever
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la fille
a daughter; a girl
Introduced in Chapter 56.

la flamme
a flame
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la fleur
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la fois
a time, an occasion
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la fontaine
a fountain
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la fourchette
a fork
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la fourmi
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

la fraise
a strawberry
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la frontière
a border
Introduced in Chapter 109.

la fumée
smoke
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la gauche
the left
Introduced in Chapter 110.

la géographie
geography
Introduced in Chapter 257.

la glace
ice cream; ice; a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 121.

la gomme
a rubber, an eraser
Introduced in Chapter 127.

la gorge
the throat
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la graine
a seed
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la grand-mère
a grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 56.

la grenouille
a frog
Introduced in Chapter 88.

la grippe
flu
Introduced in Chapter 215.

la grotte
a cave
Introduced in Chapter 254.

la guerre
war
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la guitare
a guitar
Introduced in Chapter 256.

la honte
shame
Introduced in Chapter 186.

la jambe
a leg
Introduced in Chapter 49.

la joie
joy
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la joue
a cheek
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la jupe
a skirt
Introduced in Chapter 104.

la laine
wool
Introduced in Chapter 172.

la lampe
a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la leçon
a lesson
Introduced in Chapter 126.

la lessive
washing powder; the washing
Introduced in Chapter 115.

la lettre
a letter
Introduced in Chapter 118.

la lèvre
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 134.

la loi
a law
Introduced in Chapter 222.

la lune
the Moon (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 7.

la main
the hand — feminine despite ending in a consonant, and the root of half the words you know
Introduced in Chapter 21.

la mairie
the town hall
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la maladie
an illness
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la mariée
a bride
Introduced in Chapter 197.

la mer
the sea
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la mère
mother — and the reason English calls physical stuff “matter”
Introduced in Chapter 12.

la monnaie
change (coins); currency
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la montagne
a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la montre
a watch
Introduced in Chapter 221.

la moto
a motorbike
Introduced in Chapter 247.

la mouche
a fly
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la musique
music
Introduced in Chapter 128.

la natation
swimming
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la neige
snow
Introduced in Chapter 83.

la nièce
a niece
Introduced in Chapter 59.

la noix
a walnut, a nut
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la nouvelle
a piece of news
Introduced in Chapter 195.

la paix
peace
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la peau
skin
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la pêche
a peach
Introduced in Chapter 221.

la pelouse
a lawn
Introduced in Chapter 254.

la permission
permission
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la personne
person — feminine no matter who is meant, even a man, and secretly "nobody" when it stands next to ne
Introduced in Chapter 33.

la personne âgée
an elderly person
Introduced in Chapter 250.

la petite-fille
a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 58.

la peur
fear
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la pharmacie
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 101.

la photo
a photo
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la pièce
a coin, a room
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la pierre
a stone
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la piscine
a swimming pool
Introduced in Chapter 107.

la plage
a beach
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la plaine
a plain
Introduced in Chapter 171.

la plante
a plant
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la pluie
rain
Introduced in Chapter 83.

la poche
a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 115.

la poêle
a frying pan
Introduced in Chapter 193.

la poire
a pear
Introduced in Chapter 70.

la poitrine
the chest
Introduced in Chapter 52.

la police
the police
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la politique
politics
Introduced in Chapter 248.

la pollution
pollution
Introduced in Chapter 229.

la pommade
an ointment
Introduced in Chapter 215.

la pomme
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 67.

la pomme de terre
a potato
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la possibilité
a possibility
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la poste
the post office
Introduced in Chapter 101.

la poubelle
a bin
Introduced in Chapter 114.

la poule
a hen
Introduced in Chapter 86.

la poussière
dust
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la promesse
a promise
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la publicité
advertising
Introduced in Chapter 195.

la racine
a root
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la radio
a radio
Introduced in Chapter 111.

la raison
a reason
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la raquette
a racket
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la réduction
a discount
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la règle
a rule
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la réponse
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 127.

la réservation
a booking
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la réunion
a meeting
Introduced in Chapter 174.

la rivière
a river
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la robe
a dress
Introduced in Chapter 103.

la roue
a wheel
Introduced in Chapter 227.

la rue
a street
Introduced in Chapter 98.

la salade
a salad; lettuce
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la salle à manger
a dining room
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la salle de bain
a bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la salle de sport
a gym
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la santé
health
Introduced in Chapter 154.

la sauce
a sauce
Introduced in Chapter 122.

la seconde
a second
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la sécurité
safety
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la semaine
a week
Introduced in Chapter 95.

la serrure
a lock
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la serviette
a towel; a napkin
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la société
society
Introduced in Chapter 222.

la soie
silk
Introduced in Chapter 172.

la soif
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la sonnette
a doorbell
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la sortie
an exit
Introduced in Chapter 199.

la soupe
a soup
Introduced in Chapter 69.

la souris
a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 85.

la statue
a statue
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la sœur
sister — the one family word that broke the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 12.

la taille
size; the waist
Introduced in Chapter 117.

la tante
an aunt
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la tasse
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la télévision
a television
Introduced in Chapter 111.

la température
temperature
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la terre
earth, land
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la tête
the head — from Latin for a clay pot
Introduced in Chapter 21.

la tomate
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la tortue
a tortoise
Introduced in Chapter 89.

la tour
a tower
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la toux
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la tradition
a tradition
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la tristesse
sadness
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la vache
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 85.

la vague
a wave
Introduced in Chapter 84.

la valise
a suitcase
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la vallée
a valley
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la vérité
the truth
Introduced in Chapter 251.

la veste
a jacket
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la victoire
a victory
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la vie
life
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la ville
a town, a city
Introduced in Chapter 98.

la voiture
a car
Introduced in Chapter 100.

là-haut
up there
Introduced in Chapter 216.

laisser
to leave (something); to let
Introduced in Chapter 65.

lancer
to throw
Introduced in Chapter 179.

laver
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 60.

le / la / les
the (masculine / feminine / plural)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

le balai
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le balcon
a balcony
Introduced in Chapter 163.

le ballon
a ball
Introduced in Chapter 173.

le bébé
a baby
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le beurre
butter — masculine, and the same borrowed word as English butter, not two separate coinages
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le bijou
a jewel, a piece of jewellery
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le billet
a ticket; a banknote
Introduced in Chapter 80.

le billet de banque
a banknote
Introduced in Chapter 198.

le biscuit
a biscuit
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le boucher
a butcher
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le boulanger
a baker
Introduced in Chapter 124.

le bouton
a button
Introduced in Chapter 221.

le bras
an arm
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le brouillard
fog
Introduced in Chapter 133.

le bureau
an office; a desk
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le bœuf
beef; an ox
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le cadeau
a present, a gift
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le café
coffee — masculine, and the one drink-word nearly all of Europe borrowed along the same single road
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le cahier
a notebook
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le caillou
a pebble
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le canapé
a sofa
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le canard
a duck
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le caoutchouc
natural rubber
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le carrefour
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le casque
a helmet
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le cerveau
the brain
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le champignon
a mushroom
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le championnat
a championship
Introduced in Chapter 203.

le chanteur
a singer
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le chantier
a building site
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le chapeau
a hat
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le chargeur
a charger
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le château
a castle
Introduced in Chapter 170.

le chauffeur
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 124.

le chercheur
a researcher
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le chocolat
chocolate
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le choix
a choice
Introduced in Chapter 225.

le cinéma
a cinema
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le citron
a lemon
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le clavier
a keyboard
Introduced in Chapter 195.

le client
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le climat
the climate
Introduced in Chapter 229.

le clou
a nail for hammering
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le cochon
a pig
Introduced in Chapter 85.

le colis
a parcel
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le collègue
a colleague
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le collier
a necklace
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le comprimé
a tablet (medicine)
Introduced in Chapter 215.

le comptable
an accountant
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le compte bancaire
a bank account
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le concert
a concert
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le concombre
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le conseil
advice
Introduced in Chapter 168.

le contrat
a contract
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le coton
cotton
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le cou
the neck
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le coude
an elbow
Introduced in Chapter 52.

le couloir
a corridor
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le courage
courage
Introduced in Chapter 186.

le courriel
an email
Introduced in Chapter 135.

le couteau
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 77.

le crayon
a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le cuir
leather
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le cuisinier
a cook
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le déjeuner
lunch
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le dentifrice
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le dentiste
a dentist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le départ
departure
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le désert
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le dessert
a dessert
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le dessin
a drawing
Introduced in Chapter 129.

le dialecte
a dialect
Introduced in Chapter 195.

le dictionnaire
a dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 232.

le dîner
dinner
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le distributeur
a cash machine
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le doigt
a finger
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le dossier
a folder, a file
Introduced in Chapter 169.

le drap
a sheet
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le facteur
a postman, a postwoman
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le fauteuil
an armchair
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le fer
iron; an iron (for clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

le feu
fire
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le feu rouge
a red light
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le fiancé
a fiancé
Introduced in Chapter 167.

le fil
a thread, a wire
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le film
a film
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le fleuve
a large river
Introduced in Chapter 164.

le foie
the liver
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le formulaire
a form
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le frère
brother — and the friar who is one
Introduced in Chapter 12.

le fromage
cheese — masculine, and named for its MOULD rather than for the milk it's made from
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le fruit
a fruit
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le gâteau
a cake
Introduced in Chapter 69.

le gaz
gas
Introduced in Chapter 255.

le gendre
a son-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

le genou
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le gouvernement
the government
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le grand-père
a grandfather
Introduced in Chapter 56.

le grenier
an attic
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le guide
a guide, a guidebook
Introduced in Chapter 169.

le jambon
ham
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le jardin
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 74.

le jeu
a game
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le joueur
a player
Introduced in Chapter 203.

le journaliste
a journalist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le juge
a judge
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le jumeau
a twin
Introduced in Chapter 250.

le jus
juice
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le lait
milk — masculine, and the one drink in this chapter French did not have to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le lapin
a rabbit
Introduced in Chapter 88.

le linge
laundry, linen
Introduced in Chapter 115.

le lion
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le loup
a wolf
Introduced in Chapter 85.

le loyer
the rent
Introduced in Chapter 142.

le magasin
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 99.

le magazine
a magazine
Introduced in Chapter 232.

le maillot
a swimsuit; a sports shirt
Introduced in Chapter 117.

le maire
a mayor
Introduced in Chapter 248.

le manteau
a coat
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le mari
a husband
Introduced in Chapter 57.

le marié
a bridegroom
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le marteau
a hammer
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le matin
the morning
Introduced in Chapter 95.

le mécanicien
a mechanic
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le médecin
a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 53.

le médicament
a medicine
Introduced in Chapter 53.

le melon
a melon
Introduced in Chapter 120.

le mensonge
a lie
Introduced in Chapter 251.

le menton
the chin
Introduced in Chapter 51.

le métal
metal
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le métro
the underground, the metro
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le miel
honey
Introduced in Chapter 69.

le miroir
a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le mois
a month
Introduced in Chapter 95.

le monde
the world
Introduced in Chapter 110.

le monument
a monument
Introduced in Chapter 170.

le mot
a word
Introduced in Chapter 126.

le moteur
an engine
Introduced in Chapter 227.

le moustique
a mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 194.

le mouton
a sheep
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le mur
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 73.

le muscle
a muscle
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le musée
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le neveu
a nephew
Introduced in Chapter 59.

le nez
nose — masculine, a silent final z, and another genuine cousin of its English counterpart
Introduced in Chapter 35.

le nord
the north
Introduced in Chapter 109.

le nuage
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 83.

le numéro
a number (on a door, a phone)
Introduced in Chapter 134.

le pain
bread — and the companion who is, literally, someone you share it with
Introduced in Chapter 13.

le pansement
a plaster, a dressing
Introduced in Chapter 243.

le pantalon
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le papier
paper
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le papillon
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 194.

le parapluie
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le parc
a park
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le parfum
perfume
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le parking
a car park
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le passeport
a passport
Introduced in Chapter 164.

le paysage
a landscape
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le péage
a toll
Introduced in Chapter 227.

le peigne
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le peintre
a painter
Introduced in Chapter 249.

le père
father — one of the oldest words anyone can reconstruct
Introduced in Chapter 12.

le permis de conduire
a driving licence
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le petit-déjeuner
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le petit-fils
a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le pharmacien
a pharmacist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le photographe
a photographer
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le piano
a piano
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le pied
a foot
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le pilote
a pilot
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le placard
a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le plafond
a ceiling
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le plastique
plastic
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le plombier
a plumber
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le poème
a poem
Introduced in Chapter 249.

le poignet
a wrist
Introduced in Chapter 52.

le poisson
fish
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le poivre
pepper
Introduced in Chapter 72.

le policier
a police officer
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le pompier
a firefighter
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le pont
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le portail
a gate
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le portefeuille
a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 117.

le potager
a vegetable garden
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le pouce
a thumb
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le poulet
chicken
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le poumon
a lung
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le pourboire
a tip
Introduced in Chapter 247.

le prêt
a loan
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le printemps
spring — literally "the first time"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

le prix
a price; a prize
Introduced in Chapter 129.

le problème
a problem
Introduced in Chapter 127.

le professeur
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 59.

le projet
a plan, a project
Introduced in Chapter 141.

le pyjama
pyjamas
Introduced in Chapter 221.

le quai
a platform
Introduced in Chapter 247.

le quartier
a district, a neighbourhood
Introduced in Chapter 103.

le raisin
grapes
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le recyclage
recycling
Introduced in Chapter 255.

le réfrigérateur
a fridge
Introduced in Chapter 111.

le régime
a diet
Introduced in Chapter 243.

le rein
a kidney
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le renard
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le repas
a meal
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le repos
rest
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le restaurant
a restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 101.

le résultat
a result
Introduced in Chapter 251.

le retour
the return
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le rêve
a dream
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le rhume
a cold
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le rideau
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 112.

le riz
rice
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le rocher
a rock
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le sable
sand
Introduced in Chapter 82.

le sac
a bag
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le sachet
a small bag
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le salaire
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le salon
a living room
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le sandwich
a sandwich
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le sang
blood
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le savon
soap
Introduced in Chapter 113.

le scientifique
a scientist
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le sel
salt — masculine, cousin of English salt by common descent, and the source of a salary story no ancient writer actually tells
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le sentier
a path
Introduced in Chapter 254.

le serpent
a snake
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le serveur
a waiter
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le shampooing
shampoo
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le siècle
a century
Introduced in Chapter 135.

le siège
a seat
Introduced in Chapter 199.

le singe
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le sirop
a syrup
Introduced in Chapter 215.

le sol
the floor, the ground
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le soldat
a soldier
Introduced in Chapter 165.

le soleil
the sun
Introduced in Chapter 83.

le sommeil
sleep
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le spectacle
a show
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le sport
sport
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le stade
a stadium
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le stylo
a pen
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le succès
success
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le sucre
sugar — masculine, closing a chapter where every drink-word is; the fourth and longest road of the four
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le sud
the south
Introduced in Chapter 109.

le supermarché
a supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le tableau
a board; a painting
Introduced in Chapter 126.

le tambour
a drum
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le tapis
a rug, a carpet
Introduced in Chapter 111.

le taxi
a taxi
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le téléphone
a phone
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le téléphone portable
a mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 204.

le temps, il pleut
weather — le temps means BOTH "time" and "weather," the SAME Latin tempus polysemy as Spanish's tiempo; il pleut keeps Latin's pl- UNCHANGED, unlike Spanish's llueve
Introduced in Chapter 25.

le thé
tea — masculine, and the drink whose name split in two depending which Chinese port a trader dealt with
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le théâtre
a theatre
Introduced in Chapter 102.

le tigre
a tiger
Introduced in Chapter 88.

le timbre
a stamp
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le tiroir
a drawer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le toit
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 74.

le tonnerre
thunder
Introduced in Chapter 229.

le touriste
a tourist
Introduced in Chapter 250.

le train
a train
Introduced in Chapter 99.

le tribunal
a court
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le tronc
a trunk
Introduced in Chapter 254.

le trottoir
a pavement
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le tunnel
a tunnel
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le vase
a vase
Introduced in Chapter 228.

le vélo
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le vendeur
a shop assistant
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le vent
the wind
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le ventre
stomach — masculine, nasal like la main but through a different vowel, and the word that closes four chapters of everyday nouns
Introduced in Chapter 35.

le verre
a glass
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le veuf
a widower
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le village
a village
Introduced in Chapter 101.

le vin
wine — the word that refused to wear down, in any language
Introduced in Chapter 13.

le vinaigre
vinegar
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le violon
a violin
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le visage
the face
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le voisin
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le volant
a steering wheel
Introduced in Chapter 199.

le volcan
a volcano
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le vote
a vote
Introduced in Chapter 248.

le voyage
a journey, a trip
Introduced in Chapter 110.

le yaourt
a yoghurt
Introduced in Chapter 71.

léger
light (not heavy)
Introduced in Chapter 93.

lequel / laquelle
which one
Introduced in Chapter 139.

les bagages
luggage
Introduced in Chapter 199.

les bottes
boots
Introduced in Chapter 117.

les chaussettes
socks
Introduced in Chapter 105.

les chaussures
shoes
Introduced in Chapter 104.

les ciseaux
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 221.

les déchets
rubbish
Introduced in Chapter 255.

les devoirs
homework
Introduced in Chapter 127.

les élections
elections
Introduced in Chapter 248.

les gants
gloves
Introduced in Chapter 116.

les haricots
beans
Introduced in Chapter 119.

les légumes
vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 119.

les lunettes
glasses
Introduced in Chapter 79.

les mathématiques
mathematics
Introduced in Chapter 257.

les pâtes
pasta
Introduced in Chapter 72.

les soldes
the sales
Introduced in Chapter 198.

les urgences
the emergency department
Introduced in Chapter 243.

les vacances
holidays
Introduced in Chapter 110.

les vêtements
clothes
Introduced in Chapter 103.

libre
free
Introduced in Chapter 131.

lire
to read — from a Latin verb that first meant "to gather," which is why reading, electing, collecting and being elegant all turn out to be the same act
Introduced in Chapter 29.

lisse
smooth
Introduced in Chapter 244.

livrer
to deliver
Introduced in Chapter 150.

loin
far
Introduced in Chapter 96.

loin de
far from
Introduced in Chapter 188.

lointain / lointaine
distant
Introduced in Chapter 192.

louer
to rent
Introduced in Chapter 235.

lourd
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 93.

lui et elle
him and her, standing alone — where elle is the same word twice and lui is not
Introduced in Chapter 43.

lundi
Monday — the Moon's day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

mai
May — the month of Maia, goddess of growth
Introduced in Chapter 9.

maigrir
to lose weight
Introduced in Chapter 242.

maintenant
now
Introduced in Chapter 96.

mais
but — Latin magis, more, which stayed more in Spanish and became but only here
Introduced in Chapter 40.

malade
ill, sick
Introduced in Chapter 54.

malgré
despite
Introduced in Chapter 189.

malheureusement
unfortunately
Introduced in Chapter 189.

manger
to eat
Introduced in Chapter 61.

manquer
to miss, to be missing
Introduced in Chapter 237.

marcher
to walk — and also to work, so ça marche is the most useful two words in the chapter; its own origin is genuinely unsettled between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer
Introduced in Chapter 30.

mardi
Tuesday — the day of Mars
Introduced in Chapter 7.

marié / mariée
married
Introduced in Chapter 162.

marron
brown (chestnut)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

mars
March — the war-god's month, and the old start of the year
Introduced in Chapter 9.

me
me / myself (reflexive and object pronoun)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

méchant
nasty, mean
Introduced in Chapter 133.

mélanger
to mix
Introduced in Chapter 240.

merci
thank you
Introduced in Chapter 3.

mercredi
Wednesday — the day of Mercury
Introduced in Chapter 7.

mériter
to deserve
Introduced in Chapter 237.

mesurer
to measure
Introduced in Chapter 234.

mettre
to put; to put on
Introduced in Chapter 137.

midi
noon — literally "the day's middle"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

mille
a thousand
Introduced in Chapter 136.

mince
thin, slim
Introduced in Chapter 93.

minuit
midnight — literally "the night's middle"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

moderne
modern
Introduced in Chapter 161.

moi et toi
me and you, standing alone — the heavy twins of je and tu, split by stress exactly as quoi split from que
Introduced in Chapter 43.

moins le quart
quarter to — literally "minus the quarter"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

Monsieur, Madame
sir and madam — my lord and my lady, worn down, and the two words French uses where English uses a surname
Introduced in Chapter 44.

montrer
to show
Introduced in Chapter 62.

mouillé
wet
Introduced in Chapter 95.

mourir
to die
Introduced in Chapter 207.

mûr / mûre
ripe
Introduced in Chapter 192.

n'importe quoi
anything at all
Introduced in Chapter 139.

naître
to be born
Introduced in Chapter 207.

nécessaire
necessary
Introduced in Chapter 191.

neiger
to snow
Introduced in Chapter 178.

nerveux / nerveuse
nervous
Introduced in Chapter 218.

nettoyer
to clean
Introduced in Chapter 63.

neuf
nine
Introduced in Chapter 6.

noir
black — the straightforward one, straight down from Latin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

non
no / not
Introduced in Chapter 22.

non plus
neither, not either
Introduced in Chapter 139.

nourrir
to feed
Introduced in Chapter 242.

nous avons
we have — and the ending is finally something you can hear
Introduced in Chapter 17.

nous sommes
we are — and the only plural that keeps the regular ending
Introduced in Chapter 19.

nouveau
new
Introduced in Chapter 89.

novembre
November — the month that still says “nine”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

nuit
night (la nuit — feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

obéir
to obey
Introduced in Chapter 240.

observer
to observe
Introduced in Chapter 148.

occupé
busy
Introduced in Chapter 131.

octobre
October — the month that still says “eight”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

offrir
to offer
Introduced in Chapter 237.

offrir un cadeau
to give a present
Introduced in Chapter 210.

on
one, people, and in practice we — a noun for man that turned into a pronoun
Introduced in Chapter 41.

onze
eleven — and not “ten-one”, which is the whole surprise
Introduced in Chapter 14.

organiser
to organise
Introduced in Chapter 141.

ou
or — the same three letters as the question word for where, kept apart by one accent
Introduced in Chapter 40.

où
where — and the accent that separates it from a completely different word
Introduced in Chapter 36.

oublier
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 63.

oui
yes
Introduced in Chapter 22.

ouvert
open
Introduced in Chapter 131.

ouvrir
to open — an -ir verb that takes -er endings, from a Latin verb reshaped to look like its own opposite, and the source of English overt and overture
Introduced in Chapter 31.

parce que
because — three words fused into two, par ce que, ’by this that’
Introduced in Chapter 40.

pareil / pareille
the same
Introduced in Chapter 219.

paresseux / paresseuse
lazy
Introduced in Chapter 246.

parfois
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 98.

parler
to speak / to talk (your first regular -er verb)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

partager
to share
Introduced in Chapter 179.

participer
to take part
Introduced in Chapter 148.

partir en vacances
to go on holiday
Introduced in Chapter 242.

partout
everywhere
Introduced in Chapter 216.

passé simple · Präteritum · passato remoto
three languages, one retreat — and it spread by contact, not coincidence
Introduced in Chapter 18.

patient / patiente
patient
Introduced in Chapter 220.

pauvre
poor
Introduced in Chapter 91.

payer
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 62.

peindre
to paint
Introduced in Chapter 66.

penser
to think — from a Latin verb meaning "to weigh," which is why English pensive, ponder, compensate, expense and even the flower pansy all sit in one family
Introduced in Chapter 29.

perdre
to lose
Introduced in Chapter 63.

permettre
to allow
Introduced in Chapter 177.

peser
to weigh
Introduced in Chapter 234.

peureux / peureuse
fearful
Introduced in Chapter 190.

photographier
to photograph
Introduced in Chapter 233.

plaisanter
to joke
Introduced in Chapter 242.

plein
full
Introduced in Chapter 90.

pleurer
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 60.

plier
to fold
Introduced in Chapter 148.

poli / polie
polite
Introduced in Chapter 159.

ponctuel / ponctuelle
punctual
Introduced in Chapter 220.

porter
to carry; to wear
Introduced in Chapter 65.

posséder
to own
Introduced in Chapter 148.

pourquoi
why — and the answer word that is built to match it
Introduced in Chapter 36.

poursuivre
to chase
Introduced in Chapter 212.

pourtant
however, yet
Introduced in Chapter 158.

pousser
to push
Introduced in Chapter 181.

pouvoir
can — the verb that turns a demand into a request
Introduced in Chapter 37.

préférer
to prefer
Introduced in Chapter 138.

prendre
to take — the grasping verb English borrowed a dozen times over, from prehensile to prison to surprise
Introduced in Chapter 28.

préparer
to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 180.

près
near
Introduced in Chapter 96.

près de
near to
Introduced in Chapter 188.

présenter
to introduce
Introduced in Chapter 180.

presque
almost
Introduced in Chapter 217.

prêt / prête
ready
Introduced in Chapter 245.

prêter
to lend
Introduced in Chapter 180.

prévenir
to warn
Introduced in Chapter 208.

prévoir
to foresee, to plan for
Introduced in Chapter 141.

prier
to pray
Introduced in Chapter 151.

prochain
next
Introduced in Chapter 132.

profiter
to enjoy, to make the most of
Introduced in Chapter 209.

profond / profonde
deep
Introduced in Chapter 160.

promettre
to promise
Introduced in Chapter 177.

proposer
to propose
Introduced in Chapter 180.

propre
clean
Introduced in Chapter 244.

protéger
to protect
Introduced in Chapter 177.

puis
then
Introduced in Chapter 96.

quand
when — and a silent d that comes back to life
Introduced in Chapter 36.

quarante
forty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

quatorze
fourteen — the longest of the welded teens, and the least worn
Introduced in Chapter 14.

quatre
four
Introduced in Chapter 6.

quatre-vingt-dix
ninety
Introduced in Chapter 136.

que
what — the partner of qui, and the one that always elides
Introduced in Chapter 43.

Quel âge as-tu ?
asking someone's age — a fixed phrase you can use whole
Introduced in Chapter 17.

qui
who — Latin quis, unchanged in twenty centuries, and the shortest question in French
Introduced in Chapter 43.

quinze
fifteen — and the fortnight the French count in
Introduced in Chapter 14.

quoi
what, standing on its own — the stressed twin of que, and the one that survives after a preposition
Introduced in Chapter 43.

ralentir
to slow down
Introduced in Chapter 151.

ramasser
to pick up
Introduced in Chapter 180.

ranger
to tidy up
Introduced in Chapter 242.

rapide
fast
Introduced in Chapter 89.

rarement
rarely
Introduced in Chapter 156.

réaliser
to achieve
Introduced in Chapter 210.

récemment
recently
Introduced in Chapter 140.

recevoir
to receive
Introduced in Chapter 65.

recommander
to recommend
Introduced in Chapter 151.

reconnaître
to recognise
Introduced in Chapter 210.

reculer
to move back
Introduced in Chapter 152.

réduire
to reduce
Introduced in Chapter 238.

refroidir
to cool down
Introduced in Chapter 206.

refuser
to refuse
Introduced in Chapter 238.

regarder
to look at, to watch
Introduced in Chapter 64.

remarquer
to notice
Introduced in Chapter 153.

remercier
to thank
Introduced in Chapter 175.

remplacer
to replace
Introduced in Chapter 153.

remplir
to fill
Introduced in Chapter 234.

remplir un formulaire
to fill in a form
Introduced in Chapter 145.

rencontrer
to meet
Introduced in Chapter 153.

rendre
to give back
Introduced in Chapter 210.

renoncer
to give up
Introduced in Chapter 183.

réparer
to repair
Introduced in Chapter 233.

repasser
to iron
Introduced in Chapter 233.

répéter
to repeat
Introduced in Chapter 233.

répondre
to answer
Introduced in Chapter 137.

réserver
to book
Introduced in Chapter 205.

résoudre
to solve
Introduced in Chapter 238.

respirer
to breathe
Introduced in Chapter 151.

ressembler
to look like
Introduced in Chapter 181.

revenir
to come back
Introduced in Chapter 62.

rêver
to dream
Introduced in Chapter 149.

riche
rich
Introduced in Chapter 91.

rien
nothing
Introduced in Chapter 139.

rire
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 59.

risquer
to risk
Introduced in Chapter 238.

rond
round
Introduced in Chapter 94.

rose
pink
Introduced in Chapter 130.

rouge
red — and English red is not a lookalike but an actual cousin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

rougir
to blush
Introduced in Chapter 153.

rugueux / rugueuse
rough
Introduced in Chapter 244.

s'amuser
to have fun
Introduced in Chapter 146.

s'approcher
to come near
Introduced in Chapter 150.

s'asseoir
to sit down — a verb you do to yourself, from Latin sedēre, and the one French verb that ships with two accepted sets of forms
Introduced in Chapter 31.

s'éloigner
to move away
Introduced in Chapter 150.

s'ennuyer
to be bored
Introduced in Chapter 146.

s'habiller
to get dressed
Introduced in Chapter 138.

s'habituer
to get used to
Introduced in Chapter 239.

s'il vous plaît
please (literally "if it pleases you")
Introduced in Chapter 23.

s'inquiéter
to worry
Introduced in Chapter 146.

saigner
to bleed
Introduced in Chapter 153.

sale
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 92.

salé
salty
Introduced in Chapter 94.

saluer
to greet
Introduced in Chapter 175.

salut
hi / bye (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

samedi
Saturday — the Sabbath day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

sauter
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 143.

sauver
to rescue
Introduced in Chapter 177.

savoir
to know (a fact)
Introduced in Chapter 64.

se coiffer
to do one's hair
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se dépêcher
to hurry
Introduced in Chapter 239.

se disputer
to quarrel
Introduced in Chapter 145.

se fâcher
to get angry
Introduced in Chapter 146.

se lever, debout
to stand — French has no single verb for it, so the movement is se lever ("to lighten yourself") and the state is être debout, literally "on end"
Introduced in Chapter 31.

se plaindre
to complain
Introduced in Chapter 209.

se produire
to happen, to occur
Introduced in Chapter 140.

se promener
to go for a walk
Introduced in Chapter 148.

se rendre compte
to realise
Introduced in Chapter 239.

se reposer
to rest
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se réveiller
to wake up
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se taire
to be silent
Introduced in Chapter 211.

sec
dry
Introduced in Chapter 94.

sécher
to dry
Introduced in Chapter 205.

seize
sixteen — the last word French inherited already welded
Introduced in Chapter 14.

semblable
similar
Introduced in Chapter 245.

sembler
to seem
Introduced in Chapter 149.

sentir
to feel; to smell
Introduced in Chapter 65.

sept
seven
Introduced in Chapter 6.

septembre
September — the month that still says “seven”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

sérieux / sérieuse
serious
Introduced in Chapter 190.

serrer
to squeeze
Introduced in Chapter 213.

servir
to serve
Introduced in Chapter 149.

seulement
only
Introduced in Chapter 217.

signer
to sign
Introduced in Chapter 145.

silencieux / silencieuse
silent
Introduced in Chapter 244.

simple
simple
Introduced in Chapter 191.

six
six
Introduced in Chapter 6.

skier
to ski
Introduced in Chapter 183.

soir
evening (le soir — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

soixante
sixty
Introduced in Chapter 136.

soixante-dix
seventy
Introduced in Chapter 136.

sombre
dark
Introduced in Chapter 192.

soudain
suddenly
Introduced in Chapter 187.

souffrir
to suffer
Introduced in Chapter 149.

soulever
to lift
Introduced in Chapter 213.

soupçonner
to suspect
Introduced in Chapter 213.

sourire
to smile
Introduced in Chapter 143.

souvent
often
Introduced in Chapter 98.

sucré
sweet (with sugar)
Introduced in Chapter 93.

suffire
to be enough
Introduced in Chapter 236.

suggérer
to suggest
Introduced in Chapter 213.

sûr / sûre
safe, sure
Introduced in Chapter 160.

surprendre
to surprise
Introduced in Chapter 213.

sympathique
nice, friendly
Introduced in Chapter 133.

tard
late
Introduced in Chapter 187.

télécharger
to download
Introduced in Chapter 183.

téléphoner
to phone
Introduced in Chapter 145.

tenir
to hold
Introduced in Chapter 176.

tenter
to attempt
Introduced in Chapter 211.

timide
shy
Introduced in Chapter 190.

tirer
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 181.

toucher
to touch
Introduced in Chapter 206.

toujours
always; still
Introduced in Chapter 95.

tourner
to turn
Introduced in Chapter 179.

tousser
to cough
Introduced in Chapter 241.

traduire
to translate
Introduced in Chapter 144.

tranquille
quiet, peaceful
Introduced in Chapter 218.

transporter
to transport
Introduced in Chapter 211.

travailler
to work (a third -er verb — and the origin of “travel”)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

travailleur / travailleuse
hard-working
Introduced in Chapter 246.

traverser
to cross
Introduced in Chapter 208.

treize
thirteen — three-ten, with both halves now legible
Introduced in Chapter 14.

trembler
to tremble
Introduced in Chapter 241.

trente
thirty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

très
very — Latin trans, 'across', which crossed over into an intensifier and takes no de at all
Introduced in Chapter 44.

triste
sad
Introduced in Chapter 56.

trois
three
Introduced in Chapter 6.

trouver
to find
Introduced in Chapter 67.

tu / vous
you (familiar / formal)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

tu as
you have — the informal one, and it sounds exactly like the last one
Introduced in Chapter 17.

tu es
you are — two letters, and it sounds like a single vowel
Introduced in Chapter 19.

tuer
to kill
Introduced in Chapter 211.

un
one — and, at the same time, "a/an"
Introduced in Chapter 6.

un an, des ans
a year — and the annual, the anniversary and the annals inside it
Introduced in Chapter 17.

un peu
a little — the opposite end of the same scale, and the same bare de after it
Introduced in Chapter 44.

unir
to unite
Introduced in Chapter 239.

utile
useful
Introduced in Chapter 191.

utiliser
to use
Introduced in Chapter 62.

valoir
to be worth
Introduced in Chapter 239.

vendredi
Friday — the day of Venus
Introduced in Chapter 7.

vérifier
to check
Introduced in Chapter 234.

vert, jaune
green and yellow — vert is the standard, expected Latin viridis descendant shared by nearly every Romance language; jaune comes from a Latin word that literally meant "yellow-GREEN," and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with German's gelb, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears
Introduced in Chapter 27.

vide
empty
Introduced in Chapter 90.

vider
to empty
Introduced in Chapter 234.

vieillir
to grow old
Introduced in Chapter 207.

vieux
old
Introduced in Chapter 89.

vingt
twenty — a single inherited word again, and the base French will later count in
Introduced in Chapter 15.

violet
purple
Introduced in Chapter 130.

visiter
to visit (a place)
Introduced in Chapter 137.

vivre
to live
Introduced in Chapter 61.

voici
here is — a frozen command, see here, and the word that lets you introduce somebody who is not you
Introduced in Chapter 38.

voler
to fly, to steal
Introduced in Chapter 238.

voter
to vote
Introduced in Chapter 241.

vouloir
to want — and why je voudrais is the form you will actually use
Introduced in Chapter 37.

vous avez
you have — plural, and polite to one person
Introduced in Chapter 17.

vous êtes
you are — and the circumflex marks the s that used to be there
Introduced in Chapter 19.

vraiment
really
Introduced in Chapter 189.

zéro
zero
Introduced in Chapter 136.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 salut — *let your eye and hand meet one known word*
Which written letter stays silent at the end of salut?

1.2 salut — *one supported copy*
Copy the visible word salut once, then report how many letters you wrote.

1.3 salut — *look, hide, write, compare*
After hiding the model for five seconds, write the casual greeting and then compare it.

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
From the heard cue sa-LU alone, write the known casual greeting.

Chapter 22

22.1 *(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si*
French has two words for yes. Which one contradicts a negative?

Chapter 45

45.1 *(reading) — six things you would be told*
Which line tells you to listen?

45.2 *(reading) — six lines off a form*
How old is she?

45.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Where does she live?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 salut — *let your eye and hand meet one known word*
Answer: t
Also accepted: the final t; final t

1.2 salut — *one supported copy*
Answer: salut — five letters
Also accepted: salut; 5; five

1.3 salut — *look, hide, write, compare*
Answer: salut

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
Answer: salut

Chapter 22

22.1 *(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si*
Answer: si
Also accepted: si!

Chapter 45

45.1 *(reading) — six things you would be told*
Answer: ecoute
Also accepted: Écoute; Écoute !; listen

45.2 *(reading) — six lines off a form*
Answer: twenty
Also accepted: vingt; vingt ans; 20

45.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: paris
Also accepted: à Paris

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

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a bakery *la boulangerie*
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a balcony *le balcon*
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a ball *le ballon*
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explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1543
a mobile phone *le téléphone portable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1375
a monkey *le singe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 663
a month *le mois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
a monument *le monument*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1171
a mosquito *le moustique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1315
a mother-in-law *la belle-mère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1153
a motorbike *la moto*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1633
a motorway *l'autoroute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1513
a mountain *la montagne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a mouse *la souris*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a muscle *le muscle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1261
a museum *le musée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 741
a mushroom *le champignon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
a nail (finger or toe) *l'ongle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
a nail for hammering *le clou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1531
a necklace *le collier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
a needle *l'aiguille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1531
a neighbour *le voisin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 487
a nephew *le neveu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493

a niece *la nièce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a notebook *le cahier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a notice, an opinion *l'avis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
a number (on a door, a phone) *le numéro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
a nurse *l'infirmière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a painter *le peintre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1645
a parcel *le colis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1663
a park *le parc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 741
a passport *le passeport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1135
a path *le sentier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1675
a pavement *le trottoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
a pay slip *la fiche de paie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1165
a peach *la pêche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1477
a pear *la poire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
a pebble *le caillou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1177
a pen *le stylo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a pencil *le crayon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a pharmacist *le pharmacien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1147
a pharmacy *la pharmacie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
a phone *le téléphone*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
a photo *la photo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a photographer *le photographe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1147

a piano *le piano*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1687
a piece of news *la nouvelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1321
a pig *le cochon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a pillow *l'oreiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a pilot *le pilote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1495
a plain *la plaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1177
a plan, a project *le projet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
a plant *la plante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1519
a plaster, a dressing *le pansement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1609
a plate *l'assiette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 595
a platform *le quai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1633
a player *le joueur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1369
a plumber *le plombier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1327
a pocket *la poche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
a poem *le poème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1645
a police officer *le policier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a possibility *la possibilité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1501
a postcard *la carte postale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1165
a postman, a postwoman *le facteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a potato *la pomme de terre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
a prescription *l'ordonnance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1441
a present, a gift *le cadeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615

a price; a prize *le prix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
a printer *l'imprimante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1375
a problem *le problème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
a promise *la promesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1339
a pupil *l'élève*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a rabbit *le lapin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
a racket *la raquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1189
a radio *la radio*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a reason *la raison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1501
a red light *le feu rouge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
a researcher *le chercheur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1495
a restaurant *le restaurant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
a result *le résultat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1657
a ring *la bague*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
a river *la rivière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a rock *le rocher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1177
a roof *le toit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 583
a root *la racine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1519
a rope *la corde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1363
a rubber, an eraser *la gomme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
a rug, a carpet *le tapis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a rule *la règle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1159

a salad; lettuce *la salade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
a salary *le salaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1195
a sandwich *le sandwich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
a sauce *la sauce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
a saucepan *la casserole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1309
a scar *la cicatrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1261
a scarf *l'écharpe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
a school *l'école*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a scientist *le scientifique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1495
a screen *l'écran*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1321
a seat *le siège*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1345
a second *la seconde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957
a seed *la graine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1519
a sheep *le mouton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 663
a sheet *le drap*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1309
a sheet of paper *la feuille de papier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1375
a shelf *l'étagère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a shirt *la chemise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
a shop *le magasin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a shop assistant *le vendeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a shoulder *l'épaule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
a show *le spectacle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1489

a shower *la douche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a singer *le chanteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1489
a skirt *la jupe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
a small bag *le sachet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1363
a snake *le serpent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 657
a sofa *le canapé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
a soldier *le soldat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1141
a son-in-law *le gendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1153
a song *la chanson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
a soup *la soupe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
a spoon *la cuillère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 601
a stadium *le stade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a stamp *le timbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1663
a star *l'étoile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
a statue *la statue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1171
a steering wheel *le volant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1345
a stone *la pierre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
a stop *l'arrêt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1633
a storm *l'orage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
a strawberry *la fraise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
a street *la rue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
a student *l'étudiant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 889

a suitcase *la valise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a supermarket *le supermarché*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a swimming pool *la piscine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a swimsuit; a sports shirt *le maillot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
a syrup *le sirop*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1441
a tablet (medicine) *le comprimé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1441
a tax *l'impôt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1663
a taxi *le taxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 779
a teacher *le professeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a team *l'équipe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1693
a television *la télévision*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a theatre *le théâtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
a thorn *l'épine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1675
a thousand *mille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
a thread, a wire *le fil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1531
a thumb *le pouce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1261
a ticket; a banknote *le billet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a tie *la cravate*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
a tiger *le tigre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
a till, a checkout *la caisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a time, an occasion *la fois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
a tip *le pourboire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1633

a toll *le péage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1513
a tomato *la tomate*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
a tool *l'outil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1687
a tooth *la dent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 433
a toothbrush *la brosse à dents*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a tortoise *la tortue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
a tourist *le touriste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1651
a towel; a napkin *la serviette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a tower *la tour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1171
a town, a city *la ville*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
a tradition *la tradition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1141
a train *le train*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a tree *l'arbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a trunk *le tronc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1675
a tunnel *le tunnel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1669
a twin *le jumeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1651
a university *l'université*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1543
a vacuum cleaner *l'aspirateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
a valley *la vallée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1315
a vase *le vase*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1519
a vegetable garden *le potager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1351
a victory *la victoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1189

a village *le village*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
a violin *le violon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1687
a volcano *le volcan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1177
a vote *le vote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1639
a waiter *le serveur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a wall *le mur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 577
a wallet *le portefeuille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
a walnut, a nut *la noix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
a wardrobe *l'armoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a watch *la montre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1477
a waterfall *la cascade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1177
a wave *la vague*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
a week *la semaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
a wheel *la roue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1513
a widower *le veuf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1333
a window *la fenêtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 577
a wolf *le loup*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a woman; a wife *la femme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
a word *le mot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 901
a worker *l'ouvrier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1327
a wound *la blessure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1261
a wrist *le poignet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451

a writer *l'écrivain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1645
a year — and the annual, the anniversary and the annals inside it *un an, des ans*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
a yoghurt *le yaourt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
about, approximately *environ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1453
above *au-dessus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1093
Actor, Actress, Poem, Writer, Painter
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1645
advertising *la publicité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1321
advice *le conseil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1159
afterwards, next *ensuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
ai · as · a — three spellings, one ear
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 195
aller · venir · naître · mourir — the shape of the list
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
almost *presque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1453
Almost, About, Only, Together, Nevertheless
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1453
already *déjà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 989
although *bien que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
always; still *toujours*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
an accountant *le comptable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1495
an actor *l'acteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1645
an actress *l'actrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1645

an address *l'adresse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
an adult *l'adulte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1651
an advert, an announcement *l'annonce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
an aeroplane *l'avion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
an airport *l'aéroport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
an ankle *la cheville*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
an answer *la réponse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
an ant *la fourmi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
an apple *la pomme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
an architect *l'architecte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1147
an arm *le bras*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 433
an armchair *le fauteuil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1309
an army *l'armée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1141
an attic *le grenier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1351
an aunt *la tante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
an ear *l'oreille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
an elbow *le coude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
an elderly person *la personne âgée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1651
an electrician *l'électricien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1327
an elephant *l'éléphant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
an email *le courriel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957
an emergency *l'urgence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1609

an employee *l'employé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1495
an engine *le moteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1513
an engineer *l'ingénieur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 889
an entrance *l'entrée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1345
an envelope *l'enveloppe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1663
an exam *l'examen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 901
an example *l'exemple*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1657
an exit *la sortie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1345
an idea *l'idée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
an illness *la maladie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
an interview *l'entretien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1375
an island *l'île*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
an office; a desk *le bureau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
an ointment *la pommade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1441
an onion *l'oignon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
an orange *l'orange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
an umbrella *le parapluie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
an uncle *l'oncle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
and — Latin et unchanged, and a t that never joins to the next word *et*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
anger *la colère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
angry *fâché / fâchée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1627
Ant, Elephant, Rabbit, Frog, Tiger
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 669

anxiety *l'angoisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
anything at all *n'importe quoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
anyway *de toute façon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
April — perhaps the opening month *avril*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113
Arm, Leg, Foot, Finger, Tooth
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 433
around *autour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1447
Around, Everywhere, Elsewhere, Up there, Suburbs
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1447
arrival *l'arrivée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1537
art *l'art*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1693
Asking a Question — Three Ways, and Which One to Use
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 349
asking someone's age — a fixed phrase you can use whole *Quel âge as-tu ?*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 17, p. 195
at the bottom, at the back *au fond*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1279
-ātum · -ītum · -ūtum — where the endings came from
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 213
au, aux — where *à* and *le* melt together
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
au printemps, en été — saying you are *in* a season
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 11, p. 133
August — the month renamed for the emperor Augustus *août*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 123
autumn — the season English borrowed whole *l'automne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133

B

Baker, Student, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 889
Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1189
Banana, Orange, Potato, Tomato, Onion
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 547

Bank card, Cash machine, Bank account, Loan, Debt
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1507
Battery, Charger, Singer, Concert, Show
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1489
beans *les haricots*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Bear, Fox, Snake, Hen, Duck
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 657
because — three words fused into two, par ce que, 'by this that' *parce que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
beef; an ox *le bœuf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom, Beans, Cucumber
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 859
beer *la bière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
Beer, Juice, Ice cream, Chocolate, Biscuit
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 871
behind *derrière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
below *au-dessous*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
beside *à côté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
Bicycle, Underground, Taxi, Car park, Lift
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 779
big, fat *gros*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
Bill, Tip, Stop, Motorbike, Platform
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1633
bitter *amer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
black — the straightforward one, straight down from Latin *noir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
blood *le sang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
blue — a Germanic word that went to France, changed clothes, and came back *bleu*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
boots *les bottes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
Boots, Cap, Swimsuit, Size, Wallet
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 847

Border, North, South, West, Letterbox
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 797
boring *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1465
Boring, Fun, Strange, Different, Same
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1465
Box, Suitcase, Ticket, Map, Photo
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 621
brave *courageux / courageuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1291
bread — and the companion who is, literally, someone you share it with *le pain*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153
Bread, Water, Wine
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 153
breakfast *le petit-déjeuner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1333
brother — and the friar who is one *le frère*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
brown (chestnut) *marron*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
brown (of hair, skin) *brun*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
busy *occupé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
Busy, Free, Open, Closed, Calm
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 933
but — Latin magis, more, which stayed more in Spanish and became but only here *mais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1327
butter — masculine, and the same borrowed word as English butter, not two separate coinages *le beurre*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 34, p. 335

C

ç — the little tail that softens *c*
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 45
calm, quiet *calme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933

can — the verb that turns a demand into a request *pouvoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
Car, Bridge, Park, Church, Museum
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 741
Carrot, Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 553
Castle, Tower, Monument, Statue, Fountain
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1171
ce, cet, cette, ces — pointing at a noun
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
certainly *certainement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1285
change (coins); currency *la monnaie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957
cheerful *joyeux / joyeuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1291
Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1291
Cheese, Butter, Salt, Egg
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 335
cheese — masculine, and named for its MOULD rather than for the milk it's made from *le fromage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
Chest, Stomach, Ankle, Elbow, Wrist
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 451
chicken *le poulet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
(chien, chat, continued) — chat
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 279
child — one spelling for both genders, the article alone showing which; literally "not yet speaking" *l'enfant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
chocolate *le chocolat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
Class, Lesson, Exam, Word, Board
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 901
clean *propre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1615
Clean, Cut, Forget, Look for, Lose
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 517
clear, light (of a colour) *clair / claire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1303
closed *fermé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933

clothes *les vêtements*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
coffee — masculine, and the one drink-word nearly all of Europe borrowed along the same single road *le café*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
Coffee, Tea, Milk, Sugar
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 323
Colours
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 183
Come back, Study, Pay, Use, Show
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 511
comfortable *confortable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
Comfortable, Uncomfortable, Polite, Rude, Unpleasant
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1105
Comment vas-tu ? / Comment allez-vous ?
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 3, p. 33
Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1195
complicated *compliqué / compliquée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1297
cooked *cuit / cuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1303
Cooked, Ripe, Dark, Clear, Distant
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1303
cotton *le coton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1183
courage *le courage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1267
Cow, Pig, Bird, Mouse, Wolf
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 651
cream *la crème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
Cry, Wash, Cook, Play, Learn
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 499
Cupboard, Ceiling, Corridor, Glass, Plate
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 595
curious *curieux / curieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1459
Curious, Jealous, Proud, Nervous, Quiet
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1459
customs *la douane*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1135

D

dangerous *dangereux / dangereuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
dark *sombre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1303
day (le jour — masculine) *jour*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
de la — the half of the partitive that was missing
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
dear; expensive *cher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
December — the month that still says "ten" *décembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
deep *profond / profonde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
Deep, Low, Unknown, Dangerous, Safe
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1111
Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1369
departure *le départ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1537
des — the plural of *un*, and the last shape of *some*
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
despite *malgré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1285
Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1285
Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1321
different *différent / différente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1465
difficult *difficile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
Difficult, Dear, High, Full, Empty
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 681
dinner *le dîner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
dirty *sale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
distant *lointain / lointaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1303
District, Airport, Clothes, Shirt, Dress
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 759

divorced *divorcé / divorcée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1123
Dog and Cat
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 279
dog and cat — chien is the REGULAR, expected descendant of canis (unlike Spanish's mysterious perro); chat continues cattus, the same Egypt-to-Rome story as Spanish's gato *chien, chat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 279
Draw, Paint, Count, Win, Hide
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 535
Drawing, Life, Time, Colour, Price
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 921
Driving licence, Helmet, Tunnel, Building site, Block of flats
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1669
dry *sec*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
du pain, de l'eau — asking for *some*
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 13, p. 153
dust *la poussière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1357

E

é è ê — the three hats on *e*, and the one that hides an *s*
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
earth, land *la terre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1357
Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1357
easy *facile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
egg — masculine, a genuine cousin of English egg, and the one French noun whose final consonant vanishes only in the plural *l'œuf, les œufs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
eight *huit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
eighteen — free, once you have the rule *dix-huit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
elections *les élections*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1639
electricity *l'électricité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1681

eleven — and not "ten-one", which is the whole surprise *onze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
elle est allée — the participle agrees
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elle s'est lavée — the auxiliary lies about the rule
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elles se sont souvenues — the verbs with no other form
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elsewhere *ailleurs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1447
Employee, Pilot, Accountant, Scientist, Researcher
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1495
empty *vide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
energy *l'énergie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1681
enough, and rather — one word doing both jobs, and it takes de before a noun and nothing before an adjective *assez*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
Entrance, Exit, Luggage, Seat, Steering wheel
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1345
esse — the first stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
est-ce que — the phrase that announces a question before it starts
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
été — the third stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
evening (le soir — masculine) *soir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
everywhere *partout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1447
experience *l'expérience*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1501
Experience, Choice, Decision, Possibility, Reason
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1501
eye — masculine, with a plural that looks irregular but is the REGULAR outcome of Latin oculos; œil's own singular is the piece that changed *l'œil, les yeux*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 35, p. 341
Eyes, Nose, Mouth, Stomach
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 341

F

failure *l'échec*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1333
fair, right *juste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1621
false, wrong *faux / fausse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1621
Family, and the Oldest Words We Have
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 141
family — feminine and fixed, whoever is in it, and once meant the household's servants *la famille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
famous *célèbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
far *loin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
far from *loin de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1279
Farewells
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 45
fast *rapide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
father — one of the oldest words anyone can reconstruct *le père*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
fear *la peur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
fearful *peureux / peureuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1291
February — the month of the purification festival *février*
explicit focus: pronunciation, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 113
fifteen — and the fortnight the French count in *quinze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
fifty *cinquante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
finally *enfin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
Find, Fish, Chicken, Fruit, Apple
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 541
fini · vendu — the other two classes
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
fire *le feu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
Firefighter, Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 895

fish *le poisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
five *cinq*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Five Ways to Point
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 367
Flat, Dining room, Balcony, Lock, Doorbell
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1129
Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Living room, Sofa
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 589
flour *la farine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
flu *la grippe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1441
Flu, Prescription, Tablet, Syrup, Ointment
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1441
fog *le brouillard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
foreign *étranger / étrangère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1471
Foreigner, Tourist, Adult, Elderly person, Twin
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1651
former, ancient *ancien / ancienne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1117
formerly, in the old days *autrefois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
forty *quarante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
four *quatre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Four lines, and the joiner that moves nothing
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 48, p. 431
fourteen — the longest of the welded teens, and the least worn *quatorze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
free *libre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
free of charge *gratuit / gratuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1621
fresh, cool *frais / fraîche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1117
Friday — the day of Venus *vendredi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89

friend — masculine or feminine by a regular swap, and the reason le/la elides to l' before a vowel *l'ami, l'amie*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
friendly *aimable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1471
friendship *l'amitié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1267
Friendship, Hope, Trust, Courage, Shame
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1267
from now on *désormais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
full *plein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
fun, amusing *amusant / amusante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1465
funny *drôle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939

G

garlic *l'ail*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
gas *le gaz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1681
Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 1351
generous *généreux / généreuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1627
Generous, Lazy, Hard-working, Talkative, Angry
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1627
geography *la géographie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1693
Geography, Mathematics, Art, Team, Birthday
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 1693
glasses *les lunettes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
gloves *les gants*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
good (adjective) *bon / bonne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
good evening *bonsoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
good night (going to bed) *bonne nuit*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

goodbye (literally "until the seeing-again") *au revoir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
grapes *le raisin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
grass *l'herbe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 951
Green and Yellow
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 283
green and yellow — vert is the standard, expected Latin viridis descendant shared by nearly every Romance language; jaune comes from a Latin word that literally meant "yellow-GREEN," and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with German's gelb, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears *vert, jaune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 283
Greetings
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
grey *gris*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687

H

habeō litterās scriptās — the buried possessive
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
habēre — the root you already met
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
half past — literally "and a half" *et demie*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
ham *le jambon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
happy *heureux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
hard *dur / dure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1615
hard-working *travailleur / travailleuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1627
he has, she has — the verb worn down to a single letter *il a, elle a*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
he is, she is — the most frequently said word in the language *il est, elle est*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229

Head and Hand
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 259
health *la santé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1075
Hearing, Sleeping, Walking, Running
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 303
heat *la chaleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
heavy *lourd*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
hello / good day *bonjour*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
here is — a frozen command, see here, and the word that lets you introduce somebody who is not you *voici*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
here, there, over there — three distances, and the same ci and la already frozen inside voici and voila *ici, là, là-bas*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
hi / bye (informal) *salut*
explicit focus: pronunciation, writing, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
high, tall *haut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
him and her, standing alone — where elle is the same word twice and lui is not *lui et elle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
history, a story *l'histoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1543
holidays *les vacances*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
homework *les devoirs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
honest *honnête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1471
honey *le miel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
hope *l'espoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1267
Hospital, Illness, Thirst, Tiredness, Ill
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 463
hour (feminine) *heure*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
how *comment*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21

how — a word you have been using since your first lesson *comment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 33
how are you? — the neutral everyday question *comment ça va ?*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
how much and how many — one word where English needs two *combien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
How Much, and What to Call People
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 415
however, yet *pourtant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
Husband, Woman, Uncle, Aunt, Cousin
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 481

I

I *je*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
I am — from Latin sum, and one of the oldest word-shapes in Europe *je suis*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
ï ë ü — the two dots that say "say me on my own"
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 4, p. 45
I have — one syllable, one vowel, and all that is left of Latin habeō *j'ai*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
I'm sorry (literally "I am desolate") *je suis désolé(e)*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 24, p. 271
"I speak French" — your first full sentence (français = French) *Je parle français*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
ice cream; ice; a mirror *la glace*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
il parla · habló · falou — the same tense, four fates
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 213
il parla — the past you read but never say
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
ill, sick *malade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463

in front *devant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1273
in that case, so *alors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1273
inside *dedans*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1375
Introducing Yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 21
iron; an iron (for clothes) *le fer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
"it is ... o'clock" — the frame that tells the time *il est, … heures*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101

J

j'ai couru — not every motion verb qualifies
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
j'ai parlé — the past built from "have"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
j'ai vingt ans — having your years
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 195
Jacket, Tie, Belt, Gloves, Scarf
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 839
jam *la confiture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
January — the month of Janus, god of doorways *janvier*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113
je fus — the second stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
je me suis levé — the pronominal family
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
je sais pas — the *ne* that speech leaves out
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
je suis allé — the past built from "be"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
je suis monté / j'ai monté les valises
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
je vais partir — the future made out of "go"
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391

jealous *jaloux / jalouse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1459
Jewel, Ring, Necklace, Perfume, Letter
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 853
joy *la joie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Happy
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 469
juice *le jus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
July — the month renamed for Julius Caesar *juillet*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
June — the month of Juno, queen of the gods *juin*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113

K

kind, nice *gentil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
Kitchen, Window, Chair, Key, Wall
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 577

L

l'aube — the white that stopped being a colour
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
la consonne finale — the rule under half this book
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
(la main, continued) — French kept it too
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 259
(la tête, continued) — The circumflex is a receipt
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 21, p. 259
last *dernier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
late *tard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1273
laundry, linen *le linge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
lazy *paresseux / paresseuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1627
le pluriel en -s — written, and never heard
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399

(le temps, il pleut, continued) — il pleut
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 275
le vin rouge — where the colour goes
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 16, p. 183
leather *le cuir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1183
Leave, Carry, Send, Receive, Feel
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 529
Lemon, Grapes, Jam, Yoghurt, Ham
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 565
les bateaux — the plural that is not irregular
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
les lettres que j'ai écrites — the fossil
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
life *la vie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
light (not heavy) *léger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
lightning *l'éclair*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1525
Lightning, Thunder, Climate, Environment, Pollution
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1525
Look at, Listen to, Wait for, Buy, Know
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 523
love *l'amour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
low *bas / basse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
luckily *heureusement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1285
luggage *les bagages*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1345
lunch *le déjeuner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
Lunch, Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 559

M

Magazine, Dictionary, University, Mistake, History
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1543
March — the war-god's month, and the old start of the year *mars*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 113

married *marié / mariée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1123
mathematics *les mathématiques*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1693
May — the month of Maia, goddess of growth *mai*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113
Mayor, Elections, Vote, Politics, Economy
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1639
me and you, standing alone — the heavy twins of je and tu, split by stress exactly as quoi split from que *moi et toi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
me / myself (reflexive and object pronoun) *me*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
metal *le métal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1363
midnight — literally "the night's middle" *minuit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
milk — masculine, and the one drink in this chapter French did not have to borrow *le lait*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
modern *moderne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1117
Modern, Former, Fresh, Spicy, Raw
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1117
Monday — the Moon's day *lundi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
money; silver *l'argent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
mother — and the reason English calls physical stuff "matter" *la mère*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
Mother-in-law, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law, Fiancé, Fiancée
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1153
mouth — feminine, and originally the Latin word for cheek, not mouth at all *la bouche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
mud *la boue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1357
Muscle, Thumb, Wound, Scar, Cold
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1261
music *la musique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
Music, Sport, Game, Film, Song
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 915

must — the third of the set, and the one with a debt inside it *devoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
my name is... (literally "I call myself") *je m'appelle…*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 2, p. 21

N

narrow *étroit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
nasty, mean *méchant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
natural rubber *le caoutchouc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1363
Natural rubber, Metal, Brick, Small bag, Rope
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1363
near *près*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
near to *près de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1279
Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1279
necessary *nécessaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1297
Neck, Shoulder, Knee, Face, Blood
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 439
Neighbour, Guest, Baby, Grandson, Granddaughter
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 487
neither, not either *non plus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
Nephew, Niece, Pupil, Teacher, Laugh
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 493
nervous *nerveux / nerveuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1459
never; ever *jamais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
Never, Now, Then, Far, Near
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 717
nevertheless, however *cependant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1453
new *nouveau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
next *prochain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939

nice, friendly *sympathique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
Nice, Nasty, Heat, Storm, Fog
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 945
night (la nuit — feminine) *nuit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
nine *neuf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
nineteen — the last number before the system changes again *dix-neuf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
ninety *quatre-vingt-dix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
no / not *non*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 22, p. 265
noisy *bruyant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
Noisy, Last, Next, Famous, Funny
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 939
none, not a single *aucun / aucune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
noon — literally "the day's middle" *midi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 8, p. 101
nose — masculine, a silent final z, and another genuine cousin of its English counterpart *le nez*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
nothing *rien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 983
November — the month that still says "nine" *novembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
now *maintenant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
Numbers One to Ten
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 73
Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 883

O

October — the month that still says "eight" *octobre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123

of, from — the word already inside du, and the one that does what English does with an apostrophe *de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
Office, Factory, Pavement, Crossroads, Red light
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 791
often *souvent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
oil *l'huile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
old *vieux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
on the contrary *au contraire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
on the left *à gauche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1279
on the right *à droite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1279
on top *dessus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
On top, Underneath, Inside, Outside, Today
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 723
one — and, at the same time, "a/an" *un*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
One heard greeting — write what you know
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
one, people, and in practice we — a noun for man that turned into a pronoun *on*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
only *seulement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1453
open *ouvert*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1001
opening hours, a timetable *l'horaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
or — the same three letters as the question word for where, kept apart by one accent *ou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 265
outside *dehors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723

P

pain *la douleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 457
Pain, Fever, Cough, Medicine, Doctor
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 457
paper *le papier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
Parle ! — the command, and the pronoun that goes missing
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
parlé — the past participle
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
parler · parlé · parlez — one sound, three jobs
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
parlez-vous — the third way to ask
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
pas de pain — where the partitive collapses
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
Passport, Customs, Booking, Butcher's, Large river
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1135
pasta *les pâtes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
patient *patient / patiente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1471
peace *la paix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1141
Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil, Bag
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 609
pepper *le poivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
père / father — one sound-law
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 12, p. 141
perfume *le parfum*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
permission *la permission*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1159
person — feminine no matter who is meant, even a man, and secretly "nobody" when it stands next to ne *la personne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
petit, petite — the ending that wakes the letter before it
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
Phone, Umbrella, Money, Present, Glasses
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 615
Photographer, Journalist, Architect, Dentist, Pharmacist
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1147

Pillow, Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 821
pink *rose*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
Pink, Purple, Brown (chestnut), Brown (of hair, Pretty
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 927
Plaster, Emergency department, Emergency, Medical appointment, Diet
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1609
plastic *le plastique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1183
Plastic, Cotton, Wool, Silk, Leather
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1183
Please
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 269
please (literally "if it pleases you") *s'il vous plaît*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 269
pleased, glad *content*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 475
pleased to meet you (literally "enchanted") *enchanté(e)*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
Police, Theatre, Library, Bakery, Town hall
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 753
polite *poli / polie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
politics *la politique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1639
pollution *la pollution*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1525
poor *pauvre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Postcard, Folder, Pay slip, Label, Guide
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1165
pretty *joli*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
Promise, Discount, Sales, Coin, Banknote
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1339
proud *fier / fière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1459
punctual *ponctuel / ponctuelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1471
Punctual, Foreign, Friendly, Honest, Patient
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1471
purple *violet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927

pyjamas *le pyjama*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1477

Q

quarter past — literally "and a quarter" *et quart*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
quarter to — literally "minus the quarter" *moins le quart*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
quel, quelle — which
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
quiet, peaceful *tranquille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1459

R

rain *la pluie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
rarely *rarement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1087
raw *cru / crue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1117
Reading — Instructions, a Form, and a First Paragraph
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 423
ready *prêt / prête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1621
really *vraiment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1285
recently *récemment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
recycling *le recyclage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1681
red — and English red is not a lookalike but an actual cousin *rouge*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
rest *le repos*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1081
Restaurant, Hotel, Pharmacy, Village, Post office
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 747

Result, Difference, Example, Truth, Lie
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1657
Return, Arrival, Departure, Destination, Landscape
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1537
rice *le riz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
rich *riche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Right, Left, World, Journey, Holidays
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 803
ripe *mûr / mûre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1303
Roof, Garden, Lamp, Bathroom, Bedroom
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 583
rough *rugueux / rugueuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1615
round *rond*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
Rubber, Homework, Answer, Idea, Problem
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 907
rubbish *les déchets*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1681
Rubbish, Recycling, Energy, Electricity, Gas
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1681
rude *impoli / impolie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Radio
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 809
Rule, Permission, Ban, Safety, Advice
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1159

S

sad *triste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 475
Sad, Pleased, Daughter, Grandfather, Grandmother
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 475
sadness *la tristesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
safe, sure *sûr / sûre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
safety *la sécurité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1159

Salad, Pasta, Cream, Pepper, Walnut
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 571
salt — masculine, cousin of English salt by common descent, and the source of a salary story no ancient writer actually tells *le sel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
salty *salé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
Salty, Bitter, Round, Square, Dry
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 705
***salut* — let your eye and hand meet one known word**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
***salut* — look, hide, write, compare**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
***salut* — one supported copy**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
sand *le sable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
Sandwich, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 877
Saturday — the Sabbath day *samedi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
scissors *les ciseaux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1477
Scissors, Watch, Pyjamas, Button, Peach
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1477
Sea, Stone, Sand, Beach, Island
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 633
Second, Change (coins), Date, Century, Email
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 957
see you later (literally "to more late") *à plus tard*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
see you soon (literally "to well-soon") *à bientôt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 45
see you tomorrow (literally "to tomorrow") *à demain*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
seize / dix-sept — the seam
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 15, p. 173
September — the month that still says "seven" *septembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
serious *sérieux / sérieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1291
seven *sept*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73

seventeen — the number where French stops inheriting and starts building *dix-sept*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
seventy *soixante-dix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
shame *la honte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1267
shampoo *le shampooing*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 827
Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey, Bee
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 663
Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1309
shoes *les chaussures*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
Shop, School, Bank, Train, Aeroplane
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 735
Shower, Bathtub, Wardrobe, Shelf, Curtain
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 815
shy *timide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1291
silent *silencieux / silencieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1615
Silent, Clean, Hard, Smooth, Rough
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1615
silk *la soie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1183
similar *semblable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1621
Similar, Fair, False, Ready, Free of charge
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1621
simple *simple*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1297
Simple, Complicated, Necessary, Useful, Useless
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1297
since, for *depuis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1273
single *célibataire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1123
sir and madam — my lord and my lady, worn down, and the two words French uses where English uses a surname *Monsieur, Madame*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
sister — the one family word that broke the pattern *la sœur*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141

Sitting, Standing, Opening, Closing
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 313
six *six*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
sixteen — the last word French inherited already welded *seize*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
sixty *soixante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
size; the waist *la taille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
skin *la peau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
Skin, Nail, Chin, Throat, Cheek
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 445
sleep *le sommeil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
smoke *la fumée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1357
smooth *lisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1615
snow *la neige*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
So, However, Anyway, On the contrary, Although
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1099
so-so (literally "like this, like that") *comme ci, comme ça*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
so, therefore *donc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
soap *le savon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
society *la société*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1483
Society, Government, Law, Court, Judge
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1483
socks *les chaussettes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
Socks, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 771
Soft, Dirty, Young, Kind, Narrow
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 693
soft; mild; sweet *doux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
sometimes *parfois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729

Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 271
spicy *épicé / épicée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1117
Spoon, Knife, Fork, Bottle, Cup
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 601
sport *le sport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
spring — literally "the first time" *le printemps*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
square *carré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
Standing Alone
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 407
still, again *encore*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
stomach — masculine, nasal like la main but through a different vowel, and the word that closes four chapters of everyday nouns *le ventre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
strange *étrange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1465
Strawberry, Cherry, Melon, Garlic, Flour
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 865
strong *fort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Strong, Weak, Rich, Poor, Grey
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 687
success *le succès*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1333
suddenly *soudain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1273
sugar — masculine, closing a chapter where every drink-word is; the fourth and longest road of the four *le sucre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 32, p. 323
sujet, verbe, objet — the order that carries the meaning
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
summer — literally "the heat" *l'été*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
Sun, Star, Cloud, Rain, Snow
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 639
Sunday — the Lord's day *dimanche*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
Supermarket, Cinema, Stadium, Swimming pool, Grocer's shop
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 785

suppletion — three verbs in a trench coat
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 19, p. 229
sweet (with sugar) *sucré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
swimming *la natation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1189

T

Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 287
talkative *bavard / bavarde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1627
Tax, Form, Envelope, Stamp, Parcel
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1663
tea — masculine, and the drink whose name split in two depending which Chinese port a trader dealt with *le thé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
Teach, Drink, Eat, Give, Live
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 505
Telling the Time
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 101
temperature *la température*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1315
ten *dix*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
thank you *merci*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
the bill *l'addition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1633
the brain *le cerveau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
the chest *la poitrine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
the chin *le menton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
the climate *le climat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1525
The Compound Past
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 213
the day before yesterday *avant-hier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
The Days of the Week
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 89

the economy *l'économie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1639
the emergency department *les urgences*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1609
the environment *l'environnement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1525
the face *le visage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
The First Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 63
the flag, in order — and two of its three colours are loanwords *bleu, blanc, rouge*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 183
the floor, the ground *le sol*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
The Four Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 133
the future *l'avenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 995
the government *le gouvernement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1483
the hand — feminine despite ending in a consonant, and the root of half the words you know *la main*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 259
the head — from Latin for a clay pot *la tête*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 259
the left *la gauche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
the liver *le foie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
the (masculine / feminine / plural) *le / la / les*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
The Months: Caesars and Counting
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 123
The Months: Gods and Beginnings
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 113
The months that are off by two
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
the Moon (feminine) *la lune*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 89
the morning *le matin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711

the neck *le cou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
the north *le nord*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
The Past That Takes être
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 245
The People You Introduce
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 329
the police *la police*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
the post office *la poste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
the rent *le loyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
the return *le retour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1537
the right *la droite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
the sales *les soldes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1339
the same *pareil / pareille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1465
the same two Latin verbs, and the opposite solution — Spanish kept them apart *être / ser · estar*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 19, p. 229
The same writing, with a clock
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 47, p. 429
the sea *la mer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
the south *le sud*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
the stairs *l'escalier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
the stomach *l'estomac*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
the suburbs *la banlieue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1447
the sun *le soleil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
the throat *la gorge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
the town hall *la mairie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
the truth *la vérité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1657

the underground, the metro *le métro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 779
The Welded Teens
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 161
the west *l'ouest*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
the wind *le vent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
the world *le monde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
then *puis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
there is, there are — literally it has there, and the y is a Latin word for there that survives nowhere else *il y a*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
they are — the hiss against ils ont's buzz *ils sont, elles sont*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
they have — the form that refuses to look like the rest *ils ont, elles ont*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
Thin, Big, Heavy, Light, Sweet
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 699
thin, slim *mince*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
thirst *la soif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
thirteen — three-ten, with both halves now legible *treize*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
thirty *trente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
this evening *ce soir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
this is, that is — ce plus est, with the elision you have been hearing since l'eau *c'est*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
Thread, Needle, Nail for hammering, Hammer, Ladder
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1531
three *trois*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
three languages, one retreat — and it spread by contact, not coincidence *passé simple · Präteritum · passato remoto*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 18, p. 213
Three More Ways to Use a Verb
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 391

thunder *le tonnerre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1525
Thursday — the day of Jupiter *jeudi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
tiredness *la fatigue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
to achieve *réaliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1411
to act *agir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to add *ajouter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1219
to admire *admirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to advise *conseiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to allow *permettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1213
to announce *annoncer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1219
to answer *répondre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to appear *apparaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1219
to applaud *applaudir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1399
To applaud, To cross, To increase, To decrease, To warn
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1399
to ask — an ordinary, polite, everyday word, and one of the sharpest false friends French holds for an English speaker *demander*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 287
to, at — one letter, Latin ad, and the accent that keeps it apart from the verb a *à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
to attempt *tenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1417
to avoid *éviter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1225
To Be, and the Three Verbs Inside It
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 229
to be bored *s'ennuyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025

To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to be born *naître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1393
To be born, To die, To grow old, To marry, To divorce
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1393
to be enough *suffire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1567
To be enough, To burn, To throw away, To calculate, To hit
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1567
to be silent *se taire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1417
To be silent, To fear, To attempt, To transport, To kill
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1417
to be worth *valoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1585
to begin *commencer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 969
to believe *croire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to bleed *saigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to blush *rougir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to book *réserver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1381
To book, To spend, To save, To order, To dry
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1381
to borrow *emprunter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1255
to brake *freiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to break *casser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1387
To break, To touch, To taste, To heat, To cool down
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1387
to breathe *respirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to build *construire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1549
to burn *brûler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1567

to buy *acheter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to calculate *calculer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1567
to call / to call oneself *(s')appeler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
to carry; to wear *porter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to celebrate *fêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1243
to change *changer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1207
to chase *poursuivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to chat *bavarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to check *vérifier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1555
to clean *nettoyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to close — from Latin firmāre, "to make firm," so a French door is not shut but made fast; the same verb gave Italian "to stop" and Spanish "to sign" *fermer*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to come back *revenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to come near *s'approcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to compare *comparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to complain *se plaindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to continue *continuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to convince *convaincre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to cook *cuisiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to cool down *refroidir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1387
to correct *corriger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1243

To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1243
to cough *tousser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1597
To cough, To tremble, To scream, To vote, To welcome
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1597
to count *compter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to criticise *critiquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to cross *traverser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1399
to cry *pleurer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to cut *couper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to decide *décider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to decrease *diminuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1399
to defend *défendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1255
to deliver *livrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to depend *dépendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1225
To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1225
to deserve *mériter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1573
to destroy *détruire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1243
to die *mourir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1393
to direct *diriger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1243
to disappear *disparaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1255
to discover *découvrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to discuss *discuter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019

to divorce *divorcer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1393
to do one's hair *se coiffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1561
to download *télécharger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1249
to draw *dessiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to dream *rêver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to drink *boire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to drive *conduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to dry *sécher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1381
to eat *manger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to empty *vider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1555
To enjoy, To imagine, To point out, To inform, To complain
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to enjoy, to make the most of *profiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to exaggerate *exagérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1243
to exchange *échanger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1249
to exist *exister*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1435
to explain *expliquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to express *exprimer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1435
to fear *craindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1417
to feed *nourrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1603
to feel; to smell *sentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to fill *remplir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1555

to fill in a form *remplir un formulaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
To fill, To empty, To measure, To weigh, To check
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1555
to find *trouver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
to finish — and the second regular family, which grows an extra syllable in the plural *finir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
To fix, To brake, To function, To float, To chase
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to fix, to stare at *fixer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to float *flotter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to fly, to steal *voler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1579
to fold *plier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to forbid *interdire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1213
to foresee, to plan for *prévoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
to forget *oublier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to function, to work *fonctionner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1423
to get angry *se fâcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to get dressed *s'habiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to get used to *s'habituer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1585
to get worse *empirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1573
to give *donner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to give a present *offrir un cadeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1411
to give back *rendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1411
to give up *renoncer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1249
To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1249

to go (and, oddly, "to be" in "how are you?") *aller*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
to go for a walk *se promener*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to go on holiday *partir en vacances*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1603
to go with *accompagner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1219
to greet *saluer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1201
to grow old *vieillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1393
to happen, to occur *se produire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
To Have, and How Old You Are
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 195
to have fun *s'amuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to hear — from a Latin verb meaning "to stretch toward," so English's intend is its closest surviving cousin, and French still keeps the older sense in entendu and s'entendre *entendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 303
to heat *chauffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1387
to help — English aid arriving by the Latin road, while English help came by the Germanic one; the two words are unrelated *aider*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 287
to hide *cacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to hit, to knock *frapper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1567
to hold *tenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1207
to hope *espérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to hurry *se dépêcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1585
to imagine *imaginer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to improve *améliorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1573
to increase *augmenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1399

to inform *informer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to insist *insister*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1591
To insist, To interrupt, To tie, To mix, To obey
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1591
to interrupt *interrompre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1591
to introduce *présenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1231
to invite *inviter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1201
to iron *repasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1549
To iron, To repair, To build, To photograph, To repeat
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1549
to joke *plaisanter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1603
to jump *sauter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to kill *tuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1417
to kiss *embrasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1201
To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1201
to know (a fact) *savoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to know (a person, a place) *connaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 975
to laugh *rire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
to learn *apprendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to leave (something); to let *laisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to lend *prêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1231
to lift *soulever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1429
To lift, To surprise, To suspect, To squeeze, To suggest
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1429

to like AND to love — one French verb where English keeps two, so the strength comes from what follows it, and adding bien makes it WEAKER *aimer*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 287
to listen to *écouter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to live *vivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to live / to dwell (a second -er verb — same pattern) *habiter*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to look at, to watch *regarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to look for *chercher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to look like *ressembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1237
To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1237
to lose *perdre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to lose weight *maigrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1603
To lose weight, To feed, To go on holiday, To joke, To tidy up
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1603
to lower *baisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to maintain *entretenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1435
to marry *épouser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1393
to measure *mesurer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1555
to meet *rencontrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to miss, to be missing *manquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1573
To miss, To deserve, To improve, To get worse, To offer
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1573
to mix *mélanger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1591
to move away *s'éloigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1049

to move back *reculer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to move forward *avancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to move house *déménager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1561
To move house, To rent, To rest, To wake up, To do one's hair
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1561
to move (something) *déplacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1207
to notice *remarquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to obey *obéir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1591
to observe *observer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to offer *offrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1573
to open — an -ir verb that takes -er endings, from a Latin verb reshaped to look like its own opposite, and the source of English overt and overture *ouvrir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to order *commander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1381
to organise *organiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
to overtake *dépasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1237
to own *posséder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to paint *peindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to park *garer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1201
to pay *payer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to phone *téléphoner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to photograph *photographier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1549

to pick (flowers, fruit) *cueillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1255
to pick up *ramasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1231
to play *jouer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to plug in *brancher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to point out *indiquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1405
to pray *prier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to prefer *préférer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to prepare *préparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1231
To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1231
to promise *promettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1213
To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1213
to propose *proposer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1231
to protect *protéger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1213
to prove *démontrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to pull *tirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1237
to push *pousser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1237
to put on weight *grossir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1435
to put; to put on *mettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to put up (a guest) *héberger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to quarrel *se disputer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to reach *atteindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1411

To reach, To achieve, To give a present, To give back, To recognise
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1411
to read — from a Latin verb that first meant "to gather," which is why reading, electing, collecting and being elegant all turn out to be the same act *lire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to realise *se rendre compte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1585
to receive *recevoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to recognise *reconnaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1411
to recommend *recommander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to record *enregistrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1435
To record, To maintain, To exist, To express, To put on weight
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1435
to reduce *réduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1579
To reduce, To refuse, To risk, To solve, To fly
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1579
to refuse *refuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1579
to rent *louer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1561
to repair *réparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1549
to repeat *répéter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1549
to replace *remplacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to rescue *sauver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1213
to rest *se reposer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1561
to risk *risquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1579
to run — Latin currere, the root under current, course, courier and curriculum, and the verb that shows why chien palatalized its c and courir did not *courir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 303
to save (money) *économiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1381

to scream *hurler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1597
to seem *sembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to send *envoyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to serve *servir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to share *partager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1225
to shout *crier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to show *montrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to sign *signer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to sit down — a verb you do to yourself, from Latin sedēre, and the one French verb that ships with two accepted sets of forms *s'asseoir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to ski *skier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1249
to sleep — Latin dormīre, unchanged in French, and the source of dormitory and dormant, though not of the dormouse *dormir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 303
to slip *glisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1249
to slow down *ralentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to smile *sourire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to smoke *fumer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to snow *neiger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1219
To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1219
to solve *résoudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1579
to speak / to talk (your first regular -er verb) *parler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to spend (money) *dépenser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1381

to squeeze *serrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1429
to stand — French has no single verb for it, so the movement is se lever ("to lighten yourself") and the state is être debout, literally "on end" *se lever, debout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to stir, to move *bouger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1255
To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1255
to stop *arrêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1207
To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1207
to study *étudier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to suffer *souffrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to suggest *suggérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1429
to surprise *surprendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1429
to suspect *soupçonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1429
to switch off, to put out *éteindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to switch on, to light *allumer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to take off, to remove *enlever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1207
to take part *participer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to take — the grasping verb English borrowed a dozen times over, from prehensile to prison to surprise *prendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 287
to taste *goûter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1387
to teach *enseigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to thank *remercier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1201

to think — from a Latin verb meaning "to weigh," which is why English pensive, ponder, compensate, expense and even the flower pansy all sit in one family *penser*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to throw *lancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1225
to throw away *jeter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1567
to tidy up *ranger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1603
to tie, to fasten *attacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1591
to touch *toucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1387
to translate *traduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to transport *transporter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1417
to tremble *trembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1597
to try *essayer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to turn *tourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1225
to understand — literally com- + prendre, "to take together," so in French understanding IS grasping, and the verb conjugates exactly like the one it is built from *comprendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to unite *unir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1585
To unite, To be worth, To get used to, To realise, To hurry
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1585
to use *utiliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to visit (a place) *visiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to vote *voter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1597
to wait for *attendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to wake up *se réveiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1561

to walk — and also to work, so ça marche is the most useful two words in the chapter; its own origin is genuinely unsettled between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer *marcher*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 303
to want — and why je voudrais is the form you will actually use *vouloir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
to warn *prévenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1399
to wash *laver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to waste *gaspiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1237
to weigh *peser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1555
to welcome *accueillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1597
to win; to earn *gagner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to work (a third -er verb — and the origin of "travel") *travailler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 5, p. 63
to worry *s'inquiéter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to write — Latin scrībere, "to scratch," with a propped-up é- that French added in front of every borrowed sc-, sp- and st- word *écrire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
today *aujourd'hui*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
together *ensemble*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1453
Tool, Guitar, Piano, Violin, Drum
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1687
toothpaste *le dentifrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 827
Toothpaste, Shampoo, Comb, Bin, Broom
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 827
Tortoise, New, Old, Fast, Easy
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 675
Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain, River
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 627
trei-ze — which half is which
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 14, p. 161

trousers *le pantalon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
Trousers, Shoes, Hat, Coat, Skirt
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 765
Trunk, Thorn, Lawn, Path, Cave
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1675
trust *la confiance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1267
Tuesday — the day of Mars *mardi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
twelve — the second welded teen, and the one that shows the pattern *douze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
twenty — a single inherited word again, and the base French will later count in *vingt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
two *deux*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Two Ideas, One Sentence
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 383

U

uncomfortable *inconfortable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
underneath *dessous*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
une heure — one o'clock
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 8, p. 101
une question — the question you make with your voice alone
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
une seule règle — both halves are the same fact
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
unfortunately *malheureusement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1285
unknown *inconnu / inconnue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
unpleasant *désagréable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
until *jusqu'à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1273
up there *là-haut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1447

useful *utile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1297
useless *inutile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1297

V

Vacuum, Laundry, Washing powder, Iron, Pocket
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 833
Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1315
Vase, Plant, Seed, Root, Branch
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1519
vegetables *les légumes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Verbs of the Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 295
(vert, jaune, continued) — jaune
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 283
very — Latin trans, 'across', which crossed over into an intensifier and takes no de at all *très*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
vīgintī — the number French counts in
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
vinegar *le vinaigre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1177

W

Want, Can, Must
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 359
war *la guerre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1141
War, Peace, Army, Soldier, Tradition
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1141
washing powder; the washing *la lessive*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
water — the most worn-down word French ever took from Latin *l'eau*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153

we are — and the only plural that keeps the regular ending *nous sommes*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
we have — and the ending is finally something you can hear *nous avons*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
weak *faible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 275
weather — le temps means BOTH "time" and "weather," the SAME Latin tempus polysemy as Spanish's tiempo; il pleut keeps Latin's pl- UNCHANGED, unlike Spanish's llueve *le temps, il pleut*
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 275
Wednesday — the day of Mercury *mercredi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
well / good / fine *bien*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
wet *mouillé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
Wet, Week, Month, Morning, Always
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 711
what's your name? (literally "how do you call yourself?") *comment vous appelez-vous?*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
what, standing on its own — the stressed twin of que, and the one that survives after a preposition *quoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
What the Ear Cannot Hear
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 399
what — the partner of qui, and the one that always elides *que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
Wheel, Engine, Toll, Motorway, Fine
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1513
when — and a silent d that comes back to life *quand*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
where — and the accent that separates it from a completely different word *où*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Where French Changes Its Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 173
Where Two Words Melt Into One
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 375

which one *lequel / laquelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
white — a Germanic word in a Latin language, running against the traffic *blanc*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
who — Latin quis, unchanged in twenty centuries, and the shortest question in French *qui*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
why — and the answer word that is built to match it *pourquoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Wind, Fire, Hill, Desert, Wave
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 645
wine — the word that refused to wear down, in any language *le vin*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153
winter — literally "the wintry season" *l'hiver*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
with a cold *enrhumé / enrhumée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1123
wool *la laine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1183
worried *inquiet / inquiète*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1123
Worried, With a cold, Single, Married, Divorced
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1123
Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Moves Nothing
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 431
Writing — My Own Line
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 427
Writing — With A Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 429

Y

yes *oui*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 22, p. 265
Yes and No
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 265
yesterday *hier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
Yesterday, Often, Sometimes, Town, Street
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 729

you are — and the circumflex marks the s that used to be there *vous êtes*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
you are — two letters, and it sounds like a single vowel *tu es*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
you (familiar / formal) *tu / vous*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
you have — plural, and polite to one person *vous avez*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
you have — the informal one, and it sounds exactly like the last one *tu as*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
you're welcome (literally "of nothing") *de rien*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
young *jeune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
Your own line — the first writing with no model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 46, p. 427

Z

-ze — the ten you keep meeting
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
zero *zéro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
Zero, Sixty, Seventy, Ninety, Thousand
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 963

Other

œ — one letter, not two
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 141